

THE
MARCUS GARVEY
AND
UNIVERSAL NEGRO
IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION
PAPERS

Caribbean Series

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Volume XII

The Caribbean Diaspora

1920–1921

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THE PEOPLE OF THE CARIBBEAN

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The final stages of production depended upon the expertise of several individuals. In preparing photographs and illustrations for publication, Freida Ibanez demonstrated rare skill as designer. Chase Langford expertly prepared the maps for each of the volumes.

Duke University Press and its staff have once again proved what an important part academic publishing plays in the larger scholarly enterprise. The project's sponsoring editor, Ken Wissoker, and Valerie Millholland, senior editor of Duke University Press, facilitated an otherwise arduous process by assisting with the various arrangements at every step of the production and

publication process. Mark Mastromarino proofed the pages and prepared the index. Typesetting was done by Kalina Klamann and Bytheway Publishing Services.

Supervision of a large historical documentary editing project brings with it many responsibilities that place administrative demands on the academic institution and department with which it is affiliated.

Finally, the project wishes to acknowledge the institutional sponsors of the edition as well as the generous assistance received from private foundations in support of the project's work. We should like to thank the National Endowment for the Humanities, National Historical Publications and Records Commission, and the Ford, Rockefeller, Ahmanson, and UCLA Foundations.

INTRODUCTION

The present volume marks the second volume to be published of the Caribbean Series within the larger edition of *The Marcus Garvey and Universal Negro Improvement Association Papers*. It covers a period of twelve months, from the opening of the UNIA's historic first international convention in New York, held in August 1920, to Marcus Garvey's return to the U.S. in mid-July 1921 after an extended sojourn in the Caribbean and Central America. It was a period marked by some glittering political triumphs, but also by intensifying financial problems that would undercut those political gains. The documents in the present volume display both sides of this dual dynamic as it unfolded in both the U.S. and the Caribbean.

The August 1920 convention in many ways marked the high-point of the Garvey movement in the U.S., while Garvey's tour of the Caribbean, in the winter and spring of 1921, registered the greatest outpouring of popular support for the UNIA in its history. In this sense, the period covered in the present volume represents the moment of political apotheosis for the movement, but also the moment when the finances of Garvey's Black Star Line went into free-fall.

The preceding volume, the first of the Caribbean Series, culminated in July 1920, on the eve of the UNIA's historic convention of August 1920. The first volume traced the political and organizational preparation leading up to the convention; by the time that the convention opened, the entire apparatus of the UNIA had moved into high gear for an event unprecedented in the annals of the black world. Only two years previously, Marcus Garvey was still a political unknown; by 1920, he had been transformed into a figure of international political significance, and was arguably the most famous black man in the world.

The present volume shows the centrality of Caribbean people not only to the convention, but also to the movement of which the convention itself was the organizational expression. The reports to the convention discussed the range of social and economic conditions obtaining in the Caribbean, particularly their impact on racial conditions. The quality of the discussions and debates were impressive. Contained in these reports are some of the earliest and most clearly enunciated statements in defense of social and political freedom in the Caribbean. These documents form a hitherto underappreciated and still underutilized record of the political awakening of Caribbean people of African descent.

The convention's message was embodied most eloquently in its "Declaration of Independence," formally known as the "Declaration of Rights of the Negro Peoples of the World," with its forthright claim for international recognition of the rights of blacks. The declaration marks in many ways the high point, ideologically, of the entire Garvey phenomenon.

The spirit emanating from the convention would find an echo in the Caribbean. J. Ralph Casimir, in his statement "What Ails Dominica?" with its call for the defense of popular liberties, was the leader of Dominica's UNIA division. Casimir would render outstanding literary and organizational service to the movement not only in Dominica, but also throughout the eastern Caribbean. His work stands out among the documents recorded in the present volume. Published and disseminated through the pages of the *Negro World*, Casimir's article created a profound impression on its readers. Letters from UNIA members in St. Vincent, and Trinidad, for example, speak of a deep sense of gratitude and admiration for articulating what many people in the Caribbean had been feeling, but felt unable to express. Casimir's essay pointed to the deep pool of dissatisfaction with colonial rule in the Caribbean that emerged following the trauma of the Great War of 1914-18. Response to its publication confirms the way in which the UNIA served as a vehicle for channeling popular dissatisfaction while incubating a whole new generation of leaders.

Official reprisals against leaders of the movement was swift in the aftermath of the convention. Thus, in Bermuda, in October 1920, the AME church revoked all previous honors and privileges granted to Rev. Richard Hilton Tobitt, following his election as "Leader of the West Indies (Eastern Province)" by the UNIA convention in New York. That same month the Governor of Bermuda cut all funding for the St. George Elementary School run by Rev. Tobitt, due to Tobitt's membership in the UNIA. Thereafter, Rev. Tobitt would serve as a sort of roving ambassador of the UNIA, travelling to Guyana and Trinidad to spread the gospel of Garveyism (Trinidad took the precaution of banning him from landing in its territory).

Not the least affected by the reverberations that radiated from the convention in New York were officials in the imperial metropolis as well as the colonial outposts of empire in the Caribbean. One month after the conclusion of the convention, the Colonial Office requested that the British Foreign Office secure copies of the UNIA's "Constitution and Book of Laws" for its use and that of the "Director of Intelligence." The range and variety of intelligence reports generated in this critical period help to provide a detailed map of the movement's spread as well as the aspects of the movement that engendered official anxiety. These reports resulted from the tracking of the movement from its headquarters in the U.S. by officials and diplomats working in close consultation. As the movement spread from the U.S. to encompass all of the territories making up the British West Indies and territories where there were concentrations of West Indian migrant communities, such as in Cuba, Haiti,

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the Dominican Republic, Puerto Rico, Panama, Costa Rica, Guatemala, and along the entire Caribbean littoral of Central America, keeping track of something as variegated as the UNIA and monitoring its far flung and at the same time local manifestations and networks of communication was not easy. The transnational character of the movement was revealed in the sustained political discourse that emanated from all these separate as well as overlapping jurisdictions.

A whole new phase in the intelligence monitoring of the UNIA was thus launched in the aftermath of the August 1920 convention. As a consequence, police reports from across the region form a significant portion of the documentation of the present volume. These reports were, essentially, political documents that not only describe the array of UNIA activities, but also identify the leaders of the movement as well as its local composition.

By this time, Garvey's *Negro World* newspaper was already officially proscribed in several territories. Copies had to be smuggled through the post and carried by black seamen travelling aboard vessels from the U.S. In Trinidad, invoking the seditious publications law, government authorities began searching the private residences of individuals suspected of having copies of the *Negro World*, the *Messenger*, and the *Crusader*, all of them proscribed under the law. The authorities in Trinidad also refused a petition from the UNIA to register as a Friendly Society.

One of the highlights of official surveillance in this period of rapid expansion of the UNIA in the Caribbean was the coverage devoted to the setting up and inauguration of local UNIA branches. The unveiling of the charter for each local division was always the occasion for an immense outpouring of popular support. As the day of the unveiling approached and members marshaled themselves, huge throngs of people gathered for the celebration, making each of these events in turn not only a truly historic occasion, but also an affirmation of cultural identity. In the documents that make up the present volume, official reports as well as reports published in the *Negro World* describe the unveiling of charters of several divisions. In chronological order, the divisions for which the present volume contains reports on the occasion of their charters being unveiled are: Roseau, Dominica; Castries, St. Lucia; San José, Costa Rica; Guaico, Trinidad; Belize, British Honduras; Bridgetown, Barbados; St. Thomas, Virgin Islands; Basseterre, St. Kitts; Hamilton, Bermuda; Guantánamo, Cuba; Tela, Honduras; Colón, Panama; Port-au-Prince, Haiti; Ciego de Avila, Cuba; and Niquero, Cuba.

Likewise, the concert programs organized by local UNIA divisions brought out large crowds of people, and the police reports on these proceedings illuminate the various ways in which these events were turned into celebrations that drew upon the entire range of cultural resources available to each community. All across the Caribbean, as communities turned out for UNIA events, it became clear that the UNIA functioned as a kind of bulwark of the community. Particularly was this so in those countries where English-speaking

West Indians formed culturally and ethnically distinct communities. Thus, the reports provide a rich prism through which one is able to see the extraordinary range of social and cultural activities engaged in by the UNIA on a regular basis in each of the communities where it operated. Indeed, in many places the UNIA's local Liberty Hall functioned as the leading cultural center of the community, outside of the church.

In the reports of these community-based initiatives of local UNIA divisions, in which the cultural resources of the community were on display, women occupied a salient role. Clearly, the importance of women as key figures in the organization and leadership of the UNIA was what made it so dynamic and gave it such popular appeal. The documents in the present volume speak eloquently of the recognition attained by women in the various endeavors undertaken in all of the local UNIA divisions. The significance of gender in the articulation of the UNIA as a social movement finds a great deal of supporting documentation in the present volume.

The crux of the UNIA communication network between its headquarters in New York and its divisions spread across the entire Caribbean archipelago was the *Negro World* newspaper. It served as a mirror in which the members of the movement communicated with each other and were enabled to grasp both its worldwide and regional dimensions and the interplay between them. As the main conduit of the movement, the *Negro World* was also its bible. It comes as no surprise, therefore, that government officials were alert to the importance of the newspaper and sought to suppress and/or monitor its circulation and distribution. Indeed, even more numerous than the number of reports describing the meetings of local divisions were reports of the perceived risks posed to the maintenance of the colonial order by the newspaper's circulation.

Thus, the subject of political censorship and the mechanics of censorship of not only the *Negro World* but all race conscious publications is one that figures prominently in the coverage of the present volume—from seizures and confiscation of copies in the post and police searches of residences to prevent distribution of copies to outright bans against distribution imposed in several territories. People knew of the official proscription of the newspaper, and this knowledge served to sharpen their criticism of colonial rule and gave the idea of racial loyalty even greater intensity. On this issue of political censorship the opposition between officialdom and the popular was stark and unclouded. By people asking—why must not the *Negro World* be read—they were aroused and made more determined to find ways to circumvent and defeat the official barrier raised against the newspaper. In the end, censorship was to prove ineffective as well as politically counterproductive.

Disaffection toward the policy of censorship could be seen in the prolific contributions from Caribbean readers published in the weekly columns of the *Negro World*, making the newspaper a veritable pan-Caribbean vehicle of print opposition and nationalist formation across the whole region. Even the discovery of two or three copies of the *Negro World* was enough in certain territories

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to cause major anxiety. In spite of the various preventive measures, it is clear from the reports in the present volume that the *Negro World* achieved a fairly large circulation in the Caribbean.

The importance of the work performed by the *Negro World* in spreading the gospel of the Garvey movement in the Caribbean, while simultaneously promoting the various drives of the UNIA, cannot be exaggerated. In a real sense, Garveyism came into the Caribbean in the form of the *Negro World*, a newspaper. Although the ships of the Black Star Line might not arrive, clandestine copies of the *Negro World*, however fugitive, would come. In this way, the UNIA became woven into the Caribbean culture of literacy and political discourse. Long before there was any overt nationalist mobilization or movement in the Caribbean, there was a bedrock culture of literacy that was celebrated. Garveyism in the colonial Caribbean never pretended to represent a direct challenge to colonial rule. Thus, rather than some sort of 'failed' political movement, the UNIA should be seen as part of a political culture in the making that to a large extent was fuelled by the popular quest for and enjoyment of literacy, of which the struggle over the denial of access to the *Negro World* was just one expression of the way that the UNIA acted as a conduit for the cultural aspirations of Caribbean people.

The bulk of the volume is taken up with Garvey's tour of Cuba, Jamaica, Panama, Costa Rica, and Belize in the winter and spring of 1921. Garvey left the U.S. at the end of February 1921, and he did not return until the middle of July. It was not Garvey's intention to spend this much time away from his base of operations in New York, but once it became J. Edgar Hoover's declared policy of preventing his reentry into the U.S., Garvey found himself denied a visa whenever he applied to U.S. consulates in the region, until his legal representatives in the U.S. succeeded with the U.S. department of state in surmounting Hoover's opposition. It took months before this could be achieved, during which time Garvey was delayed time and again from returning. It came at an especially critical time for the movement, particularly for the fate of the Black Star Line back in New York, as events would shortly prove.

The purpose of the trip ostensibly was to raise funds for the "Liberian Construction Loan," also known as the "African Liberty Loan," which had as its goal the raising of \$2,000,000 from UNIA members to build railroads, schools, churches, and other infrastructure in Liberia in preparation for the UNIA's African colonization program in Liberia. More immediately, the purpose was to sell shares in the Black Star Line to shore up its rapidly foundering finances. Away from the giddy euphoria in which the UNIA's August 1920 convention was swept up, storm clouds were fast gathering over the financial affairs of the Black Star Line. While Liberty Hall in Harlem reverberated daily with impassioned calls for "Africa for the Africans, those at home and abroad," the Black Star Line, the centerpiece of which the movement's hopes for economic independence were symbolically pinned, teetered on the brink of collapse. Three days before the UNIA convention adopted the historic declaration and

delegates affixed their signatures to the document amid great fanfare, the Black Star Line steamer S.S. *Yarmouth* arrived at the port of Charleston, South Carolina, having made a detour on its return trip to the U.S. from Haiti. Originally, the ship was intended to land in New York, but short of coal and provisions and with a case of smallpox on board the ship, the *Yarmouth* was forced to put in at Charleston. Indebted for supplies and other expenses that the Black Star Line was unable to pay, the vessel was thereupon libeled. A few days later, Luc Dorsinville resigned his position as manager of the Black Star Line in Haiti, giving as his reason the treatment meted out to Haitian passengers who had purchased tickets with the intention of going to New York.

From Garvey's perspective, the situation looked rather different going the other way, namely, going from the U.S. to the Caribbean. From the moment that he landed in Havana, Cuba, at the beginning of March 1921, until the time that he returned to the U.S., four and a half months later, Garvey's visit proved a spectacular triumph. Everywhere he went, huge crowds of people flocked to see and hear him. The sizes of audiences that turned out to hear him speak, and did so consistently, far exceeded what any West Indian had ever achieved. Nothing quite like it had been witnessed before in the Caribbean. The extensive newspaper coverage that attended his appearances wherever he visited was unprecedented, oftentimes reprinting verbatim large chunks, if not the entire texts, of his speeches. No West Indian before, and for a long time afterward, had ever excited people or raised their hopes in the way that Garvey did in the spring of 1921. Something new, a new kind of popular phenomenon, had presented itself.

Swept along on the crest of this wave of popular acclaim and enthusiasm, Garvey found a fertile environment in which to promote sales of stock in the Black Star Line. It would become the overriding, if not the sole, purpose of his tour, as the Black Star Line fleet hemorrhaged money at an ever more alarming rate. The vagaries, to say nothing of the mishaps that dogged the sailing of the Black Star Line vessel S.S. *Kanawha* (rechristened the S.S. *Antonio Maceo*) wherever it went on its tour of the Caribbean were emblematic of the deepening financial crisis in which the entire enterprise was engulfed. The documents in the present volume allow the reader to follow the vicissitudes of trying to keep the *Kanawha* afloat, while also keeping to anything like a formal travel schedule between appearances.

When the difficulty of securing a reentry visa to the U.S. is added to the host of problems bedeviling the *Kanawha*, it becomes clear why this was also a fraught time for Garvey. And yet, whatever difficulties and challenges he encountered on the tour in 1921, Garvey's supporters do not appear, for the most part, to have lost the least confidence in him, except where, in one instance, during his tour of Panama, he lost his temper and became overly demanding for payment before he would agree to speak, alienating those who had turned out and had waited to hear him speak.

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If the tour proved a personal triumph for Garvey, it also represented a historic vindication of the UNIA. Except for the crowds that turned out for parades of the UNIA conventions in Harlem, the outpouring of spontaneous support and the fervor of adherents exceeded anything seen elsewhere. The UNIA was never able again to draw crowds in the Caribbean on anything resembling the scale of 1921. It marked the height of the UNIA's influence in the Caribbean.

A final highlight of the volume is the coverage devoted to the UNIA in south Florida and its struggle for survival in the face of unrelenting racist terror. In June 1921, Rev. T. C. Glashen, a Honduran native and president of the UNIA Key West division, was arrested for "inciting a riot" and deported to Cuba in lieu of standing trial. While in Havana, Rev. Glashen testified to the racial terror inflicted by the Ku Klux Klan in Florida against the UNIA, leading up to his own arrest. The following month, on 2 July, Rev. Richard Higgs, the Bahamian Baptist preacher and president of the UNIA in Coconut Grove, Miami, was kidnapped, beaten, and ordered by his assailants to leave the U.S. Police subsequently arrested more than twenty-five armed black men who turned out to protest the beating of Rev. Higgs, though his white assailants were never apprehended. One week after the incident, Rev. Higgs, with his wife and five children, arrived in Nassau, Bahamas, from Miami.

The documents of both incidents provide a window into the functioning of the UNIA as an ethno-national protective association in the service of the migrant Bahamian community of south Florida at this critical juncture. At the same time, as the documents make plain, the racial violence of 1921 was played out against the backdrop of social tension between the African-American community and the ethnic Bahamian community.

HISTORY OF THE EDITION

The Marcus Garvey and Universal Negro Improvement Association (UNIA) Papers Project formally began in June 1976 at Northwestern University in Evanston, Illinois, under the sponsorship of the National Historical Publications and Records Commission. The edition was transferred the following year to the Center for Afro-American Studies, University of California, Los Angeles. Since 1981 it has been affiliated with the university's James S. Coleman African Studies Center under the sponsorship of the National Historical Publications and Records Commission and the National Endowment for the Humanities. The project has also received generous supporting grants from the Ahmanson, Ford, Rockefeller, and UCLA Foundations.

THE PAPERS

The Marcus Garvey and Universal Negro Improvement Association Papers is a multivolume edition organized along primarily geographical lines into three distinct but related series. The Main Series, published in seven volumes, covers Garvey's life and the historical evolution of the UNIA in North America. The African Series comprises three volumes devoted to the expansion of the Garvey movement in sub-Saharan Africa and among Africans residing in the European colonial metropolises during the interwar years. These volumes also include the responses of European imperial and colonial governments to the challenge posed by the African Garvey movement. The Caribbean Series covers the movement in the territories of the Caribbean basin, including the Central American littoral and South American mainland.

This tripartite structure of the edition reveals important differences in the Garvey movement's development in the United States, Africa, and the Caribbean. Although there were areas of overlap among the three regions, particularly in terms of the diverse ethnic origin of the leaders and followers resulting from interregional migration within the Americas and Africa, each region exhibited sufficiently distinctive patterns of development to justify separate but interrelated presentations.

The first two volumes of the Caribbean Series comprise over 1,000 documents, spanning the years from 1910 to 1921. They chronicle the complex and varied responses to Garveyism on the part of Caribbean-based organizations as well as the actions taken by European colonial governments to

defend their authority in response to the perceived threat of the Garvey phenomenon. The number of actual selected documents relating to each area appears in the following table; however, it is necessary to emphasize that many documents overlap, since they pertain to more than one particular area of interest:

DOCUMENTS BY COUNTRY

Bahamas	24	Guatemala	8
Barbados	60	Haiti	20
Bermuda	16	Honduras	6
Brazil	3	Leeward Islands	51
British Guiana	56	Panama and Canal Zone	167
British Honduras	71	Puerto Rico	14
Costa Rica	39	St. Lucia	22
Cuba	111	St. Vincent	35
Dominica	63	Trinidad and Tobago	67
Dominican Republic	78	U.S. Virgin Islands	19
Grenada	27	Other Countries	123

Following a general plan entitled “The Organization of a System of External Contributions to an Editing Project: A Summary of Research Findings,” which the project prepared in 1985 for the African Series, it was decided that the complexity and diversity of the Caribbean Series required the expertise of established scholars in the specialized fields covered by the documents. Although final responsibility for accuracy and editorial consistency resided with the project, many of the specialized annotations explicating Caribbean historical figures, events, and place-names were entrusted to scholars of Caribbean history in the Caribbean, United States, and Europe. The imperatives of establishing and maintaining clear editorial guidelines, achieving a steady flow of communication with contributors, and creating adequate editorial procedures for evaluating and vetting the resultant contributions were achieved with a great deal of effort on the part of both the project and its contributors.

The documents were divided primarily into regional or territorial groups and sent out to an initial group of scholars whom the project recruited to undertake the necessary annotation work. Consultants were also asked to prepare translations of the foreign-language documents that they were annotating as well as to write brief contextual essays, which appear in Volume XI under the caption “Historical Commentaries,” and which provide overviews of the historical impact of Garveyism within their respective areas. Most contributors worked from primary sources, some of which were provided by project research, resulting in a wealth of new historical findings that are here published for the first time.

HISTORY OF THE EDITION

In order to evaluate the quality of the annotations, external peer reviewers selected by the project were invited to read all contributing scholars' annotations and essays; to identify and correct errors and omissions; to supplement annotations and source notes when necessary; and to write reports assessing the quality and comprehensiveness of the submissions. The identity of peer reviewers was kept anonymous.

CONTRIBUTING SCHOLARS

Peter Ashdown, St. Mary's Hall, Brighton	British Honduras
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Richard Smith	World War I
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Nigel Westmaas, Binghamton University	British Guiana

EDITORIAL SELECTION, TRANSCRIPTION, AND ANNOTATION

The Caribbean Series is comprised of letters, speeches, and writings of Caribbean Garveyites and their opponents, as well as official UNIA documents and speeches by Marcus Garvey that have a direct bearing on the Caribbean. It also includes minute papers of officials; official correspondence and memoranda; government investigative records; legal documents; newspaper articles; and facsimiles of original documents. In the case of Caribbean newspaper articles, several of which were reprinted in the UNIA's *Negro World*, every effort was made to search systematically for the original newspaper sources. In some cases copies of the Caribbean newspapers have not survived or are impossible to locate. In keeping with its overall editorial principles, the policy of the project was to take the original newspaper sources, rather than the *Negro World* reprints, as the copy text wherever possible. The following table does not imply any hierarchy; it is merely a classification of included documents.

SELECTION OF DOCUMENTS BY CATEGORY

Government correspondence	319
Organizational correspondence	105
Personal correspondence	78
Official Reports and Documents	80
Organizational Records and Documents	80
Speeches and Poetry	4
Articles, Letters, and Poetry Published in Newspapers:	
African	3
African-American	2
Caribbean	216
<i>Negro World</i>	147
White American	3
Other	3
Editorials and Notices Published in Newspapers:	
Caribbean	21
<i>Negro World</i>	3

EDITORIAL PRINCIPLES AND PRACTICES

I. ARRANGEMENT OF DOCUMENTS

Documents are presented in chronological order according to the dates of authorship of the original texts. Enclosures and attachments to documents, however, appear with their original covering documents. For purposes of identification, enclosures are set in italic type in the table of contents. The publication dates of news reports, speeches, and periodical articles are given on the place and date lines within square brackets; dates of original composition or delivery, however, if available, chronologically supersede the dates of publication and are printed within double square brackets on the document's place and date lines.

Investigative or intelligence reports that give both the dates of composition and the periods covered by the reports are arranged according to the dates of composition.

Documents that lack dates and thus require editorial assignment of dates are placed in normal chronological sequence. When no day within a month appears on a document, the document is placed after the last document specifically dated within that month. Documents that carry only the date of a year are placed according to the same principle. Documents that cover substantial periods, such as diaries, journals, and accounts, appear according to the dates of their earliest entries.

When two or more documents possess the same date, they are arranged with regard to affinity with the subject of the document that immediately precedes them or that which immediately follows them.

II. FORM OF PRESENTATION

Each document is presented in the following manner:

- A. A caption introduces the document and is printed in a type size larger than the text. Letters between individuals are captioned with the names of the individuals and their titles, which are included only on first appearances. When the title but not the name of a document's author is known, the title

alone is given. The original titles of published materials are retained with the documents; however, the headlines of some news reports are abridged or omitted as indicated in the descriptive source notes.

- B. The text of a document follows the caption. The copy text of letters or reports is taken from recipients' copies whenever possible, but in the absence of a recipient's copy, a file copy of the letter or report is used. If the file copy is not available, however, and a retained draft copy of the letter is found, the retained draft copy is used as the basic text. File copies are referred to as copies or carbon copies in descriptive source notes.
- C. An unnumbered descriptive source note follows the body of each text. The descriptive source note describes the physical character of the document by means of appropriate abbreviations, such as TLS (typed letter signed). A complete list of these abbreviations may be found in the Descriptive Symbols section on page lvi. A repository symbol indicates the provenance of the original manuscript or, if it is rare, printed work.

Printed sources are identified in the following manners:

- 1. A contemporary pamphlet is identified by its full title, place and date of publication, and the location of the copy used.
- 2. A contemporary article, essay, letter, or other kind of statement that appeared originally in a contemporary publication is preceded by the words "Printed in . . . ," followed by the title, date, and, in the case of essays in magazines and journals, inclusive page numbers of the source of publication.
- 3. A contemporary printed source reprinted at a later date, the original publication of which has not been found, is identified with the words "Reproduced from . . . ," followed by the identification of the work from which the text has been reproduced in the volumes. Articles originally printed in Caribbean newspapers and reprinted in the *Negro World*, the originals of which have not been found, are identified in captions as coming from the Caribbean paper, with the *Negro World* source given in the descriptive source note.

Information on the special character or provenance of a document is also explained in the descriptive source note, as is any editorial intervention or elision regarding a document, such as "text abridged" or "headlines omitted."

- D. Numbered textual annotations that elucidate the document follow the descriptive source note.

E. The following principles of textual annotation apply:

1. Individuals, organizations, and historical events are identified upon their first mention in the volumes, with additional information about them sometimes furnished upon their later appearance where such data provide maximum clarification. Pseudonyms are identified, wherever possible, by textual annotations.
2. Elided material has in general been annotated, except in instances, such as diaries and some speeches, where it is clearly extraneous.
3. Reasons for the assignment of dates to documents or the correction of document dates are explained in instances where important historical information is involved.
4. Obscure allusions and literary or biblical references in the text are annotated whenever such references can be clarified or their source identified. Common or frequently cited biblical references are not annotated.
5. Published and manuscript materials consulted during the preparation of textual annotations appear in parentheses at the end of each annotation, except when they are cited directly, in which case reference immediately follows the quotation. Research correspondence conducted by Garvey Papers project staff members is cited in annotations. Frequently used reference works are cited in abbreviated forms, a complete table of which may be found on pages lvi–lviii.

III. TRANSCRIPTION OF TEXT

Manuscripts and printed material have been transcribed from original texts and printed as documents according to the following principles and procedures:

A. Manuscript Material

1. The place and date of composition are placed at the head of the document, regardless of their location in the original. If the place or date of a manuscript (or both) does not appear in the original text, the information is editorially supplied and printed within square brackets, in roman type if certain, in italics if uncertain or conjectural. Likewise, if either the place or date is incomplete, the necessary additional information is editorially supplied within square brackets. Original superscript letters are brought down to the line of type, and terminal punctuation is deleted.
2. In colonial government reports, investigative or intelligence reports, and other reports that were submitted on printed forms, the place and

date are abstracted and placed at the head of each document, while the name of the reporting agent or government official, when available, is placed at the end of the document on the signature line.

3. The signature, which is set in capitals and small capitals, is placed at the right-hand margin on the line beneath the text or complimentary close, with titles, where they appear, set in uppercase and lowercase on the line below. Terminal punctuation is deleted.
4. When a file copy of a document bearing no signature is used to establish the text but the signatory is known, the signature is printed in roman type within square brackets.
5. The inside address, or address printed on letterhead or other official stationery, is printed immediately below the text if historically significant and not repetitive.
6. Endorsements, dockets, and other markings appearing on official correspondence, when intelligible, are reproduced in small type following the address, with appropriate identification. In the case of other types of documents, such as private correspondence, endorsements and dockets are printed only when they are significant. Printed letterheads and other official stationery are not reproduced. They are sometimes briefly described in the descriptive source note or, if they contain lengthy or detailed information, in an annotation.
7. Minutes, enclosures, and attachments are printed immediately following their covering documents. Whenever they are not printed, this fact is recorded and explained. Whenever a transmission letter originally accompanying an enclosure or attachment is not printed, the omission is noted and the transmission document identified and recorded in the descriptive source note.
8. Proper names that are spelled erratically in the original text are regularized or corrected upon their first appearance in a document by printing the correct form in square brackets after the incorrect spelling. In words other than proper names, corrections of spelling irregularities are made within the word and printed within square brackets; however, typographical or spelling errors that contribute to the overall character of documents are retained. Accent marks missing in the original text have not been added.
9. Capitalization is retained as in the original. Words underlined once in a manuscript are printed in italics. Words that are underlined twice or spelled out in large letters or full capitals are printed in small capitals.
10. Punctuation, grammar, and syntax are retained as found in the original texts. Punctuation corrections that are essential to the accurate reading

of the text are provided within square brackets. If, however, a punctuation mark appears in a document as a result of typographical error, it is corrected in square brackets or silently deleted.

11. All contractions and abbreviations in the text are retained. Abbreviations of titles or organizations used in document heads are identified in a list that appears on pages lviii–lx. Persons represented in the text by initials only have their full names spelled out in square brackets after each initial on their first appearance, if we have been able to identify them. If we have not, this fact is noted in a textual annotation.
12. Superscript letters in the text are lowered and aligned on the line of print.
13. Omissions, mutilations, and illegible words or letters are rendered through the use of the following textual devices:
 - a) Blank spaces in a manuscript are shown as []. If the blank space is of significance or of substantial length, this fact is elaborated upon in a textual annotation.
 - b) When a word or words in the original text must be omitted from the printed document because of mutilation, illegibility, or omission, the omission is shown by editorial comment, such as: [torn], [illegible], [remainder missing].
 - c) Missing items are restored in the printed document within square brackets. A question mark following the restoration indicates that it is uncertain or conjectural.
14. Additions and corrections made by the author in the original text are rendered as follows:
 - a) Additions between the lines, or autograph insertions in a typewritten document, are brought onto the line of type and incorporated into the body of the text within diagonal lines // //.
 - b) Marginal additions or corrections by the author are also incorporated into the printed document and identified by the words [in the margin] italicized in square brackets. Marginal notes made by someone other than the author are treated as endorsements and printed after the text of the document.
 - c) Text deleted or altered in the original, as in a draft, is restored and indicated by canceled type at the place where the deletion or alteration occurs in the original text. If a lengthy deletion is illegible, this is indicated by the words [deletion illegible].

15. When texts have been translated from other languages, capitalization and punctuation have generally been changed to reflect English usage. Foreign-language titles of organizations have been kept in their original language. A concentrated effort has been made to render the spirit as well as the letter of the original, with particular attention paid to tone, style, and level of language proficiency, since such matters can convey a number of historically relevant meanings.

B. Printed Material

Contemporary printed material is treated in the same manner as original texts and is transcribed according to the same editorial principles as manuscript material. When the same article, or versions of the same article, appear in both a Caribbean and a non-Caribbean newspaper or magazine, the copy text is taken from the Caribbean source, when available, with the non-Caribbean source, as well as any differences between the two versions, described in the descriptive source note. However, if the non-Caribbean version was published before the Caribbean, the non-Caribbean version is the copy text used.

1. In the case of published letters, the place and date of composition are uniformly printed on the place and date line of the document, regardless of where they appear in the original, and placed within double square brackets. Elements that are editorially supplied are italicized.
2. Newspaper headlines and subheads are printed in capital and small capital letters. Headlines are punctuated as they are in the original, but terminal punctuation is deleted, and they are reproduced in the printed document in as few lines as possible. If they are editorially abridged, this is indicated in the descriptive source note.
3. Original small capitals are retained.
4. Signatures accompanying published letters are printed in capitals and small capitals.
5. Obvious typographical errors and errors of punctuation, such as the omission of a single parenthesis or quotation mark, are corrected and printed in roman type within square brackets. Typographical idiosyncrasies that reflect the page design of a magazine or newspaper article, such as the capitalization of the first word or words of an article, are silently regularized.
6. In the case of a printed form with spaces to be filled in, spaces are indicated as in the original with the use of hairline rules. Handwritten or typewritten insertions are printed within diagonal lines // //.

TEXTUAL DEVICES

[roman]	Editorial restoration of missing, mutilated, or illegible text. Correction of typographical errors in original manuscript or printed document. A question mark following a restoration or correction indicates that it is uncertain or conjectural. Also used to indicate known place and/or date of publication of a news report or periodical article, or known place and/or date of composition of a manuscript when the place and/or date is not given in the manuscript; or to identify unnamed individuals alluded to in text, or known signatory of a manuscript the text of which has been established on the basis of an unsigned file copy. When preceded by <i>in the margin</i> in italics, indicates marginalia brought into the line of type.
[<i>italic</i>]	Editorially assigned date and/or place of any document whose date and/or place of publication or composition is uncertain or conjectural. Editorial comment inserted in the text, such as [<i>endorsement</i>], [<i>illegible</i>], [<i>remainder missing</i>], [<i>torn</i>], [<i>enclosure</i>], [<i>attachment</i>], [<i>in the margin</i>].
[[roman]]	Known date and/or place of composition of a published letter, article, or news report, or delivery date of a speech, if publication date and/or place differs.
[[<i>italic</i>]]	Editorially assigned date and/or place of composition of a published letter, article, or news report, or delivery date of a speech, if publication date and/or place differs and date and/or place of composition or delivery is uncertain or conjectural.
// //	Incorporation into the text of an addition or correction made above or below the line by author, or of autograph insertions made in typewritten original.
canceled	Textual matter that is canceled in the original.
[. . .]	Text editorially abridged.
[]	Blank space in a document.

SYMBOLS AND ABBREVIATIONS

REPOSITORY SYMBOLS

The original locations of documents that appear in the text are described by symbols. The guide used for American repositories has been *Symbols of American Libraries*, 11th ed. (Washington D.C.: Library of Congress, 1976). Foreign repositories and collections have been assigned symbols that conform to the institutions' own usage. In some cases, however, it has been necessary to formulate acronyms. Acronyms have been created for private manuscript collections as well.

REPOSITORIES

AFRC	Federal Archives and Records Center, East Point, Georgia
RG 163	Records of the Selective Service System (World War I)
AGCA	Archivo General de Centro América, Guatemala City, Guatemala
AHPC	Archivo Histórico Provincial de Camagüey
RA	Fondo Registro de Asociaciones
AHPSC	Archivo Histórico Provincial de Santiago de Cuba
GP	Fondo Gobierno Provincial
AHPVC	Archivo Histórico Provincial de Villa Clara
RA	Registro de Asociaciones
ANC	Archivo Nacional de Cuba
RA	Fondo Registro de Asociaciones
ANCR	Archivo Nacional de Costa Rica
AP	Atlanta Federal Penitentiary Records, AFRC
ATT	Hollis Burke Frissell Library, Tuskegee Institute, Tuskegee, Alabama
BA	Bermuda Archives
BAD	Belize Archives Department
BDA	Barbados Department of Archives
GH	Records of Government House

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CZL-M	Canal Zone Library-Museum, Library of Congress	
DAB/PRO	Department of Archives, Nassau, Bahamas/Public Record Office	
DJ-FBI	Federal Bureau of Investigation, United States Department of Justice, Washington D.C.	
DLC	Library of Congress, Washington D.C.	
DNA	National Archives and Records Administration, Washington D.C.	
	RG 28	Records of the Post Office Department [POD]
	RG 38	Records of the Office of the Chief of Naval Operations [OCNO]
	RG 54	Records of the Bureau of Plant Industry, Soils, and Agricultural Engineering [BPISAE]
	RG 55	Records of the Government of the Virgin Islands
	RG 59	General Records of the Department of State
	RG 60	General Records of the Department of Justice [DOJ]
	RG 65	Records of the Federal Bureau of Investigation [FBI]
	RG 84	Records of the Foreign Service Posts of the Department of State
	RG 165	Records of the War Department General and Special Staffs [WDGS/WDSS]
	RG 185	Records of the Panama Canal
	RG 267	Records of the Supreme Court of the United States
IU	University of Ibadan Library, Ibadan, Nigeria	
JA	Jamaica Archives, Spanish Town, Jamaica	
MBZ	Ministerie van Buitenlandse Zaken, 'S-Gravenhage, Netherlands	
MU	University of Massachusetts Library, Amherst	
NAG	National Archives of Guyana, Georgetown, Guyana	
	GD	Governor's Despatches

SYMBOLS AND ABBREVIATIONS

NATT	National Archives Trinidad and Tobago, Port of Spain, Trinidad
NN-Sc	Schomburg Center for Research in Black Culture, New York Public Library, New York
NP	Notoria Publica No. 2
SKNNA	St. Kitts and Nevis National Archives, Basseterre, St. Kitts
SVGNA	St. Vincent and the Grenadines National Archives
TNA: PRO	The National Archives of the UK: Public Records Office
	BT Board of Trade
	CAB Cabinet Office
	CO Colonial Office
	FO Foreign Office
	KV Records of the Security Service
	WO War Office
TNF	Fisk University, Nashville, Tennessee
UFC	United Fruit Company
WNRC	Washington National Records Center, Suitland, Maryland
	RG 204 Records of the Pardon Attorney

MANUSCRIPT COLLECTION SYMBOLS

AJG	Amy Jacques Garvey Papers, TNF
CP	Chancellor's Papers, Oxford
CSO	Colonial Secretary's Office, JA
HM	Herbert Macaulay Papers, IU
JEB	John E. Bruce Papers, NN-Sc
JRRC	J. R. Ralph Casimir Papers, NN-Sc
NAACP	National Association for the Advancement of Colored People Papers, DLC
UCD	Universal Negro Improvement Association, Central Division Papers, NN-Sc
WEBDB	W. E. B. Du Bois Papers, MU

DESCRIPTIVE SYMBOLS

AD	Autograph document
ADI	Autograph document initialed
ADS	Autograph document signed
AL	Autograph letter
ALI	Autograph letter initialed
ALS	Autograph letter signed
AN	Autograph note
ANI	Autograph note initialed
ANS	Autograph note signed
PD	Printed document
TD	Typed document
TDI	Typed document initialed
TDS	Typed document signed
TG	Telegram
TGS	Telegram signed
TL	Typed letter
TLI	Typed letter initialed
TLS	Typed letter signed
TN	Typed note
TNI	Typed note initialed
TNS	Typed note signed
TTG	Typed telegram
TTGS	Typed telegram signed

ABBREVIATIONS OF PUBLISHED WORKS

<i>AM</i>	<i>Antigua Magnet</i>
<i>ANB</i>	<i>American National Biography</i>
<i>ATOR</i>	<i>African Times and Orient Review</i>
<i>BI</i>	<i>Belize Independent</i>

SYMBOLS AND ABBREVIATIONS

BM	<i>Black Man</i>
BMHS	<i>Journal of the Barbados Museum and Historical Society</i>
CD	<i>Chicago Defender</i>
Cl	<i>Clarion</i> , British Honduras
COL	<i>Colonial Office List</i>
CQ	<i>Caribbean Quarterly</i>
DA	<i>Daily Argosy</i>
DBH	Max Bissainthe. <i>Dictionnaire de bibliographie haitienne</i> . Washington D.C.: Scarecrow Press, 1951.
DCB	Bridget Brereton, Brinsley Samaroo, and Glenroy Taitt. <i>Dictionary of Caribbean Biography, Volume One: Trinidad and Tobago</i> . St. Augustine: Department of History/Institute of Caribbean Studies, University of the West Indies, 1998.
DC	<i>Daily Chronicle</i> , British Guiana
DC-D	<i>Dominica Chronicle</i> , Roseau, Dominica
DG	<i>Daily Gleaner</i>
DmG	<i>Dominica Guardian</i>
DNB	<i>Dictionary of National Biography</i>
DOCOL	<i>Dominions Office and Colonial Office List</i>
HJ	<i>Handbook of Jamaica</i>
JCH	<i>Journal of Caribbean History</i>
JHSN	<i>Journal of the Historical Society of Nigeria</i>
JILAS	<i>Journal of Iberian and Latin American Studies</i>
JLAS	<i>Journal of Latin American Studies</i>
JSH	<i>Journal of Social History</i>
LIBB	<i>Leeward Islands Blue Book 1889–1945</i> . Antigua, [1890]–1948.
LL	<i>Labour Leader</i> (Trinidad)
LLS	<i>Supplement to the Labour Leader</i> (Trinidad)
MGP	<i>Marcus Garvey and Universal Negro Improvement Association Papers</i>
NW	<i>Negro World</i>
NWCB	<i>Negro World Convention Bulletin</i>

THE MARCUS GARVEY AND UNIA PAPERS

NYAN	<i>New York Amsterdam News</i>
NYT	<i>New York Times</i>
OED	<i>Oxford English Dictionary</i>
P&O	Amy Jacques Garvey, ed. <i>Philosophy and Opinions of Marcus Garvey</i> . 2 vols. 1923, 1925. Reprint (2 vols. in 1). New York: Atheneum, 1992.
PS&H	<i>Panama Star and Herald</i>
PT	<i>Plain Talk</i> (Kingston, Jamaica)
SES	<i>Social and Economic Studies</i>
TrG	<i>Trinidad Guardian</i>
TrSG	<i>Sunday Guardian</i> (Sunday edition of TrG)
UM	<i>Union Messenger</i>
VSL	<i>Voice of St. Lucia</i>
WBD	<i>Webster's Biographical Dictionary</i>
WI	<i>West Indian</i>
WIC	<i>West Indian Crusader</i>
WIP	<i>Weekly Illustrated Paper</i>
WWA	<i>Who's Who in America</i>
WWCA	<i>Who's Who in Colored America</i>
WWCR	<i>Who's Who of the Colored Race</i>
WWJ	<i>Who's Who in Jamaica</i>
WWW	<i>Who Was Who</i>
WWWA	<i>Who Was Who in America</i>
WWWJ	<i>Who's Who and Why in Jamaica</i>

OTHER SYMBOLS AND ABBREVIATIONS

Included are abbreviations that are used generally throughout annotations of the text. Standard abbreviations, such as those for titles and scholastic degrees, are omitted. Abbreviations that are specific to a single annotation appear in parentheses after the initial citation and are used thereafter in the rest of the annotation.

SYMBOLS AND ABBREVIATIONS

ABB	African Blood Brotherhood
ACL	African Communities League
ACLU	American Civil Liberties Union
AFL	American Federation of Labor
AOC	African Orthodox Church
APU	African Progress Union
ATLU	Antigua Trades and Labour Union
AWA	Antigua Workingmen's Association
BPL	Barbados Progressive League
BSL	Black Star Line, Inc.
BWIR	British West Indies Regiment
CFLU	Colón Federal Labor Union
CL	Caribbean League
DBU	Dominica Brotherhood Union
DL	Democratic League
IWW	International Workers of the World
JPL	Jamaica Progressive League
LP	Labour Party
LUA	Labour and Unemployed Association (Belize)
MIS	Mutual Improvement Society (St. Kitts)
NAACP	National Association for the Advancement of Colored People
NPC	Negro Progress Convention
PAC	Pan-African Congress
PNP	People's National Party
RGA	Representative Government Association
SPAO	Society of Peoples of African Origin
TUC	British Trade Union Congress
TWA	Trinidad Workingmen's Association
UBA	Universal Benevolent Association
UFC	United Fruit Company, Bocas del Toro, Panama

THE MARCUS GARVEY AND UNIA PAPERS

UNIA	Universal Negro Improvement Association
UUU	Ulotrichian Universal Union

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AUGUST 1920—JULY 1921

1920

- 1 August UNIA's month-long First International Convention of Negro Peoples of the World opens in New York.
- The Negro Progress Convention is formed in British Guiana.
- 8 August “Professor” Arlington Newton arrives in St. Kitts and speaks at meetings of the St. Kitts Universal Benevolent Association about the Black Star Line, urging his hearers to invest their money in it.
- 10 August The Black Star Line steamer S.S. *Yarmouth* arrives at the port of Charleston, S.C., instead of New York, short of coal and provisions and with a case of smallpox on board the ship. Indebted for supplies and other expenses that the Black Star Line is unable to pay, the vessel is thereupon libeled.
- 13 August The UNIA convention adopts and signs Declaration of Rights of the Negro Peoples of the World.
- 17 August Following his letter of resignation, Luc Dorsinville, manager of the Black Star Line in Haiti, writes to officials in New York stating that “the Haitian public has lost all confidence in the Black Star Line owing to the treatment meted out to the passengers on their first trip, intending to go to New York.”
- 29 August UNIA division in U.S. Virgin Islands holds meeting at Liberty Hall, in St. Thomas.
- August Rev. R. H. Tobitt, representing Bermuda, is elected “Leader of the West Indies (Eastern Province)” by the UNIA convention in New York; J. Sydney de Bourg is elected executive member of the UNIA and “Leader of

the West Indies (Western Province)”; Rev. George A. McGuire of Antigua is elected chaplain-general and an executive member of the UNIA.

In Trinidad, copies of the officially proscribed *Negro World* are found in the cargo of a vessel coming from New York.

UNIA division is organized in the city of Key West, Florida.

Costa Rica confiscates copies of the *Negro World* from the mails.

- | | |
|----------------|--|
| 6 September | Arrival of Black Star Line steamer S.S. <i>Kanawha</i> , re-christened S.S. <i>Antonio Maceo</i> , is expected in Havana, Cuba, coming from Norfolk, Virginia. |
| September | Garvey’s wife, Amy Ashwood Garvey, brings action against Garvey for divorce; Garvey counter-sues for divorce and annulment of marriage. |
| 5 October | The Colonial Office requests the British Foreign Office to secure copies of the UNIA’s “Constitution and Book of Laws” for its use and that of the “Director of Intelligence.” |
| 8 October | After returning to Bermuda, Rev. Tobitt withdraws from the ministry of the AME church, which revokes all previous honors given to him. |
| 17 October | UNIA division in Roseau, Dominica, unveils charter and installs women officers at public meeting held at Liberty Hall. |
| 18 October | First talent performance sponsored by the UNIA division in Barbados. |
| ca. 18 October | The governor of Bermuda cuts funding for St. George Elementary School run by Reverend R. H. Tobitt, due to Tobitt’s membership in the UNIA. |
| 20 October | UNIA division in San Pedro de Macorís, Dominican Republic, installs officers. |
| 28 October | After avoiding capture for eight months, the West Indian labor leader William Stoute is arrested en route to Panama City and imprisoned. |
| October | A “Professor Brooks,” allegedly from St. Kitts and supposedly visiting from Cardiff, Wales, lectures in |

CHRONOLOGY

Georgetown, British Guiana, where he advises Negroes to go back to Africa and establish themselves in Liberia.

UNIA publishes the first volume of the Official Record of the First International Convention of Negroes.

In Trinidad, invoking the seditious bill law, government authorities begin searching private residences of individuals suspected of having copies of the *Negro World*, the *Messenger*, and the *Crusader*.

J. R. Ralph Casimir, the leader of the UNIA in Dominica, publishes article in the *Negro World*.

Garvey and the executive council of the UNIA announce plans for the "Liberian Construction Loan," also known as the "African Liberty Loan," with the goal of raising \$2,000,000 from UNIA members to build railroads, schools, churches, and other infrastructure in Liberia in preparation for repatriation.

7 November UNIA division in Castries, St. Lucia, unveils charter at public meeting held in Liberty Hall.

7 December UNIA San Pedro de Macorís division holds day-long ceremonies to celebrate its one-year anniversary.

December A children's savings system is inaugurated by the UNIA San Pedro de Macorís division.

UNIA division in Banes, Oriente province, Cuba, purchases and establishes its own Liberty Hall; it also establishes a division of the Black Cross Nurses, along with a ladies' division.

1921

7 January The UNIA chaplain general, Reverend George Alexander McGuire, leaves New York on a two-month tour of Cuba.

26 January A telegram circulates to the governors of Bermuda and the Bahamas, warning of the advertised sail of a Black Star Line steamer for the West Indies and recommending the prohibition of its landing under the Government Control Act of 1919.

January–February A reported 2,500 farm and railroad workers in the Limón-based Federación de Trabajadores strike against the United Fruit Company to protest layoffs and a

	thirty-percent wage reduction. In a signed pact, they receive financial and political support from the Confederación General de Trabajadores in San José.
6 February	Colonial authorities report the establishment of a branch of the African Blood Brotherhood in San Pedro de Macorís, Dominican Republic.
17 February	Garvey obtains British passport for travel to West Indies.
18 February	Prior to his departure for the West Indies, Garvey is honored by the Barbados group of the UNIA with a farewell banquet in Liberty Hall.
19 February	The Black Star Line announces that “instead of paying any dividends this year money will be utilized in the purchasing of more ships.”
24 February	Garvey leaves New York at the start of a fundraising tour of the Caribbean and Central America.
24 February	UNIA division in Jobabo, Cuba, is established, with its first public meeting and installation of officers at the Hotel Palacio.
25–27 February	Garvey arrives at Key West, Florida, and delivers speeches nightly at Samaritan Hall.
28 February	Garvey sails from Key West for Havana, Cuba, aboard the P & O Steamship Company’s S.S. <i>Governor Cobb</i> .
February	Controversial change in presidency occurs in the UNIA Castries, St. Lucia, division; Job E. James replaces Wilberforce Norville as president.
ca. 1–3 March	Garvey visits Havana, Cuba, where he delivers series of speeches throughout the city and meets with legislators and Cuban President Menocal.
4 March	UNIA division in Ciego de Avila, Cuba, is reorganized by the visiting UNIA chaplain-general Rev. Alexander McGuire.
4 March	<i>Heraldo de Cuba</i> publishes the text of an extensive interview with Garvey, along with the transcript of his meeting with representatives of the “Atenas Club,” representing the leadership of the Afro-Cuban community.
10–11 March	Garvey visits the city of Santiago, Cuba.

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15 March	Garvey visits Banes, Cuba. Colonial Registrar of Friendly Societies in Trinidad refuses petition by the UNIA to register as a Friendly Society.
18 March	Garvey passes through Marcane en route to Guantánamo, Cuba.
22 March	Garvey arrives in Kingston, Jamaica, from Santiago, Cuba; delivers speech at Collegiate Hall.
23 March	Garvey addresses mass meeting at Ward Theatre in Kingston, in which he denounces local clergymen as hypocrites and describes Jamaica as the most backward country in the Western hemisphere.
25 March	U.S. State Department instructs American consul general in Jamaica to refuse Garvey a visa in view of his activities “in political and race agitation.”
29 March	U.S. authorities in Panama Canal Zone lift exclusion order on Garvey after arrangements are made with the United Fruit Company.
March	The Black Star Line proposes to launch a new ship “which is to trade between the United States and Africa.”
March–May	S. P. Radway and “Professor” Dave Davidson travel throughout Cuba holding UNIA organizing meetings.
7 April	Charles L. Latham, American consul at Kingston, Jamaica, writes to inform American consul general in Panama that the State Department has instructed consular officials to refuse a visa to Garvey.
9 April	The Black Star Line’s S.S. <i>Kanahwa</i> arrives in Cuba.
11 April	Garvey applies for U.S. visa for travel to the Panama Canal, but he is refused by the American consul general in Kingston.
14 April	Garvey arrives in Port Limón, Costa Rica, from Kingston; he is greeted by a reported crowd of 2,000 people. During his stay, Garvey is also received by the Costa Rican president Julio Acosta.
16 April	Garvey is reported to be receiving from Minor Keith, the most influential American entrepreneur in Central

- America, employing thousands of West Indians as banana pickers, at \$2,000 per month.
- 17 April The United Fruit Company general manager in Limón, Costa Rica, George P. Chittenden, reports that it has achieved “an understanding with [UNIA] leaders that Garvey’s meetings would be arranged so as not to interfere with fruit cuttings or loadings.”
- 18 April Garvey leaves San Jose and returns to Port Limón.
- Garvey holds lengthy meeting in Limón, Costa Rica, with the United Fruit Company general manager, who reports that “If he keeps his word he will make no trouble.”
- Mass meeting of the African Blood Brotherhood and the UNIA is held in Georgetown, British Guiana.
- 19 April Garvey applies for Panamanian visa from U.S. consul Stewart McMillin in Port Limón.
- 20 April Public celebration in honor of Garvey held in Limón, with a reported 10,000 people in attendance, roughly half of the total black population in Costa Rica.
- 21 April Garvey visits Bocas del Toro, Panama.
- 23–24 April Garvey visits Almirante and Guabito, Panama.
- 26 April Garvey travels to Colón, Panama, aboard the S.S. *Atenas*.
- The U.S. State Department instructs the American legation in Costa Rica to refuse Garvey’s request for visa.
- 30 April Garvey visits Panama City.
- April Garvey drops legal action for divorce and annulment of marriage.
- 3 May Garvey lectures to a prospective division of the UNIA in Calidonia, Panama.
- 4 May Garvey leaves Panama City and returns to Colón, to deliver farewell address at Variedades Theatre.
- 5 May Garvey leaves Colón, Panama, for Kingston, Jamaica, aboard the S.S. *Carillo*.
- 7 May Garvey arrives back in Jamaica.

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- 9 May William C. Matthews, the UNIA assistant counselor general, petitions the U.S. State Department to allow Garvey to return to the United States.
- 10 May U.S. State department instructs the American consul general in Kingston to refuse to visa the crew list of S.S. *Kanabwa* should Garvey's name appear as crew member.
- 15 May Under new leadership, UNIA St. Lucia division holds a second ceremony to unveil charter.
- 16 May Rev. Richard Hilton Tobitt arrives in Georgetown, British Guiana, and holds UNIA meetings supported by the British Guiana Labour Union.
- 17 May After being summoned to Cuba to settle dispute with the crew of the S.S. *Kanabwa*, Garvey takes ship to Kingston from Santiago, bringing with him Henrietta Vinton Davis, UNIA international organizer, and John Sydney de Bourg, UNIA "Leader of the West Indies."
- 19 May Mass meeting of the UNIA is held at Ward Theatre, Kingston, with speeches by Sydney de Bourg, Henrietta Vinton Davis, and Garvey.
- 28 May Garvey sets sail for Panama as *Kanabwa* crew member; after three days at sea, the vessel returns to Kingston in distress.
- May The Panama strike leader William Stoute is released from prison and voluntarily leaves Panama for Cuba, where he becomes active in the UNIA Havana division.
- 1-7 June Garvey lodges series of complaints against *Kanabwa's* master and crew.
- 4 June Rev. Richard Hilton Tobitt is denied entry into Trinidad due to his reported UNIA organizing activities.
- 7 June William C. Matthews confers with the U.S. State Department's official in charge of visa control.
- 14 June American consul general in Jamaica carries out investigation of Garvey's charges against *Kanabwa's* master and chief engineer; finds them to be innocent.
- ca. 16 June Honduran native Rev. T. C. Glashen, president of UNIA Key West division, Florida, arrested for "inciting a riot" and is deported to Cuba in lieu of standing trial.

- In Havana, Glashen testifies to the racial terror inflicted by the Ku Klux Klan toward himself and the UNIA leading up to his own arrest.
- 18 June UNIA San José division, Costa Rica, unveils charter at meeting held at Club de Obreros.
- 18–22 June S.S. *Kanahwa* leaves Kingston a second time but is disabled once more and returns to port.
- 25 June The U.S. State Department cables authorization for Garvey to be issued a U.S. reentry visa in Jamaica.
- UNIA Guaico division in Trinidad unveils charter during visit by J. R. Ralph Casimir, who visits Trinidad to evaluate strengths and weaknesses of the various UNIA branches.
- 27 June Merchants in British Guiana implement a twenty-percent wage reduction for all casual laborers, stevedores, and others in the midst of postwar recession.
- 28 June Garvey leaves Jamaica for Belize, the final stop on his tour; mechanical problems again prevent S.S. *Kanawha* leaving port of Kingston.
- 28 June Garvey leaves Kingston for Belize, British Honduras, en route to the United States, aboard the S.S. *Canadian Fisher*.
- 1–5 July Garvey arrives at Belize; addresses mass meetings and holds interview with the governor.
- 2 July The Bahamian native Rev. Richard Higgs, UNIA president and Baptist preacher in Coconut Grove, Florida, is kidnapped, beaten, and told to leave the United States by his assailants. Police subsequently arrest more than twenty-five armed blacks among those protesting the incident; Rev. Higgs's kidnappers are not pursued.
- 4 July UNIA division in Niquero, Cuba, unveils charter at its first meeting, held at Liberty Hall.
- ca. 10 July Rev. Richard Higgs, with his wife and five children, arrive in Nassau, Bahamas, from Miami, Florida.
- 12 July Garvey sails from Puerto Barrios, Guatemala, for the U.S.

CHRONOLOGY

- 13–14 July Garvey arrives in New Orleans; he is detained temporarily by U.S. immigration authorities; speaks at public meetings in New Orleans.
- 17 July Garvey arrives in New York.
- 20 July Back in New York, Garvey delivers address in Liberty Hall providing extensive details of his Caribbean and Central America trip.
- 22 July Garvey’s wife, Amy Ashwood Garvey, sues for separation from Garvey.
- July Amidst economic crisis, Cuban President Menocal claims that indigent Afro-Caribbean laborers constitute “a serious danger to public health . . . [and] a public burden on the nation” and decrees that the Cuban government would cover the costs of their repatriation.



Central and South America

AUGUST 1920

UNIA Convention Report

[[*New York*, August 3, 1920]]

Following the monster public meeting at Madison Square Garden, at which nearly 25,000 persons were present, the Internation[al] Convention of Negroes entered its third day's session in Liberty Hall, on Tuesday, August 3. The session opened with a full attendance of delegates. President-General Marcus Garvey occupying the chair.

DELEGATES REPORT CONDITIONS

The first part of the convention was given over to the hearing of complaints from delegates. The complaints they brought from their respective countries and States. "We want this convention to clearly understand the universal Negro situation," said Mr. Garvey. "We can only understand it when the representatives from Georgia tells of the real conditions in Georgia; when the representative from Mississippi tells of the real conditions in Mississippi; when the representative from Basutoland or any other part of Africa tells of the real conditions in Africa. And so with the various islands of the West Indies, and South and Central America. We want to understand the universal situation of the Negro so that we can have conditions so arranged as to meet the demands of 400,000,000 people who are being represented at this convention.["]]

"So the first five or six days of the convention will be devoted to reports of every delegate. Every delegate will be given a chance to lay the grievances of the community he or she represents before this Conference of Negroes. We do not want it said after this convention is over that Georgia did not get a hearing to explain the conditions in Georgia; Canada did not get a hearing to explain the conditions in Canada; Africa did not get a hearing to explain the conditions in Africa, or the British West Indies did not get a hearing to explain the conditions in those islands." Continuing, he said[,]" "When the convention adjourns on the 31st of August, we want to feel that every Negro understands the universal situation of the Race; so that when anything is to be done, whether in the British West Indies or Canada, Africa, South and Central America, or in any of the forty-eight States of America. You as delegates elected by your respective peoples will be able to enlighten the convention as to the exact situation in that State, or island or country."

SIX DAYS TO BE DEVOTED TO DISCUSSION OF CONDITIONS

Five or six days will be devoted to a discussion of the conditions obtaining in the communities represented by the delegates.

"I offer the suggestion," said the chairman, "that fifteen minutes should be the maximum time allowed any delegate to lay the conditions of his State or country before the convention and that the time should range from five to fifteen minutes. This suggestion is now the property of the house."

Mr. James Williams, of Montclair, N.J., put the suggestion in the form of a motion.

ADOPT FIFTEEN MINUTE RULE

Mr. Phillip Van Putten, of Haiti, made an amendment to the motion to the effect that if in the discretion of the chairman a delegate's cause is of such great importance to the convention, as to consume more time than fifteen minutes, additional time be extended to the delegate. The motion, with the amendment, was carried.

"We are assembled here for a serious purpose," declared the President-General. "Some of the delegates have come from thousands of miles away. They have left their homes and families to attend this convention. I hope you will bear these facts [in] mind and try to expedite matters as much as possible." [. . .]

EDUCATION IN BRITISH HONDURAS

Mr. Lee Bennett, delegate from British Honduras, speaking on conditions obtaining in that country stated that the conditions affecting Negroes in British Honduras are not what they ought to be. "We who have started this organization down there are looked upon with suspicion by the government. We are treated as people trying to stir up sedition, so that we have had to go very carefully.["]

"There are any number of things that we might complain about," he said, "but principally, we would like to complain about educational conditions that are keeping us down. Our children are not being educated as they ought to be; and while we cannot say that there is color discrimination as existing in other places, yet there is educational discrimination. That, in brief, is the condition of affairs in British Honduras. That is what we desire to lay stress on—our need and desire for educational improvement.["] [. . .]

THE DELEGATE FROM COLON

Mr. F. S. Ric[kett]s (Colon, Panama), speaking on conditions in Colon, Republic of Panama, said:

"When the U.N.I.A. was started in 1918 we were scoffed and jeered at by the white man. We got together and we did our best. There are a number of little grievances which I hope will be taken up here later on but I will not venture now to speak of them, because the time is not opportune. I want to tell you that the people in Panama, especially in Colon—10,000 Negroes there and between 7,000 and 8,000 in Panama—a body of fully 22,000 there, for the most part coming from the various islands in the West Indies—have been accorded the worst treatment at the hands of the white man.["] [He] went on to show the United [Brother]hood called a strike to get more pay for the work they performed. When the strike was called, 17,000 Negroes stepped out. Describing conditions during the strike he said: "Drawn bayonets were fixed and the work-

ers were practically ousted from the Panama Canal by military forces. They took possession of the houses and the workers had to rent houses from the Panama Canal authorities so that they were compelled to work for them. Women and children were ejected from their homes at the point of the bayonet, and many a man has been forced to commit suicide from the time that work ceased on the Panama Canal for them.

WON'T SELL THEM PASSAGE

"You cannot get a boat to leave there. If you go to the United Fruit Co.¹ and ask for passage on one of [their] boats in order to leave Colon, they say, 'No, we have no passage for you; wait for the Black Star Line.'

["] That strike is the first strike in history where men have had to go back to work for less than they were getting. Men who had gotten \$75 a month had to return for \$50, and had to accept it because their wives and children were there. All our belongings were dashed to pieces. In Panama and Colon men are out of positions they formerly held, and the offices that were formerly held by colored men for years—fourteen and fifteen years—are now being held by white men and women. The man who formerly had an avocation now has to push a truck. But the U.N.I.A. is still doing its utmost to relieve the situation, and when the time comes I shall present the resolution that my society has forwarded by me." [. . .]

CONDITIONS IN GUATEMALA

Mr. Clifford Bourne, (Guatemala, Central America)—"I have brought a special message from the members of the Universal Negro Improvement Association in Puerto Barrios, Guatemala. On the 17th of February, last, we established there a branch of your Association with just about eleven members. I am glad to tell you that through proper organization and systematic handling, we stand today at 250. That community there is especially a Spanish community, and among us there are about 2,000 colored men. When we started our association, the United Fruit Company, a company that has tried to down everything done by the Negro, and especially, the Black Star Line, tried to get the President of the Republic, Manuel Estraba Cabrera, to forbid us from having our meetings. But your humble servant came out and told him he could not stop us. I told him: "You may stop us temporarily, but we are going to be conquerors in the end."

["] The United Fruit Company only paid the laborers \$1.50 per day. After we established our Association we got together and succeeded in establishing a union; we then demanded of the United Fruit Company that it raise the laborers['] salary 100 per cent. (Cheers). Our Association said: "If you do not raise them, we will support them." We established a charitable fund and everybody held up work for about fifteen days and they came to us and we supported them. When the white m[a]n saw that we were determined not to be led by him, the manager of the company gave the men 100 per cent raise. All of that

was accomplished through the Universal Negro Improvement Association. (Cheers).

GOT MERCHANT INTERESTED

[“]There is a noted colored merchant by the name of Mr. George C. Reneau in the city of Puerto Barrio[s] who came to me and told me that nothing at all that has been tried by Negroes has been a success. I told him this movement is to be a success. So I lectured to this gentleman. A few days after he came to my office and said to me: “Mr. Bourne, here is my check for \$1,000, send it to the President-General, for 200 shares in the Black Star Line.” I had converted him, and that is the kind of work we are doing over there. “If we are going into anything, we must exercise system; and system can only be exercised through co-operation. Let us turn our minds toward the same object, and whatever we do, let us do it systematically, and when the day shall come and the automatic button shall ring, we shall be one for Africa.[”] (Cheers). [. . .]

BOCAS DEL TORO

Mr. A. N. Willis, (Bocas del Toro, Republic of Panama)—“Our town is situated on the borders of the Division—that is, on the province of Bocas del Toro and on the Costa Rica Division—just the Sixola Bridge divides us. The Division I represent takes in thirty-six miles on the Costa Rica side and about thirty-seven miles on the Panama[n]ian territory,” said Mr. Willis. “When Mr. Samuda, the former President, and Mme. Duchatillier, the lady president, came to us about ten months ago, we were organized. Since then we have been to the best of our ability, working in the interests of this Association. There have been many difficulties in the way, brought about by the influence of the United Fruit Company. They have done everything in this world to prevent our organizing along the various sections of the line. The place is so situated that they own entire territories of land and houses. The people living in this section are foreigners, and in very few instances do you see natives there. The United Fruit Company has sent their diplomatic agents all along the lines² to prevent us from organizing. I do not like to say anything uncomplimentary about the ministers, but I cannot help telling you, my friends, that they have been the greatest enemies to this movement. The ministers along the lines, controlling the various churches, get in contact with the people and tell them they must not allow any meetings to be held in the churches owned by the United Fruit Company. They get a small salary of \$75 per month from the United Fruit Company and they are allowed to ride on the train on a pass. Knowing the United Fruit Company is opposed to the movement and have done everything in the world to prevent us from organizing along the lines, and knowing that the United Fruit Company can take away their passes and cut off their \$75 a month, which forms a great part of their support, they have not stood by the people; and hence we had to take it upon ourselves and we went into this section and forced a way to success.

CHANGED CONDITIONS

[“]Conditions have changed since we have organized the association in the Republic of Panama. Two years ago we had a strike in Bocas del Toro and the white men drew swords and killed two or three of the strikers; when we appealed to Jamaica for some representation they gave us none.[”]

[“]The Division I represent is in good standing with the government and you will be privileged to see one of the biggest officials. He is here with us—Mr. Ogilvie. He is treasurer of Bocas del Toro. Conditions to-day are very satisfactory for the association. We are all organized with but little exception and those not yet in are waiting to see what can be done.[”] [. . .]

TUESDAY AFTERNOON’S SESSION

The Black Star Line Band was in attendance, and played lively music at intervals.

PORTO RICO

The first speaker at the afternoon session was Mr. James Benjamin, a delegate from Porto Rico. He said: “I believe I am one of the few Spanish speaking delegates in this hall. I am not speaking my native language, my native language is Spanish. With my knowledge of English, however, I shall try my best to inform you of conditions in my home. I would like to he[re] say that the fact of Spanish speaking Negroes joining hands with English speaking Negroes means that language makes no difference with us as long as we are Negroes. My country is a small island 36 by 130 miles, with a population of 1,500,000 inhabitants. It is one of the most thickly populated islands in the West Indies. Ninety per cent of the inhabitants of this island are Negroes. Conditions confronting Negroes in Porto Rico are the same conditions that confront Negroes all over the world. I can see no difference in the conditions of Negroes no matter where they reside. We Negroes are the same all over the world. We are beasts of burden and servants of the white man.[”]

“A few months ago representatives of the Universal Negro Improvement Association came to my home and I lost no time in joining the association. I saw right away that this association would eventually be productive of much good.[”]

“Many other persons would have joined also, but the Universal Negro Improvement Association labored under a great disadvantage in that their propaganda was disseminated throughout the country in English, whereas the majority of my countrymen cannot understand English. I would advise them the next time they send a delegation to my home to send persons who can both read and write Spanish, and who can deliver addresses in the Spanish language. I tried to help the association out, however, by condensing their speeches, translating them into Spanish and publishing them in some of the local newspa-

pers. By so doing I was instrumental in getting several persons to join the association.["]]

DENIED SUITABLE EMPLOYMENT

["]The San Juan people are greatly enthusiastic over this idea, and I hope Ponce will be the city of Porto Rico that will hold the banner for the U.N.I.A. I do not want to take your time talking about conditions among the Negroes of Porto Rico, for they are the same everywhere the Negro lives. Negroes are educated in Porto Rico. That is all right. But what happens after that? A father works twelve or fifteen years to educate his son; he finds when his son leaves college that he cannot find suitable work in keeping with his attainments because he is a Negro. He is intelligent, but the white man will not permit him to get into an office. That happens in Porto Rico, and it is the same thing that is happening all around the world. So the only thing I have to say is that Porto Rico is getting the feelings and the sentiment that the Hon. Marcus Garvey is spreading all around the world. I see in this convention any number of English-speaking Negroes represented; and we want all Negroes to be represented; we want all Negroes organized under this flag of ours. (Applause.) I believe that we have a great work to do in those islands where English is not spoken. I want our leader to send some representative to our island who knows the language of the island to explain what this association means. We don't want any Negro to be neglected; we want every Negro in every land to be informed of the U.N.I.A. and its principles. I am sure that our banner—the red, green and black—will wave in triumph all around the world and at last claim the independence of Africa.[""] (Applause.) [. . .]

BERMUDA'S DELEGATE

Rev. R. H. Tobitt, (Bermuda)—[""]First of all, I want to lay before this convention conditions in the Island of Bermuda, respecting the Government.[""] Mr. Tobitt said, "As you know, Bermuda is a British possession that has representative government. It has what Ireland is craving for today, small as it is. It is only about twenty-five or twenty-seven square miles but I want to say its population consists of 75 per cent of Negroes or people of Negro blood; yet for all that, in the House of Parliament there are at present only two colored representatives; and one of these is dubbed by the natives as "the white man's tool." Consequently, you see the disadvantages to which these people are subjected. That is due to the fact that the people have not been far-sighted enough to own property so as to be able to be entitled to the franchise. The powers that be have put up the franchise at such a rate that only men who own property of great value can be set up to be members of the House of Parliament. In the 'Courts of Justice' the people who are condemned by the law are subject not only to fine, but after being imprisoned for a certain number of years, during that time to be flogged, as they do in some parts of Africa. For stealing a bicycle an offender was given about two years imprisonment and during that time

flogged. A colored boy and a white boy got to scrambling in the streets. Both were hailed before the Court of Justice, and I saw the white boy allowed to ride on his bicycle to the Court while the colored boy was dragged before the Court of Justice—and by a colored policeman. These are some of the things that stand out prominently in that country.[”]

URGES MERCHANT MARINE

[“]Bermuda is an agricultural country. Though small in square miles, its soil is very productive—very rich. You will get from one lot of land as great a return as you will get from an acre in some other places, simply because the soil is naturally rich. I have told you before that 75 per cent of the inhabitants are Negroes and the majority of these are farmers; and many a time during the crop season on account of the fact that all the shipping is in the hands of the white men, and he also is engaged in farming on a large scale, when the market prices are high in New York City, the white man with his own ships sends his produce to New York City and other parts and catches the high prices, but the colored farmer’s produce remains in the Customs House or on the wharf, and then when shipping is available, his produce is hardly of any value. The colored man owns but very little land and he has got to pay high rent for his land; then he has to bide the time for his crop to be sent abroad. There is the necessity, therefore, of our owning ships by taking shares in the steamship company operated by the Association, so that the people who [are] looking for shipping may be [able] to avail themselves of their [own] shipping facilities. The shipping trade is monopolized by the white man because he has got the means.[”]

ALL PRIVATE SCHOOLS

[“]The next point I want to bring before you is the educational conditions. Would it astonish you to know that in the Islands of Bermuda, there is not a single school that is owned and controlled by the Government[?] They are all private schools. The rule says that the Government or the Education Board will give a grant in aid to assist teachers to carry on the work of education. Instead of the country educating its citizens, they leave it into the hands of the teachers and give them a small grant in aid.[”]

[“]And, therefore, the work of educating the natives in Bermuda has fallen largely in the hands of the [scho]ol teachers who are doing it [as a] sacrifice to themselves. It is only within recent years, through the instrumentality of your humble servant, that we have formed what is called a Teachers Union, which is working for a better condition. Another thing is that in the schools the books are not suited to the natives. They heap upon us books that have been written by white men and books that give inspiration to the white boy because some white hero is held up before him. The colored boy reads about what white men have done and then he thinks that honor is only for the white boys. But for all these years your humble servant has been taking into his own hands

to inculcate into our children that there are black heroes as well as white heroes.[”]

FREE TO TEACH SELF RESPECT

“My school is a private school and is aided by the Government, but I made it clear to the Education Board that I was free to teach what I liked, and so I give essays on such great men like Toussa[i]nt L’Ouverture, Frederick Douglass and Crispus Attucks and such great men belonging to our race, so that the colored child can aspire to some of their own race.[”] (Cheers.)

[“]Now on the industrial side. We find that our young men have measured up very well indeed. That is due to the fact that the dockyard is owned and controlled by the British Government. Young men are given a chance. They are [allow]ed to take a trade as the white boy does. I must say that the greatest difficulty is experienced not with the Englishmen so much, [but] the native white Bermudians who are very much prejudiced against the colored people. You will find there that the colored boy has the opportunity to learn different trades at the dockyard, consequently you can find some competent tradesmen there. I hope to recommend some to the Black Star Line later. You can find engineers, fitters, plumbers of all descriptions—Negroes who are capable. We have licensed pilots who hold first, second and third class licen[s]es, many of them members of the association; and I may tell you this much: that among our pilots we have some of the most skillful in the world and there is not one white man among them. They have told us to tell our President General that they are willing at any time to give their services to the Black Star Line. You now have one of our Bermudian boys on [your] boat—Mr. Henry Tucker.[”]

WANT SHIP OF THEIR OWN

[“]These are the main facts I want to lay before you; and we hope that in this convention some means may be arrived at to bring results. The people there have asked me to ask our illustrious leader to pay a visit to Bermuda. I want to say before you, and I declare it, that the day he touches the shores of Bermuda, he will capture all the communities of Bermuda wholesale.[”] (Cheers.)

[“]The beautiful onions and potatoes which Bermuda is celebrated for are grown chiefly by the native people—the Negroes—and they are quite willing to ship them here if they have a ship of their own, and to have the trade controlled by the members of the association in New York City. (Cheers.) We have had a visitor there from Boston in the person of Dr. Gibson, and he said Montreal is quite willing to deal with the native people of Bermuda in the shipping line. And so we look forward hopefully and we feel the day is not far distant when through the instrumentality of the Black Star Line Steamship Company that

Bermuda may be the means of helping to build up this association. She has got the goods if we can find the means to deliver them.["] [. .]

Printed in *NWCB*, 7 August 1920. For full version of the report see *MGP* 2: 510–525.

1. The UFC was a Boston-based multinational corporation that produced and marketed bananas. It dominated the production and distribution of bananas from Central America and the Caribbean to the United States. The origins of this company can be traced to the year 1870, when Captain Lorenzo Dow Baker made an experimental import of bananas bought in Jamaica for a shilling and sold them in Jersey City for two dollars a bunch. After this success, Baker joined Bostonian entrepreneur Andrew Preston and created the Boston Fruit Company. This company owned a large fleet of steamships that, with time, became the largest private fleet in the world: the Great White Fleet.

In 1899, another Bostonian entrepreneur, Minor C. Keith, approached Preston and Baker with a proposal to merge their company with his business. Keith had built railways in Central America and Colombia, owned lands in those countries, and was also involved in the banana export business. Preston and Baker agreed, and on 30 March 1899, the UFC was born, with Preston as president and Keith as vice president. The diverse interests and skills of Preston and Keith complemented each other. Keith had his railroad network and plantations in Central America, plus the market in the southeastern United States. Preston grew bananas in the West Indies, ran the Great White Fleet, and sold to the northeastern United States. As the company grew, Keith continued with his railroad projects in Central America.

The UFC needed to assure a steady output of bananas to its consumer market in the United States. This was a difficult task because bananas, unlike other goods, rot quickly and easily. However, the company swiftly developed an impressive production and distribution network between the tropical lands in the Caribbean and the United States. This network included plantations (with health and housing infrastructure for the American employees and the local field-workers), railways, ports, telegraph lines, and steamships. By 1900, UFC owned 212,394 acres of land, and by 1954, it owned 603,111 acres scattered across Central America and the Caribbean. In 1913 it created the Tropical Radio & Telegraph Company to keep constant communication with its ships and plantations. It established a subsidiary company in charge of distributing bananas in the United States, the Fruit Dispatch Company, and was a major shareholder of the Hamburg Line, a German shipping company. Having bought 99 percent of the shares of a British banana import and shipping company, Elders & Fyffes, the UFC was also assured a privileged position in the British market by 1928. The UFC quickly eliminated smaller competitors like the Atlantic Fruit Company and Cuyamel Fruit Company, until only one other large banana multinational remained, the Vaccaro Brothers Corporation of New Orleans (established in 1900, later reincorporated as Standard Fruit, and presently known as Dole Corporation).

Investments by the UFC brought enormous change to the Caribbean and Central America. The company built a transportation, communication, housing, and production infrastructure from scratch. Whole towns and large plantations emerged in a very short time in regions previously covered by the jungle. The creation of the so-called Banana Empire demanded hundreds of thousands of workers who were supplied by the migration of local rural workers or by the company's organized import of labor, as in the case of the West Indian workers in Central America or the Haitian laborers in the company's sugar plantations in Cuba.

Many employees, however, were not content with their working conditions. In October 1928, the UFC called in Colombian troops to maintain order after thirty-two thousand plantation workers in Santa Marta, Colombia, started a strike. On 6 December, strikers and supporters gathered to demonstrate in Ciénaga where troops opened fire on them after a five-minute warning given to the crowd. An early telegram from the embassy to the U.S. secretary of state reported that fifty strikers were killed. A revised estimate later in the month cited five hundred to six hundred, and a dispatch in January reported that in excess of one thousand were killed. Within a few days, employees were back on site, calmly taking pictures for the company record.

The UFC's expansion was facilitated by an environment extremely friendly to foreign business in Central America. Before World War II, the UFC counted on political dictatorships that repressed labor unionism and gave generous financial concessions in terms of land grants and tax incentives. In some of the countries where the UFC operated, it was the major employer, the largest investor in infrastructure, and permitted the international marketing of the country's main export. Countries like Guatemala, Panama, or Honduras depended on bananas for more than 60 percent of their

total exports. Because of this, the local governments encouraged the company's operations in their national territories. This situation was not limited to the tiny Central American republics. UFC was also one of the most powerful investors in the British colony of Belize, although it interrupted its operations there in 1920 due to climatic hazards and diseases that destroyed the country's banana plantations. This included not only the plantations owned by UFC but also those owned by its local providers.

After World War II, the company faced serious threats that obliged it to change its internal structure from production to marketing. The rise of nationalistic governments and stronger labor unionism in Latin America made the UFC's investments in the region riskier. In 1954, Guatemalan President Jacobo Arbenz attempted to expropriate some of the company's lands, the Honduran banana workers went on the biggest strike in that country's history, and the U.S. government sued the company for failing to comply with anti-trust legislation. These events made the UFC's shareholders think that landownership in Central America increased the company's risks; therefore, in the 1960s, the company gradually got rid of its plantations and railroads and instead concentrated its efforts on the international marketing of bananas.

As demand for bananas decreased in the United States after the 1950s, the UFC diversified its operations to include processed food. This transformation went further when the company merged with AMK Corporation and created a food conglomerate in 1970 called United Brands Company. In 1989 this conglomerate changed its name to Chiquita Brands International (Robert Read, "The Growth and Structure of Multinationals in the Banana Export Trade," in *The Growth of International Business*, ed. Mark Casson [London: Allen & Unwin, 1983], pp. 180–213; Marcelo Bucheli, "United Fruit Company in Latin America," in *Banana Wars: Power, Production and History in the Americas*, ed. Steve Striffler and Mark Moberg [Durham, N.C.: Duke University Press, 2003], pp. 80–100; Frederick U. Adams, *The Conquest of the Tropics* [New York: Page, 1914]; Charles Kepner and Jay Soothill, *The Banana Empire: A Case Study of Economic Imperialism* [New York: Vanguard, 1935]; Stacy May and Galo Plaza, *United States Business Performance Abroad: The Case Study of the United Fruit Company in Latin America* [Washington D.C.: National Planning Association, 1958]; Paul Dosal, *Doing Business with the Dictators: A Political History of United Fruit in Guatemala, 1899–1944* [Wilmington, Del.: Scholarly Resources, 1993]; Aviva Chomsky, *West Indian Workers and the United Fruit Company in Costa Rica, 1870–1940* [Baton Rouge: Louisiana State University Press, 1996]; Peter Clegg and Timothy Shaw, *The Caribbean Banana Trade: From Colonialism to Globalization* [London: Palgrave/McMillan, 2002]; Marcelo Bucheli, *Bananas and Business: The United Fruit Company in Colombia, 1899–2000* [New York: New York University Press, 2005]; Peter Chapman, *Jungle Capitalists: A Story of Globalisation, Greed and Revolution* [Edinburgh: Canongate, 2007]).

2. A reference to territory traversed by the Panama Railroad Company.

All Negro Communities of the World

(of America, Africa, the West Indies, Central and South America)

ARE REQUESTED TO FORM THEMSELVES INTO BRANCHES OF THE

Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities' League of the World

**FOR THE CONSOLIDATION OF THE SENTIMENT AND ASPIRATIONS OF THE
400,000,000 OF THE NEGRO RACE**

**ORGANIZE FOR RACIAL PROGRESS, INDUSTRIALLY, COMMERCIALY, EDUCA-
TIONALLY, POLITICALLY AND SOCIALLY**

ORGANIZE FOR THE PURPOSE OF FOUNDING A GREAT NATION

**Any Seven Persons of Liberal Education of the Negro Race Can Organize
Among Themselves and Apply to the International Headquarters
for Necessary Instructions and Charter**

International Convention of Deputies

**From the Branches of the Association in Every Country in the World Will
Assemble at Liberty Hall, New York, From August 1 to 31, 1920, to Elect**

His Supreme Highness, the Potentate, His Highness, the Supreme Deputy

AND OTHER HIGH OFFICIALS

**Who Will Preside Over the Destiny of the Negro Peoples of the World Until an
African Empire is Founded**

**If You Cannot Elect a President in the United States, Then Elect a Leader. If
You Cannot Become King of England, Then Elect a Leader.**

Address All Communications to

**UNIVERSAL NEGRO IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION AND AFRICAN COMMUNI-
TIES LEAGUE INC.**

50 WEST 135th STREET NEW YORK, UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

UNIA Convention Flyer

Major E. E. Turner, Commandant,
Bahamas Police, to F. C. Wells-Durrant,
Acting Colonial Secretary, Bahamas

Police Orderly Room.
Nassau, N.P. 3/8/20

Sir:—

I forward herewith a Copy of “The Negro World” and Circulars of The Mercantile Association for your information.

These were obtained from a Mr Albury who is a Clerk in The Treasury, and who obtains the “Negro World” in a plain envelope [through] the Post.

He also states that he is acting as Secretary for the Mercantile Association. I have the honour to be Sir Your Obedient Servant,

E. E. TURNER
Major
Commandant

DAB/PRO. TLS. Marked “Confidential.”

Richard S. Barrett to Major E. E. Turner,
Commandant, Bahamas Police

Nassau N.P. August 4th 1920

Sir

I have the honour to report to you on a meeting held at the Good ~~Smart~~ Samaritan's Hall ~~on~~ last night by the Union Mer[ca]ntile Association. The meeting Commence at 8 PM there were quite a number of peopl[e] assembled. The President open the meeting with a song prayer By Treas Caleb Gibson. The President said the object of the meeting was //to// sell shares for the U.M.A. to afford //us// to buy a Boat to £ run between here and Miami and soon as they get this Boat running they will be able to employ their own colour & make them independ[e]nt of the white Races. He then introduce Mr. C. Smith as Master of Ceremonies[.] He concur the sentiment of the President and ask for as many as possible to purchase shares. M. of C. then intro the 1st speaker Reuben Bethel as Marcus Garvey[.] Bethel said he is proud of the opportunity and this scheme is the greatest in the History of Bahamas. During the Captivity of the past years we were trodden under foot. Some time ago we tried to form a Union[.] Some of us [got scared] and cause [some] to drop being intimidated by the White Race, and there //are// [many] at pres[e]nt trying to find out why & for what purpose is the U.M.A. formed. But I had a

dream some days ago and I dream I saw a great Mass of Black folks Concord together and get tired of going to [M]r Gentleman E. to ask them for help or work[.] [D]uring his speech two people went forward to buy shares. The Band played a selection[.]

2nd Speaker. Dr. C. A. Knight. Subject: Stock taking. Dr Knight said, I feel my self interested because 4 Doctors in Jamaica are engaged in a similar work ~~try~~ trying to get line of ships ~~betw~~ between Jamaica & Cuba[.] We were told that many of these houses around here were built by the Coloured people formerly. We cannot Count things as it appears to us. Dr [Holmes?] addressing ~~of~~ men of one University said ~~wa~~ we must not look to the white race for any advantages, whatever we want we must do it for ourselves, he told the story of the Ants.—Selection by the U.M.A. orchestra

3rd speaker. Mr Chas Ford~~e~~. He said Gentlemen I am very please of this meeting especially when I look around and see all the faces like my own—& I think with one accord. I want to ~~pent~~ penetrate in the vacant [minds] if there are any, our object. It is to unite us together as people in love. We want to get a Boat to fly between here and Miami for the purpose of Rescuing our Coloured Race & let them get comfort because our money is as good as the white but we do not get equivalent treatment. When we get this Boat we will be able to employ our own & make them independ[~~e~~]nt[.] [W]hen I first heard of this scheme it makes me rejoice. Many would join us today but afraid to offend their task masters but any one who are hindrance look out for Judgment[.] Remember when the Children of [Israel] was in E[gy]pt & we were told that the Lord drown the Hindrances in the Red Sea, & I hope that an Earthquake will swallow those who hindrance to the progress of the U.M. Association.

Next Introduction of 4th Speaker. Mr A. F. Adderly B.A.[,] L.L.B. He said he was asked a few days ago by Mr. Smith to give an Orati[o]n, having know what an Orati[o]n is & he left his Latin Dictionary in England he was frightened.

I am please to ~~meet~~ number of interested ~~Said~~ Continued Mr Adderly because when you [*words illegible*] at the Bottom of things God only know where it ends. One of my greatest promotions I got since I left England is Registrar General for this Association. When the Directors Consulted me I was very glad indeed to //see the// step that //my// Race ~~is~~ is making and you notice Sec 72. in our Rules reads that no one other than ~~An~~ an African Descend can hold any office or become a Director in this business showing them that we are dependant on ourselves. Should you be condem[n]ed because you try to get out the [word]? This scheme will ~~Co~~ command respect from every circle just as they do the Colour[~~e~~]d Merchants in Bay Sh. I don[']t think it ne[~~c~~]essary to apologiz[~~e~~] to anyone & we should not be ashamed to call ourselves Africans because the people in South Africa who are not Africans are calling themselves so. We are not after Racial Ant[a]gonism but //if// we are ask by anyone, why we are making such a move, we will tell them to make you honour us. 5th Speaker

Capt Ma[sher?]. He only concur the sentiments of the previous speakers. 6th sixth speaker Capt. S. Dillet.—Gentlemen I was born in Nassau & got my training at the Boys Central School of this colony,¹ and my Cry for 25 years ago was to build up our side[.] [O]ne Speaker refer to being questioned on this business I would suggest [*answer*—to prevent our Women from going like cattle to Miami & being insulted on your boats, Although I wouldn[']t allow a white horse to move me from my seat if I was travelling and pay for same.

Mr Dillet Continue saying and I don[']t loose a bit of my appetite when I sit beside a white person. [W]hen I had my vessel //one// of my Crew only know he was robbed when a white man told him so although being satisfied before, and you will [be] surprise to know that in every [robbery] there are someone of our Race there to carry tales to the White people the next day. [A] man in Bay Sh can ask me Dillet why did you say or make such a remark. When I had my vessel the Coloured people was told to call me a thief by white Race & smash our business but Gentlemen don[']t let that discourage you[.] [H]ave faith in your Race, otherwise nothing can be done.

The rest of Speakers simply Cor[ro]borate what was said already. [A]bout six people went and b[u]y shares during the meeting. The Closing Song. Doxology. I have the honour to be Sir your obt servt.

RICHARD S. BARRETT
[*initials illegible*] Pte.

DAB/PRO. ALS. Some illegible cancelled matter elided.

1. The Boy's Central School was founded in 1847. It was one of six schools in New Providence, and one of twenty-one schools in the Bahamas as a whole, that were set up following an 1847 act empowering an Educational Committee of the Executive Council to establish "a system of Popular education and Training in the Bahama Islands." The Boy's Central School was the most highly regarded of these schools, and by the 1870s it was educating the sons of poor whites alongside those of the more prosperous non-whites. As a main source of junior clerks for the Bahamian civil service and trainees for the teaching profession, the Boy's Central School offered its black and colored students some hope of upward social mobility (Michael Craton and Gail Saunders, *Islanders in the Stream: A History of the Bahamian People*, vol. 2 [Athens: University of Georgia Press, 1998], pp. 27, 29, 30).

UNIA Convention Report

[[Liberty Hall, New York,
Aug. 4, 1920]]

The sessions of the great International Convention during Wednesday and Thursday were taken up with the hearing of reports of delegates respecting conditions in their own countries or [local]ities.

ROTTEN CONDITIONS IN ANTIGUA

[Dr.] Geo. Alexander McGuire,¹ of Antigua, spoke of conditions in the Island of Antigua, Leeward Island Colony, B.W.I. His report, one of the most interesting, was a revelation in itself. Conditions existing in that section of the British possessions, he said, are abominable and deplorable; not only politically, but industrially and religiously as well. In graphic language Dr. McGuire gave a picture of the situation in that part of the world as affecting colored people, and in a strong appeal to the American Negro to give the subjects of the British West Indies a helping hand to ameliorate conditions there prevalent.

The crown colony system of government keeps Antigua, as well as most islands of the British West Indies, under the thralldom of crown officialdom,² he said. The Governor is sent out from the British Colonial Office. His Legislative Council consists of the heads of all Departments of the Public Service, known as "official members,"³ and an equal number, also appointed by the Governor, known as non-official members.

The taxpayers and people have absolutely no say in their choice for representatives in the Legislative Council, but the Governor is "graciously pleased," to use the bombastic phraseology of the petty government, to appoint one "colored" man—[not] Negro, not black, but "colored" [i]f you please, to give "color" to his Legislative Council and such gentleman knows that he is merely a c[i]pher?, to fill out space.⁴ These ten persons and the Governor make all laws, levy all taxes, and railroad through the most important legislation in an hour, and the people, the masses of the people, over 90 per cent. being Negroes, have no part in making laws or in protesting against unjust legislation. Crown colony government is the great incubus which inhibits the progress of Antigua.

THE CONTRACT LAW

The Contract Labor Law, an iniquitous and heinous and archaic piece of legislation, about 80 years old, introduced soon after emancipation and amended at various times, holds the black laborers in veritable peonage.⁵ These people are not free to move from one sugar estate to another, or from one estate to village, not free to stop one day from labor if their proprietor demands their services, not free to sever their connection on the weekly pay day if they desire, but must give from 30 to 90 days' notice. The proprietors and managers of estates thus hold an unfair and unjust advantage over the laborers who are dragged into the magistrates' courts, fined and imprisoned and sent back to work on the same estates. "Plantocracy," or domination by the planters is the second great affliction of Negroes in Antigua.

OPPRESSIVE TAXATION

Taxation is out of all proportion with the limited resources of the people.⁶ For the benefit of the salaries of a top-heavy and unnecessary official force, there are high rates of taxation, both internal and external. Everything is

taxe[d], even the uncultivated and non-arable rocks and sands[:] when it was threatened by the people that if the cocoanut trees in their backyards which served to cool their thirst on sultry days were taxed they would cut them down, and if their chickens which served to supply the community with eggs were taxed, they would kill and eat them, the Governor and his council refrained from taxing these.

POOR WAGES

Unremunerative wages. Men in agricultural toil received about 50 to 60 cents for 10 hours under a tropical sun, and they do not always get even five days' work in a week. Women laborers get from 16 to 18 cents per day. Is it any wonder that they are underfed, that their physical vitality is low, that their powers of resistance against disease are diminished and that tuberculosis, skin diseases, hookworms, malnutrition and similar conditions take their heavy toll? Is it any wonder that men and women go about in tattered rags and boys about the age of 12 and 14 can be seen playing in the villages clad only in Nature's garb—in other words absolutely nude?

ABSENTEE LANDLORDS

Absentee proprietorship is a bane on Antigua. The owners of most of the estates live in England. Their money is invested in sugar cultivation and production, and they do nothing for the economic betterment of the laboring people, whose sweat and whose brawn till the soil and reap the harvests. They stay in England and suck the island dry, while the islanders get the husks.⁷

RIGOROUS CENSORSHIP

Press Regulation and Censorship. In the island of Antigua there is one newspaper—so-called. It is run by a Barbados Negro. Its motto is, "I shine for all." Its name is the "Antigua Sun."⁸ But the "Sun" does not dare shine for all. The government won't let it. There are articles from my own pen in the editor's pigeon-holes that he states are "untimely." He cannot offend the government, or the planters, or the merchants. The government requires a bond of \$100 from any man who publishes a paper, and that means some one must go his security, and he is tied hands and feet.⁹ He has to submit for censorship his forms everyday before printing them next day. Attempts were made to suppress the Negro World and other so-called seditious literature, but up to date the Legislative Council has not committed this unpardonable sin.¹⁰

CUBA

Mr. Richard Marks, of Preston, Cuba, in his report, covered only part of Cuba, in referring to discriminations in various forms in evidence there against Negroes. [. . .]

AUGUST 1920

HAITI

Mr. Napoleon J. Francis,¹¹ of Port a[u] Prince, Haiti, spoke of the revolutions instigated in that country by white men either from the United States or other foreign countries, their object being to divide the natives and oppress them and take advantage of their helplessness. The Republic of Haiti, he said, needs help from every Negro in the United States of America. Actual independence they do not have, but they hoped to possess it and complete freedom in the not distant future, with God's help and the aid of black people from this country and other parts of the world.

DOMINICAN REPUBLIC

Delegate Philip Van Puton [Van Putten], of the Dominican Republic, Santo Domingo, said he spoke for 75,000 Negroes in that country. A system is there in practice whereby the white Spanish and white Americans conspire to exclude further immigration of Negroes into the Republic. Conditions there, he said, are terrible. The Negroes there, however, who come chiefly from the West Indian Islands, are now uniting for their own salvation. They no longer are possessed with Anglomania, but are determined to obtain and maintain their rights at all hazards, and [*are*] preparing themselves, silently, yet surely, for the time when their services will be needed for the reclamation and redemption of Africa for the Africans. No place is more productive and fruitful, he continued, than this Island. Millions of dollars are being made by the white people, but nothing by the Negro.

WHITES DOMINATE

Everything there is controlled by foreigners. Laborers get only a dollar a day. In the northern part the Negroes (who emigrated there from America 75 years ago)¹² raise an abundance of bananas and cocoa, but have no facilities for transporting it. [. . .]

BERMUDA

Mr. Benjamin Diet, of Bermuda, outlined conditions existing in his country. He mentioned the discrimination against the race in the matter of government positions, and said that in the factories men and women are given work only of the lowest and most menial character. [. . .]

THURSDAY'S SESSION [. . .]

ST. LUCIA'S DELEGATE

Randolph Felix (St. Lucia, B.W.I.): After speaking on the progress of the organization in St. Lucia, Mr. Felix said: "I am sorry to say that conditions otherwise are not to my satisfaction. We have not as much privilege as explained by the last speaker from Bocas del Toro. The preferences that have been given us are the little cultivation of cane manufactures [*manufacturers?*]; and how much

do they earn? The poor workers have very little money to spend out of the two shillings a day for ten or twelve hours' work. Then again, a little cocoa is cultivated in various parts of the island, and when it is brought to town they get seven or ten cents a pound for it. Another means of existence is as a coal carrier. Some of the people—and especially women—are compelled to carry coal for their living. They get from one to three cents for this work; so you can see that their suffering is very intense.

NO STEAMSHIP ACCOMMODATIONS

"We have had people booked for the last two or three years for different parts of the world, and up to the present time they cannot receive passage on any of the boats. My own case is an example of this. I was booked three months in anticipation of getting passage to come to this country to attend this convention, but I could not get it, and I was three months coming from St. Lucia to New York. So you see that we are surely in need of a boat in that part of the world. We need not only a boat, but we need the help of every individual Negro of the world. The movement started by Mr. Garvey has brought the West Indies around, and to-day it has reached the hearts of the people of St. Lucia. To-day we have a following, a membership, of thirty-one hundred; and, mind you, that was three months ago, when I left. They are praying for the day to come when he will be able to surprise them with a boat." [. . .]

Printed in *NWCB*, 7 August 1920. For full version of the report see *MGP* 2: 529–538.

1. Dr. George Alexander McGuire (1866–1934) was born in Sweetes Village, Antigua, and received his college education at Mico College in Jamaica and the Nisky Theological Seminary in St. Thomas, Virgin Islands, run by the Moravian Church, his mother's denomination. Graduating ca. 1888, he was appointed pastor of a Moravian congregation in Frederiksted, St. Croix. He migrated to the United States in 1894 and was ordained as a priest in the Protestant Episcopal Church. He served as an assistant to Henry L. Phillips, the pastor of the Church of the Crucifixion in Philadelphia, and undertook several missionary assignments in the United States and the Caribbean. In 1901 he was appointed the rector of the historic Afro-American Church of St. Thomas in Philadelphia that had been founded in 1794 by Absalom Jones. In 1905 he became the first black man to be appointed archdeacon and placed in charge of "colored" work in the diocese of Arkansas. He moved to Boston, Mass., in 1908 and attended Jefferson Medical College. From 1909 to 1911 he served as rector of the newly formed St. Bartholomew's Church, a black congregation that had separated itself from the white-dominated congregation of St. Peter's. In 1911 he transferred to New York City to serve as field secretary for the American Church Institute for Negroes that had been established by the Protestant Episcopal Church to direct the denomination's educational work among blacks. McGuire was deeply concerned about the racist attitudes in the predominantly white Protestant Episcopal Church, particularly their failure to promote black clergy. He was also frustrated at his inability to secure independent recognition from the national church body for his growing black congregation at St. Bartholomew's Church in Boston. That same year McGuire returned to Antigua at the invitation of Bishop Edward Hutson, Anglican bishop of Antigua, to work for the Anglican Church and practice medicine. In Antigua he sought to foster industrial education and founded the Antigua School of Domestic Science and Nursing. On several lecture tours throughout Antigua and Barbados, he attracted "immense audiences" speaking on the subject of industrial education in the United States. He also worked as a physician and served on "various committees having as their object the economic improvements of the laborer" (*MGP* 3: 217 n. 5). McGuire also served as parish rector of the Anglican Church in Falmouth, Liberta, and his native Sweetes. He returned to the United States in August 1912. In July 1919 McGuire resigned, providing no reasons, and returned to the United States. There he joined the UNIA. His participation in the 1920 Convention was widely praised in the New York press and his stirring speeches established

his popularity within the organization. A crowd of 1,800 persons gathered to listen to his public address at Liberty Hall. McGuire was elected at the Convention to the post of chaplain-general of the UNIA, replacing Rev. James Eason who had been promoted to the post of "Leader of American Negroes." McGuire worked assiduously to strengthen and clarify the role of chaplain in the various UNIA branches, ensuring that all chaplains were ordained clergy and outlining, in detail, their duties and responsibilities. In 1921, at the request of the High Executive Council of the UNIA, McGuire drafted the Universal Negro Ritual for use in religious services and the Universal Negro Catechism for use in religious instruction. McGuire also resumed his independent religious activities by joining the Reformed Episcopal Church and establishing, on 9 November 1919, the Church of the Good Shepherd in New York City. In April 1920 he broke his church's affiliation with the Reformed Episcopal Church and founded the Independent Episcopal Church as an independent black denomination incorporated under the statutes of New York. On 2 September 1921 a synod of the Independent Episcopal Church decided to reconstitute the church body as the African Orthodox Church (AOC), and McGuire was subsequently consecrated as its first bishop. An article in the *Negro World* explained that McGuire's association with the UNIA was the "impelling factor in the decision reached by him and his members not to affiliate with any existing body of white Episcopalians, but to organize an Independent African Episcopal Church to include Negroes everywhere . . ." (MGP 3: 693 n. 4). The AOC was, however, independent of the UNIA and was never accepted as an affiliate. Marcus Garvey was critical of the establishment of the AOC, and McGuire was removed from his position as chaplain-general and briefly expelled for trying to make the AOC the official religious body of the UNIA. After his expulsion, McGuire joined the ABB, and an exposé written by him and entitled "Why I left the UNIA" was published in Cyril Brigg's newspaper, the *Crusader*. McGuire subsequently rejoined the UNIA and, on 2 March 1926, submitted a petition to W. W. Husbands, U.S. Commissioner of Immigration, pointing out that Marcus Garvey had accumulated no wealth and that any fraud that had taken place in the BSL had occurred "while Mr. Garvey was gone about 5 months to the West Indies." The petition observed that the members of the UNIA "have absolute confidence in him as an organizer and a leader whom they trust absolutely." McGuire was aware of the efforts by his countryman and fellow churchman, Rev. George Auesby Weston, to engineer the ouster of Marcus Garvey and establish a rival UNIA body. He sided with Garvey during his organizational crisis and had Garvey's full confidence. On 23 February 1926 Garvey corresponded with McGuire from prison advising him to be "Fully aware of treachery of Weston and Sherrill in deceiving people for their personal and other gain . . . Show Weston and Sherrill no mercy, they are rascals" (MGP 6: 349) (NW, 6 November 1920, 6 August and 8 October 1921; NYT, 12 November 1934; 1920 United States Federal Census [database online], Provo, Utah: Ancestry.com, 14 December 2005; Passenger Records [database online], New York: www.ellisland.org, 14 December 2005; Gavin White, "Patriarch McGuire and the Episcopal Church," *Historical Magazine of the Protestant Episcopal Church* 38 [1969]: 109-141; Richard Newman, "The Origins of the African Orthodox Church," introductory essay to the reprint edition of *The Negro Churchman* [Millwood, N.Y.: Kraus Reprint Co., 1977], pp. iii-xxii; William Newton Hartshorn, *An Era of Progress and Promise* [Boston, Mass.: Priscilla Publishing Co., 1910], p. 477; Randall K. Burkett, *Black Redemption: Churchmen Speak for the Garvey Movement* [Philadelphia: Temple University Press, 1978], pp. 157-180; idem., *Garveyism as a Religious Movement* [Metuchen, N.J.: Scarecrow Press, 1978], pp. 6, 32, 72-96; MGP 2: 508-509; MGP 3: 217 n. 5, 693 n. 4; MGP 6: 390).

2. In 1868 the fully elected planter assembly of Antigua was replaced by a partially elected legislature with an equal number of elected members and members appointed by the Crown. By 1898 Antigua had accepted a wholly nominated legislature in exchange for direct financial aid from the British government. Under Crown colony rule, the leading officials in the colonial government were directly appointed by the British Colonial Office and were usually British colonial civil servants.

3. In 1920 the official members of the Antiguan legislative council included: Governor Edward M. Merewether, the colonial secretary; Lt.-Col. Reginald St. Johnson; attorney general Maurice Camacho, who came from a local Portuguese family that owned several sugar estates and a thriving mercantile business; auditor general William Auchinleck and treasurer Francis Griffiths, both British natives; Richard Dyett, magistrate of districts A & B; Charles Stretch, superintendent of public works; Thomas Fisher, chief keeper of prisons; and Cecil Rolston, resident medical officer. The unofficial nominated members included: John Joseph Camacho, the leading Portuguese estate owner and merchant on the island; John Freelande Foote, the white headmaster of the Antigua Grammar School, the premier secondary school in the island which served the children of the Euro-

pean community throughout the colony; Robert Bryson, a white planter and cofounder of one of the leading commercial establishments on the island; Robert Andre Llewelyn Warneford, a leading white merchant; Leonard Isaac Henzel, the white manager of the Antigua Sugar Factory, the main central sugar factory on the island; Robert Stephen Duke Goodwin, a white planter and leading spokesperson for the white planting community; Langford Selly Cranstoun, another white planter; and Donald Macdonald, a colored planter who was appointed to the legislature in January 1919 ("Councils and Assemblies," *LIBB*, 1919–1920, Section K).

4. In October 1920 James Anderson Harney, a colored businessman, was appointed to the legislative council, giving the colored community of Antigua their first true representative during the twentieth century. Donald Macdonald, as a planter, was not seen as representative of the colored community and did not identify with them ("Councils and Assemblies," *LIBB*, 1919–1920, Section K6).

5. The planter assembly of Antigua decided to bypass the apprenticeship system introduced by the British government following the abolition of slavery in 1834. Antigua therefore became the only British West Indian colony to introduce "full" freedom in 1834; as the planter assembly recognized "there are circumstances in the condition of this colony which invite more to such a favorable change than perhaps in any other; among these may be suggested the all-important and paramount one of an utter dependence, from peculiarity of climate and the absence of unoccupied lands, except those of absolute sterility, of the labourer on the proprietor and capitalist for the means of procuring food; and that a large portion of the population, whether bond or free, could not hope for the means of subsistence except by some laborious occupation in one of the frequent periods of long drought especially to which we are almost annually subject" (Legislature to Governor of Antigua, 2 November 1833, in *Sources of West Indian History*, ed. F. R. Augier and S. C. Gordon [London: Longman Group Ltd., 1962], p. 146). Despite the advantages of land monopoly and recurrent drought, the assembly passed the Contract Act along with their Proclamation of Freedom. The latter document reminded the soon to be freed slaves that as of 1 August 1834 they would be completely "dependent on their own honest and industrious labour for the necessities of life." It declared that the magistrates would be given the power to punish "all such as shall wander about in idleness, or attempt to make a living by Robbery, Theft or any dishonest means" (Douglas Hall, *Five of the Leewards 1834–1870* [Aylesbury, Bucks: Ginn and Company Ltd., 1971], p. 17). Under the Labour Contract Act, workers were required to enter into contracts, in writing or otherwise, with the proprietors of the estates on which they had lived as slaves. The British Secretary of State for the Colonies disallowed the act and a second Labour Contract Act was passed in 1835. The new Labour Contract Act stipulated that all disputes that arose between workers and employers should be heard and determined by a justice of the peace. A servant found guilty of any "Misdemeanor, Miscarriage or Ill-behaviour" could be punished by one month's imprisonment with "hard labour" at the "House of Correction" or by abatement of wages or discharge from employment ("An Act for the better adjusting and more easy recovery of the Wages of Servants in Husbandry, of Artificers, Handicraftsmen, and other Labourers, employed upon Plantations or Estates, and for the better regulation of such Servants, Artificers, Handicraftsmen and other Labourers, 1835," TNA: PRO CO 8/25). Absence from work "without reasonable cause," refusal to work, willful neglect of duties, and willful damage to the employer's property were all considered misdemeanors under the law. In the absence of a written contract, all laborers were deemed to be under a contract of "general hiring" of one calendar year in duration terminable by the giving of one month's notice by either party. Any person who knowingly employed a worker who was already under a contract of "general" or "special" hiring was liable to a fine of £10. A worker had the right to appeal the detention of wages by an employer to a justice of the peace. With many justices drawn from the planter or employing class, there was, however, no guarantee of a fair hearing. The Labour Contract Act was further strengthened in August 1865 by a new act which stipulated that the occupation of an estate house or tenement by a worker shall be considered as evidence that the worker had entered a contract of general hiring with the estate proprietor. The length of notification time required for the termination of a year-long contract of "general hiring" was increased from one to three calendar months. However, workers not under a "general" or "special" labor contract who worked for five days for any employer would be considered to be under a contract lasting for one calendar month. Such a contract was held to be renewable from month to month and was terminable by seven days notice given by either party before the expiry of the contract. The new Act retained the restrictive clauses and punishments of the previous act. Its new protective clauses, however, mandated the responsibility of the employer to provide medicine and medical attendance to workers employed under a contract of general hiring, the right of parents to object to a labor contract between an

employer and a worker under the age of twenty one, and the stipulation that the wage rate, in absence of an agreement to the contrary, would be the customary rate prevailing in the district. The Masters and Servants Ordinance passed in March 1922 to replace the Labor Contract Act gave the magistrate the power to impose a fine of 40/- or one month's imprisonment with hard labor in lieu of payment to any person convicted under the act. This was an attempt to address the growing protests against the Labor Contract Act by equalizing the punishments faced by employers and workers found guilty under the act. However, the inability of workers who received wages of no higher than 2/6 per day to pay a 40/- fine meant that its practical effects remained the same. The 1922 Masters and Servants Ordinance remained in force until the region-wide repeal of such legislation in 1938 by the British Colonial Office following the widespread labor disturbances in the British West Indies between 1934 and 1939 ("An Act for the better adjusting and more easy recovery of the Wages of Servants in Husbandry . . . 1835," TNA: PRO CO 8/25; "An Act to alter and amend 'An Act for the better adjusting and more easy recovery of the Wages of Servants in Husbandry, of Artificers, Handicraftsmen, and other Labourers, employed upon Plantations or Estates, and for the better regulation of such Servants, Artificers, Handicraftsmen and other Labourers,' 1865" TNA: PRO CO 8/30; "The Masters and Servants Ordinance, 1922," TNA: PRO CO 8/37; Arthur Lewis, *Labour in the West Indies: The Birth of a Worker's Movement* [London: New Beacon Books, 1977]; O. Nigel Bolland, *On the March: Labour Rebellions in the British Caribbean, 1934-39* [Kingston, Jamaica: Ian Randle Publishers, 1995]).

6. A wider range of items were subject to tax in Antigua than in any other territory in the Leeward Islands colony and the burden of taxation fell disproportionately upon items used by the poor. Import duties were levied on all foodstuff including salt beef, herring, mackerel, salt pork, cornmeal, and flour. However, steam engines and parts, oil to be used as fuel in oil engines, multiple effect machinery and parts of machinery for manufacturing sugar, and insecticides were exempt from import duties. Trade licenses were issued to porters and boatmen, watermen, and butchers (see "Schedule of Taxes, Duties, Fees and all other sources of Revenue," *LIBB*, 1901-1920, Sections A & 1).

7. As with most other British sugar colonies in the Caribbean, the system of absentee proprietorship was well established in the island of Antigua, with a high proportion of sugar estates being owned by absentee landowners who lived primarily in Britain. The leading estate proprietors in 1878 were absentees, including: Sir George W. H. Codrington, whose family holdings in Antigua dated from the seventeenth century and totaled 2,031 acres; Lord Combermere, whose four estates totaled 1,981 acres; and Fryers Sugar Concrete Company, the single largest estate proprietor with five sugar estates totaling 2,617 acres. Among the leading absentee estate owners were the heirs of Francis Shand, a resident estate owner in 1834 and a member of the Antiguan legislative assembly, who was prominently involved in the debates about slave abolition. Shand had returned to Britain by the 1840s, and in 1878 his British heirs were the owners of six sugar estates of 2,540 acres. The tendency of resident proprietors to move to Britain after they had accumulated a certain degree of wealth continuously reinforced the influence of the absentee owners and was not limited to British-born proprietors. John Athill, a colored estate proprietor who was a member of the legislative assembly and had held the positions of magistrate and postmaster of the island, migrated to England around 1836. By the twentieth century, the dominance of the absentee proprietors had been further strengthened by the establishment of a central sugar factory in 1904 by the British company Henckell-DuBuisson. By 1921 the firm had emerged as the largest estate proprietor in the island, owning seven estates totaling 3,762 acres. In 1943, under the leadership of Alexander Moody Stuart, manager of the sugar holdings of the British-owned central sugar factory, a single company known as the Antigua Syndicate Estates was established to manage all of the leading estates on the island. Moody Stuart, whose father had been the first managing director of Henckell-DuBuisson, was appointed general manager of the new sugar monopoly (Novelle Richards, *The Struggle and the Conquest: Thirty Five Years of Social Democracy in Antigua* [Portsmouth: Eyre and Spottiswoode Ltd., 1967], pp. 7, 19; Hall, *Five of the Leewards 1834-1870*, pp. 23-25, 117-118, 151-152, 188-203).

8. The *Antigua Sun* was established in 1908 and was in print until 1922. The publication of this daily newspaper was first reported in the *Dominica Guardian* of 30 October 1908. The termination of the *Sun* was reported in the *Dominica Guardian* of 27 July 1923 (Howard S. Pactor, *Colonial British Caribbean Newspapers: A Bibliography and Directory* [Westport, Conn.: Greenwood Press, 1990], p. 6).

9. The Newspaper Surety (Amendment) Act of 1919 required a bond of up to \$200.00 (Government of the Leeward Islands, *The Federal Act of the Leeward Islands containing acts of the General*

Legislative Council in force on 31.12.1927 [St. Johns, Antigua: The Government Printing Office, 1930]).

10. Similar to the legislation passed in Trinidad in 1919 and Barbados in 1920, the Seditious Publications (Prohibition) Act, Act No. 9 of 1920 that was passed in the Leeward Islands by the end of 1920 was directed against radical race-conscious publications like the *Negro World*. The Act made the importation or distribution of such publications a criminal offence (*Federal Act of the Leeward Islands containing acts of the General Legislative Council in force on 31.12.1927*, p. 23; Tony Martin, "Marcus Garvey and Trinidad, 1912–1947," in *The Pan-African Connection: From Slavery to Garvey and Beyond* [Dover, Mass.: Schenkman Publishing Company, 1983], pp. 70–71; Rodney Worrel, "Pan-Africanism in Barbados," in *The Empowering Impulse: The Nationalist Tradition of Barbados*, ed. Glenford Howe and Don Marshall [Kingston, Jamaica: The Canoe Press, 2001], p. 202).

11. Napoleon J. Francis was a UNIA organizer and representative of the BSL in Port-au-Prince, Haiti. He also served as president of the UNIA branch in Haiti in 1921 (*L'Essor* [Port-au-Prince], 25 November 1919; *NW*, 8 September 1921).

12. Samaná province, located on the northeastern coast of the present-day Dominican Republic, was the site of a large population of Samaná Americans (*Americanos de Samaná*), or the descendants of African-American settlers. The first group of these immigrants was resettled by the American Colonization Society in November 1824, when the island of Hispaniola was under the control of Haitian President Jean Pierre Boyer's administration. Boyer's pro-African immigration policy as well as Hispaniola's need for farmers and artisans enticed black Americans to move to Samaná; by 1870, a population of between 500 and 600 African Americans was living in Samaná. The province's isolation allowed these settlers to preserve separate cultures and communities. The African Americans in Samaná established an AME-affiliated church, opened English language schools, and even sought to hold political power in the region. The Samaná settlers' sustained connections to American culture and their commitment to freedom and equality, which was what contributed to their initial decisions to resettle, prompted their support for the United States' consideration of annexation of the Dominican Republic between 1870 and 1872. On 24 January 1871, a U.S. commission sent by Ulysses S. Grant's government arrived in Samaná to evaluate the plausibility of and the state of public opinion regarding annexation. Frederick Douglass served as the commission's secretary, and his trip to Samaná inspired in him a vision of Pan-Americanism. Today, around 80 percent of Samaná's population is still of African-American descent (H. Hoetink, "'Americans' in Samana," *Caribbean Studies* 2, no. 1 [1962]: 3–22; Millery Polyné, "Expansion Now!: Haiti, 'Santo Domingo,' and Frederick Douglass at the Intersection of U.S. and Caribbean Pan-Americanism," *Caribbean Studies* 34, no. 2 [2006]: 3–45; Nicholas Guyatt, "America's Conservatory: Race, Reconstruction, and the Santo Domingo Debate," *Journal of American History* 97, no. 4 [2011]: 974–1000; Ryan Mann-Hamilton, "Forgotten Migrations from the United States to Hispaniola," *Trotter Review* 19, no. 1 [2010]: 1–19).

Lieutenant-Colonel Charles O'Brien,
Governor, Barbados, to Viscount Milner,
Secretary of State, Colonial Office

Government House. 10th August 1920

Sir,

In continuation of my Secret despatch of the 24th June on the subject of the local branch of the "Universal Negro Improvement Association," I have the honour to attach a copy of a Police report and of the Programme of the largest meeting of this Association which has yet been held in Barbados. I submit that the programme and report of proceedings do not point to a dangerous associa-

tion so far as Barbados is concerned. The opening hymn is delightfully appropriate to a tropical land.¹ As I have stated in another despatch it will be seen that any meeting to be successful in this Colony must include among the items on the programme hymns and prayers and conclude with the National Anthem. This discounts the work of agitators in a considerable degree. I have the honour to be, My Lord, Your Lordship's most obedient humble servant,

CHARLES O'BRIEN
Governor

[*Handwritten minutes:*]

Mr. Grindle Mr. Wiseman Mr. Darnley

? Put by this & 42677

[*initials illegible*] 13/9

R[.] A[.] W[.] [R. A. Wiseman] 13/9/20

The Governor is a little too optimistic. If the Barbadian black led this organisation I dare say it would do no harm, but there is always danger about an organisation controlled, even imperfectly, by fanatically anti-white negroes in the U.S.

E[.] R[.] D[.] [E. R. Darnley] 13/9

I am glad to see they are collecting funds. Our experience is that this always leads to trouble, loss of the funds, & breakup of the organisation—cf the Cox effort in Jamaica.²

G[.] G[.] [G. Grindle] 13.9.20

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/33396. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Secret."

1. Composed by Richard Heber (1783–1826), an Anglican clergyman and the bishop of Calcutta, in 1819, "From Greenland's Icy Mountains" was chosen as the official hymn for the opening of UNIA meetings. The hymn was written for the Society for the Propagation of the Gospel, one of the oldest missionary societies, founded in 1701. The hymn's first stanza is "From Greenland's icy mountains, / From India's coral strand, / Where Afric's sunny fountains / Roll down their golden sand; / From many an ancient river, / From many a palmy plain, / They call us to deliver / Their land from error's chain" (Louis FitzGerald Benson, "From Greenland's Icy Mountains," chap. 6 in *Studies of Familiar Hymns*, [Philadelphia: Westminster Press, 1926], pp. 63–74; Ian Donnachie and Carmen Lavin, eds., *From Enlightenment to Romanticism: Anthology I* [Manchester: Manchester Univ. Press, 2003], pp. 266–267).

2. A reference to Solomon Alexander Gilbert Cox (1871–1922), more popularly known as "Sandy" Cox or "The People's Sandy," the founder and moving spirit of the National Club in Jamaica. Cox entered the Jamaican government service at an early age and worked as a legal clerk in the Judicial Department for twenty years before studying law at the Middle Temple in London. He was called to the bar in July 1908 and returned to Jamaica to become deputy clerk of the Court for the Parish of St. James. Cox left the post in January 1909 amid charges by the governor for libel, charges he was unsuccessful in fighting.

Founded on 3 March 1909, the National Club was Jamaica's first nationalist political organization. It was created to expose and redress the abuses of the Crown Colony government in Jamaica, focusing on "coolie" immigration, the judicial system, education, and the autocratic methods of the governor, Sir Sydney Olivier. It proposed to develop a "more liberal policy" for Jamaica by contesting the seats of Legislative Council members who in the general election of 1911 did not pledge to support the policy of the National Club. By this means, it hoped to control a political majority in

the council. The National Club's manifesto declared that only native-born Jamaicans could be members and that each member must pledge himself to Jamaican self-government. The official organ was *Our Own*, a bimonthly that appeared from July 1910 to July 1911. The title of the journal was influenced by the Irish Sinn Féin movement (*Sinn Féin* is Gaelic for "our own"). The National Club proposed to amalgamate with the Labor Federation of Trinidad in order to form a National League of the West Indies, but nothing came of the idea. At the outset of the National Club, Cox had also proposed to affiliate it with the Labour party in England to promote trade unions in Jamaica. For the early history of trade unionism in Jamaica, see George Eaton, "Trade Union Development in Jamaica," *Caribbean Quarterly* 8, no. 1 (n.d.): 43-53.

On 3 March 1909, the National Club launched a concerted political campaign against the governor, and in December, Cox submitted a statement to the secretary of state for the colonies seeking the removal of Governor Olivier from Jamaica. Prior to this action, Cox had won election to the Legislative Council as the member for the parish of St. Thomas, only to find himself suspended from the council six months later, in May 1920, for publishing the proceedings of a select committee appointed to examine charges that Cox had made against certain prison officials. But with the January 1911 general election, Cox was returned as the member for St. Thomas. A court petition challenged the legality of his election on technicalities regarding the residency requirement and income, and Cox was unseated by a court decision in June 1911.

Denied its principal voice in the legislature, the National Club soon floundered for lack of support. In October 1911, Cox went to Panama and Costa Rica to raise funds to revive his antigovernment newspaper in Jamaica, *The Daily News* ("The People's Paper"), which had discontinued publication in June 1911. But instead of returning to Jamaica, he migrated to the United States in November 1911, where he practiced as an attorney in Boston. Despite his residence abroad, Cox continued to write frequent letters to the Jamaican press on political subjects, though it appears that he disavowed politics completely after he became a Christian Scientist in 1913. When he died, the *Gleaner* noted that "Cox swayed remarkable influence over large sections of the masses of the country" (*Gleaner*, 13 December 1922; *HJ*).

*Enclosure: Lieutenant-Corporal James Jones,
Detective, Barbados Police, to Captain J. R.
Anderson, Inspector, Barbados Police*

[Barbados,] 3.8.20

Sir,

I respectfully report that a Concert was held by the Universal Negro Improvement Association at the Olympic Theatre Hall at 3 p.m. on the 1st August 1920. The Hall was filled with Members and friends of the Association, numbering between seven or eight hundred persons. The President of the Concert was one Israel Lovell,¹ and the Chairman was one James Simmons.

Lovell in his opening remarks stated that the subject of the meeting was a Race for a Continent and a Continent for a Race, that the organization is started for the purpose of teaching the negroes how to respect themselves, and that every intelligent negroe [negro] should join the organization of the Universal Negr[o] Improvement Association, so that they may be able to win back for themselves the glories of Ethiopia. It is customary in this Island to give the negroes a few dollars and a pat on the shoulder and tell him he is well paid, and that it is time that every negroe should rise to a sense of his condition.

Mr Simmons, who acted as Chairman, said every body present knew what the gathering in the hall meant. Their effort is to launch back to their dear old home Africa. That there are news spreading about that the U.N.I. Association is spreading propaganda to lead to a riot, but that is not so. We do not tell the people to steal or do anything that is wrong. All that is required, the negroe must put their pennies together and join the organization for their improvement.

Mr F. Gittens gave a short address and said the time has come that Ethiopian has stretched out her hand unto God, and he will help her. It is true he said that the negroes has been hampered for a long time. The people in other parts of the world have been united together, and we at Barbados can be united also. Some people stand aside and look on. Others said we will see what will happen; but that is not the way. We have all suffered together, and if we are to be liberated we must be liberated together.

Mr M. Inniss gave an address and said his heart went out with grief for the down trodden race. We are glad we have joined h hands with Mr Marcus Garvey, who is to-day at Liberty Hall, New York, holding a conference trying to reclaim what has been stolen 85 years ago. We have been oppressed but have been taught to bear our oppression. Very often our own people oppress us more than the white man. It is said in the sweat of man[']s brow he shall eat bread. We sweats, but we do not get what we sweats for. I exhort you to be loyal and law abiding. Any man who is tried and punished before a Judge or Magistrate will also be punished by this Association.

Reverend Cragwell, a Mission Minister from Shop Hill, St Thomas, also gave a short address and said I am one of the pillows (?) of this organization. Mr Marcus Garvey has brought us a flag as a race. God is no respecter of persons. God gave us Africa. Our forefathers was stolen and brought out as slaves and our good land Africa was stolen from us. The cry of the oppressed of Barbados has gone up to God, and he has sent us Mr Marcus Garvey, an inspired man, who has raised the Black Star Line. There is a hand outstre[t]ched across the waters, our destiny lies in our own hands. There is justice, liberty, and equality pending, but unless we be united we will never achieve it. To-day is the ~~beginning~~ //day// of a beginning of years of liberty.

The Concert ended at 6.20 p.m. The Crowd was orderly, and behaved well. I have attached one of their programmes for your perusal.

(sgd) JAMES JONES
L/Cpl

[*Handwritten minutes:*] Hon: Col: Secy:

This is the biggest meeting held by this Ass[ociation] in Barbados.

I was present for some time & can report that the Meeting was well conducted, perfect order being maintained.

THE MARCUS GARVEY AND UNIA PAPERS

The report attached gives a fairly accurate description of the proceedings.

[C. H. R.] Ag. I.G. P. 4/8/20

His Excy.

Reported Sir

[*initials illegible*] 4/8/20

Hon Col Secy

This is interesting as supporting my recent despatch to S. of S. form of agitation in B'dos of [UN.I.A.] It will [entail] some labour but I shd. like copies of this report & programme typed & then if you will let me have my last despatch I will send whole //report & programme [on]// to Sec of State with my comments as it shd. be of interest.

C. O'B. [C. O'Brien] 5.8.20

HE

Herewith last desp: Sir & copies asked for

[*initials illegible*] 9/8/20

Draft despatch herewith for typing.

C. O'B. 10.8.20

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/33396. TL. Barbadian Government minutes, BDA. Marked "Confidential."

1. Israel Lovell would become critical of the ideological development that the Garvey movement underwent in Barbados. His political speeches were steeped in the history of economic and social relations between workers and employers in the colony. In one speech he stated: "We make the wealth of this country and get nothing in return. Our slave fathers were in a better condition than we are in today. The world is against us, so let us unite in mass formation and stand up like men" (Hilary Beckles, *A History of Barbados: From Amerindian Settlement to Nation-State* [Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1990], pp. 167-168).

AUGUST 1920

Enclosure: UNIA Concert Program

[Barbados, ca. 1 August 1920]

PROGRAMME OF CONCERT

UNDER THE AUSPICES OF
THE UNIVERSAL NEGR[O] IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION

SUNDAY AUGUST 1ST 1920

SUBJECT[:] A RACE FOR A CONTINENT AND A CONTINENT FOR A RACE

Opening hymn—From Greenland's Icy Mountains

PRAYER

Introduction of Chairman by President

- | | | |
|----------------------------------|------------|-------------------------------|
| 1. Awake and Sing | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 2. A Struggling Race | Recitation | By Master Harding. |
| 3. Sing Oh Sing his Goodness | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 4. Two Great Men, Past & Present | Recitation | By Master Seale. ¹ |
| 5. Violin Solo | | By Mr Sealey. |
| 6. Address | | By Mr Davis. |
| 7. I will Call upon the Lord | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 8. May Women go Abroad | Recitation | By Miss Harris. |
| 9. A Vision of the King | Recitation | By Miss Goring. |
| 10. How Excellent | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 11. Address | | By Mr M. Inniss. |
| 12. Anchored at last | Duet | By Miss Greaves and Wilson. |
| 13. Our Ship of State | Recitation | By Miss King. |
| 14. Selection by Band | | |
| 15. Address | | By Mr F. Gittens. |
| 16. They that Trust in the Lord | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 17. Sensitiveness | Recitation | By Miss Harris. |
| 18. Life's Railway | Trio | By Miss Cragwell and others. |
| 19. Praise waileth for Thee | Solo | By Mr Maxwell. |
| 20. Address | | By Mr I Lovell. |
| 21. Thou Crownest the Year | Anthem | By Choir. |

Address from CHAIR

God Save THE KING

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/6964. TD.

1. Possibly Herbert Seale, a Garveyite who became an active trade union leader in the Barbados Progressive League (BPL) and later the Barbados Workers' Union. Seale was a committed radical whose militant left wing positions upset the moderate gradualists within the union. He was removed from his position in the union and replaced by Grantley Adams, who told the people to

“abandon their militant leaders and militant actions and to rely henceforth on his advocacy.” Abandoned and ostracized, Seale’s name has disappeared from the annals of Barbadian politics (O. Nigel Bolland, *On the March: Labour Rebellions in the British Caribbean, 1934–39* [Kingston, Jamaica: Ian Randle Publishers, 1995], pp. 123–124).

Done
1/14/20

Programme OF CONCERT

— UNDER THE AUSPICES OF THE —
UNIVERSAL NEGRO IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION

SUNDAY, AUGUST 1ST. 1920.

SUBJECT : A RACE FOR A CONTINENT.
 AND A CONTINENT FOR A RACE.

6/14/20

OPENING HYMN :—From Greenland's Icy Mountains.

PRAYER

INTRODUCTION OF CHAIRMAN BY PRESIDENT

- | | | |
|-----------------------------------|------------|----------------------------|
| 1. Awake and Sing | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 2. A Struggling Race | Recitation | By Master Harding. |
| 3. Sing Oh Sing his Goodness | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 4. Two Great Men Past and Present | Recitation | By Master Seal. |
| 5. Violin Solo | | By Mr. Sealey. |
| 6. Address | | By Mr. Davis. |
| 7. I will Call upon the Lord | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 8. May Women Go Aboard | Recitation | By Miss Harris. |
| 9. A Vision of the King | Recitation | By Miss Goring. |
| 10. How Excellent | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 11. Address | | By Mr. M. Inniss. |
| 12. Anchored at last | Duet | Misses Greaves and Wilson. |
| 13. Our Ship of State | Recitation | Miss King. |
| 14. Selection By Band. | | |
| 15. Address | | Mr. F. Gilleus. |
| 16. They that Trust in the Lord | Chorus | By Choir. |
| 17. Penitence | Recitation | By Miss Harris. |
| 18. Life's Railway | Trio | Miss Cragwell and others. |
| 19. Praise Waileth for Thee | (Solo) | Mr. Maxwell. |
| 20. Address | | By I Lovell. |
| 21. Thou Crownest the Year | Anthem | By Choir. |

ADDRESS FROM CHAIR.

UNIA Convention Programme
(Source: TNA: PRO CO 318/355/6964)

UNIA Declaration of Rights

[[New York, 13 August 1920]]

PREAMBLE

Be It Resolved, That the Negro people of the world, through their chosen representatives in convention assembled in Liberty Hall, in the City of New York and United States of America, from August 1 to August 31, in the year of Our Lord one thousand nine hundred and twenty, protest against the wrongs and injustices they are suffering at the hands of their white brethren, and state what they deem their fair and just rights, as well as the treatment they purpose to demand of all men in the future.

We complain:

1. That nowhere in the world, with few exceptions, are black men accorded equal treatment with white men, although in the same situation and circumstances, but, on the contrary, are discriminated against and denied the common rights due to human beings for no other reason than their race and color.

We are not willingly accepted as guests in the public hotels and inns of the world for no other reason than our race and color.

2. In certain parts of the United States of America our race is denied the right of public trial accorded to other races when accused of crime, but are lynched and burned by mobs, and such brutal and inhuman treatment is even practiced upon our women.

3. That European nations have parcelled out among them and taken possession of nearly all of the continent of Africa, and the natives are compelled to surrender their lands to aliens and are treated in most instances like slaves.

4. In the southern portion of the United States of America, although citizens under the Federal Constitution, and in some States almost equal to the whites in population and are qualified land owners and taxpayers, we are, nevertheless, denied all voice in the making and administration of the laws and are taxed without representation by the State governments, and at the same time compelled to do military service in defense of the country.

5. On the public conveyances and common carriers in the southern portion of the United States we are jim-crowed and compelled to accept separate and inferior accommodations and made to pay the same fare charged for first-class accommodations, and our families are often humiliated and insulted by drunken white men who habitually pass through the jim-crow cars going to the smoking car.

6. The physicians of our race are denied the right to attend their patients while in the public hospitals of the cities and States where they reside in certain parts of the United States.

Our children are forced to attend inferior separate schools for shorter terms than white children, and the public school funds are unequally divided between the white and colored schools.

7. We are discriminated against and denied an equal chance to earn wages for the support of our families, and in many instances are refused admission into labor unions and nearly everywhere are paid smaller wages than white men.

8. In the Civil Service and departmental offices we are everywhere discriminated against and made to feel that to be a black man in Europe, America and the West Indies is equivalent to being an outcast and a leper among the races of men, no matter what the character attainments of the black men may be.

9. In the British and other West Indian islands and colonies Negroes are secretly and cunningly discriminated against and denied those fuller rights of government to which white citizens are appointed, nominated and elected.

10. That our people in those parts are forced to work for lower wages than the average standard of white men and are kept in conditions repugnant to good civilized tastes and customs.

11. That the many acts of injustices against members of our race before the courts of law in the respective islands and colonies are of such nature as to create disgust and disrespect for the white man's sense of justice.

12. Against all such inhuman, unchristian and uncivilized treatment we here and now emphatically protest, and invoke the condemnation of all mankind.

In order to encourage our race all over the world and to stimulate it to overcome the handicaps and difficulties surrounding it, and to push forward to a higher and grander destiny, we demand and insist on the following Declaration of Rights:

1. Be it known to all men that whereas all men are created equal and entitled to the rights of life, liberty and the pursuit of happiness, and because of this we, the duly elected representatives of the Negro peoples of the world, invoking the aid of the just and Almighty God, do declare all men, women and children of our blood throughout the world free denizens, and do claim them as free citizens of Africa, the Motherland of all Negroes.

[2.] That we believe in the supreme authority of our race in all things racial; that all things are created and given to man as a common possession; that there should be an equitable distribution and apportionment of all such things, and in consideration of the fact that as a race we are now deprived of those things that are morally and legally ours, we believed it right that all such things should be acquired and held by whatsoever means possible.

3. That we believe the Negro, like any other race, should be governed by the ethics of civilization, and therefore should not be deprived of any of those rights or privileges common to other human beings.

4. We declare that Negroes, wheresoever they form a community among themselves should be given the right to elect their own representatives to represent them in Legislatures, courts of law, or such institutions as may exercise control over that particular community.

5. We assert that the Negro is entitled to even-handed justice before all courts of law and equity in whatever country he may be found, and when this is denied him on account of his race or color such denial is an insult to the race as a whole and should be resented by the entire body of Negroes.

6. We declare it unfair and prejudicial to the rights of Negroes in communities where they exist in considerable numbers to be tried by a judge and jury composed entirely of an alien race, but in all such cases members of our race are entitled to representation on the jury.

7. We believe that any law or practice that tends to deprive any African of his land or the privileges of free citizenship within his country is unjust and immoral, and no native should respect any such law or practice.

8. We declare taxation without representation unjust and tyrannous, and there should be no obligation on the part of the Negro to obey the levy of a tax by any law-making body from which he is excluded and denied representation on account of his race and color.

9. We believe that any law especially directed against the Negro to his detriment and singling him out because of his race or color is unfair and immoral, and should not be respected.

10. We believe all men entitled to common human respect and that our race should in no way tolerate any insults that may be interpreted to mean disrespect to our race or color.

11. We deprecate the use of the term "nigger" as applied to Negroes, and demand that the word "Negro" be written with a capital "N."

12. We believe that the Negro should adopt every means to protect himself against barbarous practices inflicted upon him because of color.

13. We believe in the freedom of Africa for the Negro people of the world, and by the principle of Europe for the Europeans and Asia for the Asiatics, we also demand Africa for the Africans at home and abroad.

14. We believe in the inherent right of the Negro to possess himself of Africa and that his possession of same shall not be regarded as an infringement on any claim or purchase made by any race or nation.

15. We strongly condemn the cupidity of those nations of the world who, by open aggression or secret schemes, have seized the territories and inexhaustible natural wealth of Africa, and we place on record our most solemn determi-

nation to reclaim the treasures and possession of the vast continent of our forefathers.

16. We believe all men should live in peace one with the other, but when races and nations provoke the ire of other races and nations by attempting to infringe upon their rights[,] war becomes inevitable, and the attempt in any way to free one's self or protect one's rights or heritage becomes justifiable.

17. Whereas the lynching, by burning, hanging or any other means, of human beings is a barbarous practice and a shame and disgrace to civilization, we therefore declare any country guilty of such atrocities outside the pale of civilization.

18. We protest against the atrocious crime of whipping, flogging and overworking of the native tribes of Africa and Negroes everywhere. These are methods that should be abolished and all means should be taken to prevent a continuance of such brutal practices.

19. We protest against the atrocious practice of shaving the heads of Africans, especially of African women or individuals of Negro blood, when placed in prison as a punishment for crime by an alien race.

20. We protest against segregated districts, separate public conveyances, industrial discrimination, lynchings and limitations of political privileges of any Negro citizen in any part of the world on account of race, color or creed, and will exert our full influence and power against all such.

21. We protest against any punishment inflicted upon a Negro with severity, as against lighter punishment inflicted upon another of an alien race for like offense, as an act of prejudice and injustice, and should be resented by the entire race.

22. We protest against the system of education in any country where Negroes are denied the same privileges and advantages as other races.

23. We declare it inhuman and unfair to boycott Negroes from industries and labor in any part of the world.

24. We believe in the doctrine of the freedom of the press, and we therefore emphatically protest against the suppression of Negro newspapers and periodicals in various parts of the world, and call upon Negroes everywhere to employ all available means to prevent such suppression.

25. We further demand free speech universally for all men.

26. We hereby protest against the publication of scandalous and inflammatory articles by an alien press tending to create racial strife and the exhibition of picture films showing the Negro as a cannibal.

27. We believe in the self-determination of all peoples.

28. We declare for the freedom of religious worship.

29. With the help of Almighty God we declare ourselves the sworn protectors of the honor and virtue of our women and children, and pledge our

lives for their protection and defense everywhere and under all circumstances from wrongs and outrages.

30. We demand the right of an unlimited and unprejudiced education for ourselves and our posterity forever[.]

31. We declare that the teaching in any school by alien teachers to our boys and girls, that the alien race is superior to the Negro race, is an insult to the Negro people of the world.

32. Where Negroes form a part of the citizenry of any country, and pass the civil service examination of such country, we declare them entitled to the same consideration as other citizens as to appointments in such civil service.

33. We vigorously protest against the increasingly unfair and unjust treatment accorded Negro travelers on land and sea by the agents and employes of railroad and steamship companies, and insist that for equal fare we receive equal privileges with travelers of other races.

34. We declare it unjust for any country, State or nation to enact laws tending to hinder and obstruct the free immigration of Negroes on account of their race and color.

35. That the right of the Negro to travel unmolested throughout the world be not abridged by any person or persons, and all Negroes are called upon to give aid to a fellow Negro when thus molested.

36. We declare that all Negroes are entitled to the same right to travel over the world as other men.

37. We hereby demand that the governments of the world recognize our leader and his representatives chosen by the race to look after the welfare of our people under such governments.

38. We demand complete control of our social institutions without interference by any alien race or races.

39. That the colors, Red, Black and Green, be the colors of the Negro race.

40. Resolved, That the anthem "Ethiopia, Thou Land of Our Fathers etc.," shall be the anthem of the Negro race. (Copy anthem appended.)

THE UNIVERSAL ETHIOPIAN ANTHEM

POEM BY BURRELL AND FORD^I

I.

Ethiopia, thou land of our fathers,
Thou land where the gods loved to be,
As storm cloud at night sudden gathers
Our armies come rushing to thee.
We must in the fight be victorious
When swords are thrust outward to glean;

AUGUST 1920

For us will the vict'ry be glorious
When led by the red, black and green.

CHORUS

Advance, advance to victory,
Let Africa be free;
Advance to meet the foe
With the might
Of the red, the black and the green.

I I.

Ethiopia, the tyrant's falling,
Who smote thee upon thy knees
And thy children are lustily calling
From over the distant seas.
Jehovah the Great One has heard us,
Has noted our sighs and our tears,
With His spirit of Love [H]e has stirred us
To be One through the coming years.

CHORUS—Advance, advance, etc.

I I I.

O, Jehovah, [T]hou God of the ages[,]
Grant unto our sons that lead
The wisdom Thou gave to Thy sages
When Israel was sore in need.
Thy voice thro' the dim past has spoken,
Ethiopia shall stretch forth her hand,
By Thee shall all fetters be broken
And Heav'n bless our dear fatherland.

CHORUS—Advance, advance, etc.

41. We believe that any limited liberty which deprives one of the complete rights and prerogatives of full citizenship is but a modified form of slavery.

42. We declare it an injustice to our people and a serious impediment to the health of the race to deny to competent licensed Negro physicians the right to practice in the public hospitals of the communities in which they reside, for no other reason than their race and color.

43. We call upon the various government[s] of the world to accept and acknowledge Negro representatives who shall be sent to the said governments to represent the general welfare of the Negro peoples of the world.

44. We deplore and protest against the practice of confining juvenile prisoners in prisons with adults, and we recommend that such youthful prisoners be taught gainful trades under human[e] supervision.

45. Be it further resolved, That we as a race of people declare the League of Nations null and void as far as the Negro is concerned, in that it seeks to deprive Negroes of their liberty.

46. We demand of all men to do unto us as we would do unto them, in the name of justice; and we cheerfully accord to all men all the rights we claim herein for ourselves.

47. We declare that no Negro shall engage himself in battle for an alien race without first obtaining the consent of the leader of the Negro people of the world, except in a matter of national self-defense.

48. We protest against the practice of drafting Negroes² and sending them to war with alien forces without proper training, and demand in all cases that Negro soldiers be given the same training as the aliens.³

49. We demand that instructions given Negro children in schools include the subject of "Negro History," to their benefit.

50. We demand a free and unfettered commercial intercourse with all the Negro people of the world.

51. We declare for the absolute freedom of the seas for all peoples.

52. We demand that our duly accredited representatives be given proper recognition in all leagues, conferences, conventions or courts of international arbitration wherever human rights are discussed.

53. We proclaim the 31st day of August of each year to be an international holiday to be observed by all Negroes.

54. We want all men to know that we shall maintain and contend for the freedom and equality of every man, woman and child of our race, with our lives, our fortunes and our sacred honor.

These rights we believe to be justly ours and proper for the protection of the Negro race at large, and because of this belief we, on behalf of the four hundred million Negroes of the world, do pledge herein the sacred blood of the race in defense, and we hereby subscribe our names as a guarantee of the truthfulness and faithfulness hereof, in the presence of Almighty God, on this 13th day of August, in the year of our Lord one thousand nine hundred and twenty.

SIGNATURES:

Marcus Garvey, James D. Brooks, James W. H. Eason, Henrietta Vinton Davis, Lionel Winston Greenidge, A[dr]ian Fitzroy Johnson,⁴ Rudolph Ethe[l]bert Brissaac Smith,⁵ Charles Augustus Petioni,⁶ Rev. Thomas H. N. Simon,⁷ Richard Hilton Tobitt, George Alexander McGuire, Rev. Peter Edward

Batson,⁸ Reynold R. Felix,⁹ Harry Walters Kirby,¹⁰ Sarah Branch,¹¹ Mme. Marie Barrier Houston, Mrs. Georgie L. O'Brien,¹² F. O. Ogilvie,¹³ Arden A. Bryan,¹⁴ Benjamin Dyett,¹⁵ Marie Duchaterlier, John Phillip Hodge, Theophilus H. Saunders, Wilford H. Smith,¹⁶ Gabriel E. Stewart,¹⁷ Arnold Josiah Ford, Lee Crawford,¹⁸ William McCartney, Adina Clem. James, William Musgrave LaMotte,¹⁹ John Sydney de Bourg, Arnold S. Cunning,²⁰ Vernal J. Williams,²¹ Francis Wilcem Ellegor,²² J. Frederick Selkridge,²³ Innis Abel Horsford,²⁴ Cyril A. Crichlow,²⁵ Rev. Samuel McIntyre, Rev. John Thomas Wilkins,²⁶ Mary Thurston, John G. Befue, William Ware,²⁷ Rev. J. A. Lewis,²⁸ O. C. Kelly, Venture R. Hamilton,²⁹ R. H. Hodge, Edward Alfred Taylor, Ellen Wilson, G. W. Wilson,³⁰ Richard Edward Riley,³¹ Miss Nellie Grant Whiting,³² G. W. Washington, Maldena Miller, Gertrude Davis,³³ James D. Williams, Emily Christmas Kinch,³⁴ Dr. D. D. Lewis,³⁵ Nettie Clayton,³⁶ Partheria Hills,³⁷ Janie Jenkins,³⁸ John C. Simons,³⁹ Alphonso A. Jones,⁴⁰ Allen Hobbs,⁴¹ Re[y]nold Fitzgerald Austin,⁴² James Benjamin Yearwood, Frank O. Raines,⁴³ Shedric[k] Williams,⁴⁴ John Edward Ivey,⁴⁵ Frederick Augustus Toote,⁴⁶ Philip Hemmings,⁴⁷ Rev. F. F. Smith,⁴⁸ D. D., Rev. E. J. Jones,⁴⁹ Rev. Dr. Joseph Josiah Cranston,⁵⁰ Frederick Samuel Ricketts, Dugald Augustus Wade, E. E. Nelom, Florida Jenkins,⁵¹ Napoleon J. Francis, Joseph D. Gibson,⁵² J. P. Jasper, J. W. Montgomery,⁵³ David Benjamin, J. Gordon,⁵⁴ Harry E. Ford,⁵⁵ Carrie M. Ashford,⁵⁶ Andrew N. Willis, Lucy Sands, Louise Woodson, George D. Creese,⁵⁷ W. A. Wallace,⁵⁸ Thomas E. Bagley,⁵⁹ James Young,⁶⁰ Prince Alfred McConney, John E. Hudson, William Ines, Harry R. Watkins [Watkis],⁶¹ C. L. Halton, J. T. Bailey, Ira Joseph Toussa[i]nt Wright, T. H. Golden, Abraham Benjamin Thomas,⁶² Richard C. Noble,⁶³ Walter Green,⁶⁴ C. S. Bourne, G. F. Bennett, B. D. Levy, Mrs. Mary E. Johnson,⁶⁵ Lionel Antonio Francis,⁶⁶ Carl Roper, E. R. Donawa, Philip Van Putten, I. Brathwaite,⁶⁷ Rev. Jesse W. Luck,⁶⁸ Oliver Kaye, J. W. Hudspeth,⁶⁹ C. B. Lovell,⁷⁰ William C. Matthews,⁷¹ A. Williams,⁷² Ratford E. M. Jack, H. Vinton Plummer,⁷³ Randolph Phillips, A. I. Bailey, duly elected representatives of the Negro people of the world.

Printed in NW, 11 September 1920. Headlines omitted. Notarized on 15 August 1920 by John G. Rayne.

1. Arnold Josiah Ford (1877–1935), composer and religious scholar, was musical director for the UNIA at Liberty Hall in the early 1920s. Ford was born in Barbados and was a member of the musical corps of the Royal Navy during World War I. He moved to Harlem in the postwar years and was attracted to the UNIA because of its concern with African repatriation. He wrote many UNIA hymns, including the “Universal Ethiopian Anthem” and “Shine On, Eternal Light,” and authored the Universal Ethiopian Hymnal. Ford was affiliated with his own synagogue, Beth B’nai Abraham, and with the Commandment Keepers congregation, another black Hebrew temple located in Harlem. Always interested in African colonization, Ford traveled to Ethiopia in the early 1930s to consider the possibility of his congregation sponsoring a settlement there. He attended the coronation of Haile Selassie and received a land grant from the Ethiopian ruler for the establishment of a colony. Ford encouraged members of his congregation to emigrate, and more than fifty came to settle in Ethiopia. Internal factionalism and hostility from external forces caused the small colony to fail, and most of the emigrants returned to the United States. Ford died in Addis Ababa

one year after the community's dissolution (K. J. King, "Some Notes on Arnold J. Ford and New World Black Attitudes to Ethiopia," *Journal of Ethiopian Studies* 10, no. 1 [January 1972]: 81-87; William R. Scott, "Rabbi Arnold Ford's Back-to-Ethiopia Movement: A Study of Black Emigration, 1930-1935," *Pan-African Journal* 7 [Summer 1975]: 191-202; *MGP* 2: 395 n. 1; *WWCA*).

2. A confidential report by the office of the French high commissioner in Washington D.C. states that the total number of African Americans drafted under the Selective Service draft, as of October 1918, stood at 311,000. An additional 39,000 were also called up to serve that same autumn, while regular regiments and the National Guard also included 20,000 blacks. The aggregate total serving in the U.S. Army by the end of the war thus stood at 370,000, of which 1,200 were officers. A logical continuation of the recruitment of Africans during World War I was the French decree of 19 July 1919, which instituted the universal draft in Africa. African military service lasted three years, not the eighteen months customary in France. Not all men eligible for the draft were actually called up; many were simply required to remain available for service (TNA: PRO WO 106/532, note for General Corvisart, French Military Mission attached to the British Imperial General Staff, 3 November 1918; Marc Michel, *L'appel à l'Afrique: Contributions et réactions à l'effort de guerre en AOF, 1914-1919* [Paris: Publications de la Sorbonne, 1982], pp. 421-424).

3. The draft law, passed in May 1917, provided for the registration of all male U.S. citizens between the ages of twenty-one and thirty-one. African-American conscripts were treated very differently from their white counterparts, however. African Americans were provided with inferior clothing, food, shelter, and medical attention at training camps throughout the nation. In addition, these conscripts, unlike whites, were used primarily for manual labor. Consequently, while all whites received basic training, military training of African Americans was inconsistent and, often, provided only after a day's manual labor. African Americans assigned to units intended for combat were often ill prepared; the Fifteenth New York Regiment, for example, during training drills in Peekskill, N.Y., was provided with sticks as a substitute for firearms. By the end of the war, only 20 percent of African-American troops had been in combat (Arthur E. Barbeau and Florette Henri, *The Unknown Soldiers: Black American Troops in World War I* [Philadelphia: Temple University Press, 1974], pp. 44-55, 96-100, 141).

4. Adrian Johnson was a colonel in the New York African Legion. Probably the son of West Indian immigrants, he grew up in Panama and served in the British army in World War I. He was a delegate to the 1920 UNIA convention, where he occupied a seat on the platform with Garvey. He worked closely with Garvey in the months following the convention and traveled to divisions outside New York to speak on behalf of the organization. In July 1921 Garvey reported that Johnson had brought over two thousand new members into the New Orleans division during an organizing tour of Louisiana. Johnson organized in the Northeast as well as in the South and Southwest and was a frequent speaker at Liberty Hall. He and E. L. Gaines led the African Legion on horseback in the opening parade of the 1921 UNIA convention. He was nominated to be West Indian leader of the Eastern Province during the convention proceedings and was chosen as a speaker for the next convention. However, during the 1922 convention, Garvey had him impeached for not paying his UNIA dues. Although Johnson protested that the other officers shared his failure to pay dues, he was successfully impeached by a majority of the delegates present. Attendance at the convention fell off after his impeachment, apparently in response to Garvey's autocratic handling of the matter. Although he was stripped of his office, Johnson remained active at the convention as a delegate. When Garvey was criticized for his alleged alliance with the Ku Klux Klan, Johnson brought a motion that a vote of confidence be taken, and Garvey successfully won the endorsement of the delegates. In 1951 Johnson was secretary-general of the wing of the UNIA affiliated with Lionel Francis (*MGP* 2-5).

5. Rudolph E. B. Smith, a member of the UNIA Field Corps, was elected third assistant president general at the 1922 UNIA convention. He was a leading speaker at Liberty Hall in the 1920s, and as a delegate, he was one of the signatories of the UNIA Declaration of Rights, ratified at the 1920 convention. He was elected Leader of the Eastern Province of the West Indies at the 1921 UNIA convention and in 1922 became "UNIA leader of the western province of the West Indies." Smith often appeared as the speaker preceding Garvey at Liberty Hall in 1922. He signed the UNIA petition to the League of Nations in July 1922, and at the UNIA convention in August, he was nominated from the floor to be one of the UNIA delegates to travel to Geneva to present the petition. In a later session, Clifford Bourne charged Smith and other West Indian leaders with incompetence; Smith defended himself by stating that it had been under Garvey's orders that he had remained in the United States after his election to office in 1921. Garvey came to Smith's defense,

describing him as a loyal and devoted member of the UNIA, and explained that he had had Smith stay in the United States because of his excellent organizing and fundraising skills.

Smith briefly resigned from the UNIA in August 1922, citing the fact that he had received only a few hundred dollars in payment toward his UNIA salary. Smith's salary was suspended in June 1923, along with that of Henrietta Vinton Davis and others. He spoke of the extreme factionalization of the movement in 1922 and 1924 in his report to the 1924 UNIA convention, and he described his visits as an organizer to many divisions in the United States. By 1925, Smith had joined several other former UNIA leaders in filing suit against the UNIA for back salary, claiming over twelve thousand dollars that had never been paid to him.

6. Charles Petioni (1885–1951), a West Indian journalist and physician, was one of the signers of the 1920 UNIA Declaration of Rights. Born in Trinidad, Petioni moved to New York in 1918, studying at the City College of New York and Howard University Medical School and receiving his medical degree in 1935. He practiced in the outpatient department of Harlem Hospital, New York, in 1936. He edited a Spanish-English newspaper in Port of Spain in 1917–1918 and was associate editor of Hubert H. Harrison's *New Negro* in 1918 and a reporter for the *Negro World* while a medical student from 1921 to 1925. Petioni became a leading advocate of West Indian political rights. He organized a number of activist associations in New York, including the Trinidad Benevolent Association and the West India Committee in America (later called the Caribbean Union). He worked for Caribbean independence and West Indian economic autonomy throughout the 1930s and 1940s (*MGP* 2: 578–579 n. 1; *WWCA*).

7. Thomas H. N. Simon worked as a pastor (*MGP* 2: 683).

8. Peter Edward Batson was a pastor at the Community African Methodist Episcopal Church in New York. He reported to the 1920 UNIA convention that he had organized a division of the UNIA in Middletown, New York, which had begun with twenty members and had added twenty-six members in the previous six months. Batson was one of the five pastors who officiated at the 15 August 1920 Sunday service in Liberty Hall, at which the declaration of rights was read; he assisted in the religious services on the other Sundays during the convention period and appeared with UNIA officers and dignitaries in the closing convention parade (*NW*, 25 June 1921; *MGP* 2).

9. Reynold Randolph Felix of Saint Lucia, B.W.I., spoke on the status of labor in Saint Lucia at the 1920 UNIA convention, describing long hours and depressed wages in the cane and cocoa fields and the difficulties faced by black women occupied as coal carriers (*MGP* 2: 536).

10. Harry Walters Kirby was the president of the Washington D.C. division of the UNIA in 1921. He presided over a series of UNIA mass meetings in Washington in September 1920, in which Garvey gave the main addresses (*NW*, 4 June 1921; *MGP* 2–3).

11. Sarah Branch of Liberia was a UNIA activist who used her oratorical skills to organize for the movement. Journalist John E. Bruce praised Branch for her fund-raising ability, writing in unpublished notes for one of his "Bruce Grit" columns, "Sister Sarah Branch is a fine type of African womanhood and is a good organizer[,] an indefatigable worker [and] an enthusiastic speaker and can get more money for the association in a drive than almost any other woman speaker on the list of speakers" (NN-Sc, JEB). Branch appeared at the podium at Liberty Hall meetings in 1919–1921. She was elected one of the delegates from the New York division to attend the 1920 UNIA convention, where she shared the platform with Garvey and other UNIA officials. She told the convention audience that the term *Negro* "is simply a pet name that the white man, when he went to Africa and stole our foreparents, gave us" and urged the delegates to call themselves Africans (*MGP* 2: 517). Branch was president of the New York branch of the Black Cross Nurses in 1921 (*MGP* 2, 4).

12. Mrs. Georgie O'Brien also served as the lady president of the Montreal division of the UNIA in 1921 (*NW*, 7 May 1921).

13. F. O. Ogilvie was president of the Morón, Camagüey, division in Cuba in 1921.

14. Arden A. Bryan (1893–1971) was traveling field secretary and chief stock salesperson for the BSL from 1919 to 1921. Bryan was born in Barbados and worked in Panama before moving to the United States in 1914. He became an elevator operator in New York before he joined the UNIA. He traveled with Garvey on stock-selling trips to major cities in the Northeast in 1918 and 1919, collecting money for the Liberian Construction Loan and the African Redemption Fund as well as for the shipping line. He was a delegate from Barbados to the 1921 UNIA convention; became UNIA commissioner of Connecticut from 1921 to 1922; and briefly served as foreign affairs editor of the *Negro World*. Bryan resigned from the organization in 1922, after his request for a commissioner appointment over a field with a larger black population than Connecticut was refused by Garvey. He appeared as a witness for the defense at Garvey's mail-fraud trial the following year. In 1933 Bryan organized the Nationalist Negro Movement and African Colonization Association and

became its first president. The organization's goal was to obtain the former German colony of Kamerun (Cameroun) as a concession from the League of Nations, in order to begin a program of black American colonization (NW, 14 June 1919; *Marcus Garvey v. United States of America*, no. 8317, Ct. App., 2d Cir., 2 February 1925, pp. 1379–1400; MGP 1, 3).

15. Benjamin Dyett, a resident of Bermuda, addressed the issues of discrimination in governmental hiring practices and the relegation of black workers to menial positions in factory labor when he reported to the 1920 UNIA convention (MGP 2: 532).

16. Wilford H. Smith (b. 1863), counsel general of the UNIA and Garvey's personal attorney in 1920 and 1921, was born in Mississippi. Before moving to New York in 1901, he was a personal attorney to Booker T. Washington, working quietly with Washington to challenge the grandfather clause in Alabama voting laws. Smith was elected counsel general at the 1920 UNIA convention and was one of five members of the commission of UNIA officials that met with Liberian president C. D. B. King at the Waldorf-Astoria Hotel in New York in March 1921. He represented the BSL in a number of legal suits, including the libel case of *Black Star Line v. W. E. B. Du Bois and NAACP* (no. 1944), brought in the New York State Supreme Court in January 1921, and the September and October 1921 cases brought by former crew members of the S.S. *Kanawha* against the UNIA line for nonpayment of wages. He also handled Garvey's personal cases, including his legal entanglements with his first wife, Amy Ashwood, and his conflicts with Cyril Briggs. Garvey made Smith his personal representative and granted him power of attorney over financial matters of the BSL when he traveled outside the United States. Although a Bureau of Investigation agent reported that Smith resigned from his position with the UNIA in November 1921 because "he found Thompson, Garcia, Silverston and Nolan crooked," Smith seems to have remained loyal to Garvey and continued to act as his attorney. He approached the government with an offer for an out-of-court settlement of the mail-fraud case in July 1922 (Louis R. Harlan, *Booker T. Washington: The Making of a Black Leader, 1856–1901* [New York: Oxford University Press, 1972], p. 302; MGP 2–5).

17. Gabriel Stewart, high chancellor of the UNIA from 1920 to 1922 and master of ceremonies at UNIA meetings in New York when Garvey was out of the country in 1921, was an adroit fundraiser for the BSL. He was a member of the UNIA delegation that met with President C. D. B. King of Liberia in New York in March 1921 and was a prominent presence at the UNIA convention in August 1921. He signed the UNIA petition to the League of Nations in July 1922 but had become privately disillusioned with Garvey and the UNIA by that time. He resigned gracefully after reading his report on UNIA finances to convention delegates on 18 August 1922, restating his dedication to the ideals of the association but declining to hold further office. A Jamaican by birth, Stewart was a minister by profession before assuming his duties with the UNIA (NW, 12 March 1921; MGP 2–4).

18. Lee Crawford (1875–1942), born in Alabama, was active in many black fraternal and self-help organizations prior to joining the UNIA. In 1906 he was elected grand chancellor of the New York State chapter of the Knights of Pythias, a position he held until 1941. After migrating from the South to Yonkers, N.Y., Crawford eventually moved to New Rochelle, N.Y., where he became the president of the local branch of the NAACP (NYT, 2 May 1942; *New York Amsterdam News*, 9 May 1942).

19. William Musgrave LaMotte of Brooklyn addressed the 1920 UNIA convention on housing conditions in Brooklyn, the need for more business enterprises owned and operated by blacks, and the discrimination faced by black patrons of white-owned establishments (MGP 2).

20. Arnold S. Cunning was a delegate to both the 1920 and 1921 UNIA conventions. He served as secretary to the UNIA's chaplain general, George Alexander McGuire, and accompanied McGuire to Cuba in this capacity in 1921 (NW, 23 April and 16 July 1921; MGP 2: 579 n. 7, 682; MGP 3: 786, 789).

21. Vernal J. Williams (1896–1952), an attorney, was a UNIA field-worker in Washington D.C. who accompanied Garvey on an organizational tour in Pennsylvania in 1920. He served as assistant counsel general for the UNIA from 1921 to 1923 and represented Garvey in private cases. Williams was born in Brown's Town, Saint Ann, Jamaica, and moved to the United States in 1905. He worked in the settlement house movement prior to World War I, graduated from New York University Law School, and practiced law in New York. In 1921 he married Doris Collins, who may have been related to Garvey loyalist Ethel Collins. He was nominated for the position of UNIA secretary-general at the 1921 UNIA convention and was one of the signers of the UNIA petition to the League of Nations in July 1922. Williams resigned from the UNIA in a bitter disagreement with Garvey in August 1923. He formed the Consolidated Tenants League in New York in the 1930s and

wrote several articles in defense of tenants' rights. He was also active in the Jamaica Progressive League (*NW*, 11 September 1920; *NYT*, 9 February 1952; *UNIA v. Vernal J. Williams*, no. 32717, New York Supreme Court, 1923, records on appeal; *MGP* 2–6; *WWCA*).

22. Francis Wilcom Ellegor (1877–1928), commissioner general of the UNIA in 1921 and 1922, was born in Demerara, British Guiana, and educated at Durham University, Durham, England. In 1910 he was ordained as a priest in the Protestant Episcopal Church in Monrovia, Liberia, where he taught at Liberia College. He immigrated to the United States in 1916 and lived in Yonkers, N.Y. He became active in the UNIA and served as a delegate to the 1920, 1921, 1922, and 1924 conventions. He announced his resignation as high commissioner at the 1922 convention but continued to serve as a chaplain at meetings and as a member on key UNIA committees. At the beginning of the 1922 convention he was elected as a member of the UNIA delegation to the League of Nations (*MGP* 2, 4, 5).

23. John Frederick Selkridge was a bishop of the United Christian Church who became involved in the Garvey movement in the early twenties, first as a special adviser to Garvey and later as a stock salesperson and field agent for the Liberian Construction Loan and BSL. He officiated as a pastor over several sessions at the 1920 UNIA convention and helped organize that convention's grand parade. In 1920 Selkridge reported that he had lost a suitcase, and the stock certificates and loan notes it contained, while traveling in Pennsylvania; he was dismissed from his UNIA position in February 1921 for carelessness. He joined the African Orthodox Church and was ordained into its ministry in May 1926. He served as pastor at the Christ Church in Brooklyn (*NW*, 26 February and 10 September 1921; *Negro Churchman* [New York] 4, no. 4 [April 1926]: 8, reprinted in *The Negro Churchman: The Official Organ of the African Orthodox Church* [Millwood, N.Y.: Kraus Reprint Co., 1977]; *MGP* 2–4).

24. Innis Abel Horsford was president of the New Haven division of the UNIA in 1920 and 1921. He represented New Haven at the 1920 UNIA convention, where he addressed the issues of discrimination against blacks in Connecticut hospitals, the underpayment of black women in the labor force, and the need for trade schools to educate black youth (*NW*, 3 and 31 December 1921; *MGP* 2).

25. Cyril A. Crichlow (b. 1889), naturalized American stenographer and accountant from Belmont, Trinidad, W.I., was a member of the UNIA commission to Liberia in February 1921 and served on the UNIA's executive council. He resigned from the UNIA while in Liberia in June 1921, after a dispute arose between him and Gabriel Johnson over the proper administration of funds and distribution of authority. Although the executive council rejected his resignation and cabled him money to enable him to return to New York, Crichlow persisted in withdrawing. He filed a report on UNIA activities in Monrovia, in which he expressed little optimism for the success of the organization's colonization goals. Joining the rival African Blood Brotherhood, founded by Cyril Briggs, the same year, he sued the UNIA for back salary. In December 1921 Crichlow published "What I Know about Liberia," criticizing Garvey in Briggs's *Crusader* magazine (World War I Draft Registration Cards, 1917–1918 [database online], Provo, Utah: Ancestry.com, 7 June 2007; *Crusader* 5, no. 4 [December 1921]: 20–23; 6, no. 1 [January–February 1922]: 18–23; *MGP* 1–4).

26. John Thomas Wilkins, a pastor, was executive secretary of the UNIA in New York in 1918–1919 (*NW*, 1 February and 5 April 1919; *MGP* 1).

27. William Ware (b. 1872) was president of the Cincinnati division of the UNIA. Born in Lexington, Ky., Ware had organized the Welfare Association for Colored People (WACP) in Cincinnati before he attended the 1920 UNIA convention. Returning to Cincinnati after the convention, he re-organized the WACP as a division of the UNIA, reportedly building its membership to nearly eight thousand. He was a delegate to the 1921, 1922, and 1924 UNIA conventions and was a member of the UNIA committee of presidents in 1925. Moreover, Ware was a candidate for speaker at the pro-Garvey emergency convention called in Detroit in March 1926. Garvey appointed him UNIA high commissioner for Ohio, Indiana, and Kentucky in January 1928. After the split between the American-based and West Indian-based wings of the movement at the 1929 UNIA convention in Jamaica, Ware refused to affiliate the Cincinnati division with the pro-Garvey UNIA, August 1929, of the World. While praising Garvey as an individual, Ware unsuccessfully pressed charges against seventeen people who started a new Cincinnati division in affiliation with Garvey's Jamaica-based group. Garvey responded by disavowing Ware's authority within the UNIA in the pages of the *Negro World* and by endorsing the rival division headed by R. H. Bachelor. In 1931 Ware wrote a series of letters reporting allegedly fraudulent activities of Garvey to the U.S. attorney general, Department of State, and postmaster general (William Ware to the U.S. attorney general's office, 2

February 1931, DNA, RG 59; NW, 27 March 1926, 21 January 1928, 21 June, 8 November, and 6 December 1930, 14 April 1931; Wendell P. Dabney, *Cincinnati's Colored Citizens* [Cincinnati: Dabney Publishing, 1926], pp. 213–214; MGP 2, 3, 5–7; WWCA).

28. J. A. Lewis was a pastor (MGP 2).

29. Venture Hamilton was one of the early members of the UNIA in Jamaica when it met in Collegiate Hall in 1915 (DG, 4 February 1915; MGP 1).

30. G. W. Wilson of Hartford, Conn., represented Connecticut at a UNIA conference at Liberty Hall in April 1921 on the purchase of the S.S. *Phyllis Wheatley*. The conference was attended by almost forty presidents of various branches from the West Indies and the United States (MGP 2, 3).

31. Richard E. Riley served as deputy of the African Legion for the New Aberdeen, Nova Scotia, division of the UNIA (NW, 4 June 1921).

32. Nellie Grant Whiting of Newport News, Va., reported to the 1920 UNIA convention on residential segregation in Newport News and the white ownership of commercial establishments in black neighborhoods. She also addressed the conciliatory attitudes of black small-business people and preachers and the assistance of preachers in the suppression of the local division of the UNIA (MGP 2).

33. In 1921 Gertrude Davis was the UNIA Cleveland division's lady president (NW, 19 March 1921).

34. Emily Christmas Kinch (d. 1932) was an African-American missionary to Africa, an educator, and a UNIA activist. Kinch was born in Orange, N.J., and was raised within the AME Church, in which her father, Rev. Jordan C. H. Christmas, was a prominent pastor. She became the first president of the AME New Jersey Conference's Sunday School Institute before she became a missionary. She lived in West Africa from 1908 to 1910, doing missionary work in Sierra Leone and in Liberia, where she organized the Eliza Turner Primary School. After returning to the United States, she wrote a pamphlet, *West Africa: An Open Door*, based on her missionary experience; she also became a recruiter of African-American missionaries to Africa. Kinch spoke to a UNIA meeting at Liberty Hall in June 1920, lauding the UNIA's repatriation program, telling her audience that the time was ripe for "going back to Africa and possessing the land. . . . Africa never was in a more susceptible, receptive mood for the U.N.I.A. than today" (MGP 2: 385–386). UNIA potentate Gabriel Johnson visited her in Philadelphia when he came to the United States in July 1921, and she contributed to the African Redemption Fund in September of that year (Randall K. Burkett, *Black Redemption: Churchmen Speak for the Garvey Movement* [Philadelphia: Temple University Press, 1978], pp. 43–46; MGP 2, 4).

35. D. D. Lewis, president of the Montreal UNIA division in 1920, was a medical doctor practicing at a sanitarium. A Garvey loyalist, he was prominent as a speaker at UNIA meetings. At the 1920 UNIA convention, he sat on the platform with Garvey and other UNIA dignitaries at the opening session and addressed the delegates in the first day's afternoon and evening sessions. Paying prolonged tribute to Garvey, he also noted the presence of "my own countryman, the Lord Mayor of Monrovia, the Hon. Mr. Johnson" (MGP 2: 486). On 3 August he spoke about the status of blacks in Canada, particularly in the province of Quebec, commenting that when the UNIA was "first introduced in Quebec it was only the toiling class—the railroad men—who took kindly to it." He said that the UNIA represented a move away from otherworldly salvation and instead offered a way to work for change "in this world" (MGP 2: 523–524). Lewis gave several other short addresses at the convention, including one on the afternoon that the UNIA Declaration of Rights was read to the delegates at large. He was sworn in as UNIA surgeon general at the end of the convention (MGP 2).

36. Nettie Clayton, a delegate from Pittsburgh to the 1920 UNIA convention, spoke from the floor on the issue of racial discrimination in urban housing (MGP 2).

37. Partheria E. Hills was still a UNIA member in 1926, when she petitioned for executive clemency toward Garvey after he was sentenced to prison (DNA, RG 204, file 42-793).

38. Janie Jenkins (1879–1926), an early Garvey loyalist, was born in Baltimore. She met Garvey in 1917 and became active in the UNIA. In 1918 she was second vice president of the organization and one of the incorporators of the African Communities League. In 1919 she was assistant treasurer of the UNIA, president of the Ladies' division, and one of the incorporators and first directors of the BSL. She was reelected to the BSL board in 1920 and 1921. In June she was elected as a delegate to represent the New York division at the 1920 UNIA convention. Jenkins appeared as a witness for the defense at Garvey's mail-fraud trial in 1923, and Garvey praised her testimony in his closing address to the jury. She was unmarried and employed as a domestic worker when she died in February 1926 (NW, 3 July 1920, 20 February 1926; *Garvey v. U.S.*, pp. 1336–1340; MGP 1–3, 5).

39. John C. Simons, a minister, was a contributor to the African Redemption Fund in September 1921 (*MGP* 2, 3).

40. Alphonso A. Jones was director of the UNIA's trucking and delivery service (*NW*, 26 February 1921).

41. Allen Hobbs was an agent of the BSL in Norfolk, Va., in 1920 and president of the Norfolk division of the UNIA in 1921. He was a delegate to the 1920 and 1921 UNIA conventions (*NW*, 19 February 1921; *MGP* 2, 3).

42. Reynold Fitzgerald Austin was president of the Brooklyn division (*NW*, 19 March 1921).

43. Frank O. Raines was a member of the Chicago chapter of the UNIA (*NW*, 25 June 1921).

44. Shedrick Williams was president of the Cleveland division in 1921. At the 1920 UNIA convention, he addressed the issue of Jewish-black relations in his report, stating that he had found Jews in Cleveland supportive of blacks in the area of employment. Garvey praised Williams's work in Cleveland at a February 1921 meeting, saying that Williams had increased the membership by some twenty-five hundred members and had purchased a Liberty Hall for use by the division. Williams was a delegate to the 1921 and 1922 UNIA conventions (*NW*, 19 February 1921; *MGP* 2-3).

45. John Edward Ivey of Costa Rica was one of several delegates representing Central America at the 1920 UNIA convention (*MGP* 2).

46. Frederick Augustus Toote (1895-1951?) was president of the Philadelphia division of the UNIA (division 47) and a member of the BSL board of directors. Born in Nassau, Bahamas, Toote was the son of Thaddeus Toote, a member of the Bahamian House of Assembly and a well-known merchant. He was educated at Boys' Central School in Nassau, and after immigrating to the United States, he became a student at the City College of New York. He reportedly completed a master's degree at Drake University, Des Moines, Iowa, as well as a theological course at the Philadelphia Divinity School prior to his ordination into the priesthood of the AOC in April 1923. He was elected speaker of the 1920 UNIA convention, during which the *Negro World* praised him as "next to President Garvey in energy" (*NW*, 21 August 1920). At the time, the membership of the Philadelphia UNIA was estimated at 9,500, making it one of the largest divisions. During 1921 Toote became an associate member of the Bahamas Rejuvenation League. After he was ordained by George Alexander McGuire, founder of the AOC, he immediately became the associate editor of the church's organ, the *Negro Churchman*. He was also appointed dean of the Bishop Holly Theological School but was stripped of both posts by the September 1924 synod. Toote reemerged as an influential UNIA leader shortly after Garvey's imprisonment in February 1925, spearheading the revival of the Philadelphia division after a precipitous drop in membership. In March 1926 Toote was elected first assistant president general (*NW*, 7 March 1925; *Crusader* 4, no. 1 [March 1921]: 10; *Negro Churchman* [New York] 1, no. 5 [May 1923]: 3, and no. 9-10 [September-October 1923]: 9-11, reprinted in *The Negro Churchman: The Official Organ of the African Orthodox Church* [Millwood, N.Y.: Kraus Reprint Co., 1977]; *Drake University Yearbook*, 1907).

47. Philip Hemmings, a Jamaican immigrant to Philadelphia, was a delegate to the 1920 UNIA convention from the Philadelphia division. Hemmings praised the work of Fred A. Toote and Rev. J. W. H. Eason from the floor of the convention, crediting the two men with the success of the Philadelphia division. In 1916 Hemmings was among a group of Jamaican residents of the United States who wrote to the editor of the *Jamaica Times* (7 October 1916), reporting that Garvey's lectures in the United States had been "pernicious, misleading, and derogatory to the prestige of the [Jamaican] government and the people." The letter went on to question Garvey's assertions that poverty and vice in Jamaica were the results of low wage scales, that education was not extended to the lower classes, that racial intermarriage was not beneficial to black people, and that Anglo-Jamaicans were prejudiced against blacks. Hemmings apparently changed his opinion of Garvey in the ensuing years (*MGP* 1, 2).

48. F. F. Smith (d. 1921) was a Philadelphia pastor. His death was announced to the delegates of the 1921 UNIA convention by Secretary-General James Benjamin Yearwood, who referred to Smith, among others, as a "very active and very influential" member (*MGP* 3: 642).

49. E. J. Jones was a pastor (*MGP* 2).

50. Joseph Josiah Cranston, pastor in the Universal Ethiopian Church, was president of the Baltimore division of the UNIA in 1920 and 1921. He spoke with Rev. James D. Brooks at a UNIA fund-raising meeting at the Mount Carmel Baptist Church in Washington D.C. in July 1920, praising the international character of the Garvey movement and comparing Garvey to such leaders of the past as Moses and Frederick Douglass. He also compared the aims of the UNIA to those of the Irish independence movement. The militancy of his rhetoric on that occasion was matched by his statement to his fellow delegates at the 1920 UNIA convention: "I hope that as we marched along

in this great procession today, the time will not be far distant when we shall congregate ourselves as a mighty army marching to the conquest of our motherland, Africa" (*MGP* 2: 496). Cranston was ordained presbyter in the Church of God by George Alexander McGuire in April 1921. He resigned from the presidency of the Baltimore division in spring 1921 and instead worked for the UNIA in Pittsburgh. He was a candidate for the newly created post of second assistant president general at the 1921 UNIA convention, losing the election to Robert L. Poston (*NW*, 19 June 1920, 7 May 1921; *MGP* 2).

51. Florida Lee Jenkins remained active in the UNIA following the 1920 convention; she contributed to the African Redemption Fund in September 1921 (*MGP* 2, 4).

52. Joseph D. Gibson (1880?–1963) was the first president of the Boston division of the UNIA (formed in November 1920) and the surgeon general of the UNIA from 1920 to 1922. Born in Saint-Pierre, Martinique, Gibson attended schools in Grenada before immigrating to the United States in 1909. He attended Holmes Institute in Atlanta and in 1915 received his medical degree from the Boston College of Physicians and Surgeons. He failed his first attempts to qualify for a medical license and served as a ship's surgeon before finally obtaining his license to practice medicine in West Virginia in 1922. Garvey had Gibson impeached at the 1922 UNIA convention for alleged disloyalty and incompetency, based on his failure to obtain a license to practice medicine in the state of New York and his criticism of Garvey's autocratic methods in administering the organization. During the impeachment proceedings, Gibson testified that he had loaned the BSL money for the purchase of ships, that he had not been repaid for these loans, and that he had been paid only a fraction of his salary while a UNIA officer. In January 1923 he contacted the U.S. Shipping Board in an effort to receive a rebate of the monies he had invested in the BSL. He moved to Logan, W. Va., where he worked as a physician for the United Mine Workers. He was a candidate for the U.S. Congress in 1933 and was active in Republican party politics throughout the 1940s and 1950s (*NW*, 8 May 1920, 12 August 1922; *NYT*, 16 November 1963; *MGP* 2, 4, 5).

53. John W. Montgomery was a delegate to the 1920 UNIA convention from Grand Bassa, a seaport southeast of Monrovia, Liberia, now known as Buchanan (*MGP* 2).

54. John D. Gordon, an African American minister, was assistant president general of the UNIA in 1920 and 1921. Born in La Grange, Ga., he attended Morehouse College in Atlanta and was pastor of the Mt. Olive Baptist Church in that city before moving to California in 1903. In Los Angeles, he became a community leader and founded the Tabernacle Baptist Church. He served as a delegate to the National Equal Rights League meeting in Chicago in September 1918.

Gordon became involved in the UNIA while in New York in 1919 and, as a major participant in the 1920 UNIA convention, was elected to the executive council. The founding ceremony of the Los Angeles division of the UNIA took place in his Tabernacle Baptist Church in January 1921. Though one of Garvey's closest aides and confidants between the 1920 and 1921 conventions, he resigned from the organization at the 1921 convention after Garvey accused him of mismanaging UNIA funds. Gordon sued the UNIA for back payment of salary and returned to Los Angeles, where he became involved in the Pacific Coast Negro Improvement Association, a faction of the UNIA that opposed Garvey's methods of leadership. Garvey temporarily reconciled his differences with Gordon during a peacemaking tour of California in June 1922, after which Gordon rejoined the UNIA, remaining a member until November 1923 (*NW*, 14 August 1920 and 27 August 1921; Emory J. Tolbert, *The UNIA and Black Los Angeles* [Los Angeles: Center for Afro-American Studies, University of California, 1980], pp. 42–62; *MGP* 2–3).

55. Harry E. Ford, one of the signers of the UNIA Declaration of Rights, was from Rahway, N.J. (*MGP* 2).

56. Carrie M. Ashford was a leader in the Atlantic City division of the UNIA. She often presided over UNIA meetings in Atlantic City in the early 1920s. She also served as the Atlantic City delegate to the 1921 UNIA convention (*NW*, 30 April 1921; *MGP* 2–3).

57. George D. Creese represented Nova Scotia and eastern Canada at the 1920 UNIA convention, where he reported on labor conditions experienced by blacks in the iron and steel industries. Creese was an active member of the Sydney–New Aberdeen, Nova Scotia, division. He was appointed commissioner to Canada at the 1921 UNIA convention and was active on the floor of the convention in 1922. He recommended in 1922 that the convention consider ways to improve relations between the local divisions and the parent body in New York (*NW*, 16 July and 10 September 1921; *MGP* 2–3).

58. William A. Wallace (1867–1946) was president of the Chicago division in the 1920s and secretary-general of the UNIA in 1926. Born in Port Deposit, Md., Wallace attended Lincoln University in Pennsylvania. He operated a bakery in Chicago from 1904 to 1924 and represented Chicago

at the 1920, 1921, and 1922 UNIA conventions and the UNIA conference at Liberty Hall in April 1921. He was nominated for the position of secretary-general during the August 1921 election proceedings. He participated at the emergency conference called in Detroit in March 1926 and was elected secretary-general of the national body after being recommended for the post by Fred A. Toote. Garvey appointed Wallace UNIA high commissioner for the states of Missouri, Kansas, and Illinois in January 1928. In the early 1930s he began a career as a county worker, beginning at the Cook County Recorder's Office and holding a series of positions in the ensuing years. He was elected to the state senate from the Third District of Illinois in 1938 (Fred A. Toote to Marcus Garvey, 16 March 1926, Atlanta Federal Records Center, records of Atlanta penitentiary; NW, 27 March 1926, 27 January 1928; *Who's Who in Chicago and Illinois* [Chicago: A. N. Marquis Co., 1945], p. 867; MGP 3-6).

59. Thomas E. Bagley was a delegate to the 1920 UNIA convention from Stamford, Conn. He spoke from the floor during the 4 August 1920 session, addressing the issues of fair housing and the lack of race consciousness among blacks in Stamford (NW, 14 August 1920; MGP 2).

60. James Young of Pittsburgh organized a series of meetings in Pittsburgh when Garvey and his entourage made an organizational tour of the city in September–October 1920. A Bureau of Investigation agent reported in October 1920 that Young was planning to organize the movement throughout Allegheny County, particularly among mill workers in Homestead and other mill towns (MGP 2-3).

61. Harry R. Watkis (often incorrectly referred to as Harry "Watkins") was a BSL stock salesman and traveling secretary of the UNIA from February through October 1920. Watkis was born in Jamaica and was a young schoolmate of Garvey. He immigrated to the United States in 1902 and passed the bar examination in Missouri. In late 1920, while selling stock, he was arrested in Youngstown, Ohio, and charged with fraud. After spending the night in jail, he used UNIA money to deposit bond and did not return for prosecution. He resigned from the UNIA soon after this experience and quarreled with Amy Jacques Garvey. He subsequently sued the UNIA for back salary, claiming that no salary had been paid him in Youngstown or elsewhere. Watkis appeared as a prosecution witness at Garvey's 1923 mail-fraud trial (*Garvey v. U.S.*, pp. 783-833; MGP 2).

62. Probably Dr. A. Ben Thomas, optometrist and leader in the Toronto UNIA (NW, 7 May 1921).

63. Richard C. Noble of Norfolk, Va., reported to the 1920 UNIA convention that conditions in Norfolk were better than those in most southern cities. He addressed the issue of the reactions of black ministers to the Garvey movement, saying that while some pastors took a conservative view of racial organization, others had done the association good by preaching in accordance with its aims (MGP 2).

64. Walter Green, a railway mechanic from Portsmouth, Va., and a regular reader of the *Negro World*, joined the UNIA in 1919 after experiencing disillusionment with the discriminatory policies of the AFL, with which he had been active for five years. He introduced a resolution to support black organizers in the field at the AFL convention in Buffalo in November 1917, only to see the resolution die in committee. He then became involved in the National Brotherhood of Workers of America, a black industrial union for both men and women that was chartered in Washington D.C., in March 1919 (NW, 19 July 1919; MGP 1, 2).

65. Mary E. Johnson was president of the UNIA's Hartford women's division in 1921, and she also served as executive secretary of the Women's Industrial Exhibit at the August 1921 convention (NW, 23 April and 16 July 1921).

66. Lionel Antonio Francis was a Trinidad-born physician practicing in London at the time he visited the United States to attend the 1920 convention. Educated at Howard University and the University of Edinburgh, Francis soon became one of Garvey's chief lieutenants and the extremely able president of the large UNIA division in Philadelphia, from 1921 until his resignation in 1924. He rejoined the UNIA in 1931 when he was elected president general of the UNIA, Inc., the New York group that split with Garvey after Garvey moved his headquarters to Jamaica. Francis led the UNIA, Inc., in its lengthy court battle with Garvey over the large Isaiah Morter estate. After the fifteen-year struggle ended in 1939, Francis went to Belize, British Honduras, to administer the estate on behalf of the victorious New York faction (NW, 19 March 1921, 6 May 1933; CD, 18 November 1939).

67. Isaac Newton Brathwaite was coproprietor with fellow UNIA member Cyril A. Crichlow of the Crichlow-Brathwaite Shorthand School in New York (NW, 14 August 1920).

68. Jesse W. Luck, a pastor from Newark, N.J., reported to the 1920 UNIA convention that he had participated in laying the claims of the UNIA before the Ministers' Conference in Newark and

that the ministers of the city had expressed their willingness to cooperate with the movement. He also addressed the issue of racial segregation in New Jersey, describing discrimination against black working women in that state's factories and public places and expressing his own bitterness as a veteran of World War I who had fought with whites abroad only to be denigrated by them at home (*MGP* 2).

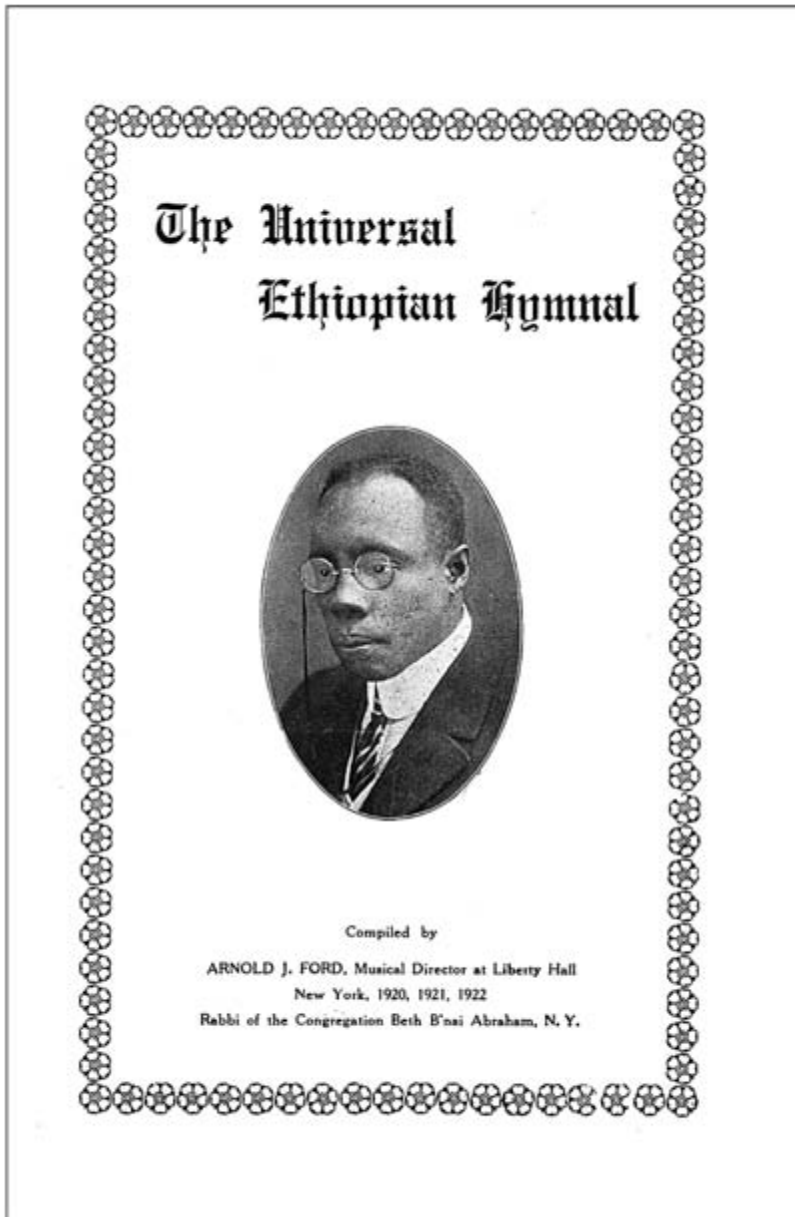
69. J. W. Hudspeth was later a contributor to the 1922 UNIA Convention Fund (*NW*, 6 May 1922).

70. C. B. Lovell was also president of the Home Progressive Association, a black real estate venture, in Brooklyn (*NW*, 28 August 1920).

71. William Clarence Matthews (1877–1928), an Alabama-born lawyer, completed his early education at Tuskegee Institute in 1897. He later attended Phillips Andover Academy, Andover, Mass., and Harvard University, from which he graduated in 1905. As a student at Andover and Harvard, Matthews won wide acclaim as a football and baseball player; for a brief period he played semiprofessional baseball in Vermont. In 1907, after earning a law degree from Boston University, he opened a law practice in Boston with William H. Lewis (1869–1949), a supporter of Booker T. Washington, and subsequently served as one of the political lieutenants of the Tuskegee machine. These connections enabled him to obtain a patronage position as a special assistant to the U.S. district attorney for Boston. Matthews served in France during World War I. Although he became a supporter of Garvey and the UNIA, he resumed his involvement in Republican party politics; he was appointed special assistant to the U.S. attorney general as a reward for his role in the successful 1924 campaign of President Calvin Coolidge (Phillips Andover Academy Archives, vertical file; Harvard College, class of 1905, *Report*; *WWCR*).

72. Arthur Williams (b. 1881), a chiropractor, was active in the UNIA in Seattle. He was born in Magnolia, Miss., and attended the Columbia Institute of Chiropodists in New York. He moved to Seattle in 1908 (*MGP* 2; *Who's Who in Religious, Fraternal, Social, Civic, and Commercial Life on the Pacific Coast, 1926–1927* [Seattle: Searchlight Publishing Co., 1927], p. 211).

73. Henry Vinton Plummer (b. 1876), a real estate salesperson in Washington D.C. and Maryland, became the head of the BSL Bureau of Publicity and Propaganda and the chief of Garvey's secret service staff. Plummer was born in Hyattsville, Md. His father, Henry Vinton Plummer, Sr., was the first black chaplain to serve in the U.S. Army after the Civil War. The junior Plummer excelled in school; in 1889 he was valedictorian of his otherwise all-white high school class in Wyoming. He attended the University of Nebraska from 1897 to 1900 and was admitted to the bar in Omaha. He ran unsuccessfully as a Republican candidate for the Nebraska state legislature and later moved to Washington D.C., where he established a real estate business in 1910. He was the assistant sergeant at arms at the Progressive party's national convention in 1922. He became involved in the UNIA African Legion in Newport News, Va., and in 1920 helped drill recruits and rewrite the U.S. Army drill regulations for use by the legions. Plummer relocated to New York, where he was a member of the UNIA delegation that greeted Liberian president C. D. B. King in March 1921. He participated in the 1920, 1922, and 1924 UNIA conventions as a delegate from New York (*NW*, 12 March and 27 August 1921; *MGP* 2–5; *WWCR*).



Cover of the *The Universal Ethiopian Hymnal*

The Universal Ethiopian Anthem

(National Anthem of the Universal Negro Improvement
Association and African Communities' League)

POEM BY BURRELL AND FORD

I.

Ethiopia, thou land of our fathers,
Thou land where the gods loved to be,
As storm cloud at night sudden gathers
Our armies come rushing to thee.
We must in the fight be victorious
When swords are thrust outward to glean;
For us will the vict'ry be glorious
When led by the red, black and green.

CHORUS

Advance, advance to victory,
Let Africa be free;
Advance to meet the foe
With the might
Of the red, the black and the green.

II.

Ethiopia, the tyrant's falling,
Who smote thee upon thy knees
And thy children are lustily calling
From over the distant seas.
Jehovah the Great One has heard us,
Has noted our sighs and our tears,
With His spirit of Love he has stirred us
To be One through the coming years.

CHORUS—Advance, advance, etc.

III.

O, Jehovah, thou God of the ages
Grant unto our sons that lead
The wisdom Thou gave to Thy sages
When Israel was sore in need.
Thy voice thro' the dim past has spoken,
Ethiopia shall stretch forth her hand,
By Thee shall all fetters be broken
And Heav'n bless our dear father land.

CHORUS—Advance, advance, etc.

The Universal Ethiopian Anthem

Article in the *Negro World*

[New York, 14 August, 1920]

PANAMA SOCIETY SENDS MONEY TO CONVENTION

Mr. F. S. Ricketts, president of the Colon Independent Mutual Benefit Co-operative Society, arrived in New York last week for the August convention and has handed into the secretary the sum of \$50.00 as coming from the Society.

Printed in *NW*, 14 August 1920.

AUGUST 1920

Herbert J. Read, Assistant Under Secretary of
State, Colonial Office, to the Under Secretary
of State, Foreign Office

Downing Street, //19// August, 1920

Sir,

With reference to your letter of the 6th April, (A.1849/443/45), I am directed by Viscount Milner to transmit to you, to be laid before Earl Curzon of Kedleston, the accompanying copy of a despatch from the Governor of British Honduras, reporting on the circulation of the "Negro World" in the Colony, and on the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League.

2. I am to request that Lord Curzon's attention may be drawn to the references to the United States contained in the Governor's despatch. I am, Sir, Your most obedient servant,

H. J. READ

TNA: PRO FO 371/4567/5851. TLS, recipient's copy.

Enclosure: Eyre Hutson, Governor,
British Honduras, to Viscount Milner,
Secretary of State, Colonial Office

GOVERNMENT HOUSE, BELIZE,
10th May, 1920

My Lord,

I have delayed to acknowledge, or to make any reply to Your Lordship's despatches noted in the margin, the first one intimating that you would be prepared, if this Government considered it advisable, to approve of the exercise of stricter control over the press by means of legislation giving power to suppress any publications of a character either seditious or calculated to incite crime; the second despatch forwarding copy of correspondence regarding the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League.

2. My reason for not communicating with Your Lordship earlier on those subjects was that at the time of the receipt of the first despatch I was of opinion, that //having// in view the sittings of the Commission then proceeding to inquire into the cause of the riot in July last, and the then strong racial feeling which prevailed, and the endeavour which I considered should be made to remove that feeling, it would have been most impolitic to have introduced such

legislation. In this view I was supported by the Attorney General. The Chief Justice whom I subsequently consulted on the subject, has informed me that I was fully justified, in his opinion, in my inaction.

3. The position is that while the newspaper "The Negro World" was censored and withheld from distribution in the Colony in the early days of 1919, under the Defence of the Colony Regulations and under Section 3 of Chapter 130, the Post Office Ordinance by order of Mr. Walter, then Acting Governor, I had every reason to believe that the newspaper was being smuggled into the Colony through Mexico and Guatemala,¹ in larger numbers than before the ban was placed on it. It is almost impossible, in this Colony, to search persons and their luggage, particularly every coloured person arriving in the Colony from the countries named, or even from the United States. The same evasion of the order, no doubt, is still continued. The Defence of the Colony Regulations having lapsed, the order referred to has automatically been withdrawn. I have not called attention to that fact, and I do not propose to take any step in the matter, unless I am appro[ac]hed, and by last week's issue of the newspaper "Independent," copy of which I enclose, I see that a proposal is on foot to move me to withdraw the ban against "The Negro World." If I am properly approached in the matter, I propose to state that the order has lapsed, and to offer to subscribe to the newspaper, and to inform the applicants, who will be Members of the local branch of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League that my object in subscribing to the newspaper, if I am allowed to do so, will be to watch closely its writings and the policy of its advocate. I cannot help feeling that to adopt any other attitude would necessarily advertise the negro movement, and would give it an importance in this Colony which would do more harm than good at the present moment. This leads me to say that another American publication of the same origin as "The Negro World" has been entering this Colony freely for a long time[.] I refer to the Maga[z]ine—"The Crisis." This magazine is no doubt known to Your Lordship's Department already. I however enclose a copy handed to me by the Attorney General to whom //it// came addressed regularly quite unsolicited. It would seem that the supply in that manner savoured of a "trap" to lead to its suppression and to thereby give a ground for agitation and grievance.

The fact therefore remains that both publications have been arriving in the Colony regularly for some time past although the circulation of "The Negro World" is possibly not so wide as it would be if there had been no ban against its importation.

4. I have recently sought the advice of the Executive Council on the subject of passing legislation on the lines of the Straits Settlements Ordinance, and I was advised unanimously not to introduce such a Bill into the Legislative Council.² The law in force here in respect of crimes against public order is contained in Sections 232 et seq: of the Criminal Code. It will be seen that the law relating to sedition is not strong enough, and as compared with the Imperial Statute on the subject, is incomplete. The Attorney General is now engaged in

preparing notes for submission as to the amendment of the Criminal Code in the directions he considers advisable. I am of opinion, and the Attorney General agrees with me, that having in view the conditions here recently emphasized by the riots in July last, it would be more politic to attempt to enlarge the scope of the law against sedition if and when the Criminal Code is amended. The present law does not cover the law of sedition as known to the ordinary English Criminal law, particularly in regard to that part of it which deals with raising discontent and disaffection among His Majesty's subjects, and promoting feelings of ill-will and hostility between different classes of such subjects.

5. I will now touch on Your Lordship's Secret despatch of the 5th February last referring to the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League. I have not been able to ascertain whether the status of the West Indian Protective Society of America is such as to justify one's acceptance without question, of its statements. I am not prepared to accept all of them without official confirmation, and I am inclined to the opinion that their attitude, in some directions, is born of race prejudice, so rampant in the United States against the negro. It is possible that the whole movement underlying the Universal Negro Association and African Communities League was originated by German propaganda and money, and probably is still so supported by German Americans. On this point i//t// seems to me that His Majesty's Ambassador at Washington should be able to make enquiry and give advice. The fact that the Association and League is undoubtedly seditious, primarily against the United States Government, constitutes its danger. First, because Branch Associations and Leagues are being established in British Colonies whereby, some day, complaint may be made against the Governments of His Majesty's possessions, secondly, because the ignorant negro in British possessions is unable to discriminate, when reading the publications and journals of the Association, between the methods of the United States Government and officials, and those of the British Government and officials, and are apt to be led astray. So far as I am aware the United States Government has not declared the Association and League to be an illegal one; and therefore there is no need for the British Colonial Governments to take steps to that end. At least, I am not satisfied that such action would either be justified or politic at the present date.

6. The fact remains that following the local circulation of "The Negro World" and "The Crisis," correspondence followed between Marcus Garvey, the "potentate," and certain well known disaffected negroes in this Colony. Some months ago it was reported to me that meetings were being held in Belize, separate ones for men and women, at which the people were being urged to join the branch of the Association and League here, and to become independent of the white people. On the 21st ultimo I received through the Acting Colonial Secretary a letter from the Branch Association and League "inviting my patronage" at the unveiling of the "Charter of the Association" on the evening of the 22nd ultimo. I enclose a copy of the "Clarion" newspaper containing a copy of the letter, of the reply I caused to be sent, and an account

of the proceedings of the meeting. I have since received from the General Secretary Mr. S. A. Haynes, his apologies for not having supplied me with full information as to the aims and objects of the Association and League, and he forwarded to me a copy of the "Constitution and Book of Laws." I forward the copy herewith in case Your Lordship's Department has not been already furnished with a copy. I have made some marginal notes against portions of the contents of the brochure.

It is a very cleverly composed document, a dangerous one, and I am inclined to think that it emanates from some enemy propaganda source—probably aimed in the main against the United States Government in fomenting racial trouble in that country; and indirectly against British possessions in the West Indies. One danger in this Colony is the fact that cut off as we are from any direct connection or communication with any British possession the sympathies and connections of the negro population are to a very large extent American. They look on New Orleans and New York as the great centres of civilization; and look at political questions mainly from the aspect of the American negro. On the other hand, I am informed from a reliable source, that the movement here has not met with that general support expected by its promoters. The reason is as pathetic as amusing. It appears that from time immemorial the black or coloured man here has objected to the description of "Negro," and has adopted that of "Creole"³ the number of pure negroes in Belize is comparatively speaking small having regard to the total coloured population of the town. A larger proportion of them are of mixed descent, with a "dash" of European, Indian or Mexican blood in their veins. They are curiously enough apparently proud of their mixed blood descent, and I am informed are excessively annoyed at being expected to class themselves as "negroes[.]" If I have an opportunity offered to me I shall, with all due care, express to the principal men in the movement my views as to its dangers and of mixing the people of the Colony with what apparently really underlies the aims and objects of the parent association in the United States, namely, political agitation against the alleged disabilities being suffered by the negro in that country. The local General Secretary is Mr. S. A. Haynes, the returned member of the British Honduras Contingent whose conduct during the riot was commended in Your Lordship's despatch on that subject. I have endeavoured to befriend the man and have given him temporary employment in the Public Service as a Relieving Clerk. He is, I fear, a troublesome agitator and very intimate with the Editor of "The Independent." He recently sent me a petition asking me to release from prison the members of the British Honduras Contingents who were convicted for riot.⁴ On my informing him that I considered that I was not justified in interfering with the sentence of the Court, he has expressed his intention of addressing Your Lordship a Memorial on the same subject. The above is a clear indication of the spirit still alive here, namely one of entire lack of appreciation among the so called educated class of negro or "creole" of the gravity and

disgrace of the outburst on the 22nd July, 1919. I am convinced that this section still consider that there was full justification for the outbreak.

7. In conclusion, I desire to record that the Executive Council has advised me not to attempt to take any open action, at present, against the branch of the Negro Association and League. I had no intention of doing so: but I considered it proper to take the advice of the Council. I also am inclined to the opinion that the movement here, although regrettable on general grounds, will not be maintained and that if not opposed by the Government, it will die a natural death locally like most such movements among the coloured people in the West Indies. They are apparently still incapable of general co-operation, and they impose little trust in each other. I shall, of course, continue to watch the operations and conduct of the Association and League: but I do not propose to act on the suggestion of the West Indian Protective Society to place any obstacle in the way of visits of Negro Agents from the United States, although, should they arrive, I shall have their public utterances recorded. The present excitement locally is the election of a representative negro to be sent to New York, at an early date, to represent British Honduras at the "Convention" to be held there. I have, etc.,

(sd.) EYRE HUTSON
Governor

[*Note in the margin:*] S.S. Secret, 10-9-19.
S.S. Secret, 5-2-20.

[*Minutes:*] Mr. Grindle ~~Mr. Darnley~~

The ban on the "Negro World" having lapsed, the Governor considers that the wisest course to adopt is not to call attention to such publications and thus advertise the whole Negro movement. A similar opinion has been expressed by the Governor of Bermuda ([v]. desp. of 5th Apl on 20847 W.I.)

In the same way this Gov., while considering the Univ. Negro Imprt. Assn and African Communities League to be undoubtedly seditious, has been advised to take no action against their local branches, and believes by so doing that the movement will die down.

[*initials illegible*] 4/6/20

(1) "Negro World"

The Governor says that when the importation of this undesirable newspaper was prohibited, he had every reason to believe that it was smuggled into the Colony from Mexico and Guatemala in larger numbers than before. He regards it as impossible to stop this smuggling & accordingly has not

renewed the prohibition. I see no reason to dissent from this view.

(2) Seditious Publications Ordinance

The Governor was unanimously advised by the Executive Council not to introduce a bill on the lines of the Straits Settlements Ord[inance] which we sent out. The reasons appear to have been that, as explained in connection with the "Negro World," it is not possible to prevent such publications from being smuggled into the Colony, and //that it// would be mischievous to provoke negro opinion, already inflamed, by such legislation when it promised little useful result.

For the same reason, no immediate amendment of the law of sedition is contemplated.

(3) Universal Negro Improvement Association & W. Indian Protective Association of America

The U.N.I.A. is well known to us as a dangerous & rabidly anti-white organisation, but the Governor now sends us what we have not had before, its constitution & book of laws.

This is an extraordinary document providing for a Potentate (Marcus Garvey) and his Consort, for the enactment and enforcement of laws, and for assisting in the development of independent negro nations and communities.

We have met with the activities of this Association in St. Lucia (17064) and Jamaica as well as in British Honduras. Because the latter Colony is already disturbed and its communications are mainly with the U.S., it is there that the Association is likely to prove the most dangerous.

We have kept the W.I. Governors informed of about the Association, but have not sought to initiate any active measures against it. The reasons adverse to such measures, given in par. 7 of this desp., are likely to apply also in other Colonies. I think that we shall be well advised in leaving the matter to the discretion of the Governors.

Pars. 5-7 of this desp. should go to the other Governors—and I think that it would be worth while to reprint the Constitution of the Association and send them copies.

? Ack & say that the S of S appreciates the care //with// which the Governor is

dealing with these questions and sees no reason to differ from his views[.]

And send all the Governors (except Gov. Leewards) the info. in 24422 about the rival association, the W.I. Protective Association.

E[.] R[.] D[.] [E. R. Darnley] 7/6

Grenada and Trinidad have legislated against seditious publications on the lines of the Straits Ord[inance], but the recent riots & the bad feeling left behind make B. Honduras a special case.

Our best answer to all this agitation seems to be (i) to provide as far as we can for the maintenance of order (ii) watch the economic situation to see that there is not too much legitimate discontent to work on. We are doing both.

Sir B. [Thomson] should have a copy of the despatch & of the reprint of the reprint of the Improvement Association?

G. G. [G. Grindle] 8.6.20

I agree that we may leave matters to the discretion of the Gov.

A copy shd go to F.O. calling attention to the refer[ences] to the U.S.

I don't think that we need incur the expense of reprinting the quaint "Constitution & Book of Laws": it is published in N. York & probably is well known on the other side. Otherwise [*word illegible*] as proposed?

[*initials illegible*] 9.6

Seen by Lord Milner. As proposed.

(Colonel Amery to Sec.)

[H. C. T.?] [H. C. Thornton] 9/8/20

seen

[*initials illegible*] 9/8 [*illegible*]

Time inopportune for legislation owing to strong racial feeling. Newspapers smuggled in, impossibility of search, lapse of D.O.R.A. States that he is prepared to subscribe to the "Negro World." Negro movement should not be advertised. It is possible that the whole movement under-lying the [U]niversal Negro Association and African Communities League was originated by German propaganda and money, and probably is still self-supported by German Americans. On this point it seems to me that

H.M. Ambassador at Washington should be able to make enquiry and give advice. Enemy propaganda probably aims in the main against the U.S. Government in fomenting racial trouble, and indirectly against British possessions in the West Indies. States that he has given Mr. Haynes, a troublesome agitator, employment in the public service as a Relieving Clerk. Thinks the movement will not be maintained and that, if not opposed by the Government, it will die a natural death locally. A representative negro is being sent to New York to represent British Honduras at the Convention.

John de Salis 23 Aug 20

TNA: PRO FO 371/4567/5851. TL, recipient's copy. Marked "Secret." Minutes from TNA: PRO CO 318/354/7252 and TNA: PRO FO 371/4567, X/MO 2243.

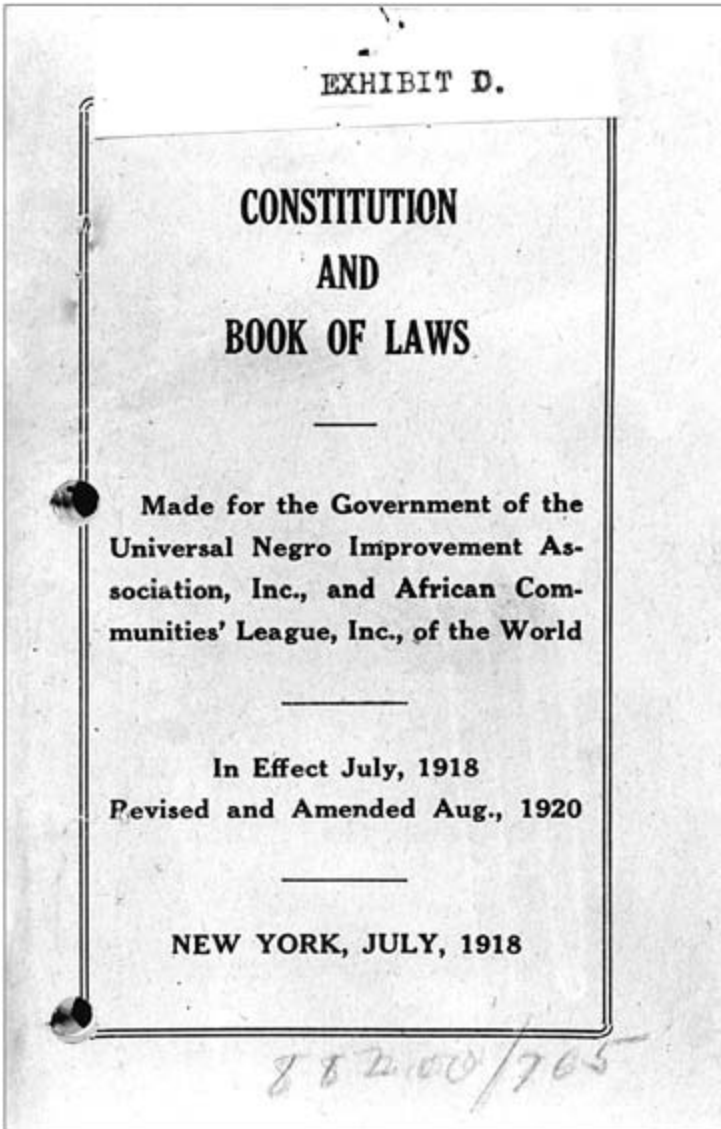
1. Belize fronts on to the Caribbean Sea to the east, but its boundaries with Mexico to the north and Guatemala to the west and south could not be controlled by police or customs officials.

2. In 1871 the Legislative Assembly abolished itself, and British Honduras became a Crown colony. The legislative council consisted of five official members and four unofficial members nominated by the governor, who presided over the Council meetings. An attempt by the local elite to reintroduce elected members in 1890 was rejected on the grounds that there were too few whites in the colony, but in 1892 the unofficial members became a majority of the Council, though they still had to be nominated by the governor. There was further agitation during elections in the 1920s, and five members of the Council were elected in 1936; but registered voters were less than 2 percent of the population, and the five official and two nominated unofficial members outnumbered the elected members. Further changes were made in the composition of the legislative council in 1945 (six elected, three official, and four nominated unofficial members), but it was not until universal adult suffrage was introduced in 1954 that the new Legislative Assembly had a majority of elected members, consisting of nine elected, three official, and three nominated unofficial members (O. Nigel Bolland, *Belize: A New Nation in Central America* [Boulder and London: Westview Press, 1986], pp. 23–24, 29, 31, 103–107; Assad Shoman, *Party Politics in Belize, 1950–1986* [Benque Viejo del Carmen: Cubola Productions, 1987], pp. 16–18).

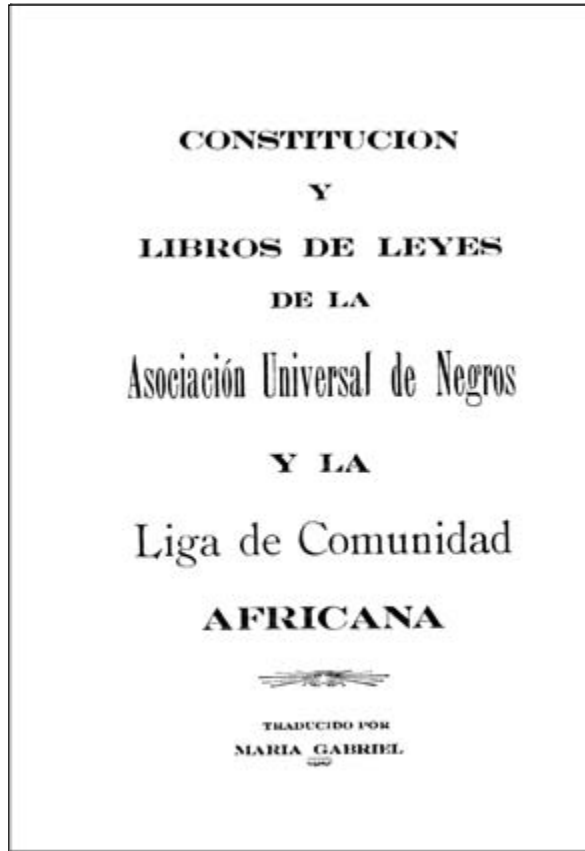
3. "Creole" generally refers to people who are born in the Americas but whose ancestors came from Africa and/or Europe, and that is how the term is widely used in Belize. In the second half of the nineteenth century some Belizeans began to link "their own identity as creoles with the history of the colony" (Karen H. Judd, "Elite Reproduction and Ethnic Identity in Belize" [Ph.D. diss., City University of New York, 1992], p. 308). By claiming the label "creole" as their own—a label that included cultural aspects, such as language, as well as "racial" ancestry—they asserted claims to the territory in ways that the expatriate British residents could not. The town of Belize, where Creoles predominate, has historically been the center of "creole" politics (O. Nigel Bolland, "Society and Politics in Belize," in *Society and Politics in the Caribbean*, ed. Colin Clarke [Basingstoke and London: Macmillan, 1991], pp. 78–109).

4. Those charged as a consequence of the 1919 riot were tried summarily or on indictment between 10 November 1919 and 22 January 1920. Of the forty men arraigned, thirty-one were convicted and received custodial sentences from six months to six years hard labor. Twelve of the thirty-one convicted men were members of the British Honduras military contingents (*CL*, 10 July 1919; Governor to the Secretary of State, 29 January 1920, TNA: PRO CO 123/299/9789).

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Cover of the UNIA *Constitution and Book of Laws*



Spanish Version of UNIA *Constitution and Book of Laws*
(Source: MGP)

Edward M. Merewether, Governor,
Leeward Islands, to Viscount Milner,
Secretary of State, Colonial Office

GOVERNMENT HOUSE, ANTIGUA.
19th August, 1920

My Lord,

I have the honour to acknowledge the receipt of Your Lordship's Secret despatch of the 25th May last, and to transmit, for Your Lordship's information, copies of despatches by the Administrators of St. Kitts-Nevis and Domi-

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nica relative to the activities of the “Universal Negro Improvement Association” of New York in those Presidencies, together with a copy of a minute by the Chief Inspector of Police.

2. It seems clear that the main object of the Association is to raise funds, but so far their appeals have met with little response, which indicates that the people to whom the appeals are addressed have little confidence in the leaders of the movement.

3. I may add that if any of the 400,000,000 negroes reach Liberia, they will probably very soon wish themselves back in the United States of America or the West Indies. I have the honour to be, My Lord, Your Lordship’s most obedient, humble Servant,

E. M. MEREWETHER
Governor

[*Handwritten minutes:*] Mr. Ayton

Can you find the desp of 25 May referred to here?

R[.] A[.] W[.] [R. A. Wiseman]
27/9/20

Mr. Wiseman,

I cannot find it (17064) in the Secret cupboard or in the Registry. There are [plenty?] copies of the despatch itself below.

E[.] A[.] 27.9.20

This body is evidently harmless in the L.I.

(See also [11] 4642)

? Copy to Div [of Int.] L.I.

R[.] A[.] W[.] 27/9/20

At once

E[.] R[.] D[.] [E. R. Darnley] 30/9

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/0254. TLS, recipient’s copy. Marked “Secret.”

Enclosure: Lieutenant-Colonel Edward Bell,
Chief Inspector, Leeward Islands Police,

to Viscount Milner, Secretary of State,
Colonial Office

[Antigua,] 3.7.20

Colonial Secretary,

Beyond that efforts have recently been made to obtain subscriptions to the Black Star Line of Steamships, no special "activities" on the part of the above mentioned Society have come to light in Antigua.

2. Some weeks ago a sailor from one of the Royal Mail Canadian Steamers landed here and remained for a week, during which time he endeavoured to induce people to subscribe to the Black Star Line. This man's name is Weston, and he is a native of Antigua.¹

3. As a sample of wh[at] takes place at meetings of our Local Ulotrich[i]an Society² I append short notes of two meetings—one a general meeting and the other for members of the Society only.

4. I have read with a great deal of interest, Mr August[u]s D[u]ncan's (whom I think I know) letters to the Secretary of State and to the Governor. I have no doubt the letters in question give a very correct account of the objects of Mr Marcus Garvey's association, and its methods of propaganda. Both the objects and the methods of propaganda of this association are mischievous to a degree.

(Intld.) E. B(ELL)

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/6964. TL, copy.

1. Most probably a reference to Rev. George Auesby Weston (1881–1972), of Greenbay, Antigua, who became a leader of the UNIA New York division. The eldest of nine children, he went to sea in 1905 and worked as a coaler on a Norwegian steamer. Discharged at Newport News, Virginia, he continued working as a seaman, sailing to Rotterdam and Cardiff. In 1908 he returned to the United States by stowing away on a cattle boat and landed in Baltimore. He worked for the next ten years on various vessels that took him from Savannah, Georgia, to Philadelphia, Boston, Maine, and Havana. In 1919 he settled in Boston and joined the Boston branch of the UNIA after accompanying a friend to a local meeting at an African Methodist Episcopal church at which Garvey spoke. Weston, a preacher in a local African Methodist Episcopal Church, was appointed chaplain of the Boston division of the UNIA. Weston helped to organize a UNIA branch in Antigua, and raised funds to permit delegates from Antigua and St. Thomas in the Virgin Islands to attend the UNIA Convention in August 1920. A full contingent from the Virgin Islands but none from Antigua marched in the Convention parade. Two days after the commencement of the 1921 UNIA convention, Weston was officially summoned by telegram to attend. Along with Dr. Lionel Francis of Philadelphia, William A. Wallace of Chicago, and Joseph A. Craig of Detroit, he was a leading opponent of Garvey's request to be empowered with a veto over all UNIA and BSL finances. Garvey at one point threatened to have Weston expelled from the convention because of the stubbornness of his opposition. Weston moved to Pittsburgh and was appointed president of the Pittsburgh division and UNIA district arbitrator for western Pennsylvania. During the 1922 UNIA convention, Weston was a leading witness at the trial of J. W. H. Eason, leader of the American section of the UNIA, for misappropriation of funds. After serving briefly in the Cleveland division, Weston resettled in New York and soon became vice president of the New York division. Following the incarceration of Marcus Garvey in 1925, Weston asserted the right of the New York division, as the original chartered UNIA body, to retain ownership of Liberty Hall property. He led the New York division in its vote to sell the property to a holding company as a first step in a long-term commercial development plan to construct a nine-story UNIA executive office building and convention hall on the

site. This brought him into direct conflict with Amy Jacques Garvey, acting as Garvey's personal representative, and an emergency UNIA convention called by a committee of presidents of the leading UNIA branches that remained loyal to Garvey was held in Detroit in March 1926. The convention expelled Weston from the organization on charges of rebellion and encumbering Liberty Hall. In the pages of the *Negro World*, Garvey described Weston as "one of the most dangerous men we have yet encountered." Weston and his supporters continued in physical occupation of Liberty Hall until the New York State Supreme Court granted the UNIA a restraining order against him. With the support of G. O. Marke, who held the UNIA office of acting potentate of Sierra Leone, William L. Sherril, who had been acting president of the UNIA before he was replaced by W. Toot at the urging of Garvey, Wesley McDonald Holder, who was a UNIA vice president, William Isles, William H. Ferris, and W. O. Symer, Weston formed a rival UNIA and convened the "Fifth International Convention of the Negro People of the World" in New York in August 1926. The rival UNIA convention voted to "expel" Marcus Garvey from the organization and elected a new executive with George Weston as president-general, G. O. Marke as supreme potentate, William Sherril as supreme deputy potentate, Wesley Macdonald Holder as secretary general, Williams Isles as chancellor, and Lester Taylor as auditor general. With the support of the courts, Garvey's followers soon regained control of Liberty Hall, and Weston's rival body disintegrated.

Weston went on to organize the Pioneer Negroes of the World and was ordained a deacon in the African Orthodox Church headed by his countryman, Bishop George A. McGuire. A baritone soloist, Weston performed at many UNIA events including the 1920 and 1922 UNIA conventions in New York. His wife was choirmaster at Liberty Hall. Weston returned home to Antigua in 1953 and founded the African Orthodox Evangelical Mission. He also instituted Negro Week as an annual event celebrating the achievements of Africans and African descendants. Weston sought to advance an economic alternative to the "industrialization by invitation" policies pursued by the local government of V. C. Bird in the 1960s, which aimed to develop the island economy through the invitation of American capital. He invited a team of black American chemists to assist Antiguan scientists in devising appropriate technologies for the economic development of the island. The scientific team developed a formula for paint utilizing Antiguan resources, but their new paint, with the brand name Pro-lad that was described by a U.S. laboratory as "the most durable known," was largely ignored by the local government. Weston died in New York City on 16 May 1972. Despite his organizational differences with Garvey, Weston retained a lifetime commitment to what he consistently described as "Garveyite philosophy" ("Father of Antiguan Liberation," *Outlet*, 26 May–9 June 1977; Judith Stein, *The World of Marcus Garvey* [Baton Rouge: Louisiana State University Press, 1986], pp. 252–253; *MGP* 3: 692–693 n. 3; *MGP* 4: 947, 968–970; *MGP* 6: 353–354, 432–433 n. 1. For a photographic portrait of George Weston see Gregson and Margo Davis, *Antiguan Black: Portrait of an Island People* [San Francisco: Scrimshaw Press, 1973], p. 95).

2. The Antigua Ulotrichian Universal Union Friendly Society (UUU), also known as the Ulotrichian Universal Lodge, was formed in 1916 and was officially registered as a friendly society on 2 April 1917 under the Leeward Island Friendly Society Act of 1880. The Ulotrichian society was founded by two brothers, Robert and James Brown, who held the offices of president and marshal respectively. The source of inspiration for the society was "Professor" S. Arlington Newton of Barbados, who had been expelled from Antigua during a lecture tour in 1916 and prohibited from re-entering the Leeward Islands. The declared objectives of the society were: "To raise funds by entrance fees, weekly contributions, fines, levies and investments for paying sick and death benefit." However, T. A. V. Best, acting governor of the Leeward Islands, observed that the organization "combined useful work as a Friendly Society with underground instruction of the labourers as to his rights and his downtrodden condition." Best added: "To the speeches delivered by some of its members can be traced the awakening of the resentment against the white man which is the most dangerous feature of recent history in St. Kitts and Antigua" (Best to Long, 28 March 1918, TNA: PRO CO 152/358/108353). In a confidential communication to the acting colonial secretary, Lt.-Col. Edward Bell accused the leaders of the society of seeking "to become dictators in the regulation of wages and conditions of labour generally." He complained that, at their public meetings, the Browns read extracts from American newspapers "giving details of negro lynching cases" and commenting on them "in terms of such a nature as to incite hatred against the white man" (Bell to Acting Colonial Secretary, enc. Best to Long, 28 March 1918, TNA: PRO CO 152/359/108353).

The UUU was seen by the colonial authorities as a "branch of Newton's society." This presumption was probably correct for the society's membership card declared its headquarters as Abyssinia and Egypt with bureaus in Paris, London, and Rome. Newton had also registered a friendly society with the same name, the Universal Ulotrichian Union, in Barbados on 30 January 1917.

In that year the Antigua UUU claimed a membership of 4,174 members, 2,000 of whom were fully paid up. Over 80 percent of the members were agricultural laborers, and 65 percent ordinary field laborers. In the same year, a split occurred in the organization and the rural members under the leadership of C. O. Sheppard, a clerk employed at the Antigua Sugar Factory, established a separate organization, the Antigua Progressive Union Friendly Society. A substantial portion of the membership of the Antigua UUU joined the new society which was registered under the Friendly Society Act on 6 September 1917. Sheppard, a Garveyite, circulated the *Negro World* and other UNIA publications among the members of his society and residents of his and other villages. One villager was later quoted as saying: "Garvey was an influence in Antigua . . . Antiguan became conscious of colour" (Caroline Carmody, "First Among Equals: Antiguan Patterns of Local-Level Leadership" [Ph.D. diss., New York University, 1978], pp. 162-163).

Sheppard's activities on behalf of workers from villages in the area led to his dismissal from his position at the sugar factory. He was successful in securing land under the government land settlement scheme operating in 1916 and 1917, becoming a peasant cane farmer. In 1925 he was accused of mismanagement of the society's welfare funds and brought to court. He was found not guilty but subsequently migrated to New York and joined the UNIA. He also became a member of the African Orthodox Church where he rose to the rank of bishop. Both friendly societies were deeply involved in labor activities, but the Antigua UUU remained the most militant. The labor agitation which it conducted from its inception was seen by the colonial administration as laying the groundwork for the island-wide general strike for higher wages and the labor riot in St. Johns, the capital town, in 1918.

Harold Wilson, the Barbadian editor of the *Antigua Magnet*, was a member of the society and, after the retirement of the Brown brothers from public life, became its president. The society remained active under his leadership and continued to be a cause of concern for the colonial government. As late as 1931 the governor described the UUU as "a semi-secret organisation which is a probable source of danger in the event of disorders arising" (St. Johnson to Passfield, 19 April 1931, TNA: PRO CO 152/428/3). Wilson served as president until 1934, when he founded the Antigua Workingmen's Association. The society was finally dissolved in 1939 after the formation of the first legal trade union, the Antigua Trades and Labour Union ("Memorandum of Evidence of Harold T. Wilson, 31 December 1938," West India Royal Commission, 1938/1939, TNA: PRO CO 950/483; Caroline Carmody, "First Among Equals"; "Saving Banks and Friendly Societies, 1916-1917," *LIBB*, 1916-1917, Section Ag 4-5; "Saving Banks and Friendly Societies, 1918-1919," *Barbados Blue Book*, 1918-1919, Section HH 14).

Enclosure: Notes on Meetings of the Antigua Ulotrichian Universal Union Friendly Society

[Antigua, ca. 3 July 1920]

ANTIGUA U.U. SOCIETY

NOTES OF MEETINGS

General meeting Sunday 27th ultimo. Police were present

Speakers:—

*Joseph Mason*¹ (Sanitary Officer City Board) Opened meeting with short prayers for Unity among the Negro race.

James Brown.² Invited all present to enrol[1] in the Black Star Line.

Robert Brown.³ To "best of his knowledge" explained about the Black Star Line and its objects. Said that prospectus had not yet been received. Spoke of Colour propaganda of white people against black in the U.S., and that black

people in America had to combine in self protection. Hoped that black people in Antigua would do likewise. He then introduced Newton.

Newton spoke criticising the Chief Inspector for having sent for him, and questioning his (*Newton's*) authority for landing in the Island. Made a short biblical address about unity, and said he was going to St. Kitts in 10 days time en route to America to attend a big negro Convention.

Adolphus Henry (butcher) spoke a few words on the Black Star Line.

Twelve new subscribers to the B.S. Line were enrolled and paid their monthly subscriptions for June at the rate of 35 cents. The names of 125 old subscribers were read out. James Brown said that when the prospectus for the Black Star Line was received anyone not satisfied "may" get back their money.

Meeting of members of the Society held on Wednesday the 30th ultimo. Police were refused admission. *Newton* at [t]his meeting is reported (from a confidential source) to have said that he had a message f//or// those present which he could not deliver as there were detectives about. He said that a mistaken view of him prevailed and that he was really a quiet man, but that wherever he went he found the water muddied.

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/6964. TD.

1. Joseph Mason was appointed sanitary inspector (first class) for the St. Johns municipality in 1914. This was his first appointment to the colonial civil establishment in Antigua (*LIBB*, 1914).

2. James A. N. "Studiation" Brown, co-founder and marshal of the Antigua UUU, had returned to Antigua from the United States with his older brother, Robert, at the start of World War I. "Studiation" Brown was a prominent local businessman and managed the family's commercial establishment for some time after the retirement of his brother. His nickname, "Studiation," came from his oft-quoted and self-created aphorism, "Studiation beats Education," meaning that knowledge gained from practical experience was superior to book learning. It was widely believed that he had developed that saying because he was illiterate (Bell to Acting Colonial Secretary, undated confidential report, enc. Best to Long, 28 March 1918, TNA: PRO CO 152/359/108533; Glen Richards, "Friendly Societies and Labour Organisations in the Leeward Islands, 1912-1919," in *Before and after 1865: Education, Politics and Regionalism in the Caribbean*, ed. B. Moore and S. Wilnot [Kingston: Ian Randle Publications, 1998], p. 141).

3. Robert Brown, co-founder and president of the Antigua UUU, returned to Antigua from the United States an independently wealthy man, having won a significant amount of money playing the numbers. Around 1916, and with his brother James, he purchased commercial property, including a block of buildings, for the sum of £600, paying £150 down in cash with the remainder left as an interest-bearing mortgage. The Brown brothers established a retail emporium, the "Bargain House," which became one of the leading commercial stores in the island. They were, for a time, the leading figures in black labor politics in Antigua, and attracted close scrutiny from the colonial police. The chief inspector of police described them as "not of a good class," and, noting that they had spent many years in the United States, he surmised that they "must have associated in America with men of their own colour imbued with racial hatred of the white man and, perhaps, also with extreme labour movement views of a physical force type." He accused them of receiving "from the United States newspapers and letters which one can only conclude come from a tainted . . . and probably pro-German source." In their private conversations with the other members of the Union, he added, they "make use of remarks to the effect that if the black people hold together they will have their own Governor, a black man and that the black man will own all the estates" (Bell to Acting Colonial Secretary, undated confidential report, enclosed in Best to Long, 28 March 1918, TNA: PRO CO 152/358/108353) (Richards, "Friendly Societies," pp. 141-142).

*Enclosure: Robert Walter, Administrator,
Dominica, to Edward M. Merewether,
Governor, Leeward Islands*¹

Government House, Dominica.
5th August, 1920

Sir,

In reply to Your Excellency's Secret despatch of the 12th ultimo, regarding the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and the Black Star Line in this Presidency, I have the honour to transmit the enclosed interesting report from Captain Skirving, Inspector of Police.²

2. I am not aware whether Marcus Garvey has been canonized but I am inclined to think that sooner or later there will be serious dissensions in his Society. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient Servant,
(Sd.) R. WALTER
Administrator

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/6964. TL, copy. Marked "Secret."

1. Because of Crown colony status, the administrator of Dominica referred matters to the governor of the Leeward Island federation who resided in Antigua. Edward M. Merewether was governor of the Leeward Islands from 1916 to 1921.

2. Captain John McKenzie Skirving was a police inspector stationed in Roseau, Dominica, at Fort Young. He had joined the Leeward Island police force on 23 July 1909 and was appointed sub-inspector of police in Antigua. The following year he was transferred to Montserrat and placed in charge of the local police force. On 1 February 1913 he was appointed inspector in charge of the Dominica police force as well as military instructor to the local defense force and keeper of the gunpowder magazine. He served in these positions until 1 November 1924, when he was appointed chief keeper of prisons in Antigua and superintendent of the Boys Training School and the paupers' cemetery ("Civil Establishment," *LIBB*, 1909-1910, 1913-1914, 1924).

*Enclosure: Report on the UNIA in Dominica
by John Skirving, Inspector, Leeward Islands
Police*

[Dominica, ca. August, 1920]

The Dominica branch of the "Universal Negro Improvement Association," established twelve months ago, has its headquarters at Roseau, with sub-branches at Marigot and Wesley. The names of the officers are appended.

2. The joining fee is 25 cents and the weekly subscription 3d, and members are led to expect monetary and medical benefits when sick; but no one has received either yet. The Association tries, with little apparent success, to persuade members and others to purchase shares i//n// the "Black Star Line," and

one or other of the leading members is quasi-agent for the sale of "The Negro World."

3. So far, the fees and subscriptions appea[r] to have been used only for payment of rent and lighting exp[en]ses of the meeting-place, which is the upper floor of a building owned by one Ducreay, and shop[k]eeper and liquor seller. Though a member, his only [real] interest in the Association appears to be the [colle]ction of his rent. The room has been named ["Libert]y Hall" by the Association, and it will [accommodate?] maximum of 150 persons—including those [*words missing*] [me]etings are well-attended, and are held [*words missing*] of Sunday, Tuesday and Th[u]rday. The [*words missing*] almost entirely of young people . . .

. . . [*pages missing*] alleged to be not one tenth of the membership. (He was in error, for there were 125 persons present, and he himself does not claim a membership over 500.) (2) By processioning with band and flags from the [R]oman Catholic church, after morning service, on the 2nd instant. (This, of course, collected a large crowd, which dispersed soon after its arrival outside the hall.) (3) By holding a meeting at the hall later in the morning, at which there were the usual speakers. (Bad organization, and lack of interest, resulted in this meeting being commenced an hour after the advertised time.) (4) By giving a Variety Entertainment at the hall on the sa[me] night.

12. Previous announcement of the "celebrations" was made in the "Guardian," the President applied to me for leave to have a band in the procession, and the Sergeant-Major of Police was invited to attend. I submit that these facts are evidence of the absence of any desire on the part of the Association to hide its activities from the Government. The President wrote asking a few black and coloured men of position to attend the celebrations, but they all with one consent began to make excuse, pleading "previous engagements"—though the programme had been well advertised nearly three weeks in advance. Not one of them attended any item on the programme. This was deplored and referred to as a shame by Mr. Steber and the officers at their meetings.

13. If I may venture an opinion, I suggest that, ere long, (so far as Dominica is concerned), this Association, like the Universal Ulotrichian Union, will become moribund, resultant upon lack of support and the inevitable internal dissension characteristic of Dominica societies.

14. It may be that parts of this report are redundant, and that I have somewhat exceeded the terms of referenc[e], but I considered it advisable to write fully.

(sd.) JOHN SKIRVING
Inspector, L.I. Police

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/6964. TD, copy.

Enclosure: John Alder Burdon, Administrator,
St. Kitts-Nevis, to Edward M. Merewether,
Governor, Leeward Islands

GOVERNMENT HOUSE, ST. KITTS, W.I.
9th August, 1920

Sir,

I have the honour to acknowledge the receipt of Your Excellency's Secret despatch of 12th July on the subject of the activities of the "Universal Negro Improvement Association" and agents of this and other bodies.

2. In reply I have the honour to enclose a copy of a publication of the above organization which has been circulated in St. Kitts. This publication, on the evidence of the type, does not appear to have been printed in this island. The Inspector of Police informs me that no delegates have proceeded from St. Kitts to the Convention in New York.¹

3. I may say that in June last I received//, enclosed in an envelope printed "British Con[s]ulate General, New York" and "On His Britannic Majesty's Service," without covering letter, a copy of the "Negro World" for June 5th. This paper appears to be the organ of Garvey and the Negro Improvement Association. There was nothing of importance or interest in the copy sent, other than an advertisement of the "Black Star Line."

4. "Professor" Arlington Newton, since his arrival here has been speaking at the meetings of the St. Kitts Universal Benevolent Association about the Black Star Line and has been urging his hearers to invest their money in it. Some of the leading members of the Association have been supporting him. But not one of them has said that he himself has so invested money. The Inspector of Police believes that no money has been invested in this concern from St. Kitts.

5. In fact the support of the Black Star Line here appears somewhat half hearted. The s//t//ory of embezzlement of \$15,000. by one of the officials of the line was brought up by Wilkes, Treasurer of the Benevolent Association, at one of the meetings.

6. I have heard from one of the Quebec Line Steamers that the "Black Star Line" consists of one small and inferior steamer. I do not know how far this information is correct.

7. The reply to Your Excellency's enquiry as to Augustus Duncan's attitude towards the St. Kitts Universal Benevolent Association is contained in the speech made by him at a meeting of that body on 4th August, 1919, of which I enclose a report.² The Inspector of Police reports that Duncan, during his visit at that time, was very closely in touch with the officers of the Benevolent Association and was regarded by them as a strong supporter of their organization.

8. Possibly a quarrel between Duncan and Garvey may have occurred subsequently to the former's visit to St. Kitts. I have no information as to Duncan's

AUGUST 1920

attitude of a later date than that of his letter of January this year which was forwarded to Your Excellency in Mr. Wigley's Confidential despatch of 10th March last. I have the honour to be Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient Servant,

J. A. BURDON
Administrator

TNA: PRO CO 318/355/6964. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Secret."

1. A delegation from St. Kitts is recorded as participating in the UNIA street parade at the commencement of the 1920 convention. It is likely that the delegation was made up of natives of St. Kitts resident in New York (*MGP* 1: 493-494).

2. The report by Sergeant-Major James Geen, Leeward Islands Police, to the acting inspector, St. Kitts-Nevis Police, Basseterre, 5 August 1919, TNA, PRO, CO 318/355/6964, is reprinted in *MGP* 11:261-266.

Article in the *Negro World*

[[St. Vincent, 21 August, 1920]]

NEWS FROM ST. VINCENT

THE U.N.I.A.

On July 1, as soon as Mr. R.E.M. Jack had finished calling out the names of his passengers who went to Cuba in the schooner Buema, Policeman Jackson called him, saying he had something to tell him. As he went near he was then and there served with a summons on a second charge of sending laborers to Cuba without license, and the case was put down for July 3. This was spitefully done. Intentionally to imprison Mr. Jack so that he could not sail on Sunday, July 4, for Barbados. It was a very unusual thing for such a case to be heard on Saturday instead of Monday. Judge Thomas tried the case and as he did not get evidence enough to imprison Mr. Jack without fining him, he unwisely fined him (25s.) costs. Pooh! What an advantage taken of Mr. Jack, all because he is the leader of the U.N.I.A. in St. Vincent. Aiston Creece was the stool of the government in this case, while Albert Burress of Trinidad contradicted his statement and saved Mr. Jack from prison. On Thursday, July 8, a parcel of greetings from Mr. Garvey to the Negro people of St. Vincent arrived in the post office at Kingstown, addressed to Mr. R.E.M. Jack and Jacob, the Negro clerk, had to do his job of ransacking his national literature. As soon as he found that they came from the Honorable Marcus Garvey he reported it to his boss, who sent up the news to the intelligent judge and acting administrator, and without delay he drafted an ordinance, without the consent of 49,998 people, and made it law prohibiting any printed matter by Mr. Garvey coming into the God-forsaken rock, viz, St. Vincent. Mr. Garvey should post a different greeting by

every mail to Mr. Jack and so make the coward draft prohibition ordinances fortnightly. I wonder what the Negroes of St. Vincent think of themselves. They have no eyes to see that they are all treated as babies who have no understanding. Ah! Poor us in St. Vincent, the least of all civilized places,

The officials of St. Vincent should blush at their tyranny. They are making a fine history for themselves and the Anglo-Saxons, who have become mere cruel than the Germans.

Printed in NW, 21 August, 1920.

“I. Ho Ch’uan”¹ to the *Barbados Times*

[[Bridgetown, Barbados,
ca. 21 August 1920]]

RISE OF THE DARKER RACES

Sir:—

At this moment when for the first time in history a great convention of black and colored people from all parts of the world is about to assemble in New York city to discuss the future of their race—an occasion that will mark the formal entry of the race into a new era of existence, as well as the birth of a new force in world affairs—it may be of interest to recall an article that appeared nearly twenty years ago² in the *Review of Reviews*³ (August, 1900), presumably from the pen of the late W. T. Stead,⁴ one of the ablest journalists of his time—a man whose pen was always lifted up against unrighteous, and who throughout life showed himself a stout and staunch friend of the victims of oppression and wrongdoing in all lands.

The occasion which called forth the article was what is known as the Boxer rising of 1900,⁵ the term “Boxer” being applied by Western nations to a powerful Chinese society of patriots whose object was the expulsion of white settlers—“the foreign devils,” as the Chinese called them—from the Celestial empire! The Boxers saw with alarm the menace to Chinese national independence presented by the growing numerical strength and influence of European adventurers and speculators in China. And well might the Chinaman have regarded these white adventurers and missionaries as “foreign devils,” for had he not witnessed forty years before the rising of 1900 the heart-rending spectacle of a royal woman with her child fleeing in hot haste before the avenging fury of a European army, this woman being none other than the Empress of China herself. Had he not witnessed the destruction wrought by these “foreign devils”—the beautiful summer palace at Peking gutted to the walls and the plundered ruin given over to the flames? The Boxer realized, as his black African brother is realizing today, that the white Christian missionary is merely the avant courier of the trading adventurer and the political oppressor with the

“mailed fist” in the form of a machine gun. What follows? The foreign devil deprives him of his lands, tramples him under foot, hoists the flag of Christian civilization and proclaims himself the most righteous being on earth. And so the Boxer, with the example of India before his eyes, adopting as his watchword, “I Ho Ch’uan” (Righteousness and the fist) decided to employ physical force to rid his Fatherland of an impending foreign yoke.

In truth, the colored races of the world are no longer to be deceived by this wholesale robbery and plunder by white nations masquerading under the banner of Christian civilization. The colored man sees that the white race pins its faith not on righteousness but on a gun, and he, too, is determined to use guns. “China must go forward or go to pieces” was a cry uttered at the time of the European scramble for her territory twenty years ago. She is going forward—has gone forward—and in that forward march she is learning the arts of European warfare. Japan has already leaped forward and taken her place among the great Powers of the world, and no truth remains in a well known couplet:

Jealous China, strange Japan
You are but dead seas of man.⁶

And the black man, too, is about to move forward. Stretching his limbs, he is rousing himself from the slumber of ages and is preparing to plant his foot on ground on which he is resolved to stand and peg out for himself “a place in the sun.” Who will deny that this is a legitimate aim? And is it too much to hope that the day is not far distant when these races with a united front will demand from those in present possession the title deeds of their claim to supremacy on this planet? The issue must sooner or later be decided, either by righteous dealing or by the sword.

The years are slow, the vision tarrieth long
And far the end may be
But one by one the ancient f[r]iends of wrong
Go out and leave earth free.⁷

Faithfully yours,

I. HO CH’UAN

Reproduced from *NW*, 21 August 1920.

1. The putative name of the members of the fiercely nationalistic and secret religious society in China responsible for the Boxer Rebellion (1899–1901) was *yì hé quán*, literally, “righteous harmonious fists.” According to Henry Keown-Boyd, “Even their name is obscure, invented, it is said, by a British or American missionary wishing to abbreviate the English translation, The Fists of Righteous Harmony, from the equivalent Chinese words and to describe in everyday terms the weird calisthenics which formed a part of their ceremonial” (*The Fists of Righteous Harmony: A History of the Boxer Uprising in China in the Year 1900* [London: Leo Cooper, 1991], p. 6; see also Larry Clinton Thompson, *William Scott Ament and the Boxer Rebellion: Heroism, Hubris and the “Ideal Missionary”* [Jefferson, N.C.: McFarland, 2009], pp. 3–16).

2. "The Progress of the World" section of the August 1900 edition of *Review of Reviews* featured an unsigned piece titled "The Situation in China." The brief article argues that beyond providing relief to besieged Americans and Europeans during the Boxer Rebellion, outsiders should not consider it any of their business to conquer the Chinese. While it did speak highly of missionaries, a population of which the rebels were not fond, it also stated that "the peril of Europeans in China has been brought about in great part by the outrageous encroachments of European governments." Interestingly, this issue also included an article by Stephen Bonsal titled "The Chinese Revolution." Bonsal referred to the Boxers as an "ignorant mob," and went on to state that "there is no record comparable to this as an outrage upon humanity and international usage" (*The American Monthly Review of Reviews*, August 1900; Victor Pierce Jones, *Saint or Sensationalist? The Story of W. T. Stead* [East Wittering, West Sussex: Gooday Publishers, 1988], pp. 56–58).

3. *Review of Reviews*, the first "digest" magazine to incorporate extracts from other journals in combination with original content, was founded by W. T. Stead in January 1890. The venture initially began as a joint venture with Stead's former schoolmate George Newnes, but the partnership was soon superseded by a loan from the Salvation Army and support from Cecil Rhodes. *Review of Reviews* quickly became popular—even Queen Victoria was said to be a reader—and Stead established subsidiary publications in the United States (1891) and in Australia (1892). The magazine advocated, among other things, a union of English-speaking peoples, the expansion and federation of the British empire, Irish home rule, and morality in government and politics. Stead used his publication to enhance the careers of friends, including Rhodes, John Morley, and Alfred Milner, and attempted to facilitate Anglo-Russian and Anglo-American understanding and amity. The editorial policy of *Review of Reviews* also stridently supported suffragism, temperance, and the Salvation Army, as well as modernization of British industry and medical reforms. Stead's growing interest in the world peace movement at the turn of the century led the magazine to oppose the Second South African War (1899–1902), a move that alienated friends and supporters including Rhodes and Milner. Despite severe circulation losses and financial difficulties, however, the publication soldiered on. *Review of Reviews* was absorbed by *World Today* in 1932.

4. William Thomas Stead (1849–1912) was a British newspaper editor and noted spiritualist. His first editorial position was at the *Northern Echo*, where he started in 1871 after working for the paper as a reporter. Stead made the paper one of the most notable dailies in the north country through his advocacy of most of the agenda of the radical Liberals, his support for British prime minister William Gladstone's political leadership, and his promotion of the religious and social programs of the Salvation Army. In July 1880, on Gladstone's recommendation, he was appointed assistant editor of the *Pall Mall Gazette*, taking over as editorial director in 1883. Under Stead's leadership the newspaper was noted for its activism in both foreign and domestic circles, advocating Irish home rule and printing controversial exposes of urban poverty. By 1886, however, Stead had alienated many of his colleagues in the press, as well as political notables including Gladstone. In the wake of unresolved disputes with the *Gazette's* proprietor, he left the paper in 1890 and founded the "non-partisan" *Review of Reviews*. During the last years of his life Stead became actively involved in the promotion of the world peace movement. He drowned in the Titanic disaster while travelling to deliver a world peace address at the Great Men and Religions Conference in New York City on 22 April 1912 (*Oxford Dictionary of National Biography*).

5. The Boxer Rebellion of 1900 was a Chinese government-supported peasant uprising. While China as a whole was never colonized, foreign forces had woven themselves deeply into the fabric of Chinese economic and social life by the end of the nineteenth century, much to the frustration of the Chinese population. Foremost among the West's corrupting influences in the eyes of traditional Chinese was the work of Christian missionaries. A secret society known as the I-ho chüan (Righteous and Harmonious Fists) or Boxers began in Shandong and Hebei provinces and gradually gained popular support among the Chinese people. The Boxers combined strands of Chinese martial arts and folk religious practices to develop a series of beliefs that, among other things, they had supernatural powers and were bulletproof. In 1898 conservative forces won control of the government and convinced the Boxers to form an alliance with the Qing Dynasty. In 1900 the Boxers launched a revolt, sacking churches and killing Christian missionaries and converts, and in June, converging in a protracted siege of the foreign diplomatic legation quarter in Beijing. Government officials surreptitiously aided the Boxers, and Qing troops attempted to defend Beijing from Allied forces sent to the city to relieve the besieged diplomatic legations. Breaking through Qing defenses at Dagu and Imperial Guards to reach the city in mid-August, the Allies quickly demonstrated that Boxers were not, in fact, bulletproof (Jonathan D. Spence, *The Gate of Heavenly Peace: The Chinese and their Revolution, 1895–1980* [New York: Viking Press, 1981], pp. 27, 92, 245; *EB*).

6. The full stanza of the poem, "A Voyage Round the World," by James Montgomery (1771–1854), was written as follows:

Jealous China, strange Japan,
With bewildered thought I scan:
They are but dead seas of man.

Lo! The eastern Cyclades,
Phoenix-nests, and halcyon seas;

But I tarry not with these. (in *Select Specimens of English Poetry*, 5th ed., ed. Edward Hughes [London: Longman, Brown, Green, and Longmans, 1856], pp. 31–35)

Montgomery was a Scottish poet whose family settled in Irvine in Ayrshire, where his father was a minister of the Moravian Brethren. When his parents left to perform missionary work in the West Indies, they sent him to the Moravian School at Fulneck, near Leeds, for ministerial training; his parents died within one year of each other while abroad. After failing in school, Montgomery became a clerk and a bookkeeper for the *Sheffield Register* newspaper, which began to publish his poetry. He eventually bought this newspaper under the name the *Sheffield Iris*. Montgomery became notorious with the public for his book of hymns, which were collected and published in 1853. After retiring from the newspaper, he remained in Sheffield and devoted his life to poetry and philanthropy. Montgomery died suddenly in 1854 (James Montgomery, "A Voyage Round the World," in *Select Specimens of English Poetry*, 5th ed., ed. Edward Hughes [London: Longman, Brown, Green, and Longmans, 1856], pp. 31–35; John Holland and James Everett, eds., *Memoirs of the Life and Writings of James Montgomery, Including Selections from His Correspondence, Remains in Prose and Verse, and Conversations on Various Subjects*, vol. 3 [London: Longman, Brown, Green, and Longmans, 1855]; Jabez Marrat, *James Montgomery, Christian Poet and Philanthropist* [London: Wesleyan Conference Office, 1879]; *DNB*).

7. Taken from the poem "Freedom in Brazil" (1867) by John Greenleaf Whittier.

Editorial in the *Barbados Times*

[Barbados, ca. 21 August 1920]]

TRIMMING A TRAITOR

"Characters ashamed of their names" is the description given by a writer in the Weekly Illustrated Paper to the retaliatory paragraph published in the Times of Wednesday the 14th inst. in the matter of the prominence given by the Illustrated to the organizers of the local division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League. When the function connected with the unveiling of the charter was celebrated there were in attendance representativ[e]s from the Advocate, Standard, Herald and Times.

If the idea had been to work in secret to be afraid or ashamed of identifying oneself with a movement aiming to uplift the Negro people of Barbados, would invitations have been extended to the press? With reference to the sentiments expressed by the publisher of the W.I.P. we would say to him: "If you haven't a good word to say for your race, learn to keep a still tongue in your head, else meddling with matters which are too high for you might lead to your being humbled. Be careful.["]

Reproduced from *NW*, 21 August 1920.

Editorial in the *Barbados Times*

[Barbados, ca. 21 August 1920]

NEGRO IS OUTGROWING HIS CHILDHOOD

It would appear that the declaration by Negroes in America to come to the aid of their brethren in the West Indies by establishing and operating the Black Star Line of steamers is being resented by the pale faces in the United States and in the West Indies, who consider that the Negroes are to be exploited indefinitely. These mistaken folk display quite a lot of ignorance and folly in thinking that any one nation or people can hold another in perpetual servitude. History, which is a guide for the present and future, is replete with instances proving that nations like individuals rise and fall and that supremacy—commercial, economic, intellectual or political—has never remained permanently with one race or people. If the Negro feels that he has outgrown or is outgrowing his childhood (politically, economically and industrially) any action on his part to attain to the fullness of manhood should not be viewed with askance by the white folk.

Reproduced from *NW*, 21 August 1920.

Viscount Milner, Secretary of State,
Colonial Office, to Lieutenant-Colonel
Charles O'Brien, Governor, Barbados

DOWNING STREET,
//23rd// August, 1920

Sir,

With reference to your Secret despatch of the 24th June, I have the honour to transmit to you for your information the accompanying extract from a despatch from the Governor of British Honduras, reporting on the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League.

2. I take this opportunity to enclose a copy of a report¹ [*in the margin*: 9th March] furnished to the Governor of the Leeward Islands by His Majesty's Consul General, New York, on the subject of the West Indian Protective Society of America. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your most obedient, humble servant,

MILNER

[*Handwritten minutes*:] Hon Col Scy.

The other papers referring to this matter are in the Govt. Hs: Secret File dealing with Labour Unrest in W. Indies. I send the despatch from Sec of State for yr. perusal. It does not require reply as my despatches of 24 June and 10 Aug. contain my full comments on the local branch of the Universal Negro Assoc. I am in accord with views of Governor Hutson that to take steps against the Assoc. would assist the movement, at same time we must watch any new developments. I think if the central funds die down or if squabbles arise the whole movement may collapse. We must have Mr. Wilson watched on his return from the Convention. The grandiloquency[,] titles & general tone of the American meeting is likely to bring the Assoc. to ridicule. So far as Barbados is concerned there are no grounds for apprehension. Please return for filing.

C. O'B. [C. O'Brien] 18.9.20

His Excy.

Seen thank you Sir.

I notice that the Nigerian Press which is for the most part influenced by a Gentleman of Yoruba extraction named Kitoyi Ajasa,² has ridiculed the whole movement naturally enough in so far as it relates to "Africa for the Africans."³

The so[-]called "White-Capped-Chief of Lagos"⁴ who was present at this Conference in the U.S. and described as a "Royal Highness" is a man of no substance whatever. There are several of them and they would doubtless all doff their "white caps" to Mr. Ajasa.

[*initials illegible*] 18/9/20.

BDA, GH 3/5/1. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Secret."

1. Enclosure to Edward Merewether to Viscount Milner, 15 April 1920 (TNA: PRO CO 318/354/02554).

2. Kitoyi Ajasa (1866–1937), a Nigerian lawyer and journalist, was born in Lagos and claimed connection to the Lagos royal family. The veracity of these claims is unclear, in that details of Ajasa's early life are obscure and contradictory. His father, Thomas Benjamin Macaulay, may have been a Mahi from northern Dahomey who was sold into slavery in Sierra Leone but was then recaptured and finally settled in Nigeria in the 1860s. Ajasa went to England to study at the age of fourteen. He later studied law, qualifying in 1893. He returned to Nigeria and became a great friend to Europeans in Lagos, as well as an attorney for many European firms. His close friendship with Governor-General Frederick Lugard may have resulted in his decision to found the *Nigerian Pioneer*, a newspaper he operated from 1914 to 1936 to propound the philosophy of cooperation between whites and blacks. He urged gradual change and long-term tutorship under Great Britain to prepare for self-government.

Ajasa's political views made him unpopular with many Africans, just as they won him the friendship of Europeans. He was rewarded for his pro-British loyalty with appointments to the Legislative Council from 1906 to 1914 and to the Nigerian Council from 1914 to 1922. He was also an unofficial member of the Legislative Council from 1923 to 1933. Ajasa was knighted in 1928. Ajasa's career has been subjected to varying interpretations. One scholar has seen him as a "thoroughgoing, uncritical proponent of British Colonialism" (Robert W. July, *The Origins of Modern African Thought: Its Development in West Africa during the Nineteenth and Twentieth Centuries* [New York: Frederick A. Praeger, 1967], p. 431). Others have argued that he should best be compared to Booker T. Washington, as one who "preached moderation and worked for change behind the scenes" (Fred I. A. Omu, *Press and Politics in Nigeria, 1880-1937* [London: Longman, 1978], p. 46). In any case, Ajasa had the ear of colonial officials and advocated recognition of Africans in the civil service. He was also known to take an occasional independent stand in opposition to colonial policy, as when he spoke out strongly against the Empire Resources Development Committee while a member of the Nigerian Council (records of the Nigerian Council, 28 December 1917, PRO, CO 583/65; *Nigerian Pioneer* [Lagos], 4 August 1922).

3. In 1920, Ajasa's newspaper, the *Nigerian Pioneer*, launched a strong campaign against the Garvey movement, claiming that Garvey ignored the great differences between Africans and West Indians and Americans and asserting that he was not either "a visionary or a dreamer in reality, but a schemer" (17 December 1920). The following week, the newspaper continued the attack with part 2 of the editorial, criticizing Garvey's methods: "The pity is that the good things like education, commercial organisation of the Negroes, economic development of Negro concerns, and wider and better opportunities for the expansion of Negro manhood are being jeopardized by fruitless methods of dangerous propaganda if serious minded men and women of European race should take Marcus Garvey at his word." The editorial expressed admiration for Booker T. Washington and W. E. B. Du Bois, lauding the "steady upward progress" and "peaceful methods" of their movements. Ajasa noted the existence of the local UNIA branch and warned his "fellow loyal subjects" to "beware of being found in bad company while pursuing a patriotic and laudable end," concluding the editorial with a reiteration of Nigerian loyalty to the British Empire ("Pan-Negroism of Marcus Garvey: II," *Nigerian Pioneer*, 29 October 1920). For some time thereafter, the paper kept up its criticism of Garvey: it urged the Anglican church to prohibit the UNIA's Lagos branch from holding meetings in church buildings (19 August 1921); compared the movement's plans to a "trip to the moon" (14 April 1922); claimed that Marcus Garvey was "preying upon the gullibility of people in Lagos, we being one of the few exceptions" (30 June 1922); and rejoiced when the local branch was quiescent (16 May 1924) (James S. Coleman, *Nigeria: Background to Nationalism* [Berkeley: University of California Press, 1958], pp. 185, 458; Fred I. A. Omu, *Press and Politics in Nigeria, 1880-1937* [London: Longman, 1978], pp. 49-50).

4. The representatives of the landowning lineages on Lagos Island were known as Idejo chiefs, and each wore a white cap as a symbol of office. Chief Oluwa was the senior white-cap chief; with Herbert Macaulay as interpreter and J. Egerton-Shyngle as legal representative, he traveled with his son to London in 1920 to contest a land case with the Nigerian government before the Privy Council, the highest court of law in the British Empire. Oluwa subsequently won this historic battle, known as the "Apapa land case," thereby ensuring African land rights as well as winning substantial compensation. At this time, all the white-cap chiefs were illiterate and had poor command of English, and Oluwa was the first to travel abroad. It does not appear that any white-cap chief from Nigeria ever attended a UNIA convention in America (*SWLN*, 7 July 1921; *New York Tribune*, 19 August 1921; Taklu Folami, *A History of Lagos, Nigeria* [Smithtown, N.J.: Exposition Press, 1982], pp. 43-44, 47; *HDN*).

AUGUST 1920

Captain Norman Randolph,
Assistant Chief of Staff for Military Intelligence,
Panama Canal Zone, to the Director,
U.S. Military Intelligence Division

Quarry Heights, C.Z. August 24, 1920

Subject: *Universal Negro Improvement Association.*

1. With reference to your report, "Convention of the Universal Negro Improvement Association," which appeared in your *Weekly Situation Survey for week ending August 4, 1920*, it is desired to ascertain definitely, if possible, the names of delegates representing the Panama Canal Zone or the Republic of Panama in this convention.

2. It is believed that possibly *Nicholas Carter* who was last heard of at 2374 Seventh Avenue, Apartment #42, New York City, N.Y., may have been a representative of the negroes in the Canal Zone and the Republic of Panama.

3. Any information that you may have on this subject will be appreciated by this office and by the Zone Authorities.

NORMAN RANDOLPH
Captain, Infantry

[*Addressed:*] From: Assistant Chief of Staff
for Military Intelligence,
To: Director of Military Intelligence, G.S.,
Washington, D.C.

[*Stamped endorsement:*] CAPTAIN SNOW
M.I.4. SEP 3 1920

DNA, RG 165, 10218-261/59. TDS, recipient's copy. On Panama Canal Department Intelligence Office letterhead.

John A. C. Tilley for Earl Curzon of Kedleston,
Secretary of State, Foreign Office,
to Auckland C. Geddes,¹
British Ambassador to the United States

FOREIGN OFFICE, S.W.1,
August 25th, 1920

Sir:—

With reference to Mr. Lindsay's despatch No. 429 of March 19th last I transmit to Your Excellency herewith a copy of a letter from the Colonial Office relative to the circulation of a paper called the "Negro World" in British Honduras, and to the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League in that Colony.

2. I would invite Your Excellency's attention in particular to paragraph 5 of the enclosed despatch from the Governor of British Honduras, and should be glad if Your Excellency would continue to report from time to time on the negro movement in the United States, especially in so far as it affects the West Indies. I am, with great truth and respect, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient, humble Servant,

(For the Secretary of State)
J. A. C. TILLEY

[*Handwritten minutes:*] According to the [fuss?], Marcus Garvey, the negro who is at the bottom of all this agitation, was recently crowned "King of Africa" in New York.

I think we have investigated the "Improvement Association" as far as possible (see N.Y. letter of March 30th)

We might 1) send copy of this to N.Y[.]

2) circulate superintending consuls in the south, asking for periodical reports on the negro question.

[N. D. C. ?]

Also inform F.O. of what we know already, saying the ambassador understands that Scotland Yard is in possession of much useful information on this question.

R. L. C. [10]/9.

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS, recipient's copy.

1. Sir Auckland Campbell Geddes (1879–1954) was the British Ambassador to the United States from 1920 until 1924. Educated at Edinburgh, Geddes served in both the South African War and World War I. His government service included Minister of National Service, President of the Local Government Board, Minister of Reconstruction, and President of the Board of Trade (WWI).

AUGUST 1920

Cecil E. A. Rawle to J. R. Ralph Casimir

[Dominica] 28/VIII/1920¹

Dear Casimir

In reply to your request for leave from the 28th. I find it necessary to dispense with your services //entirely// during the month of September. Your recent political articles² and speeches have given great offence to the majority of my clients both white and coloured, many of whom threaten [*illegible word above line*] to withdraw their work from me if I continue to employ you. These articles & speeches have been exceedingly offensive in tone and stupid in matter, and certainly cannot in any way help the cause which you profess to champion. While I cannot and do not intend to attempt to control your political views ~~such as the~~ I certainly am not going to allow my practice and reputation to be injured by your buffoonery.

A month's rest will I have decided do you a lot of good. If at the end of the month you are in a more sober frame of mind, and undertake to refrain from political or racial activities of every description I will gladly re-employ you.

CECIL E. A. RAWLE³

JRRC. ALS, recipient's copy.

1. Diagonal lines and roman numerals in original handwritten date. Casimir appears to have left the job on 21 June 1920.

2. This refers to Casimir's articles submitted to the *Negro World* and the *Guardian*.

3. As a colored barrister with influence and connections in the community, Cecil E. A. Rawle would have been vulnerable to criticism from his more affluent clientele for employing, and thus supporting, someone they perceived as a "troublemaker."

Editorial in the *Barbados Times*

[Barbados, ca. 28 August 1920]

"SEDITION" IN BARBADOS

To be seditious nowadays is to resent allowing yourself to be exploited and oppressed.

To judge by the Seditious Publications Ordinance which is now on our legislative tapis and which will undoubtedly pass the Council without, I fear, much opposition, is to follow the constitutional method to try and get your wrongs redressed; to try to uplift yourself from the apathy into which you have allowed yourself to fall because of the knowledge that you were being exploited.

When this odious bill was introduced in one of the neighboring colonies, it was said, if I remember correctly, that it was directed against certain publications emanating from the United States of America, and incidentally, the Negro

World, and one or two other American periodicals devoted to the interest of the peoples of African descent were mentioned as cases in point.

If, and according to the powers that be, to publish the truth, and to express your candid opinion of the said truth fearlessly is sedition, then must I agree with my rulers that the Negro World is a seditious publication.

We are told that we have laws in this island as also in the other West Indies which provid[e] fully against sedition. If this is correct it makes the evident determination of the government to push through the bill still more of a puzzle, or perhaps better, it would be puzzling if the reason of their determination was not so obvious.

It can be stated openly and without fear of reasonable contradiction that the British West Indies is second to none in loyalty to the throne. Proportionately these islands gave to Great Britain during the course of the World War both in men and value as much as any part of the empire and more than, oh! very much more than one of the great dominions.

Although that which the West Indies gave was given spontaneously, yet after President Wilson's "Fourteen Points" were accepted as the basis of the after-war readjustment, it was thought that these poor islands would certainly come in for their share of gratitude from the United Kingdom no matter how small it might be; but even in our wildest flights of imagination it was never conceived that England, "the home of the brave and true," the England of Pitt, Chatham, Wilberforce and Cromwell would ever have repaid our loyalty with a thing like the seditious publication bill.

Sedition! Sedition! Who is calling for sedition in the West Indies? who is he who is determined to break the peace of this quiet corner of the world? It cannot be a native of the country with whom it was the pride of inhabitants of these islands to identify themselves, for even now that odious bill has already begun to take effect. Not! Oh no! Let us hope, let us pray that it is the hopeless dream of some war crazed fanatic, maddened by the holocaust in devastated France and Belgium and no[w] glutted with the terrors of Bolshevism¹ in Russia to introduce into the midst of our peaceful community the horrible sight of a defenceless people who, maddened by injustice and oppression, resort to force to try and right their wrongs only to be butchered with machine guns from an ever ready British cruiser.

Reproduced from NW, 28 August 1920.

1. From 1918 to 1921, the Russian Civil War raged between the Bolsheviks (the Red Army) and the anti-Bolsheviks (the White Army). As, during these years, the Soviet Union became increasingly economically isolated and many of the best workers either fled or died in battle, the Bolsheviks, under Lenin, adopted the temporary economic and political policy of war communism. This policy allowed the state to take control of the entire economy, in order to feed and supply the military and the starving urban workers. However, the Red Army seized grain from farmers without compensating them, and millions of peasants in the Don region starved to death. War communism ended in March 1921, when Lenin implemented the New Economic Policy (1921-1928) (Paul Craig Roberts, "War Communism: A Re-examination," *Slavic Review* 29, no. 2 [1970]: 238-261; Peter Gatrell, "The First World War and War Communism, 1914-1920," in *The Economic Transformation of the Soviet Union*, ed. R. W. Davies, Mark Harrison, and S. G. Wheatcroft [New York: Cam-

AUGUST 1920

bridge Univ. Press, 1994], pp. 216–237; Silvana Malle, *The Economic Organization of War Communism 1918–1921* [Cambridge: Cambridge Univ. Press, 1985]).

Article in the *West Indian*

[Grenada, ca. 28 August 1920]

NEGRO WORLD SEIZED IN TRINIDAD

The Port of Spain Gazette says since the passing of the Seditious Publication Bill, under which certain publications were forbidden to be imported or brought into the colony, quite a few were still finding their way into the colony—despite all which were destroyed when found by the Postmaster General. Recently two seizures were made, one at the St. Vincent Wharf and another at the Customs. We learned in the first instance that a boatman named Hillary went off to the S.S. Maraval, and after he had returned and landed on the St. Vincent Wharf about 10 o'clock Lance Corporal Harris saw him with a small grip, and becoming suspicious questioned him as to its contents. He had it searched, and among a few articles, which he said were given him by the quartermaster of the steamer, were three copies of the *Negro World*. He was taken to the officer and reported by the lance corporal. The officer further reported the matter to the principal landing waiter, who ordered the papers be seized.

Shortly after 4 o'clock in the afternoon a carpenter of the same steamer landed at the Customs with a parcel of papers. These were searched, and among them a copy of the same paper was also found. He gave as his explanation that it was given to him by a friend in New York to take to one Holder, who is the keeper of the Cotton Hill Reservoir.

All the parties concerned were reprimanded by the Collector of Customs and the prohibited papers confiscated and destroyed.

Reproduced from *NW*, 28 August 1920.



U.S. Virgin Islands

Poem by Daniel Henderson in the *Negro World*

[[St. Croix, ca. 28 August 1920]]

A SINISTER SONG FROM ST. CROIX

II. SUGAR

I could make a song concerning the peace of St. Croix—

I could sing of an island drenched in the sun's gold and lapped by blue waters!
 I could picture lordly palms and emerald hills and white beaches under soothing turquoise skies!
 I could pretend that the fire of the hibiscus is the only flame that runs across the sugar estates!
 I could sing that the sun pours an opiate into the hearts of the natives!
 I could tell how in the silver twilight there is music and mating!
 But I cannot make a song concerning the peace of St. Croix—
 Because I know that peace does not live among the men in the canefields!
 Because I hear whispers of past uprisings¹ and present plotting!
 Because I see marines and machine guns!²
 Because I have learned of the frenzied whisper of labor leaders:

“Fire is the black man's friend!
 Fire is as strong as an army!
 One match can burn a centrale!”

And because I know that peace does not dwell in the heart of the planter's wife
 As she looks on her three young daughters aslee[p] like lilies in the moonlight!

DANIEL HENDERSON

Printed in *NW*, 28 August 1920.

1. When the three islands that comprised the Danish West Indies—St. John, St. Thomas, and St. Croix—became a royal colony in 1754, a long period of growth commenced. St. Croix, the new capital for the Danish West Indies, became one of the wealthiest islands in the Caribbean, due in large part to sugar cultivation. In addition to declining sugar prices in the 1820s, a series of slave revolts that elicited fear among the Dutch ruling class contributed to a depressed economy in St. Croix. A famous aborted conspiracy occurred in 1759, when a slave on Bagge's plantation obtained bullets from two white men. The slave was arrested, and he revealed the intricate plot for rebellion, in which the leader, William Davis, instructed slaves from different plantations to kill their masters, convene on Coleman's plantation, and storm the West End fort.

Ultimately, this fear of further insurrection culminated in the Dutch adoption of abolition in 1848, following the largest slave uprising in St. Croix's history. On 2 and 3 July 1848, news of revolt spread among the island's slave population by way of signal fires, bells, and conch shells. By the morning of 3 July, eight thousand slaves stood outside of Frederiksted Fort and demanded emancipation. Unlike other slave rebellions in the West Indies, this incident involved almost no bloodshed, and it ended in emancipation by gubernatorial fiat. The proclamation abolishing slavery forbade future enslavement and pronounced all future children born to slaves in the Dutch West Indies free. Still, in response to economic decline in St. Croix, the Danish governor general kept blacks in positions of servitude, and his proclamation forced former slaves to remain tied to their plantations until 1859. Further, former slaves in this colony worked as apprentices until 1878 (Waldemar Westergaard, “Account of the Negro Rebellion on St. Croix, Danish West Indies, 1759,” *Journal of Negro History* 11, no. 1 [1926]: 50–61; Svend Holsoe, “The Beginning of the 1848 Emancipation Rebellion on St. Croix,” in *The Danish Presence and Legacy in the Virgin Islands*, ed. Holsoe and John McCollum [Frederiksted: St. Croix Landmarks Society, 1993], pp. 75–85; Franklin W. Knight, “The Disintegration of the Caribbean Slave Systems, 1772–1886,” in *General History of the Caribbean: The Slave Societies of the Caribbean*, vol. 3, ed. Franklin W. Knight [Hong Kong: UNESCO, 1997], pp. 322–345; Isidor Paiewonsky, *Eyewitness Accounts of Slavery in the Danish West Indies (Also Graphic Tales of Other Slave Happenings on Ships and Plantations)*

[New York: Fordham Univ. Press, 1989]; Neville A. T. Hall, *Slave Society in the Danish West Indies: St. Thomas, St. John and St. Croix*, ed. B. W. Higman [Mona, Jamaica: Univ. of the West Indies Press, 1992]; Eddie Donoghue, *Negro Slavery: Slave Society and Slave Life in the Danish West Indies* [Bloomington, Indiana and Milton Keynes, U.K.: AuthorHouse, 2007]).

2. The United States Virgin Islands, formerly known as the Danish West Indies, is comprised of three major islands: St. John, St. Thomas, and St. Croix. The United States purchased these islands in 1917 for use as a naval base, due to their strategic location near the Panama Canal and Puerto Rico and to the United States' concern that Germany would purchase the Danish West Indies to use as a submarine base during World War I. The U.S. Department of the Navy administered the islands from 1917 to 1931, with Navy officers serving as posts in the executive branch of government and admirals and captains acting as the governors. In addition, a battalion of marines was assigned as the military garrison of the islands. Woodrow Wilson's decision to let the Navy govern the new colony dashed the hopes of black Virgin Islanders, who initially saw American democracy as the key to political reforms that the Dutch denied them. Instead, the Navy strengthened the power of white planters and merchants who made up the elite minority. Further, racial tensions increased, as sailors assumed that Jim Crow laws applied to the islands' black population and as marines who policed the streets acted offensively based on racial prejudices. Hence, poor policies and attitudes implemented and enacted by the naval administration and by the marines on the island cultivated radicalism among the Dutch West Indians, such as Rothschild Francis and D. Hamilton Jackson, who advocated for the removal of the "Naval Regime" and for greater self-government ("Pleads for Virgin Islands: Rothschild Francis Tells of Conditions of Negro Race There," *NYT*, 25 August 1919; "U.S. Marines Run Amuck in Virgin Island," *NW*, 23 April 1921; Donald D. Hoover, "The Virgin Islands under American Rule," *Foreign Affairs* 4, no. 3 [April 1926]: 503–506; Isaac Dookhan, "The Search for Identity: The Political Aspirations and Frustrations of Virgin Islanders under the United States Naval Administration, 1917–1927" *JCH* 12 [1979]: 1–34; José Antonio Jarvis, *Brief History of the Virgin Islands* [St. Thomas, Virgin Islands: Art Shop, 1938]; Navy Department, *Annual Reports of the Navy Department for the Fiscal Year 1917* [Washington D.C.: Government Printing Office, 1918], p. 840; Gordon K. Lewis, *The Virgin Islands: A Caribbean Lilliput* [Evanston, Ill.: Northwestern Univ. Press, 1972]; Dookhan, *A History of the Virgin Islands of the United States* [St. Thomas, Virgin Islands: College of the Virgin Islands, 1974]; William W. Boyer, *America's Virgin Islands: A History of Human Rights and Wrongs* [Durham, N.C.: Carolina Academic Press, 1983], pp. 61–183).

E. S. Jones to the *Negro World*

[[Dominica, B.W.I.,
ca. 11 September 1920]]

THE NEGRO AND CHRISTIAN CIVILIZATION

Dear Sir:

Under the Caption "The Negro's Status" the following paragraph appeared in the August number of the *Literary Guide*¹—a monthly magazine published in London by the Rationalist Press Association.²

Says the Guide: "In the April Guide I referred to a letter from a South African naval officer which had been elicited by a casual mention of the treatment of the colored races by the whites in South Africa. This allusion has brought me a very interesting letter from an Englishman resident in the Transvaal which is far too long for me to print and almost impossible to summarize. He writes: 'I am the son of an English Parson brought up to adore missionaries; used to meet Kafir parsons on equal terms in my father's house. At Cam-

bridge colored men of every hue were quite common and accepted on equal terms. So that coming to this country as a young man, I could only come prepared to regard the natives as one of ourselves with a curious color. I spent eight years in the police as J.P., prosecutor, district officer, etc., and have since been farming in the Boer back veld for twelve years, using only Kafir labor, Christian and heathen tribal and de-tribalized of half a hundred different tribes. And the result of my twenty years' experience is the conviction that white Christian civilization deteriorates the Kafir.' This correspondent utterly denies the allegations of Mr. Scully, and for the present I can only leave the matter there. But I am handing over his long and interesting letter to the R.P.A. to be considered with the replies which have come in to the questionnaire that the Association issued last year on the subject of the effect of Christian missions on the native races. R. S. P."

A statement like the above com[i]ng from a Negro would no doubt be passed over as an outburst of passion from an oppressed people, but being a plain unbiased and unsolicited statement from the other side, it must necessarily give some food for thought to the many doubting Thomases of the race and the stoic lookers on. From the above conviction of a white man who has spent twenty years among Negroes, it is quite obvious that a great necessity arises for an organization for the salvation (not necessarily spiritual) of Negroes by Negroes. The Universal Improvement Association is the best we have had as far as a means to awaken the dozing Negroes and help them to shake off their lethargy and thus be men and women worthy of a place under the sun. All success to the Universal Negro Improvement Association and long life to Marcus Garvey! Sincerely yours,

E. S. JONES

A Negro First and L[as]t

Printed in NW, 11 September 1920.

1. Published from 1885 until 1956, *The Literary Guide* was a periodical based on the ideology of freethought. The founder of the Rationalist Press Association, Charles Watts, began the publication as a small pamphlet called *Watts' Literary Guide*, which became the RPA's official periodical in 1899. It promoted humanism and rational thought, and it denounced fervent, literal religiosity. In the late nineteenth century, the publication changed its title to *The Literary Guide and Rationalist Review* and, in 1956, it became simply *The Literary Guide*. In 1966, it changed its name to the *Humanist*, and it became *New Humanist* in 1972. It continues as a successful subscription (Bill Cooke, *The Blasphemy Depot: A Hundred Years of the Rationalist Press Association* [London: Rationalist Press Association, 2003]; *DNB*).

2. The Rationalist Press Association, which changed its name to the Rationalist Association in 2002, is a freethought organization in the United Kingdom. It was founded in 1899 by George Jacob Holyoake (1817–1906), an English secularist and publisher, and Charles Watts (1858–1946), a London-born freethought editor and publisher. Freethought emerged toward the end of the seventeenth century in England as part of the rationalist agenda to oppose the Church's authority over reason based on religious belief; in other words, the freethinkers rejected the literal interpretation of the Bible, focusing instead on reason and understanding the world through nature.

Watts's father, also named Charles Watts (1836–1906), was a secularist and journalist who joined—but later left—the British Secular Union in response to his ideological disagreement with Charles Bradlaugh (1833–1891), a political activist and self-proclaimed atheist, and the National Secular Society in 1877. As did an entire subgroup of freethinkers of his father's generation, the younger Watts grew unhappy with the British secularist movement's increasingly political agenda

and its lack of intellectual focus. In 1890, he founded the Propagandist Press Committee, with Holyoake as president, both as a reaction to his discontent and to create a forum in which secularist authors could publish their work. In 1893, he renamed the press the Rationalist Press Committee, and this was incorporated as the Rationalist Press Association Limited in 1899; Holyoake took on the role of chairman. Watts served as the RPA's managing director until 1930 and then continued as vice-chairman until his death. From its inception, Watts was able to secure wealthy benefactors to support the RPA financially, and he named a series of honorary associates that included such famous authors and thinkers as J. A. Hobson, Julian Huxley, Arnold Bennett, George Brandes, Cesare Lombroso, Bronislaw Malinowski, John Morley, Bertrand Russell, Leslie Stephen, H. G. Wells, and Emile Zola. With Wells's leadership, RPA membership steadily increased throughout his lifetime. The Rationalist Association currently publishes the bimonthly *New Humanist* magazine, to which the *Literary Guide* is a predecessor (David Stewart, "The RPA at 100," *New Humanist* 114, no. 2 [1999]: 1-3, <http://newhumanist.org.uk/433/the-rpa-at-100>; J. M. Robertson, *Short History of Freethought, Ancient and Modern* [London: Watts, 1906; Frederick James Gould, *The Pioneers of Johnson's Court: A History of the Rationalist Press Association from 1899 Onwards* [London: Watts, 1929]; Robertson, *A History of Freethought in the Nineteenth Century*, vol. 1 [New York: G. P. Putnam's Sons, 1930]; Adam Gowans Whyte, *The Story of the R.P.A., 1899-1949* [London: Watts, 1949]; Bill Cooke, *The Blasphemy Depot: A Hundred Years of the Rationalist Press Association* [London: Rationalist Press Association, 2003]; DNB).

Article in the *Negro World*

[[St. Thomas, Virgin Islands,
September 11, 1920]]

GALA DAY FOR ST. THOMAS' DIVISION OF U.N.I.A.

It was arranged by the officers and members of the U.N.I.A. of the St. Thomas Division that August 29th be made a memorable day in the epoch of St. Thomas.

At 7:15 a.m. the officers and members gathered at Liberty Hall to perform for the first time in the history of the Negro in St. Thomas a ceremony for the unfurling of a flag.

And this emblem the national flag of the Negro; the Red, the Black and the Green.

The President of the Division, H. E. Flannagan, opened the meeting with an appropriate address, after which he delivered the chair to the Master of Ceremonies, C. W. Ferdinand, who spoke in choice words for a short time, and called on the Chaplain, S. A. Jacobs, to continue the ceremonies.

Immediately after the gong sounded 8 o'clock, and up went the Red, the Black and the Green floating in the breeze, while the great gathering made the air ring with the national anthem.

[“]Ethiopia, thou land of our fathers.[”]

Meeting adjourned at 8:10 to be reopened for unveiling of charter at [2] p.m.

Printed in *NW*, 11 September 1920.

SEPTEMBER 1920

Auckland C. Geddes, British Ambassador
to the United States, to Earl Curzon of
Kedleston, Secretary of State, Foreign Office

BRITISH EMBASSY, WASHINGTON,
September 15, 1920

My Lord,

I have the honour to acknowledge the receipt of Your Lordship's despatch No. 988 (A5761/443/45) of August 25th, and to inform you that I have addressed a Circular despatch to His Majesty's Superintending Consular Officers in those States where the negro question is an active issue, with a view to securing periodical reports on negro activities and the growth of the movement promoted by the various Associations having their headquarters in New York and more particularly by that known as "The Universal Negro Improvement Association." In this connection I have the honour to state that a Negro Conference held in New York in the course of last month appears to have elected Mr. Marcus Garvey, who describes himself as the President General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, to a position which, according to newspaper reports, is held to constitute him "King of Africa" and which in any case would seem to imply some measure of leadership over negroes both within and without the United States. I have the honour to be with the highest respect, My Lord, Your Lordship's most obedient, humble servant,

(SD) A. [C]. GEDDES

[*Handwritten endoresment:*] R. L. C. 15/9

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TL. Marked "No. 1161."

Draft Circular Letter from Robert Leslie
Craigie, British Embassy, to C. Braithwaite
Wallis,¹ British Consul General, New Orleans

BRITISH EMBASSY, WASHINGTON,
September 15, 1920

Sir:

I beg to inform you that I have been asked by the Foreign Office to report from time to time on the Negro movement in the United States, more particularly in so far as it affects the West Indies.

My attention and that of the Colonial Office in London has recently been called on several occasions to the activities of various negro societies and more

particularly that known as "The Universal Negro Improvement Association" having their headquarters in New York. The above mentioned Association is not merely conducting a political campaign of a nature which is likely eventually to bring it into conflict with the United States Government, but would seem also to be aiming at achieving a federation of negroes in all parts of the world which, if not at the moment prepared to claim for itself a separate national status, is evidently intended to develop on lines leading to that end. The establishment of the Black Star Line Steamship Company and of the Negro Factories Corporation under the auspices of this Association, is claimed by the leaders of the movement to have established an economic basis on which their larger political objects may rest.

In the light of this situation and having regard to the anxiety of British Colonial Governors of the West Indies and elsewhere to obtain information as to the character of a movement which cannot fail to produce a repercussion in the Colonies for which they are responsible, I should be glad if you would furnish me from time to time with a report on negro activities in the States falling within your Consular jurisdiction.

I have addressed a similar despatch to His Majesty's Consul General at Baltimore and His Majesty's Consuls at Savannah, Galveston and St. Louis, and have sent a copy to His Majesty's Consul General at New York. I am, Sir, your most obedient, humble servant,

(For H. M. Ambassador)
R. L. CRAIGIE

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS, draft.

1. Major Charles Braithwaite Wallis, F.R.G.S., F.G.S. (ca. 1873–1945), served with the Foreign Office as British consul for Liberia from 1906 to 1909; consul-general at Dakar for French Western Africa from 1909 to 1920; and consul-general in New Orleans, starting in 1920. In 1923 he became Minister to Panama and Costa Rica. Wallis was the author of *The Advance of our West African Empire, West African Warfare*, and papers in the *Journals* of the African and Royal Geographical Societies (*Times* [London], 8 August 1945).

Article in the *Crusader*

[[Port au Prince, Haiti,
Sept. 16, 1920]]

HAITI AND THE BLACK STAR LINE

HAITIAN LETTER, PART ONE

Between ten and twelve months ago there were faint sounds of the "Negro World" in this city, and some who exaggerated said Marcus Garvey is moving America. It was not taken seriously. The "Negro World" was coming into this island indeed; it did appear as if the sale of this paper was growing, for the talk

of the black man's doings in the United States was heard oftener through the appearance of the "Negro World" everywhere. The talk was of the U.N.I.A. Suddenly a notice appeared in the local newspapers that a meeting to form a branch of the U.N.I.A. would be held on a certain date. This came off on a Sunday afternoon when the building was packed with natives and English-speaking people. The President of the republic,¹ who regretfully could not attend, was represented by one [of] his Ministers. The meeting was successful and everybody went away with high hopes of becoming a member. Shortly after another meeting was called, and those who attended had to leave. It was one of the most disorderly meetings one ever witnessed. Nevertheless there were members by this time, but the prospective ones shuddered. It did not last long as the body of the U.N.I.A. broke up. A second attempt was made by a far more intelligent body, but it went down quicker than it grew. The causes of the failures for the founding to the U.N.I.A. I will not here comment on.

The nature of the reports (if any) that went up to the head office at New York, and how they took it is not known by us. Business appeared dormant. Then there was the startling announcement that the agency of the Black Star Line, Inc., is in the hands of a certain gentleman here. Through this advertisement one remembered the U.N.I.A. A glitter of hopes beamed. We understood that this agent prepared an office with its furnishings, and no doubt was getting employees. Then the scene changed. (We must here state that all kinds of reports—"lies" we would entitle them—were being posted to the office of the U.N.I.A. in New York by different people, and the officers in that office just sat at ease and swallowed everything.)

One day, in the month of May, Mr. Luc Dorsinville & Co., of this city, arrived from New York armed with a contract signed by himself and Mr. Marcus Garvey. This contract is for one year and gives him authority to establish himself as general agent for the Black Star Line, Inc., in the Republic of Haiti and to constitute sub-agencies in the island. He called a meeting by public announcement and the members of the U.N.I.A. and others attended. He showed his position and asked for co-operation. As a man full of energy, and with the desire to see the thing get a footing here, he installed an office with its requirements, got a sign-board, flag, etc., etc. He sent out a circular to the merchants of this city who signed, promising to assist the movement in every way. Considering that cargo from this port alone may not [be] sufficient he opened up sub-agencies in the towns of Jeremie, Gonaives, Port de Paix and Cape Haitien,² and three weeks before the arrival of the boat he had 77 people of this city who booked their names for passage on the "S.S. Yarmouth["] for New York.³ The sub-agents in the towns named above got busy too. They were in high glee, they lauded loudly the idea or fact to have a boat of their own to take passengers⁴ and their cargo without any ado, and here they secured as much freight as could fill the "Yarmouth" two times. There were also many passengers waiting, along with these the Government mails. But during these times all kinds of lying reports were being sent up to New York. Mr. Dorsinville did not

mind it. The merchants here got their cargo ready, but the agent could not hear from the head office as to the time of arrival of the boat here, so the cargo had to be given to the other lines.

Immediately after this happened the agency received a radio message (June 24) that the "S.S. Yarmouth" would call here from Havana. The public was notified in the local newspapers by the agency. Anxiety reigned as the propagandists put forth the argument that there was no boat of the Black Star Line—"Its only a phantom boat." It became a reality when they saw the "S.S. Yarmouth" hove in sight, and until she docked ere they believed.

The "S.S. Yarmouth" arrived at Port au Prince at about 12:30 P.M. on Sunday, June 27, and she docked at about 1 P.M. The agent, Mr. Luc Dorsinville, boarded her and welcomed her safe arrival. After a little while on this ship the Captain and other officers were taken ashore and shown around the city, taken to a few private houses where the people were all delighted to see them.

There was a public meeting at the Theatre Parisiana⁵ on Monday evening, the 28th. The orchestra played sweet pieces, indeed. The agent opened the meeting and showed the cause, its usefulness and asked for co-operation. This was responded to by a dull speech from one of the officers of the ship. He tried to show the Haitian public the reason they had a white man as captain on the boat.⁶ Ah, just here they were disappointed. Nevertheless the local papers spoke well of it the next day.

This is Tuesday. On the arrival of the boat the Captain informed the agent that he wanted coal. The situation became worse today. In a conference with the agent, Captain and another officer, the agent suggested wood, and it was agreed upon. The agent cancelled the idea immediately on the Captain's proposal to give him a letter of credit to proceed to Guantanamo for coal. Later the Captain returned to the agent and told him he had met a friend who could give him fifty tons of coal. He was glad to hear this and made himself somewhat easy. Some time after the Captain hurried to the agency and informed them he had failed to get the coal. It was late in the evening—a day had gone. Seeing things were bad the agent went about for the wood and succeeded in getting twenty tons of *lignum vitae* at \$6.00 per ton which were put alongside the ship, and put on board by laborers. The whole staff of the agency was kept busy over the affairs of the boat.

As stated above 77 people booked, but on a visit to the ship given to the public some of them called at the agency and complained of its dirty condition. (Remember the Captain had told the agent to put the time of the visit to the ship at 4 P.M. in order that they may have time to make a "clean up.") Having no stationery from the office of the Black Star Line in New York the agent printed a book of tickets (a copy is enclosed) on which he sold passages to 27 passengers bound for New York via the ports of Gonaives, Port de Paix and Cape Haitien where there was also waiting passengers and freight and mails. Passengers were going on board at about 5 P.M. on Tuesday, the 29th day scheduled for the sailing. They were all turned off the ship, and the Captain

rushed to tell the agent that the ship would leave for Kingston, Jamaica, to carry the passengers from Havana and to take coal. Imagine the state of affairs. Some of the passengers were foreigners and had arranged to leave, and thus were put in a very unpleasant position. Just here the storm clouds burst. The passengers all rushed to the agency to relate the incident. Some demanded their money paid for tickets, but he having handed over the sum of \$300 to the purser of the ship before the above occurrence was not entirely in a position to reimburse. There were also other heavy debts to be paid by the agency. A bill went into the office for supplies for the ship which reached the sum of \$469.64, and laundry, \$78.50. Up to this time the Black Star Line, Inc., had not deposited any money in any of the banks here that the agent could draw on for current expenses. The agent made reports and kept the head office in touch with everything in connection with the situation here.

(To be Continued in Next Issue.)

Printed in the *Crusader* 3 [October 1920]: 15, 19.

1. Philippe Sudre Dartiguenave (1863–1926) was born in Anse-à-Veau in southern Haiti and educated at the Petit Seminaire St. Martial. Following a lucrative career as an attorney, Dartiguenave served two terms in the Haitian legislature during the administration of Tiresias Sam and became a magistrate during the presidency of Nord Alexis. Elected to the Senate in 1910, he was presiding over that body when approached to serve as president of Haiti under U.S. direction. He was elected by the Haitian legislature on 15 August 1915 under circumstances that most Haitians thought both fraudulent and coercive. Dartiguenave was the first mulatto president in thirty-five years. His acceptance of Washington's terms, which included territorial concessions, a customs receivership, and control over the Haitian budget, made him generally unpopular. His term of office ended in 1922. That Dartiguenave sent a representative to the founding meeting of the Haitian branch of the UNIA suggests that the organizing effort was being taken seriously, if not endorsed (B. Danache, *Le Président Dartiguenave* [Port-au-Prince: Imp. De l'Etat, 1950], pp. 38–39; Hans Schmidt, *The United States Occupation of Haiti, 1915–1934* [New Brunswick: Rutgers University Press, 1971], pp. 72–74, 127–128).

2. Many transportation companies, import-export merchants, and large retailers maintained branch offices in the smaller coastal towns. By the 1920s, as the provincial economy shrank, transactions were increasingly funneled from these ports to Port-au-Prince, the capital and the most significant port. Port-au-Prince was Haiti's major exporter of coffee and sole exporter of sugar in the mid-1920s. This export trade typically experienced sharp seasonal fluctuations (*Annual Report of the Financial Adviser-General Receiver, 1926*, DNA, RG 59, p. 32; *Blue Book of Haiti* [New York: Klebold Press, 1920], passim; Monthly Bulletin of the American Chamber of Commerce of Haiti, *A Commercial Handbook of Haiti* 8, no. 1 [November 1925]: 37).

3. While the Caribbean population of the eastern United States grew in the 1920s, few of the newcomers came from Haiti, and even fewer immigrated permanently. The estimated five hundred Haitians in New York in the late 1920s tended to differ occupationally from Anglophone Caribbean immigrants. Many worked in skilled trades or in the retail sector. After the establishment of the U.S. military occupation, a handful of Haitian students came to the United States to study technical and scientific subjects (Ira DeAugustine Reid, *The Negro Immigrant, His Background, Characteristics and Social Adjustment, 1899–1937* [New York: AMS Press, 1939], pp. 97, 98).

4. Haitians wishing to travel abroad had to book passage on one of several European or North American shipping lines. Service was sometimes erratic and, as late as 1934, Haitians who were not government officials were prohibited from traveling first class on certain carriers (Haitian Afro-American Chamber of Commerce, *Official Report of the Haitian Afro-American Chamber of Commerce's Commission to Study the Commercial, Agricultural, and Industrial Possibilities of the Haitian Republic, August 17 to September 4, 1934*, bound typescript, NN-Sc).

5. Built in 1913, the Theatre Parisiana was a popular grand theater and well-known Port-au-Prince landmark. It was a place where affluent people watched films and plays or attended meetings

(Georges Corvington, *Port-au-Prince au cours des ans: La Métropole haïtienne du XIXe siècle, 1888–1915*, 2nd rev. ed., vol. 4 [Port-au-Prince: Imp. Henri Deschamps, 1994], pp. 268–269, 275–280).

6. The master of the *Yarmouth* from New York via Havana, Port-au-Prince, and Kingston was Charles Edward Dixon (“Shipping,” *DG*, 3 July 1920; Ancestry.com, *New York Passenger Lists, 1820–1957* [online database; Provo, Utah], Records of the Immigration and Naturalization Service, National Archives, Washington D.C., National Archives Microfilm Publication T715, Passenger and Crew Lists of Vessels Arriving at New York, New York, 1897–1957).

Article in the *Crusader*

[[Port au Prince, Haiti,
Sept. 16, 1920]]

HAITI AND THE BLACK STAR LINE

HAITIAN LETTER, PART TWO

The steamship *Yarmouth* sailed for Kingston, Jamaica, on the 31st of July. A letter was sent to the captain that the passengers and freight are still waiting and must return here within six days. On her arrival there the agent here cabled for her. She replied she was on repairs. Another cable from here got a reply to send \$200. Mr. Dorsinville, in order to get her back here, sent \$112. Some days passed in silence. Another was sent, the reply was, “Waiting orders from New York.” Mr. Dorsinville cabled New York to the effect and asked them to give her orders to return here, then on the 4th of June two radio messages were received, one to the captain of the steamship *Yarmouth* asking him to wait, for a representative is coming down to arrange transshipment of passengers. The other to the agent asking him to keep the steamship *Yarmouth* here for the same reasons stated above. No representative turned up as yet—still waiting. Mr. Dorsinville took his papers and went to the British Vice-Consul here and asked him to telegraph to the government of Jamaica to order the boat to come back. All these means failed to get the *Yarmouth* here. All these times the people were storming at the office for their money. Some, of course, were reimbursed, but there was no money to meet everybody. Claims from lawyers were pouring into the office. The agent was repeatedly called into court for claims against the agency of the Black Star Line, Inc. The agency here kept New York office alive to all these incidents, yet they never replied. One could not understand it. It was provocable.

On the 15th instant Mr. Dorsinville received a letter from New York dated the 30th of July. They acknowledged receipt of all letters sent, also letters given to some people who could find other money to proceed to New York for a reimbursement of their money at the office of the Black Star Line. Re the question of coal they argued that it will be a hard matter for the steamship *Yarmouth* to call at Haiti if you cannot supply coal. Did these people bring a supply of coal here? Did they give money to secure any? (A copy of the letter is

enclosed.) In another paragraph they asked how many passengers more are in Haiti, as it might be possible to have the Yarmouth call at Port au Prince. Would the Haitian people patronize this ship again after their treatment by her officers on her first trip here?

The last paragraph shows up how much the officials of this concern give themselves over to lying reports. Re stockholders' money, it is just as equal a criminal negligence for the captain to take a woman's money—\$28 to take her to New York, the ship not going there again, this agency had to refund it. Also the purser failed to pay the fee for the Haitian Government head tax taken from a passenger to Jamaica.

BLACK STAR LINE

No. Amount From to Mr. by the Steamship estimated to sail on issued

BLACK STAR LINE,
General Agent.

COPY

17th August, 1920.

The Black Star Line, Inc.,
Universal Building,
54-56 West 135th Street,
New York City, N.Y.

Gentlemen:—

We are in receipt of your letter dated the 30th ult. which has had our careful attention.

COAL.—For some time no coal can be secured in this island. Ships of other steamship lines calling here carry a sufficient quantity to last them in their incoming and outgoing trips. Can any blame be attached to this agency because there is no coal in Haiti? It is a regret[*t*]able thing that the ships of the Black Star Line cannot call here because there is no coal here. I wonder on whom the blame falls owing to the dearth of coal in Haiti?

EXPENSES.—At your time of writing we believe that you did not yet receive our statement for the month of June, hence your caustic remarks. We here clearly see that you are under the influence of the “unpleasant things” you stated you heard. Bosh! Do you know that it is a fact that the head office of the Black Star Line in New York did not deposit a cent in any banks of the banks in this island for the use of the agency here? Did not passengers try to board the S.S. “Yarmouth” after paying their passage in this office and were put off the boat, the Captain having changed his mind at the last moment? The passengers had to be reimbursed and the agency found it very difficult to do so because the purser, having demanded some money, was given the sum of \$300. We do not want to

create any bad feelings as my integrity can be seen and verified from my statement for the months of June and July.

We regret to state that the Haitian public has lost all confidence in the Black Star Line owing to the treatment meted out to the passengers on their first trip, intending to go to New York. Therefore there is none on hand that would warrant the "Yarmouth" or any other ship of the Black Star Line calling here.

The action of listening to reports unofficial about this agency we consider small. Had you commissioned a representative to come here and see conditions and make an official report it would [have] been a decent thing to do. We regard it a criminal offence that the purser takes on a female passenger to Jamaica who paid him her passage, and he failed to pay the fee for the Head Tax to the Haitian Government, though he had been notified of the procedure, and in every such case a fine of \$500 is imposed.

It may interest you to note that we are representatives for many business houses in the United States of America and France, and in none our integrity has been questioned.

Before the arrival of the S.S. "Yarmouth" we secured cargo, but owing to your silence as to what time the boat would be here, the merchants had to turn their cargoes to the other steamship lines. On proving the fact to the Haitien public that there does exist a boat for the Black Star Line by her presence, we secured cargo up to an amount of \$30,960.00 immediately after departure, and all means used to get her back proved a failure. Was it right for the officers of the "Yarmouth" to take the passengers' money, put them off the ship, leaving the heavy debt of \$547.84 to be paid; the captain on arriving at Kingston sent for \$200, and we sent \$112 in order that he return to take the passengers and freight? Is it right for the captain to take \$28.00 from a passenger who intended to go to New York and then refused to take her on the ship, she having brought her receipt to this office when we had to refund it? We had to take all our papers to the British Consul and requested him to telegraph to the Governor of Jamaica to order her to return here which was done, and from cables received from the captain assured us that they would return.

The matter of having no coal in Haiti should not be the reason for the Black Star Line not to live up to their contract. More sales would have been made if the ship was not so dirty and there was not a white captain on the ship, also if the passengers were treated better on boarding the vessel. You can see from the clippings of the newspapers sent to you how the people were glad to have a boat to travel easily. We have certified papers to show that the respective sub-agents in this island had in the Custom House freight, and passengers were waiting for the ship.

SEPTEMBER 1920

Re the sale of shares, the stock book is numbered; very good! We will readily show up our account of those who have paid cash and those that are cancelled. Cancelled because after the meeting at the Parisiana Theatre we issued a lot of blanks. But as stated above the people would not worry again as they lost confidence in the line.

We again wonder that such an organization should fail to communicate with its agency about once in two months. Well, well! Urgent replies were to be got, even to satisfy anxious people here. All communications from this agency were thus sne[e]red at, no doubt, from the fact that unpleasant things were heard about this agency.

We have no doubt you will see our position more clearly from the above and we await your early reply with interest, especially in the reimbursements of passengers' moneys, and will also remind you of the amount due this office for moneys advanced to the agency of the Black Star Line in Haiti.

As the Black Star Line does not live up to its contract I herewith beg to confirm my letters of July 31st, 1920, in regards to cancelling my contract, and reserve my right. Faithfully yours,

(Signed) LUC DORSINVILLE

Printed in the *Crusader* 3 [November 1920]: 7, 21-23.

George Tobias,¹ Treasurer, Black Star Line,
to J. R. Ralph Casimir

UNIVERSAL BUILDING,
56 WEST 135TH STREET
NEW YORK, U.S.A. September 25th, 1920

DEAR MR. CASIMIR:—

Your letter of the 30th of July and 24th of August enclosing \$9.74 and \$20.00 American bill have been received, for which please accept our best thanks.

According to your instructions enclosed herewith we are forwarding you Certificate #25820 for one share in favor of Mr. Armanstrading and a part-payment receipt for \$4.74 for yourself and Certificate #25576 for Phylis Baron and #25577 for Thomas Peter for one share each.

You enclosed a blank for Felix John Simpson but did not mention the quantity of shares therefore we are not going to issue any Stock Certificates until we hear from you. This transaction will leave us with \$10.00 in hand for you, pending your further instructions. Promptly on receipt of your reply we shall give this matter our further attention.

Many thanks for the good wishes and for the continued interest that you manifest in the work of the Organization.

FOREIGN MONIES The notice in the Negro World newspaper is principally meant for Africa and in those countries where the reckoning is done in other than dollars and cents, as long as you can get money orders in Dominica for dollars and cents it will be acceptable to us. Therefore, kindly remit what you are holding and we shall issue Stock Certificates right away.

BLACK STAR LINE BOATS Your remarks in regard to this is of great importance but the pity of it is that we have not sufficient boats to visit all the various places that our people would like them to visit. We receive letters daily from different parts of the world asking us to send our boats over, but at the present time we only own three, one of which is an excursion boat and the other two can only make one port at a time. Our President is trying his utmost to float some more boats of very large tonnage, which will be capable of withstanding the heavy seas and making ocean voyages but as you yourself know this will take a great deal of money.

If the people would subscribe the money we would get the boats and we wish to assure you that we are doing the best we can under existing circumstances. In the near future you may have the pleasure of seeing one of our boats in your part but as to when time can only tell.

Thanking you for the continued interest you are manifesting in the work of the Organization and trusting that your threatened prosecution or arrest will be averted. Yours very truly, BLACK STAR LINE, INC.

GEO. TOBIAS

//per P.P.// Treasurer

[*Addressed to:*] MR. J. R. RALPH CASIMIR
P.O. Box 81[,] Roseau, Dominica, B.W.I.

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy. On BSL letterhead.

1. George W. Tobias (b. 1888) was a native of Grenada who came to the United States in September 1913 from the Panama Canal Zone, where he was employed as a clerk with the Isthmian Canal Commission. When he met Garvey in May 1918, he was a clerk in the shipping department of the Pennsylvania Railroad in New York. His first position with the UNIA was as an editorial assistant with the *Negro World*; later he was elected first vice president, second vice president, and treasurer of the UNIA. On 17 June 1919 he was elected treasurer of the Black Star Line (BSL), a position that he retained until he was indicted, along with Garvey and two other BSL officials, on charges of mail fraud in 1922. At his trial in June 1923, Tobias was acquitted (AFRC, RG 163, registration card; *Garvey v. United States*, no. 8317 [Ct. App. 2d Cir. Feb. 2, 1925], folios 6372-6373, pp. 2124-2125; *NYT*, 17 February 1922).

SEPTEMBER 1920

Acting British Consul, Galveston,¹
to Auckland C. Geddes, British Ambassador
to the United States

BRITISH CONSULATE, GALVESTON
28th: September, 1920

Sir,

In reply to your Circular Despatch of the 15th: instant instructing me to report from time to time on the negro movement in this Consular District, especially as it affects the West Indies, I have the honour to report as follows:—

A weekly newspaper, "THE NEGRO WORLD," (a copy of which is forwarded under separate cover [*handwritten note in the margin: attached*]) printed in New York, is being mailed to some of the leading negro citizens of this town. One man stated that he had received fifty copies of one issue to be distributed among "the coloured people," but *no meeting appears to have been held nor any movement made in respect to starting THE UNIVERSAL NEGRO IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION or any such like Society.*

The *climate* of this District is *suited* to the negro race and the industrious negro, both in the cities and in the country, is *paid good wages* for services rendered. Consequently, there is *less discontent here* than is often found in the northern States and it will *take some time to instill into the negro of the South the apparent object of the "Negro Improvement Association."*

In the cities many negroes own their own homes, have separate schools for their children, the cur[r]iculum of the schools being the same as that of the schools for white children, and they have their own churches and their own libraries.

In the country, quite a large number of negro farmers are well to do. They have purchased the land on which they work, built themselves nice homes and own cows, horses and mules besides.

The *West Indian negroes* in this District, as a rule, are *loyal to their flag* and appear *proud* of their *British Citizenship*. They *consider themselves* of a *superior class* to the *Texas negro* and do not affiliate much with the native coloured man.

Many negroes from Oklahoma and Texas//, with quite a few of the West Indian negroes, at the solicitations of "Chief Sam"² took stock in the steamer "LIBERIA"³ which sailed from Galveston some seven years ago for Africa. Losing all they invested, besides their household belongings which they took with them intending to make their home in Liberia, taught them a hard lesson and they do not now appear anxious to invest their earnings in negro productions and to run after strange gods. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient, humble Servant,

[*signature illegible*]
Acting Consul

[*Handwritten Note:*] Bring up when other
replies are received.

R[.] L[.] C[.]

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS. Recipient's Copy. Italicized words are underlined by hand on recipient's copy.

1. In 1920 African Americans accounted for 22.3 percent, or 9,888 out of 44,255 people, in Galveston, Texas (United States Bureau of the Census, *Abstract of the Fourteenth Census of the United States, 1920* [Washington D.C.: Government Printing Office, 1923], p. 117). Since the late nineteenth century de facto segregation was strictly enforced in churches, theaters, hotels, saloons, and barbershops. It would not be until 1928, in one of the first clear protests against segregation, that a black schoolteacher, John H. Clouser, stood before the city commission and demanded the removal of signs that read "For White People Only" in Menard Park. The signs came down and commissioners designated a few blocks as a park for blacks, but after protests by whites, a referendum was held which vetoed the action of the commission, so that the new site became a park for white children and a former park was assigned for black children. According to David G. McComb, for the most part, "... there was little challenge like Clouser's to white authority and dominance" in Galveston during this period (David G. McComb, *Galveston: A History* [Austin: University of Texas Press, 1986], pp. 90, 211).

2. Chief Sam (ca. 1879–1930s), born Alfred Charles Sam, was a native Ghanaian who first came to America in 1911 seeking a religious conversion to a small sect of Christianity in Shiloh, Maine. Even before his trip to the United States, however, Sam had established import-export trading connections in America. In 1913 he started his own venture, the Akim Trading Company, based in New York City. Sam's company combined the interests of his capitalist venture and the goals of the emigrationists living in America at the time. Through his religious affiliates, Sam came in contact with many elite African Americans in Oklahoma and other parts of the country who wanted to start a back to Africa movement. Considered "an early attempt at Black Zionism" by J. Adoyele Langley, the Chief Sam movement sought to create a new homeland for elite, capable African Americans who could work with local African populations in the Gold Coast to farm and develop the land (*Pan-Africanism and Nationalism in West Africa 1900–1945* [Oxford: Clarendon, 1973], p. 41). Sam and his group organized a boat from Cuba, the *Curityba* (later renamed the *Liberia*), to bring these elites to the section of land Sam had purchased in the Gold Coast in 1914. The venture hit a number of obstacles, including illness due to tropical diseases and a long delay in Sierra Leone, where many of their financial resources were depleted during their detainment by the British government. Most of the emigrants returned to America soon thereafter. Because of the financial difficulties sustained under his disorganized leadership, Sam himself was accused of stealing the money from the company and eventually went into self-exile in Liberia, where he died sometime in the 1930s (Langley, *Pan-Africanism and Nationalism in West Africa 1900–1945*, pp. 41–58).

3. The steamer *Liberia* set sail from Galveston, Texas, with sixty passengers on 20 August 1914 and finally arrived at the Gold Coast on 7 January 1915 after a delay of several months in Sierra Leone (Tiya Miles and Sharon P. Holland, eds., *Crossing Waters, Crossing Worlds: The African Diaspora in Indian Country* [Durham, N.C.: Duke University Press, 2006], p. 94; *The Booker T. Washington Papers, Open Book edition, vol. 12, 1912–14*, ed. Louis R. Harlan and Raymond W. Smock, University of Illinois Press, 1982, <http://www.historycooperative.org/btw/Vol.12/html/438.html>).

SEPTEMBER 1920

Sergeant-Major Henry James Geen,
Leeward Islands Police, to Major W. E. Wilders,
Inspector, Leeward Islands Police

L.I. Police Basseterre [St. Kitts]
28th. Sep. 1920

Sir,

I have the honour to report for your information that a meeting of the St. Kitts Benevolent Society was held at Pond Pasture on night of the 23rd. instant. It commenced at 8.5 p.m. and closed at 9.20 p.m. About 300 persons were present.

Harris addressed the gathering said, my friends I am glad to be here to address you once more but I must be careful about what I say for there is listeners around. Sometime ago we had a meeting at Haynes Smiths Village and a certain man make up report on us and said that I have said all kind of things about Archdeacon Caunt. Well what I have said is true and Archdeacon Caunt Knows it too, however, Archdeacon Caunt came to our office and we are all friends now. He has made friend with us and we are not going to be his enemies no more. I am glad to tell you all that this Society is doing a lot of good work in this Island. Some of you say the Union is no good. Some say the Union is no use but when all you get in trouble all of you run to the Union for assistance and help in every way. Let me tell you all that Marcus Garvey is a wonderful man: he is the head of the Negro race and is working hard for our good and before long all of us will be in Africa. I am an office/r// in this society and I am glad to inform you all that we are soon going to get the Black Star Line Steamer here, but let me ask all of you what are you all doing to help the Black Star Line Steamer? you are all keeping quiet and doing nothing[.] All of you take my advice and join the Black Star Line by putting in as many shares as you can so that before long you will have the steamer here to take our people wherever they want to go. I am now going to tell you all about the head and tail of a fish. As you know the head of a fish should rule but in this Island it is the tail of the fish ruling all of us here, he is no damn good. I want you all to come and join this society and you all must do so now. Don[']t wait until it is too late to come and join us, come now. This is the time. You all make a plenty of money this year and it is this society that help you all so well for as you all know the white people in this Island are all afraid of this society.¹ Only call the Union society to them and you will find the/y// all tremble to hear it and you all know as I do that what I am saying is perfectly true. There is no doubt my friends that this society has a lot of enemies but I am sure we have seen the goings of many and will still continue to see the going of all this society's enemies (laughter and cheers) [. . .]

HENRY JAMES GEEN
Sergt. Major of Police

[*Handwritten endorsement:*] His Hon
The Administrator
For your Honour's information
W. E. Wilders [Insp?] 28.9.20

SKNNA, 736. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Confidential." Extraneous material elided.

1. There were significant wage increases in St. Kitts in 1920 inspired in part by the labor activities of the UBA. A petition for higher wages organized by Anthony Harris and the UBA on behalf of the porters and boatmen secured an increase in boatmen's rates from 1/- to 2/- per passenger, as well as the introduction of new overtime rates for porters. Significant increases in sugar prices, combined with labor scarcity due to large-scale seasonal migration to the Dominican Republic and Cuba by estate workers, led to an increase in estate wage rates. The *Leeward Islands Blue Book of 1920* shows the daily wage rate increasing from 1/- to 2/- for male laborers and from 9d. to 1/- for female laborers. Task rates increased from 1/6-3/6 to 5/6 for males and 10d-1/4 to 1/-2/6 for females. The printers' strike organized with the support of the UBA had also won significant wage increases ("Average Daily Wage Rates," *LIBB*, 1920, Section X).

J. R. Ralph Casimir to Marcus Garvey

[Roseau, Dominica] Sep. 29th 1920

Your Excellency,

On behalf of 40,000 Negroes of D/ca [Dominica] including officers & members of the D/ca Branch of the U.N.I.A. & A.C.L., I send you greetings hoping that Almighty God will help guide and protect you and crown your efforts with success. May He enlighten your burdens & that under your leadership "Ethiopia will stretch forth her hands unto God & Princes will come out of Egypt."

We heartily appreciate the stand which you have taken & the great battles you are fighting & assure you that we will try our best to give whatever aid we can in helping to fight the good fight.

God save Marcus Garvey! Long live Marcus Garvey
God save Marcus Garvey
Send him Victorious! Happy & Glorious
Long to lead us fearlessly & successfully
God save Marcus Garvey.

Wishing you all success & hoping to hear from you[.] I have the honor to be, Sir, Your Excellency's obedient Servant

(sd) J. R. RALPH CASIMIR
Gen-Sec
D/ca Branch U.N.I.A. & A.C.L.

JRRC. ALS, copy.

SEPTEMBER 1920

Acting British Consul, Savannah, to Auckland
C. Geddes, British Ambassador
to the United States

British Consulate, Savannah,
Georgia. 30 Sept: 1920

Sir:—

With reference to Your Excellency's circular despatch of the 15th instant, I have the honour to submit some observations on the "Negro Movement" in the United States, so far as it has come under my notice in the states of Georgia and North & South Carolina.

(1) As regards any specific propaganda by "The Universal Negro Improvement Association" I have at present been unable to hear of any branch or agency of that association which is in actual existence in this part of the United States. I am however still making enquiry and hope to make a further report in due course. The information personally furnished to me by two representative negroes here,—namely the Editor of a (coloured) Newspaper and the Manager of a Negro Bank,—is that "The Universal Negro Improvement Association,"—which is known to exist,—is *looked upon as little more than a money-making scheme for the advantage of the official promoters and is not regarded as a serious movement for the benefit of the race.*

(2) An incident that occurred last month at Charleston, South Carolina, throws some light on the subsidiary organization known as "The Black Star Line Steamship Company." In the beginning of August the Vice-Consul at Charleston reported that a vessel belonging to that line called the "YARMOUTH,"—(flying the British flag, and vulgarly known as "The Alcoholic Ark,")—had put in at that port in a miserable plight. She was short of coal & provisions: there was small-pox on board; the Master complained of difficulties with his crew, and especially of the conduct of an American stowaway, who, he said, "was eating three meals a day; very costly, and very insolent to him."

On August 12th this Master,—I believe a Canadian, and the only white man on board the ship,—had become indebted to the amount of nearly twelve thousand dollars, for supplies and other expenses which the owners were at the time unable to pay, and the "YARMOUTH" was thereupon libelled. I have no precise knowledge how she finally got away from Charleston, but it is quite certain that she came there badly found and equipped, badly managed by the owners, badly commanded by the Master, and that if it is not unfair to take this vessel as a specimen of the "Black Star Line Steamship Company"'s fleet, it may also be reasonable to conclude that the operations of such a concern are unlikely to accomplish any large commercial or political objects, but are better calculated to weaken the professed cause in view and to confirm prevailing conceptions as to the limitations of the negro race in the conduct of affairs.

(3) With regard to the connection of any Negro Movement in this country with ~~the~~ social or political develo[pm]ents in the West Indies, I have formed the opinion that the *West Indian negroes are in every way so superior to the negroes of the Southern States* of which I have any special knowledge, *that it is improbable that the former would ever follow the lead of the latter*, except, perhaps, as regards some detail of organization which might seem by it's success in this country to offer encouragement for it's adoption elsewhere. I do not at present know of any such success that has been achieved here; and former Negro movements have been characterized by a feeble policy; bad leadership; want of intelligence, and above all by a conspicuous lack of discipline.

(4) It has always struck me as very significant of what may be called the *levity* of these Negro movements that they *never seem to include any vigorous, organized attempt to obtain representation in Congress*. In the State of Georgia, at the present time, there are in round numbers some 150,000 *negroes who might exercise the franchise* and only some 7,000 *who do so*. This enormous disparity is accounted for, first by the fact that large numbers of negroes disqualify themselves by not paying their taxes, (especially the Poll-Tax,) and secondly that a very large proportion never take the trouble to register themselves as voters. That such a vital matter as representation in Congress should be thus neglected seems to me to show clearly that no action of the kind that in England would be called "constitutional" is being thought of; and though one explanation of this might be that revolutionary methods had been chosen as preferable, I cannot see any of the usual signs of any such attitude. The negroes here, though kept in a state of social subjection which is enforced by lynching, cannot be said to be in at all an exasperated mood; and they have recently made so much money, and have been more especially so successful in their small-farming operations, that apart from a certain amount of Race feeling they are more than usually contented. It would be very extraordinary if the almost universal industrial unrest of the world should have failed in any way to affect the Negro race. I am nevertheless of opinion that,—whether from simplicity, laziness, or from a happy state of ignorance,—the Negroes of the states of which I have any special knowledge are in a much less misch[iev]ous frame of mind than the majority of the white working classes, and that whether this is the case or not, the only way that they can be incited to take up a dangerous attitude will be by some organization with large funds, controlled by really able, energetic, far-seeing, disinterested men, not necessarily negroes themselves.

From the knowledge that has so far reached me I do not think that these conditions are fulfilled by "The Universal Negro Improvement Association."—I have the honour to be, With the greatest respect, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient, humble Servant,

[A. M. BROOKFIELD?]

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS. Recipient's copy. Marked "No. 65." Italicized words are underlined by hand on recipient's copy.

OCTOBER 1920

Under Secretary of State, Foreign Office, to the
Under Secretary of State, Colonial Office

FOREIGN OFFICE. S.W.I. [London]
1st October, 1920

Sir:—

With reference to your letter 26726/1920 of 19th August last I am directed by Earl Curzon of Kedleston to transmit to you herewith copy of a despatch from His Majesty's Ambassador at Washington, stating that His Majesty's Consular Officers in the United States of America have been directed to report upon the various Negro Associations in their districts and particularly upon the "Universal Negro Improvement Association."

This and other similar societies are known to be watched carefully by secret service agents of the Department of Justice in America and Marcus Garvey referred to in the above despatch has recently been concerned in certain disorders in Chicago.¹

The reports of His Majesty's Consular Officers will be transmitted as they are received. I am, Sir, Your most obedient, humble Servant,

[signature illegible]

[Handwritten minutes:] ~~Mr. Allen~~

Mr Darnley

See 26726/20 & 42677/20.

? Put by

[initials illegible] 14 10/20

R[.] A[.] W[.] 15 10/20

at once

E[.] R[.] D[.] 15/10

TNA: PRO CO 318/358/02548. TLS, recipient's copy.

1. In June 1920 a self-proclaimed Abyssinian, Grover Cleveland Redding (188?-1921), along with members of the Star Order of Ethiopia, led a procession down the streets of Chicago. Born in Baldwin County, Georgia, Redding (also known as George Brown, Grover Reading, and George Reading) started the group The Star Order, an illegitimate offshoot of Garvey's UNIA, as a vehicle to promote his version of a back to Africa movement. Redding's Star Order sought to relocate African Americans to Africa. His position was that African Americans should abandon the United States for Ethiopia, a country where they could go to reclaim their glory. To gain legitimacy among interested African Americans, Redding falsely claimed that he was an Ethiopian prince and a direct descendent of the Queen of Sheba and King Menelik of Ethiopia. On 20 June, dressed in what he claimed was Ethiopian royal clothing, Redding rode down the streets on a white horse. He stopped outside a café in South Chicago and, in front of members of the Star Order of Ethiopia and local onlookers, proceeded to burn an American flag. The burning of the American flag was meant to symbolize the Star Order members' break from a history of oppression and the end of their allegiance to the U.S. government. Upon destruction of the flag, a police officer named J. P. Owens approached Redding and his followers. After Owens stated that their actions were disrespectful and attempted to stop the burning of a second flag, he was shot and wounded. A white sailor at the scene by the name of Robert Lawson Rose also attempted to intervene but was shot and killed. A restaurant employee, Joseph Hoyt, was likewise shot and killed when the "Abyssinians" fired into

the café. According to one source, “in all about twenty-five shots were fired during the fracas, and several persons were injured” (The Chicago Commission on Race Relations, *The Negro in Chicago: A Study of Race Relations and a Race Riot in 1919* [Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1922], p. 59). For his involvement in the shooting, Redding was convicted of murder and hanged in Chicago on 24 June 1921. Several additional men were also arrested and tried for varying degrees of involvement in the affair. Oscar McGavock was tried for first-degree murder and hanged along with Redding that date in June. The others, Edward Rush, Harry Lee, Allen Hillis, James Briggs, and Dennis Brown, were tried as accessories to the murder. These men were subsequently acquitted by the courts in January 1921. Not only was Redding found guilty of the violence during the Chicago incident, but he was also denounced as a fraud by Garvey himself on accusations that he used his lies of Ethiopian royal heritage and connection to the official Garvey movement to manipulate African Americans into contributing money. Redding told these followers that if they contributed one dollar they would receive membership in the Star Order of Ethiopia and an Ethiopian flag. Redding never intended to use the money for relocating individuals but instead sought to use it for his own financial gain. The riot, also known as the “Abyssinian affair,” could have escalated into a much larger event, but according to the media sources of the time, the police were quite successful in quelling it (Gordon Johnston [assistant chief of staff] to War Department Headquarters Central Department, Chicago, 22 June 1920; Jas. O. Peyronnin Chicago, 17 January 1921. DNA, Roll 60 file, 202600-805; CD, 8 January 1921; Hubert H. Harrison, *A Hubert Harrison Reader* [Middletown: Wesleyan University Press, 2001], p. 180; The Chicago Commission on Race Relations, *The Negro in Chicago*, pp. 59–64, 480; William M. Tuttle, *Race Riot: Chicago in the Red Summer of 1919* [Champaign: University of Illinois Press, 1996], pp. 256–257).

Gilbert E. A. Grindle, Assistant Under Secretary
of State, Colonial Office, to the Under Secretary
of State, Foreign Office

COLONIAL OFFICE, DOWNING STREET,
October 5th, 1920

Sir:—

With reference to your letter of the 27th August, A 5761/443/45, regarding the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League, I am directed by Viscount Milner to state that he would be glad if three or four copies of the Constitution and Book of Laws of the Association could be obtained for the use of this Department and the Director of Intelligence. It is understood to have been published in New York in July 1918. I am, etc.,

(Signed.) G. GRINDLE

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TL.

OCTOBER 1920

Wilfred Collet, Governor, British Guiana,
to Viscount Milner, Secretary of State,
Colonial Office

GOVERNMENT HOUSE,
Georgetown, Demerara,
8th October, 1920

My Lord,

I have the honour to acknowledge the receipt of Your Lordship's secret despatch of the 23rd August covering extract from a despatch from the Governor of British Honduras reporting on the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League.

2. We have recently had here a lecturer calling himself Professor Brooks, a native, I believe, of St. Kitts who came from Cardiff *via* Brazil, lecturing on the objects of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. The general idea of his lecture was to advise negroes to go back to Africa and establish themselves in Liberia. Such advice, however foolish it may be, is not in itself unlawful. The lecturer said a good deal to promote race hatred, but I doubt if anything he can be proved to have said could be made the subject of criminal proceedings.

3. After eulogizing Mr Critchlow of the Labour League,¹ he advised his audience not to take part in the welcome to the Prince of Wales.² This advice was not taken, and the Labour Hall³ was decorated with signs of welcome when the Prince came.

4. I regard the activities of this Association as being not without danger, but I concur in the opinion of the Governor of British Honduras that no attempt should be taken at present by open action against the Association. Any attempt to suppress it would in the absence of some exceptionally gross misconduct have the effect of arousing the sympathies of negroes in the colony, the mass of whom are not swayed by the Association, and to whom I have to look for assistance in maintaining good order. It would be impossible to adopt one course with regard to seditious utterances by white people and another with regard to such utterances by negroes.

5. I am afraid that it is possible for negroes truthfully to say a lot of nasty things about white people. It is a pity that they should do so. But white people are quite as abusive of negroes. It is when the negro believes one law is applied to whites and another to blacks that he becomes really dangerous. I have the honour to be, My Lord, Your Lordship's most obedient, humble servant,

WILFRED COLLET
Governor

TNA: PRO CO 318/356/7252. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Secret."

1. A reference to the British Guiana Labor Union.

2. The Prince of Wales arrived in British Guiana on 22 September 1920. He left England on 16 March 1920 to visit New Zealand and Australia. On the way there and on the way home, the prince

toured several places, including Fiji, Hawaii, the Panama Canal, San Diego in the United States, and several West Indian islands. In March, the prince visited Barbados, and throughout the month of September, he stopped at Colón, Panama; Trinidad; Grenada; St. Lucia; Dominica; Montserrat; Antigua; and Bermuda. His scheduled visit to Jamaica was abandoned because of an outbreak of chicken pox there. He was received with great celebration throughout the West Indies and arrived back in England on 11 October 1920 (*Times* [London], 27 March, 9 September, 20 September, 23 September, 25 September, 27 September, 28 September, 11 October, and 8 December 1920).

3. The BGLU acquired as its headquarters the Labor Hall at 142 Regent Street in Georgetown “within the first two years of its existence” (Ashton Chase, *A History of Trade Unionism in Guyana*, p. 20; Walter Rodney, *A History of the Guyanese Working People 1881–1905* [Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press, 1981], p. 53). Because of “grave unemployment and mismanagement,” the property was sold at auction in March 1923 (Rodney, *A History of the Guyanese Working People*, p. 53).

George Basil Haddon-Smith, Governor,
Windward Islands, to Viscount Milner,
Secretary of State, Colonial Office

Government House,
Windward Islands, Grenada,
8th October, 1920

My Lord,

I have the honour to forward you extracts from “The Negro World” of 11th September. To those who know the negro, the utterances of Marcus Garvey are amusing; he is either ignorant of, or purposely avoids any reference to, the great M[o]h[am]medan population of Africa and from what I know of those people, the reception of the negro from either America or the West Indies would not be cordial, and, were it not for the European protection extended to the negro, might be disastrous, resulting in the extermination of the “Potentate” the “Supreme Potentate” and their sate[l]lites.

2. Mr Garvey’s anxiety as to the sale of shares in his shipping company makes one sceptical as regards his philanthropic intentions towards the negro race.

3. “The Negro World” has a fairly large circulation which is increasing in the West Indies. The articles appearing in this paper will have to be carefully watched, and if they assume a tone likely to inflame the passions of the negroes in these Islands, there must be no hesitation in prohibiting the circulation of the paper. I have the honour to be, My Lord, Your Lordship’s most obedient, humble Servant,

G. B. HADDON-SMITH
Governor

[*Handwritten minutes:*] Mr. Darnley

These appeals to abstract rights won[?]t
cut much ice in the West Indies because the
negro is not as a whole deprived of the

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rights demanded—in fact there is no ice to
cut at present.

? Put by

R[.] A[.] W[.] 9/12/20

E[.] R[.] D[.] 10/12

at once

G. G. 11.12.20

TNA: PRO CO 318/356/7252. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Confidential."

"Afro-American" to the *Workman*

[Panama City, 9 October 1920]

GARVEY ADMIRER RAILS AFRICAN PRINCE¹

SAYS POLICY OF NEGRO ASSOCIATION IS CONSTRUCTIVE

The following letter was sent us by a correspondent for publication:—

Sir:—

In the issue of the *WORKMAN* of the 25th September, there appeared a reprint from a leading foreign daily which featured the opinion of a petty African ruler relative to the aims and aspirations of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League, through the Hon. Marcus Garvey, its founder and chosen leader. To what is known as the ordinary "man in the street" it will seem that the efforts of the great Negro leader are not appreciated by the Race, but regardless of the fact that "one fool makes many," the thinkers of the race are back of a movement, the spirit of which many have not caught. This "moving-picture-operator prince" undoubtedly is imbued with the fear that the "Hon. Marcus" has designs on his kingdom, his wives and his goods. He has not yet, it seems, reached that point set by civilization when men can look into the distance; and act in the procurement of ultimate good. Men of Garvey's stamp do not flourish within the circumscribed limits of his cherished principality, and thus he is led in blindness to dub the greatest man of the race, as an "upstart" and a "spouter of words."

We remember the old adage "Where ignorance is bliss, 'tis folly to be wise." The projection of the "make believe" on the milk-white screen marks the limit of the Prince's no-wise vast intelligence.

The world is not standing still to give him a chance to catch up with progress. The cry—the slogan, is; Ever Onward!

Garvey does not aspire for power. The Association aims at racial solidarity. It aims to secure to us the inheritance of our fathers, which is therefore ours.

The policy of the Association is constructive. Whether it be a great confederation of African States or a great Negro nation, the end desired is one and the same. If this African prince must be saved, he shall be saved against his will. We march on to fate abreast, keeping before us as a beacon light our motto—"One God, one aim, one destiny."

Anent the above, we publish the following extract culled from an entirely different source in order that our readers may see that there are others just as unintelligent as the prince along the same lines:—

On the grounds that the problems of Africans are not the problems of colored Americans, the British West African Conference held in Accra,² recently voted "to give fullest patronage to the Black Star Line, but to take no part in the program of the Universal Convention of Negroes, meeting in New York City under Marcus Garvey."

In explanation of this vote, the Nigerian Times says:³

Promoters of the Black Star Line of Steamers can count on the whole hearted support of every sane minded African. The inclusion, however, of a political plan such as the founding of a Pan African Empire is too obviously ridiculous to do ought else than alienate sympathy from the whole movement.

The idea of independence of the Africans does not chime in with that propounded by Hon. Marcus Garvey. Africa will one day be controlled by Africans. The distinct African nations want [first?] rate policy entirely, rather than being a part of the universal Negro empire.

Our humble advice to the Hon. Marcus Garvey, and other members of the great movement for Negro emancipation is that so far as West Africans are concerned what is needed most is civilization. Besides the Black Star Line (already in being) West Africa needs the establishment of banks, industries, schools, (normal and vocational) colleges and an up to date University. These civilizing agencies are the best means of speeding up the progress of evolution. To talk of building up an empire on the basis of ignorance and uncivilization is but to contemplate the wildest of wildest schemes.

AFRO-AMERICAN

Printed in the *Workman* (Panama City), 9 October 1920.

1. Prince Madarikan Deniyi (1892–1959) would shortly emerge as one of Garvey's principal African critics in the U.S., leading to a long and bitter round of charges and countercharges. According to the *Negro World*, Deniyi had spoken before UNIA meetings in New York, Brooklyn, Jersey City, and Philadelphia, appealing for funds to secure passage back to Nigeria. Describing him as a "tramp preacher," the *Negro World* accused him of trying to "dominate the convention" (NW, 9 July 1921). The *Chicago Defender*, a longtime rival of Garvey's *Negro World*, printed many of Deniyi's criticisms of Garvey, who in turn branded Deniyi a fraud.

Originally a druggist and embalmer from Lagos, Nigeria, where he was known as Michael Deniyi Williams, Deniyi came to the U.S. in 1914 to study hypnotism with Lauron William De Laurence, but the two men soon parted with much acrimony (*New York Amsterdam News*, 25 May 1921; NW, 14 April and 6 August 1921; CD, 13 June 1914 and 14 May 1921). In the 1920s Deniyi went on to become an ordained Baptist minister, while often lecturing in native African costume on

Africa ("The Bright Side of Africa" was the title of one of his frequent lectures). He was later reported to have qualified as a registered pharmacist and a licensed embalmer, studying at the Jenner Medical College and the Barnes School of Embalming in Chicago and reportedly passing the Illinois State Board examination in both subjects. He married Anna Davis in May 1930 in West Palm Beach, Florida.

In March 1957 the *Chicago Defender*, quoting a Georgia newspaper, reported that Deniyi, giving a fundraising mission for churches and schools in Africa, spoke out "in defense of all good white people of the South," while severely criticizing Negro American leaders, who, he claimed, "talk too much" (CD, 2 March 1957). Deniyi never returned to Africa; he died in Tampa, Florida, in May 1959, at the age of sixty-seven (Sumter County, S.C., Clerk, Judge of Probate, Marriage License; State of Florida, Office of Vital Statistics, Certificate of Death; *Landmark* [Statesville, N.C.], 11 June 1923; *Bee* [Danville, Va.], 17 July 1923; *Daily News* [Frederick, Md.], 15 and 19 January 1924; *Gettysburg Times*, 2 June 1924; *Salisbury Times* [Salisbury, Md.], 9 October 1954; CD, 12 November 1955).

2. The National Congress of British West Africa (NCBWA), the first regional political movement in West Africa, was an attempt to reform the Crown Colony system through the combined efforts of the four British West African colonies of the Gold Coast, Nigeria, Sierra Leone, and the Gambia. The congress was loyal to the British Empire and worked only through constitutional methods. It owed its origins and establishment to Joseph Ephraim Casely Hayford and Dr. Richard Akinwande Savage, a Nigerian physician then resident in the Gold Coast. Casely Hayford proposed forming a regional political organization, influenced by the pan-Africanists Edward Blyden and W. E. B. Du Bois. While the NCBWA was partly inspired by the Pan-African Congress in Paris and the formation of the UNIA in New York following World War I, the movement also grew out of local West African enthusiasm.

The NCBWA's first meeting, held at the Rogers (African) Club in Accra from 11 to 29 March 1920, was hailed by *West Africa* magazine as the "beginning of a new era" (3 April 1920). It was attended by fifty-two delegates: forty-two from the Gold Coast itself, six from Nigeria, three from Sierra Leone, and one from the Gambia. Most delegates were members of the Western-educated coastal elite, drawn from law, medicine, journalism, and business. Casely Hayford and Thomas Hutton-Mills, who was also a Gold Coast lawyer, gave the opening addresses. During the inaugural conference, topics discussed included education, African self-determination, commerce, banking, and shipping.

During the 1920s, the NCBWA was a powerful political movement in the British West African colonies. It met in Freetown in 1923, in Bathurst in 1925 and 1926, and in Lagos in 1929 and 1930. While it supported Garvey's call for black racial dignity and economic self-sufficiency, the congress disagreed with the UNIA's more revolutionary pronouncements and strongly opposed attempts by overseas blacks to claim leadership in Africa. Casely Hayford warned American blacks that Africans were better able to understand colonial relations, and that it was strictly necessary to adhere to constitutional methods. In fact, the NCBWA's cautious policies limited its popular appeal while failing to reassure the British colonial administration of its legitimate intentions. In 1921, for example, the congress sent a delegation to London to seek public support for its demands, but the British government refused to receive it. Governor Sir Hugh Clifford of Nigeria was particularly scathing in his attacks on the congress, which was further weakened by opposition from resentful traditional rulers as well as divisions within the educated coastal elite that made up its primary constituency. The NCBWA remained financially dependent on such individuals as Hutton-Mills and Casely Hayford and, following their deaths, eventually fell apart (LaRay Denzer, "National Congress of British West Africa, Gold Coast Section" [M.A. thesis, University of Ghana, Legon, 1965]; J. G. Campbell, *The First Conference of Africans of British West Africa Held at Accra, Gold Coast Colony, March 11–29, 1920* [Lagos: Tika Tore, 1920]; J. E. Casely Hayford, *West African Leadership: Public Speeches Delivered by the Honourable J. E. Casely Hayford*, ed. Magnus J. Sampson [Ilfracombe, Devon, England: Stockwell, 1949], p. 65; David Kimble, *A Political History of Ghana: The Rise of Gold Coast Nationalism, 1850–1928* [Oxford: Clarendon, 1963]; J. Ayodele Langley, *Pan-Africanism and Nationalism in West Africa, 1900–1945* [Oxford: Clarendon, 1973], pp. 107–240).

3. "The Marcus Garvey Movement," *Times of Nigeria* (Lagos, Nigeria), 14 May 1920.

Harry Gloster Armstrong, British Consul
General, New York, to Auckland C. Geddes,
British Ambassador to the United States

BRITISH CONSULATE GENERAL
NEW YORK, October 11th, 1920

Sir:—

I have the honour in reference to correspondence forwarded by Your Excellency under cover September 15th, in regard to the activities of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League, as well as the circulation of the "Negro World," as referred to in the Despatch of the Governor of British Honduras to the Secretary of State for the Colonies, to inform Your Excellency that there is now in course of preparation the "Official Record of the First International Convention of Negroes," which was held in this city during the month of August. The first volume will be shortly issued and will contain photographs of the negro leaders, the price of the first volume being \$5.00, and presumably the succeeding volumes will be issued at the same price.

I am communicating with their Excellencies, The Governors of British Honduras, Bermuda and the Leeward Islands, and enclose copies of my Despatches of this date to them, in case Your Excellency might deem it advisable to draw the attention of any of the other Governors of the West Indies to the work referred to so that copies may be obtained should they desire them.

I have the honour to be with the greatest respect, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient, humble Servant,

GLOSTER ARMSTRONG
H.M.'s Consul General

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS. Recipient's copy. Marked "No. 1626."

Enclosure: Harry Gloster Armstrong,
British Consul General, New York,
to Eyre Hutson, Governor, British Honduras

BRITISH CONSULATE GENERAL
NEW YORK, October 11th, 1920

Sir,

I have the honour to inform Your Excellency that it is announced the first volume of the "Official Record of the First International Convention of Negroes," which occurred during the month of August in this city, will be pub-

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lished at an early date by the Universal Negro Improvement Association, 56 West 135th Street, New York City. The price of the first volume is \$5.00, but how many volumes will be issued to cover the whole Convention I am not able to say.

It is understood that the volume will contain photographs of the principal negro leaders, and the purpose of my enquiry is to know whether you desire the first and following volumes to be secured for you or not, as I assume that the number printed will be limited, and, unless the order is placed at an early date, it may be difficult to secure any copies. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient, humble Servant,

(Signed) GLOSTER ARMSTRONG
H.M.'s Consul General

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TL.

British Consul, St. Louis, Missouri, to Auckland
C. Geddes, British Ambassador to the U.S.

BRITISH CONSULATE, ST. LOUIS,
MISSOURI, U.S.A., OCTOBER 12, 1920

Sir:—

With reference to your Excellency's Circular despatch of the 15th ultimo, instructing me to report, from time to time, on negro activities in this district, I have the honour to state that this Consulate will carefully watch for any developments of this nature and report accordingly.

I have prepared a memorandum, briefly setting out my recent and, perhaps, somewhat superficial observations on the negro question, and venture to transmit this in case it may be informative in some respect.

Your Excellency will notice that I have been unable to discover any tangible evidence of anything like an organised effort in this district towards the establishment of a separate national status, but I have indicated one or two examples of the present attitude of the local negro population which, I am inclined to think, indicates a desire on its part for a more important place in the world's affairs. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient, humble servant,

[*signature illegible*]

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS. Recipient's copy. Marked "No. 202."

Enclosure: Memorandum from the British Consul, St. Louis

BRITISH CONSULATE, ST. LOUIS,
MISSOURI, U.S.A., OCTOBER 12, 1920

The negro in this district is *undoubtedly aggressive* and *shows unmistakable signs of a widespread aspiration to a position not hitherto occupied by him*. This attitude is in spite of the liberties and privileges afforded the "darkey" in this district, but denied him in the Southern States. The present determination appears to be to secure at least equal rights with the white man, such as residence in the same district as white people and to be allowed to marry into that race. There is reason to believe that this is only part of a programme which may include other much more important developments. Confidential enquiries made in this locality as to the existence of *local organisations having for their object the ultimate establishment of a negro nation* have had, however, a *negative result* and those whose business it is to know of such activities appear to be quite in the dark in the matter.

The negro for some considerable time past has been receiving high wages, due to shortage of labour and other reasons, and is now able, as never before, to obtain certain luxuries and pleasures which previously were only within reach of the more comfortably situated white man. One of the results of this is that the negro is able to dress well and adopt the fashions in vogue with white people. He enjoys the pleasure of owning his automobile and, generally, is beginning to realise that he is able to procure for himself a number of advantages in life which, previously, were not within his reach. It will not be out of place to mention that, whilst he has not been able to alter his colour or his general disposition, yet it is now possible for his women folk to have the kink removed from the hair, so that they have straight strands of hair in the same way as a white person. The kink in the hair has in the past been a sign of hum[i]liation in the eyes of the negro race and full advantage of the treatment is being taken as a step towards development.

The negro today is decidedly fastidious as to the class of work in which he engages and, owing to the present shortage of labour, is discriminating in this respect to the extreme. This attitude, moreover, is not confined to the younger generation, who have received the benefits of high school education, but is adopted also by the older people amongst them who have not had these privileges. It is the proud boast of the negro women here that the white people have now to attend in a large measure to their own cooking requirements and not so long ago, a slogan was current among them to the effect that by their attitude they had brought the white woman to do her own cooking and would shortly bring her to the washtub as well.

The conduct of the negro in the street cars of this City has of late become particularly noticeable in that on entering a sparsely filled car each negro delib-

erately spreads himself or herself out so that, as far as possible, each one occupies a place on a different seat. This results in the white person having to sit beside a coloured person, a course to which the white population in this locality, at any rate, are extremely averse. It is also ~~an~~ //no// uncommon thing for a negro to occupy a seat in a street car whilst a white woman has to stand.

Other small daily incidents along these lines could be //c//ited, and, whilst in themselves they may appear perhaps insignificant, yet if taken together in conjunction with the present general attitude of the negro are perhaps indicative that [the] time may be approaching, and perhaps fast approaching, when the negro element will attempt to measure its strength with that of the white man.

This district is well supplied with the usual negro organisations of a religious, social and labour character, but, so far, these do not appear to have shown any great signs of cohesion or unanimity. The tendency is rather for the negro as an individual to do things in his own way and these organisations are inclined to break down when occasion calls for any united effort. This is shown in the readiness with which the negro offers his services as a strike breaker even though he is a member of a union (comprising both white and coloured people) of which the members are out on strike.

The negro in this district appears to show an increasing inclination to take part in political elections and a recent registration of voters in St. Louis¹ for the General Election on November 2nd has disclosed that nearly ten percent (10%) of the registered voters consist of coloured people and of 113,000 women voters who have registered no less than 12,387 are negro women.

[signature illegible]

H.B.M. Consul

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS. Recipient's copy. Italicized words are underlined by hand on recipient's copy.

1. Missouri in 1920 had a population of 3,404,055, and out of that, 178,241 were black (5.2 percent) (14th census, p. 101). From 1910 to 1920, blacks in Missouri became more firmly attached to political bosses and machines (p. 94). "Negroes preferred the machine to the reformers because the latter too often promoted changes that were detrimental to the welfare and power of Blacks" (p. 94). The black vote for Democratic candidates in city elections moved from 47 percent in 1928 to 70 percent in 1930, making Kansas City the only place in the nation where a majority of blacks voted Democratic (Richard S. Kirkendall, *A History of Missouri*, Vol. 5, [Columbia: University of Missouri Press, 2004], p. 153). Truman also benefited from it, especially in Jackson County, where blacks gave him nearly 90 percent of their votes in November (Kirkendall, p. 177, but this refers to 1934).

Joseph Matthew Sebastian
to J. R. Ralph Casimir

P.O. [Box] 75. Basseterre, St. Kitts.
16th. October 1920

My Dear Friend //d// Casimir,

Your letter of August 31st, last reached me only on 10th //i//nstant. I was wondering what was the matter, but I now see that your letter was unavoidably delayed somewhere, somehow.

I note with regret the attitude of your late employer, and worse, his reasons for assuming that attitude. To write on the subject would be a tiresome task, but suffice it to say that no man has come to true greatness who has not felt that his life belongs to his Race, and whatever God has given him, be it talent, influence, money or authority, ought to be used for making the lot of humanity in general much easier. I have read your article in the Negro World, and can see nothing to justify any coloured West Indian taking exception to the sentiments therein expressed. I am proud of it—a picture which could be drawn of nearly every West Indian Group. In every move, some one is called upon to pay the supreme sacrifice, whatever form it takes—there are always martyrs, and therein the worthiness of the cause is proved.

Of course, I can hardly advise on the matter, as I am not sufficiently acquainted with the situation, but you will undoubtedly pursue the course which prudence and foresight will dictate, without any sacrifice to your manhood.

Letter-heads and envelopes are printed at 30¢ per hundred; plus the cost of the materials used. Stationery has been advanced tremendously. However, if you require work, you may send off to us, and trust us as to the prices, as they will certainly be in keeping with the cost of production. On any particular work, we can always send you estimate after having received manuscript and instruction, before attempting the job, and await your approval.

I have not as yet received the copies of "Emancipation Celebration" which you mentioned. You may send them, and I will do my utmost to get them off for you: Do not forget my inquiry re Mr. Z. A. Josephs of Soufriere //s// School.

Our work is progressing very well. We hope to send off cash soon for charter etc from the home Office of the U.N.I.A. I think I told you that we have started a Division here, and I have been elected President of that too. I wrote report of activities here to the New York Office, but have had no word from them. I have also ventured to sell some shares in the B.S.L. Corporation and remitted cash t//o// them. They have answered returning certificate with a promise that they are now re-organising their different departments and as soon as finished will send me the necessary authority to represent them here. I simply want the opportunity to assist in the move, for I believe that the Corporation is our "Dividing of the //R//ed Sea." The question confronting us at present is the

“Negro[']s dependence in the world’s civilisation.” We can only be made an independent element by entering respectable business as the other peoples of the world.

We have not as yet started our publication, but hope to soon. We have experienced a slight set-back,¹ but will soon jump over.

Be good. Convey my best regards to all your fellow-workers in the Cause, and tell them to hold on to the Right. Let me hear from you as soon as you can make it. With best wishes for your future, Fraternally yours,

J. MATTHEW SEBASTIAN

JRRC. TLS, recipient’s copy.

1. Probably a reference to the introduction of the Newspaper Surety (Amendment) Act of 1919.

Article in the *Negro World*

[[Barbados, ca. 23 October 1920]]

NEGRO TALENT HOLDS AUDIENCE SPELLBOUND

From every nook and crannie of the city and suburbs there flowed a relentless stream of colored and black persons on Monday night last to form part of the colossal audience which attended the first concert staged by the entertainment committee of Chartered Division No. 40 of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L., situated at the corner of Reid and Tudor streets.

From an early hour in the evening a plethora of flags, the outstanding feature of which was the Negro flag (red, black and green), waved happily in the breeze as if portending success to the venture.

Despite the several sharp peals of thunder and murky clouds which preceded the hour scheduled for commencing the entertainment, the hall was yet taxed to its utmost capacity with Negroes, and motor cars, cabs and carriages continued to deposit their human freight at the door of the U.N.I.A. up to 9:30 o’clock.

The program was executed without a hitch, and was rich in its entirety holding the audience spell-bound throughout. A short address by the General President, followed by a descriptive account of the aims and objects of the Association by Mr. E. Morris, started “the ball rolling.” Then followed a selection by the chair, and the concert started in spirited reality. Special mention must be made of Messrs. Clifford Millington, B. Sealy, T. Ashby and A. Maynard, who were each in turn applauded to the echo for their brilliant singing.

The second part of the program was, if anything, a trifle better than the first, as our local crack pianist, Mr. A. Quarless, appeared on the scene and simply made things hum. At 10:57 o’clock a vote of thanks was delivered by the Acting General Secretary, Mr. E. Turpin, which brought an exceedingly enjoy-

able evening (the handwork of Negroes without an exception) to a close. Thus ended the first concert held by Chartered Division No. 40, of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L., and with it should also end the old fallacy that no large mixed assembly of Negroes can possibly behave well at any function. The concert was a huge success, from every point of view.

Printed in NW, 23 October 1920.

Article in the *Negro World*

[New York, 23 October 1920]

IN DOMINICA

UNVEILING THE CHARTER

The members of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L. in Roseau and vicinity had a pleasant meeting on Sunday last, the occasion being the ceremony of unveiling the charter granted to the local division of the association, which function took place that afternoon at their headquarters, Liberty Hall, beginning at 3 o'clock[.] The hall, which was full to its utmost capacity, was beautifully decorated, principal among the colors being the red, black and green of the association, the Union Jack, Stars and Stripes, the French and Belgian tri-colors, etc.

Upon the sound of the bugle call Mr. F. L. Gardier, the president-general, took the chair, and immediately the choir sang "From Greenland's Icy Mountains," which was followed by the association's prayer.

The president-general then installed Misses M. J. Ellen Allen and Alice Dumas as president and secretary respectively of the ladies' division. Messrs. N. A. Michael as member of the advisory board and J. A. Stephen and C. John as marshals,¹ and then delivered a stirring speech on "The Vision of the Hon. Marcus Garvey," which was well received throughout.

So soon as the cable announcing the result of the big Negro Convention, viz., the appointment of Mr. Eason as leader of the United States millions of Negroes, and of the Hon. Marcus Garvey, founder of the U.N.I. Association of New York and of the redemption of Africa for the Negroes, as Provisional President of the African Continent, was received here[,], Mr. Francis L. Gardier, the local president-general of the association, sent the bell-man around to notify the members and the public in general of a patriotic meeting to be held in the society's hall that evening. The meeting opened at 8:15 p.m. with the usual functions. The hall was never so packed with people, and the crowds outside were so thick that passage through that portion of the street was very difficult, hundreds of people having had to stay outside. Lively speeches were delivered by the president and other officers of the association, other speakers being Messrs. Dontfraid, Roberts and Michael.² The "African's Black Star Spangled

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Banner” and “Africa, Our Home” were lustily sung at intervals, and the meeting closed at 11:10 p.m., each one leaving the hall contemplating the happy end of a most perfect day.

Printed in *NW*, 23 October 1920.

1. M. J. Ellen Allen was from Balalou Town. Alice Dumas, N. A. Michael, and J. A. Stephen were from Roseau. C. John was from Canefield.

2. Dontfraid and Roberts were both from Roseau. Dontfraid was treasurer of the UNIA branch in Dominica.

Maurice Peterson, British Embassy,
Washington D.C., to Harry Gloster Armstrong,
British Consul General, New York

BRITISH EMBASSY, WASHINGTON,
October 26, 1920

Sir:

With reference to Mr. Peterson’s letter addressed to Mr. Watson on March 10th, with regard to the Universal Negro Improvement Association, I have received a communication from the Foreign Office requesting me to obtain three or four copies of the Constitution and Book of Laws of the Association for the use of the Colonial Office and the Director of Intelligence.

I shall be grateful if you will be good enough to take the necessary steps to obtain and forward these to me as soon as possible, I am, Sir, your most obedient, humble servant,

(For H.M. Ambassador)
(Sd.) MAURICE PETERSON

TNA: PRO FO 115/2619. TLS. Marked “No. 215.”

Excerpt from British Cabinet Office Report

[Whitehall, October 1920]

. . . LEEWARD ISLANDS

Interest in Marcus Garvey’s “Universal Negro Improvement Society” is confined to young people. Despite all efforts to attract investors, no one of any standing has attended its meetings, or taken shares in his Black Star Line.

TNA: PRO CAB 24/115, C. P. 2192, Report No. 24, 15/D/155. PD.

V. P. M. Langton in the *Crusader*

[[Trinidad, B.W.I., Oct., 1920]]

TRINIDAD NEWS LETTER

Sometime ago Mr. R. R. Cuffee was raided by the police of Couva,¹ headed by Inspector Power, for The *Crusader*, Messenger and Negro World. Had any copies of these publications been found in his possession he would have been arrested for "sedition."

It appears the Trinidad Divisions of the U.N.I.A. are rotten with "false Negroes" in the know. Its private business is heard outside. Whenever the police go in for a Negro for "sedition" (i.e., being in possession of periodicals with Negro thought and Negro genius) they go to the correct man—only they do not find what they look for!

I overheard one Mr. R. C. Pierre of Tabaquite² say that he was sent for by the police sergeant in charge of the [G]ran Couva and warned not to spread seditious matter because of his efforts to raise some funds for the building of a hall to aid in the uplift and education of the Negro. An attempt in this line at Tabaquite is most necessary, for here, more than in most districts of Trinidad, drunkenness and vice are rampant.

At this time of the year the farmers in the sugar cane districts are wearing haggard faces, the cause being that the capitalist owners of the lands they work do not advance them in any way near to a just ratio to work the land from which they must get cane for the same owners. These men can be seen from 4 a.m. to 7, walking with their wives and children (from seven years up), trotting behind, equipped with tools and half rations, going to the farms to work and returning in the same manner from 5 p.m. to 12 p.m. from work. Fine education, eh? Fine progress? Are you not told that Trinidad is the most progressive island of the West?

The laboring colored population are at last attempting corporation enterprises. There are many old corporations here with laborers as shareholders, but in none of these can a laborer rise to the rank of director, and the laboring shareholder is, in most cases, a victim of graft and other forms of dishonesty.

In investigating the failure of a certain Negro corporation which by all signs should have succeeded, I discovered that the organizer was given 1,000 shares for his services and that as soon as the corporation had 1,000 paid up shares this same organizer sold out his rights to a capitalist. The latter man[e]uvered and made his cruel claim. The corporation could not stand an action and it went under. Will the Negro never realize that every piece of vill[ai]ny he practices upon his race is an obstacle to his personal progress and another handicap to the progress of his race?

Printed in the *Crusader* 3 [November 1920]: 29, 30.

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1. Couva, situated on the west coast of Trinidad, was an area of extensive sugar cultivation (Michael Anthony, *Towns and Villages of Trinidad and Tobago* [Port of Spain: Circle Press, 1988], p. 65).

2. Tabaquite is located in central Trinidad. During the 1920s its primary economic pursuits were cocoa cultivation and oil mining (Anthony, *Towns and Villages*, p. 314).

General James Willcocks, Governor, Bermuda,
to Viscount Milner, Secretary of State,
Colonial Office

Government House, Bermuda.
2nd November, 1920

My Lord,

I have the honour to report for Your Lordship's information, the action taken by the local Government in the case of the Reverend R. H. Tobitt, a coloured clergyman of this Colony, who at a "Convention of the Negro Race" recently held in New York under the auspices of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, was elected "Leader of the West Indies (Eastern Province)," a dignity to which the title of "His Excellency" purports to be attached. In addition to taking part in the convention, Tobitt appended his signature to a document described as a Declaration of Independence which contained many clauses antagonistic to the existing order.¹ Copies of this document have no doubt been communicated to Your Lordship through other channels, and it needs no comment to emphasize its character or the threats to peace and good order involved in its clauses.

2. Upon his return to Bermuda Tobitt was disavowed by the African Methodist Episcopal Church of which he was a minister, and given the option of severing his connexion with the Association referred to, or withdrawing from his office under this Church.² He chose the latter alternative. A copy of a letter from the Presiding Elder of that Church in Bermuda reporting their action in this matter, is enclosed for Your Lordship's information.

3. In addition to his connexion with the African Methodist Episcopal Church, Tobitt is the master of a school in St. George's which received Government assistance as an aided school under The Schools Act, 1907, and upon learning of his open association with the Universal Negro Improvement Association and support of the dangerous principles embodied in their "Declaration of Independence," I caused the Board of Education to be informed that in my opinion Tobitt was no longer a fit person to be entrusted with the education of children, and requested that all Government assistance given to his school should be discontinued forthwith, which has been done.³

4. Tobitt, who is of West Indian origin, acted on his own initiative in attending the conference referred to above, and in no way represents any section

or body of opinion in this Colony. The character of the Association whose cause he has thus openly espoused is well-known to Your Lordship and I am confident that the action of the Government in the matter will command the support of all sober opinion in the Colony both among the white and coloured population. I have the honour to be, Your Lordship's most obedient, humble servant,

JAMES WILLCOCKS
General, Governor and
Commander-in-Chief

[*Handwritten minutes:*] Mr. Grindle
~~Mr. Darnley~~

The said "declaration of independence" will be found in the Negro World of 11 Sept 1920 forwarded in 54897. It is mainly aimed at treatment of the negro in the U.S. and many of the complaints are at any rate theoretically quite legitimate. It complains however that "In the British & other W.I. islands & colonies Negroes are secretly & cunningly discriminated against & denied those [public?] rights of Govt to which white citizens are appointed, nominated & elected."

But while the abstract rights claimed may be legitimate, the purpose of the agitation is to incite discontent where it does not exist & to stir up strife & I recognize such old friends from T'dad as de Bourg, McConney & Brathwaite among the signatories. It is the signatories rather than their publications which are dangerous.

?Put by.

R[.] A[.] W[.] 9/12/20

Action is being taken against Rev. Tobitt because of his close connection with the Univ. Negro Improvement Association. I agree, having regard to the character of that Assn, although I should be sorry to see negroes penalised for participating in a more moderate organisation.

E[.] R[.] D[.] 10/12

Ack. receipt

At once.

G. G. 11.22.20

TNA: PRO CO 318/356/02541. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "No. 127." Stamped "C.O. 57747."

1. Rev. Richard H. Tobitt was not only branded in the eyes of colonial officials in Bermuda because of his union activities, his earlier advocacy of free education in the colony, and his open embrace of Garveyism. He was also in conflict with his presiding elder, Rev. E. D. Robinson, who

arrived in Bermuda in August 1917. Garveyism was anathema to both Rev. Robinson and the presiding bishop, Rt. Rev. James M. Connor. They regarded it as "a very dangerous movement [which] arouses antagonism among the races wherever it goes" (Robinson to Colonial Secretary of Bermuda, 18 October 1920, TNA: PRO CO 318/356/02541). The fact that Rev. Tobitt not only organized a Bermuda branch of the UNIA on 16 April 1920 but did so in his church and state-aided school was intolerable to them.

2. Coincidental with Rev. Tobitt's return to Bermuda was the convening, on 8 October 1920, of the 37th Annual Bermuda Conference, presided over by Bishop Connor. On the first day of the conference,

Rev. Tobitt was called upon to answer the charge brought against him by the Presiding Elder, viz., that the same Rev. R. H. Tobitt, Deacon in charge of the AME Mission work at St. David's did on the 27th day of July, 1920, leave his appointment to be absent in the U.S.A. representing a secular organization, without the permission of the Bishop of the District or Presiding Elder. Br. Tobitt tried to justify his action by various allegations and "heresays" against the Presiding Elder, all of which were irrelevant, but finally acknowledged his guilt and begged to be forgiven (Minutes of the Bermuda Conference, BA, J. Daniel Smith Collection, pp. 7-8).

His apology was accepted by motion of the conference. When the conference resumed the following day, the minutes noted,

Rev. Tobitt rose and addressing the bishop stated that since he was connected with an organization [UNIA] which brought reflection and criticism on the church, he being an AME preacher, and considering that the said organization was a worthy one which would afford him a larger scope for usefulness among his people, he desired to remove all responsibility from the church for his actions and restore her public confidence; therefore, he begged that he be allowed to withdraw from the Conference. On the question being put to the Conference, Bro. Tobitt was allowed to withdraw. Rev. R. J. Stovell expressed regret events had taken that course (ibid.).

3. St. George's Elementary School was cut off from government funding, and it quickly declined. Rev. Tobitt resigned from the presidency of the union, but the status of honorable membership was conferred on him. A Jamaican, C. A. Isaac Henry, succeeded him as president.

*Enclosure: Edward D. Robinson,¹ Presiding
Elder, A.M.E. Churches, Bermuda,
to the Colonial Secretary, Bermuda*

St. Paul African Methodist Episcopal
Church, Hamilton, Bermuda.
October 18, 1920

Dear Sir:

This comes to inform you officially, of the with-drawal [fr]om the ministry of the A.M.E. Church, of the Rev. R. H. Tobitt, St. [Ge]orges, Bermuda. All honors which had been given to him as a [min]ister in the A.M.E. Church ceased October 8, 1920.

His withdrawal is due to the fact, that I, as the [Pres]iding Elder of the work in Bermuda, assailed the Marcus Garvey [movem]ent, with which Mr.

Tobitt is connected, in open conference. [It] is a very dangerous movement, in that it arouses antagonism [amo]ng races wherever it goes. This was followed by Bishop James [M.] Connor's advice to him to withdraw, if he intended to follow [this] movement, stating at the same time that he could not accept [any] institution upon which the General Conference of the A.M.E. [Chu]rch had not put its approval, and it had not as yet and would [not] approve of the Garvey movement.

I am enclosing, for your information, a copy of the [Bermuda] Colonist and Daily News, this contains a synopsis of the [General?] Conference, mentioning the withdrawal of Mr. Tobitt from [the?] A.M.E. Church.² I am Respectfully,

(Sgd.) EDWARD D. ROBINSON
Presiding Elder of the
A.M.E. Churches in Bermuda

TNA: PRO CO 318/356/02541. TL, copy.

1. Rev. E. D. Robinson, M.A., B.D., arrived in Bermuda on 14 August 1917 from the Pittsburgh Conference of the AME Church's Third Episcopal District to take charge of the pastoral work at St. Paul's AME Church, Hamilton, and to be presiding elder of the Bermuda District (Minutes of 27th Annual Bermuda Conference of the AME Church, BA, J. D. Smith Collection).

2. The enclosure has not been found.

John Sydney de Bourg to Osiris de Bourg

105 West 138th Street,
New York City U.S.A.,
6th November 1920

My dear Son,

Nothing could have given me a more pleasurable surprise that has put an end to the great anxieties of myself and your step-mother Bee than locating you through your letter of the 5th Sept. last to your brother-in-law—Albert sent me and received last P.M. For reasons best known to yourself you have thought it your best duty to me for these many years is to abstain from taking any communicative notice of me—your legitimate aged father. Regardless of this manifestation of your stubbornness in adhering to your undutiful resolve I conscientiously feel that you would be greatly pleased to perceive I am yet alive and have not up to my 67th year of age brought disgrace on you my simple children. Amidst all my persecutions and they have been in the greatest abundance and severity I have by the all powerful aid assistance and protection of "My God" stood firmly & as fearlessly as did Daniel in the lions' den until victory has now come to me—an undying victory—through the cross. In your letter you wonder if it is "Pa" who is the deported de-Bourg of whom you have read. I am fully persuaded from the content of that very letter that you feel

almost certain that I your humanitarian and lover-of-my-race father am the deported undesirable of the capitalists' gods of Trinidad.

All I am able to tell you or anyone else of my quasi-deportation are that I know of no offence that I have committed, I was never charged with any, neither could any be sustained truthfully against me in any matter to justify my alleged deportation.

I am now engaging the necessary assistance //to// remove in London the stigma placed unjustifiably on my fair reputation throughout the world by a band of assassins in Poor Trinidad. When I tell you it took me 4 long months from the date of my alleged deportation the 28th of March last to get here whither your step-mother had preceded me since the month of September of last year you may judge the worries and anxieties that I underwent. It was not until I had reached San Domingo that I was able to secure steamship conveyance for here reaching here by a perilous voyage to Charleston and by rail drive to here a distance of fully 800 miles. In San Domingo and at St. Kitts I tried to move heaven and earth to discover your whereabouts but all my efforts were unavailable so that you must realize my pleasurable surprise and satisfaction now. I feel that I have located my son that seemed lost to me—a son I feel bound to love dearly to my heart even if it were not reciprocated by you Osiris. [Y]ou have expressed your honest conviction that if I am not dead you are sure that I am affiliated to the U.N.I.A and A.C.L. of His Excellency Hon. Marcus Garvey to whom and our Honorable Members of our High Executive Council and the Public Meeting of Liberty Hall at which I delivered an address last night[.] I made special allusion amidst uproars of applause. I showed the particular passages in said letter. [Y]ou will perceive in enclosed cuttings that I have received my due recompense at the election by that Great Convention of our race of the world at a salary of \$6,000.⁰⁰/₁₀₀ (Six thousand dollars) yearly equal to \$500.⁰⁰/₁₀₀ (Five hundred dollars) monthly and to reside at Panama as my headquarters for 4 years. I will have a Private Secretary and office staff there. I should be there this month but our Executive Council seems disposed to be making as much of my services here as would engage me until the end of the year. I have still in Trinidad besides [your] brothers and sisters of my lamented 3 wives[,], 2 boys and 1 girl of my 4th wife Bee. These your sister and brothers are Kuru of the age of past 14 yrs. whom you left when 8 months old[.] Arthur whom you don't know as also Ruby. Ruby past 12. Arthur born the 16th inst., Sylvia the last approaching 3 yrs. & 8 months was by a strange coincidence born on the very day of Kuru's 11 years anniversary birthday. And yet more remarkable is her birthday and his their hour day and date are identical in every particular even the month. She is here with us and is a lovely intelligent link of Kuru who at the age of 8 years and 7½ months won his exhibition for free admission to St. Mary's College coming 4th amongst all the primary school-children of the Colony numbering 167 who sat and the only one from 25 pupils of his own school. He is the first in the colony at this age to have achieved such success as the age conceded is 14 years at the latest and [*illegible*] at the earliest.

In fact he is a philosopher gifted by My God. He is no doubt publicly regarded as the best mental mathematician in the West Indies able to not only solve any problem without slate paper or pencil but he can solve a long multiplication or a long division in the same manner [in] a surprisingly short time and shorter than most Masters can do it. He is in the highest form at the College and is now to sit for the island Gold Medal Scholarship entitling him one of the learned professions. By this you should see how anxious myself and his mother and all of his unprejudiced relatives and friends must be at this parental separation at a time when he and the other 2 most require parental constant attention and protection in such a colony. We are however planning as to the best method of getting if [it] be possible the whole family in one grand gathering [at] Panama at as early a date as possible. There are already 2 of your cousins there with a quantity of children and others here—Albert and Cassie—single young men—from Grenada.

To these last 2 I owe a deep debt of gratitude for their very kind attention to me here. As for Albert he it is who got me out of San Domingo to here by sending me \$100.⁰⁰/₁₀₀ to assist me in paying passage expenses in the middle of all my pecuniary embarrassments even scouring San Dom[ingo] //to// find you out in vain. Enclosed you will find photos [of] myself standing before the Moravian Church of San Pedro de Macoris in San Domingo in which I delivered 3 addresses and one taken at Trinidad before my quasi deportation and the other little Sylvia. The conditions of these photos you must accept as the good [*illegible*] for a good deed as I have nothing superior to these on hand. I have enclosed to you cuttings of the Great Convention of the World's Negroes Delegates which I confidently trust you would find worthy of your careful perusal and comments in [y]our reply which I trust in all seriousness you will soon do. In fact instead of all of us by next mail going to Cuba my most and greatest earnest desire is that you could meet us here by next mail to form the de Bourg's family ring at Panama—a place of which you can in [*illegible*] me. If I do not succeed in getting the Executive Council to transfer me to the Eastern Division of the West Indies by which I would take Trinidad under my jurisdiction & would have Cuba as one of my provinces. In this way no doubt in going to take up duties at Panama I may have to travel via Cuba and all being well must see you. Meanwhile I would be very glad to hear that you are an active member of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League holding shares in the Black Star Line Steamship Company and in our Factories and other Corporations which would enable me to make use of you in a beneficially prosperous way to you and your family as quickly as we meet. I will hold over much of what I have further to say until I hear from you. Whatever may be your present [*illegible*]cation let me know that you are or have identified yourself with this inspired movement of "My God" and make mention to the Branch there of your relationship to me at once. With best wishes & regards in which Bee joins [your] Papa [to] you and your affectionate dear wife Alice.

NOVEMBER 1920

J. SYDNEY DE BOURG

[*Handwritten note at top of letter:*] N.B. Do you speak and write Spanish fluently? If so send and say.

NN-Sc, Sydney de Bourg Papers. ALS.

J. R. Ralph Casimir to George Tobias,
Treasurer, Black Star Line

[*Roseau*] Nov. 10th 1920

Dear Sir,

All your letters re shares for B.S.L. have been received for which accept my [thanks.]

Please find enclosed receipt (3) for Certificate also Money Order (12) value \$116.88 for 23 shares. Subscription forms enclosed herewith. Balance due to my credit: \$1.88.

Please note that Felix John Simpson bought only one share, thus leaving \$5 to my credit[.] I have paid \$7.83 toward my two shares for which I hold two separate receipts for \$3.09 and \$4.74 dated June 22nd, Sept 16th respectively. You will therefore deduct balance due from \$5 to my credit leaving a balance of \$2.83. You will please pay \$2 to the Negro World and tell the Editor to send me 20 copies each of the two latest issues, and you'll please keep 83¢ till further orders.

Please don't delay Certificates as on previous occasions.

It is time that the Corp. appoint someone to collect shares for the Black Star Line in Dominica. I will write more of this matter later as I am now only recovering from a serious illness and just forcing myself to forward these shares which have been long on hand.

Please inform the Sec. Gen that I'll reply to his letters when I have recovered from my illness. I am suffering through fatigue and brain fever.

Sorry to learn of death of your daughter. Please accept my deepest sympathy.

Please convey best wishes from officers and members D/ca [Dominica] Div U.N.I.A. & A.C.L. to staff B.S.L. S[.]S[.] Corp. With very best wishes for your success and hoping to hear soon from you I am, dear Sir, Yours for the Race & Africa

(sd) J. R. RALPH CASIMIR
Gen. Sec U.N.I.A. & A.C.L.
D/ca

[*Addressed to:*] Treasurer
B.S.L. Inc 56 W 135 St.
N.Y.C. [U.S.A.]

JRRC. ALS, copy.

Samuel Ethan King, Secretary, UNIA
St. Lucia Division, to the *Voice of St. Lucia*

[St. Lucia, 13 November 1920]

Dear Sir,—

Kindly publish the following for general information.

The St. Lucia Chartered Division (No 87) of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities (Imperial) League unveiled its Charter¹ on Sunday 7th November 1920 at Liberty Hall.²

The function, under the able Chairmanship of George Cooper Esqr.³ who e[u]logised the movement and invited the Negroes to take an earnest part in this, the only true cause, that must eventually give a practical solution of the adverse problems which confront the Negroes the world over, was solemn and impressive whilst a choice programme, comprising amongst other things a song by Miss Noel, a reading—extract from the Negro World—by Master Collingwood King,⁴ seven year old son of the Secretary, a violin solo by Alex. Ryan E[s]q. and an Anthem “Onward Christian Soldiers” excellently rendered by Misses Evelyn and Estwick⁵ and Misses Hinkson and Brown, [c]ontributed to the success of the evening.

Addresses were also delivered by the Chaplain D. L. E. Bowen Esq and the President, W. O. Norville Esq. who dilated on the purports and aims of the Association and the ultimate good that must come to those who embrace its doctrine; and that the delusions under which some people were labouring through adverse influence, that we were working in opposition to a particular race or people should be now and forever dispelled as we are working together for the good of our mass which, he was sure, would reduce [the] criminal records, through its moral effects.

During the singing of a verse of the Star Spangled Banner the lovely pannelled doors of the Charter Case were thrown open disclosing on their insides, right and left two lovely scrolls of raised wood work with the initials U.N.I.A. & A.C.L. also of raised wood work thereon, each being punctuated with red and black.

Surmounting the Charter in its exquisite threadwork frame is the Association’s motto on a scroll. One God, One Aim, One Destiny in raised woodwork.

The Association’s colors, red, black and green which draped the Charter were drawn aside by Mrs. Norville, Lady President, during the singing of the

National Anthem and exposing it to view amid deafening cheers, after which the first two bars of the British National Anthem were sung.

Messrs. A. Ryan and D. Pitcairn,⁶ Violinists, led the singing throughout the function.

The hall was tastily decorated with flags. The Union Jack and Stars and Stripes occupied positions on the right and left of the Charter.

The Charter frame and case are the design and handiwork of Mr. Vincent Paul, the Vice President, who is second to none in his zeal for the Association's progress.

The singing of the National Anthem of the U.N.I.A. & A.C.L. brought a most enjoyable and memorable evening to a close. Thanking you for space I am, Dear Sir Yours for racial progress

S. E. KING
Secretary

Printed in *VSL*, 13 November 1920.

1. The same charter was to be unveiled again later, following a change in the leadership of the UNIA.

2. The whereabouts of the UNIA's Liberty Hall are unclear. Collingwood King remembers a house on Brogile Street near the junction with Jeremie Street where UNIA meetings were held (Collingwood and Winville King, interview by Michael Louis, 15 December 1999, Ciceron, St. Lucia). However, when another unveiling ceremony was held in May of the following year, the press reported that the ceremony was held "in their [UNIA] Hall at the foot of Morne Duden Road" (*VSL*, 18 May 1921).

3. George Cooper (ca. 1890–1958) was involved in the UNIA for a period that spanned nearly two decades. While Norville and the others who attended this unveiling ceremony became the much maligned "Norville faction," accused of creating misapprehension of the organization and unnecessary disturbance in the community, Cooper remained unaffected. Indeed, his role in the organization continued, and when Marcus Garvey made his historic visit to St. Lucia on 17 October 1937, George Cooper served as chairman for the evening ceremony held in Garvey's honor. Two weeks later, when Garvey stopped off in St. Lucia as an in transit passenger, Cooper entertained him at a luncheon at the then Caribbeana Hotel. Vernon Cooper, George's son, recounted Cooper's involvement in other areas of public life, although Vernon found it "somewhat embarrassing for a son to write about his father" (Vernon Cooper, *St. Lucians Past and Present* [St. Lucia: St. Lucia National Archives, 1995], p. 149). As he put it, the elder Cooper "was no outstanding scholar nor was he an outstanding politician, but he was one of those men who had a public spirit, a fighting one, and who made his contribution" (*ibid.*). The writer noted that the UNIA recognized him, along with Job E. James and J. B. D. Osbourne, as the foremost leaders of the St. Lucia division of the UNIA and saw this as evidence of his father's "devotion to the cause of the Negro" (*ibid.*, p. 151). George Cooper also received credit as a "champion of the Labour Movement" who "championed" the cause of coal carriers at a time when there were no unions and won greater benefits for them. He was also influential, together with John Pilgrim and other colleagues, in organizing an embryonic union at a time of great opposition (*VSL*, 16 October and 2 November 1937).

4. Collingwood King became a junior master at St. Mary's College, the only boy's secondary school of the day. He soon extended his sights to the wider Caribbean, first as a teacher at the Grenada Boys Secondary School, then into the Grenada civil service, and thence to Belize on promotion. In 1952 he became one of the first Caribbean nationals appointed in the British government's Overseas Colonial Service; he was posted in Jamaica from 1954 to 1968, when he retired. He still recalls the activities of that day: reciting a poem and shedding tears of joy after receiving praises for his recitation (Collingwood and Winville King, interview by Michael Louis).

5. Ms. Estwick was the daughter of the UNIA treasurer, a Barbadian employed as harbor master in St. Lucia. Ms. Evelyn may or may not have been the daughter of E. Evelyn, who was the chief clerk at Government House. He was also captain of the St. Lucia Cricket Club, and was one of the nine-member committee elected annually to manage the Racing Association (Collingwood and

Winville King, interview by Michael Louis; Everard G. Garraway, *The Saint Lucia Handbook, Directory and Almanac, 1900* [St. Lucia Archives: Bradbury, Agnew & Co., England, n.d.], microfilm, p. 75).

6. The latter may have been a relation of T. A. Pitcairn, a bailiff at the Magistrate's Court (*St. Lucia Handbook of 1900*). One informant claimed that one or both men may have come from Barbados (Collingwood and Winville King, interview by Michael Louis).

Article in the *Crusader*

[[Port-[of]-Spain, Nov. 25, 1920]]

TRINIDAD NEWS LETTER

BRITISH SEARCH HOMES OF TRINIDADIANs FOR PROSCRIBED
CRUSADER, MESSENGER AND NEGRO WORLD—
TAKE AWAY FOR EXAMINATION COPY OF THE PROMOTER

On Monday, Oct. 4, 1920, the home of a lady living at Chaguanas was visited by two detectives, and in her absence they forced their way into the house in search of the *Negro World*, the *Messenger* and the *Crusader*. Then they went to the home of Mr. P. V. [V. P. M.] Langton, one of our true spirited Negroes. His house was carefully searched for these publications, but without success. A copy of the *Promoter*¹ was taken away for investigation. He was questioned as to where and from whom he got the *Promoter*. Some days later, reports came from Carpachiamia [Carapichaima]² that the house of Mr. Richard R. Cuffee was raided in search for the above named publications. And this is the second time that this gentleman's home was raided in search of radical publications.

These actions are the outcome of the Sedition Bill Law which was partly put through by mulattoes who consider themselves white. It is these people who are largely responsible for many of the impositions placed upon us.

His Royal Highness, the Prince came here on his tour. He was received with the greatest loyalty and love; yet we are still oppressed and all newspaper communications are suppressed. What prejudice and unfairness!

Printed in the *Crusader* 3 [January 1921]: 23.

1. The *Promoter* was a short-lived magazine that was in the publishing vanguard of the post-World War I New Negro movement in Harlem. Described as a "monthly magazine of educational interest / Instructive and expressive of the spirit of the times / Devoted to the interests and activities of the race" (advertisement, *Crusader*, vol. II, no. 10 [June 1920] p.23), it was edited and published by Hodge Kirnon (1891-1962) of Montserrat, British West Indies, one of the leading lights of the postwar Negro Renaissance (Hodge Kirnon, "Hubert Harrison: An Appreciation," *New York Amsterdam News*, 4 January 1928; "This Week's Guest Editor Says," *New York Amsterdam News*, 6 November 1937; A. M. Wendell Malliet, "Skill of New York West Indians Rates High," *New York Amsterdam News*, 13 July 1940; *Montserrat and Montserratians* [New York, n.p., 1925], an elaboration of a lecture entitled "Montserrat and Montserratians," delivered in March 1924 at the Montserrat Progressive Society Hall, New York City; Howard A. Fergus, *Gallery Montserrat: Some Prominent People in Our History* [Cave Hill, Barbados: Canoe Press, 1996], 96-97). Kirnon, who was the elevator operator for the building in which Alfred Stieglitz's gallery 291 was situated, came to know and was part of the circle around Stieglitz and Georgia O'Keeffe; he wrote an evoca-

tive and much-praised article for *Camera Work: A Photographic Quarterly* in 1914 to 1915 titled "What 291 Means to Me" ("Hodge Kirnon, 1917," in education kit for *Alfred Stieglitz: The Lake George Years*, curated and ed. Judy Annear [Sydney, Australia: Art Gallery of New South Wales, 2010]; Waldo David Frank, *America and Alfred Stieglitz: A Collective Portrait* [New York: Octagon Books, 1975], p. 112; Rachel Cohen, *A Chance Meeting: Intertwined Lives of American Artists and Writers, 1854-1967* [New York: Random House, 2004], p. 154). Kirnon was the author of several notable essays, among them "Impressions, Notes and Comments on the Convention of the U.N.I.A." and "The Growing Recognition of Negro Culture," *Promoter*, vol. 1 [September 1920]; "The Negro in the Reconstruction and the Coming Era," *Promoter*, vol. 1 [November 1920]; "Hodge Kirnon Analyses Work of Young West Indian Author [J. A. Rogers]," *NW*, 17 June 1922; and "Hodge Kirnon Analyzes Results of Anti-Garvey Campaign," *NW*, 2 September 1920.

2. Carapichaima is a village in central Trinidad.

Read the PROMOTER

A new monthly magazine of educational interest.
Instructive and expressive of the spirit of the
times. Devoted to the interests and activities of
the race.

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Agents Wanted

THE PROMOTER MAGAZINE
2189 Seventh Avenue, New York City

Advertisement of the *Promoter* magazine
Source: The *Crusader*, vol. II, no. 10 (June 1920) p. 23.

H. E. W. Grant, Officer Administering the
Government, The Bahamas, to Viscount Milner,
Secretary of State, Colonial Office

Government House, Nassau,
27th November, 1920

My Lord,

With reference to Your Lordship's Secret despatch of the 25th May last requesting to be informed whether I had any evidence of activities on the part of the organization calling itself the "Universal Negro Improvement Association" of New York, I have the honour to report that in July last it was discovered that an occasional copy of the newspaper "The Negro World" was being introduced into the Colony by letter-post. The matter is being carefully watched, and any copy found in the mails is promptly suppressed.

2. At the present moment there is no evidence of unrest in the Colony. Work is plentiful and wages are high.¹ I have the honour to be, My Lord, Your most obedient, humble servant,

H. E. W. GRANT
Administering the Government

[*Handwritten minute:*] Copy to Dir of
Intelligence [L.F.?
at once
R[.] A[.] W[.] 11/1/21

TNA: PRO CO 318/356/02541. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Secret." Stamped "C.O. 62362."

1. By late 1920 the Volstead Act, passed in the United States in December 1919, had begun to affect the Bahamas, which quickly became an important center for the transshipment of liquor into the United States, leading to an unprecedented boom in the colony's economy (Michael Craton, *A History of the Bahamas* [London: Collins, 1962], p. 264; Paul Albury, *The Story of the Bahamas* [London: Macmillan Caribbean, 1975]; Craton and D. Gail Saunders, *Islanders in the Stream: A History of the Bahamian People*, vol. 2 [Athens: University of Georgia Press, 1998]).

"An Observer" to Viscount Milner,
Secretary of State, Colonial Office

New York U.S.A., 27/11/20

Sir,

There is a man by the name of R. E. M. Jack born in St Vincent. (He was a delegate to the Negro Convention representing 5 islands. He is a schoolmaster and is well respected by people of the different islands. He is now Revd R.

NOVEMBER 1920

E. M. Jack Minister of the Independent Episcopal Church of New York and resides at 223 W 135 St New York.

He told me that he laboured for the UNIA in the West Indies without pay and now they have created positions with big salaries and he is not considered. Men who have not worked have got the positions, so he is thinking to sever his connection with the UNIA and advise his people in the West Indies to do likewise. I think if you can get hold of that man he will help to retard the progress of Marcus Garvey. He is a newspaper man and a letter from him will convince. He is very dissatisfied with Marcus Garvey and will do anything to stop his progress. Yours truthfully,

AN OBSERVER

[*Addressed to:*] The Sec of State
London

TNA: PRO CO 318/361/02548. ALS, recipient's copy. Stamped "C.O. 61137."

John R. Chancellor, Governor, Trinidad,
to Viscount Milner, Secretary of State,
Colonial Office

Government House [Port of Spain],
30th. November, 1920

My Lord,

In reply to Your Lordship's Secret despatch of the 25th. May I have the honour to report that attempts on the part of the "Universal Negro Improvement Association" to obtain adherents in this Colony were first noticed at the beginning of 1919. In February of that year an Agent of the Association was found to be selling a number of copies of its organ the "Negro World," and instructions were issued to the Post Office and the Collector of Customs to prevent its importation. There is no doubt that copies have nevertheless been imported into Trinidad, together with leaflets produced by the same organization and writings by its President Marcus Garvey. The paper was up till recently reported to be on sale in Bermuda and Barbados and was brought ashore here by negro sailors, and on one occasion in August 1920 was found distributed amongst the cargo of a vessel from New York. The "Negro World" was proclaimed as a seditious publication in April 1920 under the "Seditious Publications Ordinance" and many copies have been confiscated by the Police and in the Post Office.

2. Evidence of action by local Agents of the Association is difficult to obtain; but that its propaganda has been carried on in the Colony is evident from the fact that at the meetings of the "Workingmen's Association," and

elsewhere, verbatim quotations from the “Negro World” and the writings of Marcus Garvey are used by negro speakers. Shares in the “Black Star” Line are also held in Trinidad and generally it may be said that the allegations of the “West Indian Protective Society of America” in the enclosure to Mr. Amery’s Secret despatch of the 5th. February are correct as regards this Colony.

3. I enclose a copy of a pamphlet addressed by Marcus Garvey to the people of Trinidad of which a large number were confiscated in the Post.¹ Your Lordship will be aware that the Convention referred to in this pamphlet was held in New York, and I am informed that Sidney [Sydney] de Bourg, whose history will be found in enclosure IV to my Secret despatch of the 12th. March, 1920, was then elected representative of Trinidad on the Association. I have the honour to be, My Lord, Your Lordship’s most obedient humble Servant,

J. R. CHANCELLOR
Governor

TNA: PRO CO 318/356/7252. TLS, recipient’s copy. Marked “Secret.”

1. The enclosure has not been found.

Receipt for Payment made by the UNIA Dominica Division

Dated at Roseau the 4th December 1920

DOMINICA

Received from the Dominica Division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League Charter Number 85. per Mr Francis Louis Gardier the General President of the said Division of the said Association and League the sum of Four pounds (£4) as binding the sale to the said Association and League through the said Mr Francis Louis Gardier of a certain lot of land with buildings thereon sold to the said Association and League through the said Mr Francis Louis Gardier for the sum of Four hundred and seventy pounds. The said lot of land with buildings thereon is situated [in] Ship Street in the town of Roseau in the parish of St. George in the island of Dominica and contains one thousand nine hundred and forty four square feet or thereabouts and [batted?] and bounded as follows:—Northerly by Ship Street; Easterly by land of Miss Rose Tavernier; Southerly by land of Mr. Lockhart and Westerly by land of Madam Proper.

THOS W. EDWARD
Witness

THOMAS GITHENS

HORATIO BENJAMIN FERGUS

DECEMBER 1920

HUBERT MICHEL

CLARENCE [GOULD]

SAMUEL [WYKE]¹

JRRC. ADS.

1. According to Casimir's membership list, Samuel Wyke was a resident of Roseau.

George Tobias, Treasurer, Black Star Line,
to J. R. Ralph Casimir

UNIVERSAL BUILDING,
56 WEST 135TH STREET
NEW YORK, U.S.A. December 11, 1920

DEAR MR. CASIMER [CASIMIR]:—

Your letters of the 10th and 25th of November, enclosing \$116.88 and \$29.29 respectively, total \$146.10, have been received, for which please accept our best thanks.

Enclosed herewith please find:—

CERTIFICATE NUMBER	NAME	NUMBER OF SHARES
28836	NORBERT J. ALEXANDER	2 Tete Morne, [Grand] Bay (Delivered 8/1)
28837	JOSEPH POTIPHAR GEORGE	2 [<i>illegible</i>] " (To be returned) [<i>illegible</i>]
28838	FRANCIS NATHAN LESLIE	2 Wesley [Dominica]
28839	SHERRIE GABRIEL	2 Riviere Plaine & Hill [<i>illegible</i>](Del: 22/1/21)
28840	WATSON GEORGE SERAPHIN	2 Soufriere, [Dominica] (Delivered) 29/1/21
28841	JOSEPH BAYNES SERAPHIN	2 " " (Delivered 7/1/21)
28842	ALLONCIA PHILIP	1 Balalou Town (" 6/1/21)
28843	ANTHONY JOHN	1 Roseau (Delivered 8/1/21)
28844	JOSEPH FRANCIS	1 Mahaut (" 19/1/21)
28845	GEORGE BARZEY	1
28846	THOMAS MICHEL	1 Hillsboro St (Delivered 24/1/21)
28847	WILLIAM LEE	1 [Owen St?] Roseau (Delivered 13/1/21)
28848	WILLIAM ROACH	1 Geneva, [Grand] Bay (" 24/1/21)
28849	MARY FLOYD	1 Marigot
28850	JAMES PREVOST	1 "
28851	JOSEPH PHILIP	1 Balalou Town (Delivered 6/1/21)
28852	J. R. RALPH CASIM/1/R	2 Roseau ([Personal?] 6/1/21)
28889	BASS[IE]N/A/Y LAWRENT	1 Canefield (Delivered 9/1/21)
28890	GERALDINE ST. LOUIS	1 Roseau (Delivered 6/1/21)
28891	ELIZABETH PAUL	1 Roseau (" 6/1/21)
28892	OLIPHY TALBERT	1 Bellevue Delivered 10/1/21
28893	WITNEL FAUSTIN	1 Delivered [10/1/21]

Total 29 shares, money value \$1[*illegible*].17, \$7.83 being previously paid by you on two shares. Two part payment receipts totalling \$6.93 are also enclosed, thus squaring this transaction, as \$2.00 according to your instructions, was given over to the Negro World.

F. G. SIMPSON:—Certificate #29110 is enclosed herewith for Mr. Simpson. [*Handwritten note*: Roseau delivered 16.1.21]

We are sorry to hear that you were ill, and trust that you will improve as time goes on. Your sympathy in my bereavement is very much appreciated. The receipt for the \$6.93 which we enclosed you herewith, is being forwarded you, as we have not yet published the official record of the convention. It is still in the hands of the printers, and we do not really know when it will be out, and as you may want to subscribe for some more stock in the meantime, we thought it best to send you this receipt.

Relative to agency for the Black Star Line, we shall send you forms, etc., within a few days.

There still remains \$5.00 to your credit. Our letter of the 25th of September, in its third paragraph, mentioned a balance of \$10.00 we had for you, and as we are only issuing one share of stock to Mr. Simpson, that will leave you \$5.00 to the good.

CERTIFICATE #28837:—This certificate is being forwarded you now, but please get the name of Master George's mother or father so that we can record it on our books and return the certificate also to us in order that we may be able to make the necessary additions on it. Luckily, we noticed the subscription blank had the word "Master." Please bear in mind that in the case of all minors, the name of parent or guardian should be forwarded also, so that it can be recorded on the certificates as well as on the books of the corporation. Legally, no certificate can be made out in the name of a minor.

Thanking you for the continued good work you are doing, and wishing you the compliments of the season, we are Yours very truly, BLACK STAR LINE, INC.

GEO. TOBIAS
P. P. Treasurer

[*Addressed to:*] MR. J. R. RALPH CASIMER
P.O. Box 81, Roseau Dominica, B.W.I.

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy. On BSL letterhead. Delivery comments handwritten on recipient's copy.

DECEMBER 1920

H. N. Huggins, President, St. Vincent UNIA
Division, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

Stubbs P.O. St. Vincent
B.W.I. 16.12.20

Dear Fellowman Casimir

I am in receipt of your last letter dated Dec. 6th which was rec[ei]ved// on the 14th inst safe to hand trusting this will meet you and yours still adding more links to your chain as I am still awaiting the [slow] march of our people.

Thanks very much for papers[.] I rec[ei]ved same safely and was very proud, also What Ails Dominica. What thanks shall I render unto Thee for same[?] I've lent some ~~of~~/to// my Officers that they may read for themselves; I did not go to Town myself a friend of mine and Cousin is aboard the said ship[.] [H]is name is David Jack. Mr. England knows him So I asked his Uncle who were going aboard to get Same[.]

With regards other papers (Negro) I am getting Crusader here[.] [S]end Messenger //(one)// and Promoter //(one)// along with Negro World. I would be more than proud to rec[ei]ve same and I would remit for same by month would that suit say please [for] we are proud to hear of the rapid progress you are making in Dominica[.] I do not know when our people this way //will// go forward[.] [I]f I did not know its object & meaning Then I might of think something but not when I can read of all the predictions of what is taking place and what is to come off. I must confess it right now to you, we in St Vincent are going to be water carriers[.] I am sorry I am here because when I read of numbers in other places and I see our people should of been on the same pitch it make me feel like leaving them and if I leave it would fall flat to the earth[.] I still look upwards to the Great[.] I am asking Him for faith and patience to see and witness when they would be ready for the [drive?]

WHAT AILS DOMINICA

Dear Fellowman I cannot find words sufficient to state my mind and thinking powers to you[.] I wish the reading had such power that when such fools who disdain their race to such lowness the reading would cause their [breath] to cease at once[.] [W]e has the same kind of people in St Vincent and ~~and~~ elsewhere. They are too coward to publi[s]h such power in the so called press in St Vincent and to write such Language[.] I am proud to read same (and) Dominica has a Garvey our Garvey has gone we Bless God for Him.

Compliments to Officers and members of your Division[.] I pray God's blessing on us as a race universally and as determined as other Islands are St Vincent will soon wake from her slumber[.] God grant the day[.] With regards your arrest How glad I feel how your members stick on you and had prepar[e]d for anything[.] [I]t shows Unity[.] Had that taken place in St Vincent you never would of had a hundred to lean on[.]

The authorities in these Islands wants handling men of your type and ability, and pluck, would of done well here another with our delegate were sufficient to [quell] everything in this Island.

My Kindest regards to all officers, and Members not forgetting you hoping to hear Soon[.] I remain yours for Race progress & African Redemption

H. N. HUGGINS
President

PS The Govmt have to cut off my head in spite of the Sed[iti]ous Prohibition Bill to get me stop from reading my ancest[o]rs life and works (The Negro World) be good keep good,

H. N. H.

JRRC. ALS, recipient's copy.

Edgar Bridgewater,¹ Reporting Secretary,
UNIA San Pedro de Macoris Division,
in the *Negro World*

[[San Pedro de Macoris, R. D.,
Dec. 30th, 1920]]

ANNIVERSARY DAY CELEBRATION

HELD AT SAN PEDRO DE MACORIS

At five o'clock a.m. on Tuesday morning there was held a devotional service at Emancipation Hall at San Pedro de Macoris, in honor of the Anniversary Day celebration of Branch No. 26. The gathering was fair. Our Rev. President, Mr. Dixon E. Phillips,² was master of ceremonies. He gave an appropriate address in honor of the day. The session closed with the singing of the National Anthem of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League while the national flag of the U.N.I.A. and the ensign of the Black Star Line were raised.

Later at about nine o'clock, the officers and members of this branch began their assembly on the newly purchased lands of the Association under a temporary tent. An elaborate program was arranged for the days festivities and at twelve o'clock sharp the well known ode, "From Greenland's Icy Mountains" was sung. The President, Rev. Bro. D. E. Phillips, made a few opening remarks, and after leading in prayer, called upon the breth[re]n, J. H. Thomas, Chas Henry, W. L. J. Butler [W. J. E. Butler],³ Henry Williams, and Anthony Bastian⁴ to lead the audience in prayer. The meeting was now opened for

reports and addresses. The first report was by Brother Chas. Henry, one of the earliest organizers and 3rd vice-president of this branch, which reads as follows:

In September, 1919, Mr. David Hennessey⁵ with a copy of the "Negro World" announced to Messrs. Chas. Wilson, Samuel MacKenzie and I the existence of the Universal Negro Improvement Association in the United States of America. We quickly decided to establish in this city, and began immediately to canvass for members. We held three meetings in the house of Mr. Samuel MacKenzie, our present janitor. Among those present were Messrs. Theodore Norman, A. G. Potter, Chas. Wilson, E. M. Charles, Joseph Sinclair, David Hen[n]essey, and myself. We arranged among ourselves to make a start, in the meantime wasting no time to solicit for members. In the following months we held our meetings and it was finally decided that on Dec. 7 we would begin definite work for and in the name of the U.N.I.A. & A.C.L.

On this day, Dec. 7th, 1919, we gathered after many difficulties in the A.M.E. Church under the pastorate of Mr. Joseph MacKay [McKay].⁶ Permission was granted through the able work of the board of trustees of the church. Among these officers may be mentioned Bro. Phillip Van Putten, Benjamin Jeffers and Chas. Henry.

We met in the church at about four ten p.m. There was a large gathering. Bro. McKay was asked to preside over the meeting, but declined on the grounds that he did not know the object of the Association. Bro. Charles Martin was then asked to preside. This offer was accepted. Bro. David Hen[n]essey read a part of the Constitution. Addresses were delivered by Bro. Van Putten and the Chairman. We then elected our officers as follows:

Phillip Van Putten, president; Theo. Norman, first vice-president; A. G. Potter, treasurer; David Hennessey, general secretary, and W. J. E. Butler, assistant secretary.

About a week after we secured our own hall, and the name "Emancipation Hall," suggested by Bro. Henry, was given to it. This is but a brief report stating the origin of the U.N.I.A. in this Republic. It has fought many battles, but we can safely say that she has been the victor. Our hearty thanks to Mr. David Hennessey for his good work and to all the others who assisted in the commencement.

We began as a small body, but today we are a large body extending through the length and breadth of this Republic. We were about ten (10) when we called our first meeting. We were over three hundred (300) when we assembled at the church on Dec. 7th, 1919, and today we are about two thousand (2,000).⁷ Thanks be to God for all we were able to do. We sincerely hope and trust that the Association will grow and flourish till it brings every Negro under the banner of the red, black and green. (Much applause.)

The President presented his report from the date of his installation, Monday, Oct. 25th, 1920, as president of this Association. In this report he mentioned what the Association had done for the sick and distressed, and closed his report showing the claims of the Association on every Negro.

Addresses were then delivered by the following speakers: Bro. Thomas Dureo, first vice-president; W. J. E. Butler, second vice-president; Joseph Thomas, chairman of the Hon. Adv. Board; Anthony Bastian, treasurer, and Bro. A. Labegar [Labega], of the Consuelo Division.⁸ Then a song by Sister Jacobs, assistant treasurer of the Ladies Division, entitled, "The Song of Africa." After this song refreshments were served and several events in athletic sports were taken up under the supervision of Bro. Laviest of the Trustee Board.

At about 4:30 p.m. all sports were halted and we reassembled under our tent once more and listened with strained ears to other speakers in person of Bro. James Cooks of the Board of Trustees and St. George Carty of the Advisory Board; Bro. Shedrach of Santa Fe Division,⁹ and Bro. Myers, all of whom were applauded.

The Ethiopian National Anthem was sung by all, accompanied by W. J. E. Butler with his cornet. All moved to their respective homes, expressing joys of their well-spent day.

(Signed) EDGAR BRIDGEWATER
Reporting Secretary

Printed in *NW*, 5 February 1921.

1. Edgar Bridgewater (b. ca. 1901) was a native of Nevis and migrated to the Dominican Republic aboard the *Warspite* in 1920. Along with his fellow Nevisian, W. J. E. Butler, he was a founding member of the UNIA branch in San Pedro de Macorís. When Butler became the musical director of the local Moravian church, Bridgewater, a competent musician, became the organist. Bridgewater had obtained much of his musical training from his father, who had been a police sergeant and a piano tuner. Edgar Bridgewater would himself maintain a lifelong devotion to the training of young musicians, teaching many youngsters free of cost. A talented individual, he was also a trained tailor, having completed his apprenticeship shortly before migrating to the Dominican Republic. His several careers included court stenographer, prison superintendent, labor officer, and banker.

Bridgewater was one of the UNIA members arrested by the Dominican army, aided by the American forces, during the American occupation. Local lore in his native country has it that Bridgewater had been "marked for death" by the American forces after a mysterious attack on the nearby American barracks. The American commander swore to "kill every goddam nigger" in San Pedro de Macorís, and a bullet intended for Bridgewater caught a friend instead (Washington Archibald, *Reflections on an Epic Journey* [W. Archibald: Basseterre, St. Kitts, 1993], p. 3). Bridgewater was imprisoned for thirty days. After the deportation of Butler and other leading UNIA figures, he tried to continue Butler's work by reopening the music school and attempting to revive the San Pedro de Macorís UNIA branch. Bridgewater returned to St. Kitts-Nevis in 1930 during the rule of Trujillo. He joined Butler's Esperanza Brass Band and was appointed musical director of the Defence Force Band, a body that he had originally joined as early as 1913. He was also the founder of the St. Kitts-Nevis Police Band.

2. Rev. Dixon E. Phillips, originally from St. Thomas, U.S. Virgin Islands, officiated as pastor of the Moravian Church in San Pedro de Macorís. Immigrants from the Leeward Islands comprised the main body of church members. The first mission of the Moravian Church arrived in 1905, in response to an urgent request of these migrants. In a synod held in 1904 at St. John's, Antigua, the church took notice of the large emigration of its members to San Pedro de Macorís, due to the depression of the sugar cane industry in the Leeward Islands, and the expansion of the same in the

eastern Dominican Republic. The first chapel was built in Ingenio Angelina, a sugar factory belonging to the New Jersey-registered General Industrial Company, controlled by the Italian-born Vicini family. A church was built in San Pedro de Macorís in 1911. In 1914 William Charles was appointed pastor in charge of the congregation of Central Consuelo, owned by American William L. Bass. The Moravian flock numbered 1,444 members at that time. In 1919 Reverend Phillips resigned, allegedly because of disputes over his "close links to a labor and racial organization" (George A. Lockward, *El protestantismo en Dominicana* [Santo Domingo: Editora Educativa Dominicana, 1982], p. 308).

3. W. J. E. Butler (d. 1981), alias "King J. J.," migrated from his native island, Nevis, to the Dominican Republic, where he became deeply involved in the UNIA. While in the Dominican Republic, he founded a school of music and formed the first black orchestra in the country, and served as musical director for the Moravian church. Under the influence of Bishop Bloyce of New York, he helped form the first division of the UNIA in the country, becoming its first general secretary. Edgar Bridgewater, who was also a Nevisian and close associate of Butler, served as assistant secretary.

Butler was resident in the Dominican Republic during the American occupation (1916–1922), when members of the UNIA branch, most of them black men and women from the British Caribbean, regularly came into conflict with the white American troops stationed there. According to a published account of the deportation of Butler and his comrades, on the night of 3 September 1921, on the instruction of General Warfield, American soldiers surrounded the church where the UNIA choir practiced. Butler, Bridgewater, and the entire choir were arrested and imprisoned under the charge of inciting the population to defy the American occupation authorities. On Butler's release after three months in detention, he was deported along with John Grayson-Carey, and Charles Henry, two other leading members of the UNIA branch. This published account may have originated with Butler or his associates in St. Kitts and has no corroboration from other available sources. It is more likely that the deportation of Grayson-Carey, Henry, and Butler arose out of the bitter dispute that erupted in the San Pedro de Macorís UNIA branch toward the end of 1921. In a speech delivered on 18 December 1921, Garvey reported that he had received urgent cable messages from San Pedro de Macorís about the "great confusion" in the UNIA branch there (*MGP* 4: 292–293). Funds collected in the name of the UNIA branch had been used for the purchase of a church causing dissension among the members. Competing churches in the area accused the UNIA of poaching their membership under the pretence that they were recruiting members for the UNIA. The dispute came to the attention of the local authorities and some of the officers of the UNIA branch were arrested, and the UNIA branch expelled other leading individuals who had been involved in the establishment of the church. It is probable that the deportees were the UNIA officers who had been arrested by the Dominican authorities following the dispute.

On his return to St. Kitts in 1922, Butler was appointed president of the local UNIA division that received its official charter in 1924. He remained in that office until the collapse of the branch in the 1930s. Butler, a talented trumpeter and musical conductor, was appointed bandmaster of the local defense force. He founded and led his own big band, the Esperanza Brass Band, which provided martial music for the street processions of local friendly societies such as the Black and White, the Heart and Hand, and the Purple Band. The local UNIA failed to attract a significant following, but in his personal life he continued to demonstrate his attachment to the spirit and ideals of the Garveyite movement. He named his first son Zagloul Marcus, after an African prince and Marcus Garvey, his second son Nassibou Selassie, and his daughters Abdelita, Zauditu, Candace, and Mageda after African queens. He named his last daughter Wulani, the female version of the name of the African poet, Wuliwang (*St. Kitts-Nevis Daily Bulletin*, 4 October 1924; Archibald, *Reflections on an Epic Journey*).

4. Anthony Bastian, born in St. Croix, Danish Virgin Islands, worked as a mechanic in Ingenio Porvenir, which was owned and operated by Hugh Kelly & Co., New York City. Around 1924 he became the chief mechanic for the Dominican Molasses Company in San Pedro de Macorís. At that time, Bastian was treasurer of UNIA division 26. Wifred E. Rowland, who was born in St. Kitts in 1900 and immigrated to the Dominican Republic in 1918, worked under Bastian's supervision. Rowland, who joined the UNIA branch in San Pedro de Macorís at its creation, recalled:

The Cruzians are the people who— . . . I don't know about the modern generation—they had a weakness or inferiority complex of a kind. Even my old boss [Bastian] had that. But he loved his race, he loved his race. But he had an inferiority complex because he believed—he honestly

believed—that you were inferior. . . . the old man had that defect” (Wilfred E. Rowland, interview by Humberto García Muñiz, Santo Domingo, Dominican Republic, 11 May 1991).

5. David Hennessey held positions in both the ABB and the UNIA. He signed, with Samuel Industrious and Alan Jordan, a letter in the November 1920 issue of the *Crusader*, the organ of the ABB, announcing the creation of a post of the ABB (*Crusader* 3 [November 1920]). In 1931 Samuel Industrious, now with his surname in Spanish (Industrioso), published a small paper in English entitled the *Mirror* (Francisco Richiez Acevedo, “Cocolandia: cosmopolitismo e Hibridismo, consideraciones sobre el cambio social que se opera en la ciudad de San Pedro de Macorís” [tesis de Doctor en Filosofía, Facultad de Humanidades, Universidad Autónoma de Santo Domingo, 1967], p. 47; Alberto J. Rodríguez y Rodríguez, *18 décadas del periodismo dominicano*, vol. 2 [Santo Domingo: SUSAETA, Ediciones Dominicana, C. x A., n.d.], p. 270).

6. According to Wilfred E. Rowland, Rev. McKay was the minister of the A.M.E. Church where the UNIA “got started” in San Pedro de Macorís. Rowland recalled of McKay that:

He was light brown color. . . . His parents belonged to another island, but he became a minister of that church here. And in that church they announced once that a society in New York had made contact with that minister. And he invited the prominent members of the community to attend his church where there was a newspaper from the United States . . . They hired a house and started. And the thing took [off] like wildfire in the community. Not in the Dominican community. . . . it never took there. But in the English community of all the different islands that the people came from—became members. They trooped into it. The thing grew by leaps and bounds (Wilfred E. Rowland, interview by Humberto García Muñiz, 11 May 1991).

7. The exact number of members of UNIA division 26 of San Pedro de Macorís is not known.

8. Ingenio Consuelo was established by the Cuban firm Padró, Solaun & Cía. in 1882. In 1887 it passed into the ownership of the Bass family, who also owned the Pioneer Iron Works in New York. In the 1890s Ingenio Consuelo became the first central factory in the Dominican Republic and led in production up to 1918. According to José del Castillo, Bass “pioneered the promotion of migratory movements of workers called in generic terms ‘english’ or ‘cocolos’” (José del Castillo, “Consuelo: biografía de un pequeño gigante,” *Inazúcar* 6, no. 31 [May–August 1981]: 370).

9. The Santa Fe division of the UNIA operated in Ingenio Santa Fe, an estate established in 1884 and owned by the Cuban-American Ros family of New York. Registered in New Jersey as the Santa Fe Sugar Plantation Company, it owned and controlled the largest expanse of land of any sugar corporation in the province, a total of 61,069 acres, in 1925 (Melvin M. Knight, *The Americans in Santo Domingo* [New York: Vanguard Press, 1928], p. 139).

Charles Roberts, et al., UNIA Bridgetown Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Bridgetown, Barbados, Jan. 6, 1921]]

BRIDGETOWN, BARBADOS, DIVISION OF THE U.N.I.A. SENDS CHEERING MESSAGE

THE ESTABLISHING OF A NIGHT SCHOOL HAS TURNED OUT TO BE A GRAND SUCCESS

Dear Sir:—

It is now my pleasing duty to write to this section of our grand organization for space in your valuable paper to make mention of our work on this side

believed—that you were inferior. . . . the old man had that defect” (Wilfred E. Rowland, interview by Humberto García Muñiz, Santo Domingo, Dominican Republic, 11 May 1991).

5. David Hennessey held positions in both the ABB and the UNIA. He signed, with Samuel Industrious and Alan Jordan, a letter in the November 1920 issue of the *Crusader*, the organ of the ABB, announcing the creation of a post of the ABB (*Crusader* 3 [November 1920]). In 1931 Samuel Industrious, now with his surname in Spanish (Industrioso), published a small paper in English entitled the *Mirror* (Francisco Richiez Acevedo, “Cocolandia: cosmopolitismo e Hibridismo, consideraciones sobre el cambio social que se opera en la ciudad de San Pedro de Macorís” [tesis de Doctor en Filosofía, Facultad de Humanidades, Universidad Autónoma de Santo Domingo, 1967], p. 47; Alberto J. Rodríguez y Rodríguez, *18 décadas del periodismo dominicano*, vol. 2 [Santo Domingo: SUSAETA, Ediciones Dominicana, C. x A., n.d.], p. 270).

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Charles Roberts, et al., UNIA Bridgetown Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Bridgetown, Barbados, Jan. 6, 1921]]

BRIDGETOWN, BARBADOS, DIVISION OF THE U.N.I.A. SENDS CHEERING MESSAGE

THE ESTABLISHING OF A NIGHT SCHOOL HAS TURNED OUT TO BE A GRAND SUCCESS

Dear Sir:—

It is now my pleasing duty to write to this section of our grand organization for space in your valuable paper to make mention of our work on this side

of the seas, informing the entire Negro World of the steps we have taken to construct the fabric which is the most potent in rearing to the future a real and lasting posterity.

The intelligence of the people is the security of the nation, for without educated and well informed citizens no nation can stand the test of time, and we, this downtrodden race who for these many hundreds of years has been exploited and ravished, had scarcely any time to see to ourselves.

We in the greater majority had only the privilege of a mere surface draught of the pyrian stream, and for that in the consciousness of our selfish donors was and are considered undesirables, suited only to be serfs and pae[a]ns for their selfish motives.

The great struggle in which we are the overcomers, consisted chiefly in language and customs, which are the fearful odds any stranger has to encounter, especially one held in bondage. The first is, we were only permitted to learn through the ear and not with the eyes lest we might prove to be a dangerous factor, hence we were not taught to read at that time for wise reasons. Being new from home our fathers had first to be pol[l]uted and debased by imbibing custom detr[i]mental to their offspring. And any who dared to teach the Negro to write or read was subjected to serious punishment. These were civilized and cultured gentlemen, very often ministers of the gospel, and pious ladies in high society. But the basest tuition was enough as that would prove to their benefit and the courts and prisons of the various countries should not be idle in judging Negroes.

Nevertheless, we are coming and are surmounting all difficulties. Our doors were thrown open to welcome the less fortunate of our little ones ranging from 5 to 18 years of age, and in the near future to the grown-ups, who are employing our assistance.¹

We have up to now enrolled 225 children and in this amount we have 35 orphans. These little ones have none to care for them, and we are planning for a home to house these orphans, as more are yet coming. We call to all the awakened and enlightened of our race to lend a helping hand in this great work.

For the Christmas season I planned a treat for their entertainment and solicited help and collected \$105.60. I distributed clothing, hats and caps to the orphans and brought a successful treat to pass. It was a glorious scene in our community.

Our star is travelling [to]ward the meridian. Ethiopia, the glory of the past, has awakened to shine—to shine in splendor more glorious—to shine in art, science, literature, languages and experience attained through long years of cruel exploitation.

The history of our race, ancient and modern, is the present need for our boys and girls, and those who can help by sending such books to me in care of Mr. John Beckles, president of the Association, Chapel Lane City, I shall be glad, and this would be doing a great deal to our night school. At present we

are not under our own roof, and one of our pressing needs is our own building, as the proprietor would feign turn us out of doors through the night school. Our own building as a "school and home" would be a great mark in our progress.

I am calling far and near, to every true Negro for racial uplift. Thanks to our noble leader, his excellency the honorable Marcus Garvey, who has sounded the trumpet, the blast of which has awakened the sleeping Negro. Now we are awakened, let us act to uphold his hands in this gigantic task. Thanking you for space, yours earnestly,

CHARLES ROBERTS,
Director and treasurer

WILLIAM BATSON,
assistant

MILLICENT ROBERTS
ELDICA GRIFFITH,
trustees

W. HAYNES
(dentist)

LEOTTA SMITTEN

CHRISTINA ALLEYNE

OTTIE CARRINGTON

ELOUISE ALKINS

F. G. THORNE,
teachers

Printed in *NW*, 5 February 1921.

1. Alexandrian Gibbs ran a night school at the Reed Street branch of the UNIA for poor children of the city. There is no evidence that the UNIA organized any other form of education, at least of a structured form (Sam Gibbs, interview by David Browne, 1985).

JANUARY 1921

John F. Laviest to the *Negro World*

[[Macoris, Santo Domingo,
Jan. 15, 1921]]

CHILDREN'S SAVING SYSTEM INAUGURATED IN SANTO DOMINGO

In the month of December the thought came into my mind that it would be of some help to start a CHILDREN'S SAVING SYSTEM, where each child or person shall contribute twenty-five cents (25¢) weekly. At the expiration of twenty weeks, instead of paying out five dollars (\$5.00) to the winners, it was agreed that this amount be sent to buy shares in the Black Star Line Steamship Company.

This proposition met with hearty support of several of the officers of the Universal Negro Improvement Association of the Macoris No. 26 Division, of which I am proud to belong as Secretary of the Trustee Board. The system is to give opportunity by which children and others can buy hundreds of shares in the Black Star Line S.S. Company by contributing only twenty-five cents (25¢) weekly. One hundred persons are now giving 25¢ weekly to buy Black Star Line shares.¹

JOHN F. LAVIEST

Printed in *NW*, 12 February 1921.

1. Buying shares from the BSL was greeted with such enthusiasm that the Emancipation Hall acquired by the San Pedro de Macoris branch was christened with the steamship company's name—"everybody called it the Black Star Line" (Wilfred E. Rowland, interview by Humberto García Muñiz, Santo Domingo, Dominican Republic, 11 May 1991). Collections would decrease later in 1921, when the collapse of commodity prices, including sugar, ended the economic prosperity of the post-World War I period (*NW*, 2 April 1921; Abelardo Nanita, *La crisis* [Santo Domingo: Imprenta Boletín Oficial, 1921]; Wilfredo Lozano, *La dominación imperialista en la República Dominicana, 1900-1930* [Santo Domingo: Editora Universitaria de la Universidad de Santo Domingo, 1976], pp. 181-198; Frank Moya Pons, *Manual de historia dominicana*, 6th ed. [Santiago: Universidad Católica Madre y Maestra, 1981], pp. 486-487).

Harold A. Collins, Executive Secretary,
UNIA Banes Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Banes, Oriente de Cuba,
January 15, 1921]]

BANES DIVISION U.N.I.A. AND A.C.L. MAKING PROGRESS

Dear Sir:—

I have the honor of forwarding you a report of the working of the Banes Division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association during the month of December 20.

December found the active members of this division in their newly purchased hall. On every side one could hear words of cheer and hope, and some even congratulated themselves on being able to own their own Liberty Hall.

The first general meeting for the month was called to order on the first Wednesday in December and it is pleasing to say that the hall was packed to its utmost capacity and those who could not find seats remained standing at the doors and windows, so anxious was everyone to enroll as members at the close of the meeting 53 new members were registered, and at every meeting that followed during the month there was a rush for membership. Altogether 154 new members were received into the association during December, 1920.

Mr. A. J. Burrell, president of the branch, was granted three months' leave of absence, as also Mr. S. U. Hibbert, choirmaster during the month.

The Black Cross Nurses of the division were organized by Mrs. H. A. Collins during the latter part of the month.¹ When the nurses first appeared in their uniforms everyone was delighted at their smart appearance. Mrs. Collins is now arranging for weekly lectures to the nurses.

The Ladies' Division of this branch was also formed during December.

A general business meeting was called to order on the 20th for the purpose of electing the officers of the Ladies' Division. The results of the election was as follows:—

President, Mrs. E. A. Moodie; first vice-president, Mrs. A. M. Foster; general secretary, Miss J. A. Kelso; assistant secretary, Miss E. L. Hall; members of the Advisory Board (Ladies) are as follows:—Mrs. H. A. Collins, Miss Muriel Booth, Mrs. Alice Edinborough and Mrs. Mary Campbell.

On Christmas Day a grand carnival was staged on the baseball grounds. The stalls were nicely arranged and reflected credit on the Ladies' Division. A band of music was in attendance and dispensed sweet music during the afternoon, while those that were so disposed danced merrily.

Among the various games engaged in was cricket, May pole, needle and thread race and the hissing game. Each event was keenly contested and was the source of great amusement.

Judging from the mirth, laughter and happy faces, it is safe to say that all enjoyed themselves immensely.

JANUARY 1921

Long before the closing hour the stalls were seen to wane and when six o'clock came not a crum[b] of cake could be had for love or money, even though these two items were much in evidence.

The net profit for the day amounted to over \$300. Yours fraternally,

HAROLD A. COLLINS
Executive Secretary

[*Addressed to:*] Secretary General
U.N.I.A. and A.C.L., 56 West 135th St.,
New York City, U.S.A.

Printed in NW, 5 February 1921.

1. The Black Cross Nurses was a female auxiliary of the UNIA, modeled to some extent on the traditional Red Cross. The nursing auxiliaries, like the other auxiliaries of the UNIA divisions (the Juvenile divisions, sometimes referred to as the girl guides and boy scouts, the Universal African Guards, and the Motor Corps), were organized on the local level, with the first Black Cross Nurse unit established by members of the Philadelphia UNIA. Henrietta Vinton Davis was active in recruiting women to local Black Cross Nurse groups in the early 1920s, and the groups were formed in cities across the United States, Central America, and the Caribbean. The Black Cross Nurses appeared in UNIA parades with the blue-uniformed female Motor Corps and marching male legion members. The nurses formed their own marching contingent, making a striking appearance in long cowled white robes or green nursing uniforms. Although some of the Black Cross Nurses had formal medical training in nursing and maternity care, most worked with practical training in first aid and nutrition. The auxiliary performed benevolent community work and provided public health services to black neighborhoods, specializing in infant health and home care and in some localities working in conjunction with established social service agencies (*MGP* 3).

Telegram from General James Willcocks,
Governor, Bermuda, to Viscount Milner,
Secretary of State, Colonial Office

[*Hamilton, Bermuda,*]
26th January, 1921

With reference to your Secret despatch of August 23rd a party of the leaders of the negroes association is advertised to leave New York 30th instant in a Black Star Line vessel visiting American ports in West Indies and Cuba Central America as well as Bermuda and Jamaica.

If the party should include official representatives of the Association I propose to prohibit their landing under the Government Control Act 1919 since the Association is openly revolutionary as is shown by their charter signed in New York last August. Addressed to Secretary of State for the Colonies copy sent to Governor of Jamaica for information.

WILLCOCKS

[*Handwritten minutes:*] ~~Mr. Wiseman~~
~~Mr. Grindle Mr. Darnley~~ Sir G. Fiddes

Powers to prohibit the landing of undesirable is given in Regulation 7 of May 1919, made under the Govt. Control Act, 1919, which is in force until 31.12.21 [*number illegible*]

This tel. does not call for a reply unless it is considered that the Gov. should not proceed as he proposes. On that point, in view of the minutes on 57747/20, the Governor's action would seem to be correct?

As regards Jamaica, to whom a copy of this tel. has been sent, no action is required? [*initials illegible*] 27.1.21

The S. of S. will not wish to intervene?

? Ack. rec

& copy tel & reply to F.O. L.F.

& tel to Dir of Int. L.F.

R[.] A[.] W[.] 28/1

We had better leave this entirely to the Governors, but I regard the activities of Marcus Garvey & his associates with some apprehension.

I would send copies of this tel. to all the other W.I. Colonies secret [L77?] for info.¹

E[.] R[.] D[.] 28/1

& copy to Sir B. Thomson [L.F.?

G[.] G[.] 28.1.21

[*Handwritten minutes:*] C. Garv[e]/y is a promoter of this Association which is an I.W.W. organization. //(see A6880).// The Black Star line is a Company formed to trade with Negro countries with ships carrying only Negro Captains & crews. Its first ship was I fancy seized for illicit liquor traffic; and the shareholders—all black—were not pleased with the general working of the Company.

R. H. [Hadow?] 22/2-21.

News Dept: Mr Phillips [to sec?]

(The "Nation" or "New Republic" may talk if such exclusion takes place.)

I do not think we need raise any objection. It is for the Governor to decide whether more harm will result from admitting or excluding these people.

Copy Washington/ w. ref.

[*signature illegible*] 23/2

FEBRUARY 1921

The C.O. are very cautious. They do not say whether they approve the Governor's action or not.

R[.] Sperling 23/2

TNA: PRO FO 371/5684/5856. TD, copy, with handwritten minutes. Minutes are from CO 318/363/02545 and FO 371/5684/02606.

1. A copy of this telegram was sent to, among others, the governor of the Bahamas (Lord Milner to the Officer Administering the Government of the Bahamas, 7 February 1921, DAB/PRO, Sec. Minute Papers, Govt. House). There were similarities between The Bahamas and Bermuda. Both were geographically isolated from the rest of the West Indies, both had relatively large white populations, and both retained the old representative legislative system.

Ephraim J. Désir, Associate Secretary,
St. Lucia UNIA Division, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

Castries, St. Lucia, 1st. February 1921

Dear Sir,

The local Division of the U.N.I.A. & A.C.L. organised here early in November last desires to draft bye-laws, and as reports given us of the working of your division are so favourable,¹ we would feel greatly obliged to you for a copy of your own bye-laws as a guide in the drafting of our own.

Your "New Year Greetings" was read at one of our meetings, and was received with rapturous applause.

We take this opportunity to wish the Dominica division continued progress.

Awaiting an early reply, and thanking you in anticipation. Yours fraternally,

EPHRAIM J. DÉSIR
Associate Secretary

[*Addressed to:*] The Secretary General
U.N.I.A. & A[.]C.L. Dominica

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy.

1. With the existing conflict between factions in the local branch, the reports of the "favorable" working of the Dominica chapter would seem to imply that the latter had adopted a less confrontational approach, which was in keeping with the views of the new leadership in the St. Lucia branch.

P. Premdas, Chief, Correspondence
Department, Black Star Line,
to J. R. Ralph Casimir

UNIVERSAL BUILDING,
56 WEST 135TH STREET
NEW YORK, U.S.A. February 7th 1921

DEAR MR. CASIMIR,

Your letter of the 20th January enclosing \$19.48 for certificates for various persons has been received. First please accept our best thanks.

This remittance together with the Five Dollars we are holding for you makes a total of \$24.48. Certificates issued to day totals \$25.00 so you will be owing us fifty two cents on this transaction.

The following Stock Certificates are enclosed herewith:—

NAME	NO. OF CERTIFICATES	SHARES	AMOUNT
MR. CROSBEE EDWARDS	32141 /Roseau/	1	\$5.00 /Delivered & transferred to C. Morancie [12.6.21?]/
MR. WITNEY J. D. SERAPHIN	32142 /Soufriere/	2	\$10.00 /Delivered [4/3/21?]/
MR. ALEXANDER GREEN	32143	1	\$5.00 /Delivered per Russy Pascal/
MR. RUSSY PASCAL	32144	1	\$5.00 /Delivered 14/[4?]/21/
Total		5	\$25.00

We notice that you say that the certificate for Master Joseph Potiphar George¹ is enclosed, but same was not received by us. We think it best to call your attention to this as it might have been an oversight.

Relative to the matter of a written authority to be given to you with the Corporation stamp, this would be equivalent to making you an official agent of the Corporation and we would [there]fore have to be responsible for any transaction which you may have on our account. We do not mean to reflect on your character but the Board of Directors have decided that all agents must be bonded, and we are very sorry that we cannot make an exception in your favour. In you[r] capacity as Secretary for the U.N.I.A. however, you can still continue to take i[n] shares from the members and do all that you can to help the movement along.

Thanking you for the continued interest you show and for the good work you have been doing for us with all good wishes we remain, Yours very truly,

BLACK STAR LINE, INC.
P. PREMDAS
Chief, Cor. Dept.

FEBRUARY 1921

[*Addressed to:*] MR. J. R. RALPH CASIMIR
P.O. Box 81, Roseau, Dominica, B.W.I.

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy. On BSL letterhead. Delivery comments handwritten on recipient's copy.

1. Joseph Potiphar George was from Grand Bay, Dominica.

Louis I. Zachavos to the *Negro World*

[[Calle President Henrique,
Casa 72, San Pedro de Macoris,
San Domingo, R. D., Feb. 14, 1921]]

A GREETING FROM CUBA¹

Dear Sir:—

It gives me great pleasure to read within your columns those great idealistic, inspiring and self-supporting movements of our Negro race. Methinks we have begun to realize through the preachings of the Hon. Marcus Garvey and his worthy staff of eloquent lecturers the unlimited possibilities of the Negro. What joy penetrates the breast of one when he sees an illustrating symbol of Christianity as the hands of our Redeemer resting on the head of a Negro infant.

When we look again and see pictures illustrating our heroic boys bidding adieu to their wives and kindreds, just ready to join in line to go and fight so as to make the world safe for Democracy, we give another glance and see various pictures of our colored lads, who single handed combat with a half dozen and more scald face men who fall as victims to our heroic boys, who so nobly responded to their country's call when the Stars and Stripes, and America's freedom was in danger. We are obliged to usher with enthusiasm the joy that throbs within the breast to everyone at the sight of these pictures, which shows we might be the last but not the least in the realm of arts.

We do see now that our people could be brought together in one mass by constant teaching of the Garvey doctrine.

Let us remember our motto: One God, one aim, one destiny.

We hope that the day may soon dawn when every land from Orient to Occident, from pole to pole and from shore to the farthest island of the surrounding sea shall feel the glad sunshine of freedom in its breast. We hope that the day may soon come when we shall all rest our feet on that blessed shore—Africa—and usher our voices with one accord and say blessed be the tie that binds us. Thanking you for space, yours sincerely for the uplift of the race,

LOUIS I. ZACHAVOS

Printed in *NWDM*, 12 March 1921.

THE MARCUS GARVEY AND UNIA PAPERS

1. The *Negro World* headline is inaccurate; the greeting came from the Dominican Republic. The mistake occurred infrequently, and when it did it was mainly with Dominica, the British colony in the Windward Islands.

P. Premdas, Chief, Correspondence
Department, Black Star Line,
to J. R. Ralph Casimir

UNIVERSAL BUILDING,
56 WEST 135TH STREET
NEW YORK, U.S.A. February 19th, 1921

DEAR MR. CASIMIR:—

Your letter of the 3rd inst. enclosing \$38.96 for various persons has been received, for which please accept our best thanks.

According to your instructions enclosed herewith please find Certificates:—

CERT. #	NAME	NO. OF SHARES
32479	Loftus C. Resington	1 per [<i>illegible</i>] Stevens 23/3/21
32480	Florence O. Resington	1 " [ditto?] " 23/3/21
32481	Simon Alfred	1 " Latitia Alfred 6/6/21
32482 /31796*/	William Towers /Jones/	1 * See letter Apr. 13th from B.S.L.
32483	Jeremiah Telema/q/ue	1 " Charles [B.?] Telemaque 13/4/21
32484	James Todd Edward	2 personally 12/4/21
32485	Joseph Philip	2
	Total	9 Shares

money value of \$45.00. As there was \$6.93 to your credit out of which you owed us 52¢ on the last transaction, after issuing these Certificates now there is a balance due you of 32¢.

Certificate #28837 for Master Joseph P. George is also enclosed herewith with the trustee's name recorded. This has also been done on our books.

As requested we are forwarding you under separate cover 100 blanks for the Black Star Line and 50 for the Negro Factories Corporation. Kindly endeavor your utmost to raise as many subscriptions as possible as we are urgently in need of funds in order to float our next ship.

Relative to interest the management has decided that instead of paying any dividends this year money will be utilized in the purchasing of more ships.

As you may have read in the columns of the *Negro World* we are trying to launch a new ship s[o]metime next month which is to trade between the United States and Africa. Every dollar will be needed in order to successfully carry-out this program and our President is callin[g] on each and every one to

FEBRUARY 1921

do their utmost best so that 1921 may really and truly become a banner year for us.

We shall therefore appreciate your heartiest co-operation in this matter. With best wishes. Yours very truly,

BLACK STAR LINE, INC.
P. PREMDAS
Chief, Corr. Department

[*Addressed to:*] MR. J. R. RALPH CASIMIR
P.O. Box 81, Roseau, Dominica, B.W.I.

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy. On BSL letterhead. Delivery comments handwritten on recipient's copy.

J. R. Ralph Casimir to Francis Louis Gardier

Roseau, 19/2/21

Sir,

I beg to inform you that your actions which have put me in a very ~~precarious~~ //dangerous// position have compelled me to sever my friendly relations with you.

Without fear I must most sincerely let you know that to my opinion you are not fit to be even a member of this greatest and blessed organization for Negro Upliftment—the Universal Negro Improvement Association.¹

I must let you know that I am and will always be active as us[ua]l with the good work with God's help.

I am really sorry for you but cannot and will never suffer any longer for you. Yours very truly

(sd) J. R. RALPH CASIMIR

[*Addressed to:*] Mr. F. L. Gardier,
Roseau

JRRC. ALS, copy. Marked "Personal."

1. Casimir's comments may have been related to Gardier's indictment of forgery. Gardier appeared in circuit court on 12 May 1921 and was represented by C. E. A. Rawle. The case was postponed to the next session, at which time the jury was unable to agree on a decision. The Crown requested a special jury, which the judge denied. The Crown then refused to present evidence to the new jury and the judge directed the jury to return a verdict of "not guilty" (DC-D, 12 and 13 May 1921, 1 and 2 November 1921).

Eldica Griffith, Bridgetown UNIA Division,
to the *Negro World*

[[*Bridgetown*, February 22, 1921]]

A MESSAGE FROM BARBADOES

Dear Mr. Editor:

Kindly allow me a small spot in your big world whereby to convey to every Negro that we, this side of the globe, are awakened by the greatest bugle call ever sounded for Negroes by the greatest man of the day—who is none other than His Excellency, the Hon. Marcus Garvey. Long may he, who is the Negroes' salvation, live. Can Negroes find anything that is good enough or nice enough or sweet enough to say for him? I think not. In a vision I see him in future ages when I, he and you shall have gone from whence we came, being worshipped, praised and adored by those who are yet unborn, who are to enjoy the benefits of his labor. But I know he will not grudge, but will be pleased with all that he has gone through.

Fellow men and women, you who are asleep, open your eyes. This is the dawn of a new era. Are you dissatisfied with your positions? I am sure I am and was long, long ago, when I couldn't achieve the things my ambition called for because my parents worked from one end of the week to the other for a little or nothing and therefore had to deny me my rights and privileges, they being denied of theirs. And why now that the time has come for me to get my rights. Why may I not? You ask how will I get them, but you may answer yourself when I tell you I am following Garvey to Africa. Yes, to Africa, where I came from.

Some one, a Negro, is saying: "You fool, how did you come from Africa and yet are a young woman?" But I say if they knew as much as I, they too, would say let me go to my fatherland and see that I get my portion of rich soil which is so coveted by the Caucasian. I am now wishing that instead of writing this I was landing in Africa, sweet Africa, the place I long to be, the place I long to see—but nothing comes before its time. I hope every Negro woman and man will take this movement to heart as I have, for then I know there would be such a thirst and longing for home that they would use their every effort to make it a great success in a very short time. Negroes of the wide world awake to your rights, awake to your call. Follow your leader and you, critics of the day, beware! Thanking you for space, Sincerely yours for the Cause,

ELDICA GRIFFITH

(Member of the Bridge Town Division No. 40, corner of Reid and Tudor streets, and co-worker of night school of same.)

Printed in *NW*, 2 April 1921.

MARCH 1921

Article in *Heraldo de Cuba*

[Havana, 4 March 1921]

MARCUS GARVEY, MOSES OF THE BLACK RACE,
EXPLAINS TO THE HERALD HIS BROAD PLANS
FOR THE FUTURE REPUBLIC OF AFRICA

BELIEVES THAT THIS CONTINENT SHOULD BE
UNDER THE SOLE CONTROL OF THE COLORED

“I HAVE NOT COME—HE SAID—
TO MEDDLE IN CUBA’S AFFAIRS”

HE SEEKS ECONOMIC INDEPENDENCE; SOCIAL IMPROVEMENT
AND POLITICAL PERSONALITY FOR BLACKS

Mr. Marcus Garvey, the most salient and representative personality among those who direct and orient the development of North American blacks, was our guest in Havana for three days until yesterday.

Mr. Garvey’s arrival in Havana has been a true [grand] event and has served as a pretext for the foreign black colony of this capital to show signs of enormous vitality and enthusiasm.

WHO IS GARVEY

Marcus Garvey was born in Jamaica, where he spent his childhood years. In that West Indian island he was a typesetter’s apprentice and he learned with ease all teachings offered in the public schools of that British colony. After two years of apprenticeship in his trade, Garvey felt an irresistible call to a racial apostolic vocation and he began publishing a newspaper dedicated to the defense of the interests of the black race and the planning and explication of what the race’s ideal should be. When he was twenty years old, Marcus Garvey left his native land for England, and in London he came in contact with an eminent Abyssinian, Duse Mohamed Effendi, Director of the “Africa and Orient” Review, and perhaps the most formidable and radical of all of the world’s black writers.

At the side of Mohamed Effendi, Marcus Garvey studied and mastered perfectly the whole of the problem and the history of blacks, and it was there that the plan he is now implementing took its definitive, viable form. After leaving England, Marcus Garvey traveled all throughout Europe and North Africa, finally reaching the United States in 1912. American blacks, grouped around a number of native leaders, gave Garvey a very cold reception. He left the United States and returned to Jamaica where he founded a new newspaper, the main organ of his incomparably radical message.

THE CHANGE OF MENTALITY

The European war, in which several hundred thousand American blacks were drafted, had the effect of fundamentally altering the mentality of these blacks, transforming them into what Garvey graphically calls "new negroes."¹ The European environment, free of racial preoccupations, and the knowledge of their own strength that they acquired, effected the miracle. Back from Europe, the American blacks were no longer willing to accept lynchings patiently, nor to accept segregation and social scorn with resignation. The "new negro" was no longer scared and was willing to fight to death for his freedom. At that psychological moment, Marcus Garvey had the skill to break anew into the United States' scene, and, there, his rousing speech, the audacity of his plans and the irresistible magnetism of his personality managed to transform the horrible defeat of 1912 into a beautiful triumph.

"THE MAN OF THE HOUR"²

Marcus Garvey's apocalyptic speech boomed every evening during the meetings he led in Harlem's (the black district of New York) public squares and crowds of "new negroes" called incessantly for "the man of the hour." Little by little, the personality of this leader asserted itself, and today he is already the most important of all figures leading the North American black social movement.

THE TRIANGLE OF VICTORY

Marcus Garvey is today "Provisional President of the Republic of Africa"; General President of the "Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League"; President of the "Black Star" Shipping Co.; President of "Negro Factories Corporation"; and Director of "Negro World," the most important newspaper blacks have ever had in the world.

All of these pursuits form the triangle of victory, each side of which represents, respectively, the economic, social, and political aspects that constitute the black problem.

AUTONOMOUS ORGANIZATIONS

Although Marcus Garvey holds the reins to all of these institutions, they are perfectly autonomous organizations in themselves with clear, distinct, and defined goals.

Garvey's economic goals are aimed at giving blacks their necessary independence in the financial field. He plans to reach this economic goal through the "Negro Factories Corporation" in conjunction with the "Black Star Line" or steamship line.

Garvey is also after a social goal through the "Universal Negro Improvement Association," which aims at the establishment of a world brotherhood of all blacks, the promotion of the racial spirit, the spread of culture among the savage tribes of Africa, the creation of black universities and colleges through-

out the world, and the improvement of the conditions in which the world's black communities find themselves today.

Finally, Mr. Garvey pursues a political goal: the creation of a powerful black state in Africa, capable in its strength of guaranteeing equitable treatment and the strictest justice to all the world's blacks without regard to nationality.

THE THREE THEORIES

In the United States, there are today three formidable leaders who are competing for authority over 16 million American blacks. These three leaders are Dr. Roberto R. Morton [Robert R. Moton], Dr. W. E. B. Dubois [Du Bois], and the above-mentioned Marcus Garvey.

Morton—the successor to Booker T. Washington—holds the theory that blacks need to acquire economic independence as an indispensable prerequisite to more ambitious enterprises. Morton believes that American blacks should practice a “ranchopancista”³ policy and not bother with anything else for now.

Dr. Dubois, for his part, goes farther than Morton and joins economic and political aims, these last aims now inspired by a noble, sincere “Americanism.” Dubois believes that American blacks should aspire to be true citizens of the United States and that, consequently, his voting rights—specifically outlined in [*word mutilated*] constitutional amendments—[*word mutilated*] and blacks be able to aspire in North America to have the representation in the Federal Congress that their numbers warrant and even to occupy the office of President of the Republic. Dubois is the founder of the “National Association for the Advancement of the colored people” and he is also the Director of the monthly magazine “The Crisis,” the most valuable organ at the disposal of blacks in the American press. The Association founded by Dubois is inspired by a broad nationalist spirit. Within it can be found notable personalities of the white race. That association has undertaken and continues to undertake a most meritorious labor and a formidable campaign against lynching and segregation, and in favor of fraternity among both races with the final aim of establishing in America the reign of true democracy.

THE TESTIMONY OF “GARVEYISM”

The Hon. Marcus Garvey is the most radical of all black American leaders. Properly speaking, he is no longer a leader; he is an institution. His political personality is so complex that, according to him, it could be expressed algebraically as follows: Garvey equals Morton [Moton] plus Dubois, plus the dignity of blacks.

Garvey wants: economic independence, social improvement, and political personality, not only for American blacks but for blacks in all of the world. Africa is the land of origin of all blacks; thus, the continent should be ruled by blacks, just as Europe is ruled by whites and Asia is ruled by yellow peoples. It is not enough for blacks to be equal to other citizens in any nation in which they are born; it is necessary that blacks be represented by a powerful nation in

accord with the great powers. Garvey, then, preaches a Monroe doctrine applied to Africa . . .

HAS TRIUMPHED IN THE UNITED STATES

The "Black Moses"—as Garvey is called—has triumphed loudly in the United States, gathering around himself more than three million blacks. Thus, he is today the black leader with the largest following.

This man possesses a rare culture, an extraordinary vitality, and a profound knowledge of the psychology of his element. He has caused a true, peaceful revolution in the United States, dazzling blacks with his marvelous eloquence, with his pontifical gestures, and with the spectacle of his public appearances. Today, Garvey is an idol to many thousands of American blacks who call him "His Royal Highness" and who almost worship him.

It could be said without exaggeration that Garvey has created for the American black, a black ideal, a black mentality, and a black soul . . . "Garveyism," then, is something very complex that could only be defined by saying that it is simultaneously a social, economic, political, and religious institution.

Garveyism has its motto, which is "One God, one purpose, and one destiny"; it has its official hymn, entitled "Ethiopia, thou land of our fathers," and it has its flag of red, black, and green. Black represents the color of the believers; green represents the hope that motivates them, and red represents the blood that they are willing to shed for the ideal they hold . . .

CUBAN EXPECTATION

This is, in broad strokes, the description of Mr. Garvey's mental framework and doctrine. It is no surprise then that this leader's arrival has awakened so many expectations in Cuba.

He arrived three days ago aboard the "Governor Cobb" and, since he arrived until last night when he left Havana, the person of "His Royal Highness" the Honorable Marcus Garvey constituted an exotic attraction.

WHERE HE STAYED

Marcus Garvey came well recommended to Mr. Primitivo [Ramírez] Rós,⁴ representative to the House from Matanzas, through some American financiers who are friends with the local congressman. Mr. Ramírez Rós welcomed Mr. Garvey in San Francisco pier and offered him his house on 231 San Rafael Street, where Mr. Garvey has stayed with his Secretaries and servants.

SEARCHING FOR GARVEY

One of our reporters searched for Garvey all day on the day before yesterday without managing to find him. Garvey, however, had been in all the places where he was looked for and had departed only instants before our reporter arrived searching for him. At night, the *Heraldo's* representative managed to

meet face to face with “the man of the hour” and had a chance to listen to one of his speeches, delivered from the “ring” of Parque Santos y Artigas.⁵

This site was rented by Mr. Garvey to be used during his propaganda meetings and there he has delivered two celebrated speeches, one on Tuesday night and the other on Wednesday’s. Fifty cents were charged for admission into these speeches.

THE MISE EN SCENE

There, up on the stage, a man of pure African race and dressed in a broad red robe adorned in green and black which reached down to his shoes, delivered a fiery speech in English, which was interrupted constantly by the applause and the enthusiastic screams of a multitude of Jamaicans and Americans who crowded the place. That man was Marcus Garvey, the Honorable Provisional President of Africa and the most notable of the leaders of his race in the United States.

THE BLACK CROSS

On the same stage as the speaker, there were numerous persons seated who belong to the Havana branch of the “Universal Association” and a few colored ladies who wore a dress identical to the “Red Cross” but with a black cross on their caps . . . We were told that these ladies belonged to the “Black Cross,” one of the organizations headed by Marcus Garvey.

TWO HOURS SPEAKING

Marcus Garvey speaks with singular eloquence. It can be said that he has mastered the art of the word and that he exerts a strange fascination over his audience, whom he makes laugh, scream or be moved at his whim. Last night he delivered a very eloquent speech explaining in detail all of his pan-African doctrine, the need to unite all of the world’s blacks in moral and economic bonds, and affirming that up to now, blacks have only been the instruments for the ambitions of whites. He said that there were 400 million blacks and that those four hundred million blacks needed a place in the world for their motherland just as whites and yellows have their own territories. The orator had the most brilliant paragraphs in which he succeeded in moving the public, speaking of the noble effort to be undertaken and making them see, in their imaginations, the spectacle of a glorious Africa . . . magnificently redeemed . . .

MORE BLACKS THAN CHINESE

Garvey said that yellow people had numerical superiority in the world, but that currently, seven million people a day die of hunger in China. “If the decrease continues at this rate”—Garvey said—“for one month longer, then we will be the most numerous people in the world.”

MEETING GARVEY

After the speech and while his secretaries issued numerous 20 peso public loan bonds at five percent per year for the "reconstruction of Africa," we had a chance to go onto the stage and meet the Black Moses. Garvey is affable and magnetic: it can be said that when delivering a speech he seems like a lion but when conversing *tete a tete*, he is no more than a dove.

THE INTERVIEW

Mr. Garvey was kind enough to make an appointment with us for Thursday at 10 in the morning, and at that time and at the residence mentioned above, we interviewed him for the *HERALDO*.

We arrived a while before the appointed time. When it was ten o'clock, Mr. Garvey was already climbing the stairs to his home. Oh, the mathematical precision of the Americans!

THE SLIPPERY MAN

The man we interviewed is without question very able and full of [*word illegible*]. Nonetheless, he has the rare ability of appearing to answer questions categorically while doing nothing but masterful evasions. . .

["I am coming from New York["]—he said in response to our first question—"and I am traveling through the West Indies, visiting the numerous branches of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. We have 25 sections in Cuba, but I am planning to visit only the ones in Morón, Nuevitas, and Santiago de Cuba["]⁶

. . . ?

—"Oh, no! I have no intention of meddling in the internal affairs of this country. I seek only the support of Cuban blacks to achieve a greater cooperation among all blacks in the world and their social and economic progress.["]

—. . . ?

["The problems of American and Cuban blacks are essentially different, although they have a common denominator in the preoccupations there are against the race. I believe that in order to solve different problems each should use appropriate procedures; but the end that I pursue is common to all blacks.["]

—. . . ?

—"The Cuban Negroes can obtain the same benefits in my enterprises as the American Negroes acquire. Two of my enterprises, Black Star steamline company and Factories Corporation, are commercial [*word illegible*]. Buying stock from these companies, Cuban Negroes will enjoy their dividends.["]

—. . . ?

—"It is an error to assume that I want to bring Negroes to Africa. I believe that American Negroes have contributed to the establishment of American civilization and, hence, they have a perfect right to live in the United States and to aspire to equal opportunities and treatment. Each Negro can be a citizen

of the nation in which they were born or in one which they choose; but I praise the formation of a great state in Africa which, appearing in the concert of worldwide nations will make of the Negro race a race as respectable as the rest.["]

— . . . ?

—“Cuban Negroes will see themselves favored by the formation of this African state now that, when this State exists, they will be considered and respected as the descendants of this powerful country which has much strength with which to protect them.["]

— . . . ?

—[“]I don’t propose to pursue the consolidation and establishment of the Republic of Liberia, but rather the formation of an enormous and powerful state that dominates and extends itself throughout all of Africa.["]

— . . . ?

—“Yes; all of Africa is divided between European nations; but Africa is the land of our fathers and we have an inalienable right over her. The ‘New Negro’ knows that, when he was told not to think about Africa because she was a tenebrous land of savages and cannibals, they wanted to have him renege on his country in order to facilitate the usurpation which the Europeans have carried out.["]

— . . . ?

—“Of course it will be necessary to throw the Europeans out of Africa. You want to know by what means we will accomplish that goal...allow me to not speak about what could be an institutional secret.["]

— . . . ?

—“The civilization of African tribes enters into our plan. This work necessarily will facilitate the path for the redemption of Africa.["]

— . . . ?

—“In the world sociological phenomena occur so suddenly and arrive at such extraordinary conclusions that I am given hope that I will myself see the conclusion of my work.["]

There was a question in our plan that we didn’t want to hold any longer on account of its importance.

—“Tell us Mr. Garvey["]—we said to him—[“]do you believe that your campaign in the United States could end up converting itself into armed resistance?["]

Mr. Garvey looked fixedly at us, then smiled victoriously and told us smoothly:

—“Our problem is exactly the same as Ireland’s . . .["]

—“But, Mr. Garvey, in Ireland there are struggles and bloody and horrible struggles . . .["]

Mr. Garvey laughed again. Then he told us very deliberately:

—“It’s sometimes difficult to get rights recognized without a struggle . . . Cuba’s independence is an example of that.["]

—“It doesn’t worry you Mr. Garvey[”]—we told him to finish off the interview—[“]the responsibility that could fall on you if, should you fail, the evolutionary process of American Negroes slows for a long time?[”]

—“It doesn’t worry me in the slightest because that possibility does not exist. The different organizations are harmonious, but the failure of one would not affect the rest.[”]

The interview was finished.

AT THE RESIDENTIAL PALACE

Moments before the interview ended, Mr. Primitivo Ramírez Rós, Representative to the House, who was to take Mr. Garvey to the Palace so that he could greet the President of the Republic, arrived at Mr. Garvey’s residence. We parted ways with “the man of the hour” and he headed to the Presidential Palace, where he was welcomed by General Menocal.

AT THE “LINCOLN” CLUB

At the “Abraham Lincoln” Club,⁷ at 8 Blanco [St.], another Garveyite meeting was held yesterday afternoon, [and] numerous shares for the “Black Star Line” were sold among the Americans and Jamaicans present.

AT THE “FRATERNAL UNION”

Last night at eight, Mr. Garvey visited the progressive “Fraternal Union”⁸ society to which he had been previously invited and where he was welcomed by the full Board of Directors. Mr. Andrés Muñoz, President of the Union, Mr. Ramiro Neyra,⁹ Director of “La Antorcha,”¹⁰ and Marcus Garvey delivered speeches.

Mr. Garvey and his secretaries were much honored, and they retired feeling very satisfied.

AT THE “ATENAS” CLUB

Around nine at night, Mr. Garvey visited the Atenas Club.¹¹ As we said yesterday, there was eagerness to witness the exchange between the most important of the American leaders and the brilliant representatives of the Cuban colored race that belong to “Atenas Club.”

Dr. Miguel Angel Céspedes,¹² surrounded by numerous Club members, welcomed Mr. Garvey and his entourage, greeting them affectionately and noting that this association, composed of the most representative elements of the colored race in Cuba, was pleased and honored to welcome the Honorable Marcus Garvey in its midst, not only because of the outstanding qualities which make him a noteworthy personality, but also because of his high significance in the society of the United States; that they, the members of the club, were great admirers of the great progress made by the colored element of that country and that they recognized the harmony between the position they occupy in the United States and the great ideals that the Honorable Marcus Garvey pursues

with his propaganda; that fortunately Cubans belonging to the colored race, enjoyed the same privileges as Cubans of white race, and that the roads to progress were open to them as to the others; that nonetheless, there existed differences between the races in the state of progress, which is easy to explain considering that it was a short 40 years ago that the civil [legal] equality between whites and blacks was established;¹³ and that, they expected that with continuing efforts toward their moral, intellectual and material improvement those differences would disappear in the near future through complete identification in the sentiments of brotherhood, in equality of rights and in the common state of civilization.

After this salutation by the cultured President of the "Atenas Club," the Honorable Marcus Garvey said that he had been surprised to note that the blacks who had so brilliantly fought for independence in several countries looked at his pan-African ideal with indifference and that the same efforts made to liberate Cuba are required to constitute the great African nation that he envisions.

Doctor Céspedes answered with great eloquence:

—"Cuban blacks endeavored to create a Republic where they could live with dignity and exercise all of the rights of free and civilized men, thus, they cannot conceive having a motherland other than Cuba, and they do share the pan-African ideal because it has a cosmopolitan concept of the human spirit. However, we believe that your ideas, Honorable Garvey, are truly plausible if viewed in their fundamental aspect which is its civilizing mission toward the African continent, which occupies a very low plane in the order of universal civilization, and considering them from this perspective, they deserve all sorts of support."

When Mr. Garvey heard of the cultural and representative significance of the Atenas Club, he exclaimed with emotion:

—"This cultural development and the harmony that exists here between blacks and whites has impressed me deeply. The Atenas Club is an institution that honors Cuba, and with an organization of this kind, it can be said that without a doubt this land is saved.["]

After these words, the guests were served champagne, and shortly after they retired.

Garvey's visit to the Atenas Club has the greatest importance: it has served as a reason for Cuban blacks to declare publicly through their brightest institution that they feel Cuban first and black second, and that they espouse no aims related to Garvey's Africanist propaganda.

MARCUS GARVEY DEPARTED LAST NIGHT

Last night, Marcus Garvey left for Ciego de Avila on the ten o'clock train. He will go on to Jamaica.

Printed in *Heraldo de Cuba*, 4 March 1921. Translated from Spanish.

1. "New Negroes" was a term frequently employed by Marcus Garvey and other black radicals to describe the political, social, and cultural awakening of blacks during and immediately following World War I. His concept of the "New Negro" was perhaps best articulated in speeches delivered on 1 February 1921, in Chicago, Ill., and on 24 July 1921, in New York (*MGP* 3: 149–156, 549–554).

2. In English in the original.

3. *Ranchopancista* could be loosely translated as "bread and butter" or "food and shelter."

4. Primitivo Ramírez Ros (or Ross) (b. 1885?) was one of the few important black Cubans in the Conservative Party. At the age of twenty-eight, he was elected congressional representative from the province of Matanzas, a position he held from 1913 to 1917. He lost his reelection bids in 1916 and again in 1920. When the elected Conservative representative from Matanzas left his seat vacant, he returned to the House from June 1920 to April 1921, during which time Garvey visited the island.

A journalist and writer, Ramírez Ros directed two important black publications, *Labor Nueva* and *Atenas* (the monthly publication of the Club Atenas), and at times collaborated with the Havana dailies *El Día* and *Diario de la Marina*. He served as a member of the organizing committee which attempted to form a national directorate of *sociedades de color* in 1915, and then became one of the founding members of the Club Atenas. In 1919 he signed a manifesto along with other prominent Afro-Cuban members of the Club Atenas condemning the violence of white Cubans against blacks suspected of practicing *brujería*, or witchcraft (Alejandra Bronfman, "Reforming Race in Cuba, 1902–1940" [Ph.D. diss., Princeton University, 2000], chp. 3; Pedro Pablo Rodríguez, "Marcus Garvey en Cuba," *Anales del Caribe* 7–8 [1987–1988]: 284, 288–289; Mario Riera, *Cuba política, 1899–1955* [Havana: Impresora Modelo, 1955], pp. 189, 237; León Primelles, *Crónica Cubana, 1919–1922. Menocal y la Liga nacional. Zayas y Crowder. Fin de la danza de los millones y reajuste* [Havana: Editorial Lex, 1957], pp. 44, 195, 203, 461; Tomás Fernández Robaina, *Bibliografía de temas afrocubanos* [Havana: Biblioteca Nacional "José Martí," 1985], pp. 232, 278; Aline Helg, *Our Rightful Share: The Afro-Cuban Struggle for Equality, 1886–1912* [Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press, 1995], p. 315; Alejandro de la Fuente, *A Nation for All: Race, Inequality, and Politics in Twentieth-Century Cuba* [Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press, 2001], pp. 89, 167, 169).

5. A public park located in front of the Martí Theater in Old Havana (Bernardo García Domínguez, "Garvey and Cuba," in *Garvey: His Work and Impact*, ed. Rupert Lewis and Patrick Bryan [Trenton: Africa World Press, 1991], p. 300).

6. On his trip across the island of Cuba, Garvey visited UNIA branches in Ciego de Avila, Morón, Camagüey, Nuevitas, Banes, Maracán, Santiago de Cuba, and Guantánamo (NW, 2 April and 16 April 1921; Rodríguez, "Marcus Garvey en Cuba," p. 276).

7. The commercial offices of the BSL in Cuba were also located at 8 Blanco Street. In his visit to the Abraham Lincoln Club, Garvey spoke at length about the need for blacks to reclaim Africa (*La Prensa* (Havana), 4 March 1921; Rodríguez, "Marcus Garvey en Cuba," p. 282).

8. Founded in 1890, the Unión Fraternal was the black organization with "the most popular base within Cuban society" (Tomás Fernández Robaina, "Los repertorios bibliográficos y los estudios de temas afrocubanos," *Temas* [Havana] 7 [July–September 1996]: 127). Its members identified education as one of their main priorities, and to this end established a well-known library in Havana. The organization also offered accounting, dental, legal, and medical services to its members and sponsored artistic and musical activities. As with most of Cuba's *sociedades de color*, the discussion of political and religious issues was prohibited within its ranks. In 1929 the Unión Fraternal claimed a membership of 1,800 persons who supported their own library, school, and pharmacy. Membership in the Unión Fraternal declined from 3,212 in 1951 to just 211 in 1965. The Cuban government dissolved the Unión Fraternal in August 1966 (Rosalie Schwartz, "The Displaced and the Disappointed: Cultural Nationalists and Black Activists in Cuba in the 1920s" [Ph.D. diss., University of California, San Diego, 1977], p. 212; de la Fuente, *A Nation For All*, pp. 140, 162–164, 267, 282–284).

9. Ramiro Neyra Lanza was one of the most prominent Afro-Cuban journalists during the early republic. He published in the Havana newspapers *La Prensa*, *Labor Nueva*, *El Día*, and *La Antorcha* between 1915 and 1919, and served as director of the black weekly *La Antorcha* from 1917 to 1921. Neyra also dabbled in Cuban politics. In 1916 he lost in his bid to be elected to the provincial council in Havana. In 1920 he supported Alfredo Zayas's candidacy for president in the province of Matanzas (Alejandro de la Fuente, "'With All and For All': Race, Inequality and Politics in Cuba, 1900–1930," [Ph.D. diss., University of Pittsburg, 1996], pp. 293, 298; León Primelles, *Crónica*

cubana, 1915–1918. *La Reección de Menocal y la Revolución de 1917. La danza de los millones. La Primera Guerra Mundial* [Havana: Editorial Lex, 1955], pp. 350, 456; Primelles, *Crónica cubana*, 1919–1922, pp. 47, 214, 363; Fernández Robaina, *Bibliografía*, pp. 75, 204, 229–230, 246, 407).

10. Published in Havana from 1917 to 1921 by young, middle-class Afro-Cubans under the leadership of Ramiro Neyra Lanza and José Armando Plá, *La Antorcha* was a black weekly (plans to turn the paper into a daily never came to fruition) that attempted to challenge white racism in Cuba. The paper included articles which denounced incidents of racial discrimination, discussed Cuban politics, and recognized important Afro-Cuban figures in the history of Cuba. In representing the aspirations of young black professionals, *La Antorcha* expressed pride in the contributions of black Cubans to the struggles for Cuban independence and stressed the “civilized” nature of many Afro-Cubans. The directors of the paper, however, made little attempt to appeal to the majority of black Cubans and, rather than praising the contributions of African culture to the Cuban national heritage, at times even printed derogatory opinions of black culture (Primelles, *Crónica cubana*, 1915–1918, pp. 350, 456; Primelles, *Crónica cubana*, 1919–1922, pp. 47, 214, 363; Robaina, *Bibliografía de temas afrocubanos*, pp. 241–267; Helg, *Our Rightful Share*, pp. 242–244).

11. The Club Atenas, founded in Havana in 1917, brought together the most visible black leaders in Cuban society, including artists, doctors, journalists, lawyers, students, and small business owners. Loosely modelled after the NAACP, this organization sought recognition for the intellectual and moral capabilities of Afro-Cubans and stressed that its members uphold high standards of “acceptable” and “decent” behavior. Full membership was limited to men; women were only allowed to join a separate “ladies committee.” In addition to providing cultural, educational, and sporting activities for its associates, the club published a journal called *Atenas* and also promoted black enterprise by publishing a directory of Afro-Cuban professionals.

The activities of Club Atenas were often removed from the lives of most Afro-Cubans, and the club practiced exclusionary measures against working-class Afro-Cubans. “It is only an elegant circle, without effective contact with the popular masses,” wrote black journalist Gustavo Urrutia in 1932 (Robaina, *Bibliografía de temas afrocubanos*, p. 307). However, Club Atenas also functioned as an important advocacy group for Cubans of African descent and a space for the articulation of Afro-Cuban/Afro-diasporic principles of affiliation. Most black politicians joined the Club Atenas, thus providing it with some access to national political figures and limited influence over government policies. The club at times used its visible position in Cuban society to protest the most blatant instances of racial discrimination on the island, such as the 1919 lynching of a Jamaican immigrant in Regla, the expulsion of black Cubans from a public park in Santa Clara in 1925, and the exclusion of black athletes from certain contests in Havana near the end of the 1920s. The Club also played a role in the creation of an Afro-Cuban/African-American transnational community during the 1920s and 1930s; along with other Afro-Cuban societies, Club Atenas functioned as a disseminator of news and information about blacks in the United States (Frank A. Guridy, “Racial Knowledge in Cuba: The Production of a Social Fact, 1912–1944” [Ph.D. diss., University of Michigan, 2002]). Club Atenas remained in existence until 1961, when it was dissolved by the Cuban government (Schwartz, “The Displaced and the Disappointed,” pp. 194–195, 209; Fernández Robaina, *El negro en Cuba, 1902–1958* [Havana: Editorial de Ciencias Sociales, 1990], pp. 120, 168; Helg, *Our Rightful Share*, pp. 242, 244, 315; de la Fuente, *A Nation For All*, pp. 168–170, 283–284).

12. Miguel Angel Céspedes served as president of the exclusive Club Atenas for several terms, and held that position during Garvey’s visit to the island in 1921. Trained as a lawyer, Céspedes became involved in Cuban politics and was elected to Congress in 1912. After losing his bid for reelection in 1916, he was appointed public notary in Havana. Prior to the founding of the Club Atenas, he was involved in efforts to organize national directorates for Cuba’s black social societies. Céspedes nevertheless consistently discouraged autonomous black political organizing. In 1915, for example, he condemned the formation of the black political party Amigos del Pueblo, founded by former members of the Partido Independiente de Color. Céspedes was appointed Secretary of Justice by Fulgencio Batista in 1952 (*La Prensa*, 14 September 1915; Schwartz, “The Displaced and the Disappointed,” pp. 197, 208; de la Fuente, *A Nation For All*, pp. 89–90, 169, 244).

13. Title 4, article 11, of the Constitution of the Republic of Cuba reads, “All Cubans are equal before the law. The republic does not recognize special rights or privileges” (Cuba, *Constitución de la República de Cuba* [Havana, 1902], quoted in Melina Pappademos, *Black Political Activism and the Cuban Republic* [Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press], p. 233 n. 10).

THE BARBADIANS GIVE FAREWELL BANQUET TO MARCUS GARVEY

A farewell banquet was given by the Barbados group in honor of His Excellency Hon. Marcus Garvey, Provisional President of Africa and president-general of the U. N. I. A., on Friday evening, February 18, in Liberty Hall, New York city, prior to his departure for the West Indies. The flags of the various nations were strung along the wall over the beautifully decorated tables. Mr. A. Crawford, the caterer, prepared a splendid menu, consisting of grape fruit cocktail, cream of asparagus soup, roast turkey and ham with cranberry sauce, Liberty Hall salad, etc., ending with delicious desserts.

Mrs. Neblett introduced Rev. Dr. Elligor, who introduced the Hon. Marcus Garvey. The following speakers responded to toasts: Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis, Rev. Tobitt, Sir Sidney De Bourg, W. H. Ferris, Mr. Sol Plantje, Mr. Palmer Bruce, Mr. Garcia, Mr. Tobias, Dr. Stewart, Mr. R. H. J. Austin, Mr. V. Boyne and Mr. John. Mr. Garvey responded to toasts.

Committee.—Mrs. Marie Neblett, secretary; Mrs. Weeks, Mrs. Moore, Mrs. Boxill, Mrs. Leacock.

Guests at Banquet.—Hon. Marcus Garvey, Mrs. V. Barrow, Mrs. Bonnett, Miss H. Davis, Miss J. Jenkins, Miss M. Nurse, Miss B. Clarke, Miss A. Jacque, Miss Walcott, Mrs. Marie Neblett, mistress of ceremonies; Mr. and Mrs. J. E. Bruce, Mr. and Mrs. Moore, Mr. and Mrs. F. A. Robinson, Mr. and Mrs. Thomas, Mr. and Mrs. G. Tobias, Mr. and Mrs. H. C. Price, Mrs. Weeks and daughter, Mrs. Nicholls, vice-president New York local U. N. I. A.; Ina-Gen. L. E. Harrigan and wife, Capt. C. Williams, Capt. E. Gilks, Lieut. W. A. Gittens, Mr. Sol Plantje, Mr. E. Garcia, Rev. Dr. Paul, Mr. J. B. Yearwood, Mr. J. S. Debourg, Mr. G. M. Thompson, Mr. H. V. Plummer, Mr. W. H. Ferris, Mr. R. H. Tobitt, Mr. F. W. Elligor, Mr. A. Austin, president Brooklyn division; Mr. G. E. Stewart, Mr. D. Power, Mr. Bayne, Mr. C. Brathwaite, Mr. A. Jones, Mr. Normans.

Mr. A. Crawford, caterer and decorator.

Report of Farewell Banquet for Marcus Garvey, 18 February 1921

Source: *Negro World*, 5 March 1921

MARCH 1921

Article in the *Negro World*

[[*Santiago, Cuba*, ca. 6 March 1921]]

PEOPLE OF SANTIAGO THRILLED BY MARCUS GARVEY FOR TWO NIGHTS

HUNDREDS CROWD NEGRO CUBAN CLUB HOUSE
TO HEAR OF AFRICAN REDEMPTION—OLD LIBERTY HALL
SUDDENLY BECOMES TOO SMALL—A NEW LIBERTY HALL
SECURED IN THREE DAYS

Sunday morning, the sixth of March, opened a new day in the history of Santiago de Cuba. The news circulated the town that His Excellency the Honorable Marcus Garvey was really visiting Santiago because a representative had preceded him from the city of Havana and at once elaborate preparations were begun under the superintendence of Mr. A. G. Burkley, the traffic manager of the Black Star Line sent from Havana.

The Presidential party consisting of the Right Honorable Marcus Garvey, his private secretary, Miss Amy Jacques,¹ and her brother, Mr. Cleveland Jacques,² the official secretary, reached Santiago from Camaguey at three o'clock on the morning of the 10th of March, and was taken to a private residence provided for the party.

It was 10 o'clock in the morning with a warm sun shining when His Excellency received a visiting party consisting of Miss Clarice Walters, the local and active Lady President; Miss Ellen Walters, her sister; Mr. Robert French, the male vice-president, and Mrs. Elma Taylor, the latter an old acquaintance of His Excellency. The party was accompanied by Mr. Burkley, who made the introductions. The rest of the day was occupied with the arrangements for the sailing of the Lady Secretary for Kingston, Jamaica.

It was the 11th, the day dawns warm and fair; everybody is in a bustle, the anticipation is exciting. Many visit the President; others go off decorating the local Club Aponte³ where the guest of honor would speak. It was eight o'clock: the hall is aglow with bright expectant faces, all watching the stairs for the arrival of the great man of the hour. Suddenly at the warning of his approach the band plays the Cuban National Anthem, followed by "Ethiopia Thou Land of Our Fathers." Everybody standing, some on the chairs, as His Excellency enters accompanied by the Traffic Manager and take their places on the platform.

The chairman of the evening, Rev. Dr. Lewis, president of the Barbados Division, opened with a stirring address in which he eulogized the calling and the Divine duties of His Excellency, Sir Marcus Garvey.

The program was one of addresses and musical selections which kept the audience amused until His Excellency was introduced by the local organizer,

Mr. Geo. Rawlins, in English and in Spanish by Miss Clarice Walters, the Lady President.

His Excellency arose, smiling pleasantly, to keep his hearers spellbound for an hour and a half.

The applause which greeted him was deafening, then he proceeded to deliver the greeting of 15,000,000 Negroes of America and 400,000,000 Negroes of the world to the Negro people of the beautiful city of Santiago.

His Excellency outlined the rise and progress of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, the construction and development of the Black Star Line and efforts for African redemption through the Liberian construction project.

He then unfolded the process of scientific religion having first challenged anybody to serve their God more sincerely than he did his.

"If the white man makes his God a white God, his Jesus a white Jesus, and his Angels beautiful white women, then we ought to make our God and Jesus black men and our angels beautiful blacks girls," which kept the audience in a roar of applause and laughter for several minutes while the speaker wiped the perspiration from his brow and cheeks and took a drink of water prior to proceeding.

The fame of Marcus Garvey is a known fact in this beautiful land of the Antilles for the freedom of which the Negro Antonio Maceo⁴ was a foremost factor.

A new Liberty Hall of the Santiago Division became necessary to hold the added membership and this was provided in three days.

Printed in *NW*, 9 April 1921.

1. Amy Euphemia Jacques (1896–1973) became Garvey's confidential secretary and eventually his second wife and the mother of his two sons, Marcus Mosiah Garvey, Jr., and Julius Winston Garvey. She wrote that during one of her first conversations with Garvey, he showed her stacks of mail stored in a large cabinet and complained: "These accumulated while I was on a speaking trip. I haven't the time to help and teach someone to open, sort and put notations on them, before handling the monies enclosed to the treasurer. You see the awful predicament I am in for lack of qualified, honest people" (Amy Jacques Garvey, *Garvey and Garveyism*, p. 40). Amy Jacques's sparse autobiographical statements indicate she was born in Jamaica and was the eldest child of Mr. and Mrs. George Samuel Jacques. Her father had spent parts of his childhood in Cuba and had also lived at one time in Baltimore. Her education included high school courses in shorthand and typing. When her father died, Amy Jacques went to work for the family lawyer, but after four years there she grew restless. When the outbreak of World War I interrupted her plans to go to England, she went instead to the United States in 1917. Her first meeting with Garvey and her subsequent mandate to reorganize his office soon led to special status as his confidential secretary. In addition, Amy Jacques and her brother, Cleveland, became Garvey's frequent travelling companions. Amy Jacques assumed her unique role in Garvey's organization shortly before Garvey married his longtime friend and aide, Amy Ashwood. In 1920 Amy Jacques became secretary of the Negro Factories Corporation, and her expanded role as Garvey's office manager made her a controversial figure at UNIA headquarters, especially among those who objected to her uncompromising attitude toward efficiency.

Garvey's marriage to Ashwood had clearly failed when they separated after three months. Over two years later, after an initial attempt at annulment, Garvey finally obtained a divorce. On 27 July 1922, under the pressures of Garvey's impending trial and a possible jail term, Amy Jacques, according to her account, agreed to marry him and to become his personal representative. She immediately became his principal aide and a major pro-Garvey propagandist. She edited two volumes of Garvey's most salient statements, *Philosophy and Opinions of Marcus Garvey* (vol. 1, 1923, and vol. 2,

1925) in an effort to answer his critics. Later, with Garvey incarcerated in Atlanta, she claimed sole authority to speak for him as his most trusted representative.

Amy Jacques Garvey continued to influence Garveyism long after her husband's death in 1940. She became a contributing editor to the *African*, a black nationalist journal published in Harlem in the early 1940s. While residing in Jamaica in the late 1940s, she reorganized the African Study Circle of the World, claiming her place as the successor to its founder, Marcus Garvey. Her correspondence with scholars facilitated the burgeoning research on Garvey beginning in the 1950s, and in 1963 her book, *Garvey and Garveyism*, offered her personal account of the UNIA and its leader. When she died in 1973, she had achieved recognition as one of the most important sources for the study and propagation of Garveyism (TNF, AJG; *DmG*, 26 July 1973; *Jamaica Daily News*, 29 July 1973; Amy Jacques Garvey, *Garvey and Garveyism*).

2. Cleveland Augustus Jacques was the brother of Amy Jacques and a confidant as well as travelling secretary to Marcus Garvey (*MGP* 2: 168–169, 329).

3. The Club Aponte, a *sociedad de color*, was named after José Antonio Aponte, the free black sculptor for whom an 1812 rebellion of slaves and free persons of color in Cuba was named. In addition to the Club Aponte in Santiago de Cuba, a club of the same name also existed in Havana (Matt David Childs, "The Aponte Rebellion of 1812 and the Transformation of Cuban Society: Race, Slavery, and Freedom in the Atlantic World" [Ph.D. diss.: University of Texas at Austin, 2001]; José Luciano Aponte, *La conspiración de Aponte* [Havana: Publicaciones del Archivo Nacional, 1963]; Aline Helg, *Our Rightful Share: The Afro-Cuban Struggle for Equality, 1886–1912* [Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press, 1995], pp. 132, 171–172, 185).

4. Antonio Maceo (1845–1896) travelled extensively throughout the Americas during his political exile from Cuba. Along with his family, he often resided in Jamaica while planning for Cuba's independence. After his 1878 rejection of the peace treaty with the Spanish in his protest of Baraguá, Maceo was sent abroad to secure supplies and reinforcements for the insurrection. After arrangements were made with the Spaniards, Maceo and his family left for Jamaica in early May 1878. Since he arrived on a Spanish cruiser, he was seen with suspicion. He was able to raise only five shillings and recruit only seven volunteers in Kingston. Disillusioned with these results, Maceo departed for New York and arrived there on 23 May. After learning that the rebel government had accepted the Spanish peace terms on 21 May, that therefore the government he represented no longer existed, and that the fundraising program had subsequently been suspended, he went to Jamaica again in late June. From there, he corresponded with other rebels about a new revolution in Cuba.

At a conference in Kingston on 5 August 1879, Maceo and Calixto García reached an understanding for a new uprising. While Maceo was still in Jamaica, a revolt broke out on 26 August 1879. Maceo issued a proclamation from Kingston on 5 September 1879, calling on all Cubans to fight for liberty. He also visited Haiti and the Dominican Republic to rally support for the revolution. There were various setbacks as the Spanish captured various leaders. Maceo left for Cuba in June 1880, but he was detained in Haiti and sent to Turks Island. The English ordered him to leave, but Maceo refused. The governor of the Bahamas dispatched a warship from Jamaica with orders to take Maceo and his fellow conspirators to Kingston. Seeing the difficulty his presence caused, Maceo finally decided to leave for Jamaica.

Over the next few years, he also traveled to Honduras, Mexico, New York, New Orleans, and Key West to gather money for his invasion. By 1886, Maceo once again settled in Kingston and worked out the final plans for the Cuban invasion. In an August 1886 conference in Jamaica, over Maceo's objections, other rebel leaders decided to make one more effort to get the revolution started. Maceo went to work in Panama in late November 1886, but there was a scandal with the company for which he was working, and by 1889, he had returned to Kingston. He was permitted to return to Cuba in February 1890 but was deported in August. He returned to Kingston again before reaching an agreement with Costa Rica to settle a colony in 1891. In April 1895, Maceo finally returned to Cuba, where he fought until his death in 1896 (Philip S. Foner, *Antonio Maceo: The "Bronze Titan" of Cuba's Struggle for Independence* [New York: Monthly Review, 1977], pp. 81–149; Magdalen M. Pando, *Cuba's Freedom Fighter, Antonio Maceo: 1845–1896* [Gainesville, Fla.: Felicity, 1980], pp. 22–24, 39, 130–133).

Report by Leon E. Howe, Agent,
Bureau of Investigation

Miami, Fla. 3/11/21

MARCUS GARVEY: JAMAICA NEGRO AGITATION

February 24 agent received the following telegram from the Agent In Charge at Jacksonville: (in code)

[“]Following wire received from chief today quote Marcus Garvey negro radical left New York today for Key West stop Cover movements thoroughly unquote Will cover hard and keep you advised.”

Upon receipt of above agent immediately got into communication with negro informants Newbold at Miami and Hardy at Key West, and gave them instructions. I found that Newbold had already heard that GARVEY was to come to Miami to speak, and that his route included a trip to Key West, Cuba, some of the British isles including his former home in Jamaica, and probably Nassau, N[ew] P[rovidence] Bahama Islands.

I then got into communication with N.J. CONQUEST, colored, pastor of WA[L]KER'S MEMORIAL A.M.E. ZION CHURCH, Corner 18th St. and First Place, where the U.N.I.A. have been holding meetings every Sunday. Without arousing his suspicions, I learned that GARVEY would probably speak in his church. CONQUEST recently came to Miami from Los Angeles, and is an ardent supporter of GARVEY. I attempted to find PERCY A. STYLES, who has recently been appointed to the position of district organizer for the U.N.I.A., but was unable to find him.

Late March 9, agent learned GARVEY was not coming back to Miami, my informant stating that he had been warned not to come back here by some one in Key West.

Agent proceeded to Key West March 10.

The movements of GARVEY in Key West were as follows:

He arrived the morning of the 25th, and was driven to the home of P. S. GLASHAN [T. C. Glashen],¹ a Jamaica negro, living at 318 VIRGINIA STREET. GLASHEN is president of the U.N.I.A. organization at Key West. Accompanying subject was CLEVELAND A. JAGNES [Jacques] and AMY E. JAGNES [Jacques], who were supposed to be secretaries. GARVEY spoke the night of the 25th.—26th.—and 27th.—at SAMARITAN HALL, 7th and WHITEHEAD STREETS.

At the meetings GARVEY spoke principally of the necessity for the economic freedom of the black race, and devoted most of his time to soliciting subscriptions for stock in the BLACK STAR LINE. He stated that the boat line now had three ships in commission, and would [soon] float a fourth: that soon the line would put a ship in commission every three months until it covered the world. He spoke of his aims in the Liberia project, and the necessity of trained mechanics and experts in all lines of industry, emigrating to Liberia.

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DR. A. J. KERSHAW, an American negro, spoke at all three meetings giving his endorsement to GARVEY's plans. Agent interviewed KERSHAW, who stated that GARVEY had expressed surprise that several government agents had not bothered him in Key West. He then gave me the information that GARVEY expected to return to Key West the first week in April, going from there to Miami; thence to Nassau. KERSHAW is the financial secretary of the U.N.I.A. at Key West. He [seems] to be suspicious of GARVEY's financial ability, and mentioned criticisms of GARVEY made by DU BOIS in the CRISIS.² KERSHAW stated he believed GARVEY expected to meet other officials of the U.N.I.A. in Havana.

Agent then talked to S. A. MOUNTS, corresponding secretary of the U.N.I.A. at Key West. He is a naturalized Bahama negro. He gave me the information that GARVEY left no record with the local organization of how many shares of stock he had sold. MOUNTS stated that about thirty persons subscribed for stock at each meeting, each subscription from five to thirty dollars each. He seemed suspicious of GARVEY's business methods, but stated that each subscriber was given a receipt for his money by one of the secretaries accompanying subject.

GARVEY sailed from Key West for Havana Feb. 28 on the GO[V] COBB, P. & O. Steamship Company. He had a British passport, as he is a citizen of Jamaica. Agent's information of GARVEY has largely come through intercepted copies of the [NEGRO] WORLD, and I did not until this time know he was not an American citizen. I immediately went to the office of the Immigration Inspector in charge at Key West, with the intention of asking the office to co-operate in trying to keep GARVEY out of the United States. I found that Mr. Hoover, of the Bureau, had already asked such action. The inspectors, however, have no knowledge of GARVEY, and requested agent to obtain whatever evidence of disloyalty, or membership in a radical organization, that was in the possession of the Bureau.

Agent requests that any evidence which should be placed before the Immigration Inspectors be forwarded to agent at once in order that I can appear against GARVEY. This should reach us before April 1. I am this date requesting this by telegraph.

Agent has made an effort to learn who warned GARVEY not to come to Miami, and I believe this warning came from DR. A. P. HOLLY, a former Ha[i]tian revolutionist, and consul from Haiti to the Colonial Government of the Bahamas. HOLLY has been covered in reports of agent on the OVERSEAS CLUB.³ . . .

For the information of the Bureau, the U.N.I.A. has about 600 members in Miami, 300 in Key West, and more than a thousand in the city of Nassau, N.P. Bahamas. Nassau members have bought heavily in the steamship line, the principal occupation of Bahama negroes being that of operating sail boats. CASE OPEN.

[LEON E. HOWE]

DNA, RG 65, BS 198940-175. TD.

1. Born in British Honduras, Rev. T. C. Glashen was president of the UNIA branch in Key West, Fla., in 1921. Glashen was still under Bureau of Investigation surveillance in August 1923, when an agent reported: "Letters were intercepted from the Rev. R. H. Higgs, Coconut Grove, Fla., which is a suburb of Miami. These letters from Higgs to Glashen contained advice to Glashen to organize the negroes in Key West and on the given date poison everybody and take possession of the island" (DJ-FBI, file 61-746). Glashen was appointed UNIA commissioner to Tennessee in 1922 (NW, 26 August 1922).

2. W. E. B. Du Bois, "Marcus Garvey," *The Crisis: A Record of the Darker Races* 21, no. 2 (1920): 58-60; "Marcus Garvey," *ibid.*, 21, no. 3 (1921): 112-115. The first article provided an account of Garvey's personal history; the second article analyzed his economic enterprises and the feasibility of his general plans.

3. The Overseas Club and Patriotic League was an international society of British subjects with headquarters in London. About thirty-three hundred of the organization's twenty-one thousand members resided in the United States, with slightly over six hundred living in the southeastern states. John LeMansey, one of the Overseas Club's leaders, was a Haitian national born to Jamaican parents (Ancestry.com, 1920 *United States Federal Census* [online database; Provo, Utah: Ancestry.com Operations, 2010], census place: Miami, Dade, Fla., roll T625_216, p. 9B, enumeration district 23, image 24; Ancestry.com, *U.S. Passport Applications, 1795-1925* [online database; Provo, Utah: Ancestry.com Operations, 2007; National Archives and Records Administration, Washington D.C.], *Passport Applications, January 2, 1906-March 31, 1925*, ARC identifier 583830, MLR no. A1 534, NARA series M1490, roll 1458). Most of the members of the Miami branch of the club were black Bahamians, with the exception of the president, Philip A. Irwin of the Wesleyan church. Bureau of Investigation agents viewed the club with suspicion, one claiming that the club taught "its negro members particularly contempt for American institutions." The same agent reported that the club's leaders told members that "they are the social equals of the whites," concluding that racial conflict in Miami would be the result (DNA, RG 65, OG 360202; *MGP* 3: 247 n. 3).

A. Z. M. to the *Voice of St. Lucia*

[Castries, St. Lucia, 16 March 1921]

WHAT IS THE U.N.I.A.

Dear Mr. Editor—

There has lately taken place a change in the Presidency and management of the local Branch of the U.N.I.A. At first there was quite a deal of misapprehension of the objects of this organisation because of [mal-]administration of the local branch and the mad expressions of wild enthusiasts who did much to hamper the cause they presumed would advance, and produced an element of disturbance in the community just as unnecessary, as it is undesirable, in St. Lucia.

The Universal Negro Improvement Association is incorporated in America under the Laws of the State of New York. As I write I have before me a copy of the Constitution the Preamble of which I find reads as follows:

The Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League is a social, friendly humanitarian charitable, educational, institutional, constructive and expansive Society, and is founded by persons, desiring to the utmost, to work for the general uplift of the Negro peoples of the world. And the members pledge themselves to do all in

their power to conserve the rights of their *noble race* and to respect the rights of all mankind, always believing in the Brotherhood of Man and the Fatherhood of God. The motto of the organisation is: [“]One God! One Aim! One Destiny!” Therefore, let justice be done to all mankind, realizing that if the strong oppresses the weak confusion and discontent will ever mark the path of man; but with love, faith and charity towards all the reign of peace and plenty will be heralded into the world and the generations of men shall be called Blessed.

If, as the organisation seeks, a universal confraternity among coloured peoples be established having as its basis the principles above referred to there is no reason why good and not evil should result from the movement.

The objects of the Association are stated in Section 3 of the Constitution which runs as follows:—

The object of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and the African Communities League shall be: to establish a Universal Confraternity among the race; to promote the spirit of pride and love; to reclaim the fallen; to administer to and assist the needy; to assist in civilizing the backward tribes of Africa; to assist in the development of Independent Negro Nations and Communities; to establish Commissioners or Agencies in the principal countries and cities of the world for the representation and protection of all Negroes, irrespective of nationality; to promote a conscientious spiritual worship among the native tribes of Africa; to establish Universities, Colleges, Academies and Schools for the racial education and culture of the people; to conduct a world-wide Commercial and Industrial Intercourse for the good of the people; to work for better conditions in all Negro communities.

With the hope that the public will be hereby better enlightened as to the aims of the U.N.I.A., and thanking you for space, I am, Dear Mr. Editor, Sincerely Yours,

A. Z. M.

Printed in *VSL*, 16 March 1921.

George Scott Anderson, Executive Secretary,
UNIA Marcane Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Cuba, ca. 18 March 1921]]

MARCUS GARVEY GREETED BY DELEGATION
AS HE PASSES THROUGH CUBA

The president, Mr. Michal Alexander, gathered together his subofficers and members and greeted his Excellency Marcus Garvey, Provisional President of Africa, who passed through Marcane on the railroad train. Mr. Alexander was lucky enough to have sufficient time to express his greatest respects to his Excellency Marcus Garvey.

He spoke as follows:

March 18, 1921

His Excellency Marcus Garvey, Provisional President of Africa: We, the officers and members of the Marcane division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League, beg to approach you and to present to you this bouquet of flowers in token of our high esteem and gratitude we owe to you as the founder and leader of so distinguished a race.

We realize the importance of our noble movement and can trust you, with your high inspiration and noble vision, to lead us back to our fatherland.

We could not remain passive and allow you and your noble international organizer to pass us unnoticed, as we are aware that your time in Cuba is limited, so we have prepared this simple tribute, which we hope will be accepted in the spirit of brotherhood and love.

We are sorry that your Excellency could not remain with us in Marcane a while, for no greater pleasure could be afforded us than to behold the leader recognized by all well-thinking Negroes in our midst of Marcane.

But as fortune did not smile on us to have you here, we are still satisfied to know that you have passed this way. We trust your Excellen[c]y's pathway will be strewn with roses and that we, the Negroes of Marcane, can assure you that we are prepared to be with you at any call to uphold the honor and integrity of the red, the black and the green.

We wish his Excellency's health may not fail him and that every day may see him in greater spirits when he beholds his people rallying to the call of our dear fatherland. We also wish you success on your mission to the other West Indian islands and that your voyage be a pleasant one, and that when you return to America you will remember your humble servants at Marcane, Cuba.

MARCH 1921

Thanking you, Mr. Editor, for your noble space granted to advertise the above mentioned. Yours very truly,

GEO. SCOTT ANDERSON
Executive Secretary,
Marcane Division, Cuba

Printed in NW, 2 April 1921.

R. Hodge¹ to the *Negro World*

[[16 W. 137th St., New York City,
ca. 19 March 1921]]

PLEA FOR LEEWARD ISLANDS TO BRITISH GOVERNMENT

Dear Sir—

I would gladly write this letter direct to the Legislative Councils of the Leeward Islands, the Secretary of State or the British Embassy here, but since I believe it would be given to the waste basket as its safest abode, I seek the issue of your paper. The oppressed people of those places haven't any official organ with which they can voice their grievances and bring enough public sentiment to bear, and they are of the temperament that doesn't believe in asking outsiders to do them such favors.

But it is with an eye of disgust that I read the many letters from friends and relatives depicting the deplorable conditions there, economically and politically. And I personally as well as many others "who have already expressed the same wish" would gladly welcome the Americanization of those colonies tomorrow if it wasn't for the segregation and jim-crowism that America never fails to take with her everywhere.

The history of the Negroes in the Western Hemisphere is a long one, and so we will only recall what happened since the abolition of slavery. Since then the Negroes as the mass of laborers have been able to receive wages for their labor, and while quite a few have got a spot of land with a house on it for their families to live in,² the standard of wages has been such that no surplus could be realized or capital raised to create any other source of existence than to be employed all the time of these menial jobs. All the land is being used up and the laborer's time is being occupied in producing sugar cane or cotton as the ready market demands. Whatever is received for the output is practically spent again to bring in foodstuffs. Labor and production go on just to bring in turn clothing and foodstuffs as imports, which doesn't help to solve the problem any.

Little barren bits of land are sometimes given by the different estates to individuals to cultivate; but as soon as they become well irrigated they are taken away. The local government offers small bits of land near the city to some folks, but whoever heard of city folks wanting to cultivate land?³

And the only solution I can see to the problem is for the government to compel the planters to plant less sugar cane and more foodstuff or pay much bigger wages and give the people land and plenty of land that they can work and encourage thrift.

Let the churches cease to imbibe that spirit of "Think not of tomorrow what ye shall eat or drink," for it is one of their foremost doctrines which make the people loose all sight of thrift and more thrift. Such is the spirit of the young men and women there today. The majority of them are making all efforts to get into San Domingo and Cuba and America and taking ships to nowhere, trying to solve the problem.⁴ One of the islands had a riot not so long ago, "through striking for b[et]ter wages," in which marines were called in to quell them.⁵

Even the very schools that were once run by the churches, and are now taken over by the government, are being closed one by one. And such notable reading books as Blakie's "Tropical Reader" and "Royal Star Reader," etc., are substituted with little fairy tale books or nancy [anancy] stories,⁶ as they are called. We are compelled to make a plea for those islands, for but a few hand-picked Englishmen hold the wealth of the place and offices at the head of affairs here and there, while the majority of the population are Negroes. And I say if England does not do something definite to ameliorate such conditions in those islands she might wake up one fine morning finding the devil more welcome there than the Union Jack.

R. HODGE
An Antiguan

Printed in *NW*, 19 March 1921.

1. This could be R. H. Hodge who was recorded as one of the delegates to the 1920 UNIA convention. R. H. Hodge also signed his name to UNIA Declaration of Rights of the Negro People of the World launched in New York on 13 August 1920 (*MGP* 2: 682).

2. Rural laborers in Antigua lived primarily in the independent villages established there after 1835. The black ex-slaves, independently or with the assistance of the Moravian church, purchased land from the government and from those planters willing to sell. By 1842 there were 27 independent villages scattered throughout the island, containing 1,037 houses and approximately 3,600 inhabitants. Their descendants continued to live in houses built on family land (Douglas Hall, *Five of the Leewards, 1834-1870* [Aylesbury, Bucks.: Ginn & Co., 1971], pp. 43-45).

3. Plots of estate land were let to estate laborers as provision grounds by the estate proprietors, but the lack of security of tenure led to frequent disputes. After 1916 the government acquired several abandoned estates which were turned into land settlement projects. Some of these, like Skerrets and Clare Hall estates, were close to the capital town, St. Johns. Small cultivators did take advantage of the increased access to land and, by 1919, were supplying 2,733 tons of sugarcane to the Antigua Sugar Factory, out of a total of 90,156 tons purchased by the factory that year (*AM*, 26 February 1940).

4. Large-scale emigration to the Dominican Republic and Cuba to work on American-owned sugar plantations began in earnest after World War I. Migration rates for the island of Antigua were not included in the *Leeward Islands Blue Book* until the early 1920s. Annual registered emigration increased from 1,823 persons in 1923 to 2,136 by 1925. Emigration rates began to decline gradually from this point as employment opportunities for emigrants to the Dominican Republic and Cuba closed in response to the global economic depression. By 1931 the annual rate had fallen to 1,336. The official rates only showed registered emigration and underestimated actual or unofficial emigration rates (*LIBB*, 1923-1931; Patrick E. Bryan, "The Question of Labor in the Sugar Industry of the Dominican Republic in the Late Nineteenth and Early Twentieth Centuries," in *Between Slav-*

ery and Free Labor: The Spanish-Speaking Caribbean in the Nineteenth Century, ed. Manuel Moreno Fraginals, Frank Moya Pons, and Stanley L. Engerman [Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press, 1985], pp. 235–251; Bonham Richardson, *Caribbean Migrants: Environment and Human Survival on St. Kitts and Nevis* [Knoxville: University of Tennessee Press, 1983]).

5. The 1918 general strike and labor riot arose out of the attempt by the Antigua Sugar Planters Association, the representative organization of the sugar estate proprietors, and the Antigua Sugar Factory, the largest of the two sugar factories in the island, to enforce a new system of wage payment island-wide. The new system, which was already employed on a minority of estates owned by the Antigua Sugar Factory, called for payment according to the tonnage of cane cut instead of by the line, or row of canes cut, as had previously prevailed. The sparseness of the 1918 sugar crop, due to prolonged drought, led estate workers to reject the new system of payment and caused an island-wide work stoppage. Payment by the ton was widely regarded as a ruse by the planters to reduce already depressed wages. Meanwhile, as the acting governor of the Leeward Islands colony noted, “the very large profits made by the owners of sugar estates in the Leeward Islands since 1915 could not escape the labourers, while the prices of their food and clothing were rising beyond all expectation” (Best to Long, 28 March 1918, TNA: PRO CO 152/359/108353). “No payment by the ton” became the rallying cry of the dissatisfied laborers and, in February 1918, strikes broke out on most of the estates on which payment by the ton was an innovation. The planters responded by taking workers before the courts for breach of contract. Crowds of 400 to 500 laborers surrounded the magistrates courts where these cases were being held, forcing the postponement of the hearings. Large cane fires were set on several estates on the outskirts of the capital, St. Johns. Labor discontent was most intense in the capital town and involved a wide section of the urban labor force with leadership being provided principally by port workers.

The working-class leaders of the urban unrest were two porters from the urban port community of the Point, George Weston and Joseph Collins (a.k.a. “Willie Dean”), and two estate laborers also from the Point, John Furlong and “Sonny” Price. This George Weston has been identified in the past with the Garveyite leader, Rev. George Auesby Weston, but the available evidence proves this to be inaccurate. However, Rev. George Auesby Weston of Greenbay was related to the large family of Westons that lived in the Point, and the two George Westons were most likely cousins. George Weston of the Point has received an unflattering portrait from S. A. Henry, who writes that “George Weston (alias Fowl) [was] a strong fellow and a bully, and was feared by almost all of his fellow workers. He was also an inebriate and seldom sober” (S. A. Henry, “Riot in Antigua, 1918” in *Antigua and Barbuda: 1834 to 1984, from Bondage to Freedom: 150th Anniversary of Emancipation*, ed. Ralph Prince [St. Johns, Antigua: Antigua Printing and Publishing Ltd., 1984], p. 40), though this portrait clashes with accounts given of Weston’s conduct during the workers protest, suggesting that Weston’s personal bearing deteriorated sharply after 1918.

The workers protests reached a peak when, on 8 March 1918, Weston, Collins, Furlong, and Price, followed by a crowd of estate workers, successfully impeded the efforts of the security forces to extinguish three extensive cane fires on Gambles estate, a sugar estate on the outskirts of St. Johns. One of the fires was set within one hundred feet of Government House, the governor’s residence. Thirty-three acres of cane were destroyed that night. The attempt by the police to arrest Weston the following morning, Saturday, 9 March, was foiled by an angry crowd who surrounded the police and rescued the strike leader. However, the police were subsequently successful in seizing Weston, along with Collins and Furlong, later that day, sparking a major riot in the town. Weston and Collins were immediately court-martialed and undertook their own defense. None of the witnesses alleged that Weston had threatened or in any other way harmed them and no other evidence was provided to prove him guilty of any other offence. He was acquitted. Collins was, however, found guilty and sentenced to six months imprisonment with hard labor. The Antigua Defence Force, comprised largely of white merchants and planters, quelled the riot with bayonet charges, a charge on the crowd by the mounted infantry, and the selective shooting of rioters. Furlong, who had escaped custody and joined the riot, was shot dead. Another laborer from the Point, James Brown, was also killed. Fifteen persons, including four women, were wounded. Order was fully restored in the island with the assistance of troops from the Canadian Artillery stationed in St. Lucia, who were landed by a British warship, H.M.S. *Eileen*, two days later on 11 March. After the riot, the streets leading from the Point area to the police station were covered with stones that were found to amount to between two and three tons in weight after they were removed and weighed by the city commissioners. According to the chief of police, “threats to burn the town were freely made use of by persons of the rioter class” during the riot and on the following day (Bell to Acting

Colonial Secretary, 21 March 1918, enc., Best to Long, 28 March 1918, TNA: PRO CO 152/358/108353).

The colonial authorities believed the leadership of the UUU to be, if not the direct authors of the strike and riot, largely to blame for creating the conditions that led to the unrest. Chief Inspector Bell observed that, for several months before the riot in Antigua, "threats of what should be done to white people were commonly heard being used by black men and women of the labouring class, and there was general sulkiness in the demeanor of the people of the class indicated." He blamed these developments on the leaders of the UUU and cautioned that "the mischievous racial propaganda preached by the leaders . . . was a contributing cause of much force to the recent disorders in Antigua" (Bell to Acting Colonial Secretary, 21 March 1918) (Leonard Martin, born 1897, of Upper Gambles, Antigua, interviewed by Glen Richards, 9 May 1981; "Rex vs. George Western [sic] and Joseph Collins: Proceedings," enc., Best to Long, 28 March 1918, TNA: PRO CO 152/358/108353; "Father of Antiguan Liberation," *Outlet*, 26 May–9 June 1977; Glen Richards, "Friendly Societies and Labour Organisation in the Leeward Islands, 1912–19," in *Before and After 1865: Education, Politics and Regionalism in the Caribbean*, ed. B. Moore and S. Wilmot [Kingston, Jamaica: Ian Randle Publications, 1998], pp. 146–148; Paget Henry, *Peripheral Capitalism and Underdevelopment in Antigua* [New Brunswick: Transaction Books, 1985], pp. 82–83).

6. A reference to the stories of the spider Anancy/Anansi, the trickster figure in West African and Caribbean folklore. The Anancy/Anansi tales originated among the Ashanti people of Ghana and spread from West Africa through the entire Caribbean area (Donald Haase, *The Greenwood Encyclopedia of Folktales and Fairy Tales* [Westport, Conn.: Greenwood, 2008], s.v. "Anansi"; Emily Zobel Marshall, *Anansi's Journey: A Story of Jamaican Cultural Resistance* [Kingston, Jamaica: Univ. of the West Indies Press, 2012]).

"A Bermudian" to the *Negro World*

[[*New York*, March 24, 1921]]

GREAT BRITAIN AND HER COLONIES

Dear Sir—

I will try again to get a line to the Negro public through your paper, but it seems just as easy for me to get through *The Negro World* as it is to get a line into the N.Y. Times.

Referring to "An Antiguan," which appeared last week, I would like to say that Great Britain is daily bringing down the wrath of her most loyal colonies against her. As we all know, King George is not to blame; he is merely a figurehead, but the powers that be are the culprits to reckon with.

The well-known curse of this U.S.A. is all that keeps the American colonies of European governments from becoming United States territories. With such hyphenates as Winston Spencer Churchill¹ as Secretary of the Colonies we need not expect anything. Who could expect anything from the greatest Negro hater in the British Empire, next to Smuts² and a few other Boers?

A BERMUDIAN

Printed in *NW*, 2 April 1921.

1. Sir Winston Leonard Spencer Churchill (1874–1965) was colonial secretary from February 1921 until October 1922 (Jeremy Murray-Brown, *Kenya* [New York: E. P. Dutton, 1973], p. 102).

2. Jan Christiaan Smuts (1870–1950) was prime minister of South Africa from 1919 to 1924 and from 1939 to 1948. He was responsible for drafting an article of the 1902 peace treaty concluding the South African War, which left the question of the African franchise to be settled by the white minority “after the introduction of self-government” (*Parliamentary Papers*, 1902, Cd. 1284, p. 12). He was also the architect of the discriminatory regulations of the 1911 Mines and Works Act, which reserved thirty-two job categories exclusively for whites. In a 1917 speech in London, Smuts warned against arming Africans in European conflicts and defended South Africa’s policy of keeping Africans “apart as much as possible in our institutions, in land ownership, in forms of government, and in many ways” (*Times* [London], 23 May 1917). In 1920 he piloted the Native Affairs Act, which helped keep Africans out of parliament by creating a Native Affairs Commission and local councils in the African reserves. That same year, he inaugurated a “don’t hesitate to shoot” policy against striking African workers in Port Elizabeth that led to the killing of more than twenty people. Smuts was also responsible for enacting the Natives (Urban Areas) Act of 1923, which legalized compulsory segregation and instituted the registration of all labor contracts in urban areas (H. J. Simons and R. E. Simons, *Class and Colour in South Africa, 1850–1930* [Harmondsworth, England: Penguin Books, 1969], pp. 174, 251, 315; *DAHB*).

E. H. Hope Williams, General Secretary,
UNIA Jobabo,¹ Cuba, Division, in the *Negro
World*

[[Oriente de Cuba,
ca. 26 March 1921]]

THE U.N.I.A. ALMOST ENCIRCLES ISLAND OF CUBA

STRONG BRANCH FORMED IN JOBABO,
ORIENTE DE CUBA, BY FIELD WORKERS

Arriving by the 8.30 train from Camaguey on Thursday, February 24, the energetic field workers went to have a night’s rest at the Hotel Palacio, to awake on Friday morning to start announcing the meeting of the U.N.I.A. and Black Star Line to be held at 7.30 p.m. at one of the business corners of the town. Having interviewed the *teniente* and the *alcalde*,² permission was granted and a placard with red letters was stuck up reading in Spanish and English, inviting one and all to come to hear the good news of the Universal Negro Improvement Association at the hour prescribed. There were over 500 persons gathered, Cubans, Haytians and other West Indians, and a few Canadians. The opening ode, “From Greenland’s Icy Mountains,” etc., was sung and the prayer of the constitution was offered by Dr. S. P. Radway. Professor Davidson³ read the first four articles of the constitution and then in Spanish outlined the aims and objects of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and the Black Star Line, which was listened to with much interest by the Cubans. He then introduced the doctor as the speaker of the evening, who took for his address: “Men and Brethren, What Must We Do to Save Africa?” This gentleman spared no pains to show what Africa was, is and shall be. Many of his hearers were astounded, especially whites, when he expounded the ancient glories of Africa

hundreds of years before the birth of the Master Jesus, and he predicted that in thirty years or more, Africa must be free so as to feed and clothe the world, and, more, to teach the nations civilization—we shall cause them to beat their swords into pruning hooks, hang their trumpets on the wall and study war no more. In the midst of his speech, a Canadian as was told interrupted and wanted to prove that there were not 400,000,000 Negroes alive as was said by the doctor. The speaker then explained that if the boys and girls of the Negro race of fourteen years or less were to be counted, there would be over 500,000,000 Negroes alive. (Great applause.) When silence prevailed, the doctor continued and as the words of wisdom came from his lips, as in his real entreaty for men and more men to support the U.N.I.A., he told plainly he had no power to receive any monies for the U.N.I.A. but was simply a volunteer field worker to advise how to handle the situation as there were many trappers on the path of this great movement, his words were appreciated. Professor Davidson then spoke again i[n] English, thanking them for listening so attentively and announced that on the morrow eve another meeting will be held, when he expected to see a larger gathering.

Precisely on the morrow at the hour appointed another large crowd gathered to hear the story of the U.N.I.A., as many of them in this district never heard the name of the U.N.I.A. He took the chair again and outlined the aims and objects of the Association, and pointed out that it is better to die fighting for something than to die starving for nothing, and that the time had come to do or die. He spoke for nearly three-quarters of an hour, when he again introduced his co-worker the Doctor, who took for his subject: "They Call Us to Deliver Our Lands from Errors' Chain."⁴ Words cannot convey the zeal and enthusiasm shown by this gentleman, but he hoped in closing that in 25 years more we shall travel around the world as tourists and have a bite of all the continents as black millionaire. (Great applause.)

Professor Davidson then promised that Sunday night must be the proudest night in the history of Jobabo, as arrangements were being made to secure the spacious down floor of the Hotel Palaci[o] for the event as the kind owner, a Cuban, had kindly consented to loan the hall always till a suitable place is got, which will be known as the Jobabo Liberty Hall. Sunday night's meeting will live long in the memory of all Jobabo. Then the kindness of Mr. and Mrs. Haldane, who lent their parlor organ, which greatly added to the night's event. The doctor formed a choir at once, and the program was arranged, as follows:

At the hour of 7.30 the spacious floor was jammed to the limit and Professor Davidson took the chair and called the meeting to order by the sound of the gavel. The African ode, "From Greenland's Icy Mountains," was sung, which sounded in the town as the voices of many waters. Prayer was offered by the doctor, whose rose from the organ and pronounced a prayer that would lend color to St. Paul's Cathedral. All was still and the evening ceremony began.

Address by Mr. Williamson, now first vice-president of the division.

Solo, Miss May, "Nearer My God to Thee."

Special chorus, Misses Adams, Thompson and others, "Ethiopia, Thou Land of Our Fathers."

Address and Solo by Mr. Campbell, "Strike for Victory."

Full chorus by the house, "Lead, Kindly Light."

Address by the Chair, "Conscientious Workers."

Solo, Miss Morgan, the nightingale of Jobabo, "Onward, Upward."

Address by the doctor, "'Twill Not Be Long Our Journey Here."

Special solo, Miss Adams, Jobabo special.

Solo, Mrs. Haldane, now first lady vice-president.

Full chorus, "We Shall Meet on That Beautiful Shore."

This brought us to the second part of the program. The chair gave fifteen minutes for the enrollment of members, etc., when fully fifty or more were enrolled, collections taken up. The Black Star Line song composed by Dr. Radway was next sung, which was encored although an old tune (one can judge why).

The election of officers for the division was next: Mr. W. S. Jones and wife, presidents; Mr. Williams and Mrs. Haldane, first vice-presidents; Mrs. Francis, second vice-president; Mr. L. Haldane, treasurer; Mr. S. Williams and Miss Z. Adams, general secretaries; Mr. Corbin, chaplain; Mr. S. Darby, chairman of the honorary advisory board; Mr. J. Campbell, assistant secretary. The chairman then called upon the doctor to address the newly installed officers. He said in part:

You are called upon to assist to carry out the program and so help bear the great strain that is now on his Excellency the Hon. Marcus Garvey, as Africa expects every man to do his duty. To this all the officers pledge their support. Much credit is due to many friends and well-wishers of Jobabo, and special mention must be made of the honorable gentleman, Mr. J. R. Bullard, general manager of the Jobabo Sugar Company, who is a friend of the Negro. Wishing the Jobabo division a long life, which is in a very fertile field, and hoping that the good friends will continue to support the great cause, the redemption of Africa, I remain, Yours ever in the work,

E. H. HOPE WILLIAMS

General Secretary Jobabo U.N.I.A.

Printed in *NW*, 26 March 1921.

1. In 1917 Cuban soldiers had murdered seventeen British West Indian immigrants in the town of Jobabo. The massacre occurred during the armed uprising known as "La Chambelona" or the "February Revolution," which actually took place during the first week of April, when supporters of the Liberal Party protested the fraudulent reelection of Conservative president Mario García Menocal (who was known as Menocal). Eyewitness accounts agreed that no Afro-Caribbean immigrants in Jobabo had participated in the uprising. The commanding officer of the Jobabo incident, Captain Julio Cadenas, a close friend of Menocal, was acquitted in the case. The Cuban government eventually paid the families of eleven of the murdered men \$3,285 each in 1921, after four years of diplomatic correspondence (TNA: PRO FO 371/2923; Godfrey Haggard to Lord Curzon, Havana, 12 September 1921, TNA: PRO FO 371/5563; "Cuba. Annual Report, 1921," TNA: PRO FO 371/7214. The only coherent story of the "Jobabo Incident" is to be found in Jorge L. Giovan-

netti, "Black British Subjects in Cuba: Race, Ethnicity, Nation, and Identity in the Migratory Experience, 1898–1938" [Ph.D. diss.: Univeristy of North London, 2001], pp. 69–110).

2. "Teniente" and "alcalde" refer to the local military lieutenant and mayor, respectively.

3. "Professor" Dave Davidson traveled with Radway to UNIA organizing meetings in Cuba from March through May 1921. He delivered speeches in English and Spanish, often introducing Radway to audiences. In 1919 Davidson was vice president of the UNIA in St. Thomas, Virgin Islands (*MGP* 3: 425).

4. The words are taken from the opening stanza of the UNIA's official hymn, *From Greenland's Icy Mountains*, viz.,

From Greenland's icy mountains, from India's coral strand;
Where Afric's sunny fountains roll down their golden sand:
From many an ancient river, from many a palmy plain,
They call us to deliver their land from error's chain.

Percy Bryan in the *Negro World*

[[290 W. 137th St., N.Y.C.,
ca. 26 March 1921]]

WILL WHITE CUBANS SUPPORT THE NEGRO'S PROGRAM FOR A FREE AFRICA?

As a member of the New York Local Division of the U.N.I.A., I am answering the following question: Has the Negro any right to expect any moral or financial support from the Cubans in the program for a free and independent "Africa and Africans, at home and abroad"?

History ascribes to the Negro no small part of the sacrifice made for Cuban deliverance from Spanish ty[rann]y. Both as a slave and as a free man his sympathies were with the insurgents. Of the thirty thousand Cubans under arms, two-fifths were Negroes. Of all leaders produced by the Cuban war, the most imposing figure, the man the Spaniards most dreaded, was Antonio Maceo, a Negro. His fall by Spanish bullets was greeted by the enemy with indescribable joy, while men throughout the civilized world felt instinctively that the Cuban cause had lost its mightiest chieftain and the loftiest source of its inspiration.

In the war for Cuba, the American Negro impressed civilization with both his ability as a soldier and his worth as a man. The Eighth Illinois Infantry¹ had only Negro officers from the colonel down. Every Negro soldier, no matter what rank, honored himself and America on Cuban soil.

If it had not been for Negro troops the Rough Riders would have been exterminated. The former, fighting desperately without their officers, most of whom had been killed or wounded in the early part of the engagement, saved the battle and won the day. The Twenty-fourth Infantry² lost every one of its officers before the conflict was over, four regimental captains being knocked over in a minute and a lieutenant-colonel severely wounded. The Twenty-

fourth bore the brunt of the battle around Santiago, the Spaniards directing their main attacks upon them, on the theory that the Negroes would not or could not stand the punishment. The Twenty-fifth Infantry³ shared with the white men the honor and losses incident to capturing the old stone fort at El Caney and in the charge up San Juan Hill the black troops fought their way into the hearts of the civilized world. It is for us to remember and bless forever!

We are entitled to the Cubans' moral and financial support. Yours faithfully,

PERCY BRYAN

Printed in NW, 26 March 1921.

1. The Eighth Illinois Infantry was a volunteer black military unit under a full slate of black officers that performed garrison duty in Cuba in 1898. Mustered into federal service in July 1898 and arriving in Cuba in mid-August with 1,195 enlisted men, the regiment was stationed near the towns of San Luis and Palma Soriano, in the vicinity of Santiago de Cuba, until early 1899. As with other black soldiers who saw duty in Cuba, members of the Eighth Illinois expressed some degree of ambivalence toward their involvement in what was an imperialist undertaking. On the one hand, many participated in the hopes of gaining respect for blacks at home amidst the increasingly repressive and violent racial climate in the United States. "If we fail the whole race will have to shoulder the burden," declared a colonel in the regiment. On the other hand, most African Americans sympathized with the populations of Cuba, Puerto Rico, and the Philippines, each with a large percentage of people of color, in their struggles for independence, and feared that they were helping to bring U.S.-style racism to these countries (Willard B. Gatewood, Jr., *"Smoked Yankees" and the Struggle for Empire* [Urbana: University of Illinois Press, 1971], pp. 1-6, 10-11, 181-182, 186).

2. The Twenty-fourth Infantry was one of four black regiments of the regular U.S. Army, along with the Twenty-fifth Infantry and the Ninth and Tenth Cavalry, that had been formed soon after the end of the Civil War and that saw action in Cuba in 1898. Under the command of white officers, these troops encountered the racism of whites while stationed in Tampa, Florida, awaiting embarkation for Cuba at the end of June. The Twenty-fourth Infantry took part in the battle of Las Guásimas and the assault on Spanish positions atop San Juan Hill in early July 1898. In mid-July 1899, members of the Twenty-fourth and the other regular black units were sent to put down the independence movement in the Philippines (Gatewood, Jr., *Smoked Yankees*, pp. 6, 13, 21-22, 43, 60, 65-71, 240).

3. The soldiers of the Twenty-fifth Infantry were among the first U.S. troops to arrive at El Caney on 1 July 1898; they played a crucial role in the victory over Spanish forces there (Gatewood, Jr., *Smoked Yankees*, pp. 42-43, 55-57).

Article in the *Negro World*

[Ciego de Ávila,¹ Cuba,
28 March, 1921]

THE U.N.I.A. IN CUBA

To the Editor, *Negro World*:

Dear Sir:-Allow me a space in your valuable paper to insert one small report, which is as follows:

The Ciego de Avila Division No. 78, pioneer of all the present branches to be found in the province of Camaguey, Cuba, was organized in May, 1920. But through the negligence of a few of its officers, this branch had to be reorganized on the 4th of March, 1921, by the Hon. Arnold Cuning, under orders of the Hon. Chaplain General Dr. McGuire.

I am pleased to be able to report the start of the reorganized branch No. 78 is everything to be desired, as the drones were thrown out of the hive and only working bees are to be found therein.

We have got men at the head of our association who are like unto our honorable head, Marcus Garvey, Provisional President of Africa.

The president of Branch No. 78 is Mr. A.O. Christie, a man that knows no fear, one that cannot be insulted for the Negro's cause, a man that pays no attention to the everyday talk of life, "What can the Negro do?" but stands with the firm belief in the redemption of the fatherland, Africa.

Mr. C.E. Stewart, our vice-president, cannot be less spoken of, as there exists no difference between him and our honorable Marcus Garvey for the Negro's cause.

In our ladies' division we have got women who are untiring in their efforts of doing good and everything that lies within their jurisdiction for the uplift of the race. Among them are the Lady President, Mrs. Matilda Eaves who spares no pains in doing everything for her branch of No. 78, for when all hope was lost she implored the Hon. Chaplain General Dr. McGuire to visit the Liberty Hall of Branch No. 78, and that visit brought back life to the dead roots that were scattered from the branch, and today Branch No. 78 can boast of having everything desirable for the prosperity of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L.

The following are the officers: Male- A.O. Christie, president; C.E. Stewart, vice-president; Jas. McLymont, treasurer; J.P. Christian, secretary; T.H.O. Osborne, chaplain; James Boyce, chairman advisory board; Eustace Faves, secretary board of trustees, Ladies- Mrs. Matilda Eaves, lady president; Mrs. Rhoda McLymont, vice-president; Miss Annie Sievwright, secretary; Mrs. Matilda Abrams, assistant treasurer; Mrs. Naomi Osborne, trustee.

Our Liberty Hall is to be found in Calle Fernando Callejas, Barrio Maidique, Ciego, but communications must be sent to our executive secretary at Republic No. 44, Ciego.

On Sunday the 27th, we had a concert as the opening of the new hall, which was transferred from the upper floor of the building to the lower one, where we can have a better time dancing etc., the upper floor being dedicated to lodge purposes.

The promoters of our concert, Messrs Jas Boyce and A.R. Lord, are to be especially thanked for the energetic way they went to business, showing the spirit of the new Negro, making good a concert with three nights' practice.

We must also thank Misses Gordon and Burton, who entertained us nicely, especially Miss Gordon, who took the hall by storm when she recited, "Ye Men of Africa," and sang a solo.

MARCH 1921

Our choir under Mr. A.P. Lord and Mr. Jas Boyce, with such men and women as Messrs Taylor, Williams, Duveral and Chaplain Osborne, Mrs. Ivy, Mrs. Abrams, Mrs. Edwards and Miss Moore, are to be thanked and encouraged as having the spirit of the new Negro and exercising it thus in trying to entertain the public of Ciego de Avila.

Printed in NW, 23 April, 1921.

1. Ciego de Ávila is a city in the central part of Cuba and the capital of Ciego de Ávila province; it is 290 miles east of Havana and 68 miles west of the city of Camagüey. It was part of Camagüey province until 1976, when Ciego de Ávila was made the capital of the newly created Ciego de Ávila province.

Memorandum by Captain Guy Johannes, Chief, Panama Canal Zone Police and Fire Division

Balboa Heights, March 29, 1921

MEMORANDUM FOR FILE

With reference to the instructions issued by the Governor of the Panama Canal under date of September 27, 1919, excluding Marcus Garvey, negro, from landing on the Canal Zone:

It is now considered that the reasons existing at the time the exclusion order was issued no longer exist, and that it is not necessary to exclude Garvey from the Canal Zone at the present time.¹

GUY JOHANNES
Chief, Police & Fire Division

DNA, RG 185, PCC-28-B-233, Part 1. TD.

1. This change of heart was probably related to the fact that the UFC provided Garvey with transportation and facilitated his tour by giving workers the day off and a cash advance on their wages.

APRIL 1921

Article in the *Workman*

[Panama City, 2 April 1921]

HON. MARCUS GARVEY IN JAMAICA

GIVEN BIG RECEPTION BY U.N.I.A. & A.C.L.

MAKES FAMOUS SPEECHES TO MONSTER CROWDS

From recent issues of the *Gleaner*¹ we reproduce the following *inter alia* about the arrival of Marcus Garvey at Jamaica and his famous speeches in the Collegiate Hall and Ward Theatre:—

Dressed in a dark brown palm beach suit, with a Panama hat, and wearing on his vest the insignia of his office, Mr. Garvey, President of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, and the acclaimed leader in the United States of America of the coloured race, arrived here yesterday afternoon from Santiago on the s.s. *La Belle Sauvage* of Messrs. Lindsay Swan Hunter Ltd. Cuba-Jamaica service.

It was thought that Mr. Garvey was coming on the Black Star Line steamer, *Antonio Maceo*, and so when the good ship *La Belle Sauvage* swung alongside Mr. Frank Lyons's Mark Lane Pier, there were no representatives of the U.N.I.A. present. There was however on the pier the usual wharf staff and a few Waterpolicemen, as also Depot Inspector O'Sullivan, whose alertness on the waterfront must have drawn him hither. There was a slight breeze on and the vessel was a little time in docking. Mr. Garvey stood on the upper deck and soon recognized one or two old acquaintances to whom he extended a hearty salutation. Then there arrived Mr. Adrian Daley, the Secretary of the local branch of the Association with one or two other office bearers.

In an interview with a *Gleaner* representative who boarded the ship immediately on docking Mr. Garvey stated that he expected to remain in Jamaica about nine days during which time he would visit various parts of the country and deliver addresses.

Continuing Mr. Garvey said "I would have come over on the Black Star Line steamer, but it was late in reaching Santiago and as I had to keep my appointment here I came over on this vessel accompanied by one of my Secretaries Mr. Jacques. Miss Vinton Davis will be here on the vessel in the course of a few days."

"How did you get along in Cuba, Mr. Garvey?" asked the pressman.

"Well, I had a very grand reception in Cuba. I was received on my arrival at Havana by President Menocal, members of the Government and members of the Municipality. I went from Havana into the interior—on the estates where there were thousands of Jamaican labourers on the cane farms. I spent about ten days there and I spoke with them. I need hardly say I had a very warm reception from them and the cause which I am advocating received their heart-

iest support. As I had said I had a rather rough voyage and I should like to have a little rest to recuperate."

On Tuesday, the 22nd, Garvey spoke at a welcome meeting by the U.N.I.A. held in the Collegiate Hall, which was crowded to its seating and standing capacity.

In reply to an address of welcome by Mr. Adrian Daley, Secretary of the Association, Mr. Garvey replied in part as follows:—

MR. GARVEY'S REPLY

Mr. Garvey on rising to reply, was greeted with clamorous applause. "Mr. President," he said, his voice reverberating through the hall, "Members and friends of the Universal Negro Improvement Association:

"It is indeed a pleasure for me to find myself once more in the beautiful island of Jamaica." Continuing, he said he left this country between 4½ and 5 years ago for the United States. He went there primarily for the purpose of seeking aid for the Jamaica Division of the U.N.I.A. to build an industrial school after the pattern of Tuskegee in the southern part of the U.S.A., but on arriving in America he received an unwelcome response from the Jamaicans and West Indians who lived in the city of New York. He left the city of New York and travelled through 5 or 6 of the States for the same object. He met other West Indians who discouraged him in the idea of receiving help in the United States to build an industrial institution for Negroes in Jamaica. He was forced, therefore, to change his object. Nevertheless, he was deeply interested in the development of the Negro. He saw before him in America then a grave problem, and immediately went into a sociological study of conditions of the Negro in the United States, which caused him to travel through thirty-eight of the States. He lectured in some of the churches, passed on from place to place, returning to New York in the latter part of 1917 with the intention of coming back to Jamaica. But just at that time something happened that caused him to render certain assistance and he gladly gave it. Immediately after that assistance was rendered, he found out that the people there desired for him a longer stay in New York. He was, therefore, encouraged to start the U.N.I.A. and he assembled 13 men and women in the city of New York in 1917, and founded the New York Division of this Association (Cheers). Thirteen members under his leadership grew into six hundred in the space of one month. In the space of six months it improved into a membership of 10,000, in the space of three years they had grown into a membership of 35,000 in the city of New York. The Association he started in New York four years ago had now a membership of four millions. (Cheers).

Seven hundred branches were scattered all over South and Central America, the West Indies, in every State of North America and the continent of Africa. He found it impossible, therefore to return immediately to Jamaica, for his work was laid out for him in the city of New York. He was elected permanently President of the New York Organisation as well as the International

Organiser of the movement. He travelled through the 48 States of America and organised branches, and now they had 2,000,000 members in the United States. The Organisation had grown by leaps and bounds and that night he was there, not representing the American Organisation or the West Indies or the South or Central American Organisations, but an International Movement of Negroes. (Applause). He was here not speaking to them as a British born subject, but as a citizen of Africa. He had to thank them for their address of welcome. He was commissioned by the High Executive Council of his Organisation to go to Africa—to go to Liberia to lay out there certain plans for the redemption of their Motherland. But prior to taking that journey, he thought that he would pay his island home a visit for the last time; hence in mapping out the Central America and West Indian tour, he included the island of Jamaica. Before he left New York, 35,000 members of that division asked him not to visit Jamaica because of certain rumours they heard—rumours [to?] the understanding that the British Government regarded him as a disloyal subject—as a seditionist and that should he arrive in Jamaica certain things would happen. He could not really understand why such a rumour should be abroad because he had never been disloyal to any government in his life. (Cheers). He had no time to be disloyal to Governments. (Uproarious applause). All his time, every minute of his life, every second of his life was given to the glorious and grand cause for the redemption of Africa (Cheers). On the 13th of August last year, 25,000 Delegates, representing the negro people of the world (four hundred millions of them) elected him as the First Provisional President of Africa.

That job and that responsibility was given him and he would not shirk it. Africa, the land that God Almighty gave them, was robbed and despoiled by the nations of the world and shall be redeemed by the four hundred million Negroes in the world. In saying so, he meant no disrespect or any discourtesy to any nation, to any race, but any nation or any race that desired to take it as such, they were welcome to it. There were four hundred million Negroes in the world—they robbed four million of them from Africa 300 years ago; they brought them in slavery to the Western Hemisphere; when the matter was brought before Queen Elizabeth it was represented that the Negroes were taken for civilising and Christianising them. After 300 years if they were civilised and Christianised, they would use that same civilization and Christianisation—

(Here the applause was so great that the last words of the sentence [were] not distinctly heard.)

After the appla[u]se had subsided, Mr. Garvey said, in thanking them for the address of welcome they would understand that he had come to Jamaica not for the purpose of stirring up discord among the races in the island. He came here to speak to the Negro and to unify the hundreds of Negroes who lived in this country. He realised there were many races living in Jamaica—they had the white race, the yellow race, and the black race—who had lived in peace for so long. He did not come here to create any disturbance, but for the purpose of speaking to his people.

No power of hell or on earth could stop him from speaking to them. By accident he was born in this country, not through any choice of his or of his father or mother, who by some slave master, years and years ago, brought his foreparents into this country, causing him to have been born here and not in Africa. If he had the choice of birth, his choice would have been Africa, but since he was born here by accident (laughter), he believed he had the right of speaking in this country as any man born in this country or came to this country. The President and officers of the Kingston U.N.I.A. would understand that the Association had nothing to apologise for or compromise. This was a movement made up of men and women who gained a new birth out of the last world war. All races and nations fought for freedom and democracy and liberty in the last world war and two million negroes from America, the West Indies and Africa were drawn into the war; [t]hey fought most nobly and splendidly in France, Flanders and Mesopotamia and after the war they were pushed back. But the U.N.I.A. said they shall not stay back, but go forward (cheers). He came to them not as a Jamaican, he came to them as a Negro interested in negro humanity everywhere (cheers). "I cannot understand why they should say I am disloyal," he said. "I have never been disloyal to any government in the world. I am more than loyal, first of all to this race of mine because, by God! if there is a race which needs loyalty, it is the Negro Race." In coming to Jamaica he was not scared, he was a negro that could not be scared, he refused to be scared. He believed in the grand and noble utterance of Theodore Roosevelt, "Fear God, and you have no need for fear,"² (cheers). He was out in the world to meet all men of human equality, whether you were white or yellow or black, if you were a man he respected you, because you were created in the image of God Almighty. And he believed that the white man was entitled to certain rights and privileges, the yellow man was entitled to certain rights and privileges, and he believed the black man was also entitled to certain rights and privileges. So they would understand him well: he did not come to Jamaica to stir up strife, the State of Jamaica was too small a place for him. (Cheers.) He was just wasting time here. They would understand why they said he was disloyal. He was not only President General of the U.N.I.A., but they had given him the biggest political job in the world—Provisional President of Africa and he had to speak at times in the interest of his republic, and if in speaking in the interest of his republic he displeased other statesmen, it was not his fault. Warren Harding, the President of the United States had to speak for his Government. Clemenceau of France had to speak for his, and why should not he speak for us? (Cheers). All he was concerned with were politics and economy. He was interested in the economic development of the Negro, that was why they had the Black Star Line; their social and moral growth, and that was why he was interested in the U.N.I.A. He had three jobs—President of an industrial corporation[,] President General of a social and moral movement and Provisional President of a big republic, and sometimes he had to speak differently. When he was making a political speech he made no apologies, when he was speaking of

industry it was a different talk. He was not there that night to speak, the next night he would speak to the citizens of Kingston, and he welcomed white citizens, colored citizens and black citizens. He welcomed His Excellency the Governor, he welcomed everybody, and if they were coming to hear him speak sedition they would be mistaken. (Cheers.) He was going to speak on his work and responsibility, and he hoped to meet them the next night. (Prolonged applause.)

Mr. Garvey's second public speech was delivered in the Ward Theatre on Wednesday night under the auspices of the Jamaica Division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League, at which Mr. Marcus Garvey, President General of the Association, was the speaker. The building was packed from [pit] to dome with an enthusiastic audience[.] Mr. Garvey was cheered to an echo as he stepped on the platform. He delivered an oration, lasting over one hour, dealing with the aims and objects of the association. His striking eloquence riv[e]d the attention of his hearers. The vast multitude caught his enthusiasm; and as he spoke the ceiling echoed and re-echoed with the thunder of their applause. Towards the end of his speech, Mr. Garvey applied the wellknown prank of the platform speaker, "I think I have kept you long enough for tonight," he said, and the crowd roared for him to continue.

The meeting opened with the hymn, "From Greenland's Icy Mountain" after which a beautiful programme of musical and vocal selections was rendered by the U.N.I.A. choir and a special orchestra. The performers who took part were Messrs. George McCormack, Granville Campbell, R. B. Evans, Prof. C. L. Barnes, Mrs. McCormack and Miss Brown. The audience showed how well they enjoyed the programme by their flattering cheers and repeated encores.

Mr. A. Bain Alves³ first addressed the gathering. He began by quoting Shakespeare's famous lines,

"To thine ownself be true,
And it must follow as the night the day,
Thou canst not then be false to any man."⁴

He paid a warm and glowing tribute to Mr. Garvey, whom he styled "the illustrious Jamaican," the great Negro Emancipator. They could not look upon Mr. Garvey, he said, as an ordinary man, they must look upon him as a superman. Mr. Garvey was called by God to the great work of lifting his race, and this he was achieving. They must support him and help the movement to success.

Mr. Garvey then spoke. He said it was indeed a great pleasure to find himself there that night. He had come from the United States of America on a tour of the West Indies and Central America for the purpose of speaking to them in the interest of the great movement he represented (cheers). The Universal Negro Improvement Association was a world movement of Negroes. They were endeavouring through this association to draw into one united

whole the four hundred million negroes of the world for the purpose of establishing in the continent of Africa a dominion of Negroes (cheers.) They believed the time had come in the history of the Negro people of the world like in the history of the White race and the Yellow race, for the Negro to pave a way and to blast a way to Negro independence. (Applause.) The U.N.I.A. believed if it was right for the white man to dominate in Europe, and the yellow man to dominate in Asia, it was right for the black man to dominate in Africa. Nations had sprung up out of Europe and Asia and the time had come for nations to spring up out of Africa. The U.N.I.A. had no apology to make to nations or races, the one desire was to blast a way for the motherland. Three hundred years ago forty million Negroes were taken from Africa, as slaves to the Western Hemisphere and the time had come for the Negro to use his civilization and Christianization to redeem the motherland (cheers.) The world in which they lived was re-organization itself. The world had just passed through a bloody war, fought on [the] sacred principle of democracy. Two million black men with white men fought for the cause, held the Germans at bay and threw them across the Rhine.⁵ But for the assistance of the negro in the war a different tale would have been told (cheers), and when the war was over all the people who fought in it demanded their share and received consideration, but the negro alone got nothing. What did they think? Did they think that the men who suffered and died, their brothers and his, in France and Flanders and Mesopotamia were going to shed their blood for nothing?

"You will understand negroes of Jamaica!" he shouted, "The world is re-organizing itself politically, and men and races and nations everywhere are clamouring for and demanding their rights. Hence the Universal Negro Improvement Association has organized itself and call upon the four hundred million negroes in the world to demand their rights. What is the matter with Jamaica? The whole world was organizing itself, Negroes everywhere were answering the call of the motherland! She was now bleeding and crying out to her children for aid and help! Negroes everywhere had answered! Are you going to answer in Jamaica?" (Cries of ["yes!"]) He continued: "I have come here to have your answer, yes or no. I have been made to understand that Jamaica is made up of cowards. Fellows are afraid to talk because they are afraid to die! Were you afraid to die in France and Flanders? Talk wherever you are! Talk for your constitutional rights! I understand there is a trembling fear in Jamaica. Trembling for what? God Almighty created you as men, as men you must die! (Applause). Are you afraid of men? I would like to see a man who dared make me afraid. You men of Jamaica, you want backbone! Take out the weak bones you have and put in backbones! Don't let anybody cow you! You have your constitutional rights! Demand them! Englishmen in England, demand their constitutional rights; Irishmen in Ireland demand their constitutional rights, throughout the whole Empire men speak for their rights! You lazy, good-for-nothing Jamaicans, wake up!" (Cheers).

In stirring language and warmly gesticulating, he almost yelled, "if for your constitutional rights, they will not hear you in Jamaica, then carry it to the foot of the Throne in England! It looks like this is a country of blind one-man rule, because in my survey of world politics and international matters

JAMAICA IS THE MOST BACKWARD COUNTRY

in this Western Hemisphere. Men dare not talk in Jamaica! What is the matter with you, men? I am glad to let you know that a change is taking place and you must join in the change now, otherwise you will lose forever. I have no respect for men who are too cowardly to demand their rights."

In an easier tone he went on, "Some have been scattering rumours that I am coming to Jamaica to stir up some sort of strife. Why so nervous about my coming here if they have done no wrong? A man with a clean conscience is ready to welcome a man and a friend at any time. I am not come to Jamaica to stir up any revolution or race strife but come to speak to the men and women and children who look like me, and I would like to see the man who would stop me do it! I never brought myself here, they brought me here, and I am here until I am ready to go (cheers). Little did they calculate 300 years ago when they robbed black men and women from Africa that black men would strike terror into their hearts to day["] (cheers).

Continuing, he asked to whom did this world belong? It belonged he said, to the Great God, the Great Architect of the Universe who created Man His Masterpiece and gave him to the world[,] the "Lord of creation[.]" He said, "Man, thou art perfect!["] God never said white men as against the privileges and rights of black men or yellow men. God said, men[!] "Are you men?["] he thundered, as he paused to wipe the perspiration from his face. "Do you still believe in the Darwin theory that man is a monkey or the missing link between the ape and man? If you think it is, that theory has been exploded in the world war. It was you, the supermen, that brought back victory at the Marne!⁶ (Cheers). If you believed yourself monkeys prior to 1914, then your achievements in the world war was such that will restore your confidence. If you are men, if you are the lords of creation, what right have you lords of creation, to allow other lords of creation, to take away what belongs to you and make slaves of you? You have as much right in the world as any other man whatever his colour. White men know their right and claim it! Here is one negro and who represents four million negroes who feel and think like me, who feel and think that we are 'lords of creation' and as the white man is exercising the jurisdiction of his over-lordship, so we are organizing negroes to exercise the jurisdiction of our over-lordship. Hence as we are willing to see Europe for the white man and Asia for the yellow man so we demand Africa for the black man." (Applause.)

(To be continued in our next)

Printed in the *Workman* (Panama City), 2 April 1921.

1. The *Workman* and other West Indian newspapers in Panama often ran articles previously published in the *Gleaner* and other Caribbean publications. As a result, the West Indians of Panama were well-informed about events in and around the Caribbean.

2. In 1916, Theodore Roosevelt (1858–1919) published a book called *Fear God and Take Your Own Part*. This book is a composite of *Metropolitan Magazine* articles that he wrote between late 1914 and early 1916, his article published in the *Wheeler Syndicate*, a paper written for the American Sociological Congress, and various speeches and public statements. The title of Roosevelt's book is a quotation from George Borrow's *The Romany Rye*; it appears on the novel's cover page, and a letter written by the main female character, Isopel Berners, repeats this phrase in the novel itself.

For Roosevelt, this quotation served as a call for patriotism and Americanism at a time when the current President of the United States, Woodrow Wilson, continued to pursue a foreign policy of nonintervention and neutrality in World War I. Indeed, Roosevelt, leading the Republicans, openly criticized Wilson's refusal to bolster the U.S. Army after a German U-boat sank the British liner RMS *Lusitania* on 7 May 1915 and 128 Americans died. Roosevelt's 1916 book repeatedly employs Borrow's phrase to promote his Americanist sentiments and his advocacy for U.S. involvement with the Allies. His conclusion states,

Fear God and take your own part! This is another way of saying that a nation must have power and will for self-sacrifice and also power and will for self-protection. There must also be both unselfishness and self-expression, each to supplement the other, neither wholly good without the other. The nation must be willing to stand out disinterestedly for a lofty ideal and yet it must also be able to insist that its own rights be heeded by others. Evil will come if it does not possess the will and the power for unselfish action on behalf of non-utilitarian ideals and also the will and power for self-mastery, self-control, self-discipline. It must possess those high and stern qualities of soul which will enable it to conquer softness and weakness and timidity and train itself to subordinate momentary pleasure, momentary profit, momentary safety to the larger future. (Theodore Roosevelt, *Fear God and Take Your Own Part* [New York: George H. Doran, 1916], p. 343)

(Lloyd E. Ambrosius, "The Great War, Americanism Revisited, and the Anti-Wilson Crusade," in *A Companion to Theodore Roosevelt*, 1st ed., ed. Serge Ricard [Malden, Mass.: Wiley-Blackwell, 2011], pp. 468–484; George Borrow, *The Romany Rye* [London: J. Murray, 1857], pp. iii, 207).

3. Bain Alves was a leading trade unionist in Jamaica. He had organized a short-lived tobacco workers union in 1907. During the war Alves had led strikes by cigar workers and longshoremen and banana carriers, incorporating previously unorganized workers in the Jamaica Federation of Labour, an affiliate of the AFL.

4. William Shakespeare, *Hamlet* [1601] act 1, scene 3.

5. Garvey is referring to the black U.S. regiment, the 369th (Fifteenth New York) Infantry, which served with considerable distinction with the French Fourth Army and 161st Divisions. Between April and August 1918, the regiment was involved in several fierce encounters with the Germans, including the assault on the Marne Bulge in August. Black sergeants, Henry Johnson and Bob Collins, earned the *croix de guerre* during this period (Arthur E. Barbeau and Florette Henri, *The Unknown Soldiers: African-American Troops in World War I* [revised ed., New York: Da Capo Press, 1996], pp. 116–119).

6. There were two Battles of the Marne during World War I. The First Battle of the Marne (also known as the Miracle of the Marne), fought between 5 and 12 September 1914, resulted in an Allied victory against the German army that effectively ended the month-long German offensive that opened the war. This victory set the stage for four years of trench warfare on the western front. The Second Battle of the Marne marked the last major German spring offensive on the western front; it was fought between 15 July and 6 August 1918. The German defeat, which culminated in the Armistice about one hundred days later, marked the beginning of the end of the Great War (Robert B. Asprey, *The First Battle of the Marne* [Philadelphia: J. B. Lippincott, 1962]; Michael S. Neiberg, *The Second Battle of the Marne* [Bloomington: Indiana Univ. Press, 2008]).

Filogenes Maillard to the *Negro World*

[[Havana, Cuba, April 7, 1921]]

AUTOCRACY IN THE DUTCH WEST INDIES

There could be no greater autocracy than that which actually exists in the Dutch West Indies which comprise the islands of Curazao, Aruba, Buen Aire [Bonaire], near the coast of Venezuela; Saba, St. Eustatius and part of the island of St. Martin in the vicinity of Virgin Islands. We may also add Dutch Guiana or Surinam on the South American continent, all of which make up a population of 155,000 souls of whose number eight-tenths are of the African race. And it is painful to state that this population is absolutely ruled by a half-dozen Hollanders who are ignorant of the needs of the people. The inhabitants of these colonies, the Negroes especially, have entirely nothing to do with the government of their respective birthplaces. But it is their fault, as they also simply pass their lives "fooling" with the Bible. They have never asked for anything, they have never petitioned her Majesty Queen Wilhemina,¹ putting before her their needs. In our opinion, if they could unite themselves they would be capable of framing their own free government.

Negro Dutch subjects should today ring out the old and ring in the new. They must cease worshipping any monarchical regime, refrain from adoring any crowned head, and adapt and proclaim republican ideals, democratic ideas, socialistic aspirations, radical reforms, popular actions, liberal methods, elective proceedings, representative methods and progressive tendencies. And until these are adopted and proclaimed they will continually be a stagnation of affairs in the Dutch possessions.

Colored Dutch subjects should realize just now that the sovereignty of the island or locality where they have been born and bred should be vested in the people and not in an unknown woman who has never been of any real service to them.

FILOGENES MAILLARD

Printed in NW, 23 April 1921.

1. Wilhelmina Helena Pauline Maria (1880-1962) of the Netherlands succeeded her father, King William II, at his passing in 1890. Her mother governed as regent in her name until 1898, when she was crowned queen. Influential in the Netherlands' position during World War I, Wilhelmina maintained a stance of pro-British neutrality. When Germany attacked the Netherlands, Wilhelmina and her family fled to London. From there, through her radio broadcasts on Radio Orange, she served as a symbol of Dutch freedom. Her conduct helped eliminate antimonarchical forces in Dutch society, and she was greatly welcomed after the war. In 1948 Wilhelmina abdicated her throne and was succeeded by her daughter Juliana. Her memoirs were published as *Eenzaam maar niet alleen* (1959; *Lonely but Not Alone*, 1960) (*Encyclopedia of World Biography*, 2nd ed., vol. 16 [Detroit: Gale, 1998], s.v. "Wilhelmina"; NEB).

Article in the *Workman*

[Panama City, 9 April 1921]

HON. MARCUS GARVEY CONTINUES TO ADDRESS

MONSTER CROWDS AT DIFFERENT PLACES IN THE ISLAND OF JAMAICA

As briefly announced in Saturday's "Gleaner," Mr. Marcus Garvey, President-General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League, who is now on a visit to Jamaica, delivered another powerful address at the Ward Theatre on Thursday night on "Jamaica, her needs and the Negro Problem." There was a large turn-out, and an excellent musical programme was rendered. Those who contributed to the programme were Mr. and Mrs. G. McCormack, Mr. Evans and Professor Barnes (Pianist).

At the outset of the meeting Mr. Adrian Daly [Daley] explained the objects of the Negro Improvement Association.

Mr. Garvey, who was received [w]ith cheers, said Jamaica was an island that was somewhat isolated from world activities. In all his travel he had never come across a country that was more backward than Jamaica. Whilst in Jamaica the negroes made no progress. They had the Chinese and Syrians coming here and making wonderful progress (cheers). Why was it that Jamaicans had to leave their country? Why was it that m[e]n had to leave and go abroad to make a living[?] It was because of the backward condition in which the country was. If they had good statesmen in the island, Jamaica would be more prosperous. In England they had statesmen like David Lloyd George, Winston Spencer Churchill. In France they had a Briand; in America they had a Warren Harding then in Cuba they had statesmen. In Jamaica they had no statesmen (cheers). They had a bunch of ignoramuses. They wanted men

WITH EXPERIENCE, MEN WITH VISION.

He then pointed out how dependent Jamaica was in respect to foreign trade, and said he was there to warn them how cautiously they should move. The United States of America had developed such islands as Porto Rico, San Domingo and Hayti. It was not [un]likely that prohibitive tariffs would be raised against this island, and what Jamaica needed was men of backbone—men of vision who would lead them through any impending crisis. He was interested in the 800,000 negroes who lived in Jamaica. His future lay in the Continent of Africa. When he looked at the undeveloped resources of the island, he could not help thinking that what they wanted was more men of vision but unfortunately there was too much selfishness—a selfishness that was not known abroad. The spirit which pervaded the average Jamaican was that he did not like to see the other Jamaican rise (cheers). What they wanted was real leadership. They had too many hypocrites and a bunch of religion, which was doing no real good for the people (cheers). If the negroes in this country would unite, they

would achieve greater things. They did not want a man who occupied an honorary position. They wanted to have a paid leader—a man who would devote himself to the cause and interests of the people—whether he was a J. A. G. Smith (cheers) or a Gordon Somers.¹ They wanted a leader who would be able to maintain a lasting co-operation; [a] leader who would be able to carry out their aims and desires. It was a shame that men in this civilized age should go about naked and not be able to earn enough to feed themselves whilst the other fellow lived in luxury and affluence (cheers). They had in this country all the elements which, if developed, would mean material progress to the country. What had the men who had made money out of the people done for the country? (A voice: None).

They had no factories, no industries here. Nearly everything they needed came from abroad. This was probably his last visit to Jamaica as he would be proceeding to Africa where he had a big and important job and he wanted them to co-operate and improve themselves. From what he could understand, there was no desire of their Governor² to see that people were living in a state of starvation; were badly housed and poorly clad. "Negroes of Jamaica," he proclaimed, "don't allow yourselves to remain in a process of stagnation. Arouse yourselves. Do not make fools of yourselves.[""] (cheers)

Proceeding, Mr. Garvey said they could not get anything by merely praying for it. The negroes had been kept under and it was all

DUE TO THEIR OWN INERTNESS.

People who came here from abroad were able to make substantial progress. They had a Chinese J.P., a Coolie J.P., and soon they would have an Assyrian J.P. Could a negro go to China and be appointed a J.P.? (Voices: No). He wanted them to think. They should arouse themselves and cease begging for what justly belonged to them. There was no reason why the negro should not advance economically, socially and politically. He wanted to see negro statesmen, negro magnates, negro admirals and negro Field-m Marshalls (cheers). And that hope would eventually be achieved when they set up the great republic in Africa (cheers). The Englishmen, he pointed out, had years ago been held in bondage by the Romans. To-day what was the position of Britons—[""]Britons, Britons never shall be slaves."³ This was their song; and when the negroes returned to Africa, their motherland, they would sing; [""]Ethiopians, Ethiopians never shall be slaves" (prolonged cheers). He had brought the message from the 2,000,000 negroes of America to be of good cheer, and to look forward to the day when the four hundred millions of negroes in the world would unite under the one standard and would be under one vine and fig tree (cheers). In Liberia they had men [laying the foundation?] for the great cause. He then proceeded to refer to the Black Star Line, and the value of owning stock in the company. They had a White Star Line and a Red Star Line and the negroes were now having a Black Star Line. What the negroes wanted was to co-operate and to advance themselves, socially, economically and politically;

and he threw out the hint that he had a scheme under consideration which he would submit to his associates in New York for the establishment of a big Departmental Store in Kingston where black girls would be employed just as white girls were employed in other stores. (cheers)

At the conclusion of his address, Mr. Garvey was lustily cheered; and the proceedings terminated with the singing of the National Anthem.

AT MORANT BAY

Mr. Marcus Garvey spoke to an audience numbering about 100 at the Court House, Morant Bay, on Saturday night. Mr Louis Duff presided, and in a ten minute speech introduced Mr. Garvey as a leader who had come forward to help the Negro Race on the path of progress.

Mr. Joshua N. Gordon of the local branch of the Universal Negro Improvement Association then presented Mr. Garvey with an address, in which his organizing abilities, as shown by the success and great speed of the Association, Mr. Garvey had founded, was praised and the final success of the meeting hoped for.

SUNDAY NIGHT'S MEETING

On few other occasions has the Ward Theatre been so crowded with people as on Sunday night at the meeting of the Jamaica Division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association when Mr. Marcus Garvey, President General of the Association, spoke on the subject "The Man Jesus Christ as understood by the New Negro." Every seat was occupied and standing room in the building was hard to be obtained.

Mr. Garvey appeared in his robes of office made up of the emblematic colours of the Association—red, green and black. He entered on the stage in a procession formed of office bearers of the Association with banner aloft and of members of the Jamaica Labour Union also carrying their banner, while the choir sang the hymn, "Now thank we all our God."

Mr. Adrian Daily [Daley], Hon. Secretary of the Association made a few remarks thanking the people for attending the meetings in such large numbers and inviting new members to join.

Mr. and Mrs. George McCormack rendered a short program of songs and their performance was heartily appreciated.

Rev. E. Seiler Salmon, who was in his robes, begun giving a discourse on Easter, but the audience refused to hear him. Mr. A. Bain Alves also started to address the audience and was well received, but when he attempted to picture the old days of slavery and to give an account of the origin of the people of mixed colour the crowd showed their disapproval and silenced him with clapping.

MR. GARVEY SPEAKS

Mr. Garvey, who was suffering from a cold and the exertions of the past week rose to speak, amidst general applause. He said: Over nineteen hundred

years ago, the Man Jesus Christ was born to the world. His mission was to redeem fallen mankind. After nineteen hundred years they were taught the doctrine that Jesus taught during His time. Men everywhere bowed at the footstool of the Christ who was crucified for the redemption of fallen man. Wheresoever they turned their eyes within Christendom they found men professing Christ. Jamaica like everywhere else in ch[r]istendom believed in the Christian idea, in the Christian dogma as taught by the Man Jesus.

After giving a long desideratum about "The Man Christ Jesus" his crucifixion by his own people, the Jews, to whom he had come, Garvey continued thus:—

Just at this Easter time it was the Negro that rendered the greatest assistance to His Master when the world rejected Him, and the U.N.I.A., knowing the gratitude of Jesus Christ had chosen Him as their Standard Bearer, and wheresoever He led many followed (cheers). No human power, no human agency could have made the association what it was to-day; no human power could have brought into the association four million Negroes, the hardest of all people to organize in the world. In his experience and that of others they could not get Negroes to organize, they could not get 12 Negroes anywhere to agree on any matter whatever, but there was an association of four million Negroes all agreed on one destiny. That night he came to them—the scattered sons and daughters of Ethiopia asking them to stretch forth their hands simultaneously with other Ethiopians. That night he

SAW IN THEIR FACES

the image of their Great Creator, if God had created them in His own image; why should anyone despise them? Why should they give them a back place in the world? Why not preach the good doctrine? Why all this hypocrisy and lies? He could not understand it, but more lies were told in the pulpit of Jamaica than anywhere else (here here). They wanted more God, more Christ in their pulpits. The Chaplain General of the U.N.I.A., told him that wanting to find out the [right] attitude of the Bishop of the West Indies he asked him the question, "Bishop, are you my brother?" The question was put to the Bishop four times before he replied, "Yes, [a] brother in Christ." He wanted them to understand that the white man had a different notion about God and about Christ and that they (his hearers) had the sentimental, emotional idea about Jesus and about God. The white man had the scientific idea. He wanted them to change their emotionalism and sentimentalism and give some of the scientific application.

There was science in religion. It took a good suit of clothes, a clean and tidy home and good food to be a christian, otherwise they were going to be villains. The kind of christianity the U.N.I.A. wanted them to follow was the christianity Jesus taught in the sermon on the Mount[,] the true and undefiled religion that made all men equal (cheers). They wanted the kind of religion that would help them to rise and find happiness on earth. He could not understand

how this beautiful and resourceful country could allow its people to live in rags, half starved and diseased. Who was to bring about the change? Not the doctors and lawyers, it was the preachers, but they seemed worse than anybody else, because though the people were poor, these preachers sought to take away their last penny. The people of Jamaica wanted to demand of their preachers to preach Jesus Christ, to preach the real religion and if the preachers did not do so they should shut up the churches and select a leader to preach Jesus to them. They could not get the right kind of understanding because they had too much theology, they wanted more of Christ and less of theology (cheers). He was no preacher, he was a publicist, but he saw "some of the fellows not doing their work and he had to help them do it." He then exhorted the people to [unite and] co-operate to rise. He bespoke a hearty welcome for Miss Vinton Davis, the Right Honourable International Organizer of the Association, who would soon be in the island to carry on the work he had begun. Liberty was not gained without fighting, liberty was not got by petitions, deputations and mass meetings. They must be prepared to die for their liberty; he was one Negro prepared to die, even now on the spot, for the cause he thought just and righteous. This may be his last public appearance in Kingston and he bade them farewell (cheers.)

The National Anthem was sung and the gathering dispersed.

Printed in the *Workman* (Panama City), 9 April 1921.

1. Rev. Thomas Gordon Somers (1866–1931), born at Camrose, St. James, served as the pastor of the First Baptist Church in Spanish Town and the Stewart Town Baptist Church in Trelawny. Somers was chairman of the Jamaica Baptist Union in 1908, and later its secretary in February 1918. In 1918 he was elected president of the Jamaica League, and he also served for a period as chairman of the St. Catherine Parochial Board (*HJ*, 1932).

2. Sir Leslie Probyn (1862–1938) was the governor of Jamaica from 1918 to 1924; he served earlier, from 1904 to 1910, as governor of Sierra Leone and, subsequently, of Barbados. He was made a KCMG in 1909 (Obituary, *Glasgow Herald*, 20 December 1938).

3. The words were derived from the original lyrics of "Rule, Britannia," the famous British patriotic song, which originated from the poem "Rule, Britannia," by James Thomson, and was set to music by Thomas Arne in 1740 (*The Works of James Thomson*, vol. 2 [1763], p. 191):

Rule, Britannia! rule the waves:
Britons never will be slaves.

Charles L. Latham,¹ U.S. Consul,
Jamaica, to Chief Quarantine Officer,
Panama Canal Zone

Kingston, Jamaica, April 11, 1921

Sir:

This is to inform you that MARCUS GARVEY has applied for the visa of this office for his travel to the Canal Zone and that acting under instructions of the

APRIL 1921

Department of State we have refused to grant him a visa of any sort. This is based upon his activities in political and racial agitation.

In case he succeeds in getting to your port without our visa I have to suggest that it might be worth while for you to get in touch with the Consular Officers in Panama before facilitating him in either entering United States territory or proceeding to the United States. Very respectfully yours,

CHARLES L. LATHAM
American Consul

DNA, RG 185, PCC-28-B-233, Part 1. TL, copy.

1. Charles L. Latham (1881-1960) had previously been appointed to positions in the U.S. Consular Service in Colombia, Chile, Brazil, and Scotland (*NYT*, 11 March 1960).

Telegram to Charles Evans Hughes,¹ U.S. Secretary of State

Kingston. April 12, 1921

Referring to the Department's instruction of March 25th concerning Marcus Garvey, visa for the Canal Zone refused. Sailing to-day on the steamer CORONADO touching at Cristobal. Passage paid to Port Limon.

As he may attempt to land at the Canal Zone I have telegraphed Consul General at Panama. Garvey's activities here indicate that he would arouse considerable racial antagonism among the negroes at the Canal Zone and in the Republic of Panama.

[*Addressed to:*] Secretary of State,
Washington D.C. *FROM* GRAY Kingston

DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/5. TG, recipient's copy.

1. Charles Evans Hughes (1862-1948) was the secretary of state in the Harding administration. A former governor of New York, Hughes was the Republican candidate for president who lost to Woodrow Wilson in 1916 in one of the closest elections in American history (*WBD*).

P. Premdas, Chief, Correspondence
Department, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

UNIVERSAL BUILDING,
56 WEST 135TH STREET
NEW YORK, U.S.A. April 13th, 1921

DEAR MR. CASIMIR:—

Your letter of the 31st of March enclosing money order for \$9.74 has been received, for which please accept our best thanks.

Enclosed herewith please find Certificates Nos. 33598 and 9 for Ann Sylvester and Alphaeus Andrew for one share each. As we owed you 32¢, there will be a balance now of 6¢ due you on this transaction. Attached to the Certificates are receipts which please get the individual Shareholders to sign in the usual way and return to us.

Certificate #31796 for William Jones is also enclosed in place of Certificate #32482.

We are sorry to hear that you cannot purchase anymore money orders and would suggest to you to try and get American bills and forward same to us in a registered letter. You can mark the envelope "RETURNED RECEIPT REQUESTED." By sending it this way some one here at the office will have to sign a receipt for the letter and which receipt will be returned you by the Postal Authorities. This is about the safest way that we know of.

Your request for rates of passage to the different points named in your letter has been referred over to the Shipping Department, who will write you direct.

Thanking you for the continued interest which you show and with best wishes. Yours very truly,

BLACK STAR LINE, INC.
P. PREMDAS
Chief, Cor. Department

[*Addressed to:*] MR. J. R. RALPH CASIMIR
P.O. Box 81, Roseau Dominica, B.W.I.

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy. On BSL letterhead.

APRIL 1921

Telegram from Walter C. Thurston,¹
Secretary, U.S. Embassy, Costa Rica, to Charles
Evans Hughes, U.S. Secretary of State

San Jose, CR. [Costa Rica,]
April 15, 1921

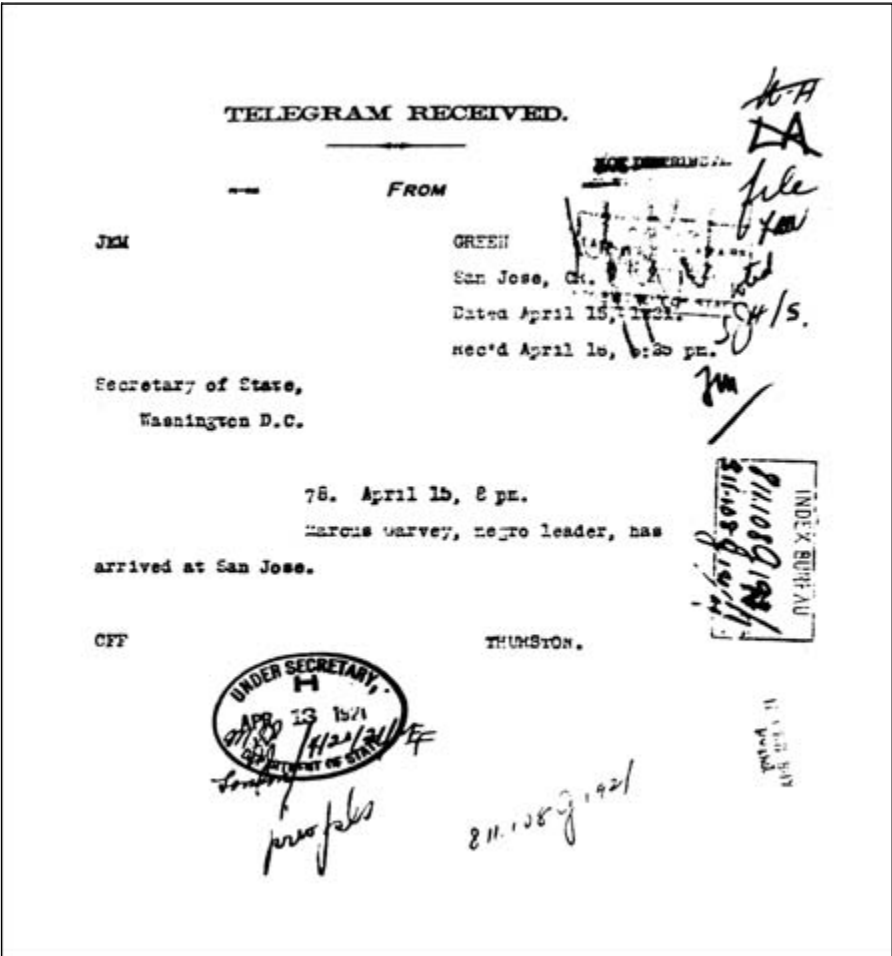
Marcus Garvey, negro leader, has arrived at San Jose.

THURSTON

[*Addressed to:*] Secretary of State,
Washington D.C. *FROM* GREEN
San Jose, CR.

DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/1. TG, recipient's copy.

1. Walter C. Thurston, born 1894, was the first secretary of the American Embassy at Costa Rica (U.S. Department of State, *Register of the Department of State*, 1924 [Washington D.C.: Government Printing Office, 1924], p. 197). The information in this cable was furnished by the State Department's William L. Hurley to Brig. Gen. Dennis E. Nolan of MID (DNA, RG 165, 10218-418/5) (*MGP* 3: 359).



Telegram from Walter C. Thurston to U.S. Secretary of State
Charles Evans Hughes (Source: DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/1)

APRIL 1921

“An Observer” to the *Negro World*

[[St. Thomas, V.I., U.S.A.
April 15, 1921]]

U.S. MARINES RUN AMUCK IN ST. THOMAS, V.I., U.S.A.

Dear Sir—

Enclose herewith please find two issues of the St. Thomas Mail Notes.¹ I wish you would publish same in the mouthpiece of the U.N.I.A. so that the race the world over may learn what is going on in St. Thomas under the Red, White and Blue. It was indeed a great wonder that the editor wasted his time with such a matter as this, for, although being a Negro, he denies the fact and tries to be somebody else (white). That is one reason why his accounts are very much colored, and the real thing is not given. For the little that he gave the gentlemen from the south were going to destroy his place of business, because he dared to make public the gentleness of the marines. In his issue of March 31 he had to deny that the Negro policemen were called off the street before the marines started to do the town. On the night of April 1 the place of business was to be destroyed. As a reward for his denial the entire police force, about nine men, guarded the printing office, while the barbarians had the city for themselves. In the fighting on this night the Negroes, who are not protected in any wise, were this time prepared to give their full measure for self-protection. Although the natives dare not own a gun, and have none, for once their minds were set to give the most in defending themselves. The braves must have got a wireless, for, although they were plentiful, they did not start anything. An assault may be looked for any time.

AN OBSERVER

Printed in *NW*, 7 May 1921.

1. An article from St. Thomas, 10 April 1921, and entitled “U.S. Marines Run Amuck in Virgin Island,” was printed in the *Negro World*, 23 April 1921.

Report on Costa Rica

[*Washington, D.C.*] April 16, 1921

SUBJECT. Costa Rica Economic

Marcus Garvey, negro leader, editor of the “Negro World,” “Provisional President of Africa,” promoter of the “Black Star Line,” arrived at Port Limon from Kingston, Jamaica, April 14th, on the English ship “Coronado.” This ship was to sail for England April 16th, but the United Fruit Co. //RECEIVED ORDERS// not to load her as there was a strike on in England.¹

Garvey comes here in the role of the chief of "The Universal Negro Improvement Association." He thinks that the Jamaica negro would be better off under United States government than British. He receives \$2,000.00 a month from Minor C. Keith,² who employs thousands of negroes as banana pickers.³

DNA, RG 165, 10218-418. TD, copy. Marked "No. 78."

1. As ordered by their union, coal miners in England began their fourteen-week strike against wage reductions on the night of 31 March 1921. Only the enginemen and pump men, in defiance of the order, stayed at work for the safety of the mines. A state of emergency was declared by a royal proclamation under the Emergency Powers Act of 1920. The postwar period in Britain was characterized by a great deal of unrest and strikes. Peter Hain explains that "workers who came home [from World War I] to promises of 'a land fit for heroes' soon had their hopes dashed, and they reacted by resorting to industrial militancy" (*Political Strikes: The State and Trade Unionism in Britain* [Harmondsworth, Middlesex, England: Viking, 1986], p. 73). During the period of 1919 to 1921, there were 1,241 strikes, compared to 844 strikes from 1914 to 1918 and 629 strikes from 1922 to 1925 (*Times* [London], 1 April, 4 April and 18 July 1921; Richard Hyman, *Strikes* [London: Fontana, 1972], pp. 25-28).

2. Minor Cooper Keith (1848-1929), an American entrepreneur in Central America, was raised in New York as a member of a prosperous family. After working in the cattle industry until 1869, he accepted an invitation from his uncle Henry Meiggs, in 1871, to build a railroad from San José to Port Limón on the Caribbean coast of Costa Rica. Meiggs had already succeeded at building the Callao-Lima Railroad and the Oreja Railroad in Peru some years before. Keith accepted the invitation enthusiastically and went to Costa Rica with his two brothers to work in the railroad project.

During the first twenty-five miles of the construction Meiggs and the Keith brothers faced incredible odds. Building in the jungle was much more difficult than calculated—diseases and hard working conditions cost around five thousand deaths during the construction, including Keith's brothers who died in 1874. Keith stubbornly continued with the project despite all the difficulties. The railroad's notorious reputation made it hard for him to recruit new workers in Central America, so he decided to get them in the jails of New Orleans. He recruited 700 murderers and criminals but only 25 survived to see New Orleans again. He also brought a boat with 2,000 Italian immigrants from Louisiana who rebelled when they discovered the terrible working conditions. By 1882 Keith had carried the construction of the railroad 70 miles from the coast to Río Sucio, but he was running out of money since the Costa Rican government had defaulted on promised payments. Keith was forced into a debt of 1.2 million pounds before he finished the railroad to San José in 1890.

Once the railroad was finished, Keith faced a new problem: the insufficient number of passengers made it impossible for Keith to repay his debts. The only solution he found to enable him to keep the business going was to ship bananas from the trees he had planted along the tracks in times of financial crisis to feed the workers. The experiment proved successful, and by 1883 Keith owned three banana export companies. By 1890 the railway was converted to handle only the transport of bananas. With his booming banana and railroad business Keith became a very influential and respected man in Costa Rican society. He married the daughter of a national President, and worked as the main negotiator on behalf of the Costa Rican foreign debt with English banks. With this power, he expanded his banana and railway businesses through Central America and the Colombian Caribbean. By 1899 he dominated the Central American banana business, but also faced new challenges following the bankruptcy of his main broker company in New York. This forced him to travel to Boston and negotiate with the owners of his main rival, the Boston Fruit Company. As a result of his negotiations, his interests and those of the Boston Fruit merged, creating the United Fruit Company (UFC). After creating the company Keith continued building railroads in Central America, which were used for the newly created banana company, extending them into Mexican territory. In 1911 Keith consolidated his railway network into a new company, the International Railways of Central America (IRCA), with which he managed to connect 800 miles in track worth \$80 million. He remained until his death the most influential U.S. citizen in Central America. Known as the "uncrowned king of Central America," his business decisions transformed the region's economy and society shaping its development for the twentieth century (Frederick U. Adams, *The Conquest of the Tropics* [New York: Page & Co., 1914]; Stacy May and Galo Plaza,

United States Business Performance Abroad: The Case Study of the United Fruit Company in Latin America [Washington D.C.: National Planning Association, 1958]; Thomas McCann, *An American Company: The Tragedy of the United Fruit* [New York: Crown, 1976]; John N. Ingham, ed., *Biographical Dictionary of American Business Leaders* [Westport, Conn.: Greenwood Press, 1983]).

3. The UFC payroll accounted for most of the money generated by the UNIA in Costa Rica. The money could be seen as a deliberate payoff to keep the UNIA from creating labor unrest on the plantations. Garvey was very accommodating toward the company's interests and could have taken the money as a contribution (Ron Harpelle, "Radicalism, Accommodation and Decline: Garveyism in a United Fruit Company Enclave," *JILAS* 6, no. 1 [July 2000]).

Article in the *Negro World*

[[Havana, Cuba, April 16, 1921]]

"ANTONIO MACEO" ARRIVES IN CUBA IN A BLAZE OF GLORY

HIGH CUBAN OFFICIALS GO ON BOARD SHIP AND
HEARTILY WELCOME OFFICIALS OF U.N.I.A. ABOARD

Sunday morning, April 10, the Antonio Maceo of the Black Star Line, named after the great Cuban liberator, steamed quietly into port, and in spite of the Sunday stillness of the city the news soon spread around, even the suburbs, that the distinguished ship and visitors had arrived.

At the early hour of 7:30 p.m. the Liberty Hall of Havana was crowded to its utmost capacity.

VISITOR WELCOME ON BOARD VESSEL

No less important was the visit to the vessel of Sr. Juan Marcelino Martinez, president of the patriotic institution, and the "National Column of Defense" and stockholder in the corporation; Sr. Florentino del Campo, mechanic and general machinist; Sr. Eulio Junto, assistant manager of the veterinary of Havana, also stockholder of the corporation; Sr. Miguel Martinez, journalist; Mr. F. Houchon, general mechanic; Mr. Ernest Peterson, first vice-president of the Guantanamo branch, U.N.I.A., and Mr. Fred Tommins. The gentlemen were asked to have tea on board, and seated with them at the table were the official visitors, Mr. A. G. Burkley, traffic manager of the corporation; Jabez L. Clarke, agent in Havana, and the ship's officers. They expressed their entire satisfaction with the condition of the boat and wished the corporation unrivaled success, pledging their continued support.

[RECEPTION] AT LIBERTY HALL

The [grand?] official reception was given [party?] on the night of April [13?] when they ate and drank to Havana's health and exchanged salutations and greetings. In responding to the greetings extended the officials, in part, Miss Davis said: "It affords me great pleasure to be with you in Havana and to encourage you to continue the fight, and hope that the Havana division shall

succeed. I am expecting that at the convention in August you shall be able to send not only an English-speaking delegate, but also a Spanish-speaking one, and I am looking for that Spanish one to be no less a person than Sr. Francisco De Belen, who has caught the true spirit of Negroism."

Mr. De Belen replied (in Spanish): "I lift this cup in the name and in the honor of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and the distinguished officials here present with us, and wish that the association and allied corporations shall prosper not only here in Cuba, but throughout the entire universe, and pledge all in my power to further the interest of the cause and hope that the promoters shall never grow tired, but continue to fight the good fight."

Miss Davis, international organizer, and Mr. De Bourg attended a local officers' meeting and gave their opinions and advice regarding the welfare of the branch. The party left for the country parts of Cuba. The boat met them at Santiago de Cuba, whence they proceeded to Jamaica.

Printed in *NW*, 30 April 1921.

Alfred B. Rawlins to the *Negro World*

[[Banes, Oriente, Cuba,
ca. 16 April 1921]]

BANES IS LEFT GRIEVING

Sir:—

Thanking you for the space given in your valuable paper, I venture to say that never in the English Negro history of Banes was there such enthusiasm as when on Thursday, the 15th of March, it was announced that the Honorable Marcus Garvey had reached Banes. Not only were our people rushing to have a look at the man of the hour, but also those of the other race. We had the pleasure of securing the great Theatre Heredia, where he lectured in such simple but powerful words as never a man of our race has done. No wonder, sir, that the movement is so rapidly progressing, when we have such a man as our leader. Permit me to say, sir, that his words of encouragement have given us (the members of this division) a stronger determination to press forward until we achieve our aims. But he, having to obey the orders of onward march, is lost from our midst, leaving us grieving for one that is not dead. I am yours faithfully,

ALFRED B. RAWLINS

Printed in *NW*, 16 April 1921.

APRIL 1921

John Sydney De Bourg to the *Negro World*

[[*Panama*, ca. 16 April 1921]]

A CORRECTION

Sir:—

In reproducing my farewell address in your issue of the 12th instant by a very brief summary of same. I was made to have mentioned not only that I am the leader of the British West Indies, but that I am making Trinidad my official headquarters.

As neither of these allegation could be true nor could have been made by me, I beg to have the following corrections inserted in your next issue: I am the leader of the Wester[n] Provinces of the West Indies and of Central and South America, with my official headquarters at Panama, whither I now go.

ENC. SYDNEY DE BOURG

Printed in *NW*, 16 April 1921.

O. Louis Sherwood, General Secretary,
UNIA Guantánamo Division,
in the *Negro World*

[[Guantanamo Division No. 164
of the U.N.I.A. & A.C.L.,
ca. 16 April 1921]]

FURTHER DISTINGUISHED VISIT PAID TO SEVERAL BRANCHES
OF U.N.I.A. IN CUBA BY HIS EXCELLENCY, THE HON.
MARCUS GARVEY, PROVISIONAL PRESIDENT OF AFRICA
AND PRESIDENT GENERAL OF THE U.N.I.A.

Supplementing the very recent distinguished visit which was paid to us by His Grace Dr. G. Alexander McGuire, our Chaplain General, we were on Monday, 14th inst., furnished with telegraphic communication to the effect that we would again be favored with the presence of another distinguished visitor in the person of His Excellency the Hon. Marcus Garvey on Friday, the 18th inst., and, of course, the necessary preparations were immediately started, several meetings being called in order to devise plans. Our local president thereupon proceeded to the junction at San Luis to meet his Excellency, and came on with him, accompanied by his secretary, Mr. Ja[c]ques, to Guantanamo. It was, however, decided to have the municipal band of this town to meet his Excellency at the railroad station in Guantanamo and to have a procession march to

the Club Moncada,¹ where the celebration should be performed, but unfortunately the band was unable to do so, owing to the fact that there intervened a funeral, it is understood, at which the band was summoned to play, thus rendering it impossible. However, a goodly number of the officers and members of the division, accompanied with the portrait of his Excellency as well as with banners, met his Excellency at the station, from which a procession proceeded to the Club Moncada, where his Excellency decided to indulge in a short repose, having been slightly tired from his long traveling and from the effects of a slight attack of influenza, which he expressed as having been caused from his coming from the cold climate of the North into the tropical climate of Cuba, but that he hoped to be quite all right again shortly.

At 8 p.m. our local president, Mr. J. J. Henry, called the meeting to order. After a period of about two minutes his Excellency, accompanied by Mr. Henry, entered the hall, whereupon the entire audience stood in honor to his Excellency and the municipal band played the Cuban national anthem until his Excellency took his seat. This done, our local president asked for the singing of "From Greenland's Icy Mountains," after which our local chaplain, Mr. Bachelor,² led the meeting in prayer.

Our local president, Mr. Henry, here addressed the audience. He said, in part:

We have been hearing a lot about the Hon. Mr. Marcus Garvey, and I am glad to see that we now have the presence of this wonderful gentleman in our midst tonight. Before his arrival we were about 300 strong, and if all these people who are sitting here tonight were members we would feel proud of being loyal to the cause, and I hope all of you who are present tonight will realize from the presence of our wonderful hero what the object of this move[ment] is and render all your assistance to help in every possible way. I know that the program is pretty lengthy, and as we are anxious to hear all the news from the sweet lips of his Excellency that he has brought for us, but take pleasure in calling upon our former president, Mr. Joseph Matthias, to address you.

Mr. Matthias here said:

To His Excellency, the President General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League.

It is with pleasure that our eyes behold the great hero of the twentieth century. (Cheer.) I reviewed your history on that memorable night when you were appointed our leader, and that you did not hesitate to undertake the task to use all possible efforts to restore Africa to a renewed ancient glory for the Negroes.

You have pledged yourself to sac[ri]fice your life, not selfishly but unselfishly, to free four hundred million Negroes. I may not live to see

Africa but I have a six-year-old son and hope that he will be able to see those beautiful shores of Africa. As I am asked not to be too lengthy, I hope, sir, that the God of Heaven may help you to accomplish your aim and that you will be successful in your undertaking and that your great deeds and your excellent talent may be written upon your tombstone. Salute!

Mr. Ernest Peterson here addressed the audience in Spanish in a very brilliant and fiery manner which brought repetitions of cheers, especially from the Cubans, who, of course, fully understood all he said.

Mr. J. Parris next addressed the audience and recited a recitation composed by himself concerning the race in every respect. Same reads as follows:

Africa's sons and daughters we,
United let our objects be
As we gather day by day
To spread the propaganda of our U.N.I.A.
They call to us from our Fatherland,
Come brothers, come sisters, let's join heart and hand.
There's no time for schism, negligence or delay,
But join in co-operation, ye members of our U.N.I.A.
His Honor, Marcus Garvey, is our leader.
Haven't you seen the Negro World dear reader?
He claims God's help to lead the way
Victoriously for members of our U.N.I.A.
He has sent us here this great charter:
Reverence to God and love our neighbors is its character.
All who loyally this rule obey
Shall swell the music of our U.N.I.A.
We live to do each other good,
To shelter and clothe our needy and give them food;
God has said there is no nobler way
For members of our U.N.I.A.
Africa's sons and daughters, we,
Cubans, Jamaicans, small Islanders we be,
Cast in your lot with us and tell me not nay,
For your destiny is enveloped in our U.N.I.A.
Let us all as New Negroes to this movement respond
With shares in the Black Star Line to force the big ships along.
The redemption of Africa is the motto of the day,
And we can do it by adhering to the U.N.I.A.

Mrs. Theodora Thomas, President of the Ladies' Division, next spoke. She said:

Never in my life have I had the joy which I now have in my heart. I have long been reading, I have long been hearing of the Hon. Marcus Garvey and now I have the pleasure of seeing this wonderful gentleman. Honorable sir, I greet you with all my heart. I do not believe that I may be mistaken when I say that you know me—not personally—but from the work which I have been doing in this movement. I wish you all the success that any man of honor should deserve, the success of King George or any other in the world. I know that you are filling the position that any king, lord or duke could fill. Never have we seen a movement of this sort and I know some of us do not yet realize the good of it. We have before us our President General, a great champion, a great hero; he has made a record and has the interests of four hundred million Negroes at heart and we pray that God will guide us onward, and you may depend that we here in Guantanamo will do our best to help you and to help all that have brought honor to our race.

A duet and chorus was next rendered by the choir, entitled "There Is a Cry from Macedonia, Come Over and Help Us," (the writer presiding at the organ). This duet was composed of very appropriate words to suit the race, specially prepared by the choir.

Mr. Daniel Richardson, executive secretary, said:

Your Excellency, Officers and Members of the Universal Negro Improvement Association: My heart is now filled with joy because I have seen, sir, you, the Provisional President of Africa, and am pleased to know you personally. This is really the time for us, the four hundred million Negroes of the world to do all that lies within our power to help the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L. to achieve the desired end.

Miss Luisa Raymond, Secretary of the Cuban Auxiliary Division, next spoke and brought scores of applause. This young lady, as can be expressed by His Excellency, was excellent in her address, though he could not understand all she said, but conspicuously from her impression which stimulated the entire audience, especially the Cubans who readily understood her, was evidence for itself. She also presented a beautiful bunch of roses to His Excellency, who gratefully thanked her.

Mr. John Daniels, one of our eloquent Spanish interpreters, here stood and shouted, ["three cheers for the Hon. Marcus Garvey, three cheers for the Universal Negro Improvement Association, viva Antonio Maceo, viva Cuba, and viva la raza Negra."]

The Hon. Mr. Cunning here said:

His Excellency, Mr. Chairman, officers and members, it affords me much pleasure to be present here with you tonight. Tonight we have with us

our illustrious head, the Hon. Marcus Garvey, Provisional President-General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League.³ It should, therefore, give us that bright ambition which we should have. [I]t should inspire us. He has not come here tonight to beg us anything, he has come to instil[1] into our minds the importance of the great movement, for, as I know him well, he is too proud to beg. It is for us to wake up out of our lethargy and push forward to that strong determination. Some of you have been like doubting Thomases, but I hope you will be convinced [*illegible*] from the presence of our President-General. The time has come for us to have a government for ourselves, the whites have their own governments, the yellows have their own, but there is really no proper government for the Negroes. He has appealed to you to give your assistance to establish our Negro Government in Africa. I do not know if you see the necessity as I see it. To me it seems as if every Negro should think seriously of this movement. Africa is pleading, Africa is calling us, and if we shall follow the line as is shown to us, we shall go through successfully.

Ladies and gentlemen, what a pleasure it is for us to have our illustrious leader here with us tonight, and I must tell you, it may be the last time we may see him here, because he is a busy man. He has the world to visit, and there may be some places that he can only visit in a life time. If you are considering of this movement I must ask you to support the cause, and right there is the secretary sitting idle. I would like to see you all coming up to him, one by one, not in a rush, and buy your shares and bonds. His Grace, Dr. McGuire, was here a few weeks ago, and do you remember what he said, "Hold the fort for I am coming." Now Mr. Garvey is here and he wants to see you hold the fort. If you come up and buy shares the Negroes will be able to float big ships and be able to flourish in the world as any other race. Let me see you all coming up one by one.

The next speaker being the president of the Club Moncada, who delivered himself eloquently and brought scores of cheers, the enthusiasm of this deliverance being rather conspicuous to everyone.

MARCUS GARVEY SPEAKS

Our local president here took pleasure in giving His Excellency his "full swing," and the anxiety of the entire audience is self-explained, as everyone was uneasy to hear His Excellency's voice. Here he started and which was interpreted to Spanish by Mr. E. Peterson.

Mr. President, ladies and gentlemen, I am pleased, indeed, to be in this beautiful island of Cuba. I have been in this, your country, for about sixteen days, and from what I have seen, I can only say that you have a beautiful country to be admired by everyone. I am only sorry that I cannot

speak your native language, but I hope on my next return to the island I will be able to converse with you in your language. I have come here, however, for the purpose of conveying to you a message from the Negro peoples of the world, of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, that I have the honor to represent, and endeavoring to organize all the Negro peoples of the world into one organization. The object of this organization of the entire four hundred million Negroes of the world is for the purpose of establishing a strong government of our own in Africa. In view of the fact that Cuban Negroes, like all other West Indian Negroes, were taken from Africa three hundred years ago, we believe that every Negro should be interested in a movement of this kind.

He then continued in English only:

Mr. President, members and friends of the Guantanamo division: It is, indeed, a pleasure for me to find myself in your midst tonight. I have come to this, your division, to speak to you for a while, and to tell you what we are endeavoring to do and what we want to accomplish in the near future. The Universal Negro Improvement Association, as you know, was organized in the United States of America four and a half years ago with thirteen members. After four and a half years of active work, we have now an organization of four million negroes. The one branch which we started four and a half years ago has now grown to seven hundred branches, and you in Guantanamo are one of these seven hundred branches. Wherever you turn in America, in Jamaica, in Cuba, there you will see one of the branches of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. When I was leaving New York to visit the several branches on my six-weeks' tour to the West Indies I understood from the Executive Secretary that there are several branches in Cuba, and I asked him to give me the names of the most progressive branches in Cuba, and among them he gave me the Guantanamo division. I understand that His Grace was here with you a few weeks ago, and that you received him very hospitably. During the convention of last year they elected nineteen leaders, and His Grace, the Chaplain-General was amongst the leaders and also your humble servant. As you all know, to be President of Africa is one of the biggest jobs in the world. They have given me the job to drive all the aliens out of Africa and I, alone, cannot go through the job, and that is why I have come to the Guantanamo division to let you know that we will want you to enlist for the freedom of your motherhood [motherland].

Africa, as you know, is the richest and most prolific country in the world. As American, Cuban, Jamaican, Haytian Negroes were never in existence three hundred years ago, it is therefore quite clear that we were all African Negroes that were brought to the United States of America and were kept there as slaves for two hundred and fifty years, and those

who were sold to the West Indies were slaves for two hundred and thirty years. Some of us got our freedom through emancipation and some of us got our liberty by fighting for it. We have decided that in this age of human progress the time has come for us to get together and to restore to ourselves that land that God Almighty originally gave to our forefathers. It is for that purpose that I have come to visit your city. Guantanamo is a faraway place from America, but at the same time, wherever there are two or three that are gathered together in favor of the Negro Improvement Association, it is my duty to come and visit you. It is small enough for you in Guantanamo at this time to do your duty for this great and honorable cause, and I want you to realize that just at this time the world is reorganizing itself. The war continued for nearly four and a half years, and in that war Russian men fought, Frenchmen fought, American men fought. They took two million Negroes from the West Indian islands to Mesopotamia, who were promised all sorts of things.⁴ We have been deprived of our share of democracy. Since we have been deprived of our share of democracy, we have decided to fight for our democracy, and that is for Africa, and that is why I am appealing to you colored peoples of Africa. If you turn to the map of Africa and look in the south you will find the English people. If you turn to the map of Africa and look in the west you will find the French people. If you look to the east you will find the Turks and French. Nearly all of Africa is taken up by aliens. Nearly 11,500 square miles of the land which God Almighty gave to us have been taken away from us, and they have elected me to take back, and, as I said before, it is not possible for me alone to take it over, and thus I have come to you to ask your assistance to help me to put it over. I am not representing a social organization; I am representing a Negro improvement organization; and, sufficient you are a Negro, this organization is for you. Before we were born West Indians, before we were born American Negroes, we were brought from Africa.

THE U.N.I.A.

I want to say to you that the work of the Negro Improvement Association has greatly advanced the improvement of the Negroes. Prior to this organization the other races had no respect whatever for the Negro race. In America they lynched and burned us, but since this organization has come into existence we have compelled every government to respect the Negroes. As an Englishman will fight and die for the Union Jack of England, as an American will die for the Stars and Stripes of America, we, as Negroes, must live and die for the Red, the Black and the Green, under which you can stand up at any time and anywhere and demand your rights. This is the sort of organization that I represent, and I want you to exert every sense, for there is no other movement in the world as progressive as the Negro Improvement Association. Just fancy, in three to four

and a half years we have linked up four hundred million Negroes! There are some of us who have lost courage and there are some who have lost hope, but I want you all to understand that there is a chance for every man, woman and child in the world. We do not want you to be cowards. The Negro Improvement Association wants every Negro who will stand up for his rights and die for his rights. I want you to understand that the world is rapidly organizing and all nations are expecting to find independence of their own. All other races are fighting for their freedom and Negroes are the only one race that is not fighting for a freedom of their own, and for that reason we are asking you in Guantanamo (I may see you only for once in a lifetime) to give your assistance. If this was a white concern here tonight and you were to meet a white man coming here and ask him what is the purpose of the meeting, he would tell you exactly what the purpose is. The white race does not laugh and sleep as most of our race; if the white race were to laugh and sleep there would be no activity. I tell you that the purpose of this Association is a serious one, and one that we must strive to uplift. If the white man can rule and dominate there is no reason why the black man cannot rule and dominate, too. If the white men are to build up their government and call it the British Government, etc., the yellow men build up their government and call it China, Japan, etc., then the black men should build up a government for themselves and call it Africa. There are four hundred million Negroes in the world. Two hundred and eighty millions live in Africa and form a part of Africa, and the other one hundred and twenty millions are scattered all over the world. Africa is calling you for a redemption. If you fail to answer the call and allow the aliens to go down and take charge of Africa, you will suffer for another hundred years. What we want is, as England has a government of its own[,], as France has a government of its own, the Negroes want to have a government of their own, because you are maltreated, you are abused, all because of your color.

I have traveled the world all over and I have come across Negroes who are ill-treated because they seek their rights. If the Negro is in England[,], they have no respect for him; if he is in France, there is no respect for him, but if it is an Englishman, and he goes anywhere, he is respected because they know that behind him stands a great government. Just as an Englishman or a Frenchman can go anywhere and demand respect, why cannot a Negro travel the world over and demand from any man of the world the respect which is due to him as any other government? It will only be a question of time and we shall have a government of our own. We have already sent out a large number of men to Liberia to lay out our railroads, build factories, etc., and we expect to send a greater number very shortly. God Almighty, when He created the world, did not intend any man to occupy any one operation in life; it has been a propaganda to keep you down all these 300 years. God Almighty created you to be men

and not to be hewers of wood, as the white man expects you to be all the days of your lives. A white man says that black men are monkeys. If you were to ask any of these people here tonight who is the most beautiful woman in the world, he would tell you or take out a white woman and say she is the most beautiful woman in the world; if you were to go to China and ask a Chinaman to point out the most beautiful woman in the world, he would pick out a Chinese woman, but if you go to a Negro and ask him who is the most beautiful woman in the world he would at once pick out a white woman. You must learn to love yourself first and love others last; you are the strongest race of people in the world, therefore we must all cling together, and thus the reason that I have come before you here in Guantan[a]mo is to ask you to help us in New York to unite and protect our race.

THE BLACK STAR LINE

I have seen many Negroes who have been brutalized by other nations and the government refused to take up their cases, saying that they are not paid to protect Negroes but to protect Englishmen. All other nations have arms and battleships, etc.; we want our own battleships, too. We have built up a "Black Star Line." Twenty months ago, as you know, the Negroes had no ships, but now we have four ships. The first one was bought by us two months after we organized, and which is called the Frederick Douglas [Douglass], or otherwise the Yarmouth. The Yarmouth goes to Jamaica, comes to Cuba, and the United States. Since we have floated the Yarmouth we have floated three more. One is called after a Cuban general named Antonio Maceo, and when I leave here on Sunday morning for Santiago, I shall board the Antonio Maceo for Kingston, Jamaica. On the twentieth of this month we shall launch the biggest ship, that will sail from New York to Liberia. We want more ships, we want bigger ships, so that we may be able to carry Negroes to any part of the world. When you are going to leave Cuba we want you to leave in no other ships but the steamships of the Black Star Line. You will be better treated, better facilitated on your own steamships. Black captains, black crews. In the next five years we expect to have fifty ships. If you are going to Japan, China, or anywhere, you can go on a ship of the Black Star Line. But, ladies and gentlemen, you cannot expect to do this except you assist financially. You can buy shares from five to 200. In buying shares you are not giving away your money to charity or any other donation, you are investing your money in a concern which will be of great benefit to you. Do you expect to get up every morning at 6 o'clock and work from January to December; if you expect to work all the days of your life, you will be working until you become old and still working. We want you to work and invest your money and allow it to work for you. John D. Rockefeller, now a millionaire, started out as a poor boy and worked, and after he

worked for a short time and saved his money, he invested it and allowed the money to work for him, and now he is sitting down in his home and his money is still working for him. He could never work for all that money which he possesses.

We want to have big ships that we can go to Jamaica and all the West Indian Islands and load up bananas, etc. At the end of every year the directors call a meeting and whatever profits that are made are divided up amongst the shareholders of the Black Star Line. You must understand that the Black Star Line is owned by you. We have been given concessions to go to Liberia and build up railroads and factories, etc. Liberia is bigger than Cuba. The soil of Liberia is one of the richest in the world. We are going to build homes in Liberia; we are going to build schools in order to school our children. In the last two months we have sent out bricklayers, carpenters and other workmen to construct buildings in Liberia. We have to send out materials to lay the railroads and to build the factories, so that in years to come you can have factories to work in, you can have railroads to ride on when you are going to your work; so that is the reason why we are borrowing two million dollars to assist us to construct Liberia.⁵ The Liberia Construction Loan gives an interest of 5 per cent. at the end of each year. It is no dream, it is no myth, it is no speculation, so that when you [invest in] the Liberia Construction Loan, so that when you invest in the Black Star Line, your money is secured. When you put your money in the white man's bank, he takes the money and uses it and after working that money and getting enormous profits off it, he gives you 3 per cent. interest. At the close of this meeting I would like to see as many of you as possible coming forward to buy shares in the Construction Loan and also in the Star Line. I am only sorry that from the cold which I have had for the last few days, I am unable to speak to you in the manner I would like to, but tomorrow night I hope to be able to speak to you on the battle cry. If you have \$100 in the bank draw \$50 and buy shares in the Black Star Line and the Liberia Construction Loan.

The meeting here came to a close, after His Excellency having spoken for fully one hour and fifty-five minutes, with prayer by our local chaplain at 11:25.

SATURDAY'S MEETING

On Saturday the 19th, the meeting started with the singing of our National Anthem and prayer by our local chaplain. Next was rendered an address by our president, as below:

To His Excellency, Officers, Members and Friends: This evening we meet again for the occasion of the race and to hear all the interesting words from our President General, Hon. Marcus Garvey. Last night he told us of the Black Star Line Corporation and the Liberian Construction Loan

and tonight he has promised to tell us about the battle cry. I am sorry to say that since he came to Cuba he has not been in the best of health. Today he had a slight walk around the town and after he came back he had to go to bed; therefore this evening he is not feeling very well [*line mutilated*] forced himself to speak to us, and we must be still and listen to all that he has to say. He has asked us to assist in order that the association can buy big ships; as it is now there is a ship lying in the harbor at Santiago and which does not belong to any other person but the Negro race, and I hope that we all do not come here only for the purpose of giving addresses but that you have come prepared to buy as many shares as possible and endeavor to do everything we can to assist and support this wonderful gentleman to bring this movement to a desired success. If any of us should go to a white man's shipping office and ask for a first-class passage, the first thing that is told to you is, there are no berths, neither first nor second, and of course you have to either accept deck or be disappointed, even though you may have your delicate family to take home or anywhere. I beg to impress it upon you all to give all the support you can to insure our future benefits.

Mr. Ernest Peterson, Second Vice-President, here said in part:

His Excellency, Officers and Friends, I assume it a very great privilege and pleasure to be able to address you tonight on the subject of appealing to the entire members of the Negro Improvement Association in Cuba (of course our making it known to the other divisions in some way) to endeavor to accumulate a sum of money in order that we could purchase a ship independently for all the divisions in Cuba, and name that ship "The Cuba." I feel sure that it would not run over \$500,000 to buy that ship and also feel sure that it could easily be done, as the people in Cuba have money. If we named it after any one individual it would not represent the entire amount of branches in Cuba, but if we name it "The Cuba" then it would be more appropriate. Now I am asking every man, woman and child to try and subscribe at least one dollar in the Black Star Line for this purpose. It does not mean that you should start right in at once, but I want every member of this association in Cuba to subscribe for the purpose of purchasing a ship. I know that though His Excellency remains here silent he is justly in accord with me. We do not want anybody else to tell us that the "Garvey System" is a fake. If a man were faking, I do not believe he would come out of a sick bed to address a group of people; he is not looking for anything for himself, he is looking for the benefits of the entire race. The majority of us believe that as we become members of the Black Star Line Association we are eligible to the benefits of the entire association.

The only way that you will be is when you put your hands down into your pockets and buy even one share at \$5. We are in the primera clase, as the Hon. Dr. McGuire stated, and I want everybody to realize that we are in the primera clase. I do not want Preston, Banes nor any other place to be above us and therefore I want to see as many as possible of you pushing forward toward the secretary and piling your money on the table.

Mr. Peterson here left off speaking English and spoke in Spanish for the benefit of the Cubans present.

A song was rendered by Miss A. Moncreath, entitled "With Four Hundred Million Men We Shall Fight for Liberty." After which Mr. J. Hillhouse addressed the audience in an able manner.

Mr. A. Recard of the Moncada Club here spoke in Spanish and which was translated by Mr. Peterson to read that he was pleased to state that the Moncada Club has received the Hon. Marcus Garvey with the highest of honor and that any time he should come to Cuba it will be at his disposal, and that His Excellency, though having been to a place of great critics (Havana), no one there was able to criticize him and that his works must exce[el]. He also said that although the Mayor was unable to be present, he showed his great appreciation by giving the use of the municipal band, and that he is strictly in accord with the movement and that he thinks that every Cuban is, sufficient he has some proportion of colored blood in him.

After the following speakers had addressed the audience our president introduced His Excellency in the same manner as the night before: Mr. Alex. Charles,⁶ Miss E. Giscombe, Chaplain Bachelor, Mrs. Sponsper and Mr. A. Fredericks.⁷ These people, as usual, aroused the enthusiasm of the entire crowd and did bring down the house with cheers.

MARCUS GARVEY SPEAKS

His Excellency here commenced at 9:10 p.m. and spoke for fully two hours and forty minutes, lasting until 11:50 p.m.

Mr. President, members and friends of the Guantanamo division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association: As you know, I am suffering from a bad cold I contracted in Key West, caused by coming from the northern climate into this warm one. Nevertheless, I promised you last night that I would speak to you in detail tonight regarding the association. I have been to your city and I have watched you very keenly, notwithstanding your obligation in your work, but those of you who are Cubans, and those of you who are Haytians and Jamaicans, as Negroes you have been trying every effort that every other division of the race could put forth. It is for me to tell you that this race of ours is still enslaved. We are enslaved industrially, economically and in every way

today. We are regarded as industrial slaves. Wherever you go amongst the Negroes in all parts of the world you will find that we are trampled in every way, if it is in the West Indies or anywhere else. Negroes occupy the most menial positions in the world, and this Negro improvement association is trying to relieve us from this mean position that we now occupy. So long as you have one-sixteenth of Negro blood in your veins you are regarded as a member of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. We do not care where you were born—if you were born in the West Indies, if you were born in Cuba, you must understand that you were originally born in Africa and were taken slaves and brought into Jamaica, Cuba, etc., and it is only a case of accident, and I want you to understand that you will have to be born again as a true born African.

I look at it that whatever is your destiny it is my destiny and also look upon it that if I fall you will fall and if I rise you will rise. We are all of the same race, if we go to the United States and you suffer, I will suffer also. If we go to England and you suffer I will suffer also. We must uplift this organization and I want you to realize the seriousness of this movement. It is not a religion, it is not a doctrine of new faith I am preaching to you—I have come to tell you of my determination to carve out the destiny of your race. This particular material world in which we live is reorganizing itself. If a man has a business and it is not paying he will reorganize his staff and put in a new staff to try to build up a fresh trade, and therefore we want you to prepare to reorganize. God Almighty has kept and preserved Africa for us these many years, and Ethiopia is stretching forth its hands to you and I and every other Negro. Some of you may regard it as an idle joke and some of you may regard it as an idle problem, but you will realize the seriousness of it later on. There are some people who say it is only but a dream, but out of this great dream has come four hundred million souls, out of this dream has come seven hundred branches of this association and out of this dream shall come a free and independent Africa. This organization is made up of a determined nature.

COURAGE AND FAITH

The Negro race has been in contact with the white man for over three hundred years, and with all the brutal treatment instead of decreasing in number we have increased to four hundred million, and now Ethiopia is stretching forth its hands for us to come and claim our promised land, and therefore I am here to encourage you, as many of you have lost courage and faith. Many of us have lost confidence in ourselves. If you travel to any part of the world you are kept down to the lowest degree just because your skin is black, and I want to tell you that this world belongs as much to you as to any other race and that you have as much right to exist in this world as any of the other races; that you Negroes made up of the Universal Negro Improvement Association expect as

much out of the world as any white man expects out of it. The white man expects the right to rule and dominate, the yellow man expects the right to rule and dominate and the black man expects the right to rule and dominate also, it is a question that Negroes must find a home of our own. We have pledged our lives and our money and we expect that the world must yield to us what it yields to the white man. As a black man I am not out to fight for anything that belongs to the white man, but I am out to fight and prepared to die for anything that belongs to me. I am not here to preach against anything against the whites over the ques-[tion of . . .]

To be continued⁸

O. LOUIS SHERWOOD
General Secretary

Printed in *NW*, 16 April 1921. Quotations not extracted in original.

1. Club Moncada was a *sociedad de color* named after Guillermo Moncada, one of the Afro-Cuban leaders of the Wars for Independence in Oriente.

2. Richard A. Hilton Bachelor was the chaplain, choirmaster, and official reporter for the Guantánamo division in the early 1920s before serving as one of the Cuban delegates to the 1924 UNIA convention in New York (*NW*, 8 September 1923, 5 July 1924). At the convention, he proposed or supported a number of actions, including: the appointment of a UNIA commissioner for Cuba; sending a note of thanks to the Cuban government for its support of UNIA divisions on the island; pressuring the U.S. government to end its intervention in Haiti; and the possibility of blacks migrating to Haiti and the Dominican Republic to establish agricultural cooperatives. He also complained of the quarantine system in Cuba which applied only to black, but not white, immigrants entering the island (*NW*, 16, 23, and 30 August 1924; *MGP* 5: 714; for detailed information about the conditions in the quarantine stations in Cuba see *Further Correspondence between His Majesty's Government and the Cuban Government Respecting the Ill-treatment of British West Indian Labourers in Cuba*, No. 2 [London, 1924]; and Secretaría de Estado, Cuba, *Copia de la correspondencia cambiata entre la Legación de Su Majestad Británica en La Habana y la Secretaría de Estado de la República, relativa al trato de los inmigrantes jamaquinos* [Havana, 1924]). After returning from the convention, Bachelor toured the length of the island as UNIA organizer, delivering speeches in both English and Spanish to the many divisions he visited (*NW*, 8 November and 22 November 1924, 17 January, 21 February, 28 March, and 11 April 1925). "It is very evident that the visit of this young champion in the cause of liberty has brought a revival in the vicinity. He has also put new life into those who were lukewarm and silenced many critics," reported the Central Macareño branch after Bachelor's visit (*NW*, 7 February 1925). By July 1925 he had been appointed UNIA representative for all of Cuba (*NW*, 18 July and 19 September 1925). In the early 1930s a Richard H. Bachelor was serving as president of UNIA division 139 in Cincinnati, Ohio (*NW*, 9 August 1930, 7 February 1931).

3. Garvey was Provisional President of Africa and President General of the UNIA, not Provisional President General of the UNIA.

4. England campaigned against Turkish forces in Mesopotamia (modern-day Iraq) from 1914 until the end of World War I. The Mesopotamia campaign intensified during 1915 when British forces stationed at Basra moved northward along both the Tigris and Euphrates Rivers. The British failed to capture Baghdad against superior Turkish forces in 1915 but were more successful in 1916 when African troops and a Honduran detachment of the BWIR served in supporting roles (John Buchan, *History of the Great War*, vols. 2–4 [1922; reprint, The Nautical & Aviation Publishing Co. of America, 1980]; Glenford Deroy Howe, *Race, War, and Nationalism: A Social History of West Indians in the First World War* [Kingston, Jamaica, and Oxford: Ian Randle and James Currey, 2002], p. 112). Garvey's suggestion that two million West Indians served in the war is either a slip of the tongue or a misquotation. In a later speech reported in the *Workman* [2 April 1921] his figure of two million included Africans serving in the British, French, and U.S. armies.

5. In October 1920 Garvey announced that the executive council of the UNIA had decided to start construction work in Liberia and declared that the council was "raising a constructive loan of \$2,000,000 from its members" through the bond issue of promissory notes. The stated goal of the fund, dubbed the Liberian Construction Loan, also the African Liberty Loan, was the building of railroads, schools, churches, and other infrastructure in Liberia to create "employment for the millions who will repatriate themselves to the grand old country." The mobilization and propaganda surrounding the loan drive helped to revive Garvey's flagging program in 1921 (*MGP* 3: 54, 68).

6. R. Alexander Charles served Guantánamo Division 164 as secretary in 1922 and president in 1927 and 1928 ("Reglamento de la Asociación Universal Para el Adelanto de la Raza Negra," Santiago de Cuba, 11 July 1922, AHPSC, GP, leg. 2452, exp. 3; R. A. Charles, president, and Geo. H. Tyrell, secretary, UNIA division no. 164, to Civil Governor of the Province of Oriente, Guantánamo, 28 February 1927, AHPSC, GP, leg. 2452, exp. 3; *NW*, 7 January 1928).

7. Christian Alexander Frederick served as president, vice president, and general secretary of Guantánamo Division 164, as well as chairman of the division's literary club, at different times during the 1920s and early 1930s (Charles and Tyrell to Civil Governor of the Province of Oriente, Guantánamo, 28 February 1927; "Asociación Universal para el Adelanto de Raza Negra, División No. 164," Guantánamo, 15 April 1928, AHPSC, GP, leg. 2452, exp. 10; W. Pitter, president, and C. A. Frederick, general secretary, UNIA, Guantánamo, 5 April 1932, AHPSC, GP, leg. 2452, exp. 3; *NW*, 6 October 1923, 2 January 1926, 8 December 1928, and 23 November 1929).

8. The continuation of this article has not been found.

Excerpt from the 1920 Annual Report of the Moravian Mission Province, Nicaragua, Central America, by Guido Grossman¹

[Bluefields, Nicaragua,
April 16th[,] 1921]

...ECONOMICAL CONDITIONS:

In Bluefields² and along the whole coast³ public order was very bad, even murderers going unpunished.⁴ We are sorry to state that among the Creoles⁵ are many who a[re] stepping in the footsteps of the lawless people and thereby they loose more and more thier [their] good name as beeing [being] law abiding people. The reason for this is that their [there] is no stabble [stable] work for them.⁶ Until they will be obliged to till their own soil, our Creole people never will improve. Up to now they have it too easy and this leads to mischief. Two movements have to be mentioned which are threatening to become a danger to our people. Ist. The "Central American Union". In itself good and I wish it all success in bringing it about. But the leaders have also drawn into this movement the Indians just merely for financial support's sake[,] I presume. The collectors have made propaganda among them with illusory promises, so that the Indians⁷ have the most distorted stories about what the "Union" is going to do for them. They think only in term of food, clothing and high wages. 2ndly. "The Universal Negro Improvement Association" with which is connected the "Black Star Line["] of steamship[s]. Marcus Garvey a Jamaican is the leader of the Movement now residing in New York. It is a new form of Ethiopianism.

Back to Africa is on their banner and Africa for the Africans. I do not think that anything during my stay here in Bluefields has taken the people so quickly than this new movement. The majority of our male churchmember[s] and a goodly number of the female as well are active members of the "Black Star Line" and I am sorry to say not with advantage to their inner life. The movement is also "Anti White"[.] Of our experience here in Bluefields Bro. [G.R.] Heath⁸ writes in his report: "Some of our best people have said to me openly: 'our [A]merican missionaries, the Michels,⁹ the Cruickshanks¹⁰ and Br[o]. Shimer¹¹ are fine people and we love them. But we are terrible anxious lest later on missionaries¹² with colour-prejudice be sent out". . .

GUIDO GROSSMAN

Printed in Box: Nicaragua, *Annual Reports of the Mission*, 1914–1926, Moravian Archives, Bethlehem, Pennsylvania.

1. Herbert Guido Grossman was born on 2 May 1871 in Neustadt, Germany. He was trained at the missionary schools in Königsfeld and Niesky. He was ordained a deacon in 1900, a presbyter in 1912, and bishop in 1925. He served as a Moravian missionary in Nicaragua from 1900 to 1937, and in the country, served as superintendent of the region from 1914 through 1937. He left Nicaragua in March 1937 and returned to Kleinwelka, Bautzen, Germany as a result of health concerns, where he died in 1945.

2. Bluefields, located along the shores of the Caribbean Sea, is the largest city along the Atlantic Coast. In 1730, the British colonized it and established a military outpost there. By 1848, Moravian missionaries Heinrich (Henry) Gottlob Pfeiffer, Johannes Eugen Lundberg, and Ernst Gottfried Georg Kandler, established their first mission station in the country at Bluefields. On 14 March 1849, the three found a welcome audience with the British appointed Miskito king. At Bluefields, the missionaries found a mix of native peoples including indigenous Miskito, Europeans, Americans, and transplants from the West Indies, originally descended from Africans. By the 1880s, Bluefields was a bustling commercial center and the center of government. Throughout the twentieth century, it remained the largest center on the Atlantic coast.

3. In total, the coast extends approximately three hundred miles and is filled by dense tropical vegetation. With an annual rainfall of two hundred inches, the inaccurately spelled, "Mosquito Coast" is a term used to designate 300 miles of coast between the 11th and 16th degrees of latitude from the mouth of the Roman River in Honduras to the San Juan de Norte River near Greytown, Nicaragua. Its eastern border is the Caribbean Sea, while the western border is said to stretch approximately forty to forty-five miles inland. The northernmost point of Nicaragua's Atlantic Coast is the town of Cabo Gracias. This expanse of territory is composed of coastline, volcanoes, and highlands, perfect for cultivating coffee and bananas, and harvesting resources including gold, silver, and rubber.

4. The Annual Reports by the Moravian missionaries consistently noted the instability of the coast in the late 1910s and early 1920s. With the economic and fiscal crisis abounding, it is conceivable that there was judicial turmoil as well, but no evidence in non-Moravian sources has been found suggesting that murderers or other criminals were going unpunished or that laws were not being upheld.

5. According to Moravian Bishop Karl Mueller the Creole in Nicaragua are "descendents of the Buccaneers (especially those of Scotch nationality), who in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries had founded a kind of free booter republic on the Spanish main (Among Sumu, Rama, Miskito, and Creole, 56)." They allied themselves with the Miskito people and spoke English. Numerous other sources, including anthropologist Charles R. Hale, note that the Creole peoples along the coast were of Afro-Caribbean heritage. (Charles R. Hale, *Resistance and Contradiction: Miskito Indians and the Nicaraguan State, 1894–1987* [Stanford: Stanford University Press, 1994]). Both sources agree that approximately one-third of the Creole people were adherents to Moravianism by 1932 and that the language spoken by this group was English. Most Creole peoples resided in either Bluefields or Pearl Lagoon.

6. In the years after World War I, numerous businesses dismissed their workers because the price of mahogany wood had fallen. Traders along the coast stopped their practices and collected their

debts. Money was scarce, and the prices of goods remained high. The 1920 Annual Report notes "in 1916, four Mahagony [*sic*] Camps employing 250 to 300 men also in the District were 6 stores to day all the camps are shut and just one store is still open." The following year, economic conditions remained the same, as noted in the "Annual Report of the Work in the Mission Province, Nicaragua, 1921" by Guido Grossman. The closure of the mahogany works had reduced the activity in the gold mines. He wrote, "Consequently no demand for labourers neither for paddlers on the river to bring goods to the miners and mahogany camps, finally also the failure of some important business houses on the coast caused great perplexity among our people." As a result, there was little opportunity for anyone to make money, and hence the prevalence of poverty among some of their members.

7. The Moravians were in contact with the Sumo, Rama, Woolwas, and Miskito tribes of Nicaragua in the 1920s. Moravian Bishop Karl Mueller suggested that the indigenous people did not live in Bluefields, but preferred the riverbank or the savannah to town.

8. George Reinke Heath was born on 16 February 1879 in Fairfield, Jamaica, to Reverend George Octavius Heath and Charlotte Elizabeth Reinke. He studied medicine at the University of Manchester from 1895 through 1899 and then received missionary training in Niesky, Germany, from 1899 through 1901. (He was unable to complete his medical training because of illness.) In 1901, he was called to serve in Nicaragua; a position he retained until 1924. During his years in the country, he was stationed at Ephrata, Karata, Bluefields, and Karawala. He was ordained a deacon in June of 1901 and a presbyter in 1910. His most enduring legacy during his time in Nicaragua was his translation of the Scriptures and hymns into the Miskitu language, thus giving thousands of Miskitu people access to them. From 1930 through 1945, he was stationed in Honduras and became the first superintendent of the region after it was made a separate field in 1938. He passed away in 1956 in Winston-Salem, North Carolina.

9. Eugene Levin Michel was born on 3 July 1886 in West Salem, Illinois, to Ferdinand and Anna Michel. He was trained at Moravian College's Theological Seminary in Bethlehem, Pennsylvania, where he earned Bachelor of Arts and Bachelor of Divinity degrees. He was ordained a deacon in 1915. He was called to be the warden of Nicaragua during the close of World War I, where he served from 1918 through 1923. His health, however, prevented him from staying in Nicaragua for the duration of his career, and instead he returned to the United States, where he served until his retirement in 1949. He passed away in 1961.

10. James Herbert Skinner Cruickshank was born on 17 October 1885 in Dundee, Scotland. He was trained at the Moravian College's Theological Seminary in Bethlehem, Pennsylvania. After working in West Africa, he left the mission field as a result of illness. By 1919, he had recovered and was called to serve in Bluefields, Nicaragua, from 1919 to 1922, where he was charged with supervising the Moravian school system in Nicaragua. He left the mission field in 1922. Mrs. Louise Bertha Gapp Cruickshank was born on 3 January 1886 in Egg Harbour, New Jersey, to Philip Henry Gapp and Anna Sperber Gapp. She married Herbert Cruickshank on 25 September 1907, and the two moved to South Africa in 1908. In South Africa, she worked as a teacher. The records do not indicate that she moved to Nicaragua; however, the annual report mentions her being there with her husband in 1921.

11. Clayton Conrad Shimer was born on 27 March 1892 to Clayton L. and Carolina Louisa Shimer. He was trained at the Moravian College's Theological Seminary in Bethlehem, Pennsylvania. In 1920, he accepted an assignment as the assistant manager of the mission store, the "Casa Comercial," in Bluefields, Nicaragua. He was ordained a deacon in 1923 and continued to work in Nicaragua until retiring in 1960. During his forty years of service, Shimer taught Spanish at the Colegio Morava, became a leader in the Mission's Sunday School, was active in the Young Men's and Young Women's Unions, and became the warden of the area from 1923 to 1934. He died in 1970.

12. Missionaries were people charged with the job of converting a specific population, in this case the indigenous and Creole populations, to Christianity. They were ordained and trained, most commonly at the Mission schools of Niesky or Konigsfeld in Germany, Livingstone Medical College in London, or the Moravian Seminary in Bethlehem, Pennsylvania. Missionaries were responsible for uplifting the population they worked with. Included in the missionaries' responsibilities would be evangelizing, preaching, delivering church services, performing sacraments, teaching primary and secondary school, and providing medical aid.

Robert S. F. Blake to the *Negro World*

[[Banes-Oriente, Cuba,
16 April, 1921]]

A MESSAGE FROM BANES-ORIENTE, CUBA

Editor Negro World:

Dear Sir: Permit me a little space in one of the columns of your valuable paper for the insertion of this letter. We of the Banes Division send greetings to you and your associates for the marvelous work The Negro World, edited by you, is accomplishing. You do not often hear from us, but at this juncture we cannot help making our brethren know throughout the world the wonderful strides we are making. The Chaplain General's visit has electrified the entire community. Banes was taken by storm by the presence of this notable personage, this learned doctor, this prince of the race. His every word was inspiring, educating and uplifting. For five nights Liberty Hall was packed to its utmost capacity. Since this visit our numbers are soaring by leaps and bounds. Dear Sir, we are glad of this fact, that the most intelligent people of the community are all earnest, active members of the U.N.I.A. Having passed our 300 mark, and seeing the 400 in view, we have accordingly elected our honorable advisory board, consisting of twenty-five men, true race men.

In this division, sir, you will find men in all walks of life, men of the medical profession, engineers, tradesmen, mechanics, and others, all united, standing firm, with one watch-word, "A free and redeemed Africa," willing, if need be, to make the supreme sacrifice, even the shedding of their life blood. We are glad to be living in an age like this. Our Black Cross nurses have also been formed, and are under training by their efficient leader, Mrs. H.A. Collins, whose husband is our worthy executive secretary. In the absence of the president, Mr. A.J. Burrell, the leadership has fallen on the shoulders of our enthusiastic first vice-president, Mr. Egbert Newton. Honor to whom honor is due. In this man is embodied the attributes of a leader, a stately figure, a wonderful delivery, a wise counselor, coupled with a clear vision. Such are the leaders that the Hon. Marcus Garvey needs. May they be favored with a long life to carry on this glorious work until our goal is reached.

Thanking you for space, I am very respectfully yours,

Robert S. F. Blake,
Acting Chaplain, Banes Div.

Printed in NW, 16 April 1921.

Article in the *Negro World*

[Tela,¹ Honduras, 16 April, 1921]

SPECIAL EASTER PROGRAM IN HONDURAS

Tela, Honduras, April 16.-The local division of the U.N.I.A. here celebrated Easter under the colors of the Red, Black and Green. Perhaps the largest (excepting the unveiling ceremony) assembled in the local Liberty Hall (the Samaritan's Hall) when special services were held. The choir pealed out in melodious sound the "Allelula, Alleluia, Alleluia." "The Strife is Over." Chaplain J.J. Brown occupied the chair, and seated on the platform with him were D. Erastus Thorpe, divisional president Ladies' Division; Mr. J.B. Wray, schoolmaster, and Mr. and Mrs. Ensign Alexander of the Salvation Army; and T.A. Vernal general secretary. Too much praise cannot be given the chaplain for his masterful and eloquent address for the afternoon. The closing of this celebration, however, was on Monday night, when the juveniles entertained the community. This was the children's night and amused the parents and friends assembled. These youngsters and misses demonstrated their prowess in being useful citizens when grown up. Much credit must be given to those persons who have had the arduous task in preparing them. President Thorpe occupied the chair, and in his usual style did put through what was a lengthy but enjoyable program.

Special mention must be made of the choir under Miss S. Fuller and Mr. O.E. Barrell. Their rendition was of the highest order and can scarcely be excelled, especially for the short space of time they were in preparation. Mr. C. Painting as usual was at his best and Miss G. Moore, the Madame Patti² of our local division, was in the pink of form. Miss Eber, the alto deserves special mention for her singing, as she attracted the attention of the entire audience. The orchestra under the presidency of Mr. J.A. Kennedy, first vice-president of the division, and the musical direction of Mr. G. Adolphus, added splendor to the musical program.

Printed in NW, 30 April 1921.

1. Honduran settlers established Tela in the 1860s with a population of about five hundred. It first flourished when Hondurans cultivated bananas, a control that remained important into the first decade of the twentieth century. Whereas La Ceiba became the seat of Standard Fruit Co.'s managerial operations, Tela became the early hub of the UFC's administration. The Tela region saw imported black British laborers officially permitted for the banana companies for the first time in 1912. However, some sources suggest that black labor from the British Caribbean came to Honduras to work on railroad construction in the late 1860s and early 1870s (Alfredo León Gómez, *El Escandalo del ferrocarril* [Tegucigalpa: Imprenta Soto, 1978], p. 129; Rafael Angel Elvir, *La cartilla histórica de los teleños* [Tela: Mimeo, 1982]; Mario R. Argueta, *Historia de los sin historia* [Tegucigalpa: Editorial Universitaria, 1992], p. 58).

2. Adelina Juana Maria Patti (1843-1919), a famous prima donna, was born in Spain to Italian parents who were both operatic singers. Her family immigrated to the United States when she was five, and she received her operatic training in New York City. Patti sang operas of the Italian school, and she performed in major cities throughout the United States and in France, Germany, Italy, Spain, Russia, Mexico, and parts of South America. The soprano was the highest-paid singer of her

era. She bought Craig-y-Nos Castle in Wales in 1878 and lived there with her lover, Italian tenor singer Ernesto Nicolini, whom she married in 1886 after divorcing her first husband, Henri de Roger de Cahusac, the Marquis of Caux. Following Nicolini's death in 1898, Patti married a Swedish aristocrat, Baron Rolf Cederström, in 1899. Patti died in Wales and was buried in Paris's Père Lachaise cemetery (Michael Kennedy and Joyce Bourne, eds., *The Concise Oxford Dictionary of Music*, 4th ed. [Oxford: Oxford Univ. Press, 1996], s.v. "Patti, Adelina"; Michel Mortier, *Biographical Sketch of Madame Adelina Patti* [New York: Steinway and Sons, 1881]; Herman Klein, *The Reign of Patti* [New York: Century, 1920]; John Frederick Cone, *Adelina Patti: Queen of Hearts* [Portland, Oreg.: Amadeus Press, 1993]).

George P. Chittenden, General Manager,
United Fruit Company, to H. S. Blair,
Division Manager, United Fruit Company

LIMÓN, COSTA RICA
April 17th, 1921

Dear Sir:

Referring to our telephone conversation in regard to Garvey's visit to Costa Rica and Panama. For some time past, the local branch here have been expecting him and we have had an understanding with their leaders that Garvey's meetings would be arranged so as not to interfere with fruit cuttings or loadings. He was reported to be travelling around on a ya[cht] or special steamer but for some reason changed his plans and came over to Limon on the S/S Coronado which arrived Thursday afternoon. I understand it was Garvey's original intention to start his meetings here Friday night and Saturday night and leave for Bocas Monday or Tuesday. However, after his arrival he agreed to follow out the program arranged by the Limon Branch, that is, to put in the time visiting San José until Monday when we would be through with our fruit cuttings and loadings. He left for San José by special train Friday morning and will return to Limon Monday, holding his first meeting here Monday afternoon and night. The officers of the local branch expect an attendance of five or six thousand West Indians and are arranging for special trains from all of the banana districts to Limon Monday.

On account of the delay in holding his first meeting here Garvey has now decided to postpone his trip to Bocas until Thursday. He wishes to leave Limon Thursday morning, arrive Bocas del Toro Thursday afternoon and hold his first meeting there Thursday night; leave for Guabito¹ Friday morning and hold his second meeting in Guabito Friday night, returning to Almirante² Saturday and holding his third and last meeting in Almirante Saturday afternoon and night, returning to Limon Sunday to take his steamer which he says will surely appear by that time.

From our telephone conversation I understand that the above program will not interfere with your work; in fact, these people have so far shown a will-

APRIL 1921

ingness to make their arrangements fit in with our work and I do not believe either of us will have any trouble. In view of this spirit, I believe it policy for us to handle Garvey to and from Bocas on the launch Preston. On receipt of this letter please confirm the arrangement to dispatch the Preston to arrive Limon Wednesday afternoon to take Garvey to Bocas Thursday morning, also to send him back to Limon on the Preston leaving Bocas early Sunday morning. Very truly yours,

G. P. CHITTENDEN

cc MR. CUTTER

UFC. TLS, recipient's copy. On UFC letterhead, Costa Rica Division. Marked "Confidential."

1. Guabito is a small town in the Changuinola district of Bocas del Toro province; located directly across the Rio Sixaola from Sixaola, Costa Rica, it is a border crossing between Panama and Costa Rica and connects Guabito to Sixaola.

2. Almirante is a town in the province of Bocas del Toro, built by the United Fruit Company as a port for the export of its bananas. Its first settlers were mostly descendants of West Indians who moved inland for the banana plantations in the early 1900s. It is mainly used as a jumping-off point for land travel to other cities on the mainland of Panama or to Costa Rica.

Article in the *Negro World*

[New Providence,¹ Panama,
18 April, 1921]

NEW PROVIDENCE BRANCH ACTIVE IN PANAMA

New Providence, Panama, April 18. A sacred concert was given under the auspices of the Branch of the U.N.I.A. here on Easter Sunday by Mrs. Florence Bailey, one of the association's elementary school teachers. Tho concert was held in the Liberty Hall here, which is the bona fide property of the branch, and the hall was crowded beyond its scattting capacity, hundreds being turned away.

Seated on the platform were Messrs. J.D. Burnet, president: W.S. McCourty, first vice-president: H.G. Johnson, chaplain: Mrs. Iris McDonald, lady president: Mrs. L.R. Gordon, general secretary, and other high officials of the New Providence Star Lodge and the New Providence Trading and Developing Corporation, who paid the U.N.I.A. a glowing tribute of honor by sending their officers and members in large numbers as a token of honor and appreciation to the cause. The chaplain opened the meeting with the ode, "From Greenland's Icy Mountains" and prayer, after which he in his usually impressive manner threw out some very touching remarks relative to the U.N.I.A. and its spiritual development of the race. He exhorted his hearers to follow closely the principles of the U.N.I.A. and success will surely be ours. The well-known druggist, Mr. C.C. Woodham acted as chairman. In a brief address

he featured the birth of his Excellency, the Hon. Marcus Garvey, and the doctrine of the U.N.I.A. as in close semblance with that of Christ.

The program follows: Anthem, "Open My Lips," by the choir: recitation, "A Child of a King": song, by the school: recitation, "Virtue Be Your Aim," by Miss Denny: address, by Mr. Collins; anthem, "Praise Ye the Lord," choir: recitation, "Africa, Awake": solo, "Dark Below and Light Above," by Mrs. Essie Hylton; dramatic play, "Belshazzar's Feast": song. "Merry Birds," by the school: address, by W.S. McCourty: recitation. "The Day of Wrath," by Master Harold Darkins: solo, "The Golden Gate," by Miss Entie Rose: address, by Mr. Morris: anthem, "As the Heart Panteth," by the choir: solo. "Sing praises," by Mrs. Boyce: recitation, "Love" by Master O. Denny; duet. "Some Day," by Corp. Henderson and Mrs. L.D. Gordon: recitation, by Miss Priscilla Burnet: anthem, "Have Mercy Upon Us," by choir; address, by Mr. J.D. Burnet, president; duet, by Mrs. Denny and Mrs. Hylton: recitation, by Miss Winfred Small: quartet, "Oh, Sing Praises": address by Mr. Fred Johnson: anthem, "I Will Call Upon the Lord," by choir: recitation, "Kind Words" by Mr. Collins; song, by school: address, by Mr. H.G. Johnson: anthem. "Onward," choir; "Mizpah," by Mrs. Kidd.

Much credit is due Mrs. Bailey, the association's school teacher of this branch, for her devotion to the cause.

Easter Monday was also known as a red-letter day among the residents of this neighborhood and members of the association. At 9 o'clock a.m. the ladies and lasses of the Black Cross Nurses' First Aid Society and Boys' Brigade of this branch, fully dressed in their uniforms, made a thorough lineup by the way of a procession, carrying slogans and mottoes, marched to the entrance of the district to meet their comrades of the Black Cross Nurses First Aid Society and Boys' Brigade of the Colon Division. The former, under the leadership of Mr. W.E. Allen, and the latter under the leadership of Corp. D.V. Watson. Here they made a demonstration on the parade grounds after which the Boys' Brigade of this branch under the command of Corp. Henderson engaged in a sham fight with that of the Colon division under the command of Corp. Watson. Among them were the Black Cross Nurses of both divisions. When this was over the bogie sounded, and under the command of their respective leaders they marched to the front of Liberty Hall, where they were banqueted. A monster mass meeting was given in honor of the Colon Division of the U.N.I.A. that evening.

Printed in *NW*, 30 April 1921.

1. New Providence, Colón, Panama.

Article in the *Negro World*

[Oriente, Cuba, 18 April, 1921]

U.N.I.A., MARCANE¹ DIVISION CUBA

The president, Mr. Michael Alexander, is on his way to Panama on a vacation trip. The following speech was delivered to him before his departure: "Mr. Michael Alexander, president of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L., Marcane, Oriente de Cuba.

"Sir: In behalf of this division of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L., we the undersigned think it our utmost duty to present you this address on this the eve of your departure from our midst. We have already missed you, but owing to the fact that your going home is only a vacation trip, we will surely give you up until those days are accomplished. We therefore wish that you may have many happy returns of the day and that you may have good times among your family and friends. While those behind here will be sorry to lose you for some time, there are many who are yearning to give you happy repose and sweet responses home. Sir, we can never for the least forget to think of the many happy days you have spent among us, especially in this grand organization of the Negroes of the world. Since this branch has been placed or organized you have been placed in the presidential chair, and never could such a position be filled by a better man than you. You have spared no pains to make this branch a success. Through your energetic and strategic manner you have truly gained the hearts of every well-thinking Negro in Marcane, Oriente. You have had all the power necessary to be a leader and ruler, and we hope that this same spirit may exist in you to lead us, though far away. We'll be ever looking to you for your messages, which are always a stimulant to your people. We trust that the days may quickly come or glide when we will have you back to your post of duty. Hoping your health may not fail you and those related to you, and hoping the God in heaven may keep and protect you to bring you back to us once more. Wishing you a safe and pleasant voyage. To show your people's appreciation of your worth we have the honor of presenting you this purse. The Lord watch between we and thee, though we be absent one from another."

At the ending of this departing lecture all the officers arose and stood at ease in front of the Hon. President Mr. Alexander sang hymn No. 298, which is as follows: "God be with you till we meet again." This mournful and departing song brought tears from many members' eyes; at the point of this view the executive secretary, Mr. George Scott Anderson, was elected as acting president until the president's return.

Congratulations for the space granted, Mr. Editor, to advertise this matter to the public in your most wonderful paper.

The Negro World. (Signed):
R. Webley, Chaplain
C. Francis, Organizer

A.G. Peart, Treasurer
Geo. Scott Anderson
Executive Secretary and Acting President.
Now, Mercane Division, Oriente, Cuba.
April 18, 1921.

Printed in NW, 7 May 1921.

1. Marcané is a barrio of the municipality and city of Banes in the northeastern province of Holguín, the third most populous province of Cuba after Ciudad de la Habana and Santiago de Cuba.

Telegram from Walter C. Thurston, Secretary,
U.S. Embassy, Costa Rica, to Charles Evans
Hughes, U.S. Secretary of State

San Jose [Costa Rica,]
April 19th, 1921

Please instruct me at once whether or not Marcus Garvey may be aided in entering Panama. He desires Panam[ani]an visa from Consul McMillin at Port Limon who holds Panam[ani]an consular representation.

THURSTON

[*Addressed to:*] Secretary of State,
Washington D.C. *FROM* Green San Jose

DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/9. TG, recipient's copy.

Article in *Diario de Costa Rica*¹

[San José, 19 April 1921]

HOW MR. GARVEY WAS RECEIVED IN LIMÓN

THE *NEGRITOS*² ARE STILL CELEBRATING

The *negritos* are still celebrating the arrival of Mr. Marcus Garvey, the likely President of Africa.

Fliers were posted on the street corners in Limón to announce his imminent arrival and the *negritos* prepared clothing and insignias to wear to attend the demonstration.

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WHO IS MARCUS GARVEY?

Many natives of the country and no smaller number of resident foreigners are well acquainted with this Jamaican subject who from one moment to the next acquired a high profile in the world by assuming the leadership of the formidable ethnic revolution that is believed to be near exploding.

He lived here for a long time and dedicated himself to agriculture and then to journalism. In this last capacity, he was the deceased Salomón Aguilera's partner.

He spent a long time in San José and forged many friendships. We do not know what kind of employment he had in the capital, but it is likely that it was humble. Mr. Garvey had not yet developed the magnificent and delicate idea thanks to which his name is now known in the whole world.

WHICH IDEA IS THAT?

Although we are not well versed in the scope of his plans, we have read in more than one foreign magazine that this new Messiah intends to end the apparent inferiority of the black race, placing it above the white race, by means of force or numbers[.] [T]hat is to say, he advocates for a movement seeking vindication to place control of the world in the hands of the black race.

We do not know to what extent this version [of Garvey's ideas] may be true, but as we said, on different occasions we have seen such views publicized in a number of well-recognized magazines.

PRESIDENT OF AFRICA

Lately, Mr. Marcus Garvey has been proposed for the Presidency of Africa. He is supported by the will of four million citizens who acclaim him joyfully as their Redeemer, which makes it likely that he will soon occupy such high office.

In the United States, Mr. [G]arvey has already established a great office of propaganda. Someone who visited there and who knows the person with whom we are concerned, tells us that several hundred employees work there constantly. To see Mr. [G]arvey in his offices, one must keep a protracted wait. It is almost harder than seeing the President of the great northern republic.

HIS ARRIVAL

His Excellency was expected on Tuesday or Wednesday of this week aboard the "Antonio Maceo," a ship of the Black Line, but last Thursday, in the late afternoon, the rumor that Mr. Garvey would arrive in Limón at 19 hours circulated persistently.

Indeed, the notable Mr. Garvey arrived on our shores on the indicated hour on board the "Conrado [Coronado]," and even though his arrival occurred earlier than expected, no fewer than 2000 *negritos* were present to pay him their respects.

In that place, Mr. Garvey harangued the crowd with very cordial words, and was interrupted repeatedly by the warm hurrahs and applause.

From that moment on, the community of colored immigrants who reside here was overflowing with enthusiasm, traversing the main streets of the city.

The illustrious guest will remain in Costa Rica for a very short stay.

Nonetheless, a huge demonstration is expected, since sympathizers will be coming from all places of the rail lines.

Printed in *Diario de Costa Rica*, 19 April 1921. Translated from Spanish.

1. Both this and the following article (from 20 April 1921) appeared on the front page of the *Diario de Costa Rica*. The interest shown by the *Diario de Costa Rica* in Marcus Garvey is noteworthy because the newspapers in San José seldom paid attention to events and issues that concerned the West Indian community in Limón. The tone of the article, in the original Spanish, is not sarcastic but rather quite respectful (if somewhat exoticizing).

2. There is a sharp contrast between the condescending tone used by Costa Rican newspapers in discussing local black immigrants ("los negritos") and the quite respectful tone used regarding the struggles of the worldwide black population ("los negros"). In Costa Rican Spanish, "negrito" is a mildly bigoted term that is still used. The term "negro" in Spanish means black and was not necessarily derogatory during this period. The term has become more politically and racially charged in recent decades. In the current context the term "moreno," or "colored," is used, but "negro" is never used in the presence of Afro-Costa Ricans.

Article in *Diario de Costa Rica*

[San José, 20 April 1921]

PRESIDENT OF THE FUTURE AFRICAN FEDERATION HONORED

NEARLY 10,000¹ IN ATTENDANCE

The celebration that the colored race organized in Limón to honor Mr. Marcus Garvey was extraordinary.

Nearly 10,000 persons who did not want to miss the festivities arrived in Limón from along the rail lines.

The President, Mr. Garvey, arrived at Limón at 17 hours. He was received at the station by a colored crowd bearing banners, flags, and bouquets.

Stages and grandstands, adorned for the celebration with flags and garlands, were built in the plaza in front of the military barracks.

Printed in *Diario de Costa Rica*, 20 April 1921. Translated from Spanish.

1. 10,000 people is roughly half the total population of people of African descent in Costa Rica at this time.

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George P. Chittenden, General Manager,
United Fruit Company, to H. S. Blair,
Division Manager, United Fruit Company

LIMÓN, COSTA RICA
[20 April] 1921

Dear Blair:

Referring to letters between you and Mr. Doswell, dated April 16th and 17th, in the matter of Marcus Garvey. Mr. Garvey made a long call on me in San José the day before yesterday. If he keeps his word he will make no trouble; but the policy originally initiated by you of not entering into any discussion, is beyond doubt the best one to follow.

Garvey impressed me as something mean to debate with. He has no rules at all. However, if you play up to his vanity a little, and talk to him the way you would talk to one of your own laborers with whom you were on extra good terms, you will have no trouble with him. This is said long before he leaves, and I may be wrong, but it is the way I size up the matter right now.

He states that he too is an employer of labor, understands our position, is against labor unions, and is using his best endeavor to get the negro race to work and better themselves through work.

Supposing you take this as my final size-up. If I have anything else to add I will send it by special messenger.

Garvey expects the "Antonio Maceo," his yacht, to arrive in Bocas on Sunday and will, therefore, not require transportation back to Limon. That is, he has not engaged transportation here and therefore will have to come after anyone else in case he changes his mind.

I confirm what Mr. Doswell said on the 17th, to the effect that it would be well to handle him on the "Preston" if you can possibly see your way to do so. We have made him pay for all train service here at special rate which covers the cost of handling, and a bit over. Do you want us to collect in advance for the "Preston"? If so, how much? Very truly yours,

G. P. CHITTENDEN

cc V. M. Cutter, Esq.

[*Handwritten note:*] We shall expect you to cancel ball game any time you see fit. Are you coming over & is Mrs. B coming. We expect you but [*remainder missing*]

UFC. TLS. On UFC letterhead, Costa Rica Division. Marked "Personal."

Article in the *Daily Chronicle*

[Georgetown, British Guiana,
20 April 1921]

NEGRO IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION

MEETING ON THE PARADE GROUND¹

On Monday morning there was a Mass meeting in the Bourda Green² by the members of the African Blood Brotherhood and the Negro Improvement Association, at which several matters of importance to the association were discussed. The holding of this meeting is significant when it is remembered that Mr. Marcus Garvey, the President of the Parent Association in America, is at present on a visit to Jamaica of which island he is a native and where he is busy holding a series of meetings in an effort to secure greater co-operation among the negroes of that country.

Printed in *DC*, 20 April 1921.

1. The Parade Ground is in the city of Georgetown.

2. Bourda Green is also in the city of Georgetown, near one of the municipal markets. However, as Bourda Green and the Parade Ground are nearly a mile apart, there appears to be some contradiction over where the meeting was actually held.

Article in *Jueves* [Mexico]

[Mexico City, 21 April 1921]

HE HAS TRIUMPHED IN THE UNITED STATES

[The] "Black Moses"—as Garvey is called—has triumphed loudly in the United States, gathering around himself more than three million blacks. Thus, he is today the black leader with the largest following.

This man possesses a rare culture, an extraordinary vitality, and a profound knowledge of the psychology of his element. He has caused a true, peaceful revolution in the United States, dazzling blacks with his marvelous eloquence, with his pontifical gestures, and with the spectacle of his public appearances. Today, Garvey is an idol to many thousands of American blacks who call him "His Royal Highness" and who almost worship him.

It could be said without exaggeration that Garvey has created for the American black, a black ideal, a black mentality, and a black soul . . . "Garveyism," then, is something very complex that could only be defined by saying that it is simultaneously a social, economic, political, and religious institution.

Garveyism has its motto, which is "One God, one purpose, and one destiny"; it has its official hymn, entitled "Ethiopia, thou land of our fathers" and it has its flag of red, black, and green. Black represents the color of the believ-

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ers; green represents the hope that motivates them, and red represents the blood that they are willing to shed for the ideal they hold. . .

Mr. Garvey remained in Costa Rica four days and departed last Monday on the steam ship "Coronado." While visiting this capital, he visited the main public buildings but because he had no more time he did not lecture on the topics discussed above.

Printed in *Jueves*, 21 April 1921. Translated from Spanish.

George P. Chittenden, General Manager,
United Fruit Company, to Victor M. Cutter,
Vice President, United Fruit Company

LIMÓN, COSTA RICA

April 22, 1921

Dear Sir:

Marcus Garvey sailed for Bocas Thursday morning after three days of speaking in Limon and vicinity. The result of his speeches will be in general, favorable to our business. The meetings were largely attended but there were not so many people as was expected originally. Three or four Jamaicans, resident in Costa Rica, had been groomed by their followers to attack Garvey in the meetings, demanding financial statements of his various enterprises and show him up in general. The best one of these lasted five minutes.

After all Garvey was the most conservative man of any attending the meetings. He told them they should not fight the United Fruit Company, that the work given them by the United Fruit Company meant their bread and butter and that they would not only deserve but receive the same respect as the United Fruit Company, once they had farms, railways and steamships of their own and showed that they could operate them. He said that in order to operate such an enterprise they must have money and that in order to get money they had to work. I know that at one meeting two scrap baskets and one suit case full of United States gold notes were collected (Garvey announced that he would receive nothing but U.S. currency in contributions). I know that at another meeting he stood beside a pile of gold notes which reached above his knees. It is impossible to estimate the amount collected but it might easily be as much as \$50,000.00,¹ all of which he took away with him in cash.

Mr. Barnett of the Federacion de Trabajadores,² endeavored to start a counter attraction during Garvey's stay here. He made no impression on the populace. All together we are very well satisfied with the results of the visit and can only wish the Panama Division the same luck as walked with us. I enclose Mr. Barnett's circular³ covering his counter attraction. Very truly yours,

cc H. S. Blair, Esq.

UFC. TLS. On UFC letterhead, Costa Rica Division.

1. This is the highest estimate of the contributions made to the UNIA during Garvey's visit, but even if Garvey collected only half as much it would be an enormous amount of money for the Costa Rican West Indian community that numbered approximately 20,000 in total. Most of those who did work were unskilled, and even the better-paid skilled workers would not have made more than \$75.00 per month in 1921 (Aviva Chomsky, *West Indian Workers and the United Fruit Company in Costa Rica, 1870-1940* [Baton Rouge: University of Louisiana Press, 1996]).

2. The Federación de Trabajadores was a Limón-based union that led a strike against the UFC in January-February 1921. It was reported that 2,500 farm and railroad workers participated in the strike, which was a protest against layoffs, as well as a 30 percent wage reduction. The strike helped to establish important ties between the Limón banana workers and organizations in San José. Most notably, the Federación received financial and political support from the Confederación General de Trabajadores in San José, with which it signed a pact in January 1921 (Elisavinda Echeverri-Gent, "Forgotten Workers: British West Indians and the Early Days of the Banana Industry in Costa Rica and Honduras," *JLAS* 24:2 [May 1992]: 295-296; Ronald N. Harpelle, *The West Indians of Costa Rica: Race, Class, and the Integration of an Ethnic Minority* [Montreal and Kingston: McGill-Queen's University Press and Ian Randle Publishers, 2001], pp. 56, 58).

3. This document has not been found.

Mabel M. Douglas to the *Negro World*

[[Banes, Oriente, Cuba,
ca. 23 April 1921]]

THE U.N.I.A. THE NEGRO'S ONLY HOPE IN THE WORLD

After being privileged to see face to face the Moses and Aaron of our race and to hear from them personally the aims and objects of this world-wide movement, it is my intention to publish my opinion of the movement and its leaders through the columns of your valuable paper, feeling sure you will permit me space.

To my mind the U.N.I.A. is the greatest world-wide movement that has ever been organized for Negroes since the history of the race. Its aims and objects are just and right in the sight of the most irrational. The U.N.I.A. is the only hope that the Negro has left in the world, therefore its success or failure will either arm or disarm him.

The ode of the U.N.I.A. is inspiring. It has something that awakens the heart when it is being sung. It tells of something that is done, something that is doing and something that is still to be done. Its authors I dare say, are fully Christ[ia]nized, else they would not have been able to accomplish such a mast[er]piece.

The founder of the U.N.I.A., His Excellency the Hon. Marcus Garvey, is a man of genius. Taking him by picture one will say "he looks as if he has some reasoning," but taking Mr. Garvey personally no poet could find words to

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define his stature, his physical build or his humor. At the sight of Mr. Garvey well may all Negroes say "This is the redeemer of our race."

Our noble Aaron,¹ in the person of His Grace the Chaplain General, is indeed a true Christian, thus rendering himself the right man in the right place. He is an ideal orator. I feel sure, sir, that with the right "Hur" manfully will he perform his duty, not on the hill in Rephidim,² but on one of the Cameroon peaks, West Africa.

In conclusion, may I say sir:

God bless our Marcus Garvey.
And our Chaplain, long live he,
And when they in Liberia shall rule,
May I be there to see.

I remain, sir, Yours fraternally,

MABEL M. DOUGLAS

Printed in *NW*, 23 April 1921.

1. In the Hebrew Bible and the Qur'an, Aaron was the older brother of Moses (Exod. 6:16-20, 7:7; Qur'an 28:34) and a prophet of God.

2. In Scripture, Rephidim was the site where Moses miraculously caused water to flow from a rock after striking it with his rod. It was also the site where the Israelites fought the Amalekites, a battle which they won after Aaron and Hur helped Moses to raise his rod (Exod. 17; Paul J. Achtemeier, ed., *Harper's Bible Dictionary* [San Francisco, Calif.: Harper & Row, 1985], pp. 2, 862).

Article in the *Negro World*

[[Guaro, Cuba, 23 April, 1921]]

U.N.I.A. AND A.C.L., GUARO DIVISION, CUBA

Editor *Negro World*:

Dear Sir- I am taking a great pleasure in sending you some news from our division, hoping you will find space in your paper to mention same at your earliest possible convenience. I want my brother men, women and children throughout the entire world to know that we, as a division, are not sleeping, but marching onward into success. We had on Easter Sunday a very pleasant mass meeting. Our text was taken from the twentieth chapter of St. John, verse 13. The words were as follows: "And they say unto her, Woman, why weepest thou?" And she saith unto them, "Because they have taken away my Lord and I know not where they have laid him." The words of the text were so expressively explained by the chaplain that the people all listened attentively. At the close of

the sermon the 161st hymn was sung by the choir. Next came the president's address. His address was based upon "Christ the Savior of the World and Garvey (Hon.) the savior of the Negro Race." With patience and interestedness the people silently digested his most appreciated address. Next came the secretary's address, who impressed on the people the necessity of a continual marching onward if their aims and objects are to be achieved. "Let us then be determined," said he, "to do all to attain our aims and objects so that in a very near future we may be all standing under our own vine and fig tree." Last, but not least, came a short closing address by the president. The meeting was brought to a close by the singing of the Universal Ethiopian Anthem and prayer by the chaplain.

Printed in *NW*, 23 April 1921.

Nathaniel Ricketts to the *Daily Gleaner*

[[*Panama*, ca. 23 April 1921]]

WHAT A JAMAICAN IN PANAMA THINKS OF MR. MARCUS GARVEY'S PROPAGANDA IN JAMAICA

SPEECHES DELIVERED HERE BY PRESIDENT OF UNIVERSAL NEGRO
IMPROVEMENT SOCIETY ARE ANALYSED: PEOPLE DEFENDED AGAINST
CHARGES BROUGHT BY MR. GARVEY

Sir—

As a Negro, and naturally concerned in the real progress of the Race, I cannot but express my utter disappointment over the addresses delivered by His Excellency (?) Marcus Garvey[:] Provisional President of Africa, President of the Black Star Line Corporation, President-General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League, at certain places in Jamaica and published in issues of your paper.

And though I know that there are many who will wilfully misinterpret the purpose of this letter, and rave at the thought of an insignificant being (as they will doubtless style me) criticising the all-wise, all powerful Marcus Garvey, my feelings of resentment at his unprovoked abuse of my native land and its people are too strong to be suppressed by the fear of what they might think or say or do. Born and educated in Jamaica, I am proud to be a Jamaican.

I allow that it is human to err, but it is equally true that discretion is the better part of valour, and it is therefore befitting for all men, especially those occupying high and important public positions, to exercise great care and consideration over what they may say or do. But some will argue that it is better to be frank and speak what you feel than to utter disguised sentiments. Yes, but at the same time all statements should be based on facts, should be in keeping

with the laws of personal dignity and self-respect, giving due regard to the feelings and individual rights of others.

THE BLACK STAR LINE CORPORATION

By way of preface to his remarks in the Ward Theatre on the evening of March 23rd last, Mr. Garvey told his hearers that he was touring the West Indies and Central America to speak in the interest of the great movement he represented. How he served that interest even to the slightest advantage by the addresses he delivered, I fail to see. A business agent acting in the interest of any concern, manufacturing, industrial commercial or otherwise, will endeavour to impress upon those with whom he comes in contact the paying nature of the business, the reliability of its trade, the excellence of its products, the advantage to be gained by investing, etc. But what do we find in this case? Were the crowds who paid their admission to the Ward Theatre told anything of progress (or failure) of the Black Star Line Corporation (in which hundreds had invested their all) or of any other of the Industrial Corporations connected with the U.N.I.A. movement? Were they told how much of the authorised capital was paid up or what part of same still remains unpaid? Were any plans outlined to them by which they could form some idea of what it was proposed to do in carrying on the work in the future? Was even a word of thanks awarded them for the support they had thus far given to Mr. Garvey and his plans? Were there any prospects of results portrayed to them so as to encourage the continuance of that support in the future? I shall let the people answer for themselves.

But permit me here to review a few of the statements given utterance to by this honourable gentleman.

"By accident, I was born in this country." The sentiment conveyed in this remark is at once apparent. In other words, Mr. Garvey is sorry he was born in Jamaica. I have read the book entitled "From Log Cabin to White House"¹ and I do not remember seeing it stated there that President Lincoln ever claimed it was by accident he was born in a log cabin. Did Booker T. Washington in the autobiography of his life ever express sorrow that he was born of a slave family? No, never. But it is rather a pity that Mr. Garvey could not have had the choice—as he expressed it—for to-day the world would be a able to boast, not of a provisional, but an actual president of Africa.

"Jamaica is the most backward country in the Hemisphere." From what viewpoint did the honourable gentleman arrive at this conclusion, I am at a loss to tell. Did he mean educational[ly], socially, morally, industrially, or commercially? If Mr. Garvey thinks that Jamaica is backward educationally then will he allow me to point to him such men as the Hon. Hector A. Josephs, K.C. B.A. L.L.B. and J. L. King, B.A., L.L.B. in the legal profession, Inspector of Schools, Kennedy and his able assistant, W. A. Chambers, in the educational line, Rev. T. Gordon Somers and Rev. A. A. Barclay in the ecclesiastical, A. W. Thomson and C. A. H. Thomson, in the medical, J. A. G. Smith and H. A. Laselve Simpson, O.B.E. in the legislative, and a host of others too numerous

to mention? Then will Mr. Garvey visit the Mico College, the Jamaica College, (affiliated with the London University) the Wolmer's High School, the Shortwood Training College for ladies, the Westwood High School for girls, etc. and tells us whether he thinks them signs of backwardness? Then as to Jamaica's moral and social status, I need hardly say much, as churches, religious organizations, centers of social and moral activity abound everywhere throughout the island. She even can boast of a number of branches of the U.N.I.A. (The only trouble is that the entire population of the island is not included in the membership). Her industries and commerce too are not to be despised, the products of the island meeting a ready market in far away England, Canada and the United States (though Mr. Garvey claims that he has never heard of Jamaica in all his travels), the three countries [vying] with each other to secure her import trade.

PRAYERS AND MUTUAL DISASTERS

"You Negroes of Jamaica pray too much, and with all your prayers you have earthquakes, hurricanes, droughts and everything." The idea of a man of Mr. Garvey's intellectual caliber associating the religious tendency and Christian spirit of the people of Jamaica with natural and atmospheric disturbances over which no human agency can exercise control. [Isn't] that awful? But it may be that when his presidency shall have been fully established in the dear Motherland, a ban will be placed on praying and the country will therefore be free from earthquakes, hurricanes, or any such natural or atmospheric conditions.

"In Jamaica they had no statesmen, they had a bunch of ignoramuses." Be that as it may, but to Jamaica is due the credit of having produced the greatest statesman of to-day, His Excellency the Provisional President of Africa. I think it was Shakespeare who wrote "Lowliness is young ambition's ladder whereto the climber-upward turns his face, but when he once attains the upmost round he then unto the ladder turns his back, looks into the clouds, scorning the base degrees by which he did ascend."² And so it is with Mr. Garvey. From his present high tower of intellectual fame, he looks down on us all as ignoramuses, but however high may be that tower, this fact cannot be gainsaid: that it is built on the foundation of the elementary training that Jamaica gave him. But I must hasten to conclude.

I am perfectly willing to concede to Mr. Garvey the credit due him for all he has done, is doing and intends to do for the advancement of our Race but I don't see that any law of reason justifies him for riding roughshod over his fellowmen as he feels inclined. I would inform him that some of us know the difference between counsel and abuse, and if he is to get the respect due to his position, it would be well for him to respect the feelings of others. What Mr. Garvey is to-day, it is through the support given him by his fellowmen (Jamaicans included), for though he is furnishing the brain for carrying on this great movement, we are furnishing the money, and he must admit that the one is

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absolutely helpless without the co-operation of the other. I anticipate a hot time for the subjects of his African Republic if the tone of his addresses in Jamaica is an index of what is to take place then. I am. Etc.

NATHANIEL RICKETTS
of Panama, Republic of Panama,
formerly of Kingston, Jamaica

Printed in *DG*, 23 April 1921.

1. *From Log-Cabin to the White House; Life of James A. Garfield; Boyhood, Youth, Manhood, Assassination* was the title of a biography of the twentieth U.S. President, James S. Garfield, by William Makepeace Thayer (Boston: James H. Earle, 1881); the book was reissued in an expanded version in 1920.

2. The words are taken from Shakespeare's *Julius Caesar* (2.1.22–27):

That lowliness is young ambition's ladder,
Whereto the climber-upward turns his face;
But when he once attains the upmost round,
He then unto the ladder turns his back,
Looks in the clouds, scorning the base degrees
By which he did ascend.

Article in *Diario de Costa Rica*¹

[San José, 26 April 1921]

TWO LECTURES BY GARVEY IN LIMÓN

EARNED TEN THOUSAND DOLLARS

Mr. Marcus Garvey, who was our guest for a few hours, gave two lectures in the Arrasty theater of Limón.

Each person was charged one dollar, and the theater was filled with over five thousand people in each one of the presentations.²

Mr. Garvey's presence filled the *negritos* with enthusiasm, and they went about town displaying a particular joy.

All showed up wearing the red, green, and black rosette.

Printed in *Diario de Costa Rica*, 26 April 1921. Translated from Spanish.

1. This article appeared on the front page of *Diario de Costa Rica*.

2. The Arrasty movie theater would have seated several hundred people at most. The figure of "five thousand" must therefore refer to some open-air lecture Garvey gave or be wildly inaccurate.

H. S. Blair, Division Manager,
to George P. Chittenden, General Manager,
United Fruit Company

ALMIRANTE, R. P.,
April twentysixth,
Nineteen Twentyone.

Dear Sir:—

Following the account of Garvey's arrival and reception in Bocas he spoke there again Friday evening, making no charge for admission. He spoke at length on Africa and the great future for Negroes in that country. Over and over again the people asked him to tell them about the success or otherwise of the Black Star Steamship Line, but he ignored their questions absolutely and discoursed on Africa to the end.

He left the people of Bocas thoroughly dissatisfied and as he made no overtures whatever to the Panamanian officials, they also were offended.

He came to Almirante Saturday morning and got a rather cool reception. He remained pretty well out of sight until the afternoon when he made a speech in a [hall] that holds about 100, at Halfmile. \$1.00 admission was charged. He spoke again at the same place at 6 p.m. and got a good deal of applause from his eulogy of the African Republic and his assumption that the Negro was in every respect the equal of the white man and was a fool to spend his time working for him. Efforts to sell shares in the new \$2,000,000.00 construction loan were a failure.

On Sunday he went to Guabito where the Jamaicans from all parts of the Division except Changuinola and Almirante, had gathered to see and hear him. He spoke to a small audience in their hall in the morning, made an open-air speech in the afternoon and spoke again in the hall in the evening[.] The speeches were for the people. The real work of the day was getting the head men together and persuading them to turn over to him the various sums of money collected from the people here for the Association. He appears to have been successful in getting the money and by a reorganization of the local branches of the Association, he has quieted the discontent, which was general. He returned to Bocas early Monday morning where he is now, expecting to sail on the "Atenas" for Cristobal today.

He has made little, or no, reference to the Black Star Steamship Line, but instead has talked of the Construction loan. At all meetings he has endeavored to talk this up and sell shares in it, but with little success. All the men at the head of the movement locally are negroes who have always made a living off the people in one way or another. They are not in agreement among themselves by any means and dissension may be expected after Garvey leaves.

He advised the people to work, earn money, and support the Association. At the same time there is very evident possibility of future trouble from his

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assumptions and remarks on the race question. For the present we expect no difficulty and will watch developments closely. Very truly yours,

[no signature]
Manager

CC to Mr. Cutter.

UFC. TL. On UFC letterhead, Panama Division.

Article in the *Daily Gleaner*

[Bocas del Toro, April 26 1921]

MR. GARVEY AT BOCAS DEL TORO

ARRIVAL THERE RECENTLY OF PRESIDENT
OF THE UNIVERSAL NEGRO ASSOCIATION

RECEPTION GIVEN HIM

THE SPEECHES HE DELIVERED THERE AND IMPRESSION CREATED:
RETURNING TO ISLAND

Mr. Marcus Garvey has come here and gone. He arrived on Thursday afternoon 21st inst. on a gasoline freight launch from Port Limon, Costa Rica, and left yesterday at 2 p.m. on an auxiliary schooner for Colon. A crowd gathered at the pier before we landed. But when Garvey got on shore he passed by without glancing at any one, nor did he notice the members of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, who were going in a procession to meet him, when he met them on the way. Before his arrival fly sheets were circulated around town advertising a reception in his honour at San Miguel Hall, on Sixth Street the night of his arrival. Fifty cents U.S. currency was the price published. But Mr. Garvey sent his right hand man to inform the people that he would not speak for less than \$1.00, and as the attendance was so small (between 40 and 50) the meeting would be called off that night. It was then 8.30 o'clock, and from 500 to 600 persons were outside. A big crowd proceeded to the house where he stayed and asked to be given an explanation. The message was sent in but he ignored it. Half an hour later, however, he appeared on the verandah and made a short scathing outburst in which he termed the crowd "illiterate negroes," who had come to him with "your freshness." He said further, "That's why you are where you are and you will remain in that condition." This was followed by hissing and shouts of "Away with you!" "Down with Garvey!" "That's the last nail to your coffin!" Strongly persuaded by Dr. G. W. A. Forrester and A. N. Willis who had journeyed from island Guabito, Sixaola (forty miles off) to meet him Mr. Garvey appeared on the platform at 10 p.m. (Thurs-

day). He spoke seven minutes and heaped all the blame of the evening on Felix A. Russell, Secretary of the Bocas Division, U.N.I.A.

THE RECEPTION

The reception came off on Friday night, 22nd inst. Mr. T. H. Saunders, local organizer, was chairman. There was a musical programme and an address of welcome. Mr. Saunders introduced the visitor as "Provisional President of Africa." But never once during his speech did Mr. Garvey style himself by that appendage, nor did he join the words "African Communities League" when speaking of the U.N.I.A. There was no charge for admission. Mr. Garvey's utterances were just the same as those read from time to time in the "Negro World," and as the published reports in the Gleaner of his sayings in Jamaica. The British Government came in for a good deal of censure. Of humorous language, and gesticulating manner there was so much, that intelligent men and women who heard him speak regarded the affair as a side splitting farce, instead of a serious proposition. It is estimated that about a thousand people were inside and outside the building.

Mr. Garvey and a number of members of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, left Bocas town on Saturday morning on a special launch for Almirante (thirteen and a half miles off), and proceeded on Sunday on a special train for Guabito. Reports from those [places are not yet to hand.] Mr. Garvey returned to Bocas on Sunday night.

Much dissatisfaction exists as in his speeches Mr. Garvey never gave any account of the Black Star Line Steamship Corporation, and the curt manner which he acted gained him much deprecation generally. But some of his followers call him "Jesus," and one old man asked God to let him die for he has seen Mr. Garvey.

Yesterday he was escorted by a few followers carrying the flag of the U.N.I.A. to the motor boat on which he sailed. Rumour has it that Mr. Garvey did not wait to go by the United Fruit Company's steamer this evening as he will not be allowed to land on the Canal Zone.

RETURNING TO JAMAICA

According to cable advices which have been received by the General Secretary of the Jamaica Division of the U.N.I.A. Mr. Marcus Garvey, President General of the Association, having completed his Central American tour, will arrive in this island by the end of the present week, prior to his return to New York. Mar[cus] Garvey will again address the citizens of Kingston at the Ward Theatre on Sunday and Monday nights 7th and 8th inst., and it is very probably that Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis will join Mr. Garvey at these meetings, as this lady has also cabled her intention of leaving Cuba for Jamaica within the next couple of days.

Printed in *DG*, 6 May 1921. A previous version published in *DG*, 4 May 1921, contained typesetting errors.

APRIL 1921

United Fruit Company Report

Bocas del Toro, R.P.,
April 28th, 1921

MARCUS GARVEY IN BOCAS DE TORO

INFORMATION FOR MR. H. S. BLAIR

No. 1 Marcus Garvey landed here from Port Limon about 3 P.M., the 21st inst. A group of Negroes about fifteen persons assembled at the landing place for the purpose of greeting him but Garvey passed through them as though treating every one with contempt. First sign of discourtesy displayed by him and the people in consequence comments bitterly thereon.

No. 2 Accompanied by the local General Organizer "Saunders," he drove to the home prepared for him at Sand Fly Bay.

No. 3 The first meeting was scheduled to take place at San Miguel Hall at 7.30 P.M., on the same day. According to local arrangements small placards were distributed to the public in advance otherwise long before Garvey's arrival here. Fifty and twentyfive cents U.S. Currency, were the figures printed for admission on the placards. Long before the schedule time a large crowd consisting of about six hundred persons gathered before the hall seeking admission therein. They were told that the prices had been altered by Mr. Garvey that is, from fifty and twenty five to //O//ne dollar gold. The entire crowd protested and would not pay one dollar. Various messages to the effect were sent from the hall to Garvey's home but he negatived the idea of coming to the hall to lecture for less than a dollar general admission. The final message was to the effect—those who have already paid, return them their money and announce no meeting to be held to night. The crowd then became infuriated and marched to Garvey's home. On reaching the premises the door was slammed in their faces by Garvey, notwithstanding they called to him to make an appearance. Garvey still remained inside whereupon the crowd commenced to stone the building and to yell[.]

"You D_____ thief"—"You rascal" etc, etc,

Eventually Garvey came out on the verandah and addressed the crowd as follows:

"I want you people in Bocas del Toro to understand that I am the Honorable Marcus Garvey. I have come here to uplift you, civilize you. I cannot come all the way from New York to speak to you for .50cts. You are a bunch of ignorant and impert//i//nent negroes. No wonder you are, where you are and for my part you can stay where you are" he again slammed the door and went inside. The crowd continued yelling abuses for a little time until Marcus Garvey wended his way to the hall and explained tha//t// the lamentable affair had come through a misunderstanding between the Soc[i]al Secretary and himself[.] The audience however was not satisfied and asked Garvey that he should speak to

them on the "Black Star Line[.]" Garvey would not touch that subject and went back to his home shortly after announcing a meeting for the following night admission free.

No. 4 On the following night commencing at 8 O'clock a progra[m] was opened with songs and recitations by local talents after which Garvey was introduced by the chairman. Mr. Garvey rose and delivered one of his identical professional speeches, taking particular care not to say one word on the Black Star Line Corporation.

No. 5 Next morning at 7.30 O'clock Garvey accompanied by T. H. Saunders, Local Organizer, and half a dozen people embarked for Almirante, where he was met by the President of the Local Branch there. At 4 O'clock P.M., the f[ir]st meeting took place at Liberty Hall at Almirante—admission one dollar gold. He had a full house consisting of about one hundred and fifty persons. Again he delivered the very same speech as he delivered in Bocas. The second meeting at 8 P.M., admission .50cts U.S. [Currency], was also fully attended. At midnight he travelled by special train to Guabito. The first meeting was held at Liberty Hall at 3 P.M., admission one dollar U.S. [Currency.] He had a full house of about two hundred persons. The second meeting was an open air affair and was held at Blair's Park. Here he spoke to a crowd consisting of more than two thousand persons.

No. 6 In all of the meetings mentioned his addresses were identically the same. Instead of dealing with the Black Star Line Corporation as most of the people here expected, he introduced a new idea; which is, a construction loan as he calls it, amounting to two million dollars. He appealed to the people to purchase shares and although not quite successful yet, he sold a good number of shares.

No. 7 At 11.30 P.M., he returned to Bocas from where he took passage next day on Surgeon's Auxi[li]ary Schooner for Colon.

No. 8 From what can be gathered the people in Bocas proper are more dissatisfied than pleased with him. Regrettable that the people in the lagoons¹ have not been able to realize the true states of affairs as did the people in Bocas town.

[signature illegible]

UFC. TLS. On UFC letterhead, Panama Division, Almirante, R.P.

1. A reference to the mainland in and around Almirante.

APRIL 1921

Lieutenant-Commander C. M. Hall
to Rear Admiral Marbury Johnston¹

15th Naval District, Colón, Canal Zone
29-30 Apr. 1921

INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Marcus Garvey, President of the Black Star Line Steamship Company and so called President of Africa and The Negro Republic arrived in Colón, Panama, on April 26 from Jamaica via Port Limón, Costa Rica. Six meetings under the auspices of The Universal Negro Improvement Association, all of which were well attended by the negroes of the Canal Zone and Panama, were addressed by Garvey between April 27 and April 30 on which date he left Colón for Panama City. . . .

All meetings were conducted with the great pomp and dignity necessary to impress the negro mind, but each speech was ended by Garvey's practically ordering those present to buy shares in his Steamship Company and there is no doubt but that he raised a great deal of money. At four of the meetings an admission fee of one dollar was charged.

There has been no evidence of unrest among the negroes since Garvey's appearance as many of them still remember how they were induced to strike on the Canal Zone a year ago when they not only lost the strike but lost all the money they had contributed toward the Union.

Several letters written by negroes have appeared in the local paper the past week in which the writers urge the blacks to continue as they are and not to spend their money foolishly on Garvey's schemes.

[LT. COMMDR. C. M. HALL]

DNA, RG 165, 10218-418-16. TD, carbon copy.

1. Marbury Johnston (1868-1934), a graduate of the U.S. Naval Academy, was appointed rear admiral in November 1918 (*WWWA*).

Article in the *Negro World*

[[BAY ISLAND OF RUATAN,
Spanish Honduras,¹ ca. 30 April 1921]]

NOTES FROM SPANISH HONDURAS

Mrs. Avey Bodden died from heart trouble after a short illness. She leaves two children, a beloved sister and husband to mourn her loss.

Liberty Hall, our only place of meeting and enjoyment, was called for by its owner. It was not ours, so we had to give it up and get together to plan for the building of our own.

One of our members was caught in a storm in a dory and drifted out to sea. He was unable to manage his boat and through chills from wet clothing, he got cramps in his boat and died. He was found a few days after on the mainland coast and was buried by the authorities.

The wife of our faithful treasurer passed away during childbirth.

In the month of March we lost another member, the brother of our worthy chaplain whose wife died also during last year.

This division is still active and in the near future when we shall have finished our own Liberty Hall, hope to welcome some of our noble executives for a visit.

The stork visited the home of the chairman of our Advisory Board and brought him a gift which he has named Marcus Garvey Nelson.

Printed in NW, 30 April 1921.

1. The coastal geography of Honduras, including islands off the north coast such as Roatán, played a key role in the country's banana economy from the 1860s. However, it should be noted that Roatán's racial and ethnic heritage has been rather distinct from not only the Honduran mainland and interior but also from the country's coastal areas. Roatán and its neighboring islands, collectively known as the Bay Islands, remained under British colonial control until the 1860s, when the Honduran government finally secured full sovereignty over them. By the beginning of the twentieth century, generations of settlement and resettlement of migrants originating in Jamaica and elsewhere in the British Caribbean defined the Bay Islands' racial and ethnic history as different from the colonial black presence in the rest of Honduras (William V. Davidson, "In Search of Garifuna, Beachfolk of the Bay of Honduras," *National Geographic Society Research Reports* 14 [1982]: 129–141; Rafael Leiva Vivas, "Presencia negra en Honduras," in *Presencia Africana en Centroamérica*, comp. Luz María Martínez Montiel [Mexico City: Consejo Nacional para la Cultura y las Artes, 1993], pp. 113–150; Davidson, *Historical Geography of the Bay Islands of Honduras: Anglo-Hispanic Conflict in the Western Caribbean* [Birmingham, Ala.: Southern University Press, 1979]; Marvin Barahona, *La evolución de la identidad nacional* [Tegucigalpa: Editorial Guaymuras, 1991], pp. 111–117, 166–193).

Walter C. Thurston, Secretary, U.S. Embassy,
Costa Rica, to Charles Evans Hughes,
U.S. Secretary of State

San José, Costa Rica, May 2, 1921

Sir:

I have the honor to inform the Department that prior to the receipt of its instruction number 28 of April 26, 4 p.m., Marcus Garvey, the negro leader, had departed from Puerto Limon for Bocas del Toro, Panamá. He entered Panamá under a visa granted by the Panam[ani]an Consul at Boston.

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So far as I have been able to ascertain Garvey did not conduct any radical propaganda while in Costa Rica, although he several times addressed the many negro laborers of the United Fruit Company. He was received by President Acosta,¹ who states he spoke to him only of the African Commonwealth he hopes to establish.

The General Manager of the United Fruit Company states that the voluntary and continued subscriptions in favor of Marcus Garvey, of the negro employees of that Company in Costa Rica are approximately \$2,000 monthly, and it is reported from other sources that as a result of this personal visit he received over \$30,000. I have the honor to be, Sir, Your obedient servant,

WALTER C. THURSTON

DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/11. TLS, recipient's copy.

1. Julio Acosta (1872-1954) was president of Costa Rica from 1920 to 1924.

Article in the *Panama Star and Herald*

[Panama, 4 May 1921]

CROWD FILLS VARIEDADES THEATRE TO HEAR MARCUS GARVEY SPEAK

On Monday night last another large and enthusiastic gathering assembled at the Variedades Theatre to hear Mr. Marcus Garvey deliver his last address on the Isthmus. Long before the time announced for commencing the spacious theatre was crowded and at about 9 o'clock the promoters were compelled to stop the selling of tickets.

The meeting commenced with the singing of the opening ode: "From Greenland's Icy Mountains." A few songs and recitations were rendered after which Mr. Morales gave an address in Spanish.

Mr. Graham, President of the Panama Division, introduced Mr. Garvey in most glowing terms. He eulogized the work being done by Garvey.

Mr. Garvey said as follows:

Mr. Chairman, ladies and gentlemen:

Once more I have the good fortune to be in your midst and probably for the last time in Panama. In speaking to you tonight, I desire to elaborate some more on the work of the association, which I have the honor to represent at this time. It has become a power and force. Its object is to unite [4]00,000,000 persons scattered throughout the world. To establish a government second to none in the world; to protect negroes everywhere; to demand the respect of all races; to make them men among men. The U.N.I.A. and A.C.L. has an ambitious program

and every member of the association is ambitious. We are fighting men and women. We have no use for cowards, but brave men and women, who will be prepared to die now for their freedom (cheers). The time has come when we must pray and work. We want men with broad minds and back bones. My father has been begging for 250 years and I am not prepared to beg not even one minute. If a man has that which is justly mine I will ask him for it, if he refuses to give it to me, I will take it that he is hard of hearing and ask him again in louder tones, then if he still retains it, I am going to pitch into him for I am not responsible if he has lost one of his senses. I understand that there are some professional men here who say that we cannot achieve anything, but let me tell them, that this is a fighting association. They say we are a crazy lot of people. We are no more crazy than Britain a few centuries ago when she succeeded in defeating the Romans; than Washington when he gained the Independence of North America; than France when she established her own autonomy. We of the U.N.I.A. believe in the temporal law of man divided in race groups—white, yellow, and black. If they say a government for Europe, a government for Asia, then we say a government for Africa. We believe in a new age[—]a “stand up and demanding age.” Ask and demand, and if you do not get it then fight for it and take it. Some are [*word illegible*]. We are not concerned about those who are scared. Cowardice have never done anything for any man or people. We have to fight until we get what is ours. Every coward [*words illegible*] the U.N.I.A. Some[*times*] he is the ordinary man, some[*times*] the middleman and some[*times*] the professional man. Some of them criticize me and they have never seen me. I do not want to see them. I have no use for them[.] I will pause right here and give 10 mins. to any man, whether he be a lawyer, doctor or a dentist, who has anything to say against this association. If he does not do so now, then he will hereafter keep his peace.

No one came forward and the speaker continued:

You professional men try to impede the progress of this movement. You are the lowest in the Negro family. We want men with back bone. Not men who are afraid of a white face. I have no apology to make for the aims of this association. The white man has nothing to apologize for. He is a national entity and power and I admire him for it. Why should you apologize to a God so powerful and good. You good for nothing negroes, are you afraid to stand up for your right and die if it becomes necessary? The Irish men are fighting for their independence. The Jews fought for a restored Palestine and they have succeeded in getting it. Negroes! shouted the speaker, have you not got sufficient proof to see that no other race will protect you. In Guatemala, Ecuador, Port Limon, you are ill-treated. If they will not protect you, have you not the common

sense to protect your selves? We want such a nature as to make any other man afraid of us. I repeat our program is an ambitious one. A man without ambition is not fit to live. We are ambitious men. What is good for the other fellow is good for us too. The other fellow has held on to things temporal. We want some of it too. If I refuse to live up to the requirements of civilization the police will take me to the calaboose. If civilization is good enough for one man it is good enough for the other. If the other fellow need food for the body and a home I need it too. I believe in civilization and whatsoever is belonging to it. I want some of it. There should be a consciousness of self. Why should you think you are inferior to some other man. You are insulting God. Why do you think you cannot go further. God never made you inferior. He alone demands that you bow down and worship Him. It is outside of your province to bow down and look up to any other man as supreme except the God of Heaven. I prefer to die, and every negro to die rather than to live and think that God created me as inferior to the white man.

Right here, Mr. Garvey with arms outstretched and looking heavenwards most earnestly and fervently said: "O God!—if thou created me inferior I do not want the life thou gavest me. I prefer to die now."

Continuing, he said:

Knowing myself as a man, I meet every man as a man and expect every man to meet me as a man. That silly, stupid talk of color must be destroyed. Why should you worship others because they are white. Before the white man became a national entity he was a savage, a pagan, a barbarous cannibal. When you were in palaces on the Nile in Egypt, Ancient Britains were barbarous and filled with paganism, but through evolution of matter they came out of their barbarism. Fifty-five years before the birth of Christ when Rome swayed the world with her might and power the early Britains were subjected to many attacks. Several Britishers were taken to Rome as slaves. As a result of the fall of Rome, Britain got her full civilization. Now, they have a national anthem and they sing:

"Britons, never, never shall be slaves."

The idea of the anthem brings to them that they were once slaves. The Negro failure is due to the fact that he forsakes his history. He has no guide for the future. No guide to posterity. The reason why I fight so tenaciously is because I know the history of the world and I have no compromise to make. I will only compromise with God. He speaks to me. He says: "Go on because I lead." (Some one shouted Alleluia.) The professional men say a Negro cannot lead. Do they expect some white man to lead. The white man took my father 4,000 miles and kept him as a slave 400 years. He was beaten and killed. You weak-kneed Negroes! shouted

the speaker, there is a David Lloyd George, a Bonar Law, and a Winston Churchill in England; a Clemenceau in France; a Ebert and Hollwegg in Germany; a Harding and Hughes in America; a Ishi in Japan. All these are statesmen. Where are the Negro statesmen? (Voices: None.) Where is our nation's freedom? Lloyd George, Clemenceau, Ebert, Ishi, are speaking for their national integrity and dignity. If no other Negro will speak (dramatically striking his chest) I shall do it by the help of God for the Imperial freedom of Africa. (Cheers.) I have an everlasting love, an everlasting devotion and an everlasting faith and belief in the Majesty of my God and the scriptures: "Princes shall come out of Ethiopia (Vociferous applause). Shall I wait any longer for that which my father had waited long enough? My father had been begging and praying and I do not believe in wasting all that energy. God gave us life to make good use of it and I am going to use every minute to further this movement. The impulse of the movement says: "There is a world political reorganization. It is not a question of begging and worrying God for what we can get ourselves." I do not believe in worrying my God for things temporal. God has millions of worlds, Saturn, Jupiter, Mars, to attend to, so that they may not come into contact with each other. After God created you He was through with you, with the exception that He says you must worship Him in spirit and in truth. God says I will help those who will help themselves. I love the God of justice. It is not a question of size but justice. I have an abiding faith in the U.N.I.A. Africa is going to play the David. The sensible white man is not afraid of us, for he can protect himself. But it is the good for nothing "cracker" white man who has nothing to rely on but his color. Some people can only see physical power. But I can remember history. Some of the greatest wars that have been fought and won was not a result of great battalions, but strategy. We are going to use strategy to redeem Africa. (Cheers.) Some are asking: "How is Garvey going to free Africa?" What nonsense!! No general gives away his strategic plans. I would advise those lawyers and doctors to take a 6 months' course in logic then they will see through this movement. This association consists of cultured, cultivated and educated men, who are well versed in political economy and political science and although I am alone here tonight, I challenge any man who can come on this platform and give a better discourse than I can, on either of these subjects. Lloyd George and other statesmen went to the best universities to study political science. I have been to a university and used the same textbooks they have used. They have made plans for the development of their country and empire. I shall expect no apology from them and they shall expect none from me. Black man as I am, I shall chose my way for the building of my empire. (Cheers.) There must be freedom and autonomy for all races. Some people say that this is a radical movement against the white people. I believe in conserving time and it takes time to hate a white man. Britain has her salvation and protection

and the others have got to look on and walk around. Why? Because she has her dreadnoughts, cruisers, etc. I am determined to establish a government which will make the nations of the world walk around Africa. (Thunderous applause). The Anglo-Saxons will not beat me in the race of life. Whenever you hear Garvey is licked, he is well licked.

After wiping the perspiration from his face and refreshing himself with some water, the speaker in declamatory tones, said:

I can see my counterpa[rt] in Britain, France, America, Germany, Russia and Japan and I am going to give them the race of my life. "The race is not for the swift, but for those that endure to the end."¹ The greatest diplomats in the world are Negroes. (Here he narrated the history of the defeat of the North American Indians and the tricky embrace of the African Negro. How the latter instead of shooting at a distance his bow and arrow at his enemy surrendered, and as a result succeeded in acquiring a first class knowledge of the mechanism of the gun which he can now use better than his enemy.)

Three hundred years ago the Negro studied at the feet of his so-called master and his apprenticeship was declared up in 1914. It was Negro strategy that brought the war to a close. Men of Panama prepare for the call in Africa. Women of Panama, you will be needed not as Red Cross nurses but as Black Cross nurses.

I understand that some of you professional men say that I am here to stir up revolution. I am not here for disturbance, but to speak to African citizens.

Before I bid you farewell, I want to give you a closing thought. I shall take the most pleasant recollections of my stay here. I thank the Panamanian government for the protection I received here, as also Colon and Bocas del Toro. I appreciate the hospitality extended to the Negroes living here. In the future the Negro will not forget her in time of need (perhaps the next 25 years), when we shall send the African fleet to support her. I hold the best appreciation for the Panamanian Government. I am not here to disrupt the autonomy of her government. If there is no government to protect weaker nations the Government of Africa will. A glorious day await us when we shall throw away color prejudice. We shall have liberty and democracy by your moral and financial support. I appeal to you in the name of God and in the name of reason. Liberia will soon be free. If you do not heed the call it will not be Garvey's fault.

The meeting was brought to a close by the singing of "Onward Christian Soldiers" and the pronouncing of the Benediction by Mr. H. E. Wynter.

Printed in *PS&H*, 4 May 1921. Original text not extracted.

1. Ecclesiastes 9:12.

Edward C. A. Philip, General Secretary,
UNIA Guaico,¹ Trinidad Division,
to J. R. Ralph Casimir

Guaico, Trinidad, B.W.I., 4th May 1921

Dear Brother:—

Your letter of recent date is received safe to hand on the 2nd inst by the Lady President //to whom it was address[ed]// and same was handed to me for execution, which I //have// carefully read and noted. Before introducing any other matter [to you], I must need congratulate you on your literary ability, in which one can see that erudition has played a most important role in your article “What ails Dominica.” In your analysis of the condition which affect the Negros in Dominica, in addition I will say wherever the horse is the horse fly is always present, or //that// thro out the West Indies where the Union Jack floats there is always a similitude of condition.

Your article is //truly// meritorious. I must also thank you for your thought given the question as to the existing situation of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L. in Trinidad, as to the true significance of the thought express in your letter one needn[']t to the individual, but the thought has suffice sufficient as to distinguish the true spirit of radicalism as inherent in the individual. I can say with all positive assurance that the “Dawn of a New Day” would be felt in Trinidad if the ~~true-sp~~ business of the U.N.I.A. was transacted in the true spirit of radicalism, but such “ism” I am sorry to say is “foreign[.]” Some of the men that are at the head of the business is almost to[o] coward and cringing to live. As to free myself of having a pessimistic view of the situation[,] I am going to narrate a few of the conditions as is existing here. Trinidad is an island with over two hundred thousand Negr[o] inhabitants. The U.N.I.A. and A C League made its entry about the middle part of 1919 in the island. Its now near two years since. There is now ten Divisions in the island involving not more than four hundred members. There is also over two hundred well populated districts and the better part knows absolutely nothing of [the] Ass’n. This show clearly that propaganda work is inefficient. We have got no free press, the Negro World Paper is not allowed to circulate in the island[.] I have intro[duced] an idea of securing a small press in which propaganda work can be best carried out and I was ridicule by leader of the Port of Spain and St. Joseph Division.² The U.N.I.A. in Port-of-Spain is on the rock[s]. Garvey name could not be uttered there some time ago. It is since the application been made to the governor //as to establish the U.N.I.A.// and his reply was—[that] he cannot now withhold the U.N.I.A. in the colony that the Workingman Ass’n—whose headquarters is in England affiliate very few of them to the U.N.I.A. and as to the bad management of the St. Joseph Div:—it is now in the wane. As to the point of speculation certain men have written to the Parent Body on the question of registration, when they reply that they can do so if it is necessary, whence they

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have made an application to the Registrar of Friendly society, and his reply is as follows

Registrar of Friendly Society Office,
Port-of-Spain, 15 March 1921

RE THE U.N.I.A. & A C LEAGUE,

I must refuse to register the above body as a Friendly Society for inter alia each of the two following reasons. 1st It is clear from its objects that it is not a body to which the Friendly Society Ordinance applied, and 2nd Its rules do not provide for the several matters referred to in the first schedule of the Friendly Society Ordinance.

CHARLES A. CHILD
Registrar of Friendly Society

Yet with this frank refusal these men has formulated a sort of a cooperation rules, capitalising at \$100,000 at a Dollar per share and say it is the U.N.I.A. Rules and are about to registered it as the U.N.I.A. Ny Div:—has refused to coincide with it and we are much ignored in so far they have said that the[y] will close us down.

As for me, I doest not mind who shut us down so long as they are under the banner of speculation and cowardice. For so long as the Parent Body and other radicals in the West Indies are with us we are determined to push the fight for Negro Freedom and a Free and Redeem Africa. I will be more than thankful if you can write these men whose names I ~~will~~ am sending and help to confirm the Spirit of radicalism in them[.] They are as follows:—Herman D. A. Thompson (Genl Organ) Leonville St. Joseph[,] Charles Atkinson (Secy) Tabaquite, R. R. Cuffy (Pres) Orange Hill Rd., Charapaichima, James Sergant, Penal.

I will be glad if you ~~can~~ will send on this letter to the Parent body. I have written several to them and w[h]ether they receive I cannot say for I have received no rep[ly] . . . [indecipherable] I can't say what the matter.

Will also thank you much if you can help me to eliminate this situation³ for I can assure you that the Parent Body is receiving reports of thing that is not happening. For I can say with heart full of sorrows that the U.N.I.A. is no[t] in a pretty position here. But I will say that the Truth is powerful and will ultimately prevail[.] Whilst trusting in the Supreme Goodness and your whole hearted support in helping us to eliminate our situation [a]nd assuring you of my whole hearted support in the struggle of Negro Right Liberty and Freedom and a Redeemed Africa I am your[s] Fraternally

EDWARD C. A. PHILIP
Gen'l Secretary

[Addressed to:] J. R. Ralph Casimir Pesnl
Secy Roseau Dominica B[.]W[.] Indies

[*Handwritten note:*] Address all communication to Edward C. A. Philips[,]
P.O. Guaico[,] Trinidad B.W.I.

JRRC. ALS, recipient's copy. Handwritten letterhead: "One Gods! One Aim! One Destiny!!! The Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League Guaico Division Charter No 21."

1. Guaico is a rural village in the eastern part of Trinidad.
2. The general organizer of the St. Joseph division, Hermon Thompson, was verbally accused of purchasing items on behalf of the UNIA and reselling at exorbitant prices (Tony Martin, "Marcus Garvey and Trinidad," pp. 79-80).
3. After receiving this letter, Casimir commenced a tour of Trinidad in June 1921 to evaluate the strengths and weaknesses of the various branches. He arrived in La Brea on 7 August 1921 and seemed more impressed with this branch, which had only begun around January, than he was with the others he visited (Tony Martin, "Marcus Garvey and Trinidad, 1912-1947," in *The Pan-African Connection: From Slavery to Garvey and Beyond* [Dover, Mass.: Schenkman Publishing Company, 1983], pp. 79-80).

Letter to the *Panama Star and Herald*

[Panama, 4 May 1921]

THE "BACK TO AFRICA MOVEMENT" CRITICIZED

Sir.—

Because there is much wildfire agitation among the illiterate and semi-illiterate colored people on the Isthmus in connection with the so-called Garvey Back to Africa Movement, and because there is much ado about Marcus Garvey's pointless effusions in what he arbitrarily terms platform speeches, it has become necessary for the more intelligent and better classes of West Indians to pronounce their attitude in reference to his schemes and plans for raising money from those of our people who will eventually sit down and mourn over the loss of their hard-earned dollars.

Marcus Garvey claims that he is the leader of the colored or Negro race. That is an incomparable lie. Garvey nor no man with his clap trap rantings could ever hope to force himself upon the attention of respectable, cultured, refined and dignified Negroes anywhere. The only class of Negroes to whom he could appeal is that class that would follow like the rats followed the pied-piper of Hamellin.

Garvey talks about millions of Negroes who are connected with his association. Great God! How does he count millions? Does he count one for a hundred? If he has so many millions at his standard why should he find it such a herculean task to raise the money he needs to buy ships and submarines and the thousand and one implements of industry and war he is dreaming about?

[*line illegible*] nor [*ambition*] [*words illegible*] among our race, why? Because they are men of superior intelligence and could not permit themselves to be drawn into such a ridiculous and impossible position as that which he has

been advertising for the past four years; and besides, the whole affair is such an exhibition of tom foolery that only the ignorant and gullible could appreciate and participate in the schemes.

There are so many wealthy and independent Negroes in the United States alone that if Garvey's schemes had appealed to them it would have been unnecessary for him to have appealed to Negroes in other countries for financial support. The Negroes in the States own and operate banks and other corporations in the North as well as in the South. If Garvey's Black Star Line business and the Back to Africa gambol had anything in them what would have prevented the thousands of true-blooded and loyal Negroes of worth from casting in their lot with the "Provisional President of Africa" and "The President-General of the Black Star Line?"

As a matter of fact hundreds of the people who, at first, bit at the bait are now bewailing the fact that they had ever subscribed for shares and they regard the money thus shelled out as lost in a bad bargain. And it is also a fact that several letters have reached here from the States advising people not to buy any more shares or the money will be thrown away.

Yet Garvey and his gang are advertising their fallacious and stupid moonshine and the ignorant men and women are yielding themselves victims to the affair.

It is true that among the people who are connected with the movement in Panama and Colon there are not twenty in the whole number who might be classified among the intelligent and thinking people of the Isthmus. Why is this so? Because [the movement can't appeal] to men of brains and culture, and Garvey has never tried to get them.

His senseless ha[ra]ngues are only intended for those people who laugh at insults and accept variegated balloons as solid substance. They cheer folly[,] encore nonsense and subscribe to every wild-cat enterprise that passes along.

If Garvey who claims to be the Moses of the children of the Dark Continent really meant to help this race, instead of touring around and charging big prices for people to see and hear him[,] he would have given free and open lectures and then appealed to the generosity and liberality of his sincere and devoted followers who might have responded far beyond imagination to the pocket-book calls of the first Negro out of Africa.

It is not now necessary to ask Garvey the unanswerable question of the progress of the Black Star Line and the disbursement of money he has been collecting [for] the past four years; these questions have been asked at Headquarters [at] Harlem and other places and [treated?] with cold indifference by [the man?] who still has brine enough to [*word illegible*] around and ask for more money.

But I would ask Mr. Garvey [do] you seriously hope to go [back to] the United States? When will [the] ships you have been talking [about] be sea worthy? How are [the West?] Indians to be treated in [Africa]? How much more

will their eco[nomic] and moral conditions be im[proved] by transplanting themselves [to a] clime unfamiliar and unpromising as well as undesirable?

West Indians should be [*illegible*] not to be seduced into any [*word illegible*] and impossible scheme. The [*remainder missing*]

Printed in *PS&H*, 4 May 1921.

Article in the *Panama Star and Herald*

[Panama, 4 May 1921]

LARGE CROWD ATTEND GARVEY'S LECTURE AT THE RECREATION HALL

At 3.30 o'clock yesterday afternoon at the Recreation Hall, Calidonia, Marcus Garvey, President of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, lectured to a large audience under the auspices of the Prospective Chapter of the U.N.I.A.

From 1.30 o'clock crowds of people sought admittance to the hall and at the time of Garvey's arrival every seat was taken with standing room only.

President Gadsby of the Prospective Chapter, called the meeting to order and after the usual introduction, appointed Mr. Blanchfield Thompson to act as chairman for the occasion.

Mr. Thompson spoke on the purpose of the meeting after which he introduced Mr. Marcus Garvey, who spoke for two and a half hours.

Printed in *PS&H*, 4 May 1921.

Major Norman Randolph to the Director, Military Intelligence Division

Quarry Heights, C.Z. May 7, 1921

Subject: Marcus Garvey

1. The subject arrived in Colón aboard the launch "Linda S" from Bocas del Toro, R. de P., on April 26th and remained on the Isthmus until May 5th when he sailed for Kingston, Jamaica aboard the S.S. "Carillo."¹

2. Garvey's first activities in the Republic of Panama were at Bocas del Toro, Almirante and Guabito where he was received very cool[ly] and left after wordy altercations with the negroes there. The negroes became incensed over the fact that Garvey raised the price of admission to his lectures from fifty cents,

the advertised price, to one dollar, (see enclosure #2).² The negroes in that locality put Garvey down as another “faker” in the class with Severs³ and other agitators who have “bled” the negroes here.

3. Garvey’s arrival was unannounced here and at first it appeared that his work would be a total failure but, as is characteristic of the West Indian, the curiosity of the lower class of negroes was aroused and many paid their dollars to hear him and having heard him, they were aroused and influenced by him so that they paid to hear him again, joined the Universal Negro Improvement Association and bought shares in the Black Star Line. The better class of negroes, including doctors, lawyers, clerks, etc., would have nothing to do with Garvey and did all in their power through speech and press to warn the lower classes not to let Garvey influence them and take their money, so that Garvey’s efforts did not meet with the degree of success which he expected.

4. During his stay in Colón and Panama, Garvey and his secretaries collected the following amounts:

Stock sold in Colón	\$600.00
Stock sold in Panama [City]	905.00
Admission fees in Colón	950.00
Admission fees in Panama [City]	1738.00
Total	<u>\$4193.00</u>

These figures do not show the amounts collected in Colón during Garvey’s last twenty-four hours there and they do not show stock sold privately so that it is estimated that he left the Isthmus with about \$5,000.00 collected from the poorest class of negroes. In Panama City, Garvey had to lower his admission charge to fifty cents as he could not draw the crowd with the dollar charge.

5. No difficulties arising from Garvey’s preachings are anticipated as what enthusiasm he aroused is already waning. He was not received by influential and representative negroes who, on the contrary, are combating his efforts. Negroes here have been fooled too often by men of his type to make this a very fertile field for such activities.

6. Copies of speeches made by Garvey are enclosed herewith.

NORMAN RANDOLPH
Major, 14th Infantry

DNA, RG 165, 10218-418-32. TLS, recipient’s copy.

1. The Panama Canal Zone military intelligence had also notified Matthew C. Smith, director of the Military Intelligence Division in Washington D.C. that Garvey had left for Jamaica (see Smith to W. L. Hurley, Office of the Under Secretary, Department of State, 7 May 1921, DNA, RG 59, 000-612; and Smith to L. J. Baley, Chief, Bureau of Investigation, Department of Justice, DNA, RG 59, 000-612).

2. “Marcus Garvey in Bocas del Toro,” *PS&H*, 30 April 1921; see also “Pilgrim Wilkin’s Impressions of Marcus Garvey’s Visit to the Isthmus,” *PS&H*, 3 May 1921.

3. Severs was a white American organizer for the AFL and a representative for the AFL affiliate in the Panama Canal Zone, the United Brotherhood of Maintenance of Way Employes and Railway Shop Laborers. Severs, along with another white American recruiter named Allen, held a number of meetings in the Panama Canal Zone shortly before the United Brotherhood strike of 1919. Their

goal was to promote equality in the terms of employment for blacks and whites. American and British authorities believed that Severs's organizing efforts were a factor contributing to the strike (TNA: PRO CO 318/350/02504).

Article in the *Negro World*

[[Panama, 7 May, 1921]]

U.N.I.A. NEWS OF THE PANAMA BRANCH NO. 3

The Meeting of the above named society was called to order by the president at the hall at J street and Central avenue at 5 p.m. sharp on Sunday, April 10, 1921.

The opening ode was sung by all which showed the enthusiasm in the meeting. The chaplain attended to the religious rights in words of exhortation and the president gave his usual cheering remarks of hope and expectation for the U.N.I.A. His remarks were the fruits of a very warm and enthusiastic meeting. All listened with great interest to what he had to say. Loud was the applause he received at the termination of his remarks.

The choir then gave a very interesting anthem entitled "The Universal Negro," which was well enjoyed by all present. The address by Miss Hall was something of importance to all. She spoke of the great need of keeping together and working with all our might. The song by Mrs. Hallet and choir was another feature of worthiness of Negroes and their wonder working powers. The solo by Miss Dunn the great songstress was remarkable and it was with good cheers that she left the rostrum to take her seat. This nightingale is one of the favored ones for singing in this community.

An address by Mr. Walters of La Boca¹ was a soul-stirring one. He left no stone unturned in warning his brothers and sisters of the danger that they would run in keeping away from the association. This great talent kept the large congregation spellbound for a space of fifteen minutes. Using some of his tact, he succeeded in holding the audience interested for his entire stay on the platform, though at times his various remarks were so complicated that every one, whether member or non-member, felt that there was some message for them.

The paper from Miss Haylet was the next feature of note. This showed the capabilities of Negroes, judging of the past records of the worthy members of our race. Naming some talented ancestors, she encouraged all to go forward with more trust and hope in themselves. A duet by Miss A. Titus and Mr. Graham gave joy to all. The words of this duet, well suited to the occasion, brought every one bright hopes in the redemption of Africa. The solo by Mrs. E. Irons was received with loud acclaim, the audience showing its appreciation by great applause which everywhere resounded. The president was compelled to interrupt the demonstrations, explaining that while the lady's performance well merited the hearty response it evoked, it might be an injustice for the audi-

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ence to impose upon her willingness to respond. This was taken as good counsel, and all felt that they should again give hearty cheers to the nightingale voice, and these cheers resounded through the hall.

The chaplain spoke next, showing that it was his duty to always remind his hearers of their duties to God. His cool and interesting words went forcefully to the hearts of all.

Next was an anthem by the choir, following which a collection was made.

A solo by Mrs. H. E. Willis, rendered so splendidly brought many to their feet with enthusiasm. Others followed and displayed their talent and played their parts to the best of their ability.

In spite of the storms that beat around us and tempests that rage and all else that would tend to hamper us in the pursuit of our wonderful cause, we are going by leaps and bounds with one determination.

The meeting was brought to a close at 7:15 in the usual way.

J.G.C. Phillips, Reporter

Printed in NW, 7 May 1921.

1. La Boca is a small residential and commercial neighborhood close to Balboa, the heart of the former Canal Zone; it is located at the entrance of the canal, the Bridge of the Americas, and Balboa port.

Marcus Garvey to the *Daily Gleaner*

[[York House, Kingston, Jamaica,
May 11, 1921]]

MR. GARVEY'S VISIT TO BOCAS DEL TORO

EXPLANATION OF WHAT HAS BEEN PUBLISHED

Sir,—

Since my return to Jamaica I have heard it rumoured that certain things were published in your paper pertaining to be a report from your correspondent in Bocas Del Toro, in which reference was made to my visit to that province. From what I can gather from the rumour, having not seen the publication myself in which the report appeared, it is stated that the people of the town of Bocas demonstrated against my presence there and they acted roughly and said many unpleasant things. It is for me to state that such a report is incorrect, in fact, it is a barefaced misrepresentation of what really transpired.

In my travels in Central America, I was warmly received by thousands of West Indians, and natives living in those parts, and the receptions were so warm and hospitable, that I could not in any way but feel satisfied over the visit. I was welcomed by the Presidents as well as by the ordinary citizens of the republics. In the town of Bocas, the negro populace received me with open arms. There

was a little misunderstanding over the first meeting I was to address, which was caused through a mistake of the local secretary of the Organization, but there was nothing unpleasant in the misunderstanding.

What really happened which could be magnified as being unpleasant, was, that two West Indian mulattoes, who are averse to the work of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, organised a group of streetboys, such as you have playing in the gutters of Kingston, for the purpose of demonstrating before the home in which I lodged. Several of the officers of the local division requested the little boys to move away, and their leaders gave them stones to stone the building, hence I had to appear in person and ask them to go away. This scene, I suppose, was created by these two men for the purpose of getting sufficient material to scatter a propaganda against the U.N.I.A., and against me, which propaganda was well published in your paper as coming from your correspondent in Bocas.

All intelligent people know that such are the methods of a certain class of people who are opposed to the progress of the Negro and I do trust that the Jamaica community will become a little more critical in analyzing things that are published against the interest of institutions striving to do good in the interest of the Negro Race.

In fairness to me, I trust you will publish this letter so that the people who have been asking me questions relative to what happened in Bocas, may have the satisfaction of an explanation. I am etc.,

MARCUS GARVEY

Printed in *DG*, 17 May 1921.

A. Percy Bennett,¹ British Legation, San José,
to the Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs

British Legation, San José,
Costa Rica. May 11th, 1921

His Majesty's Minister at San José, Costa Rica, presents his compliments to His Majesty's Principal Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs, and has the honour to transmit herewith copy of the undermentioned paper, for His Lordship's information[:]

H.M. Consul, Port Limon. May 9th, 1921.
Visit of Marcus Garvey to Costa Rica.

A copy of this despatch has been sent to the Governor of Jamaica.

TNA: PRO FO 371/5684/33525. TD. Marked "No. 34."

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1. Andrew Percy Bennett (1866–1943) was British minister to Costa Rica from 1920 to 1923. Educated at Cambridge, Bennett was posted as a diplomat at Manila, Galatz, New York, Vienna, Rome, Athens, Burcharest, and Zurich. He also served as British minister to Panama (1919–1923) and Venezuela (1924–1927) before retiring in 1927 (WWW).

Enclosure: Fred Gordon, British Consul,
Port Limón, to A. Percy Bennett, British
Legation, San José

British Consulate, Port Limon,
Costa Rica. May 9th, 1921

Sir,

I have the honour to inform you that the negro-agitator, Marcus Garvey, arrived in Costa Rica by the s.s. "Coronado" on Thursday April 14th last, and proceeded to San José where it is understood he had an interview with the President of the Republic.

On the 18th he returned to Port Limon, and immediately addressed a crowd of some 1,000 West Indians, and again at the local theatre at 8 pm on Tuesday the 19th; he gave a series of lectures on the future of the negro race, at each meeting collections were taken for subscriptions for the African Community League.

The sole object of his visit to Costa Rica was for the purpose of collecting funds for the establishment of factories and Machine shops in Liberia, of which country he styles himself the President-Elect. During the various meetings, he has flatly refused to answer questions put to him, as to the funds subscribed in the past, and his followers were disappointed.

On Wednesday April 20th, he proceeded to the interior by special train, and gave a series of lectures at each station along the line; he returned to Limon on the night of the 20th, and his last lecture was given at the local theatre the same night, though the audience was very small. On the morning of the 21st he proceeded to Bocas del Toro, Republic of Panama.

It is estimated that some \$25,000, United States currency, was collected during his stay here, and the greater portion during his first forty-eight hours here. His speeches were of a weak character—he was able to hold his hearers and completely baffle them—no statements were made against the "white man." His last advice to the West Indians being "to work hard and subscribe to the Liberia Government Loan." Today the West Indians are divided in their opinion regarding this man and their future; but the educated West Indian refuses to countenance his proposals.

In conclusion, I am of the opinion that the West Indians have benefited by his visit to the extent of showing them this his wild-cat schemes and teachings are impossible. I have etc.,

(Sd) F. GORDON
H.M. Consul

TNA: PRO FO 371/5684/33525. TL, copy.

Article in the *Voice of St. Lucia*

[[St. Lucia, May 18, 1921]]

U.N.I.A. MEETING

UNVEILING OF CHARTER

What certainty proved to be a creditable rendering was the programme staged by the local Division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association on Sunday afternoon, 15th instant in their Ha[ll] at the foot of Morne Dudon Road. We were present from first to last and have such pleasure in testifying to the merit of the proceedings. One could not help finding it a pity that those who first attempted to lead the Association have failed to grasp the true meaning of its object and consequently led along wrong lines. But it seems as though the recent leaders have already proved their fitness to undertake the management of the Division.

The meeting commenced at about 4:40 p.m. The Hall was filled with an audience including several of our well respected citizens and many persons a failing to find room inside, were obliged to occupy standing space in the crowded verandah.

The chair was occupied by the President Mr. Job E. James, and several sacred pieces including a duet were satisfactorily rendered by a choir of [*word illegible*] voices led by a violin and an organ. Mr. Julian Theobald's who also sat in the audience was satisfied by rendering a fine violin solo.

Then followed the unveiling of the Charter which all the while lay hidden from view by two flags—the Union Jack and the Stars & Stripes by which it was draped. The person performing this act was Miss. Pearla James, daughter of the President who, as she exposed the Charter to view in a distinct voice said: "I, now and here unveil this Charter which bestows authority on the Castries Division to operate in accord with the ideals of the U.N.I.A., and under the motto—One Good, One Aim, One Destiny!" (Applause).

The Universal Anthem of the U.N.I.A. was then sung. After this a procession of all the members and almost every one of the visitors was made round the room so as to give opportunity for each one to see the Charter at close quarter, While the procession was being made a newly composed hymn "Forward Christian Warrior" was rightly sung to the tune of 'Onward Christian Soldiers' and as many a coin was dropped into a plate near by as those taking part in the procession passed by the Charter.

The first address was delivered by the President, Mr. James who is a good speaker gripped his audience as he spoke of the work of the U.N.I.A. in which he has the honour of taking part. He said that the U.N.I.A. was not organised to make people seditious; but that its aims were to fit the Negroes socially, spiritually, intellectual, industrially, and commercially. The members of the U.N.I.A. had to be very grateful to the late Queen Victoria who freed the Negroes of the West Indies and to Abraham Lincoln a former President of the U.S.A. for bestowing the same blessings to the Negroes of the American Republic.

Another address was then delivered by Dr. E. Duncan, Chairman of the Advisory Board, who with his usual eloquence dealt with the objects of the Association treating his subject for about half an hour. The objects were quoted from the book of Constitution and clearly explained and it was shown that the Association was not organised to carry on [*word illegible*] war nor to encourage disrespect for the flag under which any Negro lived but to carry out in any part of the world a constitutional fight for the advancement and protection of Negroes. The speaker said that here in St. Lucia the Association would have much to do for the fallen; that it was putting God first in its movements, and that being the case the gates of hell could not prevail against it.

After the audience had listened to another address by Mr. S.O. Thompson, another officer, the singing of "Now the day is over" followed, after which "God, save the King" was sung and the meeting ended.

Printed in *VSL*, 18 May 1921.

H. N. Huggins, President, UNIA St. Vincent Division, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

Stubbs P.O. St. Vincent
B. W. I. 20.5.21

Dear Fellowman

[T]rusting you and yours are well. I also hope you have rec[ei]ved my last letter[.] I have mailed photo under sep[a]rate cover, also empty case. I thought photo would be made to send in case that[']s why you did not rec[ei]ve same before[.] I sent by last letter stating I did not rec[ei]ve Negro World[.] I hope to rec[ei]ve one by next mail from you. I also heard our leader has gone on to Demerara[.] I guess you had a fine reception for him. [I]f //he// had wired to us he [*line missing*] pass back on 5th June when we shall prepare for him in Kingstown 8 miles from me. [E]verybody who is interested in the movement is quite interested to see him. [H]ow is things shaping let me know please. I also received a letter from Fellow woman Mary Phillips Trinidad Guaiaco asking me to come and assist them in unveiling their Charter on the 27th June. I am sorry

you are unable to go. [S]hould they convey me I will go that[']s my answer to them. What do you think of it. My kindest regards to all and a double portion for self. While I remain Yours Fraternally,

H. N. HUGGINS

P.S. I am about going to law with a shareholder of the Company [about?] the Company's property and won[']t pay rent nor deliver[ies] as I am [manager.] [Y]ou will hear later about same.

JRRC. ALS, recipient's copy.

James Benjamin Yearwood, Assistant Secretary
General, UNIA, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

UNIVERSAL BUILDING,
56 WEST 135TH STREET
NEW YORK, U.S.A. May 20, 1921

Dear Sir:—

Pursuant to your communication of the 3rd instant addressed to the Right Honorable Secretary General and Assistant, we beg to thank you for your manifest generosity and we sincerely hope for your continuance.

We regret very much hearing of the misunderstanding in the Division and we assure you of our implicit confidence, and we hope that you shall do all that is in your power to have officers elected for the various Divisions by the people, for the people, and who will serve the people.

If there are any officers in your Division who are not working constitutionally, you are requested to call a meeting of the advisory board and have a trial of same, and if they are found guilty, it is your duty through the General membership to have same removed so that men who are interested will be elected and that in the future the Division will feel the benefit of the change of administration.

We regret having to state that it was absolutely an impossibility for us to notify you of the visit of His Excellency the West Indian Leader, R. H. Tobitt, as he [is] responsible for the making of his schedule and should have notified you ahead of time.

We again take the pleasure of expressing our appreciation for the splendid manner in which you have co-operated with us, and we are well aware of the fact that you are one of the loyal ones who have labored stren[u]ously, and we hope that in the very near future you shall reap the rewards thereof.

We are well aware of the difficulty you have in uniting our people, but hope that before many months shall have [passed?] you shall be satisfied with the success of your labor.

MAY 1921

You are requested to write us for all necessary information and special attention will be given your mail.

Rest assured of our wholehearted support and implicit confidence. We are
Yours fraternally,

UNIVERSAL NEGRO IMPROVEMENT ASSN.
J. B. YEARWOOD
Asst. Secy. General

[*Addressed to:*] Mr. J. R. Ralph Casimier
[Casimir], General Secretary, U.N.I.A.,
Roseau, Dominica, B.W.I.

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy.

D. Erastus Thorpe, President, UNIA Tela
Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Tela, May 24, 1921]]

CONDITIONS IN TELA

Dear Sir:

Kindly allow me space in your indispensable journal of the Negro race to make known some of the most damnable actions of some of our Negro people in Tela. My revelation is an issue of the true manifestation of Garveyism by a New Negro.

On the 11th inst., at 2 p.m., Bro. Stephen A. Gayle, an active member of this division, breathed his last. On receiving the news D. Erastus Thorpe, president of the local division, proceeded to the home of the deceased, and laid claim to the burial in the name of the U.N.I.A. After having done so the Rev. Harold C. Dunn (a white Englishman) visited the house and solicited the official handling of the funeral. To his solicitation he was informed by the wife and brother of deceased that deceased was a member of the U.N.I.A. and Mr. D. E. Thorpe was in charge of same. A bystander, however, gave a rejoinder to the effect that if in case he (the Rev. Dunn) was needed he would be informed later on! The reverend gentleman, however, was never communicated with. President Thorpe thereupon called a meeting of his cabinet, and after being satisfied about the brother's legal claim upon the association, made final arrangements for his interment. The wife of deceased was then acquainted with all the arrangements made, and readily acquiesced thereto.

At 5 p.m. on the 12th a procession, headed by the Municipal Band, composed as follows: Chaplain J. J. [B]rown, assisted by Bro. J. B. Wray, U.N.I.A. charter borne by two ladies of the Honorary Advisory Board. The corpse, draped in the Red, Black and Green, followed by about sixteen pall-bearers in

rows of four, and ladies and children also in rows of four marshaled by Mr. D. E. Thorpe and Mr. B. O. Buckner, left the house of deceased, proceeded to the Central street of the city in an impressive manner. The reverence paid by all to the passing procession was unique and picturesque. On arriving midway between the cemetery and the starting point the procession was met by another batch of members under the leadership of Mr. E. M. Stewart, second vice-president. Nearer the cemetery news reached President Thorpe that the Rev. Harold C. Dunn was awaiting the funeral at his mission station. On arriving at the crossroads that lead to this reverend gentleman's mission station, President Thorpe stepped forward and ordered the procession on to the cemetery, leaving the Reverend Dunn to continue to ring his bell of deception as he was then doing. At the grave Chaplain Brown performed the last rites and Brother Gayle was buried as a U.N.I.A. member, the first of this division to be thus honored. Brother Gayle was one of those members who had implicit confidence in the inherent rights of the Negro race. As such he lived, as such he died, and as such was he buried. He leaves a wife and six young children to mourn their irreparable loss. The division extends its sincerest condolence to the bereaved relatives.

But to come to the point at issue, Mr. Editor, I would like to draw the attention of our people in Tela to the better understanding of themselves through this medium.

There is a certain class of Negroes in this locality who were highly offended because they believe so much in the supremacy of the white man in every thing under the canopy of heaven that they infer that D. Erastus Thorpe had most grossly insulted this "white parson" who had come all the way from England to preach to black folks out in Tela, only forgetting at the same time that there are hundreds of his kinsmen who are within close proximity and would not pay him that much compliments as their spiritual adviser to hear him preach "Christ and Him crucified to Them." The Rev. Dunn would not and could not admit the U.N.I.A. charter in his mission station, and D. Erastus Thorpe, having sworn allegiance to the U.N.I.A. would not submit or give a thought to a white man officiating over anything flying the colors of the Red, Black and Green. Had those persons known the principles of the U.N.I.A., never in their wildest dreams as true Negroes would they ridicule the U.N.I.A. for a white man. Furthermore, the writer has already made it clear from the platform of our local Liberty Hall that the U.N.I.A. has no apologies to make when functioning on her constitutional rights, and has asked that the same be conveyed to the Rev. Dunn, and although some Negroes have gone and apologized to this parson for the supposed insult handed out to him, it is to be understood that such is not the sentiment of the executives of charter No. 165. The Rev. Dunn is guilty of handing out some of the most atrocious insults in his church to the Negroes of Tela, and if he were insulted, which I earnestly believe he has not been, then it was only a matter of paying him back with his own coin. Just a few more facts, Mr. Editor. The Rev. Dunn has been in Tela at most three years now, whence the U.F. Co. founded their stronghold here

about ten years. Negro clergy and laymen have been amongst us all along, and they have all been turned down by the Negroes because they were Negroes. Rev. Daniel Graham was one of such pioneers, and today there remains as a monument to his labor a cornerstone for the building of a church laid over five years ago and is now in ruins. The treatment meted out to that rever[en]d gentleman [*words illegible*] white race has been most piercing were the facts to be related, but alas, being a man of color nothing ill was thought of them. Now that a white parson is in the vicinity and has found it fit to utilize the Negro against the Negro for his personal benefit, these Negroes are seeing it fit to hold the Rev. Dunn in one hand and the U.N.I.A. in the other. Negroes who were never known to be churchgoers ere the advent of the U.N.I.[A]. are now ardent worshippers at the white parson's church "because they cannot allow the white parson, who had come all the way from England to preach to them, to starve on account of Garvey and his foolishness, etc." It would give one cholera at times to listen to the sentiments of some Negroes against things Negro in order to uphold the prestige (?) and integrity (?) of the white folks. The serious apprehension behind these ideas of the Negro here is due to the social hypocrisy practiced by the Rev. Dunn amongst them. He being a Britisher, and diametrically opposed to the U.N.I.A., he therefore weaves some of the most depreciating ideas into the minds of those Negroes coming under his influence. He is the only white man in Tela today who is greatly concerned about the U.N.I.A. as it affects his very existence in Tela, despite the fact that he has Negro followers. Very many threats are being hinted to Negroes relative to their freedom under British rule and authority, but I shall certainly await the issue of these threats. Personally I will vouchsafe to say I shall welcome anything, even death, in the cause of the U.N.I.A.

In closing, Mr. Editor, I would like to advise the "big Negroes" of Tela who are making of themselves tools directly or indirectly in vilifying the Hon. Marcus Garvey, myself and the U.N.I.A. that they quit their foolishness, because there shall be no difference between us when the time arrives for aggressions from our alien foes. A Negro is a Negro. Who don't like the movement keep out and keep quiet, who is for it be loyal, but we appreciate no stand of neutrality in connection with the U.N.I.A.

D. ERASTUS THORPE

Printed in NW, 10 September 1921.

“Neutral” to the *Workman*

[Panama City, 28 May 1921]

NEW YORK JOURNALIST

WRITES ON METHODS OF U.N.I.A.

Sir,—

There is a great deal being said about Garvey and his movement now-a-day: both for and against, and as I see that the policy of the *Workman* has been strictly impartial in publishing correspondence bearing on both sides of the Garvey activities here on the Isthmus, I take the liberty of sending you the attached letter clipped from the *National Review*,¹ a new colored paper published by West Indians in New York, and in close proximity to the headquarters of the Negro Improvement Association[.] I particularly ask you to give publicity to the article as it appears to me to be a fair and unbiased opinion of the writer who is on the spot to judge for himself.

The article runs thus:—

FALSE CLAIMS

Last week we opened the gospel according to Garvey² and read chapter 2 verse 2: “. . . And recently President Warren G. Harding in his message to Congress³ indicated that the Negro was entitled to a just and fair consideration. This is an immense gain. The doubting Thomases may say that is merely a temporal rather than logical sequence, that it just accidentally happened that the U.N.I.A. was crysta[l]ized at the very moment when the world began to survey the Negro through new spectacles. But we are inclined to believe that there is a casual [causal] relation between the ideas of the U.N.I.A. and the world’s changing attitude toward the Negro.”

In other words the U.N.I.A. was the direct cause of President Harding’s message[.] The U.N.I.A. frightened the British Government into placing Negroes into the West African Medical Service. The U.N.I.A. is responsible for the Milner Commission in Egypt;⁴ for the Yap note;⁵ for the revolt of the Congo Natives;⁶ for the conviction of Manning;⁷ for the growth of Negro business in Harlem and a hundred other things. This is excellent stuff to feed its members on, but it is true?

The editor of the *Negro World* knows that President Harding’s message on the race question was the identical plan that the N.A.A.C.P. (National Association for the Advancement of Colored People) through its secretary, Mr. Jas. Weldon Johnson, proposed to the President on April 4th.⁸ He also knows that a similar plan was submitted to President Wilson 8 years ago.⁹ He further knows that the N.A.A.C.P., has consistently fought for this very measure for 10 ye[a]rs. Yet he has the effrontery to claim credit for the changed attitude at the White House.

But if the *Negro World* is sincere in its solicitude for the welfare of the last Negro on the banks of the Zambesi it has an excellent opportunity to prove its sincer[i]ty right here in America[.] The suggestions of President Harding¹⁰ must be placed on the statu[t]e book; a favorable public opinion towards the Negro must be created; legislation must be influenced; and a scientific campaign carried on all over the country to remove our disabilities and consolidate our gains. No organization in America is better equipped to handle this situation than the N.A.A.C.P., and it is making a drive for 250,000 members to put its plans into operation.

The *Negro World* knows of this drive but it maintains a deep, deathly silence: while the *Nation*, a white weekly devotes an entire page to the Race Commission.¹¹ Can prejudice against a legitimate Negro American organization that is working for our betterment go further? Can censorship be more complete? Can evasion be less justified?

If Garvey dreams of a day when he can be seated in a golden chair in Timbuctoo, fantastically attired with true Garveyan gaudiness, issuing ultimata to the world, and using money from American Negroes to do this, while unconcerned with their problems here, let him say so[.] But he cannot expect to bluff us in believing that he has our interest at heart when he makes no effort to better our conditions in America.

ARTHUR KING¹²

Thanking you for space allowed. I am yours truly,

NEUTRAL

Printed in the *Workman* (Panama City), 28 May 1921. Original text not extracted.

1. The complete official title was the *National Review: A Journal Devoted to the Progress and Development of the Colored People*; it was published in New York in the twenties and thirties, but very few copies have survived or are available.

2. A reference to the *Negro World* newspaper.

3. Warren G. Harding delivered his first presidential address to Congress at a joint session of Congress on 12 April 1921. In this speech, he urged Congress to pass a federal anti-lynching law to protect African Americans. His address reads,

Somewhat related to the foregoing human problems is the race question. Congress ought to wipe the stain of barbaric lynching from the banners of a free and orderly, representative democracy. [Applause.] We face the fact that many millions of people of African descent are numbered among our population, and that in a number of States they constitute a very large proportion of the total population. It is unnecessary to recount the difficulties incident to this condition, nor to emphasize the fact that it is a condition which can not be removed. There has been suggestion, however, that some of its difficulties might be ameliorated by a humane and enlightened consideration of it, a study of its many aspects, and an effort to formulate, if not a policy, at least a national attitude of mind calculated to bring about the most satisfactory possible adjustment of relations between the races, and of each race to the national life. One proposal is the creation of a commission embracing representatives of both races, to study and report on the entire subject. The proposal has real merit. I am convinced that in mutual tolerance, understanding, charity, recognition of the interdependence of the races, and the maintenance of the rights of citizenship lies the road to righteous adjustment (Warren Gamaleil Harding, *Address of Warren G. Harding, President of the United States, Deliv-*

ered at a Joint Session of the Two Houses of Congress, April 12, 1921 [Washington D.C.: Governmental Printing Office, 1921], pp. 12–13).

4. The Milner commission to Egypt took place from December 1919 until March 1920. The professed purpose of the commission was to “inquire into the causes of the late disorders, and report on the existing situation in that country and the form of the Constitution which, under the Protectorate, will be best calculated to promote its peace and prosperity, the progressive development of self-governing institutions, and the protection of foreign interests” (*Times* [London], 23 September 1919). The commission consisted of Lord Milner; General Sir J. G. Maxwell; Sir J. Rennell Rodd; Brigadier-General Sir Owen Thomas; Mr. J. A. Spender; Mr. C. J. B. Hurst, accompanied by Mr. A. T. Lloyd as secretary; and Mr. E. M. B. Ingram as assistant secretary and private secretary to Lord Milner.

According to contemporary news reports, there were various disturbances in Egypt in the forms of protests of the commission before and during its visit. The Party of Independence called a boycott against the commission, and according to Sir Valentine Chirol, Egyptian women made noisy demonstrations against the Milner mission. Young boys and girls also went on strike to protest the Milner commission, and eleven- and twelve-year-olds sent telegrams of protest to the minister of education and to the prime minister. The *Times* claimed that these disturbances were the result of Egyptians’ being erroneously led to believe that the commissioners’ purpose in Egypt was to impose an oppressive form of the protectorate and a sham constitution. The commission’s visit, however, did lead to talks with Zaghul Pasha and the members of the Egyptian delegation in London in August and later October and November of 1920 (*Times* [London], 9 and 22 December 1919, 2 January and 15 and 23 March 1920, and 19 February 1921).

5. In a formal communication sent by U.S. Secretary of State Charles Evans Hughes to the British, French, Italian, and Japanese governments on 4 April 1921, the United States refused to recognize the allocation of the island of Yap to Japan as a mandate. According to the diplomatic note, the United States refused to recognize that the allied powers or any other agencies had the right to dispose of any of the German overseas possessions without U.S. consent. Hughes also revealed that former President Wilson had communicated with the U.S. State Department in March 1921 that he had never consented to the assignment of Yap to Japan and that he had made specific reservations regarding Yap during the Big Four sessions at the Paris Peace Conference in 1919. A Yap treaty was ratified by the U.S. Senate on 1 March 1922, providing that Yap would be a mandate under Japan as long as American rights and interests were preserved. The treaty also gave the United States free access to Yap for cable and radio telegraphic purposes, but the United States could not establish a radio station as long as Japan gave satisfactory service (*NYT*, 5 and 7 April 1921, 12 February and 2 March 1922).

6. Possibly a reference to a “period-from late 1920 until early 1921, [when] several revolts spread through southeast Equateur and northern Sankuru, leading to troop movements, displacement of prisoners, and a general concern fostered by difficult social and economic conditions, as well as by Kinshasa’s sensationalist press, which spread rumors of revolt” (*Bulletin administrative et commercial du Congo Belge*, 1920, pp. 1188–1190). This reference may also be to the revolts caused by the influence of the publication *Negro World*, which was disseminated in the region at this time by American Methodist missionaries. In June 1921, the *New York Times* reported that there was “unrest among American negroes employed by an American firm in the Belgian Congo.” “The American negroes . . .,” the report asserts, “have been receiving a newspaper which incited them to rebellion” (“Report American Negroes Arming in the Congo,” *NYT* [1857–Current file], 18 June 1921, ProQuest Historical Newspapers *NYT* (1851–2006), 1). There was also an anti-colonialist religious movement called *Kimbanguism* that followed the believed prophet Simon Kimbangu (“Report American Negroes Arming in the Congo,” *NYT* [1857–Current file], 18 June 1921, ProQuest Historical Newspapers *NYT* (1851–2006), 1).

7. Probably a reference to Clyde Manning, a black man who confessed that he had killed four men on the Williams plantation in Jasper County, Georgia, in March 1921. Agents of the Department of Justice had visited the Williams plantation to investigate peonage charges around 1 March 1921. The owner, John S. Williams, reportedly gave a satisfactory explanation, but days later, eleven black men were murdered. It was alleged that the persons killed were held in peonage and had threatened to inform the authorities. Manning declared that he had killed the four men to escape with his own life because, if he had not carried out Williams’s orders, he would have been killed. In early April 1921, Williams was convicted of the murder of one of the men in Newton County and sentenced to life imprisonment. Clyde Manning was convicted in June 1921, but after he had served

almost a year in prison, a new trial was ordered in April 1922 (*NYT*, 25, 27, 28, 30 March 1921; *Los Angeles Times*, 26 March and 12 April 1921; *The Chicago Defender*, 31 August 1921 and 15 April 1922).

8. James Weldon Johnson met with President Harding and gave him an NAACP memorandum on 4 April 1921. It asked that the president recommend action to end lynching; that he abolish racial segregation in the federal departments in Washington D.C., and in the civil service through an executive order; and that the administration appoint black assistant secretaries in the Departments of Labor and Agriculture. The memorandum also called for a Department of Justice investigation of peonage, a Congressional investigation of the occupation of Haiti, and a governmental investigation of black disfranchisement. Finally, the NAACP wanted a national interracial commission appointed to study race relations (Richard B. Sherman, *The Republican Party and Black America from McKinley to Hoover, 1896–1933* [Charlottesville: University Press of Virginia, 1973], p. 147).

9. In May 1913, the NAACP presented President Woodrow Wilson with a plan, called the National Race Commission, for ending segregation in the government. Wilson was unwilling to comply with their demands; thus, later that year, the NAACP protested and petitioned him. They then met with him about the state of race relations in the federal government. For additional information concerning the history of the NAACP and Wilson's reactions, see Nicholas Patler's *Jim Crow and the Wilson Administration: Protesting Federal Segregation in the Early Twentieth Century* (Boulder: University of Colorado Press, 2004) and Gilbert Jonas's *Freedom's Sword: The NAACP and the Struggle Against Racism, 1909–1969* (New York: Routledge, 2005).

10. During his 1920 campaign, Warren G. Harding sought to win black votes. Harding listened during audiences with black leaders but did not make many commitments. He generally favored an anti-lynching law, the protection of constitutional rights for blacks, and the appointment of blacks to more federal offices, but in an attempt not to alienate other voters, he maintained a moderate position. The result was that when the NAACP requested statements from the Republican candidates in 1920 about black patronage, Haitian independence, anti-lynching laws, and suffrage, Harding did not answer directly but instead stated that the party platform should make "every becoming declaration on behalf of Negro citizenship, which the conscience of the Party and the conditions of this country combine to suggest" (Robert K. Murray, *The Harding Era: Warren G. Harding and His Administration* [Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 1969], p. 397).

A good example of Harding's attempt to maintain a restrained position on race issues was his Oklahoma City visit on 9 October 1920. In an address, Harding declared, "I believe in equality before the law. You can't give rights to the white man and deny them to the black man. But while I stand for that great, great principle, I do not mean that the white man and the black man must be forced to associate together in the acceptance of their rights" (Randolph C. Downes, *The Rise of Warren Gamaliel Harding, 1865–1920* [Columbus: Ohio State University Press, 1970], p. 535). During this Oklahoma visit, Harding also repudiated the use of force by the federal government to enable blacks to vote. Harding's Oklahoma positions disappointed militant blacks, and according to Republicans, these views were widely known among blacks. The Chicago Republican publicity bureau therefore asked Harding to avoid further references to those comments. Democrats in Cleveland, however, did not avoid references to his speech. They published a leaflet about Republicans that quoted Harding's comment about equality, but they omitted the reference to segregation. Thus, Democratic segregationists used this moderate speech to portray Harding as an integrationist.

In reality, Harding maintained his moderate platform and centered it on three main factors: supporting political and civil equality on a segregated basis, limiting specifics to the situation in Haiti and to the issue of opposition to lynching, and focusing on black votes in the North. Republicans sponsored Negro Republican clubs throughout the North, circulated special party pamphlets designed for black voters, and staged Colored Voters' Day at Marion in September.

These small conciliations led to a white backlash. Previous to his presidential run, Harding had encountered allegations that he had black ancestry, but the allegations resurfaced in 1920 with leaflets of the "Harding Family Tree" and affidavits of people confirming that Harding had black ancestors. Republican newspapers defended Harding and called the allegations lies spread by slanderers. The mixed-blood allegations actually helped mitigate the white backlash against Harding since his supporters ardently defended him.

Harding won the presidential race, and after his inauguration, he did meet with black leaders who submitted their proposals on race issues. During a speech to Congress in April 1921, he also discussed race. He declared then that they "ought to rid the stain of barbaric lynching from the

banner of a free and orderly representative society” and proposed the establishing of an interracial commission “to formulate, if not a policy, then at least a national attitude of mind calculated to bring about the most satisfactory possible adjustment of relations between the races” (Murray, *The Harding Era*, p. 398). Later, in Birmingham on 26 October 1921, Harding declared that social equality between the two races was impossible, but he also said there was no excuse for economic, political, or educational discrimination. Overall, blacks were disappointed with Harding, as the Dyer anti-lynching bill died in Congress, segregation was kept alive in the federal government, and only a few blacks were named for political appointments (Murray, *The Harding Era*, pp. 54, 397–403; Downes, *The Rise of Warren Gamaliel Harding, 1865–1920* pp. 535, 537, 539, 546, 547, 550, 552–61; Eugene P. Trani and David L. Wilson, *The Presidency of Warren G. Harding* [Lawrence: Regents Press of Kansas, 1977], pp. 102–104).

11. In the 27 April 1921 issue, the *Nation* praises the idea of a race commission. The relevant editorial, “A Race Commission—A Constructive Plan,” begins, “There is no more useful paragraph in President Harding’s message than that which deals with the race question because he has several constructive proposals to make” (*Nation* 112, no. 2912 [1921]: 612). The editorial commends Harding’s suggestion for a race commission, while it criticizes the Wilson administration, asserting that the administration “sought, ostrich-like, to evade the whole question—after instituting segregation in the several departments in Washington” (*Nation* 112, no. 2912 [1921]: 612).

12. Arthur E. King was one of the original members of Hubert H. Harrison’s Liberty League of Negro Americans in 1917; he was also a sometime writer (Arthur E. King, “The Population Problem and the Negro,” *Opportunity* 2 [1924]: 325; 3 [1925]: 57; Jeffrey B. Perry, *Hubert H. Harrison: The Voices of Harlem Radicalism, 1883–1918* [New York: Columbia University Press, 2009], p. 316).

Article in the *Daily Gleaner*

[[Limon, Costa Rica, May 30 1921]]

PRESIDENT OF U.N.I.A. IN COSTA RICA

THE RECENT STAY OF MR. MARCUS GARVEY IN CENTRAL AMERICAN REPUBLIC

VISIT TO THE CAPITAL

AN ENTHUSIASTIC RECEPTION GIVEN HIM AT PORT LIMON.

OPINION OF PRESS

The long looked to visit here of the President-General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association is now an event of the past. Mr. Garvey arrived at this port on the S.S. Coronado on the 14th ultimo. Although the local branch of the association had for some weeks previous been advised of his contemplated visit, and were in consequence, making preparations for same, they were not definitely informed of his having left Jamaica until during the night of the day previous to that of his arrival. The news of his coming soon spread, and although the ship was not timed to arrive until 3 p.m., groups of his admirers could be seen wending their way towards the dock from the early hours of the day. By 2 p.m. the wharf was thickly crowded. It is estimated that more than 1,500 persons were assembled there. As soon as the ship dropped anchor, the

local secretary and his assistant left for the ship in the Port Captain's launch. Whilst the ship was being moored, Mr. Garvey was frequently cheered, and on landing, was immediately surrounded, the huge crowd accompanying him to the customs, where he had to attend the clearing of his baggage. An idea of the crowd can well be imagined, when it is stated that under their weight, the concrete steps at the entrance to the customs, broke and fell in. On leaving the customs, Mr. Garvey was driven by automobile to the residence provided for himself and secretaries. Here he cordially thanked his people for their welcome, and informed them that he would be leaving for San Jose, the capital of the republic, 103 miles in the interior, the following morning, but would return to Limon on the Monday. He left at 9 a.m. Friday by special train. Arrangements were soon after made with the Railway Company for special trains to be despatched to the different sections of the lines to bring in the people interested in Mr. Garvey's movement. Between Sunday afternoon and Monday morning these trains returned to Limon. The town by that time was rather crowded, it being estimated that no less than 3,000 persons came in. Mr. Garvey's special arrived at about 1 p.m. on Monday. He was met at the railway station by the entire body of members of the various branches of the association operating in the republic, carrying banners done up in the colours of the proposed African republic. A procession, headed by the President-General, and a band of music, was then made through the principal streets of the town, terminating at the theatre "Arrasty." During the procession, stoppages were made in front of the offices of the Governor of the province, the British and the American consuls, and the National Anthem of the country represented played, as also that of the "African Republic." Lectures were held in the theatre at 3 o'clock in the afternoon, and again at 8 p.m. on Monday. A charge of 1 dollar per ticket was made for each of these. At 9 a.m. the following day—Tuesday—Mr. Garvey gave an open-air lecture on the "Plaza de Toro," at the close of which a collection was taken up by a number of the "Black Cross" nurses, in aid of the Liberian Reconstruction Fund. At 3 p.m. the same afternoon, another lecture took place in the theatre to which a similar charge of 1 dollar for admission was made, his visit being closed with a further lecture on the same Plaza at night, another collection being taken up. On the Wednesday he left for Estrada and Siquirres, where he delivered lectures, returned to Limon the same night, and sailed at 7:30 a.m. Thursday morning for the Bocas del Toro, by the U.F. Co's launch "Toni," which had been specially sent up for him.

All Mr. Garvey's lectures consisted of the same things stated by him in his public utterances in Jamaica. At no time did he give out any statements respecting the operations of the "Black Star" Line, nor did he say one word about the cash transactions of any of his associations. He has promised his supporters here to send by the end of the current year, at least one of the larger ships of his line to enable those who desire to do so, to have the opportunity of going direct to Liberia. It is stated that Mr. Garvey left Costa Rica with some 35,000 dollars or 40,000 dollars.

OPINIONS OF THE PRESS

In the "Diario," published in San Jose, Costa Rica, there are comments on Mr. Garvey's visit in this republic. On April 17th that paper says: "Mr. Marcus Garvey is an important person. He is President of the African communities League, and Chief of the "Black Star" Line Company. . . . Yesterday he visited the President of the Republic and presented his respects . . . We are pleased to extend our respects to him."

On the 19th April, the same paper says:

"The Negroes continue in fiesta consequent on the arrival of Mr. Garvey, Provisional President of Africa. Large placards were placed in the streets of Limon, announcing his expected arrival, and the Negroes are preparing their robes and banners to assist in the manifestations. Many natives and foreigners, residing in Limon, are well acquainted with the citizen of Jamaica, who has for some time past assumed the chief position in the world, in the great ethical revolution, which it is believed will soon arise. He resided in Limon for a long period and was engaged in agriculture—later as the editor of a newspaper. In this latter work, he was the partner of the Late Solomon Aguilera. He has also lived in San Jose where he has many friends. We do not know what his occupation here was, but we suppose it was of little account. Mr. Garvey had not, at that time, conceived the idea, for which his name is now known throughout the world. We have not sufficient evidence as to the extent of his proposals, but what is true is, that we have read in foreign Review[s] that this new "Messiah" apparently proposes to do away with the inferiority of the black race—placing it, by reason of its numerical strength—over the white race. That is to say, by starting a formidable movement of revenge so as to place the domination of the world in the hands of the black race. We do not know how far this assertion can be true; we only repeat it, as, on different occasions, we have seen it published in various reviews of recognised integrity."

On the 21st of April the same paper says:

"The Honourable Marcus Garvey is the most radical of all the leaders of the American Negroes. He is, by his power, no longer a leader, he is an institution. His political personality is so complex, that it could only—as he says—be demonstrated by an algebraical formula, viz: Garvey equals Morton plus Dubois plus the dignity of the negro. Garvey wants economical independence, social improvement and political rights, not only for the American negroes, but for those of the entire world. Africa is the home of the negro, therefore, Africa should be a continent ruled by negroes, the same as Europe is ruled by the white and Asia by the yellow races. It is not sufficient that a negro who is born in a country should be a citizen of that country; it is necessary that the negro should be represented by a powerful nation, in concert with the other great nations. Garvey, therefore, preaches a doctrine similar to the Munro [Doctrine].¹ The Black Moses, as they call Garvey, has with much noise, triumphed in the United States, surrounded by more than three million negroes. He is

then, to-day, the Negro Leader, who has the largest partisanship. This man possesses rare culture, an extraordinary activity, and a profound knowledge of the psychology of his race. He has waged, in the United States, a real bloodless revolution, dazzling negroes with his astonishing eloquence, his pontifical achievements and by the splendour of his public appearance. Garvey is, to-day, an idol of many thousand American negroes, who call him "His Royal Highness" and pay him adoration. It can be said without exaggeration that Garvey has manufactured for the American negro, a black ideal, a black intellect and a black soul. Garveyism is very complex, and can only be defined thus:—a social, economical, political and religious institution. Garveyism has its motto, which is: one God, one purpose, and one destiny. It has an official hymn entitled "Ethiopia thou land of our Fathers," and it has a flag which consist of the colours: red, black and green. The black represents the colour of its members, the green, the hope they possess, and the red, the blood which they are prepared to shed for the maintenance of their ideal."

Printed in *DG*, 8 June 1921.

1. The so-called Monroe Doctrine was proclaimed by President James Monroe on 2 December 1823 during his seventh annual State of the Union Address to Congress, in which it was stated that further efforts by European nations to colonize land or interfere with states in North or South America would be viewed as acts of aggression requiring U.S. intervention. This promulgation became a defining moment in U.S. foreign policy, and the doctrine became one of its longest-standing tenets (Ernest R. May, *The Making of the Monroe Doctrine* [Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 1975, 1992]; Gretchen Murphy, *Hemispheric Imaginings: The Monroe Doctrine and Narratives of U.S. Empire* [Durham, N.C.: Duke University Press, 2005]; Jay Sexton, *The Monroe Doctrine: Empire and Nation in Nineteenth-Century America* [New York: Hill and Wang, 2011]).

D. Erastus Thorpe, President, UNIA Tela Division, to the *Daily Gleaner*

[[Tela, Republic of Honduras
June 1st, 1921]]

AIM OF THE UNIVERSAL NEGRO IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION

Sir,—

As the avalanche of Negro thought and inspiration sweeps along carrying in its pathway all that fail to recognize its colossal ideals, I have been noticing the many pros and cons appearing in the columns of your daily paper in support of and contrary to the Universal Negro Improvement Association. The main issue of these discords is the lack in knowledge of the fact that those Negroes who as yet fail to realize that this is a new era and people everywhere are awakening to the greatest potentialities of evolution. Never in the annals of mundane affairs do we learn of a people existing throughout their lives like a whirlpool. Hence if we believe in the principles of evolution, then the Negroes

of every clime and in the varied walks of life should accept the truth. Truth is, indeed a stubborn factor in the cause of righteousness.

But particularly do I notice an article appearing in your issue of May 4th signed "Old Jamaica," in which your correspondent states you generally publish both sides of any question and asked you to publish certain statement of Dr. W. E. B. DuBois in support of his ideas: now Mr. Editor to view the other side of the picture whereby we can exchange courtesies, I am also asking that you publish enclosed clipping from the "Negro World" of the 7th May¹ sent you by a "New Negro"² as I believe it will also interest many in your island who might not have been privileged to feast upon some of the most brilliant literature given to Negroes by our talented Prof. Wm. H. Ferris.³ I am, etc.,

D. ERASTUS THORPE

EDITORIAL NOTE:

Space will not allow us to print the clipping but anybody who wants to read it may do so at the Gleaner office.

Printed in *DG*, 7 July 1921.

1. This article summarizes Professor William H. Ferris's speeches in Toronto, Canada, on 17 and 18 April 1921. Ferris's 17 April speech, "The Possibilities of the UNIA," describes how he met Garvey and explains that he saw possibilities in Garvey's plans to develop industrial and agricultural resources in Liberia. "The Negro's Contribution to Civilization" is the subject of the 18 April speech (*NW*, 7 May 1921).

2. The letter was signed "Old Jamaica" and contained the following extract from an editorial, entitled "The Drive," in the May 1921 issue of the *Crisis*: "Into the field have jumped a hoard of scoundrels and bubble blowers, ready to conquer Africa, join the Russian Revolution and vote in the Kingdom of God to-morrow. It is without doubt certain that Africa will some day belong to the Africans; that steamship lines and grocery stores, properly organized and run, are excellent civilizers; and that we are to-day in desperate need of organized industry and organized righteousness. But what are the practical steps to these things? By yelling? By pouring out invective and vituperation against all white folk? By collecting the pennies of the ignorant poor in shovelfuls and refusing to account for them, save with bombast and lies?" ("Dr. Du Bois and the Future of Africa," *DG*, 20 May 1921; Brian Johnson, *Du Bois on Reform: Periodical-Based Leadership for African Americans* [Lanham, Md.: AltaMira, 2005], 226-227).

3. William Henry Ferris (1873-1941) was the assistant president general of the UNIA as well as associate editor of the *Negro World*. After attending Yale Graduate School, 1895-1897 (M.A., 1899), Harvard Divinity School 1889-1899, and Harvard Graduate School, 1899-1900 (M.A., 1900), he worked briefly as a correspondent for both the *Boston Guardian* and the *Colored American* from 1902 to 1903. He began lecturing on African history in 1905 and traveled extensively in the United States and Canada gathering material for his book, *The African Abroad; or, His Evolution in Western Civilization: Tracing His Development under Caucasian Milieus* (New Haven, Conn.: Tuttle, Morehouse and Taylor, 1913). Ferris "first heard of Marcus Garvey in November, 1913," as the result of Garvey's article in the *African Times and Orient Review*. "I heard no more of Garvey until the summer of 1914, when he wrote to me that he had organized the Universal Negro Improvement Association and desired to arrange for me a West Indian lecture tour under the auspices of the association," he reported, "but the World War blocked his plans" (*Philadelphia Tribune*, 27 June 1940). Ferris first met Garvey "in Chicago, Ill., in the late fall of 1916, when I was Associate Editor of the *Champion Magazine*, of which Fenton Johnson was editor, Mr. William M. Kelley, the business manager, and Mr. and Mrs. Jesse Binga, the patrons. Marcus Garvey impressed both Fenton Johnson and myself as being ambitious, wide-awake and energetic, and we published his article in the January number" (ATT, Monroe N. Work Newspaper Clipping Files; William Ferris, "Duse

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Mohamed and Marcus Garvey," n.p., n.d.; Yale University Obituary Record of Graduates Deceased during the Year Ending July 1, 1942, pp. 69-70; *MGP* 1: 75-76 n. 3).

C. H. Calhoun, Chief, Division of
Civil Affairs, Panama Canal Zone,
to the Chief Customs Inspector, Cristobal

Balboa Heights, C.Z.,
June 4, 1921

Sir:

Information has been received from the American Consul at Kingston, Jamaica, to the effect that the American steamship KANAWHA, of the Black Star Line, cleared from that port for Cristobal Saturday afternoon last, and that Marcus Garvey, negro agitator, is a member of the crew, having been signed on as Purser at \$50.00 a month on May 16, 1921, at Santiago de Cuba.

Consuls have been instructed to refuse visa for the return of this man to the United States, and also to refuse visa to the crew list on which he may appear as a seaman.

The Governor has directed that the KANAWHA shall not be cleared for a United States port with Garvey aboard. Will you please be governed accordingly, and if Garvey is on board the vessel either as a member of the crew or passenger, when clearance is requested you may inform the Master that clearance will not be granted in the circumstances. There is no objection to clearing this vessel for a United States port if Garvey is not aboard. Respectfully,

C. H. CALHOUN
Chief, Division of Civil Affairs

DNA, RG 185, C/61-H-3/B. TL, copy. Marked "~~Confidential~~."

Article in the *Workman*

[Panama City, 4 June 1921]

ANOTHER BLACK STAR LINE SHIP

ARRIVES AT JAMAICA WITH U.N.I.A. OFFICERS

MR. GARVEY AND MISS VINTON DAVIS SPEAK
AT WARD THEATRE

The Jamaica *Gleaner* of the 18th May states the Mr. Marcus Garvey[,] President of the Black Star Line, and U.N.I.A., Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis, International Organizer of the Association, and other officials of the Black Star Line, arrived here last night from Santiago de Cuba on the S.S. *Kanawha*, the second ship of the line to arrive here.

The vessel has been long expected, but her delay was in Cuba. She arrived at Port Royal about 4 p.m. yesterday and anchored in the stream off Kingston last night a little after eight o'clock.

The same paper in its issue of the 21st ulto states that another large audience listened to addresses delivered by leaders of the Universal Negro Improvement Association in the Ward Theatre on Thursday night. Mr. and Mrs. George McCormack were at their best in the songs they rendered. They delighted the gathering to a great extent and received every mark of appreciation.

Mr. Sydney deBourg [de Bourg], the leader of the movement in the West Indies, said they were not in the island to set the country against itself or to fight the Government but it was his duty as a leader to take an uncompromising stand with no apology whenever the interest of his people was at stake. The business before them was the redemption of Africa. He then showed how Africa was divided up among the European nations and how Africa had been exploited of her vast wealth. He asked why was this unrest and uneasiness on the part of Governments? Why must not the *Negro World* newspaper be read? It was because the Negro wanted to go back to Africa, it was because he wanted to be repatriated back to the Motherland. That was why the Negroes wanted ships and this their only chance, their last opportunity. Therefore, they must buy shares in the Black Star Line. There was no limit to their profit by buying shares in the Negro Factories Corporation, where girls earning two dollars per week now would be able to earn eighteen dollars per week, and young men twenty-five, thirty, forty, fifty dollars per week. Like himself they must possess the new spirit and prepare for a better future.

MISS DAVIS' REMARKS

Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis, the International Organizer and High Commissioner of the Association, followed. She again expressed her pleasure to be present. She was glad to see so many women present; she was delighted that

the women of Jamaica were taking an active part and showing a deep interest in this greatest of all Negro organizations. Women had their part to play as well as men: that women played a most important part no one would deny. She was asking the women to stand by the colours, to stand by the principles of the U.N.I.A.[,] to stand by the great corporation of the Black Star Line and never to rest until they had hundreds of Negro ships sailing upon the seven seas of the world. She was asking women also to help in the two million dollars Liberian construction loan, which means not only the opening of the door to liberty of the race that had been so long closed, for the Negro was determined that he was going to unbar that door and enter into freedom. And with the influence of the woman, the mother, the wife, the sister, not only in the home, but in the markets of the world and in the great factories also, side by side with man not merely sharing his joys but his sorrows, and influencing him to press onward and go forward, never to stop or rest until his feet had trod the very mountain top[,] until he had unfurled the flag of the red, the black and the green that would wave over the freed and redeemed Africa.

She bade them be of good cheer and still continue and hope and work, to press onward, to lead the children on in this great phalanx of the world that was preaching measure for measure, keeping time with the music of the new Negro, not the old time cringing, sycophant of a Negro, not the old time begging praying and pleading Negro but the Negro who stood upright, demanding his rights and backing that demand up with his gun. They had had false ideas held up to them and false ideas taught to them, but thank God! the scales had fallen from their eyes and the Negro now saw more clearly. That great European War that shook the world, wakened the Negro and little did the white man think that the Negro was only sleeping. But they had awakened in their might and unless given their right, that temple of civilization which they had helped to build would fall and the Negro would step out in the broad sunlight of God's humanity and say "I am a free man, emancipated at last by the hand of a black man who led us out of darkness into the light, out of barbarism into civilization, the grandest and greatest civilization the world has ever seen!"

MR. MARCUS GARVEY

Mr. Marcus Garvey, the President General of the Association next rose to speak. He again put forward the aims and objects of the U.N.I.A. for the future. In the course of his speech, he said he hated hypocrisy, and Negroes had been lied to by those reverend hypocritical vagabonds who told them that their one desire and purpose was to lift humanity and save human souls[.] Those Baptists preachers and Wesleyan Methodist preachers and Presbyterian preachers (he was speaking to white men now) for 500 years had been going to Africa saying they were missionaries. But they were liars, they were religious vagabonds, for they went for the purpose of robbing Africa. He tried to show the inequality of the black and white race and asked if any big and influential white man in his sober senses, living in a beautiful home having a cultured family was

going to reach down to a black man in the gutter, dirty, naked, untutored, unlettered and invite that black home and entertain him with his wife and family and sleep with him in the same bed?

The Rev. Ernest Price¹ who was in the audience rose to say something and some one in the audience interrupted.

Mr. Garvey called for order and asked that Mr. Price be allowed to speak. He had said so many things against Mr. Price that it was only just and fair that Mr. Price should be allowed to explain himself and that they should hear him in a quiet and orderly manner.

Mr. Price said that he would allow what Mr. Garvey had described to be done in his house.

Mr. Garvey said "The Reverend Mr. Price is a new discovery." (laughter and cheers). But he had become so doubtful being human, to believe any man and he had known so comparatively little of the Rev. Mr. Price. He could not believe because he had had bitter experience.

HE HAD TRUSTED MEN OF EVERY RACE

and those men had changed. Men had changed from good Christians and had become lynchers who would string up human beings and burn them at the stake. He had seen Christians join a mob of thousands seizing one Negro, stringing him by the neck, hoist him to a tree and pierced him with bullets on every side and he would see these good Christians cut the rope and build a fire and roast that dead human body and he would see the Christian Ministers and Christian people who go to Church every Sunday, pick out the toe and finger nails of the charred Negro as souvenirs in memory of the beautiful holiday that they had burned a Negro because he was black and because of that, and because he knew this spirit still existed all over the world, he refused to believe that any man was good until a true brotherhood was established by the equal standard of all races. They would say he had described the mob spirit of America, it was true this problem was only in America, but if they transported all the black people in America to England or any other white country, the same brutal lynching and burning would take place.

He urged upon the Negroes of Jamaica to unite and support the U.N.I.A. for their own advancement, and that they would be able to take part in the new era just dawning for the race.

The singing of the National Anthem brought the meeting to close.

Printed in the *Workman* (Panama City), 4 June 1921.

1. Known as "Mr. President" of the Baptist church in Jamaica, Rev. Price was for many years the senior local representative in Jamaica of the Baptist Missionary Society in England. He was also the founder of Calabar High School, one of Jamaica's leading secondary schools, and its headmaster for twenty-five years. He was appointed chairman of the Jamaica Baptist Union in 1924 ("Rev. Ernest Price: Friend of Man," *Star*, 9 November 1965; C. G. Webb-Harris, "Tribute to Rev. Ernest Price," *Sunday Gleaner*, 7 November 1965).

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W. Cooper, Secretary, UNIA
St. Thomas Division, to the *Negro World*

[[St. Thomas, V.I., June 5, 1921]]

THE U.N.I.A. IN THE VIRGIN ISLANDS TAKING ON NEW LIFE

Dear Sir:—

It is with joy I sit to pen you these lines, informing you of the election of a reporter for the St. Thomas Division No. 84. From time to time the people have been speaking of the luke-warmness of our Division in comparison with the other Divisions. All of the other Divisions could send and have news inserted, they said, and they could not see why we should not do likewise. The reporter is Mr. Joseph A. Morrill. He will send to you for insertion in your valued columns all transactions in our Division. He is a man of long experience and one who will stand up for this noble race and work of ours. You will hear from him at the first opportunity.

With greetings from the Division, I beg to remain, Fraternally yours,

W. COOPER

Secretary St. Thomas, V. I.,
Division No. 84

Printed in *NW*, 25 June 1921.

W. L. Hurley, Office of the Under Secretary,
U.S. Department of State, to J. Edgar Hoover,¹
Special Assistant to the U.S. Attorney General

WASHINGTON June 7, 1921

Dear Mr. Hoover:

I enclose herewith a copy of despatch No. 2995, from the American Legation at Panama, relative to MARCUS GARVEY, who recently made a visit to the Isthmus of Panama in behalf of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and the Black Star Line of New York.

This is for your information and as being of possible interest. Very truly yours,

W. L. HURLEY

DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/16. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Confidential." On Department of State letterhead.

1. John Edgar Hoover (1895–1972) served as the first director of the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI), U. S. Department of Justice, from 1924 to 1972.

Enclosure: William Jennings Price, U.S. Minister,
Panama, to Charles Evans Hughes,¹
U.S. Secretary of State

Panama, R.P., May 18, 1921

Sir:

I have the honor to report that Marcus Garvey, a British subject, native of Jamaica, President of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and also President of the Black Star Line of New York, has recently made a visit to the Isthmus of Panama in behalf of both of these organizations and has been very active in attempting to promote them. He arrived at Colon on April 26, on the launch "Linda S" from Port Limon, Costa Rica, via Bocas del Toro. He sailed for Kingston, Jamaica, on May 5, on United Fruit Company Steamer "Carrillo." He addressed at least thirteen meetings during his stay here, charging an admittance fee of \$1.00 for adults and \$.50 for children. It is estimated by the Chief of the Canal Zone Police and Detective Division that in admittance fees to his meetings and proceeds from the sale of stock, Garvey collected between \$5,000 and \$6,000 while here. The Chief of this Division, however, tells me that he does not consider this an indication of any //considerable// progress made by Garvey in his schemes on the Isthmus of Panama, because //of// the number of West Indian negroes living here. There are still employed by the Panama Canal about 15,000 West Indian negroes. It is not known just how many in addition to these are residents of the cities of Panama and Colon, but they constitute quite a considerable number.

I have the honor to enclose (enclosure No. 1), a copy of a confidential memorandum from Captain Guy Johannes, Chief of the Division mentioned, stating that the opinion of his office has been confirmed by others, to the effect that the propaganda of Garvey was effective only among a small proportion of the negro population on the Isthmus and that his following is due more to curiosity than to any real conversion to his schemes. It seems to be the belief here that Garvey is really not the leading spirit in these things but that he is being used by other negroes who are more intelligent and more forceful.

Charles L. Latham, Esq., American Consul at Kingston, Jamaica, addressed the American Consulate General in this city, under date of April 7, advising that Garvey was likely to proceed from Jamaica to some nearby city of a Central American country before attempting to return to the United States and that the Department had instructed to refuse a vis[é] of his passport in view of his activities in political and racial agitation. No attempt is known of on the part of Garvey to get a vis[é] here for the United States before his sailing for Jamaica.

I have honor to enclose (enclosure No. 2), another memorandum from Captain Johannes telling of the last series of his meetings. There are also enclosed, (enclosures No. 3, 4, 5, 6 and 7), clippings from the "Star & Herald,"

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giving the texts of certain of his addresses, which are fair examples of all of them, and giving reports of different ones of the meetings conducted by him. I have the honor to be, Sir, Your obedient servant,

WM JENNINGS PRICE
American Minister

[*Typed note:*] Enclosures:

Enclosure No. 1: Memorandum from Capt. Johannes May 18.

" No. 2: " " May 11.

" Nos. 3, 4, 5, 6 & 7: Clippings from the "Star and Herald," April 28, April 30, April 30, May 6 and May 6 respectively.²

DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/16. TLS, recipient's copy.

1. Charles Evans Hughes (1862–1948) was secretary of state from 1921 to 1925, during the Warren G. Harding administration and for part of Calvin Coolidge's first presidential term. He had earlier been the governor of New York from 1907 to 1910 and an associate justice of the U.S. Supreme Court from 1910 to 1916. He was a candidate for president of the United States in 1916 but lost the election to Woodrow Wilson. After serving on international tribunals in the late 1920s, he was appointed chief justice of the U.S. Supreme Court and served in that capacity until his retirement in 1941. Hughes's jurisprudence in this role consisted of an elaboration of his support of civil rights and civil liberties; a strong affirmation of his New Liberal outlook on regulatory issues; and initial resistance to New Deal nationalism and corporatism before 1937, when he reluctantly and partially accepted welfare state liberalism.

As secretary of state, Hughes was not prepared to use the Monroe Doctrine to justify intervention by the United States in the domestic affairs of other American countries, yet he also did not reject intervention as such. He felt impelled to justify the Caribbean policies of the United States on moral as well as legal and political grounds, and thus he showed harmony of interests between the United States and the influenced states. This broad policy can be seen in the different treatment of American countries. In the Dominican Republic, Hughes curbed the navy dictatorship and announced that the United States was ready to turn over the government to the Dominican people as soon as a responsible government was established. A new Dominican regime was established in July 1924, allowing American marines to be withdrawn by autumn. In Nicaragua, Hughes promised that after the elections of 1924 and the inauguration of the new president, the marines would also be withdrawn there, which they were shortly after the end of Hughes's term. For Haiti, however, Hughes believed departure was still premature. In Mexico, he insisted on the protection of American property rights as a condition for U.S. recognition of the Obrégón government, but he did not use military involvement. Hughes also helped settle disputes between Panama and Costa Rica (1921); among Honduras, Nicaragua, and El Salvador (1922); among Brazil, Colombia, and Peru (1925); and among Peru and Chile (1922–1925).

Hughes was involved in the State Department's monitoring of Garvey's activities in the Caribbean during the UNIA leader's organizing tour of that area in 1921. This included efforts to deny Garvey a visa to reenter the United States.

During his public career, Hughes advocated for civil rights. In *McCabe v. Atchison, Topeka, and Santa Fe Road* (1914), he insisted on equal treatment for railroad passengers, and in *Gaines v. Canada* (1938), he ruled that Missouri admit black students to its law school or provide equal facilities (James A. Henretta, "Charles Evans Hughes and the Strange Death of Liberal America," in *Law and History Review* 24, no. 1 [2006]: 149–150; Dexter Perkins, *Charles Evans Hughes and American Democratic Statesmanship* [Boston: Little, Brown, 1956], pp. 128–140; Betty Glad, *Charles Evans Hughes and the Illusions of Innocence: A Study in American Diplomacy* [Urbana, Illinois: University of Illinois Press, 1966], pp. 240–253; ANB).

2. Enclosure No. 7, not included in this volume, was the clipping of an article with the heading "Negro Moses Gets \$22,000: Marcus Garvey Voted \$12,000 A Year As Provisional President of Africa. Also Voted \$10,000 As Universal Head." It was dated "NEW YORK, April 23."

Enclosure: Confidential Memorandum
by Captain Guy Johannes, Chief,
Panama Canal Zone Police and Fire Division

Balboa Heights, May 18, 1921

Subject: Marcus Garvey

With a view to determining the effect of the subject's recent visit to the Isthmus, 12 prominent citizens in the cities of Panama and Colon were interviewed and they confirm the opinion of this office that the subject's prop[a]ganda was effective only among a small proportion of the negro population on the Isthmus.

The opinion also is confirmed that his following is due more to curiosity concerning him, than to any real conversion to his schemes.

GUY JOHANNES

Chief, Police and [F]ire Division

DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/16. TL, copy. Marked "Confidential Memorandum #899."

Enclosure: Confidential Memorandum by
Captain Guy Johannes, Chief,
Panama Canal Zone Police and Fire Division

[*Balboa Heights, 11 May 1921*]

Subject: Marcus Garvey

The eighth meeting held by subject on the Isthmus took place at the Bull Ring, Panama City, at 3[:]:00 p.m. May 1, 1921. There were approximately 750 persons present. A lengthy detailed report of this meeting is on file in this office.

The ninth meeting held by subject on the Isthmus took place at the Bull Ring, Panama City, at 7[:]:30 p.m. May 1, 1921. There were approximately 625 persons present. A lengthy detailed report of this meeting is on file in this office.

The tenth meeting held by the subject on the Isthmus took place at the Variadades Theater, Panama City, 7[:]:30 p.m. May 2, 1921. There were approximately 750 persons present. A lengthy report of this meeting is on file in this office.

The eleventh meeting held by subject on the Isthmus took place in the Schoolhouse in Guachapali, Panama City, 3[:]:00 p.m. May 3, 1921. Approximately 250 persons were present. This meeting was for members only and no report of it was available.

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The twelfth meeting held by subject on the Isthmus took place in the Schoolhouse at the corner of "J" Street and Ancon Avenue, Panama City, at 7:30 p.m. May 3, 1921. Approximately 150 persons were present. This meeting was for members only and no report of it was available.

Subject left Panama City on the first train on May 4, 1921, for Colon. He sailed for Kingston, Jamaica at 11:30 a.m. May 5, 1921, on United Fruit Line ss "Carrillo."

On the evening of May 4, 1921, a farewell rally was held for Garvey at the UNIA hall, 8th Street and Hudson Lane, Colon, at 8:20 p.m. at which approximately 500 persons were present.

While in Panama City, Garvey and party stopped at the Casino boarding house near the Bull Ring.

At each of the meetings, an admission of \$1.00 was charged for adults and \$.50 for children.

GUY JOHANNES
Chief, Police & Fire Division

DNA, RG 59, 800.108G191/16. TD. Marked "Confidential Memorandum #898."

*Enclosure: Article in
the Panama Star and Herald*

[Panama, 28 April 1921]

MARCUS GARVEY GETS WARM RECEPTION ON
HIS ARRIVAL AT COLON

CROWDS CHEER PRESIDENT OF UNIVERSAL NEGRO
IMPROVEMENT ASSOCIATION WHEN HE GIVES
SHORT ADDRESS FROM BALCONY

Arriving on the Linda S from Bocas del Toro last Tuesday evening, Mr. Marcus Garvey with Mr. and Miss Jacques, stenographer and private secretary respectively, was greeted with tremendous cheers as he stepped on Pier 2.

The news of Garvey's arrival spread like wild fire, and people could be seen running from all directions to see and welcome him.

Accompanied by officers of the Colon division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, he motored to the residence of Dr. Hamlet amidst loud cheers. By this time the crowd had increased considerably. After having been introduced to a few of the members of the association he stepped to the balcony, where in a clear and distinct voice he gave a short address, stating that he would not be speaking that night, but on the following evening at 3.30 and 7.30 he would be at Liberty Hall where he would be able to explain fully to

them the workings of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and the Black Star Line Corporation. He was heartily cheered by the crowd.

He granted an audience to the reporter, but stated that on account of his sea-legs and his tired feelings he was unable to furnish any information at that time.

Printed in *PS&H*, 28 April 1921. In DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/16. PD.

*Enclosure: Article in
the Panama Star and Herald*

[Panama, 30 April 1921]

MARCUS GARVEY ADDRESSES BIG CROWD
AT LIBERTY HALL, COLON

In the presence of a very large gathering, Mr. Marcus Garvey, the President-General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and President of the Black Star Line Corporation, gave an address last Wednesday night at Liberty Hall, Colon.

After prayer by the chaplain, followed by addresses by a few of the members of the association and other items including two anthems by the Colon Choral Union, President Brooks called upon Mr. Garvey who addressed the audience for one hour and twenty minutes. He said, in part:

Mr. President, Officers, Members of the Colon Division U.N.I.A. and Friends: I am indeed pleased to be in your midst this evening. I came here from the United States of America to speak to you about the aims of the U.N.I.A. and the Black Star Corporation and as you may know, the U.N.I.A. is a world wide movement. We are in this association to unite 400,000,000 people, not for the purpose of building up a new religious cult, but we desire to unite, to link up 400,000,00 people to form an independent state in Africa. I am not a preacher so you will not expect a sermon from me, nor will you expect a political speech from me. You will expect from me what is called now-a-days a radical speech. In the country where I came from and in all parts of the world they call me a radical. I like it. Though I am a Christian I will not say "leave everything to God." The old negro when you kick him he will say I leave you to God. I am one of those negroes who will strike you and we will go to it. I am here to speak to the old as well as the new negro. I believe some work must be done. The work that I am engaged in now is a difficult one, and pray for me while I do the job. The job I am engaged in is the building up of a nation, the building up of a government, and an empire second to none. God made you with two hands and two feet and so you must utilise them. The U.N.I.A. is just four years old as an association in the U.[S].A. We started out with fourteen members four

years ago and now we have 700 branches—Colon forms one of those branches. You will find branches in every part of Africa, the West Indies and Central America. It is only a question of time when the sons of Africa will share in the ordeals and rally on the battle plains of Africa. At the outbreak of the great world's war, [black] men were turned down from enlistment, but as soon as the Germans started to chase their opponents over the fields of France and Flanders they were accepted; and had it not been for the 2,000,000 black supermen who drove them across the Rhine, the Kaiser would now be drinking pea soup in Mesopotamia. In the past they made us British, French and everything else but today we will make ourselves Africans. I am not against being loyal to somebody, but I must first be loyal to myself. God Almighty made us all to be lords of the earth, he did not make some to be paupers and cringing beggars. All should have a grip on the world, if the white and yellow men have made the best of it, we should also make the best of it. They have built great nations and governments in Europe and Asia, what have we done? We should now start to build up Africa. "Better late than never." I believe that the black man should not rule the white man; the black man rule the black, and the white, the white. I have no objection of being a citizen of any country, but this is my term; if I am a citizen of Great Britain or France, I believe in the 50-50 proposition. If I want you to nominate me for mayor for one of the counties of London, or premier of England, what right has any man to limit my opportunities and ambitions. If it is my ambition to be president of the Republic let me be president. If I am destined to be a stat[es]man or shoe-shine let me be. Do you think any man could look into my face and tell me that he is my master? He would have to tell me after 5 rounds. I mean to appeal to the manhood of the race. There are two classes of negroes—the old class and the new. In the United States we buried the old class in 1914 and I have now come to bury it in Colon. Some of you may think me too radical. Negroes should be the last to speak about radicalism.

Last year August we called a convention. We assembled in New York City to discuss the problems of the negro race. During the 31 days we wrote a constitution of our own to produce new spirit in negroes everywhere. As the American negro will die for his constitution, we call upon the 400,000,000 negroes to die in defense of the constitution of the Red, the Black and the Green. We are going to build up a government in Africa that will protect us. Like Tipperary, it's a long way to go,¹ but we will get there.

I believe that other people have the right to have battleships and dreadnoughts and I believe we should have the same. You live in a practical and material world, our purpose is to organize negroes everywhere; the future of our race depends on it.

I must thank you people of Colon and Panama for the general support to this cause. I thank you for the sacrifice you have made. I expect in a couple of months, negroes will rush to Liberia, Africa, as they did to Central America.

The shares of the Black Star Line will close in the next 12 months, at which time we will be ready to commence paying dividends. In representing this cause our aim is not to stir strife, but the cause is one of self-love. Two months ago we sent men to Liberia to make the place sanitary. The Phillis Wheatley will sail out of New York next month with 300 mechanics, masons, bricklayers and other tradesmen. I am now raising a loan of \$2,000,000 to build up Liberia. The money loaned in this connection will bear interest at 5 per cent per annum. I trust in the people to support and carry on this work. I thank you.

Printed in *PS&H*, 30 April 1921. In DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/16. PD.

1. A reference to the World War I-era music hall song "It's a Long Way to Tipperary," written by Englishmen Harry Williams and Jack Judge (Judge's parents were Irish, and his grandparents came from Tipperary). Allegedly written in 1912, the song became widely popular among British soldiers as a marching song during the war (Max Cryer, *Love Me Tender: The Stories behind the World's Best-Loved Songs* [London: Frances Lincoln, 2009]).

Enclosure: Article in the Panama Star and Herald

[[Bocas del Toro, April 26, 1921]]

MARCUS GARVEY IN BOCAS DEL TORO

Marcus Garvey reached this town from Port Limon, Costa Rica, aboard the U.F. Co's freight launch Tony at 2.47 p.m. Thursday, 21st inst. The only persons present when the gasoline craft drew alongside the pier were the Star and Herald correspondent, the custom house men and a few boys. Seated on the port side of the launch Garvey did not so much as look around to see the appearance of the strange place to which he had come. Shortly after T. H. Saunders [Saunders], local organizer of the U.N.I.A. got there and saluted his big boss. The passenger then began to enquire of his subordinate on the pier regarding the U.F. Co's operations—when bananas are cut, ships loaded, laborers paid etc., and was about to debark when Mr. Saunders informed him that coming from Port Limon, a foreign place, the launch had to be cleared first. About a quarter of an hour later Dr. C. Alfred Vaz for the Quarantine officer, O.K'd the vessel and the Customs officer gave the order for the passengers to land.

By this time about 200 persons had gathered to see the man. With Mr. Garvey, who travelled as a merchant, were Cleveland Jacques and Amy Jacques. The reputed chief of two million negroes on coming up out of the launch did not so much as lift his eyes to glance at the people, who were for the most part members of the U.N.I.A., but went straight to the spot where his baggage was being searched. This done he walked the entire length of the building in the

same manner to the door where he took a bus, and with his travelling lady companion and Mr. Saunders drove off.

Three blocks away Garvey was met by a procession of members of the U.N.I.A. who were marching to receive him, but he paid no attention to them and kept on.

On the 20th inst. fly sheets, signed T. H. Saunders and Felix A. Russell, were issued advertising a reception in San Miguel hall, Sixth Street, on the night of the arrival of "His Excellency the Hon. Marcus Garvey," and fifty cents gold was the published price of admission. When at 7.30 o'clock the people began to assemble it was found that Garvey had increased the figure to \$1.00. This caused several sharp passages of arms between door woman Jacques and those who tried to gain entrance. Miss Jacques was rather abrupt and abusive in speech and the public in return daubed on some very nasty expressions. That state of affairs continued until 8.30 o'clock when Mr. Saunders informed the 40 or 50 persons inside that Mr. Garvey had sent to tell them that he could not speak for less than \$1, and that the meeting for the night was called off. About 500 persons were out-doors and a large number went off to 32 North Avenue where Garvey was staying to get an explanation for this behavior. The reputed "leader" of two million negroes would not at first heed the crowd; but about thirty minutes later appeared on the verandah and showered out a vitr[i]olic dressdown. In the course of his utterances he termed the people before him "illiterate negroes," said that they had come with their "freshness" to disturb him. "That's why you are where you are," shouted the man, "and you will remain there." Garvey's excommunication was followed by cries of "Away with you!" "You have struck the last nail in your coffin!" "Down with Garvey!"

Yielding to strong pressure by Dr. G. W. A. Forrester, then a nine days old member of the U.N.I.A., and A. N. Willis, both of whom had travelled forty miles from Guabito, Sixaola, to see him, Mr. Garvey appeared on the San Miguel hall platform at ten o'clock "to give an explanation."

He talked a little over five minutes, rating off all the blame for the uproar of that night on the local secretary of the Association, Felix A. Russell, who, he said, had advertised a lower price of admission than he (Garvey) had ordered from New York three months ago.

The reception came off Friday night, 22nd inst., and was a free entrance affair. It consisted of a musical program and welcome address. Mr. Saunders was chairman and the large building was packed, while scores stood outside. The address was read by Miss Vera Lynch and handed by her to Mr. Garvey, who took it sitting.

Three fine selections were rendered, among them a solo by Mr. Russell. The chairman then introduced the visitor as "Provisional President of Africa." Garvey when he rose, did not reply to the address. His speech followed the same stereotyped line as the literature published from time to time in the Negro World and was devoid of any new matter. Intelligent men and women who heard him regard Garvey's talk more as a vaudeville performance than sober

enunciations. It catered directly to the class whom on the preceding night Garvey himself termed illiterate, and did not contain a single leading thought as to the possibility of the realization of his African scheme. Neither did the leader say anything regarding the progress and profit of the Black Star Line Steamship Corporation.

It was noticeable that in the course of his speech Garvey never once coupled the words, "African Communities League," when speaking of the U.N.I.A., nor referred to himself as "Provisional President of Africa."

The meeting opened with an anthem, "Ethiopia" and closed with the first verse of the hymn, "Onward Christian Soldiers."

Saturday morning Garvey and a party of his followers left on launch for Almirante, and thence by train to Guabito. He returned to town Sunday night and sailed for Colon yesterday at 2 p.m. on the auxiliary schooner Linda S. His last speech was at the local Liberty Hall at 1 p.m. A number of his members with flags followed him to the vessel.

Garvey's curt and uncouth behavior earned for him the depreciation of Afro-Panamanians, West Indians, Government officials, and the white people.

It is said that on going aboard a gentleman said to Garvey, "Goodbye Jesus, it is the first time I have seen one of your kind come this way."

The report of his visit to the lines is not yet forthcoming.

Printed in *PS&H*, 30 April 1921. In DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/16. PD.

Enclosure: Article in the Panama Star and Herald

[Panama, 6 May 1921]

GARVEY DELIVERS FAREWELL ADDRESS AT LIBERTY HALL, COLON

As on previous occasions, Liberty Hall, Colon, was packed to its utmost seating capacity last Wednesday night to hear Mr. Marcus Garvey's farewell address.

After sing[ing] of the Hymn "From Greenland's Icy Mountains," prayer by the chaplain, recitations, an address by Mr. C. A. Reid, third vice-president, and the presentation of a flag and banner with the inscription "God Save Marcus Garvey and the U.N.I.A." from Mr. Augustine, the President introduced the speaker for the evening. He said:

Mr. President officers and members of the U.N.I.A. and fellow citizens, I am here tonight to say goodbye and at the same time to say a few words of encouragement to you, who live in this part of the world. I have been here for a few days; I have had the occasion to study the lives of the people in Colon economically, socially and politically, and in going away I shall take the impressions

of my study. Politically, I find that you are drifters, drifting to the land of nowhere. Because I am interested I desire to see the good ship strike a port. I am endeavoring to point you to a haven of peace and safety—to the Haven of Africa. My stay in Panama has given me a fuller knowledge of the conditions of my people. I realize that most of you are from different colonies. You came here during the construction of the Panama Canal: you have labored [*word illegible*], honestly and long for the perfection of this great engineering work. The work is done, the need for helpers are few; you made no preparations during the days of plenty and are now embarrassed economically. It grieves me, pains me to view the economic conditions that affect the race. The future without any preparation of the present seem dark and gloomy, but while we labored in the Canal for several years without plans or objectives individually, we are glad to realize now that we have an organization seeing and realizing the danger of living without preparation. The leaders of the Universal Negro Improvement Association years ago saw the present conditions of economic starvation and it is for that reason why the association started. No man can live without work. In six or twelve months you will have to find new fields of labor. What preparations have you made? You have treated your economic life with scant indifference. It pains me to see human suffering and it is for that cause why I fight for the Universal Negro Improvement Association. Seeing the conditions during my few days in Panama it has given me an impetus to fight for the ultimate salvation of Africa. As a movement we are sufficiently strong to demand respect in this economic world. We will meet with success as far as negroes will support the Program of Freedom of Africa. As quickly as we can get our ships of the Black Star Line Corporation to Liberia, there will be work enough in Africa, to fell trees, clear the wilderness and build cities. We want all the mechanics, carpenters, bricklayers, police, engineers, judges, lawyers, doctors, dentists and ministers too, and why have all these people idle in Colon?

I want to say a word of warning. I know that you have enemies on the outside. These enemies are learned, they belong to the professional classes and these are the people who believe they are big; and you are persuaded sometimes to follow them. Human nature is of this kind. The man who has everything he wants is satisfied, and the man who hasn't is dissatisfied. The satisfied class does not want any reform because it would mean that they would have to yield a part of what they have, so they endeavor to blindfold the other class.

There is a system of organization among the laboring classes. In other races there are trade unions and organizations which privileges negroes have never had. What's the use of a successful lawyer and merchant if he has nothing for the race? If I am wealthy and believe that I am better than you are, then let me keep to myself—stick to yourself and keep to yourself.

When we started we appealed to no one class of negroes, we appealed to all classes and our appeal was heard only by the poorer classes. The rich negroes deafened their ears to the call. If you had sufficient sense to start you will have sufficient to follow. John D. Rockefeller, Andrew Carnegie, J. Schwab and

Julius Rosenwald and hundreds of other millionaires, what do they do with their millions? Put it in the bank? Lock up in their homes? No! They are forced by public sentiment to invest it so that thousands may be employed. Do this or get out of the way.

When you are in the better class you have to give something to the poorer classes. The better class of negroes must seek to provide for the class who cannot provide for themselves.

In going away from here I shall take home to the parent body the splendid spirit displayed at Bocas del Toro, Port Limon, Panama and Colon. Panama has lived true to her traditions to the Universal Negro Improvement Association. I have to thank the administration of the government of the association in Colon. In leaving you and bidding you good bye with hopes of the future work which is growing with great rapidity, let us continue in the same spirit; let us hold fast to the principles of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, and in so doing we will attract millions of the other races to come and see one of the most notable Empires of Africa.

Our convention will take place in August of this year, and I will be leaving in September or October for Liberia to work out plans for the betterment of my people.

Much has been said about the dollar that has been charged admission. Some one suggests that a collection should be taken instead, but I know you negroes full well. I have never been a beggar in all my life. I don't like to beg for myself, how much more to beg somebody something for themselves. The dollar you pay goes to the general fund to advance the work.

I thank you for the courtesy displayed to me and my party. Take it from me that I go away with the best feelings of the support you have given me and best respect for the Panama Government.

Printed in *PS&H*, 6 May 1921. In DNA, RG 59, 811.108G191/16. PD.

Wilfred Collet, Governor, British Guiana,
to Winston S. Churchill, Secretary of State,
Colonial Office

GOVERNMENT HOUSE,
Georgetown, Demerara,
7th June, 1921

Sir,

Information has reached this Colony that Marcus Garvey, the leader of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, is now in Jamaica in one of his "Black Star" line boats; and it is announced that he intends to come on here in

this ship, partly to show her off, partly to collect subscriptions here, and partly in the interest of negro propaganda.

2. It is the intention of local merchants to take up soon the question of reduction of wharf-labourers' wages,¹ and I fear that if Marcus Garvey arrives here at such a time he may stir up a lot of trouble. In this connexion, I may state that my Government has been informed by the Administration of Trinidad that the Reverend Richard Hilton Tobitt, a representative of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and one of Marcus Garvey's colleagues, who is at present in this Colony, will not be allowed to land in Trinidad. Tobitt is, I am told, a native of Antigua and a British subject. Garvey is a Jamaican by birth and also a British subject, and, although the Government of Trinidad are taking steps to prevent Tobitt from landing in that Island, I am not sure that it is expedient, or whether I have the power to prevent Garvey from coming here. I shall be glad, therefore, to be instructed as to whether I have the power to do so should it appear expedient, or whether, if he were allowed to come here, he should be deported if he gave any trouble. In the latter case I presume he should be sent back to Jamaica, his native land. In this connexion I would draw your attention to the attached extract from the *Daily Argosy* of the 21st May² from which it will be observed that there is a possibility of Garvey's being prevented from returning to the United States of America. I also attach, for your information, extracts from the *Tribune* of the 15th and 22nd May which reproduced from the Jamaica *Daily Gleaner*³ an account of a Meeting held in that Island by Garvey.

3. As regards Tobitt, I may say that he arrived by the C.M.S. "Caraquet" on the 16th May as a first class passenger from Bermuda and was permitted to land in the Colony. He is holding meetings under the auspices of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, supported by the British Guiana Labour Union, and is inviting subscriptions towards the "Black Star" line of steamers. His movements in this Colony are being closely watched by the Police, but I am advised that at present there is no good reason why he should be deported from here. If he gives any trouble I shall, unless you otherwise direct, take steps to deport him to Antigua, of which Island he is a native.

4. I may add that in the meantime I have telegraphed to the Governor of Jamaica for as full information as he can give me concerning Garvey's movements and as to whether he proved to be a danger while in Jamaica. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your most obedient, humble servant,

WILFRED COLLET
Governor

[*Handwritten minutes:*] As regards the Rev.

R. H. Tobitt [Tobitt] see 57747/20.

~~The question~~

? There is no objection to the course
proposed by the Gov. with regard to Garvey

& Tobitt. See also in this connexion 4443/
21.

? ack rec of this desp.

[initials illegible] 20/7/4

See par 2.

Does the O. in C. of 1896 apply to B. Gui[ana]? If not is there any legislative enactment empowering the governor to prevent Garvey from landing or to deport him after arrival?

R[.] A[.] W[.] 22/7/20

The O in C of 1896 was applied to Br. Gui-ana by O in C of 2/8/18 and proclaimed in the Colony 20/9/18. From 53210.20 it would appear that the O in C is still in force.

There is a Destitute & Criminal Immigrants Regulation Ordce. (4/1896⁴ & 5/1906) which might cover the case.

[P. T. J.?] 25/7/21

Will you advise what we should say to the Governor from a legal point of view?

R[.] A[.] W[.] 25/7/21

In my opinion there is no law in force in B.G. under which the Gov: can prevent Garvey from landing. If however Garvey, ~~shd~~ after being allowed to land, sh[oul]d prove dangerous & likely to cause trouble, the Govr may exercise the power conferred by sub.ch. (3) of ch. III of the O in C 1896 & order him to quit the Colony. In the event of the order not being obeyed Garvey may be arrested & put on board ship to be taken to his native land.

The subch. may also be called in aid, if necessary or expedient, in dealing with Tobitt.

A. E. 26/7

(Write saying that the S. of S. is advised as in Mr. E[hrhardt]'s minute so far as the legal question is concerned;) [*in margin*: omit—see my minute below. H. J. R.] so far as the question of policy is concerned, say that the S. of S. is content to leave the matter to the O.A.G.'s discretion & send copies of 28093, 35993, 31208, & the enclos to 28467 & 35993 for inf[ormation] (adding that in the opinion of the S. of S. resort to

deportation is not desirable if it can be avoided.)

Mr. Flood to see pp later.

R[.] A[.] W[.] 27/7/21

Garvey is a very dangerous man & I would not tie the hands of the OAG in dealing with him. Unfortunately he is a native of Jamaica and from that Colony we could not deport him. [*in the margin*: ? The O: in C: of 21 March/16 has also been applied to Jamaica? H. J. R.]

E[.] R[.] D[.] 28/7

I have spoken to Mr Risley who points out that the O: in C: of 21 March/16 was applied to B. Guiana by the O: in C: of 2 Aug/18. Under section 3 of the former, the Govr. can make Reg[ulations] with regard to: "Arrest, detention, exclusion & deportation."

Point this out to the Govr. &, as regards policy, proceed as proposed on previous pages?

H. J. R. 28/VII/21

If Gov. has a Procl[amation] still in force under these orders he can legally use it, & Mr. Risley assures me that there is no means whereby it could be challenged in any Court of Law.

I regard it as essential in these times that these Govrs. sh[oul]d have a defensive weapon to use against firebrands of this kind; but I don't like this machinery. The O. in C[.] was intended "for the security of certain Colonies in times of Emergency," & [t]he O. in C. of 1896 was kept secret till the need—the War—arose. Some time ago we gave Govs. a lead to repeal their Proclamations under it, though we left them discretion as to the time in view of possible then-existing local circ[umstances]. Last Oct. the Gov. replied that he didn't wish to cancel these powers in view of world-unrest & local possibilities.

I am inclined to leave the particular matters to his discretion, as proposed, but to consult him as to the possibility of arming him, by legislation, with stated powers of arrest to, & therein repealing Procl[amation] under the O. in C.

[*initials illegible*] 2.8.21

Mr. Churchill

There are two points—

1. The question raised in last para. above—of substituting regular legis[ation] for Proclamations—as soon as it can be done—on this I agree with Sir G. Fiddes.

2. The //immediate// question of whether we shall authorise the Govr. to prevent the landing of, or deport, Garvey. The legal authority under proclamation to do either seems good: and I should tell local Govr. [that we would?] leave it to their discretion, as sufficient.

S. W. 3/8

TNA: PRO CO 318/364/7164. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Confidential." Stamped "C.O. 34269."

1. The 1921 pay reduction was implemented in the middle of the postwar recession. According to Ashton Chase, merchants in the colony of British Guiana gave notice that, effective 27 June 1921, "the wages for all casual laborers, stevedores and others would be reduced by 20%" (Ashton Chase, *A History of Trade Unionism in Guyana 1900 to 1961* [Georgetown: New Guyana Company, 1964], pp. 62–63).

2. The enclosed clipping from *Daily Argosy*, entitled "Marcus Garvey in the West Indies: May Be Excluded From America," introduced and reprinted a brief article from the *Chicago Whip*, 2 May 1921.

3. "Mr. Garvey in the Ward Theatre," *DG*, 26 March 1921.

4. This refers to Ordinance No. 4 of 1896, which was intended to "restrict the Introduction into this Colony of Destitute Persons likely to become chargeable to the Colony and of Vicious and Criminal Persons" (*Official Gazette [Extraordinary]* 3, no. 29 [Georgetown, 24 March 1896], pp. 591–594).

Military Intelligence Report

Panama, June 7th 1921

SUBJECT Military training among colored inhabitants. (Political factor #85.)
Monograph report.

The visit of Marcus Garvey, and his speeches on the war to come between the white and black races, has resulted in some activity among Jamaicans here. School children between the ages of six and fifteen are now having regular drills with wooden guns. The instructors are ex-members of the British West Indian [Indies] [R]egiment.

The colored Boy Scouts have so far not participated in the drills. I believe the training for war idea is temporary and will end in a few weeks.

Source of information: Personal observation.

DNA, RG 165, 310218-423. TD. Marked "No 162."

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Article in the *Panama Star and Herald*

[Kingston, Jamaica, ca. 14 June 1921]

S.S. KANAWA DISABLED AT SEA AFTER DOING 160 MILES ON WAY TO COLON

THE ASSISTANCE OF POLICE AND AMERICAN CONSUL IS INVOKED
—ENGINES REPAIRED BY INDUSTRIAL WORKS

Since the return of the Black Star Line steamer Kanawha to this port in a somewhat disabled condition, she having failed to make Colon after doing about 160 miles at sea, there has been a report of dissatisfaction among the members of the ship's company and the crew consisting of about 42 men.

While at sea after having undergone repairs further troubles is said to have developed. Water, it is alleged, was short, although Mr. Garvey, the President of the line considered that he had taken an ample supply both of water and of food as well.

Whatever happened, anyway, it was found necessary to put back to this port.

Further repairs of the engine were placed in the hands of the Industrial Works of this city and it was expected that the vessel would be ready for sea again in a day or two.

Yesterday afternoon, however, a new phase of the situation presented itself, when the assistance of the police and the American Consul (the ship being of American register) was invoked with the result that an extra guard of Water policemen were on the scene and precautions taken to cope with any emergency that might have arisen.

Later in the afternoon it transpired that Mr. Marcus Garvey called on the Inspector General of Police for further protection which was promptly rendered. Shortly after acting deputy Inspector General O'Sullivan went on board the Kanawha and investigated the affair. He spoke to the Captain of the vessel and others and advised all and sundry to commit no breach of the peace but to wait and have matters amicably adjusted.

After the acting deputy had left the Lyon's Mark Lane Wharf, where the Kanawha is berthed, it was learnt that a letter was either drafted or sent to Mr. Garvey, whom they signed on as purser last trip, to come aboard this morning in order that the vessel should put out to sea.

Printed in *PS&H*, 14 June 1921.

Suscilla A. Cream, Lady President,
UNIA Colón Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Cristobal, C.Z., June 15, 1921]]

THE NEGRO IS A HUMAN BEING

Dear Sir:

Please allow me space in our valuable paper to express my feelings in the following article. Thanking you in advance, I beg to give thanks to God for our Moses, His Excellency the Provisional President of Africa, the Honorable Marcus Garvey—the man of the hour. No Napoleon, no Washington, no Lincoln, no Julius Caesar, no Oliver Cromwell has proven us such a leader as the Hon. Marcus Garvey. I am proud and very proud that I have had the pleasure of seeing his face, and speaking to him in our Liberty Hall of Colon. Now is the time for every Negro to do his bit. We know that attempts have been made in the past to prove that the Negro was not a human being, but in this age of the world a preposterous idea does not receive countenance. The remarkable progress of the Negro race in spite of malice and prejudice have made this theory so absurd, that today no one can be found to advocate it. Men cannot refuse the fixed decree of omnipotence. Nothing but the power of God can save the Negro from extinction. Four hundred millions of blacks are doomed to extinction, for remember that the other races regard the Negro as a lawful natural slave; but we are cognizant of the fact that God created us of one blood all nations of men to dwell upon the face of the earth. God did not create an inferior race. There are races with inferior conditions, and these may be black and white, but I say that there is no absolute or essential superiority one side or another.

All of us are a unity in the plan of salvation. No man is too inferior to be saved in all the wonderful works of creation. The making of man is God's crowning act of creation, and whoever has this image is an infallible credential of his high origin and sonship. The time has come for Ethiopia to stretch forth her hands and we, her sons and daughters, must cement ourselves together and help to redeem our fatherland. Clapping of hands, flowery speeches, and frivolous talk will not help us; but let us get down to business, put our hands in our pockets and pool our dollars together for the redemption of Africa. We have before us a very broad program, the subject of which is the Universal Negro Improvement Association with the following items: Intellectual, moral, political, industrial and commercial uplift of the Negro peoples of the world.

Let us now forget selfishness and be loyal to this cause. Negroes who have not caught the vision, I am entreating you to buy the Negro World every week and read it carefully. It will help you to become interested in your race. It will help you to have a bright hope for the future. It will help you to become a new Negro. Are we not children of the same God? Are we not all compelled to think whether we wish to or not; when we see the unrest of the people of the world;

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these things create certain serious thoughts in our mind. No man can think as he desires or control the action of his heart. The blood pursues its old accustomed course in spite of us; the eyes see, the ears hear, the brain thinks something. The Negroes have inherited the ability to work through the institution of slavery. No race has improved as wonderfully as the Negro race, though handicapped in all things that tend to their uplift. A boy of the Negro race and one of another start in a store as a porter at the same time. The other boy, though not having the ability of education, will be promoted in a short time to be a clerk and from then on to be a partner. The Negro boy will remain where he has started, kept down as a slave. From this economic slavery let us free ourselves and now is the time. Let us work together.

SUSCILLA A. CREAM

Lady President

Colon Chartered Division No. 4

Printed in *NW*, 20 August 1921.

Malcolm Anderson, Acting Secretary,
UNIA San José, Costa Rica Division,
in the *Negro World*

[[*San José*, ca. June 18, 1921]]

UNVEILING OF CHARTER OF SAN JOSE'S DIVISION
OF U.N.I.A. & A.C.L.

On June 18, 1921, the San Jose Division¹ of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L. unveiled her charter in the Club de Obreros.² It was a very pleasant night and offered a wonderful opportunity to the many invited guests. The meeting was called to order by President David Rodriques at 8 p.m. The hymn "From Greenland's Icy Mountains" was sung, followed by short prayer from Mr. Marcelo Richardson, chaplain of the division.

Mr. Marcelo Richardson made a speech urging every Negro man and woman, boy and girl to do their part in this great cause. That the progress of this important movement depends largely on the support of every Negro for as without soldiers no war could have been fought; likewise, without support, faith and pers[ev]erance, no adventure would ever be successful.

Recitation, Miss P. Rodriques, "Our Land, Africa."

Music by orchestra.

Song by six young ladies, "Uplifting the Race."

Recitation by Master G. Boyd, "Columbus."

Music by orchestra.

Charter was unveiled by two children, Master G. Boyd and Miss Nellie Rodriques.

Mr. Thomas, secretary of the Honorable Advisory Board of Squirres division, was introduced and made a rousing speech, urging the members especially to be faithful, and to stand firm and be ready for action when the bugle shall call every man to his post, for without doubt, for the redemption of Africa, our Fatherland, blood must be shed. It is going to be some war to get those white-belly squatters out of Africa.

Song by six young ladies, "Beautiful Chart."

Mr. S. A. Banton, secretary of the Squirres division, spoke as follows:

Mr. President, officers and members, ladies and gentlemen well-wishers—It is with great pleasure I stand before you tonight representing the Squirres division of the U.N.I.A., and commissioned to convey to you all its warmest sympathy and good wishes, but more so, the delight of our co-operation in unity.

I have observed that this Charter was unveiled by two children—a boy and a girl. To me this signifies that it is incumbent on both members of the race to uphold the integrity of this Charter, that it should not be soiled by any of the so many slackers found everywhere.

In our young days we had not the privilege of unveiling a Charter or anything similar to it. Had our forefathers done what we are essaying today, we would be a better treated race. There will be and must be a comparative difference regarding the treatment that will be extended to our children and grandchildren, to that which we have received, all through the Garveyism movement. Here is Mr. Thomas, my colleague, at work. You have heard from his own lips that he served as a Red Cross nurse in the late European war and is ashamed to tell the treatment he got in return. Therefore, let us do all we can for our own selves; let us avoid serving the white man as much as we possibly can; let us stand firm and support the U.N.I.A. In it lies the only hope of a good future for our offspring if not for ourselves. We know very well the payment we may expect from the white race after years of long and faithful service, and as God helps those who help themselves, friends, help yourselves by supporting the U.N.I.A.

Orchestra.

Six young ladies representing the "Flower Girls."

Dialogue by Miss Tait and Miss Coward.

Song and march by Black Cross Nurses—"The Valiant Soldiers."

Orchestra.

Recitation by Miss Blanche Rodrigues—"Garvey's Charge."

Song by Miss Rachel Tait.

Orchestra.

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Song by Miss Maud Richardson—"The Fisher Girl."

Song by Mrs. Louise Lewis—"A Wedding in June."

Speech by Mr. Malcolm Anderson, chairman of the Honorable Advisory Board of San Jose:—

Mr. President, Fellow-Officers, Ladies and Gentlemen, Friends and Well-Wishers:—

The University [Universal] Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League means to consolidate the thoughts and feelings of the 400,000,000 Negro people of the world. The general objects of the U.N.I.A. are:—To establish a universal confraternity among the race; to promote the spirit of pride and love; to administer to and assist the needy; to assist in civilizing the backward tribes of Africa and to strengthen the nationalism of the Independent Negro States of Africa.

Co-workers and friends, here is the Charter of the San Jose Division before our eyes; we have reached our goal so to speak. We have been struggling for the last twelve months as constitutionally elected officers to reach this goal; rough have been the seas through which we have sailed and at times when the horrid waves dashed against our bark with such great force that it would capsize us into the deep, I hear our noble captain say, "Steady, boys, steady."

Friends, this Charter needs support. Alone it cannot stand; it will fall. Keep it up with your support; fall in line and do your part. Every Negro that is earnest; every Negro that respects himself, every Negro that has ambition, is expected to do his part.

The new Negroes know no "retreat."

"Onward, Upward," is our forward cry. On, on to victory.

The president, thanking the audience for their presence, brought the meeting to a close by the singing of the National Anthem.

MALCOLM ANDERSON
Acting Secretary

Printed in NW, 6 August 1921. Original text not extracted.

1. The San José division played a minor role in the UNIA's history in Costa Rica. The vast majority of people of African descent lived in the province of Limón and were of British West Indian descent. In San José, people of African descent were either Hispanics who descended from the relatively small number of slaves who had been imported into Costa Rica or were West Indians on their way to becoming Afro-Hispanics. The Hispanic or Hispanicized names of some of the participants should be noted (Ron Harpelle, "The Social and Political Integration of West Indians in Costa Rica: 1930-1950," *JLAS* 25, no. 1 [February 1993]: 103-120).

2. The Club de Obreros ("Worker's Club") was a union-supported social club. The club members who supported Garvey were not as willing as he was to bend to the wishes of the UFC; they were more interested in labor politics, and hence met at the Club de Obreros (Aviva Chomsky, *West Indian Workers and the United Fruit Company in Costa Rica, 1870-1940* [Baton Rouge: University of Louisiana Press, 1996]).

Farewell Address by Francis Louis Gardier,
et al., UNIA Dominica Division,
to J. R. Ralph Casimir

Dominica Division #85 Liberty Hall
Roseau D/ca [Dominica]
20th June 1921

We the undersigned officers on behalf of ourselves and members of this division of the U.N.I.A. & A.C.L. embrace this opportunity to express our appreciation and thanks for the services rendered this division of the U.N.I.A. It shall ever be memorial to us of the great sacr[i]fices that you have done for the Association here, we must endorse what the General-President uttered when he said "Had I not an industrious and diligent officer of your type I would never have succeeded in planting the U.N.I.A. in Dominica."

We can never forget the day when you were asked by your employer to "Either abandon the U.N.I.A.["] or "Abandon your employment" to see that you abandoned your employment to stick to the U.N.I.A. that caused us to believe the more in you. As a whole we cannot find the words in which to express our deep sense of gratitude. We wish you a Bon Voyage and pray that you will return in good health and strength to continue your good works.

May God Bless you during your sojourn among some of our brothers abroad and bring you back safe to us. We are, Yours fraternally and racially,

FRANCIS LOUIS GARDIER
Gen: Pres: D/ca

J. C. Wyke
2nd Vice. Pres.

CASIMIR MORANICE
3rd Vice. Pres.

SOLOMON G. W. PETER
Actg. Exct. Secty.

[THEODORE J. HARRIS?]
Member Trustee

MARIA CASIMIR
Actg. Lady Pres.

MEREDITH CASIMIR
Lady Gen. Secty.

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EDITHA HAUSTIN
Lady Assoc. Secty.

JOSEPH B. PAYNE
Trustee

WM. DONFRAID
Treasurer

M. G. ELLEN ALLEN
Asst Treasurer

JRRC. ALS, recipient's copy. Handwritten letterhead: "One God! One Aim! One Destiny! Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League."

To the Beloved and Scattered Millions of the Negro Race

Greeting

This is to Certify that
Mr. J. R. Ralph Casimir

is a duly registered active member of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities (Empire) Branch, an organization embracing the millions of men, women and children of Negro blood and of African descent of all countries of the world, striving for the FREEDOM, MANHOOD, and NATIONALISM of the Negro, and to hand down to posterity a FLAG OF EMPIRE—to restore to the world an Ethiopian Nation one and indivisible out of which shall come our princes and rulers—to bequeath to our children and our Grand Old Race the heritage of an Ancestry worthy of their time and thoughtful of the future.

Resting on the strength and mercy of Almighty God, and on the Effort and faith of our people all over the world, we the undersigned, as officers of the frican No. 85 Division, append our names this 15th day of June 1914 in the year of our Lord One Thousand Nine Hundred and twelve—one.

Francis D. Gardner
President.
J. R. Ralph Casimir
General Secretary.
Wm. B. Smith
Treasurer.

Maria Casimir
President of Ladies' Division.
Meredith Casimir
General Secretary Ladies' Division.

UNIA Membership Certificate for J. R. Ralph Casimir
(Source: JRRC)

JUNE 1921

John H. Smith, Acting Executive Secretary,
Executive Department, Panama Canal Zone,
to A. L. Flint, Chief of Office,
Panama Canal Company

Balboa Heights, C.Z.,
June 21, 1921

Sir:

With reference to Marcus Garvey's recent visit to the Isthmus, the following resume of his activities while here is furnished with the suggestion that it be transmitted to the Attorney General:

Arrived at Colon on the Launch "Linda S" at 3:00 P.M. April 26, 1921 from Bocas del Toro, R.P.; was met by a large number of West Indians; went to the residence of Dr. Hamlet at #44 Broadway, Colon where he stopped during his stay in Colon.

From date of arrival to and including April 29th, he held six meetings in Colon, two of which were for members of the Universal Negro Improvement Association only. At these meetings there were from 700 to 4000 persons present.

Subject went to Panama City on April 30th, where he stopped at the Casino boarding house, Caledonia Road. While in Panama City he held six meetings, two of which were for members of the Universal Negro Improvement Association only. At these meetings there were from 250 to 750 persons present.

Garvey returned to Colon on the morning of May 4th, where a farewell meeting was held that evening at which 500 persons were present. He sailed for Kingston, Jamaica on United Fruit ss "Carrillo" at 11:30 A.M. May 5th.

With the exception of the two meetings held in Panama City for members only, reports of the meetings held are on file in this office. Admission of \$1 for adults and \$.50 for children was charged at all meetings, except those for members only. These meetings were attended largely by the colored laboring class, whose desire to hear and see Garvey is considered to be due to curiosity rather than any real conversion to his schemes. His visit here is not believed to have had any appreciable effect on the colored population. Neither Garvey nor his Secretary had any business transactions with the banks on the Isthmus.

The American Consul General, Panama City, advised this office under date of April 13, 1921, that on account of political and racial agitation, Garvey has been refused vis[é] to return to the continental United States.

By direction of the Governor. Respectfully,

JNO. H. SMITH
Acting Executive Secretary

[*Addressed to:*] Chief of Office,
The Panama Canal, Washington D.C.

[*Handwritten endorsement:*] Mr F[lint?]
Would suggest copy also be sent to the
State Dept. a/c reference to visa of pass-
port.
S.

DNA, RG 185, 91/332. TLS, recipient's copy. On Canal Zone Executive Department letterhead.

Claribert L. Watks. to the *Negro World*

[[Coxen Hole, Bay Island of Ruatan,
Spanish Honduras, ca. 25 June 1921]]

A GREETING TO HON. MARCUS GARVEY

Dear Sir:

I am authorized by your subjects and my fellow citizens to inform you most cordially that our hearts and souls are with you in this great undertaking. We pledge you to do our best in helping you to further the move. But just now we can do nothing. We have been like others whom you are always reprimanding. We made hay when the sun shone and when the rain came it got wet for no preparation was made to secure it. But as business is just being started we will not sleep anymore, but try and keep our eyes open for the coming foe.

From the month of November past till the month dated, we have had no trade for our products¹ and no other work of any kind was done for us to procure funds. We were in dire dilemma, but, thank God, He has again opened up our way and we pledge to use it to our very best advantage, especially the one He has so nobly prepared you for. We pray His spirit may ever lead and guide you until God and man shall call you blessed for the work you have done.

We feel ourselves proud to be your subjects and long for the time when we shall be to your command, fearing no dread.

Whatever your orders or wish, we are willing to comply so long as it is in our power. Wishing you Godspeed and success in this undertaking. I conclude, yours obediently,

CLARIBERT L. WATKS.

[*Addressed to:*] Hon. Marcus Garvey,
Pres. Gen., U.N.I.A. and A.C.L.,
Universal Building, New York City

Printed in NW, 25 June 1921.

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1. The lack of trade was caused by the general strike that exploded near La Ceiba in July 1920 and that continued late into that same year. The Bay Island economies thrived on the banana export-driven economies on the mainland (Darío A. Euraque, "Zonas regionales en la formación del estado hondureño, 1830s-1930s: El caso de la Costa Norte," *Revista Centroamericana de Economía*, no. 39 [September-December 1992]: 65-102).

Solomon J. E. St. Rose to the *Workman*

[[Colon, R.P., ca. 25 June 1921]]

MARCUS GARVEY A DOER NOT A SAYER

Dear Mr. Editor:

Permit me space in the columns of your journal to express my opinion regarding an article appearing in the *Workman* issue of May 21 headed, "Garvey's Bubble Attacked." Before proceeding with my undertakings, may I ask of you, Mr. Editor, your reason for allowing such senseless logic as I have read, from time to time, to be published in the columns of your journal? You said that you do not hold yourself responsible for the sentiments expressed by your correspondents; that's true, and I did not expect to hear differently, but, I am saying here, that such articles are impregnated with maliciousness and jealousy, and I am sure that they help you none. I remembered some weeks ago, when the Hon. Marcus Garvey was lecturing in Jamaica, you manifested such enthusiasm as to have, before hand, flysheets in large letters stating "get your *Workman* on Saturday and hear the speech of the Hon. Marcus Garvey at the Ward Theatre, and, when Saturday came, you had, at the end of a certain part of the speech to be continued in the next issue—and that was to bring in a little more money. Why didn't you succeed with the sale of that issue? I am positive that there were not sufficient copies of that issue in Colon that week, for the very name of the Hon. Gentleman, the pattern for you babblers, fault-finders and do nothings was an added means of your gaining a livelihood; yet, you welcome all destructive publications connected thereto, and turn down constructive ones.

Have you forgotten that this is the age of the New Negro, and the only way to succeed is to manifest the true spirit of New Negroism? Now for your Mr. Tom Saywell: Sir, I am at a loss to conjecture the reason you a "say-well" could not advise your people against throwing their five-seventy-five with the brotherhood to enrich the coffers of the other fellow. Do you really mean to say that one of superb intelligence, an encyclopedia, the world's best orator, and a Saywell stood by and allowed such mean advantage to be perpetrated on his race and said nothing until now that the one who has all legal rights to get millions instead of five-seventy-five comes to the limelight for Negroes' emancipation, then you wake from forgetfulness and start such ridiculous braying? Oh, for Heaven's sake throw your advice at the door of the ant and listen to the

music. We shall, henceforth, look to Seewell and forget Saywell in that we will welcome the See, for seeing is believing.

We do not want your advice in telling us where to invest, nor what has become of the Black Star Line. We are today carving our own destiny as a people oppressed, discriminated and segregated, and are prepared to face all reverses, irrespective of any and all such sayers like you, we have ceased to listen to nor consider, for the man of the hour, the doer and not the sayer, is the Hon. Marcus Garvey. You remarked that his orations are inferior to that of your local talent. Yet you failed to understand that the Hon. Gentleman did not come to speak to an ass, nor to dead men. It is the hardest thing on earth to make a crab understand something, and all the local orators of whom you spoke are of your class and are expounding their orations on the Chinese rum-counter; therefore, Mr. Saywell, we have ceased to be made any more tools for those of you who live obscured and waited for a chance to dispossess us of, or sway us from, our intention and support to the Garvey movement.

You asked when will the Garvey movement cease to take advantage of the credulity and gullibility of the ignorant and unsuspecting Negroes? Well, in answer to your inquiry, allow me to apprise you of the fact, and, at least, be thought wise, that the Garvey movement shall never cease until the banner of the Black, the Red and the Green is planted on African plains, telling of an Africa redeemed and all such like you will be made to acknowledge that you are (un sot a triple etage¹). In conclusion, let me advise you that whenever you wish to show your ignorance, try to change your name from Saywell to Seewell, for, every living Negro today has seen and is appreciating the true doctrine of the Garvey movement. (En attendant) for your admonition, I am referring you to the *World's Work* issue of December, 1920, and January, 1921.² Thanking you for space, Mr. Editor, I remain yours,

SOLOMON J. E. ST. ROSE

Reproduced from *NW*, 25 June 1921.

1. "*Un sot'a triple ètage*," or "an egregious blockhead" (Samuel Johnson, *Johnson's Dictionary of the English Language in Miniature* [1797], 8th ed., s.v. "un sot a triple etage").

2. In the *World's Work* (Vol. 41), the first article mentioned, "Marcus Garvey—The Negro Moses" (December 1920), centered on the life of Garvey and how he came to be a major figure in African affairs. The second article, "Garvey's Empire of Ethiopia: Aspiration for a Negro Super-Government" (January 1921), recounts his call for equal rights for blacks and his concept of "Africa for the Africans" following World War I, when many Africans fought on behalf of white nations. Both articles were written by Truman Hughes Talley (1891–1942), who began his career writing for *World's Work* and the popular *McClure's Magazine*. Talley also wrote for the *New York Times* in 1922, before leaving the newspapers to work as a documentary filmmaker, a pursuit for which he received much acclaim (*World's Work*, vol. 41. November 1920–April 1921; *NYT*, 19 January 1942 [vol. 8, 493]; [New York: Doubleday, Page, 1900–1932], pp. 153–166, 264–270; "Milestones, Jan. 26, 1942," *Time* in partnership with CNN, <http://www.time.com/time/printout/0,8816,932346,00.html>).

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R. G. Blackett¹ to the *Negro World*

[[Cranstons, St. Kitts, W.I.,
June 25, 1921]]

IF THE WHITE RACE DO THEIR DUTY FAIRLY BY
THE COLORED MAN, GARVEYISM WILL NOT GO FAR—
F. A. MCKENZIE,² IN OVERSEAS MAGAZINE,³ APRIL, 1921

Dear Sir—

Referring to the above headlines which form the close of the last paragraph of an article on page 4 of *The Negro World* of May 14, 1921, I respectfully beg the necessary space to ask the following question—lest we stupidly stop and turn back:

African people of the world (pure and mixed), would you stupidly stop at and turn back from your seemingly determined and rapidly progressing spirit of organization at present for the peopling and retaking of our father and motherland—Africa, now in possession of the Caucasian, were that race even now to do its duty fairly by the Negro peoples of the world? I presume every new Negro, literate or il[l]iterate, would answer with an emphatic No! No! Never! Caucasian, it is too late now to do your duty; neither do we any more ask the franchise or seat in the legislative assemblies of your countries of the world, but have now decided to keep mute; to be obedient to your laws; to continue to get together, and to await the time when we shall certainly take back possession of the continent of our forefathers. Every sunset brings us nearer this goal, however impossible it looks today; but nothing before its time. Africans at home, Africans abroad, African descendants in every part of the world, be not ye deceived by such a fair-saying camouflage as the foregoing headlines, for surely we have had enough of similar camouflages said for us that we must not any more give heed to even better expressions of good-will for our race by the pen or from the lips of the Caucasian of any nationality. Brethren and sisters of Africa and African descent in every part of the world, I say again, be not any more camouflaged in this era of progressiveness of races, but let us get together the links of our oneness of thought, money and determination into one solid chain, pulling together, endeavoring to catch the glimpse of knowledge of even one-half 200,000,000 of our race, trusting—while pulling together for the one common cause, Africa's redemption—in the Lord Jehovah, for in Him, with our united determination, is everlasting strength. Honor among ourselves must be given to whom honor is due; we have got to honor and obey our potentate; thanksgiving and praise to our provisional president of the Continent of Africa, and obedience to all the members of our high executive council and officers appointed by them. Let us, the working classes of our race, do our united best, after which the wealthy of our race, seeing our successful efforts, will come in very soon with their big financial push and speed the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L.; the Liberian Construction Loan; the Negro Factories Corporation (preferably) in

Africa; the Black Star Line Steamship Corporation and other progressive organizations yet to be.

Fellow men of my race, let us, for the last time, get together. Never say fail, for this time success is ours; for methinks I hear those who are today in possession of our African birthright, when they see us coming in, week by week, month by month, and year by year, saying: See the conquering heroes come! Get us out of their land, lest we, also, share the justice of retribution at their hands for all our deeds, past, present and future.

And last, but not the least, let our attention be turned to McKenzie's closing remarks of paragraph 5 on page 4 in *The Negro World* of May 14, 1921, and thinkers of our race can see well the sentimental love for African blood in the words of F. A. McKenzie: It is interesting to note how the Negro's love for long names and high-sounding honorifics comes out.

R. G. BLACKETT

(Late of Trinidad, W. I.)

Printed in *NW*, 26 November 1921.

1. R. G. Blackett was probably a Barbadian UNIA member who was resident in Trinidad at the time of the mass deportation of Garveyites and other black radicals from that colony. He may also have been related to J. W. Blackett, the Barbadian editor of the *St. Kitts-Nevis Daily Bulletin*, and this may have influenced his choice of St. Kitts as a place of refuge. J. W. Blackett, however, although a supporter of the call for increased West Indian self-government, was a staunch conservative.

2. F. A. McKenzie, "Is There a Black Peril? The Story of Marcus Garvey, the Leader," *Overseas* 6, no. 63 (1921): 43–45. Frederick A. McKenzie (1869–1931) was a noted Canadian-born war correspondent, journalist, author, and lecturer; he wrote many books and contributed to numerous publications. He was a regular contributor to the London-based *Overseas: The Monthly Journal of the Overseas Club and Patriotic League* and wrote many pamphlets for the Salvation Army. One year before the article cited, he published "Black Peril: America's Main Problem," *Asburton Guardian* (16 April 1920); the year following, he also wrote "Practical Ideals for Negro Education," *Missionary Review of the World* 45 [1922]: 457–463. He was born in Quebec, Canada, and died in Zelst, Holland (Obituary, *NTT*, 1 August 1931; *WWW*, vol. 3, 1929–1940).

3. Known today as the Royal Over-Seas League (ROSL), the Over-seas Club and Patriotic League described itself as "a non-party society of British subjects residing in all parts of the world. Its underlying motive is to promote the unity of British subjects" (*Overseas: The Monthly Journal of the Overseas Club & Patriotic League* 4, no. 42 [1919]. 38). Founded in 1910 by Sir Evelyn Wrench (1882–1966), the Over-Seas Club was given a Royal Charter of Incorporation in 1922, and in 1960, Queen Elizabeth II granted the title "Royal" to mark its golden jubilee (Christina A. Wilbur, "Missionary for the Empire: John Evelyn Wrench, the Overseas League and the English-Speaking Union," M.A. thesis, Lamar Univ., 2010; William V. Griffin, *Sir Evelyn Wrench and His Continuing Vision of International Relations, during 40 Years. (The History of the English-Speaking Union of the United States.)* [New York: Newcomen Society in North America, 1950]).

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P. Premdas, Acting Assistant Secretary,
Black Star Line, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

UNIVERSAL BUILDING,
56 WEST 135TH STREET
NEW YORK, U.S.A. June 27th 1921

DEAR MR. CASIMIR,

Your letter of the 9th inst., enclosing certificate No. 28893—1 share—to be transferred to Harold Henry, has come to hand.

Enclosed herewith we are forwarding you certificate No. 39048 made out accordingly which please deliver to Mr. Henry for us. //Delivered per [Maria Casimir?] 28/8/21//

Attached to the certificate is a receipt which please get him to sign and return to us as usual.

We note that you intend going for a leave either to Trinidad or Barbados and hope on your way you will do some fine business for the corporation. Over this side we are doing our best to drive the movement along.

With best wishes and hoping to hear from you soon again, Yours very truly,

BLACK STAR LINE, INC.
P. PREMDAS
Actg. Asst. Secretary

[*Addressed to:*] MR. J. R. RALPH CASIMIR
P.O. Box 81, Roseau, Dominica, B.W.I.

JRRC. TLS, recipient's copy. On BSL, Inc., letterhead. Delivery comment handwritten on recipient's copy.

Robert S. F. Blake,¹ Chaplain,
UNIA Banes Division, to the *Negro World*

[[*Banes, Oriente, Cuba*, June 28, 1921]]

LOYAL MEMBER OF BANES[,] ORIENTE[,]
CUBA, U.N.I.A. PASSES AWAY

Dear Sir:

Please allow me space for the publication of this letter. We, of the Banes Division have, at last, been visited by the dread monster. The icy hand of death entered our ranks and quickly snatched from our midst a sister, Mrs. Beatrice Bradshaw, leaving behind her a husband and five children, the youngest an infant, eleven days old. I, the undersigned, had the privilege to witness her last

moments on earth, and also to commit her remains to the grave. Within ten minutes after death our notice board at Liberty Hall told the news to the community and, within two hours, the residence of the deceased was filled with officers and members. Our esteemed acting president was to be seen and heard directing the different officers as to their duties in connection with the funeral ceremony. It was gratifying to note how our members turned out to do reverence to the dead, although a weekday. At 5.30 p.m. the procession was to be seen wending its way towards Liberty Hall under the strains of the dead march played by our local band. At the gate the corpse was met by the chaplain in his robes, and the service, according to the Universal N[eg]ro Ritual, commenced. After the prayers and singing of hymn, "Near'er My God to Thee," the procession again reformed and proceeded to the graveyard. Banes has never before witnessed such a sublime spectacle. It speaks well towards the spirit of love and unity that is alive amongst us. Indeed, God is working His purpose out through the Hon. Marcus Garvey. Thank God for Garvey. The Sunday following a memorial service was held in Liberty Hall. Thanking you for space

ROBERT S. F. BLAKE
Chaplain

Printed in *NW*, 16 July 1921.

1. Robert S. F. Blake was president of Banes division 52 in 1923 and 1924. He also served as third vice president of this division as late as 1930 (*NW*, 26 May 1923, 17 May 1924, 19 April 1930).

Report by Leon E. Howe, Agent, Bureau of Investigation

Miami, Fla. 6/29/21

REV. T. C. GLASHAN [GLASHEN] (HONDURAN NEGRO)
ALLEGED RADICAL U.N.I.A. AT KEY WEST FLORIDA

Reference is made to report of agent dated March 11, 1921, under Caption MARCUS GARVEY, JAMAICA NEGRO AGITATOR, and to letter from the Chief of the Bureau dated MAY 11 INITIALED GFR with reference to negro radicals at KEY WEST FLORIDA.

June 11 agent learned that prominent citizens of KEY WEST FLA were interesting themselves in the activities of the U.N.I.A. and its local president REV T. C. GLASHAN. Following the visit of GARVEY to KEY WEST the movement grew considerably, and the organization held many meetings. GLASHAN always s[po]ke, and informant gives the following as a sample of his ranting: "We have been under the White people's control long enough. The time has come for us to strike, and all of us negroes must let the world know that we are a power, strong and ready to defend our rights. If we can't know suc[c]eed with words,

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we will [use?] other methods, and never mind what happens. If blood is need[ed, let it be] shared. We fought to help this and other countr[ie]s to be free, so let[']s fight to free ourselves."

In speaking of GARVEY, whom he called "our Moses," he said they should demand that he be allowed to go to the halls of Congress and speak for negro recognition. He bitterly [criticized] the American negroes because they would not join the U.N.I.A.

About June 16 a warrant was sworn out charging GLASHAN with "inciting a riot" under the state laws. Shortly afterwards DR. A. J. KERSHAW, financial secretary of the U.N.I.A. at KEY WEST, was arrested, charged with stealing the funds of the organization. KERSHAW turned over the books and papers of the organization to agent's informant, and is at present at liberty under bond.

KERSHAW has resigned from the U.N.I.A. GLASHAN has been given the option of leaving KEY WEST by way of CUBA, or of standing trial on the charge of inciting a riot. It is my understanding that he has already left for CUBA. The case against KERSHAW, which was instituted by the U.N.I.A., is still standing, and agent will be advised of all matters in this connection by KERSHAW himself.

The books and minutes of the U.N.I.A. at KEY WEST have been examined by agent, and only two things of interest appear therein. One is the fact that the membership numbers 690, and agent has a list of all these members which is being forwarded with copy of report to Jacksonville.¹ The other is an entry with reference to some action which was proposed at a meeting, and action was not taken "because it would be in violation of the Federal Law." What this entry refers to agent has not yet been able to learn. One informant states there was a debate one night with reference to the serving of some liquor at a meeting, and this may be the truth.

The new president of the U.N.I.A. at KEY WEST is GILBERT ALBREY and the financial secretary is [D]. HEALD. The organization is operating a bakery on a cooperative plan, and the delivery wagon is painted in the U.N.I.A. colors.

Agent has carefully refrained from having anything to do with the activities of the citizens of KEY WEST in the foregoing matters, and have obtained my information largely from KERSHAW. There is likely some question of the legality of ordering GLASHAN to leave Key West via Cuba, but it was done by a judge of the Circuit Court, Judge Hunt Harris. Practically all members of the U.N.I.A. at KEY WEST are aliens, as is the case of MIAMI and WEST PALM BEACH.

LEON E. HOWE

[*Endorsement:*] NOTED F. D. W.

DNA, RG 65, BS 198940-175. TD. Stamped endorsement.

1. The list was not retained with the report.

Jabez L. Clarke, General Secretary,
UNIA Havana Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Diavia No. 8, Havana, Cuba,
July 1, 1921]]

PRESIDENT OF KEY WEST DIVISION
FACED DEATH SEVERAL TIMES
BEGGED TO LEAVE CITY TO AVOID RIOT
SPEAKS IN HAVANA

Within a couple of hours after the Right Hon. High Commissioner for Cuba visited and left the Havana division more than ever enthused over the spirit of Garveyism, we had our Liberty Hall crammed with members of the race on Sunday, June 26, all ready to listen with interest to the message of the true Negro.

The chief spectacle of the evening was the Rev. T. C. Glashen, president of the Key West division, who, after having caught the Garvey fever, labored with the true spirit of Negroism and succeeded in making his division, within a couple of months, one of the strongest in the United States.

He was envied by traitors of the race, especially members of the N.A.A.C.P. and the Klu-Klux-Klan, who sought his life, but with his strong will and determination and the help of his brave and loyal members he overcame them on several occasions. A race riot ensued, and he was begged by the government to leave the city. He was obliged to go by way of Havana to New York, lest he be taken off the train by mobs that were waiting to lynch him, thereby getting rid of the association in that section.

The meeting began at 8.30 p.m., presided over by Mr. G. M. G. Clarke, recently elected president and installed by Mr. Morales. The following was the order of the program, which was well carried out by the performers—Hymn: "From Greenland's Icy Mountains," by the audience; prayer, from the ritual by the Rev. C. H. Johnson, chaplain; hymn, "Nearer My God to Thee," by the audience; opening address and welcome by the chairman, in which he pledges the faithful execution of the duties incumbent on him as president of the division; anthem, "Now Let the Gates of Zion Ring," by the choir; address, by the Rev. T. C. Glashen; information on the "The Black Star Line," by Mr. A. G. Burkley, agent; solo, "O, Touch the Hem of His Garment," by Miss Maud Hibbert; address, "We Must Redeem Africa," by Mr. J. Thompson; solo, "Speak the Truth," by Master Joseph Clarke; solo, "Clinging to Thee," by Miss Ethline Wallace, associate secretary; Ethiopian National Anthem, by the audience, and close in prayer, by the chaplain.

MR. GLASHEN SPEAKS

The Rev. T. C. Glashen, on being called upon by the chairman, said it was not only pleasant but also fortunate for him to be with us for the second time in this glorious city of Havana. He expressed his pleasure and satisfaction in the recent election and [*install*]ation of officers at which he was present, and further said that he was glad to see our people coming together.

"My presence in Havana," he said, "is a very fortunate thing for me, and it is because I defended the U.N.I.A. from my heart that causes me to be here; not that it is from my own will, but for reasons which I had to make good of. I passed through this city nearly two years ago, and left your division working splendidly. Now in the space of seven months, in Key West we have a membership of 1,500; we started a bakery which made food for itself and also had a few dollars in the bank, and buried one of our members who died recently. I was 195 miles in the South, where crimes are committed daily; we started the organization on the 29th day of August of last year and we came in contact with the N.A.A.C.P., founded by Dubois [Du Bois], whom you must have heard about.

[“]Nothing of the U.N.I.A. was mentioned previously, and when I queried, I was told that there were four thousand Negroes and fifteen thousand whites in that vicinity, and I said ‘We are good to go.’

[“]I was also told that the N.A.A.C.P. was in operation for nine years and had but a few members, and within the space of seven months, we are able to count hundreds of members. The scripture reads that Princes shall come out of Judah, and Ethiopia shall stretch forth her hands unto God, and I am glad to see four millions of Negroes stretching forth their hands unto God at this time, for their freedom and liberty.

[“]The funds of the organization were entrusted to the executive secretary, one Doctor Cushaw [Kershaw], and I discovered some blunder in his books. I took him privately and asked him for an explanation, and could not help reminding him that it is the peoples’ money for which he would have to account. There was a falsification of \$225.00, and he was placed under arrest, with bail of \$500.00. After I had warned Cushaw, and previous to his arrest, he went away and told the Southern Crackers that this association was backed up by the Japanese Government, and was training men to fight against the white race, and advised them to get me out of the city.

[“]On the fourth of this month, the chairman of the Chamber of Commerce sent for me. He introduced himself as Glash, and I was Glashen. He began to tell me, ‘Now, I want you to understand that here is the South, and the white man’s country, and I want you to get to hell out of here. The Japanese Government is using you all as tools; the United States is going to battle against Japan and the Negroes are training to fight on the side of the Japanese. Garvey missed it by the skin of his teeth when he passed through here, but he escaped. Now, I give you twenty-four hours to clear out of here.’ After further argument, his opponent told him that he liked the Negro constitution except-

ing the part that reads that the Negro must not go to battle without the consent of his leader.”

On the fourth night after this interview, he held his meeting in Liberty Hall, and the same man confronted him and said that he was advising him to leave the city because there was going to be danger on account of the number of the Ku Klux Klan and other enemies that were planning against his life. He was advised to leave the city that night, for fear of being killed. Arrangements were made among the mob to have him board the train that night and be taken off and lynched, and these seeming friends were engaged to influence him to be caught in the trap. The lynching could not be done in Key West because the members of the Division were determined to fight to the last.

Mr. Glashen further said that he went to the mayor of the city and reported the threats made against his life. The enemies of the association had already gone to the mayor and lied against him, saying that he was a spy in the city, whereas he had lived there for seven months. The mayor informed him that he realized that the others had coveted him for the progress his association had made in the city, and while there was nothing against his behavior he could not order him to leave.

The association was removing into new quarters, which they were prepared to lease for five years. “I was at the new site,” he continued in part, “where an automobile rode up and the sheriff of the city alighted in a big hurry asking for Glashen. He knew me before, but he was in such a hurry to find me that he oversighted me. I said, ‘Here I am.’ He pointed a revolver at me and said, ‘Get in this car! Get in this car!’ I questioned why, and he told me that he had a warrant for me: ‘Get in this car.’ I obeyed and got in the car and was taken to the jail.

[“]I was able to peep out of the window and see a number of white folks gathering together and making merry; while they were doing that, the members of the association also were gathering, and not merry, but getting busy. The mayor of the city, being a lodge brother, sent word to the jailer to put me on the top floor to avoid the mob which was preparing to lynch me. During all this excitement and threats, I had no fear, because I realize[d] that some sacrifice must be made in this association before we achieve anything, and therefore I was prepared to go to redeem four hundred million Negroes the world over. And I was glad to see the spirit of the members of the association who were prepared to rescue me. I happened to glimpse one of them through the window, who yelled at me, ‘Don’t be afraid, nothing like lynching tonight.’ Later in the evening I could discern armed men and the marine force in charge of the city, who were prepared to prevent a race riot.

[“]We sent a telegram to the Parent Body in New York, but it was cut off, and so we could not get word from them. The division, however, was determ[in]ed to get in communication with the New York division, and so they dispatched the Lady President of the division with the message to New York. Friends, I think that you should be doing better in Havana. If you had been

having such combats, there would be more members in the association, but you seem to be living too easy. The time is coming when it means a getting together, and there are many who are going to regret that they had not joined this association before.

[“]As soon as the Parent Body received word that I was in jail, they dispatched two telegrams, one to the authorities, saying to let me go and hold the association responsible, and the other to me saying that assistance was coming (telegrams submitted and read to audience by secretary). After I was detained in the jail for some time, the judge of the city told me that there was nothing against me, but that if I had stayed there was going to be a riot; therefore he was asking me please to leave, not by train, because the mob would catch me, but by way of Havana, where they would not get a hold on me. Since I did not want to be on the wrong side, and there was also another telegram sent from New York requesting me to come there, I consented to leave.

[“]Friends, this association means a getting together of the Negro race, it means that we must make up our minds, to achieve something.

[“]On one occasion I was going to hold a meeting, and it was just twilight. On reaching a certain spot, I heard two shots fired behind me, but I paid little attention. On overtaking the Lady President of the division she was surprised to know that I was behind and asked me if I heard the bullets. So as not to let her lose her nerves, I told her I knew nothing about them. Next morning I returned to the spot and saw where the two shots struck against the wall, and I said to myself that those were the two intended to be in my body.

[“]I informed my opponents on several occasions that this association must live while God said, ‘Let there be light,’ and there are four hundred million Negroes living on the face of this earth; therefore, if they took my life, the association would still progress.

[“]I was approached on one occasion by Mr. Harris of the Monroe County jail, who congratulated me for my strong spirit, and told me that I am a splendid man and promising, but that he was sorry to say that I was going to be killed, because several members of my race and others had gone to the mayor and complained that they could not allow me to live any longer in their city, and were preparing to lynch me that night.

[“]I obtained protection [permission?] from the police department to protect myself, and went to the store and bought a red light and hung [it] over my door, meaning danger, and kept watch that night, prepared for a battle. Next morning I was told by some of my friends who were watching the mob that I was saved through the stars in heaven, because God had prepared a great storm which showered down, and at which the mob fled.

[“]They were determined to get me, so as to be able to knife the association. They organized a branch of the Ku-Klux[-]Klan for no other reason than to put out the U.N.I.A., but I told them plainly, ‘White folks, you have a hard time to get me, because death is too small to be afraid of. I take it as I take a drink of cool water. I fear no man.’

[“]In the South the Negro is treated like a dog; I went to the city of Miami, which is next to Georgia¹ where lynching is concerned. When they are going to lynch anyone, they give a sign days before and the whole town begins to think who is going. They make an image and hang it at the lynching spot below which there is a precipice, and dead men tell no tales. One day a friend of mine met me and said, ‘Man, you see yourself?’ I replied, ‘Oh, that isn’t much; I am prepared to go. If the first man comes and runs, and the second and the third run too, there will always be lynchings; but if we would always resist and let somebody go with us when we are going, there would soon be a stop.’

[“]The charter of that division has been stolen away, and the Judge promised that if he caught the man he would give him a sentence from here to yonder world. And do you think I mean it, brothers? Yes, I mean it. We offered a reward for the finding of the man, and the amount was increased and still good; we still hope to find him.

[“]The only thing that can save 400,000,000 Negroes the world over is faith in the movement and faith without works is dead. The Negroes in the South mean business, and we want you to mean business in Havana, too, and everywhere where Negroes are supposed to be.

[“]The Negroes say if we can’t get it one way, four hundred million get together and say we must get it the other way. We are in a year of universal activity, and the greatest factor today is the Negro race.

[“]We are told that we were only made to hew wood and draw water, but we are not prepared to be hewers of wood and drawers of water any more. God did not say let us make whitemen and Blackmen. He said, “Let us make man after our own Image.” And what right have we to let the other man tell us that we were made to hew wood and draw water?

The destiny of the Negro is the destiny of 400,000,000, and wherever one Negro is oppressed, 400,000,000 Negroes are oppressed.”

At this point the speaker asked those who were active members of the division to hold their hands up, and appealed to the others to become active members, to which eight responded. He continued, “We want to become one great thing spelled with five letters, and that great thing is (quite forcibly) POWER.” He called attention to the fact that a few years ago no other nation respected the Japanese Government because she was weak, but today all nations are racing to become allied with her through the power that she has. If the Negroes get together we shall have that, because, tell the world, we are 400,000,000 strong.

[“]While some Negroes are at ease, Europe and America are serious over the U.N.I.A. because they realize that we are coming, for we heard the voice of God say, “I have heard your groanings and I am coming to redeem you out of this oppression.” My friends, wake up, this is the time! Join the U.N.I.A. We want to have a fleet of ships and a government owned and controlled solely by Negroes, for the Negroes. I do not know how long I will stay in this city, but my only advice to you is to get together.

He gave two illustrations of the three sons and a bundle of sticks, united, could not be beaten or broken; and the horses defending themselves unitedly, saying that if 400,000,000 Negroes all bray and kick together, all Europe flees. ["We want everybody to do their best to support this organization because if we fall back, what will be the consequences? 400,000,000 slaves! Therefore I am asking you to get together and continue the fight, because we have pledged with God that we cannot anymore stand the injustices. I will give you an example of the cruelties done to the Negro in the South.

["There was a farmer who employed a stranger on his farm for some time and kept his money for him. The laborer told him that he wanted to go home to see his family, therefore he asked him for his money. He was told to return another day. On the day appointed the farmer dug a hole at the entrance of his farm and set a trap for the Negro. He came and was caught in the hole, his head alone left above ground, the remaining portion of his body covered up. The farmer asked, "You came for your money?" "Yes, sah, but mi no mean so, sah," crying. And the wicked savage let loose a number of wild dogs which he had tied up which took the poor Negro's head to pieces and carried them to different parts of the farm."

"Negroes," the speaker continued, "Let us get together; we cannot stand for this any longer. They are not doing that to white men. White men would not stand for it—he is too united. The Negro is always contending that he is from Jamaica and Barbad[os] and Trinidad and so on, but we must get together and cut that out. We are too great a people to be down trodden. We have read in the newspaper how so many homes in Tulsa² were burnt down, and Negroes shot while fleeing from the burning homes. Friends in Havana, let us get together, let us remember the Hon. Marcus Garvey whose life is for a purpose in this world.

["The white man is telling us that this is a white man's country, but another great day is coming when the Negroes look for the redemption of Africa. Several lodgings refused to admit me in Miami when I spoke there, saying that the hotel was going to be blown up by crackers, and when I went home with the president of the division, we had to leave our beds to fight against them. When I was about leaving the city, I took a Ford car to take me to the railway, and while he was driving, a lodge brother of mine beckoned me to get out of the car. I quickly obeyed, and when I questioned the reason, he asked me: 'Do you know where you are, you are in a hearse?' He explained to me that the Ford in which I was, was one of the confederates who had a certain lonely road to drive, at which a mob would wait for their prey and seize him, and he was going right in that direction then.

["Friends, I mean business in this movement, and if everybody means business, we will soon accomplish our aims. When a man talk about the redemption of Africa, he talks about my mother and father.

["Men of Ethiopia awake; members of the dark-skinned race, awake! Let us not only assist Marcus Garvey, but let us assist 400,000,000 members of our

race. One Negro burnt in the United States is one burnt in Havana, and one oppressed in Europe is one oppressed in Asia; therefore let's get together and fight for our Motherland. We want to lay a foundation for our little boys and girls, growing up in the world."

JABEZ L. CLARKE
General Secretary,
Havana Division.

Printed in NW, 16 July 1921.

1. In 1920 there were seven lynchings in Georgia, six of them in Cotton Belt and South Georgia. These areas were comprised of large black populations and had economies dependent upon cotton cultivation (W. Fitzhugh Brundage, *Lynching in the New South: Georgia and Virginia, 1880-1930* [Urbana: University of Illinois Press, 1993], pp. 106, 279).

2. The Tulsa, Okla., race riot began in June 1921 when a black man was arrested on the accusation of assaulting a young white woman. Heavily armed blacks took up arms around the Tulsa jail after rumors circulated through black neighborhoods that the accused man would be lynched. Confrontations and fights between whites and blacks broke out at the jail and quickly spread across the city. The National Guard had to be deployed to restore peace and order but not before rioting left nine whites and twenty-one blacks dead and hundreds of others injured (John Hope Franklin Jr. and Alfred A. Moss Jr., *From Slavery to Freedom: A History of Negro Americans* [1947; reprint, New York: Alfred A. Knopf, Inc., 1988], pp. 315-316; Tim Madigan, *The Burning: Massacre, Destruction, and the Tulsa Race Riot of 1921* [New York: Thomas Dunne Books/St. Martin's Press, 2001]; James S. Hirsch, *Riot and Remembrance: The Tulsa Race War and Its Legacy* [Boston, Mass.: Houghton Mifflin, 2002]).

Eyre Hutson, Governor, British Honduras, to
Leslie Probyn, Governor, Jamaica

Government House, Belize,
2nd. July 1921

Sir,

I have the honour to acknowledge the receipt of your telegram of the 30th. ultimo, reporting the departure of Marcus Garvey for British Honduras. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your Excellency's most obedient servant,

EYRE HUTSON
Governor

JA, CSO Records 1B/5/52. TLS. Marked "Confidential."

JULY 1921

Article in the *Miami Herald*¹

[[Miami, Florida, July 2, 1921]]

KIDNAP NEGRO PREACHER; CAUSE RACE RIOT ALARM;
BRIDGE GUARD SHOOTS 2

POLICE, WITH MACHINE GUNS AND ARMED VETERANS RUSHED TO QUELL
INCIPIENT REVOLT IN COCONUT GROVE

INCITED BY RACIAL EQUALITY SERMONS

BELIEVE VICTIM WAS SLAIN; 25 NEGROES DISARMED;
ONE BLACK WOUNDED AND WHITE MAN IS ALSO HIT

The kidnapping tonight of the Rev. H. [R.] H. Higgs,² a negro Baptist preacher, who has been conducting revival services in Coconut Grove,³ because of his alleged doctrines of racial equality, resulted in a riot call being sent to Miami, the dispatch of several automobile loads of policemen with machine guns and the shooting of two men here.

Higgs was taken away by four men in an automobile and it is thought that he was lynched, but a search by the sheriff and his deputies for his body was fruitless.

When the commotion began, all former service men here were called out and were thrown about the roads to prevent a gathering of negroes. One negro who failed to halt when commanded to do so was fired upon by a guard with a shotgun and was seriously wounded. A white man passing was slightly injured.

REPORTED NEGROES ARMING

The local police station and the sheriff's office received the call for aid over the telephone at about 9:30 p.m., last night from Policeman O. L. Kennedy at Coconut Grove. It was requested that every available officer in Miami be sent at once to Coconut Grove as a negro preacher had been kidnapped by four armed men in an automobile, and that it was reported the negroes were arming themselves and swearing vengeance against the whites. Officer Kennedy also stated that armed negroes had already fired into two automobiles occupied by white people but that so far no one had been injured.

Every police officer and deputy sheriff in the city, with the exception of the best officers, was immediately dispatched to Coconut Grove, and the officers arrested and disarmed more than 25 negroes, arresting nine negroes, lodging three in the city jail. According to the officers, all the negroes arrested and even those disarmed, were armed with shotguns or pistols. None of the negroes offered any resistance. The negroes arrested by the police were released early this morning, while those arrested by the sheriff's men were still lodged in the county jail at 3 a.m. this morning.

VETERANS CALLED OUT

Following the dispatching of the officers to Coconut Grove, A. J. Cleary, commander of the Harvey Seeds Post, No. 29, American Legion, called out every member of the local legion here who could be located and these men were ordered to report at police headquarters where they were armed with rifles and shotguns. The door to Chief Raymond Dillon's office containing the case of rifles and shotguns kept by the police for riot duty was unlocked and the case broken open and the arms distributed among the legion men as Chief Dillon could not be located at the time and no one else had a key to the case.

Cleary then opened the two cases containing two Lewis automatic rifles and a squad of men, consisting of Sergt. E. C. Allen, vice-commander of the local post; K. W. Pratt, H. M. Barton, L. V. Martin and others, were loaded into a truck and rushed to Coconut Grove where one machine gun was mounted in the center of the town in order to command all approaches. Deputy Sheriff K. W. Clow, of Palm Beach County, was assigned to the duty of keeping the Coconut Grove officers and legion men in touch with Miami.

GUARDS PLACED ON BRIDGE

Guards of ex-service men and others were placed on every bridge in and near both Miami and Coconut Grove with orders to halt every person. These guards were withdrawn at about 1 a.m., after the affair had quieted down.

The men who kidnapped Higgs, it is said, walked up to the house occupied by him and told him that he was under arrest, at the same time placing handcuffs on both wrists, he was placed in the car which dashed off at a high rate of speed.

Shortly after the car left his home he began yelling for help. He was soon silenced and when the car occupied by the armed men arrived near the Rice Packing Company, four other automobiles all occupied by a large number of men joined the first car and the entire procession headed in a westerly direction.

FIRE ON AUTOMOBILE

Within a few minutes after the kidnapping of the negro, two cars occupied by white people dashed into Coconut Grove, the passengers reporting that armed negroes had fired into their cars. The members of the Lindsey De Garmo legion post at Coconut Grove were immediately called into service and a call for aid sent into the sheriff's office and the police station at Miami.

Within a few minutes after the autoists had reported that negroes had fired into their cars, hundreds of armed men arrived at Coconut Grove and the men led by officers proceeded to go through colored town disarming all negroes they met up with and telling them to disperse and go home and keep quiet.

A party of citizens and officers then proceeded to secure the country in the direction the armed white men with Higgs had taken but no trace had been

found of him or the kidnappers up to a late hour this morning. The officers and the citizens expressed the opinion that Higgs, who was born and reared at Nassau, probably had been lynched or else taken into the woods and whipped and warned to leave the country.

PREACHES RACE EQUALITY

According to citizens of Coconut Grove, Higgs has been conducting a negro revival meeting at a negro church in colored town for the past ten days and it was alleged that he had been preaching social equality of the races to the negroes and had on numerous occasions declared that a negro was just as good as a white man.

The citizens of Coconut Grove expressed the opinion that the armed men were probably members of a secret order.

The Miami police station resembled a small sized arsenal between the hours of 10 p.m. and 1 a.m., this morning, due to the many armed men on guard at the station. The remaining Lewis gun was mounted in the call room and the drums loaded with shells ready to be carried to any place where it would likely be needed. The gun was manned by a number of local legion men.

ALL QUIET AT 3 A.M.

Everything was reported quiet a[t] Coconut Grove at 3 a.m., today and the officers and citizens stated that they anticipated no more trouble. A searching party will be sent out again this morning to search for Higgs, Officer Kennedy stated.

When the rumors of the trouble were received here scores of cars were soon on their way to that little suburb and within one-half hour after the report was received at the local police station hundreds of men had arrived at the scene of the kidnapping.

Mayor W. P. Smith and other city officials including various county officers and Sheriff Louis A. Allen mingled with the armed men and cautioned them to be careful of their action and not to take any hasty action that might lead to a riot here.

Printed in *MH*, 2 July 1921.

1. The *Miami Herald*, founded in 1903, was the South Florida newspaper with the largest circulation (Nixon Smiley, *Knights of the Fourth Estate: The Story of the "Miami Herald"* [Miami, Fla.: E. A. Seemann, 1974]).

2. Richard Henry Higgs (b. 1879), minister of the St. James Baptist Church in Coconut Grove, Dade County, Florida, migrated in 1898 from the Bahamas to Florida, settling in 1900 in Key Largo, Monroe County (Ancestry.com, *U.S., World War I Draft Registration Cards, 1917-1918* [online database; Provo, Utah: Ancestry.com Operations, 2005]; Ancestry.com, *1900 United States Federal Census* [online database; Provo, Utah: Ancestry.com Operations, 2004]).

3. The Miami neighborhood of Coconut Grove was formed in 1925, when the city of Miami annexed the city of Coconut Grove and most of the town of Silver Bluff. It is considered the oldest continuously inhabited modern neighborhood of Miami, Florida. The name has sometimes been spelled "Cocoanut Grove," but the definitive spelling of "Coconut Grove" was established when the city was incorporated in 1919 (Grant Livingston, "The Annexation of the City of Coconut Grove," *Tequesta: The Journal of the Historical Association of Southern Florida* 60 [2000]: 32-55).

Article in the *Miami Herald*

[Miami, Florida, July 3, 1921]

KIDNAPPING BARES PLOT TO KILL WHITES IN KEY WEST

HIGGS ALLEGED COMPLICITY THOUGHT TO HAVE LEAD [LED]
TO COCONUT GROVE INCIDENT;

DECLARE DAY HAD BEEN SET FOR WHOLESALE POISONINGS

An address by H. [R.] H. Higgs, head of a local negro secret society, before a gathering of negroes in Key West, in which Higgs not only endorsed racial equality and inter-marriage, but advocated the supremacy of the negro and the use of violent measures to bring this about, was the original cause of the threatened clash between the races at Coconut Grove Friday night, the authorities here have been informed on apparently reliable authority.

This Key West speech is said to have been followed up by others in which Higgs addressed the members of his lodge and other gatherings of negroes at Coconut Grove and elsewhere in this vicinity and in which he carried on his propaganda with reference to the intermarriage of the races and the use of violence in intimidating the whites.

WATCHED FOR WEEKS

Higgs has been under surveillance for several weeks, the authorities having been informed of his activities both at Key West and here and were also informed that the negro Garvin [Garvey], publisher of a northern negro periodical, met Higgs in Key West and provided him with the propaganda which he assiduously spread here and in Key West.

When Higgs was taken from his home at Coconut Grove Friday night by eight men, his followers and fellow lodge members started the trouble which caused nine of their members to be brought to Miami late Friday night and locked in jail.

According to the story told by Higgs yesterday morning to Sheriff Louis A. Allen, County Detective Jack Adams and L. E. Howe, local agent for the department of justice, Higgs was taken to a spot on Ft. Lonesome road, four miles west of Larkin, and there given the choice of leaving the United States or taking the consequences.

LASHED WITH ROPE

He was tied and placed face downward on the ground and a rope-end was used to impress on him an understanding that the eight men meant business. A rope was placed about his neck and he was told, he informed the officers, that it

would be best for him to leave the United States and do it speedily. He was given his choice, he said, and he promised to leave on the next boat for Nassau.

Mr. Howe said he was satisfied no local men were involved in the admonition given Higgs. This statement was further borne out by an assertion by Higgs, who declared he heard no names mentioned, but that each of the white men was addressed by an appellation which indicated he had come from a distant city, one being Detective Havana, a third Detective Palatka and the fourth Detective Key West. He did not recall the names applied to the other four.

LEAVING FOR NASSAU

Sheriff Allen asked Higgs what the men had told him and was informed that they told him to leave the country at once.

"What are you going to do?" Sheriff Allen asked.

"I am going to leave," Higgs replied. He added that he would depart on the next boat leaving Miami for Nassau.

Higgs, a native of Harbor Island, one of the Bahama Island group, has been a resident of the United States 20 years, he told the officer's yesterday morning.

But he has never become a citizen of the United States, and said he never did so because he didn't have any occasion to do so. He appeared to be well educated.

The secret organization of which Higgs was president was known as the United Negro Improvement Association and is said to have been a clandestine branch of the Overseas Club.¹

It is known that a branch of the British Overseas Club was organized some time since in this vicinity and to have been disbanded because not authorized and not conducted along the lines intended by the parent organization. The U.N.I.A. is said to be an outgrowth of this clandestine lodge. Ninety percent of its members are Bahama Island negroes.

Sheriff Allen also declared it is his belief that no local men had any connection with the whipping of Higgs, and said he had no idea as to who the eight men were. Neither did Higgs know. He told the sheriff he would not be able to identify any of them, and could not even guess.

KEY WEST POISON PLOT

Under pressure, Higgs admitted making the speeches in Key West alluded to by the officers and to have made others in this vicinity, but maintained he [did] not know of a plot said to have been formed in Key West and having for its purpose the wholesale murder of white men, women and children by their negro servants.

The officers believe that Higgs was either directly involved in this plot, was implicated in some manner or at least had knowledge of it. The plan included the poisoning of families by their cooks, a concerted movement hav-

ing been made in this direction and a day and hour set when the plot was to be put into execution.

Prompt action by the officers alone is said to have prevented the carrying out of this plan, but he denies participation in it.

According to information to Sheriff Allen yesterday, when Higgs was seized by the white men at his home and handcuffed, his cries apprized his friends of his capture and they armed themselves and, incited by Fred Higgs, a brother of the negro preacher,² they started along the road toward the white settlement.

Telephone messages to police headquarters and the sheriff's office in Miami to the effect that a riot impended, sent every available officer hurrying to Coconut Grove and caused a response by the local post of the American Legion and the Coconut Grove post. Citizens of Coconut Grove and Miami, expecting trouble, hastened toward the scene of trouble. All armed with various weapons.

DISARM BODY OF NEGROES

One car contained George M. Okell, justice of the peace for the Miami district, John W. Bishop, detective; Policeman Fred Barton and J. W. Crittington, a chauffeur. These men encountered a body of armed negroes, and while Crittington turned the spot light on them, Bishop covered them with a riot gun and disarmed them. They were handed over to Sheriff Allen and brought to Miami.

Three negroes, placed under arrest and in jail yesterday awaiting developments, are said to have fired at an automobile, containing a white man and his wife, and also to have shot at Red Glisson, a watchman at Coconut Grove. They are Joe Springer, Anthony McCloud and Jim Lee. They were arrested by Deputy Sheriff Albin, Chief of Police Rex Williams, of Coconut Grove, and O.L. Kennedy, a policeman of Coconut Grove.

John Flowers, another negro, was found in possession of a gun and was arrested for having a concealed weapon on his person. Mack Pherson, Fred Higgs, Will Solomon, Eli Haymen and Robert Dunn are charged with inciting a riot.

Higgs, Baptist preacher and head of the United Negro Improvement Association, was at his home yesterday afternoon awaiting the sailing of the next boat for Nassau on which he said he would obtain passage for the Bahamas, never to return to the United States.

Late yesterday afternoon Sheriff Allen said he anticipated no further trouble as the situation was well in hand. While at Coconut Grove yesterday Sheriff Allen talked to a group of negroes, telling them that if they conducted themselves properly he would protect them from violence and that in fact no violence would be done [to] them unless they started out looking for trouble. His talk seemed to have a quieting effect on them for they dispersed and went to their homes.

Printed in *MH*, 3 July 1921.

JULY 1921

1. The widely held notion that the Overseas Club was the parent organization of the UNIA prompted concerted attacks on both groups in July 1921. In addition to the kidnapping of Higgs, there was an attack by hooded whites on a white Irish Episcopal priest, Philip Irwin, believed to be the tactical and spiritual leader of the Overseas Club. Irwin, like Higgs, was taken from his home under cover of darkness. He was then beaten, tarred, and feathered, only to be removed from his post by church leaders who feared Irwin's continued presence would inspire further violence ("Tarred and Feathered," *The Independent*, 17 September 1921). Ironically, Philip Irwin, John LeMansey, and other leaders of the Overseas Club vowed to purge from the group's ranks any member who joined the UNIA or even vaguely supported the association's program of black nationalism ("Disclaim Responsibility," *Miami Herald*, 6 July 1921).

2. Fred Higgs (b. 1874), a laborer in Coconut Grove, Florida, was born on Harbour Island, The Bahamas, and became a naturalized U.S. citizen on 9 November 1942 (Ancestry.com, *U.S., World War I Draft Registration Cards, 1917-1918* [online database; Provo, Utah: Ancestry.com Operations, 2005]; National Archives Southeast Region, Morrow, Ga., *Southern District of Florida [Miami Division], Petitions for Naturalization, 1913-1991*, vols. 47-49).

Cecil Clementi, Officer Administering the Government, British Guiana, to Leslie Probyn, Governor, Jamaica

GOVERNMENT HOUSE,
Georgetown, Demerara,
4th July, 1921

Sir,

I have the honour to acknowledge, with thanks, the receipt of Your Excellency's telegram of the 30th June which, decoded, reads:

Marcus Garvey and three colleagues left Jamaica 28th June in s.s. "Canadian Fisher" for Belize to conduct propaganda in British Honduras. It is understood that this change in plan is in consequence of defects which prevent s.s. "Kanawha" Black Star Line leaving port of Kingston.

I have the honour to be, Sir, Your Excellency's obedient servant,

C. CLEMENTI
Officer Administering
the Government

JA, CSO Records 1B/5/52. TLS, recipient's copy. Marked "Confidential" and "No. 3929."

Telford H. Williams, Assistant Secretary,
UNIA Niquero Division, in the *Negro World*

[[Oriente de Cuba, ca. 4 July 1921]]

UNVEILING OF CHARTER OF NIQUERO DIVISION,
ORIENTE DE CUBA

Sunday evening, July 4, at half past three in the midst of an interested audience, with surrounding joys, the members of the Niquero Division "tackled the thing they wanted done and did it." To have a chartered division[.] The evening was bright and weather fair, and the program was put through by the speed of Almighty God. Our Liberty Hall was prettily decorated with flags of the Red, Black and Green and Cuban flag. Never before had we such a gathering.

The president, Mr. L. A. Hall, stood at the chair and, with much zeal and capability performed the task entrusted him. The opening address that he gave was a lengthy, vigorous and heart-winning one. It seemed to have made brighter and stronger the golden cord that builds our hearts in racial love. It could be philosophically seen in the visitors, that their hearts were melted to moral flexibility. This address was followed by the singing of "Onward Christian Soldiers." When the melodious sound swelled in the roof it seemed to answer back to us, "Jesus is saying, hold on! hold on, victory is nigh, joy to ye Negroes. Africa shall be free."

The treasurer, Mr. George Pennant gave a recitation that brought animation to the people and encouraged them to unite, one and all for the common good of Africa, the land of Ham.

Mr. Edwin F. Bailey gave an address that also added to the success of the day. It brought concentration to our hearts. It strengthened our spirit to keep united under the banners of the Red, Black and the Green. The unveiling of the charter came next. It was unveiled by Miss Salome Brown and Miss Rosetta Brown, and the treasurer read it to the audience. The choir then rendered a song, "On, March On." The next was a recitation by Miss Rosetta Brown.

The treasurer gave a short and impressive address. Time did not permit him to say much, so he gave a short, sweet, encouraging one for us to hold on still, because the movement is a divine one and it cannot fail. Mr. H. A. Hall gave another recitation. It was so well rendered that the audience clamored for repetition.

The choir gave another song. Then we had a short address by the assistant secretary. He gave a lot of jokes. Miss Salome Brown gave another recitation that brought thunderous applause. The assistant secretary gave a little talk, telling how the thing that was considered difficult has been tackled by Negroes and they did it. The president gave the benediction and the meeting was terminated by singing the Doxology.

The program was as follows:

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Opening Hymn—The Ode.
Prayer—From Constitution.
Address—President's.
Song—"Onward Christian Soldiers,[""] by Choir.
Recitation—"The Land of Ham," by Mr. George Pennant.
Solo—Mrs. Eva Grant.
Recitation—"Christian Soldiers," by J. E. Campbell.
Address—Vice-President.
Unveiling of the Charter.
Song—No. 1098, by the Choir.
Recitation—"Our Nation," by Miss Rosetta Brown.
Address—By Treasurer.
Recitation—"The Mother Church," by Mr. H. A. Hall.
Song—No. 752, by Choir.
Address—Assistant Secretary.
Recitation—"Our Fatherland," by Miss Salome Brown.
Recitation—"Don't Give Up the Ship," by Mr. H. A. Hall.
Recitation—"As He Tackled the Thing," by Assistant Secretary.
Benediction and Doxology.

TELFORD H. WILLIAMS
Assistant Secretary

Printed in NW, 6 August 1921.

W. J. H. Taylor,¹ British Vice-consul,
Key West, Florida to Tom Ffennell Carlisle,²
British Consul, New Orleans

Key West, Fla. July 5th 1921

Sir:

I have the honour to refer to your CIRCULAR no 161/21 "NEGRO ACTIVITIES IN THIS DISTRICT" and beg to further report to you on this subject as follows:

A negro Marcus Garvey said to be editor of the "Negro World" published in New York U.S.A. came to Key West from New York and started the organization of a secret society to be called the United Negro Improvement Association. Garvey was successful in obtaining n[u]merous applicants and after the organization it is said information started to leak out disclosing its purpose to be to incite the negroes to use violence to obtain its assumed rights. It was said that threats were made to the negro population here to join this organization

otherwise the organization would use its efforts and prevent them from obtaining or h[o]lding positions in the community.

It seems that the better class of the negro element resented the efforts of this organization or organizer and the Society and readily supplied information to the authorities upon which his Secretary one T. C. Gla[s]hen was arrested together with others and after the arrest of Gla[s]hen he concluded to leave Key West and departed for Havana Cuba.

During the time of the arrest conditions looked bad but calmness on the part of the authorities together with riot drills held by the Marines prevented any trouble in this Community.

One [R.] H. Higgs[,], pastor of one of the coloured churches in this city for years, came under the influence of Garvey and went to Miami and there created some trouble as will appear by a clipping taken from the Miami Herald of July 3rd 1921. Copy of same is enclosed herewith.³

It is said that Higgs expects to leave M[ia]mi for Nassau and it is anticipated that no further difficulty will be had and it is reported that the organization [ha]s broken up.

I may also say that the United States has sent an additional of eight[y] (80) soldiers to the post here.

I have the honor to be sir, your most obedient servant

W. J. H. TAYLOR
British Vice Consul

No. 70/21

PRO, FO 115/2690. TLS, recipient's copy.

1. William John Hamilton Taylor served as British vice-consul of Key West and Miami, Fla. (U.S. Department of State, *Register*, 1924, [Washington D.C.: Government Printing Office, 1924], pp. 268, 283).

2. Tom Ffennell Carlisle was the British consul general for Alabama, Louisiana, Florida, and Mississippi from January 1927 (U.S. Department of state, *Register*, 1918 [Washington D.C.: Government Printing Office, 1918], p. 234).

3. The enclosure was not retained.

Article in the *Miami Herald*

[Miami, Florida, July 5, 1921]

COMMUNICATIONS

DISCLAIM RESPONSIBILITY

Editor Miami Herald: Will you kindly allow us a space in your columns to set ourselves as members of the Miami Branch of The Universal Negro Improvement Association in a right relation to the wrong conception that seems to exist in the minds of the public; because of the activities of that division here in Miami. First we wish to state that we are in no manner connected with the

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resent trouble at Coconut Grove, of which the Rev. H. [R.] H. Higgs was the central figure.

We wish to refute a certain statement made in the columns of the Metropolis under the caption, "Negroes Raise Funds to Send Higgs Etc." We beg to state that our branch of the U.N.I.A. did not raise a collection for that purpose on Sunday afternoon.

We also desire to have it understood that the U.N.I.A., of this city, is and has been grossly misrepresented as to its object. We are not as you seem to have been informed an offspring of the Overseas Club. The association had its origin in city of New York some three years ago, and now has hundreds of branches all over the U.S., the British colonies and other parts of the world, where men of African origin are. It is not a seditious body, as many seem to think, but is organized for the general uplift of the negro race. Its official organ is the Negro World, a weekly, having a subscription list that runs into hundreds of thousands. The U.N.I.A. is widely known in other parts of the world. It is frequently discussed in the white press. The World's Work Magazine of December, 1920, and January 1921, carried an article dealing at length with one movement and its founder. Its contribution and by-laws may be inspected at any time by the public, by getting in touch with the president, and our doors are thrown open to officials of the city, who may visit us on Friday nights at our meeting place, 171 N.W. Eleventh Terrace, or our Sunday afternoon meetings.

Thanking you for the space allowed we remain,
Yours truly,

The Universal Negro Improvement Assn.

Printed in *MH*, 5 July 1921.

Article in the *Miami Herald*

[Miami, Florida, July 5th, 1921]

WILL TRY NEGROES ON RIOTING CHARGE

MEMBERS OF SECRET SOCIETY PLEDGE MONEY TO PAY HIGGS' PASSAGE
TO BAHAMA ISLANDS

Solicitor Fred W. Pine, of the criminal court said yesterday that he intends filing information's against the negroes seized in connection with the near-riot at Coconut Grove Friday night, some of whom fired into an automobile containing a man and a woman and also at James (Red) Glisson, a watchman at Coconut Grove.

Negro members of the United Negro Improvement Association, said to be a clandestine branch of the Overseas Club, are reported to have raised a

purse for the Rev. H.H. Higgs, president of their lodge and Baptist preacher, so that he might have the wherewith to begin life anew in the Bahama Islands.

Higgs is understood to have promised eight white men who took him from his home Friday night to a spot four miles west of Larkin that he would return to the Bahamas if they would agree not to harm him further, and to have told Sheriff Louis A. Allen and others Saturday morning that he intends keeping his promise, leaving for Nassau on the first boat.

It was said at the city dock yesterday that no vessels cleared for Nassau during the day and therefore, Higgs is still here. He came from Harbor Island,¹ one of the outer islands of the Bahama group more than twenty years ago, but never became a citizen of the United States.

Mayor Hugh Mattheson, of Coconut Grove, is said to have requested Police-man O.L. Kennedy to hand in his resignation as a member of the police force of Coconut Grove, because of his telephoning to Miami for aid Friday night when negroes began arming there after Higgs was taken from his home by the eight white men. The mayor believed the Coconut Grove authorities capable of handling the situation.

Policeman Kennedy is reported to have told the mayor he was unable to get in touch with Chief of Police Rex Williams, and that the thought it time to act when the negroes began arming themselves as if they intended starting a riot.

Printed in *MH*, 5 July 1921.

1. Harbour Island forms part of the Out Islands of the Bahamas. Famous for its pink sand beaches found along the east side of the island, it is located off the northeast coast of Eleuthera Island.

Article in the *Miami Herald*

[Miami, Florida, July 6, 1921]

NO CORRECTION

Editor Miami Herald: I wish to call your attention to the fact that the British Overseas Club is not and never has been associated or connected in any way with the Universal Negro Improvement Association and if such is the case that some of the members of the Overseas Club have seen fit to become members of the U.N.I.A. they are no longer recognized by the Overseas Club.

The reason that I wish this to be made public is: that owing to the late disturbance at Coconut Grove the U.N.I.A. has been taken in relationship to the Overseas Club and I object to this upon these grounds: that the overseas Club is a patriotic league and is a non-party society of British subjects residing in all parts of the world, its underlying motive is to promote the unity of British subjects.

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Its four chief objects are:

1. To draw together in the bond of comradeship British people the world over
2. To render individual service to our empire
3. To maintain the power of our empire and to hold to its best traditions
4. To help one another

The United Negro Improvement Association is not formed upon these lines, and their ideas and methods of working would not be allowed by the Overseas Club.

This said club is known as the Overseas Club and Patriotic League, incorporated the League of the Empire.

Patron, His Britannic Majesty King George Fifth, and is supervised here by Mr. J. F. Bethel, honorable corresponding secretary.

It is strictly impressed upon every member of the Overseas Club that they must abide by and uphold the laws in the country in which they reside, and if it is known to me that they do not comply with the laws of this country and state, I have power, as representative in His Majesty's government, to deal with them in the strictest form.

I have the honor to be sir,

Your obedient servant,
ARTHUR H. HUBBARD
British Consul

Printed in *MH*, 6 July 1921.

Article in the *Miami Herald*

[Miami, Florida, July 6, 1921]

HIGGS TAKES FINAL VOYAGE FROM MIAMI

NEGRO PREACHER WHOSE TEACHINGS WERE CAUSE OF TROUBLE
SAILS FOR HIS NATIVE HEATH

Rev. H. [R.] H. Higgs, negro minister, advocate of race equality and inter-marriage of the races, is on his way to Nassau, never to return. He left yesterday evening on board the British gas boat Maysie A., from the Municipal docks, where a large crowd of colored people from Miami and Coconut Grove had congregated to give him a send-off.

It was the teachings of Higgs at his church in Coconut Grove that brought him under the displeasure of eight white men. Identity unknown, who on Friday night last, carried the negro away from his home in Coconut Grove, and sent him back with just 48 hours' notice to leave the country for good. The kidnapping of Higgs alarmed the negro population of Coconut Grove and for several hours a great deal of uneasiness was manifested among them. Several armed negroes were arrested and lodged in jail.

GIVES NEGROES ADVICE

When Sheriff Louis A. Allen yesterday morning released from the county jail Mack Pierson, Robert Dunn, Eli Haymen and Will Solomon, negroes, charged with inciting to riot during the disturbance, the sheriff told them that at any future time they felt they needed guns for their protection he would furnish the guns and also the men to shoot the guns.

"I want each of you to remember you are a negro, and stay in a negro's place; you will have no trouble then," he told them.

"If you need protection, call up my office and you will get it, as long as you behave yourselves. I am going to see that the law is enforced."

BREAKS SHOT GUNS ON WALL

The sheriff took the shotguns with which the negroes had armed themselves Friday night and smashed them one by one over a concrete wall in the jail yard.

Five other negroes arrested at the same time are out on bail and will be given a preliminary examination by County Judge W. Frank Blanton at 10 a.m. Friday. Each has been arrested on two charges, one for unlawful assembly and the other for firing into an automobile, the latter by virtue of a special statute similar to the one providing a penalty for firing into a train.

Printed in *MH*, 6 July 1921.

Report by Bureau of Investigation Agent
Leon E. Howe

Miami, Fla. 7/6/21

REV. R. H. HIGGS (BAHAMA NEGRO)
FORMER VICE-PRES.

JULY 1921

U.N.I.A. AT COCONUT GROVE, FLA. DEPORTED BY
K[U] KLUX KLAN.

Subject left MIAMI July 5 on the British gas boat MAISIE, for NASSAU, BAHAMA ISLANDS, N[ew] P[rovidence], following a whipping given him by four masked men, and orders to leave the United States within 48 hours.

OSCAR JOHNSON, Financial Secretary of the Miami branch of the U.N.I.A., was a passenger on the same boat. He is also an alien. Agent is informed that he became frightened on account of the treatment given to HIGGS at COCONUT GROVE and to GLASHEN at KEY WEST. In the opinion of agent, JOHNSON was not warned to leave as was HIGGS. Further Report.

LEON E. HOWE

DNA, RG 65, file BS 217184-2. TD.

“E. A. L.” in the *Clarion*

[British Honduras, July 7, 1921]

AN HONOUR CONFERRED ON THE COLONY

Mr. Marcus Garvey has travelled through the vast United States, Canada and the West Indies and on returning from these places he has always left with the same party which has accompanied him from New York. British Honduras is, up to now, the last place Mr. Garvey has visited and in coming here he has made a discovery—a wonderful discovery. He has found in a young man of Belize—a son of the soil, one who with some training, he says, can be of some assistance to him in his great world-wide movement; the young man I refer to is Samuel Alfred Haynes. At a meeting of the U.N.I.A. held in their quarters on Monday night at which the Mr. Garvey gave an address, Mr. Haynes was present and was privileged to give a speech; the fearless man[ner] he spoke for the cause of U.N.I.A, backed up by the earnestness he showed coupled with his brilliancy of speech, did not escape the notice of Mr. Garvey. He at once decided that in young Haynes he found the sort of man he wants and immediately offered to take him to New York. Haynes will be leaving on Tuesday next the 12th inst, for one of the neighbouring republic's where he will meet Mr. Garvey and accompany him to New York. Mr. Haynes is a member of the Wesley Old Boys Brigade Association and as a member of that body also, I may assure him that we are proud of him—proud that such a noble choice has been made from one of our numbers. It reflects give credit on the Association, more than all it reflects still greater credit on the Colony, and it is an honour conferred on British Honduras. The W.O.B.B.A. will bid him farewell on Friday

night. I predict a bright future for Mr. Haynes and as a friend of his I conclude by saying—

Courage, brother! do not stumble;
Though thy path be dark as night;
There's a star to guide the humble:
Trust in God, and do the right.

Printed in *CL*, 7 July 1921.

“E. A. L.” in the *Clarion*

[British Honduras, July 7, 1921]

MR MARCUS GARVEY AND MISS HENRIETTA VINTON DAVIS GIVE STIRRING ADDRESSES

The writer of this article had the pleasure to be present at St. Mary's Hall on Saturday night last when Mr. Marcus Garvey President General of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and world famed negro orator, and Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis, International Organizer of the Association gave addresses at the mass meeting held for the purpose. The attendance was not large but those who availed themselves of the opportunity given, certainly did not regret being present to hear the powerful orations which were delivered. The meeting was presided over [b]y the 1st Vice President of the local Division of the Association, Mr. W. M. Campbell, besides the Chairman, Mr. Marcus Garvey and Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis, the platform was occupied by the following Officers and friends of the Association: Mr J. N. Anglin, Mr H. H. Cain, Mr C. M. Staine, Mr B. Adderly, Mr and Mrs. I. E. Morter, Mr D. Belizario, Mrs Joe, Miss Eva Cain and Miss V. Seay. Among the audience we noted the following persons: The Colonial Secretary, Col. and Mrs. Max Smith, the Asst. Colonial Secretary H. E. and Mrs Phillips, The Supt. of Police, Capt. Cavenaugh, Mr F. R. Dragten and Mr R. K. Masson.¹

The meeting was opened with the hearty singing of, “From Greenland's Icy Mountains” followed by a fitting prayer by the Chaplain, Mr J. N. Anglin in which he prayed for the advancement of the Negro race and for the delivery of the right message by the speakers, he also prayed that the people may bear in mind their allegiance to the King. Their flag and the Empire to which they belong. The Chairman then called on Mr B. Adderly to welcome the distinguished party. Mr. Adderley in a few but well chosen remarks extended on behalf of the members of the U.N.I.A. a hearty welcome to the visitors. He made reference to Mr. Garvey's last visit to the Colony about 11 years ago; he spoke of the significance surrounding the present visit of Mr Garvey. He

remarked that Mr Garvey was not received with the great ovation when he last visited Belize as he has been received with to-day; the name of Mr. Marcus Garvey is an household one he said; the speaker in concluding, again heartily welcomed to these shores the distinguished party. A selection was then played by the Union Band which was in attendance, followed by the following items which were all well rendered and well received: A song by Mr R. A. Arthurs, a recitation by Mr S. A. Haynes, a song by Mrs. Stamp, a violin solo by Mr George Squires and a song by Mr N. E. Willis. Mr H. Ferrel presided at the piano for all the vocal items. After the above items were rendered, the Chairman called on Mr. J. N. Anglin to introduce to the audience Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis. Mr. Anglin remarked how pleased he was in doing so, he said that he has heard several orators but nothing had ever stirred him so much as when he read the speech of Miss Davis after she visited Jamaica, he said that he was perfectly sure that once hearing Miss Davis, the people would always crave the opportunity of hearing her again, and right here the writer may endorse those words. Miss Davis then addressed the gathering. She said it afforded her the greatest pleasure to address the people and remarked of her inability to find words that would describe the impressions made on her since she has arrived. Not only the scenery of the city is she taken with but above all the hospitality of the people. "I find Belize indeed a Home Sweet Home" said Miss Davis. She is pleased to see the strong hold the U.N.I.A. has taken on the people. Ever since she saw the delegate from British Honduras at the Convention, it was her desire to visit Belize, but said that up to a week ago she did not have any dreams of coming here; on being told that she was to come here she was glad she said; she remarked that she would also go with pleasure to any other part of the world so long as it is for the cause of the U.N.I.A. Miss Davis said she was pleased to hear that the local Division of the Association is endeavouring to acquire a Liberty Hall of their own where they can meet together and freely discuss the possibilities for the advancement of the Negro race.² "No matter where we go the inspiration we gathered in Liberty Hall goes with us," she said. Only a few years ago since Mr. Marcus Garvey came to New York and started the movement with only thirteen members and to [*words illegible*] Miss Davis of the wonderful advancement made from such a small nucleus. She made mention of the success of the Steamship Corporation as a proof of the advancement the U.N.I.A. is making.

[“]It matters not what language we may speak, what countries we may live in: some may want to deny their Negro blood, but for me I am proud of the Negro blood that flows in my veins; it is just as good as any other blood that flows in any other veins,” says Miss Davis. Continuing she said, “Thank God a man from the beautiful island of Jamaica has brought the message to the negroes—a man who stands for right and justice for his people.”

“We are not seeking any man’s crown, any man’s territory, we are just asking for that which God has given us—our Country.”

“Might has been made right but no longer shall it be; I bid you keep cheerful, keep hopeful; one that is greater than I is here and shall deliver the message you are awaiting for.”

Miss Davis concluded by appealing to the people for their support because the upliftment of the U.N.I.A. means the upliftment of all she said. She was loudly applauded by the audience. Miss Davis is certainly a speaker of no mean ability and the sincerity she displayed in her speech, coupled with her flowery language, had the audience spell bound from [when] she commenced until she was through.

Mr. Campbell[,] the Chairman, then introduced Mr. Marcus Garvey to the audience. Mr. Campbell said that he knew Mr. Garvey when he was about 23 years of age here; he remarked that some time ago he unfolded a paper sent him which was the “Negro World” and therein he saw the name of the Hon. Marcus Garvey; after reading [about] him and his works, he said his ambition was stirred. Mr. Campbell mentioned the need for Co[-]operation among the people and said he was glad to see to learn to co-operate. Continuing he said, “British Honduras has really caught the Spirit of Negroism; our intention is to go forward[.]” In concluding he said, “I have pleasure in introducing to you the Hon. Marcus Garvey.”

Mr. Marcus Garvey then rose and was greeted with loud applause. In a ringing, emphatic and unmistakable tone, he elucidated the aims and objects of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. The honourable gentleman said i[t] gave him pleasure to speak to the people on the U.N.I.A. He remarked that the Association is endeavouring to link up Africa. “We are living in a world that is re-organizing itself, we must organize too,” he said[.]

Two millions of us coloured men from the United States of America, from Africa and from the British Islands went into the war; we were told to fight for the weaker people, for the democracy of the world. We fought nobly in France, Flanders, Mesopotamia and other parts. But when the war was over only the Negroes did not get freedom, but now we are determined; let there be freedom for the white man, the yellow man and let there be freedom for us, black men too. There should be a free and unfettered Africa, said Mr. Garvey. He remarked that the U.N.I.A. is organized in every West Indian Island, in all Central America, in the United States, Canada and in Africa and said that the 400 millions of the race are looking to the Association for their advancements[.] He said that he is appealing to the New Negro, the Negro of backbone who will stand for his right and if needs be even die for the cause. He made mention of the term given Negroes[,] [p]rior to the war, as missing links, but said that during the war, the negroes proved themselves men on the battlefields, super men. He spoke of the pluck and indomitable courage shown by the black man in the war in assisting to establish peace for the world, but said after the war was over all that was given the Negro was a “kick and a smile” and no freedom. Continuing Mr. Garvey said, [“]I believe that we have arrived at a stage of civilization when we can take care of ourselves, humanity anywhere desires free-

dom and the negro must have freedom." He strongly and clearly emphasized it that he did not come here to put fight, the black and the white, but what he is striving for is liberty for his people. He is not preaching disloyalty or sedition he said, therefore he hoped his remarks would not be misinterpreted. Continuing further the speaker said, "We have developed a new stage of enlightenment; we have a right at this stage of civilization to re-educate the negroes."

"In four year[s] we organized four millions into one organization and we all pulling together as one man." He remarked that it is not the intention of the Assn. to change the Government of British Honduras, or in any other Country, but the Negroes want to build a Government of its own. Mr. Garvey said that the U.N.I.A. wants men of learning, science, religion and men of engineering skill because they want to build up in Africa. The speaker said that when he first went over to New York to form the Steamship Corporation, the negroes were not able to pull together, and he did not meet with any encouragement, negroes like himself were opposing him, he said. A District Attorney in New York, Mr. Garvey said, challenged him that he would not be allowed to put his schemes into effect and did all he could have done to oppose him, but he told him he said, that even if the ships had to sail through the sea of human blood they must be floated. In two months time the speaker said there was a change among the negroes in New York; they were for the movement and in that short time \$185,000 was collected and the first ship the Yarmouth was bought from a Canadian firm and rechristened the s.s. Frederick Douglas. Thousands of people assembled to see the ship off for her maiden trip to Cuba where the Captain and Officers of the ship were received and royally treated by the President of that country as the standard bearers of the first Black Merchant Marine. Mr. Garvey remarked that during the present month the s.s. Phy[1]lis Wheatley the largest ship of the line which is 5000 tons will be leaving for Liberia, Africa with a very large number of negroes as pioneers to build up the country. In concluding the speaker appealed to the people for their support; thanked them for their attention and again emphatically expressed the hope that no one would leave the building with a wrong conception, misleading others that they are preaching sedition, disloyalty, etc.

Mr. Garvey then asked the audience to stand and sing the National Anthem, the hearty singing of which brought a most interesting meeting, long to be remembered, to a close. Similar meetings were held on Sunday in the C.U.s Theatre when Mr. Marcus Garvey and Miss Henrietta Vinton Davis appeared in their official robes. The last meeting was held in the U.N.I.A. Hall on Monday night when the visitors bade good-bye to the members of the Local Division.

Printed in *CL*, 7 July 1921.

1. R. K. Masson served as harbor master, as well as senior customs and excise officer, British Honduras (*COL*).

2. The Belize branch did purchase a Liberty Hall, which became the setting for regular meetings and cultural activities, but it was demolished by the devastating hurricane that hit the town in 1931. A new building was constructed on the old site in Barrack Road by 1934, but this was badly dam-

aged once more by the 1961 hurricane, and this time the organization lacked the money to repair it (Peter Ashdown, *Garveyism in Belize* [Benque Viejo del Carmen, Belize: Published for SPEAR for Cubola Productions, 1990], pp. 25-27).

Report by Bureau of Investigation Agent Leon E. Howe

Miami, Fla. 7/8/21

U.N.I.A.-MIAMI BRANCH

Reference is made to previous reports of agent on the U.N. I. A. activities in this section under captions "MARCUS GARVEY[,] "T. C. GLASHEN" and "R. H. HIGGS". Owing to the threatening attitude of white[s] toward colored persons in this section, agent devoted the past few days to ascertaining the extent of the activities of the U.N.I.A. in Miami, COCONUT GROVE, HOMESTEAD¹ and vicinity. In general, my investigation has shown that over 95 percent of the members and officers of the U.N.I.A. in these places are aliens, mainly Bahama negroes, and hence, BRITISH CITIZENS. A few are from the BARBADOS, HAITI, and JAMAICA. Of the membership in MIAMI, which numbers about 1,000, I have found only seven American negroes. Of the 690 members at KEY WEST, the proportion of American negroes is slightly larger. This condition is what has aroused the action of citizens in ordering GLASHEN and HIGGS to leave the United States, as negroes from the British islands are not accustomed to being restricted to certain districts, and bitterly resent the color line as drawn in Florida. Of the approximately 10,000 negroes in Miami, more than 7,000 are aliens.

In continuing the investigation of the Miami Branch of the U.N.I.A.[,] agent obtained all the books and papers of the organization for examination. These books contain detailed information of every meeting, financial status of each member, and extracts from speeches of various men including three speeches of JOTHAR W. NISHIDA,² an alleged HAWAI(I)AN, who is well known to the LOS ANGELES office of the Bureau as the owner of a revolutionary book shop in that city, and whose activities in MIAMI were covered in previous report of agent.

The official roll gives the following as officers: (All are aliens except those marked otherwise)

President REV. J. A. DAVIS (Am.), G. M. BROWN, J. R. TAYLOR and S. C. MCPHERSON, 1st., 2nd. and 3rd. vice-presidents, FINANCIAL SECRETARY OSCAR E. JOHNSON, ASSISTANT SEC. PERCY A. STYLES, TREASURER J. H. HOWARD, TRUSTEES—G. E. CARTER (Am), R. A. ROBERTS, PERCY A. STYLES, W. D. ROBINSON, F. BATES. ADVISORY BOARD—REV. S. H. CLARKE (Am.), E. C. GIBSON, HANNAH TAY-

LOR, J. H. HOWARD, G. M. BROWN, NATHANIEL ROLLE, S. C. MCPHERSON.

Ladies Division

PRESIDENT LILY FARRINGTON, VICE-PRES. NEJTIE TROUBLEFIELD,

SECRETARY EMMA ROLLE, ASST. SEC. OLGA MINUS, TREASURER ALICIA JOHNSON, (advisory board composed of men, all Bahama negroes).

Agent is forwarding copy of list of all members to the Jacksonville office of the Bureau as soon as it can be completed.

From a partial reading of the minutes of the organization, which go into minute detail, J. A. DAVIS and REV. DR. BROOKINGS, Presiding Elder of the Florida District A.M.E. Church, attended the first meeting and were influential in forming the organization. J. A. DAVIS, apparently had been soliciting members, and mention is made of both having attended the national convention held in WASHINGTON in August, 1920. The first meeting held was

September 16, 1920, so evidently DAVIS was appointed a district organizer, and immediately returned to Miami and went to work. From the speech of BROOKINGS, DAVIS evidently attended the convention on his own responsibility, and was not an elected delegate.

With the exception of DAVIS and CARTER, American negroes, all the active work of the organization was in the hands of the BAHAMA negroes, especially the financial matters. In this connection, OSCAR E. JOHNSON who left for NASSAU on the same boat with R. H. HIGGS of COCONUT GROVE is suspected of being short in his accounts. CARTER told agent that he had been elected delegate to the National Convention to be held in NEW YORK in AUGUST 1921, and that \$300 had been raised to defray his expenses, but that he believed that the money had been stolen by JOHNSON. As chairman of the trustees, he said it was his duty to audit the books and find out the shortage. CARTER is secretary of the colored Y.M.C.A. and says he entered the organization in order to strengthen his own work, but the minutes of the meetings indicate that he took an active part in everything, and made a speech every meeting.

The financial records indicate the organization took a year's lease on what is known as the old Airdrome Building in colored town, bought benches for the place, placed a huge sign on it reading "U.N.I.A. Miami Branch", purchased a motion picture machine, and otherwise seemed to be in a flourishing condition. The minutes indicate the average collections amounted to about \$25, this including subscriptions for stock in the BLACK STAR LINE, dues, and buttons, pamphlets, and copies of the [Negro] WORLD. At one time the organization seems to have had \$1,848.00 in the treasury.

The meeting place was known as LIBERTY HALL. The situation is very strained between white and colored citizens of the Miami district, and agent is expecting a recurrence of the race troubles which occurred during July and August last year.³ Reports from informants in colored town indicate the negroes are well supplied with arms and ammunition, which is no doubt the result of the action of city and state authorities in obtaining machine guns, riot guns, and ammunition in large quantities. When any race trouble threatens as in COCONUT GROVE recently, the American Legion, two companies of the National Guard, and hundreds of private citizens seize their guns, and any event might precipitate a riot. All white citizens seem to be convinced that a race war is sure to occur.

Since the affair at COCONUT GROVE the U.N.I.A. has not been meeting, and it is agent's opinion that they have been warned by citizens not to meet.

Agent will keep in touch with negro activities, and make further report from time to time.

LEON E. HOWE
[Endorsement] NOTED F.D.W

DNA, RG 65, file BS 198940-183. TD. Stamped endorsement.

1. Homestead is the second oldest city in Miami-Dade County, next to the city of Miami. Primarily a Miami suburb as well as a major agricultural area, it was incorporated in 1913. It is located approximately thirty-five miles southwest of Miami and twenty-five miles northwest of Key Largo, near the southern terminus of the Homestead extension of Florida's Turnpike.

2. Nishida served as the Los Angeles agent for the *Messenger* magazine and was reportedly its most successful salesman. The War Department's intelligence reports claimed that he was a member of the IWW as well as a translator of IWW publications into Asian languages (DNA, RG 165, file 10110-1241 and file 10218-364; DNA, RG 65, "Jothar Nishida, Radical Literature, 1919," reproduced in Theodore Kornweibel Jr., *Federal Surveillance of Afro-Americans [1917-1925]: The First World War, the Red Scare, and the Garvey Movement* [Frederick, Md.: University Publications of America, 1985], Casefile BS 215368, microfilm reel 7). Nishida was described by Max Eastman in the *Liberator* (March 1920) as "one of the most faithful, energetic, and intelligent distributors of radical literature in this country." Eastman complained that he had been indicted "for no crime whatever but that of conducting a wonderful Red International Book Store" in Los Angeles and was being held on excessive bail. Eastman wrote asking readers to send Nishida "some token of your appreciation" (quoted in J. Robert Constantine, ed., *Letters of Eugene V. Debs*, vol. 1, 1874-1912 [Urbana: University of Illinois Press, 1990], p. 60).

3. In late July 1920, Herbert Brooks, a black laborer from the Bahamas, was hunted down and apprehended after a fifty-five-year old white woman accused Brooks, her employee, of sexual assault ("Brooks Positively Identified as Assaulter of White Women," *Miami Herald*, 3 August 1920). Miami's white authorities sought and received the cooperation of prominent black Americans in tracking down Brooks. Select black business owners and veterans successfully apprehended Brooks on the promise that he would be given a fair trial. Shortly after being handed over to white authorities, however, Brooks "was reported to have been killed in a leap from a train taking him to Jacksonville for safe keeping" ("Negro Instantly Killed in Leap from Train," *Miami Herald*, 1 August, 1920). Members of Miami's West Indian community cried foul and held the city's black American elites principally responsible for Brooks's death. When it was rumored that a black American mortician would be the one responsible for readying Brooks's body for burial, some four hundred Bahamians and other West Indians, most of them members of the Overseas Club, took to the streets in protest. Violent altercations between what Arizona's *Tucson Daily Citizen* called a "Mob of Bahama Negroes" and groups of black Americans ensued, including shootouts in the streets and the targeted destruction of storefronts owned by U.S. blacks ("Miami Protected by Soldiers from Mob of Bahama Negroes," *Tucson Daily Citizen*, 3 August 1920). Miami's white authorities elected

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to deploy the National Guard around the border of Miami's Colored Town to keep the conflict contained. At the same time, within the neighborhood, black American entrepreneurs and forty members of Miami's Colored American Legion stood guard to protect black American businesses from further destruction. FBI agent Leon Howe, who was monitoring these events, noted in one of his field reports, "There is almost a state of war between English and American Negroes." Overseas Club members organized a widespread, if short-lived, boycott of all U.S. black-owned businesses in Miami's black neighborhood. In an attempt to placate the ongoing conflict between West Indian and American blacks, George Emonei Carter, a black American from New York, and Reverend Higgs of the Bahamas established the Miami chapter of the UNIA in the fall of 1920 (Nathan D. B. Connolly, *A World More Concrete: Real Estate and the Remaking of Jim Crow South Florida* [University of Chicago Press, 2014], chap. 2).

Christian Alexander Frederick to the *Negro World*

[[Guantanamo, Cuba, ca. 9 July 1921]]

RACIAL EXPERIENCE

Sir:—

I am indeed interested in this race march, and I do hereby beg of you space in your journal to express my experience.

In the first place, there is a large percentage of the Negro race who have not yet grasped this movement in its right sense. Some of our people are moving along with it, as if it is merely a benevolent society. Some have joined because they hear that seventy-five dollars will be given to bury them when they lie lifeless.

Some have joined because their ability reflects an influence on some of our people and affords them the opportunity to become officers. Some have joined because they think that their so-called intelligence serves to captivate some of the people in the community, and that they can have things their own way. Some of us have caught the spirit, as it came like whirlwind to rouse every Negro out of his slumber; we have opened our eyes and looked at the salvation.

Some are so dead that their eyes refuse to be opened, even though their fellowmen are trying to open them, as they can not open their own eyes, or will not. But the Negro who has a live spirit and a quick d[is]cerning eye must jump to his heels as the whirlwind passes over him. And seeing his fellowmen ascending the heights with His Excellency, Marcus Garvey at the top, soaring through the universe, he is compelled to fall in the line.

Other races are in the heights since civilization has taken a foothold, and the Negro had been given a tail heavy enough to keep him down in the dust and ashes, but the Almighty has caused a whirlwind to be in action, and move the Negroes to sweep off the dust, turn them over, break off the tails of those who had live spirits, and they have sprung to their heels and are in the flight.

The heavy head Negroes with their weighty tails ("although they have felt the breeze"), are saying to themselves that it is not possible for the race to elevate. But we want such Negroes to understand that a man can be what he will, and he will be what he wants to be.

Saying that we are Negroes and do not consider the situation of the Negro as one that should be superlative? 'Tis better not to utter such expression, because the Negro is for aspiration. As one writer says that the Negro has only half a chance in this industrial and commercial world, and he is plunging forward, and it is a surety if he gets a whole chance the world will have to stay to one side; or, in other words, the other races will have to draw to one side and give him the middle of the road. Fellow men, I beseech you to catch hold of this race consciousness. Don't be hypocrites, for you will be deceiving yourselves. Grasp with truth the golden opportunity that offers itself to you, and for the benefit of those coming after. Let us build a firm foundation. We will not all reap, but let us do our part in planting.

Some may think that we will all be elevated, but individually it will never be. Yet we must all wake up, and those who are too heavy to jump and whose bones are too stiff to move can do their bit by pushing the movable ones on to the summit of success, so that we as a race, like other races created by the Omnipotent's hand, will be legally admired and respected.

We have been serfs and peons for hundreds of years. Now is our chance to take the bat in hand and score for our side. Keep your wicket, look readily on the bowler, and with the help of God you will hit every ball to the boundary line. Remember we have opponents who will try all endeavors to knock down our wickets, and should we lose this game it will be a hard time for us all.

Fellow men, don't be false hearted; don't be false minded; be earnest, respect yourselves, and others will respect you. If you as a Negro believe that there is no aspiration for you, then surely you won't stir yourself for a betterment and those who have you under foot will think nothing more of you. But if you think to be under the feet of the other races is not the place for you you will put forth all efforts to get out from under and stand alongside as they won't be able to keep you down any longer.

As I have said before, some of us have not yet grasped the right thing. This is an improvement association, and it simply means that those who are able to go swiftly and firm and masterly must impart their knowledge to those who are less cultured. We may all have enthusiastic spirit, but Improvement means building up; it means making good better and better best. It does not mean that those who think they are intelligent must trample and thrust aside the willing and hard-working ones who are less cultured. Not like what took place in our division, among a clique of men who wanted to be administrators and chiefs after we had cut down the trees and burned the brush, plowed the land and sowed the seed of the U.N.I.A. They then came in and said that the seed was now well sown, and tried all endeavors to crush the plant, so that they could replant this field and be called the sowers.

When Mrs. Theodora Thomas¹ came from across the seas and preached the doctrine of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L. on the streets and corners these men were all here and possessed of the knowledge of this movement; but they never attempted to start such a work, and, now that this good lady has established the U.N.I.A., they feel that she should not have had that fame. They tried in every possible way, but did not succeed, until last of all their plans worked out to their desire under the judgment of His Grace Rev. Dr. McGuire. And when the Hon. A. Cunning returned to complete the work some were disappointed in their expectations. Even then there was not due satisfaction, but as he ruled, we were subordinate. God is working out all injustice, and there is one example. The leader of the once opposing group, who is one of the permanent officers, "in the presence of His Excellency Hon. Marcus Garvey," tore from his bosom the colors of the U.N.I.A. and threw them away. His Excellency saw the action, and authorized the president of the division to have the individual straightened up. This case will certify my former remarks, that some only want to be head of affairs, but have not the true spirit of helpfulness. Let us be sincere in our help to this movement; be true to ourselves and God will be true to us. Give all you can to help this movement, individually as well as collectively, and the day will come when we shall reach to our desired haven.

And let us remember that heights that great men reached and kept were not attained by sudden flight, but they, "while their companions slept," were toiling upwards in the night. And the lives of those great men all remind us that we can make our lives sublime, and, departing, leave behind us footprints on the sands of time.²

With regret I announce the death of our second ex-president, who was hurried into eternity on the 7th inst., crushed to death by a train. We mourn the loss of our dear brother, and tender our sympathy to his bereaved family. The deceased, John J. Henry, was elected president and served one month in the office and resigned owing to ill health. Thanking you in advance, sir, for the space, I am Yours of the race,

A. FREDERICK

Printed in *NW*, 9 July 1921.

1. Theodora Thomas remained active in the Guantánamo division of the UNIA, serving as first vice president of the Ladies division in the mid-1920s (AHPSC, GP, leg. 2452, no. 3; *NW*, 2 January 1926).

2. From Henry Wadsworth Longfellow (1807–1882), "A Psalm of Life"—

Lives of great men all remind us
We can make our lives sublime,
And, departing, leave behind us
Footprints on the sands of time.

St. Philip's Notes in the Georgetown *Tribune*

[[Georgetown, Demerara,
ca. 9 July 1921]]

MARCUS GARVEY

We have been hearing a lot about Mr. Marcus Garvey recently. He is the head of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. This gentleman really wishes to improve the status of his people. He has started a steamship company and advises black men to buy shares and to save money and so become men of means. The cry is, Wake up, Ethiopia. We agree with saving money. We hope many a man in this colony who works for good money will save some of it. Squandermania seems to be rampant everywhere. Our experience is that very few black men do save, and we have had 30 years' experience. There is too much drinking and spreeing, chambering and wantonness. Street corner orators are giving the people a wrong impression of Mr. Garvey. They give the people the impression that if they want to progress they must have as little as possible to do with religion. In the Negro World recently we saw Mr. Garvey advising his people to build on a religious foundation. A man can't be a real man without religion. Then there is the cry "Back to Africa." Very good. But if any man wants to get back to Africa to live (no doubt they mean to Liberia), although the government of that republic offers to give settlers ten acres of land, yet let those who go see that they have their savings in their pockets, for to arrive in a strange land without money to start work is a sad job. Emigrants will bite the dust, see very hard days, till such time as their land can be sufficiently developed to support them. In Liberia there is a church in communion with ours. It was started from America and they now have a black bishop with the Apostolic succession; they have many priests, and we believe the dissenting bodies of Christians are well represented there. These street orators here are talking through their hats when they shout "down with all ministers." If they all go to Liberia, with regard to religion, it will be "out of the frying pan into the fire." Men can't do without religion.

At street corners one often hears, "What has the church done for you? Nothing at all." The church is the kingdom of God; it was not started on the day of Pentecost to put money into [more pockets?]. The existence of education in the colony is due to the instruction of the religious bodies due to their care for the people. In any out-of-the-way place where a school has been started religion was at the bottom. In Uganda today 1,000,000 of the people would not be able to read and write had it not been for church schools; Uganda is in Africa. When a man wants to talk to intelligent people let him give even the devil his due. The church ministers to men's souls and advises them about their earthly well-being but it is well nigh as hard to make people have a mind to become independent citizens by education and thrift as it is to remove Kaiteur¹ to Africa.

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Here in this colony there is freedom for every man of every nationality; there is plenty of food, plenty of land, plenty of space for shops, plenty of opportunity for developing character, plenty of banks to save money. When men have saved some money there is no reason why they should not strike out on their own account for the benefit of themselves and their own people. Talk will not do much; what is wanted is effort.

Reproduced from *NW*, 9 July 1921.

1. A reference to Kaieteur Falls on the Potaro river, the famous, 741 feet, single-drop waterfall in the interior of Guyana (*Gazetteer of Guyana* [Georgetown: Government of Guyana, 1974], p. 61).

Jonas Thompson to the *Workman*

[Panama City, 9 July 1921]

A LAME ATTEMPT

BY WOULD-BE CRITIC SCATHINGLY CRITICISED

Sir,—

There is an open letter addressed to the *Workman* of Panama in the *Negro World* of June 25th over signature of one Solomon J. E. St. Rose. This letter purports to be a belated defence of Marcus Garvey and his activities against the attack of Tom Saywell which appeared in the *Workman* over two months ago. Apparently, the writer in his anger aimed at the *Workman* to avenge his hero, but the bullet missed its billet. I am not concerned one way or other in this controversy, but for God's sake Mr. Editor, please advise our people to stop rushing into print until they have something to say, and have the ability to say it. The U.N.I.A., is certainly in need of a "Solomon" to assist in guiding its destinies at this critical period of its existence, but not one in name only. If this Solomon St. Rose is so ardent an admirer of Mr. Garvey, he should enlist the help of some one capable enough to defend him and in the meantime, the wise'un should buy an English Grammar and study it diligently before he tries to earn fame with his pen[.] Mr. St. Rose may be able to advise a janitor how to clean a building—that's in his line—but to defend Mr. Garvey and the U.N.I.A., he is hopelessly incompetent. Incidentally, may I ask Mr. St. Rose if he is such a zealous U.N.I.A. member, why is he so often found in the company of a certain notorious professional idler of Colon who hates that organization and Mr. Garvey more than the devil hates holy water. Thanking you etc., Yours truly,

JONAS THOMPSON

P.S.—A similar letter was sent to this office by Mr. St. Rose for publication but same was turned down as it was not in conformity with the policy of this office.—(Ed. W.)

Printed in the *Workman* (Panama City), 9 July 1921.

C. J. Whebell, Acting Commandant,
Bahamas Police, to H. E. W. Grant,
Colonial Secretary, Bahamas

Police Orderly Room. Nassau.
N[ew] P[rovidence] July 13th. 1921.

Re: Rev. Richard Higgs

Sir,

I have the honour to submit herewith, report upon the above named who was recently ordered to leave MIAMI, FLA.

This man held a service at St. Johns Church, Grants Town, on Sunday last the 10th. inst. during which he preached to the congregation regarding his treatment at Cocoa-Nut Grove[,] Miami, Fla.

He stated that he was arrested by men in automobiles (six cars in all), was handcuffed, blindfolded and a [gag?] placed in this mouth and was then driven away for a distance of [15?] miles.

After a rope had been placed around his neck and a revolver pressed against his throat he was turned loose and ordered to leave Miami within 48 hours. He fully expected to be shot during those proceedings.

He complained most bitterly of the treatment he received, stating that he had been over there for the past 23 years and has a wife and five children.

Owing to his forced departure he was compelled to leave his family behind, and to assist him in getting them away a collection was taken which was liberally subscribed to[.]

He has aroused considerable feeling among the coloured folk here and I believe he intends holding a series of meetings which I am endeavouring to have covered.

Some members of the Police Force belong to his church and they are quite concerned over the affair. During a conversation with one of them (a Bahamian) I find the feelings and opinions are very bitter against the Americans and it is quite probable that there may be clashes between the two races whenever they meet.

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However, I do not as yet anticipate any local disturbances as a result of this affair but will watch the situation closely and submit reports from time to time. I have the honour to be, Sir, Your obedient Servant.

C. J. WHEBELL

Acting Commandant of Police

[*Minutes:*] H.E. the Governor
Submitted for information.

2. Atty: Genl: to see?

H. E. W. G. [H. E. W. Grant] C. S.

15.7.21.

C.S.

Seen.

2. Please.

H. C. [H. E. S. Cordeaux] 16.vii.21

Hon. Ag. Atty. Genl.

To see.

H. E. W. G. C.S. 16/7/21

General Secretary, UNIA Brother's Road Division, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

Brother's Road Division [Trinidad]

14th July 1921

Dear Bro Casimir,

Yours is safe to hand and was grand to hear from you and to note that you have postponed your voyage home to a future date. I am also glad to note that you have and are visiting the other Divisions, I sincerely hope you would touch every one of them before leaving the Colony.

Our Dear meeting comes off on Saturday night. [Can] you not call in and travel to Siparia¹ on Sunday by first train? I wrote Phillip a letter, has he got it?² I hope at least to see you again before you leave. Remember me to all whom I am acquainted with at Guaico, especially the Phillips family. With good wishes & on behalf of the Division, to you. I Remain Yours brother [uni & acl?]

[*signature illegible*]

General Secretary

JRRC. ALS, recipient's copy. Handwritten letterhead: "One God! One Aim! One Destiny! Universal Negro Improvement Association and African Communities League."

1. Siparia is a small town in southern Trinidad.

2. Probably Edward Philip, the secretary of the Guaico branch of the UNIA, who, along with Mary Philip and S. Philip, corresponded with Casimir in 1921-1922.

Lieutenant-Corporal Frank D. Kelly, Bahamas,
to C. J. Whebell, Acting Commandant,
Bahamas Police

Nassau N.P. 14th July 1921

Sir

I have the honour to report to you on certain remarks made by the Rev. Richard Higgs who preached at The Metropolitan Baptist church in Grant Town, on Wednesday evening the 13th inst. I had to go around to the various Baptist Church in the City owing to the fact that I did not know where this man was going to preach[.] I found him however at the above mentioned church. He was introduced to the congregation by the Pastor of the church, Rev Gilbert Thompson. When he got up he raised an anthem, but he never sang very long when he stopped, and told the congregation that they were not all singing and that he wanted them to sing aloud, as [it] was the way that the negroes did after they were delivered from slavery. He said to the audience if they wanted to be christians, they would have to stand lots of persecutions, he said that he was wrongly accused by one of his own negro race,¹ and on that account he was handcuffed, gagged and then taken away some 10 or 15 miles from his home in the woods in Florida by some white folks and beaten nearly to death, but he told them that this make him pray harder now and cling more nearer to Christ. He then told all present to acquaint all their friends that he will tell the thrilling story in detail //on [*words missing*]// how he suffered for Christ's sake in Florida. He concluded by saying that he was no stranger in Nassau, and that he is going to live here now, and that he has already sent for his wife and (5) children, and that he cannot go back in the Southern States of America.

Rev Thompson then asked the congregation to make up a collection for Rev Higgs which they did. I have the honour to be Sir Your humble and ob[edien]t servant

FRANK D. KELLY
No. 82 L. Corpl.

[*Handwritten endorsement:*] Hon. Col. Sec.

Forwarded for your information. Next
Sunday's meeting will be covered
C. J. W. Acting Comdt 15/7/21

DAB/PRO. ALS. Marked "Confidential."

1. This is probably another reference to a black American's allegedly informing against and accusing a West Indian, in this case Reverend Higgs (Nathan D. B. Connolly, *A World More Concrete: Real Estate and the Remaking of Jim Crow South Florida* [University of Chicago Press, 2014], chap. 2).

JULY 1921

Henry O. Mattos¹ to the *Negro World*

[[Lurs Street, No. 47, Havana, Cuba,
ca. 16 July 1921]]

A RINGING MESSAGE FROM HAVANA, CUBA

Dear Sir:

Please permit me through the columns of your most valuable paper, the *Negro World*, to transmit to the doubting Thomases where he may be found, the determination of the New Negro.

Be it known, that the New Negro does not appreciate any other counsel but Almighty God and the Universal Negro Improvement Association.

We who are so proud of our color, race and motherhood have no apology to make in declaring Africa first, last and all the time. We do not care to be told how, when and where to invest our hard-worked dollars, as we have been having 200 years of blind investment. Ye that hath eyes to see Let him see us shine in race unity, let him see our "one God! on[e] aim! one destiny"; let him know that we stand for "Pro Deo Africa et Justitia," and let him see Ethiopia stretching forth her hands unto God.

Let us thank God for having brought the U.N.I.A. in existence, or the Negro, as a race, would have been a cripple. Three hundred years of maladministration has caused the New Negro to say, "Let me take a trial. Let me have an administrator who looks like me to administrate in the true sense of the word, for the Negro and at all times." And, because we are capable of such an administration, we will fear no more to trust the Negro, and will exploit ourselves no more for the other fellow. We shall let all our investments be in the Black Star Line and its allied corporations, and will allow no one who can't see further than his nose to impede our progress.

We shall let those on the outside, who are more curious and sympathetic about our getting of interest from our investment than the investor himself, that we have invested far more a racial uplift than for mere grasp, for grasping from ones-self is dangerous. We would advise them to become a stockholder in the Black Star Line, where and when they can get first-hand information (not the second-hand ones which they so appreciate) at any and all times, regarding their monies. Let me say just here, that the Black Star Line has stood the acid test, and can never fail.

"Success comes in Can;
Failure in Can[']ts."

While they are having nightmares over the Black Star Line and Marcus Garvey, the other race recognizes it as a power, a world-wide movement beyond human control, a movement whose principle is based upon love and justice. Yes, Mr. Knocker, the U.N.I.A. comes to stay and live, so don't worry,

but get in line and seek the protection of your wives and children, even if you, yourself, are too alright to need protection. I never like to be too frequent a guest to the homes of some of my associates, as they talk much of what's the use[,] are we preparing, and we have no guns, etc. I think you'll agree with me when I get through.

As my contents is race first and the love and respect for our Negro women, it may happen that, during there be an attack from the outside on our ladies, and, as my friend, according to his assertions, his [is] too doubtful to stick to anything, I, as a race man, would be obliged to make the counter-attack with or without a gun, but ever with preparedness.

And as I never think of defending a coward but the defenceless, it would be a fine spectacle to see me helping the helpless with a coward in the corner the same which I might have reserved for my retreat.

Thanking you in advance for space Mr. Editor. Yours for racial uplift,

HENRY O. MATTOS

Printed in *NW*, 16 July 1921.

1. Henry O. Mattos was elected vice secretary of UNIA division 24 in Havana in October 1921 (Gerald M. Gordon Clarke, president, Havana division, to Provincial Governor, Havana, 15 October 1921, ANC, RA, leg. 388).

A. J. Kershaw, Former Financial Secretary, UNIA Key West Division, to the *Negro World*

[[Key West, Fla., July 20, 1921]]

DR. KERSHAW EXPLAINS CONDITIONS IN KEY WEST, FLA.

Dear Editor:

In the issue of July 16 there appeared an article from the general secretary of the Havana Division, in which an account of the labors of the president of the Key West Division was stated. Were it not for the untruths made in the statements of the Rev. T. C. Glashen in his speech before the Havana Division, we could lightly pass the matter up. For the benefit of the many readers I shall give a few facts that will perchance throw a little light on conditions as they exist today in the Key West Division.

First.—For the months of March, April and May I served as financial secretary of the Key West Division. During that time the sum \$690.16 was collected by me as funds for the division and the same turned over to the assistant treasurer and receipts given to me for the same.

Second.—The Rev. T. C. Glashen did not make the Key West Division one of the strongest in the United States in the period of two months, as stated in the report of the general secretary of the Havana Division. The records in the office of the secretary general in New York will show that the division was orga-

nized in the city of Key West in the month of August, 1920, and at no time until I became financial secretary did the membership reach 300. In my three months as financial secretary the membership grew from 212 to 676. The monthly reports were sent to parent body as per instructions received from that body. Has one been sent since I resigned?

Third.—At no time has the division had a membership of 1,500; to be exact, the membership reached 676 at the close of the month of May.

Fourth.—As to the Rev. Glashen finding some blunders in my books and taking me privately and asking for some explanation, I have this to say: The only private taking aside the “Rev.” has ever had with me was when he advised me to take the funds collected from lectures delivered by me for the Black Cross Nurses and pocket it for myself. This I refused to do under any consideration. Can he and the lady president claim as much in regards of money collected from “dinner sales” and the lectures delivered by me for the nurses? The amount the Rev. Glashen claims that he found short in my books as reported by the secretary of the Havana division was \$225. The information filed against me with the clerk of the court states that the sum was \$25 that I stole. The truth in the matter is that I was arrested without an audit of books, without any charge having been made against me to the body, and against my advice. The result is, those that swore out the warrant for me have some things on their hands that they don’t know how to rid themselves of. When the time comes I shall strive to have them thoroughly understand what is meant by the expression: “Fools rush in where angels fear to tread.”

Let us hope that wherever the lot of the good Rev. may fall to labor that he will learn to respect the truth in his statements.

Should the good Rev. H. Glashen answer my corrections, kindly have him spell my name correctly. It’s indeed strange that he should fail to spell same correctly now, as he has seen my name time after time spelled correctly, and especially on my personal checks given him as loans, the same having never been repaid by him. Yours,

A. J. KERSHAW

Printed in NW, 6 August 1921.

Z. A. Cunningham to the *Negro World*

[[Box 43, Céspedes,¹ Camaguey, Cuba,
July 20, 1921]]

POSITION OF SOME OF OUR DIVISIONS IN CUBA AMID ECONOMIC DEPRESSION²

Sir—

The economic depression in Cuba is telling terribly against the English speaking section of West Indians in the island, the majority of whom are necessitated to work merely for their food. Not that the amount offered to do the work is just enough to buy food, but that no cash is offered you to work. You must take whatever remuneration you are to get in the shape of foodstuff only.

What makes it worse, the price offered to do field work, which is almost the only work available for West Indian Negroes here, is so miserably low that if a man is not content to live on 30 cents a day he is sure very soon to have eaten more than he has earned, which means a stoppage of further “vales”³ for food. Indeed, a hard working man does well if he earns the 30 cents each day he works. It is painfully evident that 30 cents cannot at the rate of things in Cuba feed a working man for a day.

Yet, hard as the above condition may seem, things appear to be getting worse, as on many Colonoses⁴ (the plantations) this scanty ration is not even forthcoming and the laborers are laid off from work.

Indeed, at the date of writing the outlook is dreary in the extreme. The writer is one in whom Hope is very large and therefore one who takes optimistic views of situations, but under present conditions is very much oppressed with gloomy forebodings.

Our division, which I believe is as desirous as any other in the island to meet its obligations to the parent body and to the whole racial movement as set forth in our propaganda, has fallen into the unenviable position of “unfinancial.”

The struggle—and a grim one it is with the majority of our members—is “What shall I eat?” If to give material help to the U.N.I.A. is alone to be taken as proof of our loyalty and fidelity to the great cause, we are sorry to say, then, for the time being we must be considered as an unprofitable member.

We are hoping that our promptness in better days in attending to our obligations will in part atone for our present shortcomings, brought about by circumstances over which we have no control.

The dear parent body in her herculean task, with problems gigantic in size and difficulties, needs perhaps more than ever before the help of her children. But, alas! as far as we at Céspedes are concerned, she cannot look for that help, as we are, right here and now, struggling in financial impotence and battling with extreme economic depression. God help us to stick together until this “calamity be overpast.” In the immortal words of Carlyle let us “Await the

issue. In all battles if you await the issue each fighter has prospered according to his right. His might and his right at the close of the account were one and the same. He has fought with all his might, and in exact proportion to all his right he has prevailed.”⁵

The founder of the U.N.I.A. and A.C.L. is right to have founded such an organization, and the U.N.I.A. as an organization is right in its efforts to release its peoples from the disabilities heaped upon them, and so, working with the full consciousness of right on our side, we need not fear the issue. Yours respectfully,

Z. A. CUNNINGHAM

Printed in NW, 13 August 1921.

1. The town of Cespedes is the seat of the Carlos M. de Cespedes municipality in the province of Camagüey, the largest of Cuba's provinces. It is located in the western part of the province on the south coast. The town was named for the independence fighter Carlos Manuel de Céspedes.

2. A brief but sharp recession lasting seven months (August 1918–March 1919), caused by a combination of severe hyperinflation in Europe, the end of wartime production, and the influx of labor from returning troops, was followed in ten months by a short but extremely painful recession that lasted eighteen months (January 1920–July 1921). During the first postwar recession, trade and industrial activity declined by 14 percent, and business activity fell by 24.5 percent. In 1920 to 1921, trade and industrial activity declined by 38 percent, and business activity fell by 32.7 percent in the United States, causing high unemployment. Original estimates of real GNP from the Commerce Department showed that real GNP fell 8 percent between 1919 and 1920 and another 7 percent between 1920 and 1921. The behavior of prices contributed to the naming of the latter recession “the Depression of 1921.” The economy had a strong recovery following the end of “the Depression of 1920 to 1921,” brought about by a period of economic prosperity that would take the name “the Roaring Twenties” (Christina Duckworth Romer, “World War I and the Postwar Depression: A Reinterpretation Based on Alternative Estimates of GNP,” *Journal of Monetary Economics* 22, no. 1 (1988): 91–115; J. R. Vernon, “The 1920–21 Deflation: The Role of Aggregate Supply,” *Economic Inquiry* 29, no. 3 (1991): 572–580; Daniel Kuehn, “A Critique of Powell, Woods, and Murphy on the 1920–1921 Depression,” *Review of Austrian Economics* 24, no. 3 (2011): 273–291; *Business Cycles and Depressions: An Encyclopedia*, ed. David Glasner and Thomas F. Cooley [New York: Garland Publishing, 1997], s.v. “Depression of 1920–1921” [by Anthony Patrick O’Brien]; Randall E. Parker, “An Overview of the Great Depression,” in *Reflections on the Great Depression*, ed. Randall E. Parker (Northampton, Mass.: Edward Elgar, 2002), pp. 1–24; Gene Smiley, “The U.S. Economy in the 1920s,” in *E.H.net Encyclopedia*, ed. Robert Whaples [Economic History Association, article published 1 February 2010, <http://eh.net/encyclopedia/article/Smiley.1920s.final>]).

3. “Vales” were vouchers or tokens given to workers in lieu of actual payment in cash to be redeemed at company stores or at a later date. The Arteaga Law of 1909 had prohibited payment in vales, yet the practice persisted for many years, and seems to have been especially common during the economic crisis of 1920–1921, when employers complained of lack of capital (Marc McLeod, “Undesirable Aliens: Haitian and British West Indian Immigrant Workers in Cuba, 1898 to 1940,” [Ph.D. diss., University of Texas at Austin, 2000], pp. 100–101).

4. “Colonos” were cane farmers who usually rented pieces of land (called *colonias*) from sugar companies, hired laborers to cut the cane during the harvest, and then sold their cane to be processed at company mills for a share of the product. Some colonias were owned by colonos, and some were given personal names, such as Diego, that reflected the independence of the colonos.

5. This is a quotation from *Past and Present* (1843), book 1, “Proem,” in chapter 2, “The Sphinx,” by Scottish essayist and historian Thomas Carlyle (1795–1881). In this chapter, Carlyle affirms that justice exists, even if it is delayed. In *Past and Present*, Carlyle attacks the “laissez-faire” doctrine and the inhuman society that results from measuring everything by the “cash nexus.” This text also contains his advocacy of hero worship, a demand for greater state control, especially of emigration and education; the approval of forcible methods to attain goals; and the use of the army as a model of government (Thomas Carlyle, *Past and Present* [1912; reprint, London: Dent & Sons, 1947], pp. 7–14; Albert J. LaValley, *Carlyle and the Idea of the Modern: Studies in Carlyle's*

Prophetic Literature and Its Relation to Blake, Nietzsche, Marx, and Others [New Haven: Yale University Press, 1968], pp. 198, 203, 221; Ian Campbell, *Thomas Carlyle* [London: Hamilton, 1974], pp. 109–110; *Oxford Dictionary of National Biography*).

Speech by Marcus Garvey¹

[[Liberty Hall, New York,
20 July 1921]]

[. . .] May it please your Highness, the Potentate, Right Hon. Members of the Executive Council, Members and Friends of the New York D[i]vision of the Universal Negro Improvement Association:—Again it [is] my good fortune to address you. Tonight I am supposed to explain to you my experience as gathered from my trip to the West Indies and Central America in your behalf. As I said last night,² I took my departure from this country, leaving New York on the 23d of February for Key West, arriving there on the 25th, where I spoke to the Key West division of the association on two occasions. From Key West I journeyed on to Havana, Cuba, where I met the Havana Division of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. I was entertained by the division in a manner that was characteristic of the spirit of the membership of the U.N.I.A. in all parts. I spoke for them three nights at one [of] the Savan[n]ahs of Havana. The people turned out by the thousands to hear me on these occasions, not only the West Indians and American Negroes who were domiciled in Cuba, but the native Cubans came by the hundreds and by the thousands to hear me at these meetings. They were attended by not only the ordinary citizens, but they were attended by some of the biggest officials in the Cuban Government, as also members of the Cuban Senate. After remaining in Havana for two days, it became widely known throughout the Island that I was then speaking in Havana. A special message was sent throughout the length and breadth of Cuba to the various municipalities to extend to me the freedom of these municipalities wherever I should visit. Hence my trip through Cuba was a most enjoyable one, in that wheresoever I appeared, wheresoever I went, throughout Cuba, the officials of the communities, as well as the populace, received me with open arms. I was presented to His Excellency, the then President of Cuba, President Menocal, and also to the President-elect at that time, who is now the governing president of Cuba.³ I met both of them in the National Palace at Havana. They gave me a hearty welcome to the Republic and for a few minutes we discussed the question of the Universal Improvement Association; and I gathered from both presidents that they were in hearty symp[ath]y with the work of the organization for the liberation of Africa for the Negro peoples of the world. (Cheers).

From Havana, after receiving a hearty reception and watching the people respond most nobly in a financial way to the Black Star Line, and for the Libe-

rian Construction Loan, I went to Moron, little town in the province of Oriente—I had two meetings in Moron where I was also splendidly entertained by that division. They also supported the Black Star Line and the Construction Loan. From Moron I went to the little city of Nuevitas, and there also I received another hearty response, and there the people “Went Over the Top” 100 per cent. for the Black Star Line and the Liberian Construction Loan, even though his Grace, the Chaplain-General, Dr. McGuire had been there, and as an Archbishop, naturally he had cleaned up all Cuba and left not even a brass nickel there. But when I arrived in Nuevitas, the ladies went down into their “National Banks” and they brought out all the reserves they had, and they went over the top 100 per cent. for the Black Star Line shares and for the Construction Loan for the industrial development of Liberia.

From Nuevitas, I went to the great stronghold of the Universal Improvement Association—Preston. In Preston I also received a warm reception. Dr. McGuire had preceeded me there, and I believe in two nights took away all the savings of the people in Preston. So when I arrived there to get some more they did the best they could, and I think that best can be measured with the best of any other center of the Universal Improvement Association, because they openheartedly did every thing they possibly could to make my trip there a success. From Preston, I went to another great stronghold, the stronghold of Barnes, where Dr. McGuire, I believe, in two nights got \$4,000 for the Black Star Line.

I must say that I was sick all during my stay in Cuba, because I contracted a very bad cold, having gone immediately from the cold in the North to the warmth of the tropics down in Key West. I took a very bad cold and having to speak every night it developed seriously and I was very much embarrassed in my speeches in Cuba because I suffered nightly from the effects of the bad cold. Nevertheless, I was sent out to represent the Universal Improvement Association, and the first night hundreds and thousands of people assembled in the biggest theatre [in] the city of Barnes, and I was suffering terribly while I spoke. I sold thousands of dollars worth of stock at that meeting, and we received a large amount of money for the door admittance, because all the meetings that I addressed during my stay from New York the people paid a dollar to attend. That amount was paid in Cuba, in Jamaica and in all the places that I spoke. Miss Jacques collected \$14,000 for door receipts alone, outside of the dozens of meetings I addressed for nothing so as to accommodate all the people of the various communities I visited. As I said last night, in Panama, when I was about to leave there the people were so anxious (those who were closed out because of the overtaxed capacity of the building), they were willing to pay \$50 just to hear me for the last time in Panama. That will give you an idea of the enthusiasm of the people in Cuba, Jamaica and the Panama Republic in hearing me as the representative of the Universal Improvement Association. The second night I was unable to continue my meetings in Barnes; even though I was determined to go out, yet the Black Cross Nurses there under the direction of Mrs. Collins, refused to let me get out of bed. When I was preparing to get out they barred

the door so that I could not get out. That was the only meeting I was unable to address during the time I was away even though I suffered all the time. I was thankful, however, that they kept me away from that meeting, because I suffered that night, and at one time I thought I was going across on a long journey, not on the ship of the Black Star Line, but on the spiritual ship. Nevertheless, Mrs. Collins worked on me all night and I recovered enough to continue the journey next morning to Antilla and I spoke in Antilla the following night.

From there I journeyed to Santiago where I met a large band of men and women working in the interest of the U.N.I.A. The people are doing splendid work at that end of Cuba for the carrying through of this great cause of ours.

In leaving Cuba for Jamaica, I left a country 100 per cent. working in the interest of the U.N.I.A. When I arrived in Jamaica some time late in April I was received most heartily and enthusiastically by the citizens of Kingston. My advent into the city was not well known; that is, the hour and the date of my arrival was not known beforehand. Nevertheless, they were looking out for me at any time, and in the space of a couple of minutes the news flashed around the city that I had arrived; so they came from all parts so as to greet me and bid me welcome to my own native land. The first night when I landed there I calculated I would take a rest because I was suffering, but they refused to let me rest, and arranged a welcome meeting for me, and that night hundreds and thousands were turned away from the Collegiate Hall where the welcome was tendered to me. The next night I spoke to them in the largest public building in Jamaica, the Ward Theatre, and it was said it was the first time in the history of that theatre that so many people were crowded into it, and although the capacity of the theatre was overtaxed we turned away thousands, and each person inside had paid 2 shillings and 6 pence to enter that building. Notwithstanding the poverty of the country the people overtaxed the building to demonstrate their enthusiasm for the Universal Improvement Association. I addressed large meetings at the Ward Theatre and stirred the entire Island of Jamaica in the name of the Universal Improvement Association, insomuch so that for several days—Jamaica being the most critical country in the West Indies—no critics dared to attack me; they were afraid. Then after several days passed by[,] some of the bolder critics of the country came forward and attacked me, and those of you in the United States who have received communications from Jamaica will realize how we handled ourselves in the name of the U.N.I.A. (Cheers.) We handled ourselves in Jamaica so splendidly that I hard[ly] believe there is one man in Jamaica bold enough to attack the Universal Improvement Association. We silenced the critics of Jamaica forever.

From Jamaica I journeyed to Costa Rica, and in Costa Rica I received a warm reception on my arrival by 15,000 residents of that republic—West Indian residents and American Negro residents, men and women who were domiciled there for 40, 30, 20, 15 or 10 years,⁴ and they gave me a welcome that I will never forget. Costa Rica is the country that really gave us to believe that the

Universal Negro Improvement Association cannot die, because people there are willing to sacrifice their last so that this association will accomplish the task of giving us a free and redeemed Africa. The people of Costa Rica were so enthusiastic—the large majority of them are employees of the United Fruit Co., scattered in all sections of Costa Rica working on the farms; they have been working there, as I said, for 40, 30, 20 or 15 years—and when they heard that Marcus Garvey, representing the Universal Association, had arrived in Costa Rica, every man threw down his cutlass, every man threw down his hoe and other instruments of labor and said that there was going to be no more work until Marcus Garvey got out of Costa Rica. (Cheers.) Well, the United Fruit Co. had about three ships which were to be loaded with bananas and they were up against it, so I believe they came to a compromise with me and they said, “Look here, we don’t want to embarrass[s] you; we want you to have all the money you want to get so as to carry on the work, so we are going to have a special pay-day that these folks can get money to do what you want them to; but you must help us in this way: you must go out to the capital for three days and stay out there, during which time they will load all the bananas on the ships, and by the time the ships are loaded we will send a special train for you and bring you down and have a pay-day so that they will have money to support your cause.[”] (Cheers and laughter.) I did not go there to embarrass anybody; I went there for the purpose of doing business; so I accepted the arrangement and took the special train. Outside of the satisfaction it gave to me in that they paid a compliment to me not as Marcus Garvey but as representative of the Negro peoples of the world, I am pleased at the satisfaction it gave to the people of Costa Rica; because never in the history of Costa Rica was a black man or a dark man allowed to ride on certain cars of the railroad that runs from Port Limon to San Jose; in that a certain class of people are allowed to ride in a certain class of coach going from Port Limon to the capital, San Jose. And when I arrived there I was the first black man who ever had a special train. (Cheers.) And that gave satisfaction to the people of Costa Rica for having put it over for once, and I was glad to help them anyhow. We had a special train all during the time I was there. The United Fruit Co. was very kind; they not only gave us a special train but they also arranged for a special launch to take me from Costa Rica to the province of Bocas del Toro and I accepted it because the people demanded it. And let me tell you a joke. The morning I was to leave for San Jose, the capital, before I arrived they brought out a certain coach, and I believe there were a few dirty spots on the outside of the coach, and the people refused to have that coach. They said: “This coach is not going to move from here until you bring the best coach you have down in Limon,” and so the railroad had to shunt it off and put on one of the brand newest coaches they had so as to accommodate the Provisional President of Africa. (Cheers.) In Limon they had a holiday lasting for several days; they ran special trains for the people from all sections of Costa Rica to bring them down to Port Limon, and the day that I was going to San Jose so as to address a meeting in the afternoon

in Port Limon I saw miles of cars stretched on the railroad track all the way down through certain sections of Costa Rica to Port Limon. The people came down from all sections by the thousands; they were inside the coaches, they hung outside of the coaches at the doors and windows, and they sat on top of the coaches; the coaches could not hold them; they did not have enough coaches to bring them down from the different parts of the line to Port Limon. They came by the thousands and there was no place large enough in Port Limon to accommodate them; therefore they rented a stand on the plaza—I believe they call it the Open Plaza—of several acres of land, and I spoke to the thousands of people there. They had a time of it all day and all night. The house they arranged to accommodate me was immediately opposite the Plaza and they had the house decorated with the flags of the African Republic, the Red, the Black and the Green; and they enjoyed themselves at the Plaza all night and all day. They had electric lights; they had music and they played and danced all day and all night for four days; there was no work in Costa Rica; all the Negro people were on strike celebrating the forthcoming emancipation of Africa. We did a splendid business in Costa Rica. The young man I took with me (Mr. Jacques) was occupied all day and all night writing out shares in the Black Star Line and selling bonds of the Liberian Construction Loan, and Miss Jacques, my secretary, was working all the time counting money received as entrance fees to the meetings and contributions they gave to the cause of the U.N.I.A.

From Costa Rica I went to Bocas del Toro and there again I had another beautiful time in the province of Almirante, up in the woodlands of Bocas del Toro; there you will find hundreds and thousands of West Indian Negroes, chiefly Barbadians and Jamaicans—the majority Jamaicans. They had saved their money there and had kept it on tap until I got there to buy shares in the Black Star Line and bonds in the Liberian Construction Loan. There again we did great business, and the enthusiasm was warm. There again the United Fruit Co. could not get the people to work until I was out of the country, and they gave us special trains and ran them at midnight and did everything to accommodate us so we could have a successful time in order that I should get out and allow some work to be done.

I left Bocas del Toro for Colon. I arrived in Colon some time in April, and there again I went unannounced because I did not want any trouble with the Canal Zone Government. They were looking for me somewhere and I was determined to get there from under the sea; so I took a submarine, and I just got out of the water one afternoon and dropped on shore in Colon and checked my baggage and stood up beside a man. I said to him, "Sam, go and call Mr. Morales." He said, "Who are you?" I said go and tell Mr. Morales Marcus Garvey wants him and in two minutes after there were about ten thousand people around me. By that time the Canal Zone heard I was there, but there was ten thousand around me so they could not get to me through the crowd. Mr. Morales came in an automobile and took me to the place they had

prepared for me—the residence of Dr. Hammlet, a kind-hearted man, and a loyal member of the U.N.I.A., from Barbados; he is now a citizen of Panama. He entertained me and my party royal[ly] and we enjoyed our stay in his home. The first afternoon when I arrived the people forced me to come out on the veranda to make a speech and I had to make a speech and inform them that I would speak that night. Night came and it was arranged for me to speak in Liberty Hall. Liberty Hall of Colon is a beautiful structure and can accommodate 800 or 900 persons, and when I went there at 7 o'clock the place was overcrowded. I believe they had a thousand people in the hall, all having paid a dollar apiece, and there were about 5,000 outside trying to get into the hall; there were about 2,000 on the veranda of another building outside, and the crowd was so immense they tore the veranda down, and the verandas all around that building [were] overcrowded with people trying to hear something of my voice as giving an explanation of the aims and objects of the Universal Improvement Association. I delivered six addresses in Colon, each night and each afternoon, and we did a splendid business there.

From Colon we journeyed up to Panama City, and as I said last night, when I arrived in Panama City I met the largest crowd of people I have ever seen at any one time—at least Negro people. They came from all directions. They overcrowded the city. From the time I arrived I met crowds of people and they made such a rush on me that they lifted me from the [*railroad*] car, smashed the windows of the car, took me out, lifted me and carried me to the automobile, placed me in the automobile and they all got in the automobile. (Cheers and Laughter.) You can just imagine the work of that poor automobile. They got into the automobile, punctured the tires and put the automobile on the rims, and they were not satisfied until they had to get out and push it all the way. (Laughter.) They had a gala day in Panama. On my arrival in the city it was said by the Panama newspapers that it was the largest assembly of people ever yet seen in the Republic of Panama. I addressed the people that night in the circus tent. A circus company was performing there and they gave over the tent to us for that night where I addressed a large crowd. The following Saturday afternoon and Sunday night I addressed a large concourse of people in the "Bull Ring." Thousands of people assembled, because it was the largest place they could get. The meetings were so successful that the news went all the way down the [*Canal*] Zone and everybody wanted to hear me. On Monday night everybody came out to hear me for the last. They got a theatre with a seating capacity, I think, of 1,800. The meeting was scheduled for 8 o'clock, and by 6 o'clock the theatre was overcrowded and over two thousand people were outside clamoring to get in. At 8 o'clock when I got there I had to go through a dense crowd of people, and at that time they were offering \$50, \$25, \$20, \$10, and \$5 just to get a peep in to hear me for the last time in Panama. I was very sorry that all the people could not be accommodated and they went away at 11 o'clock when I dismissed the meeting, back to the Canal Zone. They came in

automobiles from all parts of the Zone. In returning from Panama to Colon I boarded a ship of the United Fruit Co. for Jamaica.

On my return to Jamaica I addressed another series of meetings, and then made up my mind to return to the United States of America. The day prior to arranging for my passage to the United States of America, I received a cable from Miss Davis in Santiago asking me to come immediately to Santiago because there was trouble there with the members determined to discipline the captain and crew of the Kanaw[ha] who had displeased them by their actions and the stockholders there had called a meeting, and if I did not go down[,] there would have been serious trouble, because somebody would have been lynched in Santiago. I went there in time to save the situation and took the ship from Santiago to Jamaica. The explanation about the ship I will give to you tomorrow night in my discussions of the Black Star Line. I want all of you to turn out tomorrow night to hear me on the subject of the Black Star Line. Tomorrow night you will get all the information you desire about our ship, the Kanaw[ha], and about the business relationship of the Black Star Line and what has been done since my absence.

But suffice it to say that from Jamaica I traveled with Miss Davis, Miss Jacques and her brother to Belize, British Honduras, with the intention of going by that way to the United States of America. We were heartily received in Belize, British Honduras, by the people of that country. In Belize they have a beautiful Liberty Hall. They bought that Liberty Hall proper for \$2,100, and they had paid off all but a couple of hundred dollars. It is a splendid hall and is living testimony of the loyalty and devotion and the splendid spirit of the people living in that city of Belize in British Honduras. I spoke there for several nights and won the confidence of the people. There I was the guest of a black man who is known as the "Coconut King" of Central America. He is known to be a millionaire—a man who is coming up to the convention to be presented to you—a loyal member of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. His name is Mr. Isaac [Isaiah] Morter. He is known as the "Coconut King" of Central America; so we have already started to make "coconut kings," and soon we will have diamond kings in Africa. We were his guests for the time we remained in Belize.

From Belize we went to Puerto Barrios, Guatemala, and there we saw a beautiful division of the organization. There are people there from all parts of Jamaica, Barbados and other West Indian Islands and from America. They are domiciled there and work for the United Fruit Co. They have banded themselves into a division of the U.N.I.A. and are doing splendid work. They sent out with me on the ship [on] which I came their deputy, Mr. Clifford Bourne, who was here at the last convention as their representative—a splendid man, a man who has done great work for the U.N.I.A. in Guatemala as well as in other parts of Central America. Later on during this week I will take the pleasure and honor of introducing Mr. Bourne to you, because he has come to you representing one of the strongest divisions of the Universal Negro Improvement

Association that stands 100 per cent. for the cause that you represent. Again, in Barrios, I had the privilege and good fortune to be entertained by another "prince" of the race. I was entertained by Mr. Ren[e]au,⁵ who is known as the uncrowned king of Guatemala—a black man; when you think of money you think of that man in Barrios. He is a 100 per cent. U.N.I.A. and has bought to the limit in the shares of the Black Star Line. I was entertained by him most hospitably.

From Puerto Barrios I sailed for New Orleans and arrived there last Wednesday morning [13 July]. Before I departed for the West Indies and Central America I gave an itinerary to all the men of the council and to the men of the field corps, and sent them out into different sections of this country; and among the men I sent out was Colonel Adrian Johnson. All of you are acquainted with Mr. Adrian Johnson during the convention here and during the time preparatory to the convention when he was around Liberty Hall and did splendid work for the cause. I sent him to the far South—New Orleans, La. There were just about 100 or 200 members down there who were not properly organized. I sent him to organize New Orleans, La., Mississippi and Alabama. He spent a couple of months in New Orleans, in the heart of the South, and he took the 200 members to 2,500 when I arrived there. (Cheers.) Johnson did splendid work in the South, and I do hope that all the members of the Executive Council who were sent out will have a record as good as Johnson's to present to the convention, because we have to recognize men for their work and for their merit. Johnson was not satisfied only to be in New York; he went into the heart of the South; he went into jail, came out of jail and organized the U.N.I.A. for the better (Cheers), and I understand now that he has the heart to go into Texas, and from there I hope he is coming back to the convention. So you will see the stuff he is made up of.

When I arrived in New Orleans I found hundreds of loyal men—good men and true men—who were waiting to receive me through the great work that Johnson had done preparatory to my getting there. We had a time in New Orleans. I spoke for two nights in the National Park in New Orleans, where we had thousands of people, and there they celebrated the occasion just as they did in Costa Rica. They had a large plaza and they had midnight dances and other amusements. They had music, and they danced all night.

From New Orleans I journeyed to New York and arrived here at 9.15 last Sunday morning. I rested up on Sunday, because I was too tired to come out on Sunday night, and last night I appeared before you for the first time after being away for five months.

Now let me say in summing up my trip to the West Indies, that the Universal Negro Improvement Association stands now as a mighty rock. There is no speculating about it; there is no doubt about it. It stands as the "Rock of Ages," as far as anything human can stand for such a time. (Cheers.) Nobody dares think that they can permanently boycott or interfere with the success of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. (Cheers.) As I have often said

from the platform of Liberty Hall, the Universal Negro Improvement Association is like a mighty avalanche which sweeps on and on. We have already swept the world; all that is left for us to do is to conquer Africa (cheers), that is all. We have already swept the world. There is no doubt about it, the U.N.I.A. is the strongest living force among Negroes. (Cheers.) It causes men, it causes races, it causes governments to tremble and to live in fear. But they need not tremble; they need not live in fear, because we do not want to do anybody harm. All that we want is a square deal. (Cheers.) I repeat what I said last night, we have no animus against any race; we are not organizing to fight any race, but we are organized to demand the things that are ours, and we are not going to give them up, we do not care how much you preach to us. We do not care how much you beg us to be quiet, we are not going to be quiet until you give us 100 per cent. of what we ask for. (Cheers.) And now let me tell you that you are the strongest point, and that is why you have so many enemies now—because you have become so significant, you have become so powerful they cannot afford to ignore you. Can you not remember four years ago Marcus Garvey standing on a step-ladder on Lenox avenue? Can you not remember that not even the ordinary policeman on the beat paid any attention to Marcus Garvey? What a change! To think that at that time the ordinary policeman would not notice Marcus Garvey, and today the governments of the world are noticing and are afraid of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. (Cheers.) This Marcus Garvey that the ordinary policeman would not notice four years ago is causing governments to spend hundreds of dollars every day in cables asking where is Garvey. (Cheers.) Again I say, Garvey is still here, and “the more you look, the less you will see,” and I feel that with the grace of God and with the blessing of our Divine Master I will still be here until we see the Promised Land. (Cheers.) And let me tell you, men, the vision of the Promised Land is not so far off after all. We have brought pressure to bear; and let me tell you, there are certain things that I cannot say and you may better understand them not said, but let me tell you[,] you are at your strongest point, and that is why the fellows are so worried; keep up the work, keep it up! You cannot af[f]ord to lose time and the money and the sacrifice you have made, because you are coming near the turning point. They are feeling your pressure. Remember it is not only Liberty Hall, but it is the world of organized Negroes; that is where the pressure comes from. There was once Garvey talking on Lenox avenue; now it is a matter of Garvey and the Universal Negro Improvement Association talking to the world over. Some tourists went to Jamaica the other day and paid me a compliment by coming back to New York and writing in the *New York World*, I believe, that when they arrived in Jamaica all they could hear was discussions of President Wilson and Marcus Garvey. Before I got there some other tourists said all they could hear about was Marcus Garvey and the Black Star Line. Wheresoever they have gone and they have come back, they have said that. It shows that you have made an impression the world over. That is what we wanted; that is what we were organized for, and the question is now not only Liberty Hall,

New York, it is Liberty Hall everywhere. (Cheers.) They have been worried about Africa. My good friends, the British have said: "But why, this provisional president of Africa?" That is the thing that is troubling them. They do not know what part of Africa, and I won't tell them. (Laughter.)

That is all they are worried over. You have every cause to be satisfied with the work you have done. I have not given enough in money and in sacrifice to the Universal Negro Improvement Association because what has been done here already is enough satisfaction for me for all that I have done for the cause. Because wheresoever I go I see the change that has come about among Negroes. Negroes who used to submit to a kick and insult with a smile are standing up now and saying: "Man, what do you mean by it?" Not only in America, but through the West Indies and all through Central America; and if you once wear the colors of the Universal Negro Improvement Association—the red, the black and the green—nobody will molest you in Central America and in the West Indies. Do you know that during the war between Panama and Costa Rica⁶ the Costa Ricans invaded the Panamanian territory in Guabito, in the province of Almirante, in one particular section, and when they came they were looking for every Panamanian under the Panamanian flag, and the Panamanians ran out of the town and there was but one flag seen in that town of Guabito. It was the flag of the African republic—the red, the black and the green—and in the house over which that flag floated Panamanians and West Indians sheltered themselves for protection. When the Costa Ricans approached and asked what flag is that, the president of the division said "That is the flag of the republic of Africa." The Costa Ricans turned away and said "All right." (Cheers.) And for over forty-eight hours that was the only flag that gave protection to the Negro people who lived in that section called Guabito. It was the only recognized flag, and any man who sheltered himself under that flag was not disturbed. It proves to you the force and the potency of this great movement. And as the Costa Rican soldiers had to turn away from the flag, in another few years we are going to have any government who dares to think of insulting the Negro turn away from it.

The movement is strong and that is why we have so many enemies at work. And the other people—I am not blaming them for it because they are great diplomats and because they might be misinformed—they may be adopting methods to protect themselves, but they have nothing to protect themselves against, because we are not trying to interfere with them. We are endeavoring to do them no harm; we are only trying to organize ourselves in a peaceful manner for our own protection. So white folks need not fear of Negroes, because if Negroes did not trouble them in the past they will not trouble them now. If when they were beating Negroes and killing Negroes we did not get even with them, I do not see why Negroes should interfere with them so long as they go about their business and allow Negroes to go about their business. (Cheers.) What we are suffering from now is not the enmity of the white man; we are suffering from the treachery of Negroes. We are our own

enemies; that is all. The trouble we have had came not from the white man. Even in a few isolated cases where the white man shows up as the prosecutor he never originated the prosecution; it was the treacherous Negro who went there and begged him and worried him and induced him into doing what he did not care to do. Therefore I am not blaming the white people, because they are looking out for themselves, and Negroes will be fools if they do not look out for themselves. What I am engaged in doing is looking out for Negroes, because other folks are looking out for themselves. My embarrassment in not arriving in America before was because not through the white government of this country—not through the white men of this country—but because of the Negro traitors. The moment I left this country a certain class of men who had been fighting us all the time organized themselves into a band to influence this government by making misrepresentations to them to keep me out of the country because they feared the growing strength of the Universal Negro Improvement Association and the destruction of their hypocritical leadership. They found out that the people were getting away from them and that their positions were becoming unsafe, and they attributed it to the propagation of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, and for that reason they tried to destroy me, believing that if they smote the shepherd they would scatter the sheep. But, thank God, there are many shepherds of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, and though they may not be shepherds of long occupation they are shepherds anyhow who can hold the fort until somebody comes. And I think when I delegated the Right Hon. the High Chancel[1]or⁷ the position of presiding over the meetings in Liberty Hall I struck a shepherd who had backbone. (Turning to the High Chancellor) Sir, I am to thank you and all those who helped you for so successfully conducting the meetings of Liberty Hall. I waited longingly for every copy of *The Negro World* to see what was going on in Liberty Hall, and as I said last night, I decided to remain out for so long simply because of the splendid reports I saw from Liberty Hall. I saw you had control over the people here and I was satisfied that Liberty Hall was safe. About three weeks ago when I saw that you were admonishing the enemies and encouraging the members who were somewhat restless, it was only then that I decided that it was time to come home, and I came home in time to help and rescue the situation. I am here now and I am ready for the enemies.

Let me say, as heretofore, to the “big” Negroes of this country who have been fighting the Universal Negro Improvement Association; let me say to Dr. Du Bois; let me say to Bishop Smith of Detroit, that I am here, and you will have to reckon with me here for another four years. It may not be permanently four [y]ears, because I have to go and come between here, Africa and other parts; but you will have to reckon with me because when Marcus Garvey starts a fight he will not stop until he has finished completely. I never interfered with Dr. Du Bois; I never interfered with Bishop Smith, but I am willing to fight them to the bitter end, and I am saying to Dr. Du Bois, “I accept your challenge between here and Paris.” I accept Dr. Du Bois as the leader of the oppo-

sition to the Universal Negro Improvement Association's policy and program. There is much more in Dr. Du Bois' writing than you may see on the surface. Dr. Du Bois is the exponent of the reactionary class of men who have kept Negroes in serfdom and peonage. (Cheers.) My life is staked on the liberty and the freedom of the Negro everywhere. Dr. Du Bois will have the bitterest foe-man in Marcus Garvey in putting over his program to the detriment of the Negro peoples of the world. I realize that he represents a party of compromise; I realize that in this African proposition many projects are advanced for the purpose of destroying the ultimate aim and object of the U.N.I.A. and many methods are adopted to forestall us in this work in which we are engaged. I can see that beneath the surface of Dr. Du Bois' writings. He may be scholarly; he may be from Harvard; he may be from Yale, but Marcus Garvey has been through some of the best schools of the world, and above all the schools, he is a graduate of the "academy of the world." (Loud and prolonged cheers.) I feel sure that the final analysis—the official reckoning—that the Universal Negro Improvement Association will have nothing to be ashamed of, because millions of us have pledged that the Red, the Black and the Green shall never trail in the dust.

We have carried the association for four years, until today it is a recognized emblem everywhere. It is not only recognized by Negroes, but it is recognized by all other races, and it is more than all recognized by governments. We have nothing to be ashamed of. They talk about intelligence; they talk about education; if they want to see intelligence; if they want to see education, they will have to come into the ranks of the Universal Negro Improvement Association. (Cheers.) Their talk about education is all a farce—is all bosh. It is only one of the ways and one of the methods for the purpose of prejudicing the minds of the people against the leadership of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, though they know well they cannot stand against the intellectuality of the U.N.I.A. I did it several months ago, and again I give out a challenge to Dr. Du Bois, graduate of Harvard and Yale as you are, to meet me on the platform of Liberty Hall at midnight, at noon time, or any time, and I will make you look like a bit of cotton. (Cheers.) If you think your education so superior this is your chance to defeat Marcus Garvey and close his mouth forever. That is my challenge to Dr. Du Bois and the class of men who call themselves intellectuals. Let them meet me if not on the platform of Liberty Hall, anywhere. I am willing to meet them anywhere, at any time, under any circumstances. I will be satisfied even to give them their own judge and jury. That is as far as I can go.

Let it be known, men, that before this convention of 1921 adjourns we feel sure that we will so legislate and so act that it will be impossible for traitors to be able to damage the Universal Negro Improvement Association after the 31st of August. I have to thank you for your presence here tonight, and let me reassure you that the Universal Negro Improvement Association is a moving power that has already encircled the world. I have again to thank you for the

splendid support, morally and financially, that you have given this great cause. I pray God's blessing on you. I trust He will guide and help you so that you will continue the work you have started. Good night! I hope to see you tomorrow night, when I will speak on the subject of the Black Star Line. (Cheers.)

Printed in *NW*, 30 July 1921. Original headlines omitted.

1. This speech appeared as part of the article, "Marcus Garvey and Miss H. V. Davis Tell Thrilling Story of Trip to West Indies and Central America."

2. The issue of the *NW* that would have contained the report of Garvey's speech has not survived.

3. Dr. Alfredo Zayas y Alfonso (1861–1934) was president of the Cuban Republic from 20 May 1921 to 20 May 1925. Earlier in his career in 1907, he represented the revolutionary part in Havana, his birthplace. He was also politically active in Cuban American relations at that time (Willis Fletcher Johnson, *History of Cuba* [New York: Buck, 1920]; Clifford L. Staten, *The History of Cuba* [Westport: Greenwood, 2003]).

4. The 1927 census listed 17,245 Jamaicans living in Costa Rica, most of whom were employees of the UFC in Limón Province. Jamaican immigration to Costa Rica and Panama was cyclical, beginning in the 1870s and reaching a peak in the decades from 1881 to 1891 and from 1911 to 1921 (Michael D. Olien, "The Adaptation of West Indian Blacks to North American and Hispanic Culture in Costa Rica," in Annon Pescatello, ed., *Old Roots in New Lands* [Westport, Conn.: Greenwood Press, 1977]; Roy S. Bryce-Laporte, "West Indian Labor in Central America: Limón, Costa Rica, 1870–1948," Paper presented at the symposium "The Political Economy of the Black World," Center for Afro-American Studies, University of California, Los Angeles, May 1979).

5. George C. Reneau was a black merchant in Puerto Barrios who purchased two hundred shares of BSL stock in 1920 (*NWCB*, 7 August 1920).

6. The long-standing border dispute between Costa Rica and Panama erupted on 21 February 1921, when a small contingent of Costa Rican troops invaded the town of Coto in the province of Chiriqui. Panama recaptured Coto, prompting a Costa Rican retaliation on Guabito and Almirante on 4 March 1921. The UFC, whose headquarters at Port Limón had been attacked, provided food and transportation to the Costa Rican forces (William D. McCain, *The United States and the Republic of Panama* [New York: Russell & Russell, 1965]).

7. A reference to Gabriel E. Stewart.

J. A. Sergeant,¹ President, UNIA
Penal Division, Trinidad, to J. R. Ralph Casimir

[[Trinidad]] UNIA & A.C.L.

Penal Division² No. 260

22: July 1921

Dear Brother

You must have [some?] excuse for not answering your kind note [before?] is because I were absent from home a few days at any rate I know that won[']t change our feelings. Well regards of your passage going back to your native home it is the duty of all the [Divs.] in this Island to do their best in the one & Common cause Especially today when we watch before us Africa is to be redeem & so I [&] mine shall do our best to assist you will please infor[m] Lady Philip she will hear from me early our ad. Board is meeting on Friday evening 22nd, [toward?] that sister I told her that you seems to love her she said

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she notice such since up at Guaico. at any rate since then only once I happened to see her all is good [A]cept our best love & Respect Yours Fraternally

J. A. SERGEANT

[*Handwritten note in margin:*] Please ask the Sect. to send me 1 or 2 disbursement sheet—I am out

JRRC. ALS, recipient's copy.

1. J. A. Sergeant was president of the Penal branch of the UNIA (Tony Martin, "Marcus Garvey and Trinidad, 1912-1947," in *The Pan-African Connection: From Slavery to Garvey and Beyond* [Dover, Mass.: Schenkman Publishing Company, 1983], p. 88).

2. Penal is a predominantly Indian settlement in the south of Trinidad. Its occupation was begun in the early years of the twentieth century as Indians left the sugar estates upon the expiration of their terms of indenture.

Article in the *Negro World*

[New York, July 26, 1921]

THE U.N.I.A. SPREADING IN HAITI

SECRETARY GENERAL U.N.I.A., NEW YORK CITY
CHARTER DIVISION NO.1 OF PORT-AU-PRINCE, HAITI

REPORT:

Dear Sir-I arrived at Port-au-Prince on the thirtieth day of June with the charter of the Port-au-Prince Division, and found the population in high anticipation of the future.

After getting in contact with the members of the association, each refused to attend our public meetings unless I was officially granted authorization by the Haitian Government to hold our meetings.

On the refusal of the members to come together I immediately wrote a letter to the Haitian Minister of the Interior, asking him for the authorization which would empower me to hold our public meetings without trouble.

In response thereto he gave me in his letter of July 14 full authority to hold our meetings throughout the Republic. Notwithstanding, the people were afraid to come to the meetings, apprehending the possibility of arrest by the American authorities.¹

Certain American articles having stated that the Hon. Marcus Garvey would not be allowed to reenter the U.S.A. In order to convince the people that the newspapers were mistaken with the respect to the stand that they had taken against Marcus Garvey, I was obliged to reply to the article through one

of our leading newspapers—"Le Nouvelliste." After the publication of the article we held our first meeting on the 13th July and the second meeting on the 14th.

In this last meeting I made an address on reconstruction, the reconstruction of the power of our branch. A vote of confidence was given to our Provisional President and Delegate, who is leaving Port-au-Prince in order to attend the Second Annual Convention of the U.N.I.A. to be held in Liberty Hall, New York.

We have asked our Delegate to be the bearer of greetings to all members of the Society as well as to our Potentate and President-General and members of the Executive Board.

We have likewise asked our Delegate to express our deep regrets of the present financial situation which does not permit us to give either to our Delegate or to the Mother Society all the satisfaction that we would like. We hope to catch up our headway within a very short time and again be abreast of all records.

Our Delegate has quite a number of projects to present at the Convention for the benefit of the U.N.I.A. We are confident that the Convention will ratify all plans which our Delegate will submit for the benefit of our people.

The meeting was closed with the National Anthem and the meeting adjourned at 1 A.M.

Be good enough to publish the correspondence which I herewith enclose and which was received by the U.N.I.A. Branch at Port-au-Prince, Haiti.

I have the honor to be,
Yours very truly,
Napoleon J. Francis.
President U.N.I.A. and Delegate
D. Smith, Secretary.

P.S.-In the meeting of the 13th July the charter was turned over to the Branch; 14 of our members were present.

An appropriate speech was made by our Delegate who was about to sail for New York.

Port-au-Prince, 7th July, 1921.
Secrétaire d'Etat du Département de l'Intérieur, Il son Hotel.

Mr. Secretary of State:-

I have the honor to inform you that a branch of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, African Communities League, has been founded in this city, and that the charter thereof bears the number 336.

Mr. Secretary of State, I need not put before you the purpose of this Association as you are already aware of its aims. This Association is designed to work for the evolution of the Black Race.

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In this connection the Association is going to reorganize its works, we therefore beg for our authorization for the purpose of holding our different meetings.

In the expectation that you will not fail to respond to our call.

Receive, Mr. Secretary of State, our distinguished salutations.

N.J. Francis
Republic of Haiti
Secrétariat d'Etat de l'Intérieur
591 Rio C.S.
Port-au-Prince, 13 Juillet, 1921.

A. Monsieur Napoleon J. Francis,
Vice-President and General Agent of the International American Development Association, Incorporated, Port-au-Prince.

Mr. General Agent:-It is advantageous to me to acknowledge the receipt of your letter of the 7th July by which you have brought to notice of my Department that the branch of the Universal Negro Improvement Association, African Communities League, has been founded at Port-au-Prince, the charter of which bears the number 336.

In taking good note of your communications relative to same, my Department informs you that the authorization solicited by you has been granted.

Receive, Mr. General Agent, the assurance of my perfect consideration.

(Signed) B. Dartiguenave

Printed in NW, 3 September 1921.

1. The Haitians' fear of repression by U.S. Marines stems from the U.S. occupation of Haiti that began in 1915. The United States' occupation of Haiti commenced on 28 July 1915, when 330 U.S. Marines stormed the beach in what was intended as a short-term measure. This invasion was, however, actually part of the U.S. government's strategy to secure empire and preserve its economic dominance over Haiti. While Woodrow Wilson justified the occupation on moral grounds, based on a series of riots and coups in recent years, the invasion actually stemmed from the culmination of a series of political and economic factors. The Haitian government owed large sums of money to the National City Bank in New York, and the United States wanted Haiti's constitution modified to allow Americans to purchase land. Further, the occupation served as a strategic political move, since the United States feared that Germany might establish submarine bases that would threaten U.S. shipping and the Panama Canal.

The marines quickly crushed several immediate attempts by Haitians at armed resistance and, in April 1916, U.S. forces dissolved the Haitian Senate. Haitian rebel units, led by Charlemagne Peralte, formed beginning in 1917, angered by a new U.S. law that revived the practice of conscripted labor. In 1919, as many as forty thousand Haitians seized control of the country's northern region. However, the U.S. Marines' repression of this resistance movement involved air support; the fighting continued from March until the end of the year, by which time U.S. forces had killed over three thousand Haitians. Throughout this period, the marines' racism and fears of further Haitian uprisings led them to commit repeated atrocities on Haitian peasants and resisters alike. Stories of these atrocities surfaced in 1920, and Congress launched a formal inquiry in response. Nonetheless, Haiti's formal occupation by U.S. troops continued until 1936 (Hans Schmidt, *The United States Occupation of Haiti, 1915-1934* [New Brunswick, N.J.: Rutgers University Press, 1971]; Rubin Francis Weston, *Racism in U.S. Imperialism: The Influence of Racial Assumptions on American Foreign Policy, 1893-1946* [Columbia: University of South Carolina Press, 1972]; David Healy,

Gunboat Diplomacy in the Wilson Era: The U.S. Navy in Haiti, 1915–1916 [Madison: University of Wisconsin Press, 1976]; Michel-Rolph Trouillot, *Haiti: State against Nation* [New York: Monthly Review Press, 1990], pp. 101–102; Mary A. Renda, *Taking Haiti: Military Occupation and the Culture of U.S. Imperialism, 1915–1940* [Chapel Hill: University of North Carolina Press, 2001]; Robert Fatton, *The Roots of Haitian Despotism* [Boulder, Colo.: Lynne Rienner, 2007]; Laurent Dubois, *Haiti: The Aftershocks of History* [New York: Henry Holt, 2012]).

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A Note on the Index

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When there are variant spellings of a name, the spelling that seems most nearly correct or is most often used in the cited sources is given. Married names are enclosed in parentheses, e.g., “Ashwood, Amy (Garvey).”

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